Research report after round 6. The run is still in progress: this is the report text as it stands after this round, text only, with no figures. The results and the writing are not final.

Where a Prompt Ban Sends a Code Model, and What Else Moves Its Algorithm Choice

This report is the internal record of a study of algorithmic diversity in an open-weight instruction-tuned model. The question that started the run is how "creativity" shows up inside a language model and whether it can be influenced: if a model is asked to implement a path search algorithm, does it always write the same one, and which knobs (sampling temperature, random context seeds, instructions, prohibitions, or edits to the activations) change the algorithm rather than only its wording. The behavioural puzzle comes from the inspiration repository by Drejc Pesjak that the request names, in which a closed model wrote Dijkstra's algorithm for a weighted shortest path task in 125 of 125 programs across five prompting strategies, and cumulative bans moved it to SPFA and Bellman-Ford rather than to a spread of alternatives. The same collapse appears in controlled measurements across 15 model configurations, where a no cue prompt gives Dijkstra 94.1% of the time [1], and in broader benchmarks of algorithmic diversity among correct programs [2, 3].

The hypothesis entering the run is mechanistic. When an instruction-tuned model is told not to use its default solution, the prohibition is expected to do two things: suppress the banned algorithm and promote the alternative the model associates with it, so the output collapses again on one predictable substitute instead of spreading over the repertoire. This mirrors the suppression plus promotion account of negation on factual questions [4]. Competing accounts say the substitute is chosen by baseline typicality, by proximity on an activation space solution manifold, by a few early forking tokens during generation, by a single list versus implement commitment direction, or that the whole collapse was installed by post-training. The report records, iteration by iteration, which of these the evidence supported and which it did not. All work so far uses Qwen3-8B [5] with thinking mode off unless stated, on the request's two path search tasks. *(Note added in iteration 2: iteration 2 adds Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22] and a bench of 13 further coding tasks; Sections 2.7 and 2.8.) (Note added in iteration 6: iteration 6 adds Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct, read with natural language autoencoders, and gemma-3-4b-it, read with Gemma Scope 2 sparse autoencoders; Sections 6.5 and 6.6.)* The hypothesis reached its tested form after seven rounds of drafting and review before any experiment ran; the reviewer's overall score across the rounds was 5, 6, 6, 7, 7, 7 and 7, and the final round scored soundness 3, presentation 3, contribution 3 and fidelity 4.

Iteration 1: a wide screen of six accounts on the two path search tasks

1.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The first iteration was planned as a screen rather than a test. The hypothesis carried four alternates that disagree with it about what decides the algorithm written after a ban, and none of them had been measured. The strategy therefore ran every account cheaply and in parallel on the same events, with one shared protocol, one per-sample output schema and a selection rule fixed before any artifact ran, and it left inference to a later confirmation on reserved tasks. The selection rule had two columns. The PREDICT column scores each account's forecast of the distribution after a ban, committed by sha256 hash before sampling, by its log score on the realised compliant

samples; an account survives if its mean log score beats the next best account by at least 0.10 nats on at least 3 events where the accounts' top-1 nominations disagree. The BUY column scores each knob by the correctness conditioned Hill number it reaches while keeping at least 80% of the baseline pass rate; a knob survives if it beats the next best knob by at least 0.5 effective algorithms. *(Correction, iteration 2: as written in the strategy, the PREDICT rule scores only informative events, those with the banned mode present at 10% or more of the latent baseline, compliance of at least 50% and at least two survivors, and the BUY rule names a winner only if it leads on the pooled tasks and in direction on each task. This paragraph omitted both conditions, and Section 1.11 applied the rules without them. Sections 2.3.6 and 2.3.7 recompute both.)* A third check, the locus diagnostic, asks where the algorithm decision is made: it would move every geometric analysis from the read position (the last prompt token, Section 1.2) to generated-token states if a decoder at a forking token beat the read position decoder by 20 points over a shuffled label control. The strategy also stated in advance that nothing in this iteration would be inferential.

Seven artifacts ran: one dataset and six experiments, each owning one account (Table 1). We call each experiment by the account it screens: the association, geometry, forking token, decommitment and instruction tuning experiments, and the decoding experiment, which covers sampling temperature, random seeds and creativity instructions. The strategy asked the dataset artifact to build a reserved bench of 12 further tasks with hidden tests, labellers and forecasts frozen before any ban, so that the account that survived the screen could be confirmed out of sample in the next iteration.

Table 1. The seven artifacts of iteration 1, the account each was asked to screen, and the knob or predictor it contributed.

Artifact	Account screened	Predictor (PREDICT column)	Knob (BUY column)
Dataset: source data for an algorithm-choice bench	none (reserved bench for confirmation)	none	none
Association experiment	substitution by association vs typicality ladder	Borda association map; latent baseline frequency	single and cumulative prompt bans
Geometry experiment	proximity on the read position manifold; shift decomposition	geodesic kernel; read position decoder	affine directional ablation of the modal algorithm
Forking token experiment	algorithm fixed at forking tokens during generation	none	temperature raised only around forking tokens
Decommitment experiment	one list versus implement direction controls collapse	decommitted survivor distribution	activation addition of the decommitment direction
Instruction tuning experiment	post-training installed the collapse	base-model survivor distribution	subtraction of the instruct minus base direction
Decoding experiment	temperature and random seeds change wording, not ideas	none	temperature and top-k, seeds, creativity instructions, generate then select

1.2 Shared setup and the conventions used in this report

Tasks. Both tasks come from the request. The grid task asks for `solve(grid, start, goal)` returning any valid 4-neighbour path on a grid of free and blocked cells, or an empty list when the goal is unreachable. Its catalogue has six algorithms, that is, breadth-first search (BFS), depth-first

search (DFS), bidirectional BFS, iterative-deepening DFS (IDDFS), A* or greedy best-first search with a Manhattan heuristic (A* in tables), and unit weight Dijkstra. The shortest path task asks for the shortest distance from s to t in a directed graph with nonnegative integer weights and cycles, or -1. Its catalogue has five algorithms: Dijkstra, Bellman-Ford or SPFA (counted as one algorithm), bidirectional Dijkstra, Floyd-Warshall and Dial's bucket queue. Every experiment wrote its own hidden tests (between 39 and 48 cases per task) with a time limit of ten times the slowest reference implementation and a 1 s minimum, and every catalogue reference had to pass before any model sample was scored.

Model and decoding. Qwen3-8B in bf16 with the chat template and thinking off, sampled at temperature 1.0 with top-p 1.0 and no top-k unless a table says otherwise. Engines differed between artifacts because the containers had no C compiler: vLLM 0.11.0 [6] in eager mode in five experiments (association, forking token, decommitment, instruction tuning and decoding), and HF transformers `generate` in the geometry experiment and in the hooked steering arms. GPUs were an RTX 5090 (association and decoding experiments), an NVIDIA GPU with 23 GB of memory (geometry and instruction tuning experiments) or an RTX A4500 (forking token and decommitment experiments).

Prompts. Every prompt is a condition segment, then a fixed task specification of at least 50 tokens, then the assistant header. The read position is the last prompt token, so no token specific to a condition sits at or near it. The conditions shared by all experiments are the baseline (no condition segment or a neutral one), a ban (`Do not use X.`), the mention twin and the listing control. The mention twin (`X is one well-known approach to this task; implement any correct algorithm.`) puts the same name at the same place without forbidding it, because naming a forbidden item can itself prime it [7]. We call the condition that names every catalogue algorithm the listing control. Each condition segment has 10 paraphrases, and N = 100 means 10 paraphrases with 10 samples each. Each experiment wrote its own paraphrases.

Labels and correctness. Each program is labelled with one catalogue algorithm or "other" by a runtime signature tracer (the program runs on crafted inputs with instrumented heaps, queues, stacks and grid reads) and by AST rules; disagreements go to a blind LLM judge on OpenRouter. Recursion versus iteration never counts as a separate algorithm. A program is correct when it passes the hidden tests within the limit. Intervals on proportions are Wilson score intervals [8] unless stated.

Quantities. We use the following names throughout. The *banned mode share* is the fraction of all coded samples labelled as the banned algorithm. A *compliant sample* is a correct program not labelled as a banned algorithm. The *realised mode* of a ban is the most common label among compliant samples if it leads the next most common label by at least 15 points; otherwise we call the event one with no clear mode. The *correctness conditioned Hill number* (Hill_cc) is the exponential of the Shannon entropy of the label distribution over correct programs, the effective number of algorithms [9]; a value of 1 means one algorithm and 2 means two equally common ones. The *log score* of a predictor on a ban event is the mean natural logarithm of the probability it assigned to the labels of the realised compliant samples, after mixing in 5% uniform mass over the surviving algorithms and a 2% floor for "other". It is a strictly proper scoring rule [10]; higher is better, and a uniform predictor over four survivors scores -1.406. Artifacts reported a quantity they called compliance in two different ways (one minus the banned mode share, or the fraction of compliant samples), so this report states the banned mode share and the number of compliant samples instead, recomputed from each artifact's per-sample rows.

Labeller validation. Each experiment validated its own labeller against a gold set adjudicated by two or three LLM judges, with Cohen's kappa [11] between the runtime and AST labels as the main agreement statistic. Table 2 collects the results. Four labellers passed their gates and two did not. Both failures were driven by runtime versus AST disagreement on small gold sets. The combined label (runtime, AST and judge) still agreed with the adjudicated label on 97% of gold programs in the association experiment, and on 93% (grid) and 70% (shortest path) in the decoding experiment, 92% on its correct gold programs.

Table 2. Labeller validation per experiment, as each artifact reported it (gold set sizes per task).

Experiment	Gold programs (Grid / Shortest path)	Kappa runtime vs AST	Runtime vs adjudicated	Combined label vs adjudicated	References correct	Gate
Association	50 / 42 (evaluation split; 92 pooled)	0.753 pooled	0.843 pooled	0.966 pooled	22/22	failed (targets 0.8 and 0.9)
Geometry	28 / 26	0.902 / 0.938	0.964 / 0.923	not reported	100%	passed
Forking token	24 / 23	1.0 / 0.847	1.0 / 0.913	1.0 / 1.0	9/9, 8/8 (AST; Dial has no runtime signature)	passed
Decommitment	10 baseline + 6 steered + references + 2 outside the catalogue per task	1.00 / 0.82	1.00 / 0.92	1.00 / 1.00	12/12	passed after two revision rounds on Shortest path
Instruction tuning	25 references and mutants; 40 audit programs	0.77 over all parseable programs	runtime never wrong on references	kappa between judges 0.93	AST 100%	passed (reference gate)
Decoding	30 / 30	0.337 / 0.111 on gold; 0.881 / 0.851 over all programs	not reported	0.933 / 0.70 (0.917 / 0.923 on correct gold programs)	9/9, 7/7	failed (strict criteria)

1.3 The dataset artifact: source data, not yet a bench

The dataset artifact was asked for a validated 12-task bench and delivered the raw material for one. It ran 98 Hugging Face Hub queries (574 unique datasets), screened 25 candidates plus the inspiration repository, and kept ten sources at pinned revisions, 61,469 examples in total (Table 3). For the 20 bench problems that LeetCode covers it parsed every I/O pair and reran the reference solutions, which passed 20 of 20. The LRU cache and streaming median problems are absent from LeetCodeDataset, so their tests must be generated.

Table 3. Sources kept by the dataset artifact (counts recomputed from `full_data_out.json`).

Source	Examples	Role in the planned bench
LeetCodeDataset [12]	2,869	problem texts, references and parsed I/O pairs for 20 bench problems
Mercury [13]	440	human solutions with runtimes for 20 bench problems, including LRU cache and median

inspiration repository (Drejc Pesjak)	225	labels of the repository's shortest path programs (Dijkstra 132, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 34, bidirectional 30, other 21, Dial 5, A* 2, Floyd-Warshall 1); code not redistributed (no licence)
TheAlgorithms/Python	1,354	MIT implementations, 55 labelled by hand by task and algorithm
CLRS-Text [14]	2,910	execution traces of 15 catalogue algorithms for tracer tests
HumanEval+ [15]	164	harness validation
ENAMEL [16]	164	efficient references with input generators for time limits
Concreteness norms [17, 18]	39,954	718 neutral nouns for neutral twins and context seeds
KodCode [19]	2,767	tested solutions, 253 naming a catalogue algorithm
XLCoST [20]	10,622	GeeksforGeeks programs, 209 naming a catalogue algorithm

The frozen task specifications, hidden tests filtered against the specification, labellers, gold sets and forecasts frozen before any ban were not built. The reserved bench on which the strategy meant to confirm the surviving account next iteration therefore does not exist yet, and the confirmation step has to build it first. No LLM calls were made and the spend was zero.

1.4 The baseline collapse, measured six times

Every experiment drew its own baseline, so the collapse was measured six times with different paraphrases, test suites and engines (Table 4; association, geometry, forking token, decommitment, instruction tuning and decoding experiments). Of 1,200 baseline programs on the grid task, 1,199 are BFS. Of 1,200 on the shortest path task, 1,174 are Dijkstra (97.8%), above the 94.1% no cue prior [1]. The few non-modal programs came from three experiments, and the decommitment experiment's baseline was the least collapsed. A further 200 samples per task at temperature 1.3 in the association experiment were also 100% BFS and 100% Dijkstra.

Table 4. Baseline label counts per experiment (all coded samples; pass = share passing the hidden tests).

Experiment (engine)	Grid N	Grid labels	Grid pass	Shortest path N	Shortest path labels	Shortest path pass
Association (vLLM)	300	BFS 300	0.933	300	Dijkstra 300	1.00
Geometry (HF)	200	BFS 200	0.99	200	Dijkstra 200	1.00
Forking token (vLLM)	200	BFS 200	0.91	200	Dijkstra 200	0.995
Decommitment (vLLM)	200	BFS 200	1.00	200	Dijkstra 181, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 14, Dial 4, other 1	0.885
Instruction tuning (vLLM)	200	BFS 200	1.00	200	Dijkstra 193, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	1.00
Decoding (vLLM)	100	BFS 99, unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.97	100	Dijkstra 100	0.99

The collapse makes one of the planned predictors uninformative before any ban runs. The typicality ladder predicts that a ban redistributes mass in proportion to each survivor's baseline frequency. Every survivor's baseline frequency was zero in the association, geometry and forking token experiments and at most 7% elsewhere (Bellman-Ford/SPFA, 14 of 200 in the decommitment experiment), so the frequency forecast is uniform wherever the baseline is fully collapsed and its top-1 nomination is a tie. The preregistered presence strata are empty for the same reason: no catalogue algorithm other than the default reached the 10% presence cut, so every non-modal single ban is a ban of an absent algorithm.

1.5 Association experiment: does the alternative the model names predict where a ban lands?

Why. This experiment screened the main hypothesis against its behavioural rival. The main hypothesis predicts the algorithm written after a ban from the model's association between algorithms; the typicality ladder predicts it from baseline frequencies restricted to the survivors. Both predictors were elicited and frozen before any ban prompt was generated, and every prediction file was chained by sha256 hash before the samples it predicts. The commitment audit found the chain intact and every event committed in advance (commit at 15:18:30 UTC, first ban generation at 15:20:05 UTC).

Design. The latent baseline was N = 300 per task at temperature 1.0, plus 200 samples at temperature 1.3 and 50 without the neutral condition segment. The association map was elicited on separate queries with thinking off: for each of the 11 catalogue algorithms X, the model returned 20 sampled complete rankings of the other algorithms by the criterion `how standard an alternative to X for this task`, aggregated by Borda count (each ranking gives an alternative points according to its rank) with one extra point per algorithm. We call the normalised result the *association map* A(X); its winner is the association nomination. The *clarity* of X is the share of the 20 rankings whose alternative ranked first is the Borda winner, and Kendall's W [21] measures agreement across the 20 rankings. The model also gave 20 free-form answers to the question `what is the standard alternative to X?`, and Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22] repeated the whole elicitation as an external map. The ban arms were all 11 single bans at N = 100, the mention twin of each at N = 50, the listing control at N = 100 and a greedy succession that bans the realised mode of each step cumulatively, in the manner of denial prompting [23]. Generation used vLLM on one RTX 5090 (about 6 GPU minutes); OpenRouter spend was USD 0.27 for the judge, gold set adjudication and the external elicitation.

The association maps. Table 5 gives the map for every catalogue algorithm. The two maps that matter are those of the defaults. For BFS, the model's rankings spread the Borda mass almost evenly over unit weight Dijkstra, bidirectional BFS and A*, with DFS ranked last; clarity was 0.20, the lowest of all 11 algorithms. Yet 19 of its 20 free-form answers named DFS. For Dijkstra, all 20 rankings put Bellman-Ford/SPFA first (clarity 1.0). The map from Llama agreed with the Borda winner of Qwen for 5 of 6 grid algorithms and 4 of 5 shortest path algorithms, and its map for BFS tied DFS and IDDFS on top.

Table 5. Association maps from the association experiment. Borda shares of the top alternative, clarity (share of 20 rankings whose first choice is the Borda winner), Kendall's W across the 20 rankings, the modal free-form answer (out of 20), and the external (Llama-3.1-8B) Borda winner and clarity.

Task	X	Qwen Borda winner (share)	Clarity	Kendall's W	Qwen free-form (count/20)	Llama Borda winner	Llama clarity
Grid	BFS	unit weight Dijkstra (0.293); bidir BFS 0.283, A* 0.263, IDDFS 0.107, DFS 0.054	0.20	0.52	DFS (19)	DFS = IDDFS (0.251)	0.368
Grid	DFS	BFS (0.395)	1.0	0.577	BFS (20)	BFS	0.684
Grid	bidirectional BFS	BFS (0.38)	0.9	0.454	A* (11)	BFS	0.70

Grid	IDDFS	BFS (0.395)	1.0	0.513	BFS (18)	BFS	0.60
Grid	A*	BFS (0.385)	0.9	0.70	BFS (20)	BFS	0.60
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	BFS (0.395)	1.0	0.589	BFS (18)	BFS	0.75
Shortest path	Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.492); Floyd-Warshall 0.226, bidir Dijkstra 0.153, Dial 0.129	1.0	0.639	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 8, other 8, self 4	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.65
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	Dijkstra (0.435)	0.65	0.573	self 15, Dijkstra 5	Dijkstra	0.65
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	Dijkstra (0.492)	1.0	0.981	Dijkstra (20)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.40
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	Dijkstra (0.444)	0.7	0.916	Dijkstra (20)	Dijkstra	0.55
Shortest path	Dial	Dijkstra (0.492)	1.0	0.841	Dijkstra (20)	Dijkstra	0.65

The Borda winners of the two models matched at a rate of 0.833 on the grid task and 0.8 on the shortest path task, with a mean Kendall tau (rank agreement between the two models' rankings) of 0.362 and 0.765. A post hoc map from gpt-4.1-mini, collected after the freeze and so not a contest predictor, showed the same split for BFS: its Borda winner was bidirectional BFS while its free-form answer was DFS. The artifact's reading is that the ranking question elicits the closest shortest path variant of BFS rather than the alternative a programmer reaches for.

What the bans did. Table 6 gives every condition of the experiment. The two modal bans were largely obeyed in this experiment: 10 of 100 grid programs and 9 of 100 shortest path programs still used the banned algorithm. Every compliant program landed on one substitute, DFS for the grid task (38 of 38) and Bellman-Ford/SPFA for the shortest path task (86 of 86). The low pass rate of the grid ban (0.46) comes from the DFS programs: 52 of 90 failed the hidden tests (43 wrong answers, 7 timeouts, 2 runtime errors), and forced DFS implementations passed only 3 of 10 times.

Table 6. Every condition in the association experiment (labels over all coded samples; Hill_cc over correct programs).

Task	Condition	N	Labels	Pass rate	Hill_cc
Grid	baseline	300	BFS 300	0.933	1.0
Grid	baseline, T = 1.3	200	BFS 200	0.895	1.0
Grid	baseline, no condition segment	50	BFS 50	0.94	1.0
Grid	ban BFS (modal)	100	DFS 90, BFS 10	0.46	1.587
Grid	ban DFS	100	BFS 96, DFS 4	0.88	1.115
Grid	ban bidirectional BFS	100	BFS 99, other 1	0.92	1.0
Grid	ban IDDFS	100	BFS 88, DFS 12	0.80	1.220
Grid	ban A*	100	BFS 100	0.72	1.0
Grid	ban unit weight Dijkstra	100	BFS 92, DFS 8	0.71	1.137
Grid	listing control	100	BFS 97, DFS 3	0.92	1.0
Grid	mention BFS	50	BFS 50	1.00	1.0
Grid	mention DFS	50	DFS 50	0.30	1.0
Grid	mention bidirectional BFS	50	BFS 43, bidirectional BFS 5, other 2	0.72	1.405
Grid	mention IDDFS	50	IDDFS 36, DFS 14	0.18	1.417

Grid	mention A*	50	A* 28, BFS 12, unit weight Dijkstra 8, DFS 2	0.82	2.756
Grid	mention unit weight Dijkstra	50	BFS 50	0.90	1.0
Grid	succession step 2 (ban BFS and DFS)	100	DFS 79, BFS 15, unit weight Dijkstra 4, A* 1, IDDFS 1	0.53	2.278
Shortest path	baseline	300	Dijkstra 300	1.00	1.0
Shortest path	baseline, T = 1.3	200	Dijkstra 200	1.00	1.0
Shortest path	baseline, no condition segment	50	Dijkstra 50	1.00	1.0
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra (modal)	100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 90, Dijkstra 9, other 1	0.95	1.368
Shortest path	ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA	100	Dijkstra 94, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5, other 1	0.93	1.061
Shortest path	ban bidirectional Dijkstra	100	Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.00	1.144
Shortest path	ban Dial	100	Dijkstra 95, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	0.97	1.106
Shortest path	ban Floyd-Warshall	100	Dijkstra 77, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 23	0.71	1.191
Shortest path	listing control	100	Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.00	1.144
Shortest path	mention Dijkstra	50	Dijkstra 50	1.00	1.0
Shortest path	mention Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 50	0.84	1.0
Shortest path	mention bidirectional Dijkstra	50	Dijkstra 50	0.30	1.0
Shortest path	mention Dial	50	Dijkstra 50	1.00	1.0
Shortest path	mention Floyd-Warshall	50	Floyd-Warshall 43, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	0.88	1.115
Shortest path	succession step 2 (ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA)	100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 65, Dijkstra 35	0.85	1.960

(Added in iteration 2: the caption says every condition, but the experiment also ran eleven forced implementation conditions of 10 samples each, which this table omits; they are given in Table 50, Section 2.3.10. Forced IDDFS passed 0 of 10, forced Dial 0 of 10, and forced bidirectional Dijkstra was written as plain Dijkstra 10 of 10 times.)

The forecast contest. Only the two modal bans were informative events, since every other ban removed an algorithm the model never produced. Table 7 scores every predictor on them. The association map missed the grid event, where it nominated unit weight Dijkstra and ranked DFS last, and hit the shortest path event. Against the uniform frequency forecast it lost by 1.188 nats per sample on the grid event and won by 0.652 on the shortest path event, a mean of -0.268 (association wins 1 of 2). The two predictors that hit both events were not in the preregistered contest: the model's own free-form answer and what we define as the listing control distribution, the label distribution the model produces when every catalogue name is listed. Their log scores were close to zero.

Table 7. Forecast contest on the two informative events of the association experiment (raw log score in nats per compliant sample; top-1 nomination in brackets; chance top-1 is 1/5 and 1/4).

Predictor	Grid ban BFS (38 compliant, all DFS)	Shortest path ban Dijkstra (86 compliant, all Bellman-Ford/SPFA)	Mean log score
Association map, Borda (preregistered)	-2.817 (unit weight Dijkstra, miss)	-0.755 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA, hit)	-1.786
Association map, first rank counts	-2.474 (bidirectional BFS, miss)	-0.190 (hit)	-1.332
External map, Llama-3.1-8B Borda	-1.412 (DFS/IDDFS tie)	-0.928 (hit)	-1.170
Latent frequency (typicality ladder)	-1.630 (tie over all survivors)	-1.406 (tie)	-1.518
Free-form answer (standard alternative question)	-0.112 (DFS, hit)	-0.058 (hit)	-0.085
Listing control distribution	-0.061 (DFS, hit)	-0.058 (hit)	-0.060

The family test, which the hypothesis treats as its direct test of substitution against subtraction, was degenerate here. It fits a substitution family (a point mass on the association winner with a uniform leak) and a subtraction family (the baseline restricted to the survivors) on half of an event's compliant samples and scores both on the other half. Because the baseline gave zero mass to every survivor, the subtraction family was uniform: the grid event was a tie at -1.63 and the shortest path event went to substitution (-0.058 against -1.406). With one decisive event the family test says nothing about the hypothesis.

Mention twins are recommendations. The mention twin was meant as a placebo that carries the name without the prohibition. It is not one. Mentioning an absent algorithm moved 100 points of mass to DFS and to Bellman-Ford/SPFA, 86 points to Floyd-Warshall, 72 to IDDFS and 56 to A*, and 10 to bidirectional BFS; it moved nothing for unit weight Dijkstra on grids, Dial and bidirectional Dijkstra. Several mentioned algorithms were then implemented badly (mention DFS passed 0.30, mention IDDFS 0.18, mention bidirectional Dijkstra 0.30).

The sham ban control. Bans of absent algorithms were planned as a negative control that should match the mention twin. Because the mention twin recommends, the comparison inverts (Table 8): a sham ban kept the default at 77-100%, while its mention twin moved the model to the mentioned algorithm whenever the model could write it. None of the nine sham events was equivalent to its twin under the paraphrase null, whose 95th percentile was 0.003 bits. Against the baseline, sham bans moved some mass toward a related algorithm: banning Floyd-Warshall gave 23% Bellman-Ford/SPFA, banning IDDFS 12% DFS.

Table 8. Sham bans (bans of absent algorithms) against their mention twins. JS is the Jensen-Shannon divergence, that is, a symmetric and bounded divergence in bits between the two label distributions; the default's share is BFS on the grid task and Dijkstra on the shortest path task.

Event	JS (ban vs mention)	Default share under ban	Default share under mention	Shift (points)	Compliant samples (realised mode)
Grid ban DFS	0.801	0.96	0.0	+96	86 (BFS)
Grid ban bidirectional BFS	0.053	0.99	0.86	+13	92 (BFS)
Grid ban IDDFS	0.741	0.88	0.0	+88	80 (BFS 76, DFS 4)
Grid ban A*	0.506	1.0	0.24	+76	72 (BFS)

Grid ban unit weight Dijkstra	0.027	0.92	1.0	-8	71 (BFS 69, DFS 2)
Shortest path ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.780	0.94	0.0	+94	92 (Dijkstra)
Shortest path ban bidirectional Dijkstra	0.007	0.97	1.0	-3	100 (Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3)
Shortest path ban Floyd-Warshall	0.745	0.77	0.0	+77	71 (Dijkstra 68, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3)
Shortest path ban Dial	0.015	0.95	1.0	-5	97 (Dijkstra 95, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2)

The succession stalled at step 2. Banning the first substitute as well (BFS and DFS on the grid task, Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA on the shortest path task) failed outright. 94 of 100 and 100 of 100 programs used a banned algorithm, leaving 5 and 0 compliant samples, and the preregistered stop rule (fewer than 20 compliant) ended both successions. The model reimplemented the banned mechanism under another description (Table 9). On the grid task 41 of 94 recurrent programs never named the banned algorithm and 20 called their DFS `backtracking`; on the shortest path task 58 of 100 never named it, and 19 described SPFA as `BFS with pruning`.

Table 9. Recurrence of banned algorithms and how often recurrent programs avoid naming them (regular expression counts over comments and identifiers).

Event	Recurrent programs	Naming the banned algorithm	Not naming it	Most common descriptors
Grid ban BFS	10	1	9	`queue` 10
Grid ban DFS (sham)	4	2	2	`backtracking` 2
Grid succession step 2 (BFS, DFS)	94	53	41	`backtracking` 20, `queue` 16, `BFS` 7
Shortest path ban Dijkstra	9	8	1	`priority queue` 9, `queue` 8
Shortest path ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA (sham)	5	1	4	`queue` 3
Shortest path succession step 2 (Dijkstra, Bellman-Ford/SPFA)	100	42	58	`BFS` 98, `queue` 91, `priority queue` 48, `pruning` 19

The ladder limit test. The hypothesis predicts that a ban fails more often when the banned algorithm's alternative is unclear. With four present algorithm events the relation cannot be estimated (Table 10). The grid modal ban had the lowest clarity and was obeyed; the two step-2 events had higher clarity and failed. The pooled Spearman rank correlation between recurrence and clarity was -0.2 over 4 events.

Table 10. Recurrence of the banned algorithm against clarity of its alternative.

Event	Recurrence	Clarity	Clarity corrected for chance	Kendall's W
Grid ban BFS	0.10	0.20	0.0	0.52
Grid succession step 2	0.94	0.45	1.0	0.577
Shortest path ban Dijkstra	0.09	1.0	1.0	0.639
Shortest path succession step 2	1.00	0.65	0.533	0.573

What this experiment settled. On the one event where the model's ranked association map and its free-form answer disagreed (the grid task), the free-form answer was right and the map was wrong; on the other event both were right. The ranking instrument, which the design chose because it

gives full support where a free-form answer gives a point mass, does not measure the same association the model acts on. The typicality predictor built from baseline frequencies is uninformative under a full collapse, while the listing control distribution, a typicality measure taken under a prompt that names every algorithm, predicted both events. Bans naming several algorithms fail by disguise, so compliance has to be checked at the level of mechanism, not name. The labeller gate failed its runtime accuracy targets (Table 2), and every runtime and AST disagreement was resolved by the judge. Both task suites passed their acceptance checks: all 22 reference implementations passed, and every planted mutant (an off by one distance, a hop count in place of a weighted distance, a path through a wall, a diagonal step) was rejected. Resending 6 requests (64 samples) with the same request seeds reproduced 39 of 64 texts exactly, so results reproduce in distribution rather than token for token. An independent script rederived all 36 headline numbers from the raw files.

1.6 Geometry experiment: the read position manifold, the ban shift, and activation removal

Why. The hypothesis places the algorithm decision at the read position and predicts that the ban shift there, the change in the read position state that the ban causes, has a larger component toward the associated alternative than away from the banned algorithm. This experiment built the solution manifold at the read position, tested whether the read position encodes the algorithm at all, nominated the geodesically nearest survivor as a third predictor (the geodesic kernel, a forecast that weights each survivor by the exponential of minus its geodesic distance from the banned algorithm's centroid, scaled by the median distance between centroids), decomposed the ban shift, and tried to remove the modal algorithm with an activation edit instead of a prompt. It ran HF `generate` on one NVIDIA GPU with 23 GB of memory, since vLLM could not start, for about 2.2 GPU hours; OpenRouter spend was about USD 0.09.

Design. Forced implementation prompts (`Implement X for this task`) with 30 paraphrases per catalogue algorithm, plus a name masked set that describes X without naming it, gave a point cloud of residual stream activations at the read position for each algorithm for layers 8 to 28 of 36. A logistic linear probe from the read position state to the algorithm label was trained with one paraphrase held out at a time and compared with 20 shuffled label refits, the control-task logic of probe selectivity [24]. Two gate statistics were computed per layer: transfer accuracy from named to name masked prompts, and the Jensen-Shannon divergence, that is, a symmetric and bounded divergence, between the probe's decoded distribution on the baseline prompts and the realised label distribution of the baseline. The manifold used principal component analysis down to 95% of the variance, a k-nearest-neighbour graph with $k = 10$, geodesic distances along the graph as in Isomap [25], two dimensional multidimensional scaling and the TwoNN intrinsic-dimension estimator [26], following the manifold-steering instrument [27].

Manipulation check. The model can write most catalogue algorithms when told to, but not all of them correctly (Table 11). Forced IDDFS was implemented as IDDFS every time on the grid task and never passed the tests; forced bidirectional Dijkstra and forced Dial were implemented as asked in only 33% and 37% of samples. These two shortest path algorithms were flagged, and their centroids rest on fewer valid points.

Table 11. Forced implementation prompts in the geometry experiment (30 samples each): share labelled as the requested algorithm, and pass rate, for named and name masked prompts.

Task	Requested algorithm	Named: share as asked / pass	Name masked: share as asked / pass

Grid	BFS	1.0 / 1.0	1.0 / 0.933
Grid	DFS	1.0 / 0.30	0.933 / 0.167
Grid	bidirectional BFS	0.667 / 0.233	0.967 / 0.067
Grid	IDDFS	1.0 / 0.0	0.767 / 0.0
Grid	A*	0.967 / 0.967	1.0 / 0.933
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	1.0 / 0.90	1.0 / 0.833
Shortest path	Dijkstra	1.0 / 1.0	1.0 / 0.967
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	1.0 / 0.767	0.767 / 0.667
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	0.333 / 0.50	0.20 / 0.433
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	1.0 / 1.0	0.733 / 0.667
Shortest path	Dial	0.367 / 0.30	0.567 / 0.70

Does the read position encode the algorithm? Named probes reached 0.98-1.0 accuracy at every layer, which says only that the algorithm's name is in the context. The informative statistic is transfer to name masked prompts (Figure 1). It rose with depth and peaked at layer 27 on the grid task (0.672 against a shuffled label 95th percentile of 0.218) and at layer 24 on the shortest path task (0.54 against 0.307). The decoder criterion split the tasks. On the shortest path task the probe decoded the baseline state as 98% Dijkstra (JS 0.011 against a null 5th percentile of 0.030). On the grid task it decoded the baseline as DFS 0.60, unit weight Dijkstra 0.27 and BFS 0.12, while the model writes BFS every time, so the grid read position gate failed and the grid geometry below carries that flag.

[Figure fig_probe_layers: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The manifold. The point clouds are low-dimensional: TwoNN intrinsic dimension 4.16 on the grid task and 5.24 on the shortest path task, against 11.92 and 11.58 for nulls with shuffled columns (5th-95th percentiles 10.78-13.46 and 10.64-12.71). MDS stress-1, the residual misfit of the two dimensional embedding, was 0.22 on both tasks and geodesic and Euclidean distances had Spearman correlation 0.87 and 0.90. Figure 2 draws the two maps with every condition's read position point, and Table 12 gives the geodesic distances from the default's centroid. On the grid task, BFS's two nearest centroids are DFS (41.19) and unit weight Dijkstra (58.39); A*, IDDFS and bidirectional BFS lie 71-95 away. On the shortest path task Dijkstra's nearest centroid is Floyd-Warshall (25.49), with Bellman-Ford/SPFA and bidirectional Dijkstra tied at about 42.

[Figure fig_manifold: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Table 12. Geodesic distances between centroids at the read position (grid task, layer 27; shortest path task, layer 24), from the default algorithm's centroid.

Task	From	To: distance
Grid	BFS	DFS 41.19; unit weight Dijkstra 58.39; A* 71.06; IDDFS 81.66; bidirectional BFS 94.95
Shortest path	Dijkstra	Floyd-Warshall 25.49; Bellman-Ford/SPFA 42.18; bidirectional Dijkstra 42.46; Dial 54.96

The ban points do not sit near the centroids of the algorithms the model then wrote. Under the grid ban the read position point moved far from both BFS and DFS (from (-20.26, -58.22) for the baseline to (-24.67, 10.46)), while the mention point of BFS stayed close to the BFS centroid; the ban points of all six grid algorithms clustered together in one region of the map regardless of which algorithm was banned. This matches the decomposition below: most of the ban shift is not along the algorithm directions.

The bans in this experiment. Here the modal bans mostly failed (Table 13). On the grid task 62 of 100 programs were still BFS and the 18 compliant programs split into DFS 10 and unit weight

Dijkstra 8, so there was no clear realised mode. On the shortest path task 72 of 100 were still Dijkstra and all 22 compliant programs were Bellman-Ford/SPFA. Compliance depended on the paraphrase: on the grid task four of the ten ban wordings gave 10 of 10 BFS while two gave 0 of 10 (Section 1.11). Some programs acknowledged the ban in a comment and used the algorithm anyway (`# Dijkstra's algorithm (but since the user said not to use Dijkstra's algorithm, this is a workaround)`). Three step-2 bans were run as exploratory events after the preregistered succession stopped. On the grid task the displaced mass landed only on BFS's two geodesic neighbours, DFS and unit weight Dijkstra, and banning one of them moved the compliant programs to the other; it never reached A*, IDDFS or bidirectional BFS. In the words of the request, mass moved to the edge of the banned region rather than to the opposite side. On the shortest path task the mass went to the second nearest centroid, Bellman-Ford/SPFA, and the nearest, Floyd-Warshall, received none. *(Correction, iteration 2: the claim that Bellman-Ford/SPFA is second nearest does not survive the sensitivity matrix of this experiment, which puts bidirectional Dijkstra (40.91) closer to Dijkstra than Bellman-Ford/SPFA (42.18) once the two flagged centroids are recomputed from correctly labelled forced samples. Under paraphrase level resampling Floyd-Warshall is nearest in every subsample, and Bellman-Ford/SPFA is second at layers 23 to 27 and third at layers 21 and 22; Section 2.3.2.)*

Table 13. Ban events in the geometry experiment (all coded samples; compliant = correct and not banned).

Event	N	Labels	Compliant (labels)	Realised mode	Status
Grid ban BFS	100	BFS 62, DFS 29, unit weight Dijkstra 9	18 (DFS 10, unit weight Dijkstra 8)	no clear mode	primary
Grid ban BFS and DFS	50	BFS 29, unit weight Dijkstra 19, DFS 2	18 (unit weight Dijkstra 18)	unit weight Dijkstra	exploratory
Grid ban BFS and unit weight Dijkstra	50	BFS 31, DFS 17, unit weight Dijkstra 2	5 (DFS 5)	DFS	exploratory
Shortest path ban Dijkstra	100	Dijkstra 72, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 27, other 1	22 (Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 22)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	primary
Shortest path ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	Dijkstra 37, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 12, other 1	0	no clear mode	exploratory

The ban raised the correctness conditioned Hill number from 1.00 to 2.034 on the grid task at a pass-rate cost of 0.99 to 0.76, and from 1.00 to 1.723 on the shortest path task at 1.00 to 0.94. Most of this diversity is the banned algorithm mixed with its substitute, since banned programs that pass the tests count toward Hill_cc.

The forecast contest. Forecasts for 45 planned events were committed by hash (sha256 186f7182...) at 16:36:57 UTC, before any ban or removal sample. Table 14 scores them. This experiment's own association elicitation produced different maps from the association experiment's: it nominated A* for BFS (clarity 0.80, Kendall's W 0.886) and Dial for Dijkstra (clarity 0.579). Both nominations missed and the association map was the worst predictor, worse than uniform. The geodesic kernel was the best on the two primary events (mean -1.433 against -1.563 for uniform), by a margin of 0.13 nats per sample, and no predictor scored a top-1 hit on a primary event.

Table 14. Forecast contest in the geometry experiment (raw mean log score; top-1 nomination; the samples scored are all labels of the event other than the banned algorithm).

Event (samples scored)	Association map	Latent frequency	Geodesic kernel	Read position decoder

Grid ban BFS (38)	-3.543 (A*)	-1.630 (tie)	-1.337 (DFS)	-1.287 (DFS)
Shortest path ban Dijkstra (28)	-1.647 (Dial)	-1.496 (tie)	-1.530 (Floyd-Warshall)	-1.587 (bidirectional Dijkstra)
Grid ban BFS and DFS, exploratory (19)	-0.998 (unit weight Dijkstra, hit)	-1.406 (tie)	-1.073 (unit weight Dijkstra, hit)	-4.124 (IDDFS)
Grid ban BFS and unit weight Dijkstra, exploratory (17)	-3.966 (A*)	-1.406 (tie)	-1.280 (A*)	-1.372 (IDDFS)
Shortest path ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA, exploratory (1)	-3.912	-3.912	-3.912	-3.912
Mean, 2 primary events	-2.595	-1.563	-1.433	-1.437
Mean, all 5 events; top-1 hits	-2.813; 1/5	-1.970; ties	-1.826; 1/5	-2.456; 0/5

The shift decomposition. The ban shift is the read position state under the ban minus the state under its reference, computed against the mention twin and against the listing control. It was decomposed in a preregistered order into a component away from the banned algorithm (u_ren), toward the association winner (u_sub), toward the most frequent survivor (u_typ) and toward the geodesically nearest other survivor (u_rel), each orthogonalised against the previous ones. The preregistered share test needed the u_sub share to exceed the u_ren share and the u_ren share to exceed a split half paraphrase null under both references. Table 15 gives the shares at the gate layer. The four named components together explained 1-39% of the squared norm; the rest was residual. The u_ren share exceeded its null in only 7 of 130 cells across the layer band (Dial under the mention reference at layers 23-27, and bidirectional Dijkstra twice), never under both references, so every algorithm was inconclusive. The cosine of each shift with the banned name's input embedding and unembedding row was at most 0.034 in absolute value. A synthetic test with a planted 36/64 split recovered it, so the decomposition code works; the shifts simply do not lie along the algorithm directions.

Table 15. Squared norm shares of the ban shift at the gate layer (layer 27 for the grid task, layer 24 for the shortest path task); u_typ is undefined when the most frequent survivor is also the association winner or no survivor has baseline mass.

Task	Banned X	Reference	u_ren	u_sub	u_typ	u_rel	Residual	u_ren null p95
Grid	BFS	mention	0.067	0.054	0.012	0.003	0.863	0.248
Grid	BFS	listing control	0.058	0.061	0.034	0.004	0.844	0.248
Grid	DFS	mention	0.042	0.038	n/a	0.000	0.920	0.170
Grid	DFS	listing control	0.052	0.017	n/a	0.002	0.929	0.170
Grid	bidirectional BFS	mention	0.078	0.020	n/a	0.000	0.901	0.263
Grid	bidirectional BFS	listing control	0.001	0.099	n/a	0.003	0.897	0.263
Grid	IDDFS	mention	0.090	0.005	n/a	0.029	0.876	0.274
Grid	IDDFS	listing control	0.003	0.034	n/a	0.054	0.909	0.274
Grid	A*	mention	0.086	0.005	n/a	0.014	0.895	0.134
Grid	A*	listing control	0.003	0.004	n/a	0.003	0.990	0.134
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	mention	0.017	0.041	0.014	0.000	0.927	0.287
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	listing control	0.130	0.076	0.000	0.011	0.783	0.287
Shortest path	Dijkstra	mention	0.004	0.002	0.041	0.013	0.940	0.311
Shortest path	Dijkstra	listing control	0.047	0.003	0.050	0.000	0.900	0.311
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	mention	0.000	0.069	n/a	0.021	0.909	0.298

Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	listing control	0.104	0.094	n/a	0.005	0.797	0.298
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	mention	0.107	0.079	n/a	0.001	0.812	0.126
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	listing control	0.003	0.027	n/a	0.000	0.970	0.126
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	mention	0.000	0.019	n/a	0.004	0.976	0.212
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	listing control	0.075	0.005	n/a	0.001	0.919	0.212
Shortest path	Dial	mention	0.329	0.056	n/a	0.001	0.614	0.267
Shortest path	Dial	listing control	0.014	0.015	n/a	0.001	0.970	0.267

Activation removal of the modal algorithm. The removal used affine directional ablation [28, 29], anchored at the mean of the survivors: the component of each activation along a difference-in-means direction d_X for the modal algorithm was moved to the survivors' mean, scaled by a coefficient alpha. Neither direction check reached its 0.9 target: the held-out AUC of d_X was 0.89 and 0.79 at the read position and at best 0.66 and 0.76 at generated positions. The fallback declared in advance therefore ran. It edited the prompt suffix including the read position, over a 5-layer band on the grid task and a 7-layer band on the shortest path task, at alpha 0.5, 1 and 2, with two random directions of identical edit norm under common random numbers (the same sampling seeds for edited and unedited runs). It moved 0 of 50 samples on either task at every alpha (Table 16). Between 78% and 90% of the edited outputs were byte-identical to their alpha = 0 twins, as were 80-96% of the random direction outputs. The hook tests passed on both tasks: at alpha = 0 the logits were identical to the unhooked model, the remaining projection on d_X after the edit was below 1e-6 of its value before, and random and d_X edits had exactly equal norms. A post hoc full variant that also edited every generated position still left 25 of 25 programs on BFS and on Dijkstra at alpha 2; at alpha 4 the d_X edit destroyed generation (25 of 25 without code on both tasks) and the random direction broke most outputs as well. The verdict, as declared, was untestable, because the removal was unsuccessful at the tested coefficients. The comparison between prompt bans and activation removal, which the hypothesis treats as a headline, could not be made.

Table 16. Affine directional ablation of the modal algorithm (prompt suffix variant declared in advance unless marked full; HF engine; pass rates over all samples).

Task	**Arm**	**Alpha**	**N**	**Labels**	**Pass**	**Moved off the modal algorithm**	**Identical text to alpha = 0**
Grid	hooked control	0	50	BFS 50	1.0	0/50	1.0
Grid	d_X	0.5 / 1.0 / 2.0	50 each	BFS 50 each	1.0 each	0/50 each	0.80 / 0.86 / 0.78
Grid	random 1	0.5 / 1.0 / 2.0	25 each	BFS 25 each	1.0 each	0/25 each	0.80 / 0.80 / 0.84
Grid	random 2	0.5 / 1.0	25 each	BFS 25 each	1.0 each	0/25 each	0.80 / 0.84
Grid	d_X, full (post hoc)	2.0	25	BFS 25	0.76	0/25	0.0
Grid	d_X, full (post hoc)	4.0	25	no code 25	0.0	0/25	0.0
Grid	random 1, full (post hoc)	4.0	25	BFS 18, other 6, no code 1	0.0	6/25	0.0
Shortest path	hooked control	0	50	Dijkstra 50	1.0	0/50	1.0
Shortest path	d_X	0.5 / 1.0 / 2.0	50 each	Dijkstra 50 each	1.0 each	0/50 each	0.90 / 0.86 / 0.82

Shortest path	random 1	0.5 / 1.0 / 2.0	25 each	Dijkstra 25 each	1.0 each	0/25 each	0.88 / 0.96 / 0.92
Shortest path	random 2	0.5 / 1.0	25 each	Dijkstra 25 each	1.0 each	0/25 each	0.96 / 0.92
Shortest path	d_X, full (post hoc)	2.0	25	Dijkstra 25	1.0	0/25	0.04
Shortest path	d_X, full (post hoc)	4.0	25	no code 25	0.0	0/25	0.0
Shortest path	random 1, full (post hoc)	4.0	25	no code 20, Dijkstra 3, other 2	0.0	2/25	0.0

What this experiment settled. The read position holds a low-dimensional map of the catalogue, and on the grid task the mass displaced by the ban went to the geodesic neighbours of the default; the geodesic kernel was the least bad forecaster on the primary events. *(Correction, iteration 2: those neighbours, DFS and unit weight Dijkstra, are also second choices of the model, so the observation is consistent with geodesic proximity and with typicality and does not separate them; both events called primary here fail the forecast contest's compliance gate; Sections 2.3.2 and 2.3.7.)* The read position does not, however, decode the grid task's actual default, the ban shift is almost entirely orthogonal to the algorithm directions, and an activation edit of the modal algorithm did nothing until it broke the model. The labeller passed its gate on both tasks. An independent recomputation reproduced 99 headline numbers with no mismatch.

1.7 Forking token experiment: is the algorithm decided during generation?

Why. If the read position does not fix the algorithm, the decision may be made at a few high entropy tokens during generation, as forking token analyses find for other outcomes [30, 31]. The knob this account implies is a sampler that raises temperature only around those tokens, in the spirit of adaptive temperature sampling for code [32]. This experiment screened that account on its own pool of about 10,000 labelled generations, with vLLM 0.11.0 in eager mode, its own tests (40 per task, 17 reference solutions) and a judge used only on 6 disputed programs (USD 0.024).

Design. A resampling screen took 10 base paths per task for the baseline and for the modal ban and drew 8 continuations at every fourth generated token over the first 92 tokens. Baseline paths were screened only at tokens 4, 8, 16, 32 and 64, a fallback declared in advance because the baseline was already fixed at the read position. Change points in the series of continuation outcome distributions were detected against a permutation threshold (a PELT detector [33] run alongside found none on any path), localised to single tokens, and confirmed with 30 continuations at each candidate and at two control positions without a change point. A prompt swap cut a baseline path just before or just after its commitment token (the first token of evidence that identifies the algorithm, such as the `deque` import) and continued it under the ban prompt. The knob arm compared global temperature 0.3-1.3 with temperature 1.3 applied only in a window around detected forking tokens, which we call the forking window knob, against a random window of the same size and an anchored window at the start of the code block. A planted change sensitivity test found that the detector caught a total variation change of 0.2, 0.3 and 0.5 in 82.5%, 95% and 99% of trials, with a 6% false-positive rate at no change.

Table 17. Sample pools in the forking token experiment.

Task	Pool	N	Labels	Pass	Hill_cc
Grid	baseline, T = 1.0	200	BFS 200	0.91	1.0

Grid	ban BFS, T = 1.0	100	DFS 78, BFS 21, unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.56	1.945
Grid	baseline, T = 0.3 / 0.7 / 1.3	100 each	BFS 100 each	0.91 / 0.82 / 0.96	1.0
Shortest path	baseline, T = 1.0	200	Dijkstra 200	0.995	1.0
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra, T = 1.0	100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 80, Dijkstra 20	1.00	1.649
Shortest path	baseline, T = 0.3 / 0.7 / 1.3	100 each	Dijkstra 100 each	1.00 each	1.0

Where the outcome is fixed. The sample pools behind the screen (Table 17) repeat the collapse: every baseline pool at every temperature was 100% BFS or 100% Dijkstra, and the ban pools were the only ones with a second algorithm. Under the baseline prompt every base path was fixed at the read position on both tasks: all continuations from token 0 onward produced the path's own algorithm (Table 18). Under the ban, outcomes were open for longer. On the grid task 3 of 10 ban paths were fixed from the read position and 5 of 10 by token 16; on the shortest path task none was fixed at the read position and only 3 of 10 by token 64. Change points were confirmed only on the shortest path ban paths: 6 forking tokens on 5 of the 10 paths, while the 3 grid candidates failed confirmation and the 10 control positions produced no false positive.

Table 18. Resampling screen. We call a base path decided at the read position when its continuations from token 0 agree with its final label at least 80% of the time, and fixed by token k when at least 7 of 8 continuations agree with it at every screened position from k on; the columns give the share of base paths of each kind.

Condition	Base paths	Decided at the read position	Fixed by token 0 / 8 / 16 / 32 / 64	Paths not fixed	Forking token candidates	Confirmed forking tokens	Final labels
Grid baseline	10	1.0	1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0	0	0	0	BFS 10
Grid ban BFS	10	0.8	0.3 / 0.3 / 0.5 / 0.5 / 0.5	7	3	0	DFS 9, BFS 1
Shortest path baseline	10	1.0	1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0 / 1.0	0	0	0	Dijkstra 10
Shortest path ban Dijkstra	10	0.4	0.0 / 0.1 / 0.1 / 0.1 / 0.3	10	10	6	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 6, Dijkstra 4

The confirmed forking tokens are not the punctuation tokens that studies of forking paths report on other tasks (Table 19). Two are the `import` token at position 3, where the model decides which module to import, two are algorithm names written in comments (the tokens `Bell` and `D` at position 68, each with a leading space), one is `BFS` inside the description of an SPFA queue, and one is a newline at position 7. Across confirmed forking tokens the outcome entropy fell by a mean of -0.131 bits, that is, it rose slightly, because several forking tokens moved a path from a fixed outcome to a mixed one.

Table 19. Confirmed forking tokens (all on shortest path ban paths). TVD is the total variation distance between continuation outcome distributions on either side.

Base path	Position	Token	Token type	TVD	Permutation p	Outcome entropy before / after (bits)
Shortest path ban 0	3	`import`	import	0.80	0.0005	0.567 / 0.353
Shortest path ban 1	3	`import`	import	0.767	0.0005	0.211 / 0.784
Shortest path ban 1	77	`BFS` (leading space)	identifier	0.333	0.013	1.0 / 0.65
Shortest path ban 3	68	`Bell` (leading space)	identifier	0.333	0.002	0.948 / 0.211
Shortest path ban 4	68	`D` (leading space)	identifier	0.533	0.0005	0.0 / 1.368
Shortest path ban 7	7	newline	whitespace	0.90	0.0005	0.211 / 0.353

Does the commitment token lock the algorithm in? No. The prompt swap predicted that a ban would work better on a prefix cut before the commitment token than after it. The ban effect was the same on both sides (Table 20): on the grid task 75% of continuations avoided BFS before the cut and 73.5% after it, a difference of 0.015 with a 95% interval of -0.02 to 0.055. Writing `from collections import deque` did not commit the model to BFS. On the shortest path task the ban was weak on both sides of the cut (25.5% and 27% avoided Dijkstra).

Table 20. Prompt swap at the commitment token (10 base paths per task; ban effect = share of continuations avoiding the banned algorithm; 95% bootstrap intervals).

Task	Ban effect, cut before commitment	Ban effect, cut after commitment	Before minus after	Banned share after the cut (lock in)
Grid	0.75 [0.545, 0.91]	0.735 [0.54, 0.895]	0.015 [-0.02, 0.055]	0.265 [0.095, 0.45]
Shortest path	0.255 [0.155, 0.365]	0.27 [0.155, 0.40]	-0.015 [-0.095, 0.05]	0.73 [0.61, 0.84]
Pooled	0.5025 [0.347, 0.648]	0.5025 [0.347, 0.642]	0.0 [-0.045, 0.04]	0.498 [0.343, 0.638]

The forking window temperature knob. Raising temperature only around detected forking tokens changed nothing about the algorithm (Table 21): every arm on both tasks was 100% BFS or 100% Dijkstra, and the difference in Hill_cc between the forking token window and a random window was 0 with a [0, 0] interval. What temperature did change was the number of distinct phrasings. On the grid task global temperature took the number of phrasing clusters (defined in Section 1.10) at a Jaccard threshold of 0.8 from 11 at T = 0.3 to 63 at T = 1.3, while the forking token window gave 10, about the same as T = 0.3.

Table 21. Temperature arms of the forking token experiment (N = 100 each; all programs BFS on the grid task and Dijkstra on the shortest path task). Phrasing clusters at Jaccard thresholds 0.7 / 0.8 / 0.9 over identifier normalised AST shingles; phrasing Hill number at 0.8.

Task	Arm	Pass	Hill_cc	Phrasing clusters (0.7 / 0.8 / 0.9)	Phrasing Hill (0.8)	Mean length (tokens)
Grid	global T = 0.3	0.91	1.0	8 / 11 / 18	6.28	335.15
Grid	global T = 0.7	0.82	1.0	17 / 25 / 35	14.36	345.11
Grid	global T = 1.0	0.94	1.0	24 / 41 / 60	24.58	331.6
Grid	global T = 1.3	0.96	1.0	39 / 63 / 80	44.72	342.62

Grid	forking token window	0.83	1.0	8 / 10 / 23	6.06	346.67
Grid	random window	0.85	1.0	6 / 11 / 20	5.63	349.55
Grid	anchored window	0.85	1.0	9 / 13 / 25	5.85	337.87
Shortest path	global T = 0.3	1.00	1.0	1 / 1 / 1	1.0	191.88
Shortest path	global T = 0.7	1.00	1.0	1 / 2 / 2	1.10	192.28
Shortest path	global T = 1.0	0.99	1.0	2 / 4 / 5	1.47	193.62
Shortest path	global T = 1.3	1.00	1.0	3 / 5 / 7	1.84	195.08
Shortest path	forking token window	1.00	1.0	1 / 2 / 2	1.06	192.01
Shortest path	random window	0.99	1.0	1 / 2 / 2	1.10	192.5
Shortest path	anchored window	1.00	1.0	1 / 1 / 2	1.0	192.3

Dead end: the locus probes never ran to completion. The decisive measurement for this account was a probe from residual-stream states at the read position, at generated tokens 8, 16, 32 and 64, at the forking token and at the commitment token, to the final label. The states were extracted (300 samples per task at 8 positions and 21 layers, with read position cosine to a separate pass of at least 0.9997), but the probe stage wrote an empty `probes.json` and no probe result exists. The strategy's locus diagnostic is therefore undetermined. *(Correction, iteration 2: the cause is now recorded. `probes.json` (28 bytes, an empty summary) was written at 18:29:22, while the state log records the state phase starting at 18:31:55 and the grid and shortest path states saved at 18:34:34 and 18:34:50: the probe stage ran before its inputs existed. The states (`states/T{1,2}_part_001-005.npz`, about 790 MB, kept on the run volume) were intact, and the audit ran the probe on them in iteration 2; Section 2.3.1.)* The preregistered verdict rule returned INCONCLUSIVE: no confirmed forking token on the grid task, confirmed forking tokens on half of the shortest path ban paths, and no effect of the forking window knob.

What this experiment settled. Without a ban the algorithm is fixed before the first generated token on both tasks, so there is no forking token for temperature to act on. Under a ban the outcome stays open for dozens of tokens and a few forking tokens exist on the shortest path task, including the choice of import; the first token that identifies the algorithm does not lock the algorithm in. A temperature knob aimed at forking tokens adds neither ideas nor phrasings.

1.8 Decommitment experiment: does one list versus implement direction control the collapse?

Why. An alternate account holds that the bottleneck is commitment, not the choice of a particular algorithm: a model asked to list ten approaches knows many, and a model asked to implement one collapses. If a single direction separates the two framings, adding it while the model implements should spread its output over the repertoire instead of moving it to one substitute. This experiment built that direction, steered with it under random direction and prompting controls [34], and tested whether a ban moves the read position along it.

Design. The decommitment direction is a difference-in-means direction at the read position: the

mean state over 50 paraphrases of `list ten different approaches to this task`, which we call the list framing, minus the mean over 50 paraphrases of `implement one correct algorithm`, the implement framing, per layer. Held-out separation AUC was 1.00 at every layer from 9 to 28, and layer 18 was chosen by the held-out separation statistic d' (8.55). At layer 18 the direction's norm was 0.21 (grid) and 0.19 (shortest path) times the state norm, its split half cosine was 0.99, and the two tasks' directions had cosine 0.98. Its cosine was 0.53-0.55 with a breadth direction that contrasts listing approaches with naming one, -0.08 to -0.04 with a variable name placebo direction, and 0.59-0.62 with the shift produced by the enumeration prompt. It was added as c times the state norm times the unit direction at the read position and at every generated token, with c in {0.25, 0.5, 1, 1.5} plus a preregistered bisection. The correctness preserving coefficient c* was the largest c with at least 80% of the c = 0 pass rate: 0.1 on the grid task and 0.25 on the shortest path task. Controls were two random directions, the placebo and breadth directions at c*, the other task's direction, the prompt we call the enumeration prompt (`list 10 approaches, then implement one`), the modal ban and its mention twin, and a two-step succession. Labels came from hidden tests (43 and 39 cases), the tracer and AST rules, with a judge on disagreements; the labeller gate passed (Table 2). An engine check compared the vLLM baseline with the hooked HF arm at c = 0: identical on the grid task, total variation 0.03 on the shortest path task (Fisher p 0.40).

Steering moved the shortest path task and never the grid task. On the grid task every arm except the bans wrote BFS (Table 22). At c = 0.25 the pass rate fell to 0.57 and every passing program was still BFS; at c = 0.5 it fell to 0.03, and from c = 1 all output was broken (pass 0, 28-85% of samples truncated). On the shortest path task the c* = 0.25 arm moved correct programs from Dijkstra to Bellman-Ford/SPFA (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1, against Dijkstra 88 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7 at c = 0), a rarefied Hill-number gain of +0.65 (paraphrase-cluster 90% interval 0.31 to 0.97) at a 17-point pass-rate cost. A random direction at the same strength did almost the same (+0.59), and the difference between the decommitment direction and that random direction was +0.07 (-0.26 to 0.39). The gain therefore is not specific to the direction, although it exceeded the second random direction (+0.70, 0.38 to 1.01) and the placebo (+0.47, 0.01 to 0.84). Per-sample flips against c = 0 under common random numbers were 0.66 for the decommitment direction, 0.42 and 0.18 for the two random directions and 0.22 for the placebo. On the shortest path task the off-mode rate peaked at c = 0.25 (0.55) and fell again at c = 0.5 (0.12) as programs broke. A Hill number of 2 was reached at c of about 0.40 for a 34.5-point pass cost; a Hill number of 3 was not reached in the tested range.

Table 22. BUY table of the decommitment experiment. Delta Hill is the change in correctness conditioned Hill number, rarefied to a common sample depth, against the HF c = 0 arm for steering and against the vLLM baseline for prompts, with a 90% paraphrase-cluster interval; efficiency is Delta Hill per pass-rate point lost.

Task	Knob	Pass	Pass points lost	Labels of correct programs	Delta Hill [90% interval]	Efficiency
Grid	vLLM baseline (N = 200)	1.00	n/a	BFS 200	n/a	n/a
Grid	HF c = 0	1.00	n/a	BFS 100	n/a	n/a
Grid	decommitment c = 0.1 (c*)	0.98	2	BFS 98	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]	0.0
Grid	decommitment c = 0.25	0.57	43	BFS 57	0.0	0.0
Grid	decommitment c = 0.5	0.03	97	BFS 3	0.0	0.0

Grid	decommitment c = 1 / 1.5	0.0 / 0.0	100	none	n/a	n/a
Grid	random 1 / random 2 / placebo / breadth at c*	0.98 / 1.00 / 1.00 / 0.99	2 / 0 / 0 / 1	all BFS	0.0	0.0
Grid	other task's direction at c* (N = 50)	0.98	2	all BFS	0.0	0.0
Grid	enumeration prompt	1.00	0	BFS 100	0.0	n/a
Grid	mention BFS	1.00	0	BFS 100	0.0	n/a
Grid	ban BFS	0.64	36	BFS 46, DFS 16, unit weight Dijkstra 2	+0.99 [0.55, 1.34]	0.028
Grid	succession (ban BFS and DFS)	0.88	12	BFS 65, unit weight Dijkstra 13, DFS 7, A* 3	+1.27 [0.64, 1.80]	0.106
Shortest path	vLLM baseline (N = 200)	0.89	n/a	Dijkstra 169, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 8	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	HF c = 0	0.95	n/a	Dijkstra 88, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	decommitment c = 0.25 (c*)	0.78	17	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1	+0.65 [0.31, 0.97]	0.038
Shortest path	decommitment c = 0.375	0.67	28	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 47, Dijkstra 19	+0.65 [0.29, 0.94]	0.023
Shortest path	decommitment c = 0.5	0.37	58	Dijkstra 25, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 10, other 2	+0.87 [0.09, 1.38]	0.015
Shortest path	decommitment c = 1 / 1.5	0.0 / 0.0	95	none	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	random 1 at c*	0.79	16	Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26	+0.59 [0.21, 0.85]	0.037
Shortest path	random 2 at c*	0.87	8	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	-0.05 [-0.31, 0.20]	-0.006
Shortest path	placebo at c*	0.66	29	Dijkstra 60, Dial 3, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	+0.19 [-0.30, 0.70]	0.006
Shortest path	breadth direction at c*	0.60	35	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 28, Dial 1	+0.85 [0.46, 1.17]	0.024
Shortest path	other task's direction at c* (N = 50)	0.72	23	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 28, Dijkstra 8	+0.40 [-0.01, 0.69]	0.018
Shortest path	enumeration prompt	0.82	6.5	Dijkstra 80, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	-0.08 [-0.27, 0.13]	-0.013
Shortest path	mention Dijkstra	0.94	-5.5	Dijkstra 92, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	-0.09 [-0.29, 0.12]	n/a
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra	0.87	1.5	Dijkstra 49, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 38	+0.79 [0.60, 0.90]	0.524
Shortest path	succession (ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA)	0.68	20.5	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 34, Dijkstra 33, other 1	+0.93 [0.66, 1.17]	0.045

The prompting baselines decide the comparison. The enumeration prompt, which states the decommitment framing in words, produced no diversity on either task. The modal ban bought +0.79 effective algorithms on the shortest path task for 1.5 pass points, an efficiency 14 times that of steering, but most banned samples still used the banned algorithm: 46 of 64 correct grid programs were BFS and 49 of 87 correct shortest path programs were Dijkstra. The ban's Hill gain is therefore mostly a mixture of ban failures and Bellman-Ford/SPFA, not two algorithms chosen freely.

Does a ban decommit? The commitment test projects the ban minus mention shift at layer 18 onto the axis from the implement framing (0) to the list framing (1). The ban moved the read position toward the list framing by 0.039 on the grid task and 0.053 on the shortest path task (Table 23), outside the preregistered paraphrase split null band (plus or minus 0.024 and 0.025), so the preregistered label is that the ban decommits. An audit judged that band too narrow; exact permutation tests gave $p = 0.021$ and 0.007 (label permutation) and 0.025 and 0.016 (paired sign flip), with 8 of 10 paraphrase pairs positive on each task. The shift is small: the enumeration prompt, the positive control, moved the state by 0.544 and 0.582 of the same distance, and the listing control sat at 0.816 and 0.806. The share of the ban shift along the direction ranked at the 78th and 87th percentiles of a null built from the top 50 principal components.

Table 23. Position along the implement (0) to list (1) axis at layer 18 for each prompt condition.

Condition	Grid	Shortest path
baseline	-0.054	-0.075
enumeration prompt	0.483	0.495
listing control	0.816	0.806
framing that names one approach	0.653	0.650
ban of the modal algorithm / its mention twin	0.040 / 0.001	0.035 / -0.018
ban DFS / mention DFS (Grid); ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA / mention (Shortest path)	0.023 / -0.001	0.047 / -0.018
ban bidirectional BFS / mention (Grid); ban bidirectional Dijkstra / mention (Shortest path)	0.007 / -0.004	0.017 / 0.001
ban IDDFS / mention (Grid); ban Floyd-Warshall / mention (Shortest path)	0.036 / 0.012	0.030 / -0.013
ban A* / mention (Grid); ban Dial / mention (Shortest path)	0.073 / 0.004	0.052 / -0.002
ban unit weight Dijkstra / mention (Grid)	0.051 / 0.010	n/a
Ban minus mention for the modal algorithm (null band)	0.039 (±0.024)	0.053 (±0.025)
Enumeration minus baseline, positive control (null band)	0.544 (±0.047)	0.582 (±0.048)

The forecast record. Forecasts were committed at 16:26:17 UTC, before the ban samples. On the shortest path modal ban all 38 compliant programs were Bellman-Ford/SPFA; the decommitted survivor distribution scored -0.058 and hit, the vLLM frequency forecast -0.219 (hit), the HF frequency forecast -0.238 (hit) and the uniform forecast -1.406. On the grid modal ban (18 compliant: DFS 16, unit weight Dijkstra 2) every forecast was degenerate, because no correct program other than BFS existed before the ban, and all tied at -1.630. The succession events tied as well (16 compliant grid programs, unit weight Dijkstra 13 and A* 3; 1 compliant shortest path program).

What this experiment settled. The decommitment direction exists as a clean difference-in-means direction, shared across tasks, but adding it is a generic perturbation: it moves the shortest path task toward Bellman-Ford/SPFA as a random direction does and costs a sixth of the pass rate, and it

never moves the grid task. Its prompt counterpart, the enumeration prompt, does nothing. A ban moves the read position measurably but slightly toward the list framing. The preregistered verdict was PARTIAL (the diversity gain held on one task, the specificity test failed). vLLM same seed determinism failed on the grid task, so vLLM arms are reproducible in distribution only, and every common random number analysis used HF arms.

1.9 Instruction tuning experiment: did post-training install the collapse?

Why. If instruction tuning installed the collapse, the base model should spread over several algorithms at matched prompts, and subtracting the instruct minus base activation difference should restore that spread inside the instruct model. Base models are reported to be more diverse than aligned ones [35], and chat formatting alone narrows output diversity [36]; this experiment separated the two causes on the two tasks.

Design. A two by two design crossed weights (Qwen3-8B-Base, Qwen3-8B) with format (code completion without a chat template, which we call plain completion, or the instruct chat template), all at temperature 1.0 with top-p 1.0, thinking off. Each program ran on 47 (grid) or 46 (shortest path) hidden tests and was labelled by the tracer and AST rules with Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite as judge on disagreements; a second judge agreed with the first on 95% of 40 audit programs (kappa 0.93). The runtime and AST labels agreed with kappa 0.77 over all parseable programs, but much lower on base-model output (0.20-0.50), where 217 of 292 grid programs in plain completion needed the judge. The sharpening direction is the paired difference between instruct and base read position states over the same chat-templated prompts, per layer from 8 to 28. It was subtracted at c in {0.5, 1.0, 1.5} over the whole band, at the read position only, and at layer 18 only, against two norm-matched random directions. Hardware was one NVIDIA GPU with 23 GB of memory (2.1 GPU hours); judge spend was USD 0.21.

The collapse is sharpened by post-training, not invented by it. Table 24 gives every arm. The instruct model in chat format is collapsed on both tasks. The base model under the same chat tokens writes mostly the same algorithm but less exclusively: BFS in 49 of 57 correct grid programs and Dijkstra in 63 of 90 correct shortest path programs, with Bellman-Ford/SPFA second (24). In plain completion the base model rarely writes a correct program (pass 0.05 and 0.08), and its correct shortest path programs are mostly Bellman-Ford/SPFA (16 of 25).

Table 24. Arms of the instruction tuning experiment (vLLM, T = 1.0). Hill_cc with 95% cluster bootstrap interval; Hill_all over all parseable labelled programs.

Arm	Task	N	Parse rate	Pass [95% Wilson]	Correct	Labels of correct programs	Hill_cc [95%]	Hill_all
base, plain completion	Grid	300	0.97	0.05 [0.03, 0.08]	15	BFS 12, DFS 3	1.65 [1.00, 2.00]	3.34
base, plain completion	Shortest path	300	0.97	0.08 [0.06, 0.12]	25	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 16, Dijkstra 8, Floyd-Warshall 1	2.18 [1.00, 2.73]	3.24
base, chat template	Grid	300	0.58	0.19 [0.15, 0.24]	57	BFS 49, DFS 7, A* 1	1.58 [1.10, 2.06]	3.13
base, chat template	Shortest path	300	0.66	0.30 [0.25, 0.35]	90	Dijkstra 63, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 24, Floyd-Warshall 1, other 2	2.09 [1.63, 2.54]	2.67

instruct, plain completion	Grid	100 0.93	0.73 [0.64, 0.81]	73	BFS 73	1.00 [1.00, 1.00]	1.41
instruct, plain completion	Shortest path	100 0.89	0.72 [0.63, 0.80]	72	Dijkstra 57, Floyd-Warshall 8, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	1.93 [1.41, 2.37]	2.60
instruct, chat template	Grid	200 1.00	1.00 [0.98, 1.00]	200	BFS 200	1.00 [1.00, 1.00]	1.00
instruct, chat template	Shortest path	200 1.00	1.00 [0.98, 1.00]	200	Dijkstra 193, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	1.16 [1.03, 1.31]	1.16
base, plain completion, ban	Grid	100 0.95	0.01 [0.00, 0.05]	1	BFS 1	1.00	3.50
base, plain completion, ban	Shortest path	100 0.98	0.08 [0.04, 0.15]	8	Dijkstra 4, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4	2.00	3.43
instruct, chat template, ban	Grid	100 1.00	0.70 [0.60, 0.78]	70	BFS 57, DFS 12, unit weight Dijkstra 1	1.70 [1.22, 2.25]	2.10
instruct, chat template, ban	Shortest path	100 1.00	1.00 [0.96, 1.00]	100	Dijkstra 54, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 46	1.99 [1.65, 2.00]	1.99

The labels of base-model output lean heavily on the judge, which matters for the base arms' Hill numbers (Table 24b): runtime and AST rules agreed with kappa 0.20-0.50 on base-model programs, and the judge labelled 217 of 292 grid programs in plain completion. The final labels agreed with the judge on 97-100% of programs in every arm, and a 15-program audit per arm found them correct in every arm but one (0.93 on the base chat shortest path arm).

Table 24b. Labeller agreement per generation arm in the instruction tuning experiment.

Arm	Task	Parseable programs	Kappa runtime vs AST	Final label vs judge	Runtime + AST label vs judge	Labelled by the judge
base, plain completion	Grid	292	0.45	0.98	0.91	217
base, plain completion	Shortest path	291	0.20	0.99	0.92	266
base, chat template	Grid	175	0.40	0.99	0.99	94
base, chat template	Shortest path	199	0.50	0.97	0.94	94
base, plain completion, ban	Grid	95	0.43	0.98	0.93	68
base, plain completion, ban	Shortest path	98	0.34	0.99	0.93	83
instruct, chat template	Grid	200	1.00	1.00	1.00	0
instruct, chat template	Shortest path	200	1.00	1.00	1.00	7
instruct, plain completion	Grid	93	0.71	1.00	1.00	17

instruct, plain completion	Shortest path	89	0.89	1.00	1.00	23
instruct, chat template, ban	Grid	100	0.64	1.00	1.00	20
instruct, chat template, ban	Shortest path	100	0.98	1.00	1.00	46

Table 25 gives the preregistered contrasts. The weights effect (instruct chat minus base chat) is negative on both tasks: -0.58 effective algorithms on the grid task and -0.93 on the shortest path task, with intervals excluding zero. The format effect inside the base model is near zero on both tasks, while inside the instruct model the chat format cuts the shortest path Hill number by 0.76. The preregistered verdict was INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on the shortest path task and MIXED on the grid task, where the gap in modal share of 14.0 points fell just short of the 15-point bar; under Hill_all both tasks read INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING. At the originally planned N, before the base arms were extended to 300, both tasks read MIXED. The chat format also switched the base model's shortest path mode from Bellman-Ford/SPFA to Dijkstra.

Table 25. Collapse screen: differences in Hill numbers with paraphrase cluster bootstrap 95% intervals.

Task	Weights effect: instruct chat minus base chat	Format effect in base: chat minus plain completion	Format effect in instruct	Interaction	Verdict (Hill_cc)	Verdict (Hill_all)
Grid (Hill_cc)	-0.58 [-1.01, -0.15]	-0.07 [-0.76, 0.88]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.07 [-0.83, 0.74]	MIXED	INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING
Shortest path (Hill_cc)	-0.93 [-1.38, -0.46]	-0.09 [-0.79, 1.12]	-0.76 [-1.26, -0.23]	-0.67 [-1.73, 0.10]	INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING	INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING
Grid (Hill_all)	-2.13 [-2.66, -1.43]	-0.21 [-1.05, 0.55]	-0.41 [-0.66, -0.15]	-0.19 [-0.94, 0.63]		
Shortest path (Hill_all)	-1.50 [-1.91, -1.06]	-0.57 [-1.04, -0.10]	-1.44 [-2.03, -0.71]	-0.87 [-1.60, 0.04]		

The sharpening direction is a format direction. The instruct minus base difference at the read position was stable (split half cosine 0.998-0.999 across the band) and largely shared between tasks (cosine between the two tasks' differences 0.84-0.93 across layers 8-28), with a relative norm of about 1.0-1.1 of the state at layer 18. The logit lens (reading an intermediate state through the model's unembedding matrix) at layer 28 showed what subtracting it promotes: `def` and `class` on the grid prompts, and `Conversation`, `Claude`, `Prompt` and `chat` on the shortest path prompts. Subtracting it over the band destroyed generation at every coefficient (0 of 100 parseable programs, Table 26); the downstream layers amplified the edit, so the gap to the base state was closed at layer 8 but overshot at layers 18 and 28 (gap closed -0.38 and -0.40 at $c = 1.5$). Read position only subtraction turned the model into thinking style prose (73% and 95% of outputs opened like a thinking trace), and the code it still wrote named BFS and Dijkstra. Subtraction at layer 18 alone kept 94-98% of the pass rate at $c = 0.25$ with no algorithm change. No coefficient of any variant restored diversity.

Table 26. Steering arms of the instruction tuning experiment (HF, coupled seeds; deltas against the hooked c = 0 control).

Task	Arm	N	Parse	Pass	Hill_cc	Delta Hill_cc	Delta pass (points)	Flip rate
Grid	control c = 0	100	1.00	1.00	1.00	n/a	n/a	n/a
Grid	random 1	100	0.96	0.41	1.00	0.00	-59.0	0.04
Grid	random 1, read position only, c = 1.0	100	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	0.0	0.00
Grid	random 2	100	0.98	0.68	1.00	0.00	-32.0	0.01
Grid	sharpening, band, c = 0.5 / 1.0 / 1.5	100 each	0.00	0.00	n/a	n/a	-100.0	n/a
Grid	sharpening, read position only, c = 1.0	100	0.28	0.14	1.00	0.00	-86.0	0.07
Grid	same, no 512-token cutoff	20	0.55	0.15	1.00	0.00	-85.0	0.00
Grid	sharpening, layer 18 only, c = 0.25 / 0.5 / 1.0	50 each	1.00 / 1.00 / 0.00	0.94 / 0.52 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / n/a	0.00 / 0.00 / n/a	-6.0 / -48.0 / -100.0	0.00 / 0.00 / n/a
Shortest path	control c = 0	100	1.00	1.00	1.00	n/a	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	random 1	100	1.00	0.00	n/a	n/a	-100.0	0.00
Shortest path	random 1, read position only, c = 1.0	100	1.00	1.00	1.43	+0.43 [0.12, 0.74]	0.0	0.10
Shortest path	random 2	100	1.00	0.33	1.00	0.00	-67.0	0.36
Shortest path	sharpening, band, c = 0.5 / 1.0 / 1.5	100 each	0.00	0.00	n/a	n/a	-100.0	n/a
Shortest path	sharpening, read position only, c = 1.0	100	0.05	0.05	1.00	0.00	-95.0	0.00
Shortest path	same, no 512-token cutoff	20	0.40	0.20	1.75	+0.75 [0.00, 1.00]	-80.0	0.50
Shortest path	sharpening, layer 18 only, c = 0.25 / 0.5 / 1.0	50 each	1.00 / 1.00 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.98 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.10 / n/a	0.00 / +0.10 / n/a	-2.0 / -2.0 / -100.0	0.00 / 0.02 / n/a

(Correction, iteration 2: Table 26 reports Hill numbers and flip rates but not what the correct programs were, which hides a complete algorithm switch. On the shortest path task band random direction 2 turned all 33 of its correct programs into Bellman-Ford/SPFA, against Dijkstra 100 of 100 in the control, and band random direction 1 left no correct program; the read position only random edit gave Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9 and other 1; layer-18 sharpening at c = 0.5 gave Dijkstra 48 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1; read position sharpening without the cutoff gave Dijkstra 3 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1. On the grid task every correct program in every arm was BFS (41 under band random direction 1, 68 under band random direction 2, 100 under the read position random edit). Source: audit `tables/perturbation_table.csv`*; Section 2.3.5.)*

Table 26b shows why the band subtraction broke the model. The edit closed the gap between instruct and base states completely at layer 8 at c = 1.0, but by layers 18 and 28 the downstream

computation had erased most of the correction, and at c = 1.5 it overshot past the base state.

Table 26b. Manipulation check at the read position: gap closed is 1 minus the ratio of two distances, from the mean steered state to the mean base state and from the mean instruct state to the mean base state, at layers 8, 18 and 28.

Arm	Grid: layers 8 / 18 / 28	Shortest path: layers 8 / 18 / 28
sharpening, band, c = 0.5	0.50 / 0.34 / 0.38	0.50 / 0.37 / 0.38
sharpening, band, c = 1.0	1.00 / 0.05 / 0.01	1.00 / 0.08 / 0.04
sharpening, band, c = 1.5	0.50 / -0.38 / -0.40	0.50 / -0.32 / -0.37
random 1	-0.12 / 0.06 / -0.07	-0.12 / 0.05 / -0.08
random 2	-0.12 / 0.07 / -0.05	-0.12 / 0.06 / -0.05
sharpening, layer 18 only, c = 0.25 / 0.5 / 1.0	0.00 / 0.25 / 0.04; 0.00 / 0.50 / 0.11; 0.00 / 1.00 / 0.36	0.00 / 0.25 / 0.06; 0.00 / 0.50 / 0.13; 0.00 / 1.00 / 0.34
sharpening, read position only, c = 1.0	1.00 / 0.05 / 0.01	1.00 / 0.08 / 0.04
random 1, read position only, c = 1.0	-0.42 / 0.03 / -0.33	-0.42 / 0.03 / -0.31

The ban prompt did better than any steering arm: on the shortest path task it raised Hill_cc from 1.16 to 1.99 with no loss of pass rate, the best price of any knob in the run (the artifact's efficiency score was 0.830), and on the grid task to 1.70 for 30 pass points. The base model, by contrast, did not obey bans: the banned share of the base model in plain completion moved from 0.46 to 0.36 on the grid task and from 0.25 to 0.27 on the shortest path task, with 0 and 4 compliant programs.

The forecast record. The base model's own survivor distribution, committed before the instruct ban samples, nominated DFS and Bellman-Ford/SPFA and hit both (log scores -0.470 and -0.220 against uniform -1.630 and -1.406). The base chat distribution did as well (-0.412 and -0.058), and on the shortest path task so did the instruct chat distribution (-0.058), because Bellman-Ford/SPFA was the second algorithm in every reference distribution.

What this experiment settled. Post-training concentrated an ordering the base model already had (BFS first, Dijkstra first in chat format, Bellman-Ford/SPFA second on the shortest path task); it did not install a new attractor. *(Correction, iteration 2: the preregistered verdicts stay as recorded above, INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on the shortest path task and MIXED on the grid task, and MIXED on both at the planned sample size; the base ordering matches the instruct ordering only under the chat template, and in plain completion the base model's shortest path mode is Bellman-Ford/SPFA, first rather than second.)* The direction that separates instruct from base states is about answer format, and subtracting it breaks the model rather than freeing it. This alternate passed its screen under the preregistered rule, but the pass rests on the shortest path task and on extended sample sizes, and the knob it implies does not work.

1.10 Decoding experiment: temperature, top-k, random seeds and creativity instructions

Why. The request asks three things directly: whether a tight temperature with top-k = 10 yields one idea in many phrasings or many ideas, whether loosening temperature multiplies ideas or phrasings, and whether a random "seed" in the prompt (an entropy string or a list of unrelated words) pushes the model into a different region of its solution space. The account screened here says that temperature and random seeds change wording and leave the algorithm alone, and that only context with meaning moves it, in line with the finding that temperature correlates only

weakly with novelty [37]. This experiment also produced the request's literal first figure, the BFS fraction by temperature.

Design. The experiment drew 5,220 generations on one RTX 5090 with vLLM in eager mode, N = 100 per cell (10 paraphrases of 10 samples). Besides the no cue baseline, a temperature grid crossed T in {0.3, 0.7, 1.0, 1.3} with top-k = 10 and top-p = 0.95, once with thinking off and once with thinking on (thinking capped at 2,048 tokens). Three seed conditions added an entropy seed (`seed=d32qxk4nt43`), a word seed (`seed=(horse chair roof love)`) or a semantic seed, a paragraph that implies without naming a search from both ends on the grid task and a relaxation over all edges on the shortest path task. Four instructions followed, which we call the creativity instruction (`be creative`), the new algorithm instruction (`make a new algorithm`), the novelty instruction (`make a fully novel algorithm never seen before`) and, as in Section 1.8, the enumeration prompt (`list 10 approaches, then implement one`). In the generate then select arm the model listed ten approaches and an external random draw picked the one it had to implement. For the read position analyses, forced implementations of every catalogue algorithm (20 framings each) defined the mode subspace, and three further conditions were encoded without generation: a fresh entropy seed and a fresh word seed (a different random string or word list for each paraphrase) and a neutral sentence of matched length. OpenRouter spend was USD 0.11. The labeller failed its strict gate on both tasks (Table 2), so every number here is descriptive.

The BFS fraction does not depend on temperature or sampler. Table 27 answers the request's BFS question. With thinking off, 797 of 800 grid programs across the eight temperature and sampler cells were BFS and every cell was at least 0.99 BFS; with thinking on, 800 of 800 were. On the shortest path task 797 of 800 were Dijkstra with thinking off and 800 of 800 with thinking on. A chart of these shares would be a flat line at 1.0, so the table stands alone.

Table 27. Share of programs that are BFS (grid task) or Dijkstra (shortest path task) across the temperature grid (N = 100 per cell; all other labels listed; pass = share passing the hidden tests).

Task	Thinking	Sampler	T = 0.3	T = 0.7	T = 1.0	T = 1.3
Grid	off	top-k = 10	BFS 100 (pass 1.00)	BFS 99, DFS 1 (0.98)	BFS 100 (0.98)	BFS 99, DFS 1 (0.95)
Grid	off	top-p = 0.95	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 99, DFS 1 (0.97)
Grid	on	top-k = 10	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (0.98)	BFS 100 (1.00)
Grid	on	top-p = 0.95	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (1.00)	BFS 100 (0.99)	BFS 100 (1.00)
Shortest path	off	top-k = 10	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (0.99)	Dijkstra 99, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1 (0.98)	Dijkstra 99, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1 (1.00)
Shortest path	off	top-p = 0.95	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (0.97)	Dijkstra 99, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1 (0.99)
Shortest path	on	top-k = 10	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)
Shortest path	on	top-p = 0.95	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)	Dijkstra 100 (1.00)

The no cue baseline at T = 1.0 without top-k or top-p gave BFS 99 and unit weight Dijkstra 1 (pass 0.97) and Dijkstra 100 (pass 0.99).

Ideas and phrasings. We count ideas as distinct runtime labelled algorithms among correct programs. A *phrasing cluster* is a connected component, within one algorithm, of programs whose

identifier normalised AST 4-gram shingle sets have Jaccard similarity at or above a threshold theta. Identifiers are renamed in order of appearance, and comments, docstrings and constants are dropped. Theta 0.8 is primary, 0.7 and 0.9 are sensitivity values, and complete linkage is a robustness check. The *phrasings per idea* is the rarefied number of phrasing clusters divided by the rarefied number of ideas at a depth of 25 programs. Table 28 gives the full ideas by phrasings table, which answers the request's question 1a-c. At the tightest setting (T = 0.3, top-k = 10, thinking off) the model wrote one idea in 4 phrasing clusters on the grid task and 1 on the shortest path task. Loosening temperature multiplied phrasings and left ideas at one or two: on the grid task the clusters at theta 0.8 rose from 4 to 36 (top-k) and from 3 to 24 (top-p) between T = 0.3 and T = 1.3. Output with thinking on was more varied in wording at every temperature (26 clusters at T = 0.3 with top-k) but never in algorithm. The shortest path programs are shorter and more uniform (one to six clusters with thinking off). Figure 3 plots the clusters at theta 0.8 against temperature.

Table 28. Ideas by phrasings (correct programs only). Phrasing clusters at theta 0.7 / 0.8 / 0.9 with single linkage, at 0.8 with complete linkage, and phrasings per idea at theta 0.8.

Task	Thinking	Sampler	T	Correct	Ideas	Clusters 0.7 / 0.8 / 0.9	Complete linkage 0.8	Phrasings per idea
Grid	off	none (baseline)	1.0	97	2	15 / 21 / 32	29	7.48
Grid	off	top-k = 10	0.3	100	1	4 / 4 / 6	7	3.21
Grid	off	top-k = 10	0.7	98	1	11 / 13 / 17	18	6.20
Grid	off	top-k = 10	1.0	98	1	19 / 22 / 36	32	9.57
Grid	off	top-k = 10	1.3	95	2	31 / 36 / 54	50	10.96
Grid	off	top-p = 0.95	0.3	100	1	3 / 3 / 5	5	2.91
Grid	off	top-p = 0.95	0.7	100	1	7 / 8 / 10	12	4.73
Grid	off	top-p = 0.95	1.0	100	1	11 / 15 / 28	26	7.44
Grid	off	top-p = 0.95	1.3	97	1	21 / 24 / 41	36	9.58
Grid	on	top-k = 10	0.3	100	1	18 / 26 / 41	36	11.69
Grid	on	top-k = 10	0.7	100	1	24 / 36 / 57	48	14.36
Grid	on	top-k = 10	1.0	98	1	36 / 49 / 67	60	16.43
Grid	on	top-k = 10	1.3	100	1	39 / 55 / 73	68	17.60
Grid	on	top-p = 0.95	0.3	100	1	25 / 31 / 46	41	12.32
Grid	on	top-p = 0.95	0.7	100	1	29 / 41 / 57	51	15.21
Grid	on	top-p = 0.95	1.0	99	1	26 / 35 / 56	47	13.51
Grid	on	top-p = 0.95	1.3	100	1	41 / 53 / 78	66	17.65
Shortest path	off	none (baseline)	1.0	99	1	3 / 3 / 17	10	2.24
Shortest path	off	top-k = 10	0.3	100	1	1 / 1 / 3	2	1.00
Shortest path	off	top-k = 10	0.7	99	1	2 / 2 / 7	5	1.59
Shortest path	off	top-k = 10	1.0	98	2	3 / 3 / 14	10	1.62
Shortest path	off	top-k = 10	1.3	100	2	5 / 6 / 15	11	2.26
Shortest path	off	top-p = 0.95	0.3	100	1	2 / 2 / 3	2	1.25

Shortest path	off	top-p = 0.95	0.7 100	1	3 / 3 / 7	4	1.69
Shortest path	off	top-p = 0.95	1.0 97	1	2 / 2 / 9	5	1.70
Shortest path	off	top-p = 0.95	1.3 99	1	3 / 3 / 9	6	1.84
Shortest path	on	top-k = 10	0.3 100	1	2 / 3 / 18	14	2.25
Shortest path	on	top-k = 10	0.7 100	1	3 / 4 / 17	11	2.69
Shortest path	on	top-k = 10	1.0 100	1	4 / 7 / 24	19	3.25
Shortest path	on	top-k = 10	1.3 100	1	10 / 12 / 32	26	5.46
Shortest path	on	top-p = 0.95	0.3 100	1	3 / 3 / 13	9	2.25
Shortest path	on	top-p = 0.95	0.7 100	1	2 / 4 / 16	12	2.50
Shortest path	on	top-p = 0.95	1.0 100	1	2 / 3 / 16	13	2.25
Shortest path	on	top-p = 0.95	1.3 100	1	3 / 4 / 20	15	3.02

[Figure fig_phrasings: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Table 29 gives the bootstrap slopes of log phrasings per idea in temperature. The slope was positive with a 95% interval above zero in six of eight task-sampler-thinking combinations at theta 0.8; the two exceptions were the shortest path task with top-p, thinking off (0.365, interval -0.077 to 0.759) and thinking on (0.232, interval -0.0 to 0.484). The slope of log ideas was zero everywhere except the thinking off top-k cells (0.203 on the grid task, 0.266 on the shortest path task), where single non-modal programs appeared at the highest temperatures. The preregistered criterion (positive slope at every theta and sampler, with the paired interval above zero) held on the grid task and failed on the shortest path task.

Table 29. Slope of log phrasings per idea against temperature (per unit T; 1,000 bootstrap draws; single linkage) at theta 0.7, 0.8 and 0.9, with 95% intervals, and the slope of log ideas (identical at every theta).

Task	Sampler	Thinking	Theta 0.7	Theta 0.8	Theta 0.9	Slope, ideas
Grid	top-k = 10	off	1.138 [0.808, 1.409]	1.265 [0.902, 1.547]	1.440 [0.990, 1.727]	0.203 [0.0, 0.41]
Grid	top-p = 0.95	off	1.083 [0.835, 1.253]	1.223 [0.975, 1.368]	1.435 [1.182, 1.620]	0.0
Grid	top-k = 10	on	0.563 [0.282, 0.784]	0.417 [0.213, 0.567]	0.233 [0.072, 0.321]	0.0
Grid	top-p = 0.95	on	0.289 [0.113, 0.602]	0.293 [0.134, 0.486]	0.247 [0.123, 0.351]	0.0
Shortest path	top-k = 10	off	0.693 [0.442, 1.001]	0.758 [0.453, 1.044]	1.295 [0.916, 1.849]	0.266 [0.0, 0.486]
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	off	0.365 [-0.102, 0.757]	0.365 [-0.077, 0.759]	1.101 [0.780, 1.475]	0.0

Shortest path	top-k = 10	on	0.752 [0.449, 0.956]	0.846 [0.520, 1.075]	0.408 [0.213, 0.567]	0.0
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	on	-0.011 [-0.245, 0.222]	0.232 [-0.0, 0.484]	0.205 [0.017, 0.355]	0.0

Thinking traces do not explore. Every thinking on trace hit the 2,048-token cap, so no trace completed. In the 800 grid traces the first approach named was BFS in all but one, and DFS was mentioned as a second option in 67-90% of traces depending on the cell; the implemented algorithm equalled the first approach named in 99-100% of traces. In the shortest path traces the first approach was Dijkstra in 98-100% and Bellman-Ford/SPFA was mentioned in 1-5% (Table 30). The plan-statement lexicon used to read the traces had precision 0.62 and recall 0.482 against a judge on 30 traces, so these counts are approximate.

Table 30. Approaches named in thinking traces (N = 100 per cell; all traces truncated at 2,048 tokens).

Task	Sampler	T	First approach named	Also considered	Mean approaches considered	First equals implemented
Grid	top-k = 10	0.3	BFS 100	DFS 67	1.67	1.00
Grid	top-k = 10	0.7	BFS 100	DFS 78	1.78	1.00
Grid	top-k = 10	1.0	BFS 100	DFS 84, A* 1	1.85	1.00
Grid	top-k = 10	1.3	BFS 99, DFS 1	DFS 90	1.90	0.99
Grid	top-p = 0.95	0.3	BFS 100	DFS 70	1.70	1.00
Grid	top-p = 0.95	0.7	BFS 100	DFS 77	1.77	1.00
Grid	top-p = 0.95	1.0	BFS 100	DFS 84	1.84	1.00
Grid	top-p = 0.95	1.3	BFS 100	DFS 85, A* 1	1.86	1.00
Shortest path	top-k = 10	0.3	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	1.02	1.00
Shortest path	top-k = 10	0.7	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	1.02	1.00
Shortest path	top-k = 10	1.0	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.03	1.00
Shortest path	top-k = 10	1.3	Dijkstra 98, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 2	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4	1.04	0.98
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	0.3	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	1.01	1.00
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	0.7	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.03	1.00
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	1.0	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4, Floyd-Warshall 1	1.05	1.00
Shortest path	top-p = 0.95	1.3	Dijkstra 100	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.03	1.00

Seeds and instructions. Random seeds did nothing to the output (Table 31): the entropy and word seeds shifted the modal share by about 1 point on the grid task and 0 on the shortest path task, with 90% intervals inside the preregistered 15-point equivalence bound. The semantic seed moved the shortest path task by 66.3 points toward Bellman-Ford/SPFA among correct programs (61 of 92

correct programs, while the Dijkstra share fell by 67.39 points; permutation $p < 0.001$; corrected in iteration 2 from 67 points, which is the fall in the Dijkstra share) and the grid task by 2.2 points toward bidirectional BFS (2 of 93 correct programs; permutation $p = 0.078$ for the shift toward the implied algorithm). Among the instructions, the creativity instruction did nothing and the new algorithm instruction moved 1-4 points. The novelty instruction moved 3.7 points on the grid task and 14.6 points on the shortest path task, toward Bellman-Ford/SPFA. The enumeration prompt moved 10.7 points on the shortest path task at a 24-point pass-rate cost.

Table 31. Seeds and instructions (N = 100 each; labels of correct programs; shift of the default's share against the baseline, with 90% interval; cluster permutation p).

Task	Condition	Pass	Labels of correct programs	Default share shift (points) [90%]	p
Grid	baseline (reference)	0.97	BFS 96, unit weight Dijkstra 1	n/a	n/a
Grid	entropy seed	1.00	BFS 100	+1.03 [0.0, 4.08]	0.086
Grid	word seed	1.00	BFS 100	+1.03 [0.0, 4.04]	0.096
Grid	semantic seed	0.93	BFS 91, bidirectional BFS 2	-1.12 [-5.47, 3.03]	0.402
Grid	creativity instruction	1.00	BFS 100	+1.03 [0.0, 4.04]	0.085
Grid	new algorithm instruction	0.94	BFS 92, DFS 2	-1.10 [-5.26, 3.0]	0.329
Grid	novelty instruction	0.85	BFS 81, unit weight Dijkstra 2, DFS 1, A* 1	-3.68 [-9.19, 0.98]	0.031
Grid	enumeration prompt	0.99	BFS 99	+1.03 [0.0, 4.0]	0.246
Shortest path	baseline (reference)	0.99	Dijkstra 99	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	entropy seed	1.00	Dijkstra 100	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]	1.0
Shortest path	word seed	1.00	Dijkstra 100	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]	1.0
Shortest path	semantic seed	0.92	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30, Floyd-Warshall 1	-67.39 [-87.18, -46.39]	<0.001
Shortest path	creativity instruction	0.99	Dijkstra 99	0.0 [0.0, 0.0]	1.0
Shortest path	new algorithm instruction	0.94	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4	-4.26 [-9.47, 0.0]	0.012
Shortest path	novelty instruction	0.96	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 14	-14.58 [-25.26, -5.44]	0.001
Shortest path	enumeration prompt	0.75	Dijkstra 67, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 8	-10.67 [-20.38, -3.57]	0.001

The generate then select arm was the only one to reach several algorithms. On the grid task its correct programs were BFS 26, A* 14, unit weight Dijkstra 9 and DFS 6 (Hill_cc 3.457) at a pass rate of 0.55; on the shortest path task Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 29 and Floyd-Warshall 15 (Hill_cc 2.87) at 0.75. The rarefied number of ideas at depth 25 was 3.977 and 2.999, against 1.258 and 1.0 for the baseline. Every one of the 100 stage-1 lists named all six grid algorithms, so the model knows the repertoire it does not use.

Seeds at the read position. The subspace test asks whether a condition moves the read position state along the mode subspace (the span of the forced implementation centroids, dimension 5 on

the grid task and 4 on the shortest path task) more than switching between baseline paraphrases does. The statistic is the ratio of the median displacement under the condition to the median paraphrase displacement (Table 32, Figure 4). The entropy seed stayed within the paraphrase noise (0.734 and 1.165). *(Correction, iteration 2: on the shortest path task its 90% interval reaches 1.596, above the 1.5 equivalence bound, so equivalence with paraphrase noise was not shown there.)* The word seed moved the grid state 1.555 times the noise (90% interval 1.309 to 1.85), above the preregistered 1.5 bound, although a fresh word seed with a different word list per paraphrase moved it only 1.055 times and a neutral sentence of the same length 0.812 times. The semantic seed moved the state 3.4 and 3.7 times the noise, and on the grid task its displacement pointed toward the implied centroid (cosine 0.493) while the output did not follow. *(Added in iteration 2: the other half of the same result was omitted. On the shortest path task the semantic seed's displacement did not point toward the Bellman-Ford/SPFA centroid (cosine -0.087), yet the output moved 66.3 points toward it, and the fixed word seed moved the grid probe's decoded distribution 0.88 toward A* with no behavioural change. Displacement along the mode subspace predicted behavioural movement in neither direction; Section 2.3.8.)* The instructions that changed behaviour also moved the state: the novelty instruction 1.809 and 3.063, the enumeration prompt 2.757 and 2.959. A probe from the read position to the label distribution did not beat its shuffled label null on the shortest path task (mean JS 0.122 against a 5th percentile of 0.121), so the mode subspace there rests on forced prompts that the natural output never visits.

Table 32. Subspace test: median displacement along the mode subspace relative to the paraphrase null, with 90% interval (grid task at layer 27, subspace dimension 5; shortest path task at layer 22, dimension 4). Conditions marked * were encoded without generation.

Condition	Grid ratio [90%]	Shortest path ratio [90%]
entropy seed	0.734 [0.579, 0.875]	1.165 [1.0, 1.596]
word seed	1.555 [1.309, 1.85]	1.012 [0.865, 1.401]
fresh entropy seed*	0.664 [0.53, 0.825]	0.968 [0.796, 1.365]
fresh word seed*	1.055 [0.842, 1.314]	0.927 [0.756, 1.252]
neutral sentence*	0.812 [0.561, 1.073]	1.288 [1.002, 1.932]
semantic seed	3.417 [2.876, 4.211]	3.70 [3.005, 4.951]
creativity instruction	1.041 [0.846, 1.436]	1.684 [1.304, 2.35]
new algorithm instruction	1.302 [0.979, 1.637]	1.017 [0.79, 1.963]
novelty instruction	1.809 [1.509, 2.173]	3.063 [2.523, 4.158]
enumeration prompt	2.757 [2.251, 3.435]	2.959 [2.382, 4.016]

[Figure fig_subspace: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The same ratios four layers before and after the analysis layer keep the ordering (Table 32b). The semantic seed and the enumeration prompt stay at two to four times the noise and the random seeds stay near 1. The exception is the shortest path task at layer 18, where the neutral sentence (1.812) and the entropy seed (1.484) also exceed 1.4.

Table 32b. Subspace test ratios at layers four before and four after the analysis layer (90% intervals).

Condition	Grid layer 23	Grid layer 31	Shortest path layer 18	Shortest path layer 26
entropy seed	0.846 [0.771, 1.023]	0.777 [0.648, 0.962]	1.484 [1.153, 1.953]	0.953 [0.707, 1.411]

word seed	1.921 [1.665, 2.170]	1.504 [1.311, 1.897]	1.331 [1.031, 1.786]	1.072 [0.793, 1.508]
fresh entropy seed*	0.883 [0.708, 1.079]	0.737 [0.634, 0.942]	1.278 [1.053, 1.687]	0.791 [0.604, 1.187]
fresh word seed*	1.294 [1.082, 1.632]	1.067 [0.918, 1.434]	1.238 [0.903, 1.581]	0.871 [0.655, 1.343]
neutral sentence*	0.777 [0.607, 1.044]	0.879 [0.577, 1.203]	1.812 [1.238, 2.674]	0.901 [0.667, 1.348]
semantic seed	3.806 [3.314, 4.437]	3.237 [2.809, 4.270]	3.427 [2.801, 4.364]	4.009 [3.166, 5.873]
creativity instruction	1.525 [1.301, 1.822]	1.048 [0.894, 1.607]	2.128 [1.672, 2.813]	1.093 [0.843, 1.721]
new algorithm instruction	1.611 [1.259, 2.062]	1.220 [0.900, 1.687]	1.770 [1.349, 2.274]	0.848 [0.672, 1.698]
novelty instruction	2.717 [2.234, 3.159]	1.838 [1.590, 2.363]	3.410 [2.647, 4.329]	2.291 [1.675, 3.270]
enumeration prompt	3.242 [2.827, 3.858]	2.614 [2.303, 3.308]	4.257 [3.537, 5.363]	2.005 [1.541, 3.101]

Where temperature acts in the trajectory. Over the first 64 generated tokens, the variance of the residual-stream states rose with temperature almost entirely outside the mode subspace (Table 33). On the grid task the complement variance rose from 36,267 to 46,308 between T = 0.3 and T = 1.3 while the share in the mode subspace estimated from generated tokens stayed at 0.061-0.062. The preregistered prediction was a nonpositive slope of the share in excess of a null matched to the data; the slope was slightly positive (0.006 and 0.015 per unit T, intervals above zero), so the prediction failed, although the excess itself stayed negative at every temperature on both tasks. In the mode subspace estimated at the read position the share was 0.004 (grid) and 0.003 (shortest path) at every temperature, and a subspace from naturally sampled programs could not be estimated because 399 of 400 programs per task were the default.

Table 33. Variance of trajectory states (first 64 generated tokens) inside the mode subspace estimated from generated tokens, per temperature (N = 50 per cell).

Task (layer)	T	Share in mode subspace	Excess over null matched to the data	Mode subspace variance	Complement variance
Grid (27)	0.3	0.062	-0.023	2,733	36,267
Grid (27)	0.7	0.062	-0.022	2,970	39,928
Grid (27)	1.0	0.061	-0.020	3,334	46,586
Grid (27)	1.3	0.062	-0.016	3,375	46,308
Shortest path (22)	0.3	0.018	-0.050	9	422
Shortest path (22)	0.7	0.035	-0.032	113	2,808
Shortest path (22)	1.0	0.041	-0.025	194	4,206
Shortest path (22)	1.3	0.030	-0.037	205	5,825

The forecast record. Eight predictions were committed before generation; six hit. The two misses were the predictions that random seeds stay within 1.5 times the paraphrase null at the read position (the grid word seed exceeded it) and that the excess mode subspace share has a

nonpositive slope in temperature. The preregistered verdict was MIXED.

What this experiment settled. Temperature and the sampler are phrasing knobs on these tasks: they never changed the algorithm from 0.3 to 1.3, with or without thinking, while the number of distinct phrasings rose severalfold. Random seeds do not change the output, and apart from the fixed grid word seed their effect on the read position state is at most that of an arbitrary sentence. Context with meaning does move the algorithm, but not reliably: the same semantic seed moved the shortest path task by 66.3 points and the grid task by 2.2 (among correct programs; corrected in iteration 2 from 67 and 2). Explicit novelty instructions move little, and generate then select reaches three to four algorithms at a 24-42-point pass-rate cost.

1.11 Comparisons across the six experiments

The strategy deferred the scorecard that combines all experiments to an evaluation artifact in the next iteration. The comparisons below were compiled for this report from each experiment's per-sample rows and result files; the replication table was recomputed with `work/replication.py` in this workspace.

The same ban, five draws. Five experiments ran the same modal ban under the shared protocol, each with its own ten paraphrases of `Do not use X`, its own test suite and, in one case, its own engine. Where the ban had compliant samples, they landed on Bellman-Ford/SPFA on the shortest path task in all five draws (272 of 272 compliant programs), and on DFS on the grid task in four of five draws; in the geometry draw, sampled with HF `generate` and with the highest banned share (0.62), the 18 compliant programs split into DFS 10 and unit weight Dijkstra 8, with no clear mode (Table 34). *(Corrected in iteration 2; this sentence previously said that the compliant samples landed on the same substitute every time, DFS on the grid task with a few unit weight Dijkstra programs, which Tables 13 and 34 contradict. Section 2.3.3 gives the per draw counts.)* How often the ban was obeyed did not replicate. The banned mode share ranged from 0.10 to 0.62 on the grid task and from 0.09 to 0.72 on the shortest path task. Within each experiment it depended on the wording: on the grid task the banned counts per paraphrase ranged from 0 of 10 to 9 or 10 of 10 in four of the five experiments (Figure 5). The association experiment's paraphrases were the most effective (eight of ten grid wordings gave 0 of 10 BFS), which is why its compliance looked high. Constraints that oppose a model's default pattern are known to fail at rates between 10% and 100% [38]; here the spread occurs within one model, one task and one ban. Compliance is therefore a property of the ban sentence at least as much as of the banned algorithm, and any analysis that relates ban failure to properties of the algorithm (the ladder limit test) has to hold the wording fixed or model it.

Table 34. The modal ban across experiments (N = 100 each; recomputed from per-sample rows; compliant = correct and not the banned algorithm).

Experiment (engine)	Grid ban BFS: labels	Banned share	Compliant (labels)	Shortest path ban Dijkstra: labels	Banned share	Compliant (labels)
Association (vLLM)	DFS 90, BFS 10	0.10	38 (DFS 38)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 90, Dijkstra 9, other 1	0.09	86 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 86)

Geometry (HF)	BFS 62, DFS 29, unit weight Dijkstra 9	0.62	18 (DFS 10, unit weight Dijkstra 8)	Dijkstra 72, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 27, other 1	0.72	22 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 22)
Forking token (vLLM)	DFS 78, BFS 21, unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.21	41 (DFS 40, unit weight Dijkstra 1)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 80, Dijkstra 20	0.20	80 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 80)
Decommitment (vLLM)	BFS 49, DFS 48, unit weight Dijkstra 2, other 1	0.49	18 (DFS 16, unit weight Dijkstra 2)	Dijkstra 54, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 40, other 6	0.54	38 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 38)
Instruction tuning (vLLM)	BFS 62, DFS 36, unit weight Dijkstra 2	0.62	13 (DFS 12, unit weight Dijkstra 1)	Dijkstra 54, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 46	0.54	46 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 46)
Pooled, five draws (row added in iteration 2)	n/a	0.41	128 (DFS 116, unit weight Dijkstra 12); DFS share 0.906, Wilson [0.843, 0.946]	n/a	0.42	272 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 272); share 1.0, Wilson [0.986, 1.000]

[Figure fig_replication: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Two elicitations of the same association map disagree. The association and geometry experiments asked the same model the same question with different prompt wordings and got different maps (Table 35). For BFS one map put unit weight Dijkstra first with clarity 0.20 and the other put A* first with clarity 0.80; for Dijkstra one put Bellman-Ford/SPFA first with clarity 1.0 and the other put Dial first with clarity 0.579. The realised substitutes (DFS, Bellman-Ford/SPFA) were ranked last for BFS and third for Dijkstra in the second map. The ranking instrument is not stable under rewording, and where its two versions disagree, neither matches the free-form answer the model gives when asked directly.

Table 35. The association map of the two default algorithms in the two experiments that elicited it (20 sampled rankings each; 19 for Dijkstra in the geometry experiment).

X	Elicitation	Borda shares of the alternatives	Winner	Clarity	Kendall's W
BFS	association experiment	unit weight Dijkstra 0.293, bidirectional BFS 0.283, A* 0.263, IDDFS 0.107, DFS 0.054	unit weight Dijkstra	0.20	0.52
BFS	geometry experiment	A* 0.371, unit weight Dijkstra 0.288, bidirectional BFS 0.229, IDDFS 0.107, DFS 0.005	A*	0.80	0.886
Dijkstra	association experiment	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 0.492, Floyd-Warshall 0.226, bidirectional Dijkstra 0.153, Dial 0.129	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	1.0	0.639
Dijkstra	geometry experiment	Dial 0.424, bidirectional Dijkstra 0.314, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 0.212, Floyd-Warshall 0.051	Dial	0.579	0.581

The PREDICT column. Every forecasting family was scored by the experiment that owned it, on that experiment's own draw of the two modal ban events, and all forecasts were committed before the samples (Table 36). The selection rule needs at least three events on which the families' top-1 nominations disagree; the screen produced two shared events (the step-2 events had too few compliant samples or were exploratory), so the rule cannot name a survivor. *(Correction, iteration 2:*

the rule also gates events on compliance of at least 50%. Under that gate the geometry, instruction tuning and decommitment shortest path events in Table 36 are excluded, the base model, decommitted and geodesic forecasts were scored only on excluded events, and the ranking that follows rests largely on them. On gated events no family can advance; Section 2.3.7.) Descriptively, the highest scoring forecasts on both events were those that already put most of their mass on the realised substitute before the ban: the model's free-form answer, the listing control distribution, the base model's own distribution and, on the shortest path task, the decommitted distribution. All of them rank the realised substitute second in the preferences the model shows before any ban. The preregistered association map was the worst or second worst forecast in both experiments that elicited it on the grid event. The geodesic kernel beat uniform by 0.29 nats on the grid event and lost to the uniform forecast based on frequency on the shortest path event.

Table 36. PREDICT column: raw log score of every committed forecast on the modal ban events (each experiment scored on its own samples; higher is better; uniform over survivors is -1.630 on the grid task and -1.406 on the shortest path task under the shared mix and floor). The geometry experiment scored every sample not labelled as the banned algorithm rather than only compliant ones.

Forecast family (experiment)	Grid ban BFS	Shortest path ban Dijkstra
Association map, Borda (association)	-2.817	-0.755
Association map, first rank (association)	-2.474	-0.190
External association map, Llama-3.1-8B (association)	-1.412	-0.928
Free-form answer about the standard alternative (association, not preregistered as a contest predictor)	-0.112	-0.058
Listing control distribution (association, not preregistered as a contest predictor)	-0.061	-0.058
Latent frequency, uniform under collapse (association)	-1.630	-1.406
Association map, Borda (geometry)	-3.543	-1.647
Geodesic kernel (geometry)	-1.337	-1.530
Read position decoder (geometry)	-1.287	-1.587
Latent frequency (geometry)	-1.630	-1.496
Decommitted survivor distribution (decommitment)	-1.630, degenerate	-0.058
vLLM frequency forecast (decommitment)	-1.630	-0.219
Base model, plain completion, all samples (instruction tuning, primary)	-0.470	-0.220
Base model, chat template, correct samples (instruction tuning)	-0.412	-0.058
Instruct model, chat template, correct samples (instruction tuning)	-1.630	-0.058

The BUY column. The rule asks for the highest correctness conditioned Hill number at the strongest setting that keeps at least 80% of the baseline pass rate. Table 37 lists every knob that reached that pass-rate floor with a Hill gain, and the main ones that did not; Figure 6 plots the shortest path knobs as Hill gain against pass-rate points lost. On the grid task the cumulative ban of BFS and DFS kept 88% of its reference pass rate in the decommitment draw and produced 16 compliant programs over two algorithms (unit weight Dijkstra 13, A* 3), but it does not replicate: the geometry draw (pass 0.96 against 0.99) put all 18 of its compliant programs on unit weight Dijkstra, and the association draw (pass 0.53 against 0.933) left 5 compliant programs; the novelty instruction raised Hill_cc to 1.27. *(Corrected in iteration 2; this sentence previously said that no knob keeping 80% of the pass rate produced a second algorithm among compliant programs and that the gain*

of the cumulative ban came from programs that still used BFS, which the decommitment row of Table 37 contradicts. Section 2.3.4.) On the shortest path task the prompt ban and the semantic seed reached about 2 effective algorithms at no or small pass cost, while the activation knobs (decommitment, a random direction) reached about +0.6 at 17 points. By the rule's 0.5 margin the prompt ban and the semantic seed tie, so both would advance. *(Correction, iteration 2: the BUY rule names a winner only on the pooled tasks and in direction on each task, and this comparison used the shortest path task alone, with Hill numbers from different statistics. Recomputed with one statistic, rarefied Hill-1 over compliant programs, no knob advances on either task, the prompt ban scores 1.0 on the shortest path task, and the positive target of a second correct algorithm at under 20 pass points is met on neither task; Section 2.3.6.)* The table also exposes a flaw in the metric: Hill_cc counts correct programs of the banned algorithm, so a ban that half fails scores as two algorithms. The prompt-ban rows on the shortest path task are Dijkstra mixed with Bellman-Ford/SPFA; only the semantic seed and generate then select produced diversity without a banned algorithm in the mix.

Table 37. BUY column: knobs on the two tasks, with pass rate relative to their own reference, and the Hill number or its change as each artifact reported it.

Task	Knob (experiment)	Pass / reference pass	Reaches 80% floor	Hill_cc (or Delta Hill)	Correct program composition
Shortest path	prompt ban (instruction tuning)	1.00 / 1.00	yes	1.99	Dijkstra 54, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 46
Shortest path	semantic seed (decoding)	0.92 / 0.99	yes	1.988	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30, Floyd-Warshall 1
Shortest path	prompt ban (geometry)	0.94 / 1.00	yes	1.723	Dijkstra 72 correct banned plus Bellman-Ford/SPFA 22
Shortest path	prompt ban (forking token)	1.00 / 0.995	yes	1.649	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 80, Dijkstra 20
Shortest path	novelty instruction (decoding)	0.96 / 0.99	yes	1.515	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 14
Shortest path	prompt ban (association)	0.95 / 1.00	yes	1.368	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 86, Dijkstra 9
Shortest path	prompt ban (decommitment)	0.87 / 0.89	yes	Delta +0.79	Dijkstra 49, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 38
Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	0.78 / 0.95	yes (82%)	Delta +0.65	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1
Shortest path	random direction, c = 0.25 (decommitment)	0.79 / 0.95	yes (83%)	Delta +0.59	Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26
Shortest path	generate then select (decoding)	0.75 / 0.99	no (76%)	2.87	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 29, Floyd-Warshall 15
Shortest path	enumeration prompt (decoding)	0.75 / 0.99	no	1.404	Dijkstra 67, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 8
Shortest path	temperature 1.0-1.3, top-k = 10 (decoding)	0.98-1.00 / 0.99	yes	1.058-1.059	Dijkstra with one Bellman-Ford/SPFA
Shortest path	sharpening subtraction, any variant (instruction tuning)	0.00-0.98 / 1.00	only at layer 18, c of 0.5 or less	1.00-1.10	Dijkstra

Grid	cumulative ban of BFS and DFS (decommitment)	0.88 / 1.00	yes	Delta +1.27	BFS 65, unit weight Dijkstra 13, DFS 7, A* 3
Grid	novelty instruction (decoding)	0.85 / 0.97	yes	1.27	BFS 81, unit weight Dijkstra 2, DFS 1, A* 1
Grid	prompt ban (geometry)	0.76 / 0.99	no (77%)	2.034	BFS 58 correct banned, DFS 10, unit weight Dijkstra 8
Grid	prompt ban (instruction tuning)	0.70 / 1.00	no	1.70	BFS 57, DFS 12, unit weight Dijkstra 1
Grid	prompt ban (association)	0.46 / 0.933	no	1.587	DFS 38, BFS 8
Grid	generate then select (decoding)	0.55 / 0.97	no	3.457	BFS 26, A* 14, unit weight Dijkstra 9, DFS 6
Grid	decommitment direction, any c	0.98 at $c = 0.1$	yes at $c = 0.1$	1.0	BFS
Grid	temperature, any setting (decoding)	0.95-1.00	yes	1.0-1.06	BFS

[Figure fig_knobs: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The locus diagnostic. The test that would move the geometric analyses from the read position to generated tokens needed a probe at the forking token and commitment positions, and that probe produced no output. The read position evidence is split: it encodes the shortest path default and fails to decode the grid default, while the forking token screen found every baseline path fixed at the read position on both tasks. The diagnostic is undetermined.

1.12 What iteration 1 established, and what it abandoned

Everything below is descriptive: one model, two tasks, two informative ban events per experiment, and labellers of which two failed their strict gates.

Established.

1. The collapse is total and robust to decoding. Across six independent baselines, 1,199 of 1,200 grid programs were BFS and 1,174 of 1,200 shortest path programs were Dijkstra. Temperature from 0.3 to 1.3, top-k = 10 or top-p = 0.95, and thinking on or off changed the algorithm in at most 3 of 800 programs per task.
2. Temperature is a phrasing knob. At the tightest setting the model writes one idea in a handful of phrasings; loosening temperature multiplies phrasings (4 to 36 clusters on the grid task with top-k = 10) and leaves ideas at one or two. This is the answer this run gives to the request's question 1a-c on these two tasks.
3. Random context seeds change nothing in the output. Apart from the fixed word seed on the grid task (1.56 times the paraphrase noise, against 1.06 for word seeds drawn fresh per paraphrase), they displace the read position state no more than an arbitrary sentence does. Context with meaning moves the state three to four times the paraphrase noise and can move the output, by 66.3 points on the shortest path task and by 2.2 points on the grid task (among correct programs). *(Corrected in iteration 2; the item previously gave 67 and 2 points, 67 being the fall in the Dijkstra share. It also omitted that read position displacement did not predict which algorithm the output moved to on either task: the grid semantic seed pointed at its implied algorithm and behaviour barely moved, the shortest path seed did not point at Bellman-Ford/SPFA and behaviour moved two thirds of the way; and the shortest path entropy seed's interval reaches 1.596, above the equivalence bound. Section 2.3.8.)*

4. When a prompt ban is obeyed, the compliant programs land mostly on one substitute. On the shortest path task it was Bellman-Ford/SPFA in five of five draws (272 of 272 compliant programs); on the grid task DFS was the realised mode in four of five draws (116 of 128 pooled, 0.906, Wilson [0.843, 0.946]), and the HF engine geometry draw, with the highest banned share (0.62), had no clear mode (DFS 10, unit weight Dijkstra 8). A single ban collapses the output again; a second step grid ban can spread compliant output over unit weight Dijkstra and A* (decommitment draw: 13 and 3) or put all of it on unit weight Dijkstra (geometry draw: 18). *(Corrected in iteration 2; the item previously said that the substitute replicated in five independent draws and that bans collapse the output again without spreading it, which the geometry draw and the second step bans contradict. Section 2.3.3.)* How often a ban is obeyed did not replicate (banned mode share 0.09-0.72) and depends on the wording of the ban sentence. Banning the substitute as well fails, and the model then reimplements the banned mechanism under another description.
5. The substitute is the model's second preference, visible before any ban in its free-form answer, in its output when every algorithm is listed, and in the base model's distribution. The preregistered ranked association map did not identify it on the grid task and gave different answers under two elicitation wordings. *(Note added in iteration 2: on the shortest path task random activation directions and every other perturbation that moved the model off Dijkstra also landed on Bellman-Ford/SPFA (Section 2.3.5), so there the second preference of the model cannot be told apart from wherever any perturbation lands.)*
6. The read position carries a low-dimensional map of the catalogue (intrinsic dimension 4-5 against 11-12 for shuffled nulls). On the grid task the mass displaced by bans moved to BFS's geodesic neighbours and never to the far side, *(clause inserted in iteration 2, marked in iteration 3)* which is consistent with geodesic proximity and with typicality, since those neighbours are also second choices of the model; the two are not separated on these events. *(Corrected in iteration 2: the geodesic order is unstable at layer 24 under paraphrase resampling, and on the shortest path task Floyd-Warshall, not the realised Bellman-Ford/SPFA, is the nearest survivor in every subsample. Section 2.3.2.)* The ban shift itself is almost entirely orthogonal to the algorithm directions, so the substitution versus subtraction share test was inconclusive for every algorithm.
7. No activation edit beat the prompt ban. Affine ablation of the modal algorithm did nothing at alpha up to 2 and broke generation at 4, as random directions did; the decommitment direction acted like a random direction; subtracting the instruct minus base direction destroyed generation.
8. Post training sharpened an ordering the base model already had, rather than installing a new attractor; the chat format sharpens it further on the shortest path task. *(Correction, iteration 2: this item replaced the preregistered verdicts with an interpretation. The verdicts are INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on the shortest path task and MIXED on the grid task under the correctness conditioned Hill number (INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on both under the Hill number over all programs), and MIXED on both at the planned sample size. The base ordering matches the instruct ordering only under the chat template, where the base model parsed 0.58 and 0.66 of samples and wrote 57 and 90 correct programs, labelled with runtime against AST kappa of 0.20 to 0.50 (Table 24b); in plain completion its shortest path mode is Bellman-Ford/SPFA, 16 of 25 correct programs.)*
9. Without a ban the algorithm is fixed at the read position on both tasks. Under a ban the outcome stays open for dozens of tokens, a few forking tokens exist on the shortest path task, and writing the first token that identifies the algorithm does not lock the algorithm in.

Abandoned or failed, with the evidence.

- *Affine directional ablation of the modal algorithm as a removal knob.* 0 of 50 samples moved at alpha 0.5, 1 and 2 on both tasks, with 78-90% of outputs byte-identical to the unedited run; at alpha 4 the edit removed all code. The direction checks had failed beforehand (AUC 0.79-0.89). The prompt-versus-removal comparison that the hypothesis treats as a headline was therefore untestable in this form.
- *Subtracting the instruct minus base direction.* 0 of 100 parseable programs at every band coefficient; the direction promotes format tokens under the logit lens.
- *Forking window temperature.* Every arm was 100% the default algorithm; its phrasing count matched $T = 0.3$.
- *The decommitment direction as a diversity knob.* Its shortest path gain equalled a random direction's (difference $+0.07$, interval -0.26 to 0.39) and the grid task never moved; the enumeration prompt that states the same framing did nothing.
- *The ranked (Borda) association map as the association instrument.* It missed the grid event, ranked the realised substitute last, and changed its winner for both default algorithms under a second elicitation.
- *Baseline frequency as the typicality predictor.* Under a full collapse every survivor has zero frequency, so the forecast is uniform by construction and the discordance strata that the design defined by stability are empty.
- *The mention twin as a placebo, and the sham ban as a negative control.* Mentioning an algorithm recommends it ($+56$ to $+100$ points), so sham bans cannot be tested for equivalence with their mention twins.
- *The locus probes.* The forking token experiment extracted the states but its probe stage produced no output; this is a technical failure, not a negative result, and the measurement is still missing. *(Correction, iteration 2: the probe stage ran before the states were written (Section 1.7); the audit ran it in iteration 2 and found no decision locus among the saved positions, Section 2.3.1.)*
- *The reserved bench.* The dataset artifact delivered source data but no frozen specifications, tests, labellers or forecasts, so the planned out-of-sample confirmation cannot start until the bench is built.

Spend. OpenRouter: USD 0.27 (association), about 0.09 (geometry), 0.024 (forking token), 0.062 (decommitment), 0.21 (instruction tuning), 0.11 (decoding) and 0 (dataset), about USD 0.77 in total. GPU: about 6 minutes on an RTX 5090 (association), 2.2 hours on a 23 GB NVIDIA GPU (geometry), 2.1 hours on the same model of GPU (instruction tuning); the other experiments did not record GPU hours. *(Correction, iteration 2: from the union of each experiment's GPU phase log spans, an upper bound that includes waits, geometry 2.92, forking token 1.55, decommitment 3.23, instruction tuning 2.47 and decoding 3.31 GPU hours; Section 2.3.10. The answers this screen gives to the objections of the hypothesis review are recorded in Section 2.1.)*

Iteration 2: the record repaired, a likelihood instrument, the route of a ban, the top five prohibition and a second model

2.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The review of the iteration-1 record. The review was blocking. It scored the report 4 overall (confidence 4), with soundness 1, presentation 3 and contribution 3. The soundness score came from two places where the report's conclusions contradicted its own tables. The report claimed that the substitute a ban produces replicated in five independent draws, but on the grid task the geometry draw had no clear mode (DFS 10 and unit weight Dijkstra 8 of 18 compliant programs). It also claimed that no grid knob above the 80% pass rate floor produced a second algorithm among compliant programs, but the decommitment draw's cumulative ban of BFS and DFS produced 16 compliant programs over unit weight Dijkstra and A*. The review further found that the selection rule had been quoted without its event gate and then applied to events the gate excludes; that the iteration had added forecasting families instead of events; that the report never named the rival its own controls suggested, namely that random directions push the shortest path task to the same substitute as a ban; that the geometric claim outran its evidence; that the cause of the missing locus probe was recorded nowhere; that several items of the request were not covered; that no positive claim was set against its nearest published neighbour; that the read position evidence on seeds was reported by halves; and that the objections of the hypothesis review had not been answered. Eleven items were marked must fix and three minor. The corrections they require are made in place in the iteration-1 section, each marked with what changed and why. Table 38 maps every item to the place where it is answered.

Table 38. Review items on the iteration-1 record and where this report answers them.

Review item	What the review found	Where it is answered
Substitute claim over five draws	Grid geometry draw had no clear mode; the few unit weight Dijkstra programs were in fact 8 of 18	Corrections in Sections 1.11 and 1.12; per draw table in Section 2.3.3
Grid knob verdict	The cumulative BFS and DFS ban produced compliant unit weight Dijkstra and A* programs	Correction in Section 1.11; three draws in Section 2.3.4; positive target per task in Section 2.3.6
Selection rule	Event gate omitted; rule applied to events the gate excludes; one Hill statistic not used	Correction in Section 1.1; gated forecast scores in Section 2.3.7; one statistic knob table in Section 2.3.6
Events, not predictors	Fifteen forecasting families scored on two events	Families frozen at four (this section); bench with a presence pilot in Section 2.8; Section 2.12
Generic perturbation rival	Random directions land on Bellman-Ford/SPFA like the ban	Correction to Table 26 in Section 1.9; perturbation table in Section 2.3.5; external ladder profile in Sections 2.4 and 2.7
Geometric overreach	Proximity and typicality confounded; stability from point resampling	Correction to Section 1.12; layer and k sweep in Section 2.3.2
Locus probe dead end	Cause unrecorded; inputs exist on disk	Correction in Section 1.7; probe re-run in Section 2.3.1

Request coverage	Top five ban, natural run internals, SAE, thought anchors, same seed, lenses, NLA missing	Sections 2.3.1, 2.5, 2.6 and 2.9
Novelty positioning	No claim set against its nearest neighbour	Section 2.3.11
Seeds half reported	Shortest path cosine, word seed probe shift and entropy seed interval omitted	Corrections in Sections 1.10 and 1.12; Section 2.3.8
Objections of the hypothesis review	Sham bans, simulation of own behaviour, point resampling, missing precedent	This section, below
Minor: missing outputs	Executed conditions and diagnostics absent from the record	Section 2.3.10 and notes in Sections 1.5 to 1.10
Minor: post training verdict	Preregistered label replaced by an interpretation	Corrections in Sections 1.9 and 1.12
Minor: bookkeeping	GPU hours, source files, grid failure taxonomy	Section 2.3.10; correction to the spend line in Section 1.12

What the hypothesis review asked for, and what the iteration-1 screen showed. The review of the hypothesis before iteration 1 raised four objections that the screen can now answer. First, the review argued that if processing a negation promotes an associate [4], a ban of an algorithm the model never writes should still move mass toward a related algorithm, so the preregistered equivalence between a sham ban and its mention twin was inconsistent with the mechanism. Two of nine sham bans did move mass: banning Floyd-Warshall gave Bellman-Ford/SPFA 23% of attempted programs and banning IDDFS gave DFS 12% (Section 2.3.9). Both promoted algorithms are content neighbours of the banned one and also the second choice of the model, so this is weak and confounded evidence for promotion triggered by negation. Second, the review named simulation of its own behaviour [39] as a rival reason why the stated alternative of the model predicts its behaviour: a model can forecast what it will do without any privileged access to a decision. That is exactly the free-form predictor's success in Table 7. Such simulation fits either branch of the substitution test below, so the free-form result says nothing about mechanism. Third, the review warned that resampling points within a fixed graph would make geodesic stability uninformative. The iteration-1 stability of 0.985 came from that procedure, and resampling at the level of paraphrases changes the shortest path picture (Section 2.3.2). Fourth, the review flagged an omitted precedent on approach organised internal states [40] and an unmapped lens named in the request, which we refer to as the j lens. The precedent is positioned in Section 2.3.11, and the lens, a Jacobian lens, was tested in Section 2.9.

The hypothesis update. The update kept the claim and changed the instrument. The claim is that a prohibition both subtracts the banned algorithm X and substitutes: it raises particular survivors by more than renormalisation would, and which survivors it raises depends on X. We call the rival the *latent ladder*: a fixed ordering of the survivors that any perturbation of the model reveals, under which a ban only subtracts and exposes the second choice of the model. Iteration 1 could not separate the two accounts, because every substitute it observed was also the second choice of the model and because on the shortest path task random directions reached the same second choice as the ban. The update made four changes. It replaced sampled frequencies, which carry no information under a fully collapsed baseline, with a likelihood instrument read from forward passes (Section 2.2), so that every single ban, sham ban and ban list becomes a measured event. It added a causal test of where a ban acts: through the prompt states before the first generated token, or by generated tokens reading the prohibition directly. It froze the forecasting families at four (ladder, association, prime and veto, proximity), fixed the ban wording at five templates, and moved the

budget from predictors to events. And it ordered the iteration-1 record to be repaired before any new generation. A second claim was added: the read position encodes how strongly a ban will be obeyed, not what replaces X.

The strategy. Seven artifacts ran, one audit without generation and six experiments (Table 39). The audit repaired the record and ran every diagnostic that needed no GPU, including the locus probe that had never run. The likelihood screen and the Llama replication tested substitution against the latent ladder on the two path search tasks, in Qwen3-8B [5] and in Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22]. The route experiment patched key and value (KV) caches between a ban prompt and its neutral twin. The ban list experiment ran the request's literal prohibition of the top five algorithms. The bench build froze a confirmation bench of 12 new tasks behind a cheap presence pilot, with no ban prompt run on it. The readout experiment looked at the ban with sparse autoencoder features, attention, thought anchors, a same seed temperature test and lenses. The strategy fixed one rule for every experiment: the screen tasks (grid and shortest path) are never pooled into confirmation statistics, so the bench stays untouched until forecasts are committed in the next iteration.

Table 39. The seven artifacts of iteration 2, the question each was asked, and its hardware and spend.

Artifact	Question	Model and hardware	OpenRouter spend
Audit	Repair the iteration-1 record; locus probe; geometry sweep; perturbation table; one statistic knob table; gated forecasts	No generation; probes on one RTX 4090 (about 8 min)	USD 0
Likelihood screen	Substitution or latent ladder in Qwen3-8B (validity gate, gain matrices, X specific share)	Qwen3-8B; one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU, 3.38 GPU hours of scoring plus about 0.24 hours of generation	USD 0.30
Route experiment	Does the ban act through the prompt states or directly at generation time; does the read position know how hard a ban will be obeyed	Qwen3-8B bf16; one RTX 4090, about 1.2 GPU hours	USD 0.32
Ban list experiment	Where the mass lands when four or five algorithms are banned at once; bans that leave one survivor	Qwen3-8B; one RTX 4090, about 1 GPU hour	USD 0.42
Llama replication	The likelihood screen and route readout in a second model family	Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct bf16; one RTX 4090, 0.64 GPU hours logged	USD 0.49
Bench build	A frozen 12-task confirmation bench with presence pilot, labeller gate and baseline likelihoods	Qwen3-8B, official 8-bit floating point checkpoint (and a Llama pilot); one RTX 2000 Ada (16 GB), about 1.4 GPU hours	USD 0.14
Readout experiment	SAE, attention and prime and veto readouts of the ban; thought anchors; same seed temperature test; Jacobian lens and NLA	Qwen3-8B bf16 states, 8-bit twin for generation; one 16 GB GPU, about 1.05 GPU hours	USD 0.04

2.2 Shared protocol v2 and the likelihood instrument

Canonical suite and labels. Every experiment on the path search tasks used the association experiment's task text, prompt scaffold, hidden tests (48 grid cases, 45 shortest path cases), 22

references and labeller, copied byte for byte. Each rechecked the labeller before use: the combined label agreed with the adjudicated gold set on 0.965 or 0.966 of 141 programs in four experiments and on 135 of 144 in the ban list experiment, and all 22 references were labelled correctly. Labels are at the level of mechanism: the runtime signature decides, so a renamed BFS counts as BFS.

Templates and twins. Ban wording was frozen at five templates (Table 40), each with a mention twin and a neutral twin. We call a ban's *neutral twin* the same sentence with the algorithm's display name replaced by frequent concrete nouns from the dataset artifact's 718-noun bank (`man`, `guy`, `house` and so on) and padded with filler tokens until the prompt has the ban prompt's exact token length; from the task text onward the two prompts have identical token ids. Two generic perturbations were also frozen: a nonce ban (`Do not use the Zorblax method`, in the five templates) and a novelty instruction (`Write a novel algorithm for this task, one you have not seen before.`). We refer to the templates by their order in Table 40, from the first to the fifth.

Table 40. The five frozen ban templates of shared protocol v2 (X is the algorithm's display name, N the neutral nouns).

Template	Ban	Mention twin	Neutral twin
first	Do not use X for this task.	You could use X for this task.	Do not use N for this task.
second	Your solution must not rely on X.	Your solution may rely on X.	Your solution must not rely on N.
third	Avoid X entirely.	Consider X first.	Avoid N entirely.
fourth	X is not allowed here.	X is allowed here.	N is not allowed here.
fifth	Write a correct solution that does not use X.	Write a correct solution that may use X.	Write a correct solution that does not use N.

Event gate. One definition replaces the two that iteration 1 mixed. The *avoidance* of a ban is one minus the share of all sampled programs labelled as a banned mechanism. An event enters a forecast contest only if avoidance is at least 0.5 and at least 20 attempted programs are not banned. The *landing distribution* is the label distribution of those attempted programs not banned. The compliant share (correct and not banned) is reported beside it and drives the knob table only, because most grid programs that fail do so through implementation bugs, not through the tests (Section 2.3.10).

The likelihood instrument. Under a fully collapsed baseline every survivor has sampled frequency zero, which made the typicality forecast uniform and the sham bans uninformative in iteration 1. We define the *forced ratio latent probability* (FRLP) of algorithm j under prompt c as an importance sampling estimate of the log probability that the model writes an algorithm j program when given c. The model first writes programs under forced prompts F_j (`Implement j for this task` and nine paraphrases). Programs labelled j are kept; names of catalogue algorithms are scrubbed from identifiers, comments and docstrings, and a scrubbed program is kept only if it passes the same tests and keeps the same runtime label. Each kept program p_m is then scored by teacher forcing under any prompt c, giving its summed log probability l(p_m | c). With the mixture of forced prompts q(p) = (1/K) Σ_k P(p | F_j^k) as the proposal, the balance heuristic of multiple importance sampling [41], and y_j the share of forced attempts labelled j,

$$L_j(c) = \log y_j + \log \operatorname{mean}_m \exp[\, l(p_m \mid c) - \log q(p_m) \,].$$

The same program text is scored under c and under its proposal, so phrasing and length cancel. Each cell reports the Kish effective sample size (ESS) of its importance weights. The *gain* of survivor j under a ban of X with template w is G[X, j, w] = L_j(ban_w X) − L_j(neutral_w X). The mention twin splits a ban into a *prime* (mention minus neutral) and a *veto* (ban minus mention).

The substitution test. For each single ban row, the gains are centred over the survivors and regressed on the centred *external ladder profile* u, the mean gain over generic perturbations of matched size: the nonce ban, six random edits of the prompt states in layers 12 to 24 whose norm is pinned per layer and position to the ban's own displacement, and the novelty instruction. The fitted part is the ladder component of the row and the residual its X specific component. Summed over rows and corrected for template and program replicate noise, they give V_u and V_s, and we call SHARE = V_s / (V_s + V_u) the *X specific share*. A ladder exists on a task if the generic profiles agree with one another (mean pairwise cosine over survivors other than the default of at least 0.5). The aim of the X specific residual is its Spearman correlation with the *prime and veto profile* (the mention twin's gains over its neutral twin, with X removed), computed on disjoint program halves and different nouns, against an exact within row permutation null. The branches were fixed before data: substitution (share interval above 0.5 and aim above the null's 95th percentile), X specific but unaimed (share interval above 0.5, aim not above the null), ladder (share interval below 0.5 and a ladder exists), pure subtraction (no between survivor variance beyond replicate noise), and undetermined (any other case). A row needs at least three survivors. Both references (neutral twin primary, mention twin secondary) are reported, and a branch is called robust only if they agree.

2.3 The audit: the iteration-1 record repaired, without new generation

The audit read the six iteration-1 experiments in place, generated nothing, made no LLM calls and spent nothing on OpenRouter. It ran first because several of this iteration's analyses depended on what it found: where the algorithm can be read out, whether the geometric neighbours survive resampling, and which iteration-1 events are informative at all. Every number it produced names its source file. Its own checks recomputed 40 numbers quoted in the plan and matched 38; the two mismatches are explained below (the count of gated events and the rarefied Hill number of the semantic seed). An independent script rederived 20 headline numbers with no mismatch, a second one reran five headline tests, and every placebo failed as it should.

2.3.1 The locus probe that never ran

Cause. The forking token experiment's probe file is 28 bytes, an empty summary written at 18:29:22. Its state log records the start of the state phase at 18:31:55 and the grid and shortest path states saved at 18:34:34 and 18:34:50. The probe stage ran before its inputs existed and found an empty folder. The measurement was therefore a CPU job on files already on disk, not a missing experiment.

Design. The saved states hold 300 generations per task (200 baseline, 100 under the modal ban) at eight positions (the read position, generated tokens 8, 16, 32 and 64, and the tokens before, at and after the first algorithm identifying token, which we call the commit token) and at layers 8 to 28. Within one ban prompt the model wrote BFS 21 times and DFS 78 times on the grid task (one unit weight Dijkstra) and Dijkstra 20 times and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 80 times on the shortest path task. These contrasts within one ban prompt are the natural run internals the request asks for: same prompts, different algorithms written. The probes are ridge regularised logistic regression probes fitted with folds that hold out one paraphrase at a time, which is the honest test because the read position is identical within a paraphrase. Each probe is compared with 200 refits on globally shuffled labels and 200 refits on labels shuffled within paraphrase (the null for a probe that knows no more than the base rate of each paraphrase), with a familywise null over layers. A written text control fits the same probe to features of the text written so far. A batched solver was unit tested against sklearn (identical predictions; largest relative coefficient difference 3.9e-5). The preregistered rule moves the locus to the first generated position whose decoder beats the read

position by at least 20 points of balanced accuracy and beats both nulls; a precommit qualifier asks whether the state carries more than the written text.

Table 41. Decoder of the algorithm written, within one ban prompt (grid: BFS against DFS; shortest path: Dijkstra against Bellman-Ford/SPFA), balanced accuracy at the best layer per position, with the read position accuracy at that layer, both nulls and the written text control (source: `results/locus.json`).

Task	Position (median token)	Best layer	Balanced accuracy	Read position at that layer	Difference [95% CI]	Global null p95	Within paraphrase null p95	Text control	Passes rule
Grid	read position	16	0.855	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	0.5	n/a
Grid	before commit token (6)	20	0.855	0.791	+0.064 [0.0, 0.201]	0.639	0.855	0.673	no
Grid	after commit token (7)	23	0.855	0.791	+0.064 [0.0, 0.201]	0.652	0.855	0.673	no
Grid	token 8	26	0.855	0.791	+0.064 [0.0, 0.201]	0.659	0.855	0.673	no
Grid	token 16	9	0.798	0.402	+0.396 [-0.065, 0.537]	0.658	0.879	0.673	no
Grid	token 32	23	0.798	0.791	+0.006 [-0.16, 0.229]	0.653	0.850	0.542	no
Grid	token 64	27	0.739	0.791	-0.052 [-0.203, 0.239]	0.657	0.812	0.598	no
Shortest path	read position	13	0.625	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	0.5	n/a
Shortest path	before commit token (6)	8	0.762	0.481	+0.281 [0.145, 0.388]	0.669	0.681	0.756	yes (mechanical)
Shortest path	forking token (7)	17	0.731	0.550	+0.181 [0.046, 0.261]	0.650	0.644	0.675	no
Shortest path	after commit token (7)	10	0.762	0.456	+0.306 [0.12, 0.463]	0.656	0.675	0.762	yes
Shortest path	token 8	8	0.831	0.481	+0.350 [0.182, 0.525]	0.663	0.682	0.831	yes
Shortest path	token 16	8	0.837	0.481	+0.356 [0.193, 0.525]	0.650	0.650	0.837	yes
Shortest path	token 32	15	0.837	0.550	+0.287 [0.122, 0.399]	0.675	0.669	0.831	yes

Shortest path	token	64	8	0.831	0.481	+0.350 [0.182, 0.525]	0.669	0.662	0.819	yes

[Figure fig_locus_text: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

What the locus probe showed. On the grid task no position passes the rule, so the mechanical locus stays at the read position. The read position already separates the prompts that will produce DFS from those that will produce BFS (balanced accuracy 0.855 at layer 16), but at every generated position the within paraphrase null reaches the observed accuracy: the signal is the paraphrase's base rate, not anything specific to a sample. BFS and DFS programs also share their commit token (`' deque'`; 51 of 78 DFS programs and all 21 BFS programs commit at token 6), so the commit index does not separate the classes on this task. On the shortest path task the first passing position is the token before the commit token (layer 8, +0.281 over the read position, within paraphrase $p = 0.005$; a second implementation with 40 sklearn refits gave $p = 0.024$ against a placebo p of 0.17). The written text control reaches 0.756 at the same position, so the state adds 0.006 over the text, below the preregistered 0.10 margin. The audit therefore qualified the shortest path locus as a readout after commitment. The text separates the classes from generated token 4 on: Dijkstra programs write `import heapq` and Bellman-Ford/SPFA programs write `from collections import deque`. The deciding token is generated token 3, emitted from states at tokens 1 to 3 that were never saved, and the forking token experiment had independently confirmed a forking token at that index (`import`, total variation 0.80; Table 19). The first token at which the text alone reaches 0.8 is token 8. No decision locus was found on either task.

Three further readings came out of the same states. The difference-in-means direction at the token before the commit token has held-out AUC 0.882 (grid) and 0.749 (shortest path), below the 0.9 bar that would reopen a generation time removal. Per paraphrase, the read position probe's held-out probability of the substitute tracks the share of the substitute that paraphrase produced (Spearman 0.63, exact $p = 0.056$, grid; 0.65, $p = 0.045$, shortest path; ten paraphrases each), a first sign that the read position knows how strongly a wording will be obeyed. The positive controls (baseline against ban states) were decoded at balanced accuracy close to 1.0.

2.3.2 Geometry under paraphrase resampling

The geometry experiment's stability figure of 0.985 came from resampling points on a fixed graph, which the hypothesis review had warned is uninformative. The audit rebuilt the principal component projection, the nearest neighbour graph and the centroids on 1,000 paraphrase level subsamples, for k in {5, 10, 15, 20} at every layer of the two gate bands (24 to 28 grid, 21 to 27 shortest path), after reproducing the committed distance matrices exactly (largest absolute difference 0.0000). Table 42 gives the $k = 10$ column.

Table 42. Nearest surviving centroid to the default algorithm under 1,000 paraphrase subsamples, $k = 10$ (source: `tables/geometry_stability.csv`; distances on full data).

Task	Layer	P(DFS nearest)	P(unit weight Dijkstra nearest)	P(both are the two nearest)	Full data order	MDS stress-1
Grid	24	0.523	0.477	1.0	unit weight Dijkstra > DFS > A* > IDDFS > bidirectional BFS	0.202
Grid	25	0.880	0.120	1.0	DFS > unit weight Dijkstra > A* > IDDFS > bidirectional BFS	0.212
Grid	26	0.954	0.046	1.0	same	0.213
Grid	27	1.0	0.0	1.0	same	0.217

Grid	28	1.0	0.0	1.0	same		0.230

Task	Layer	P(Floyd-Warshall nearest)	P(Bellman-Ford/SPFA nearest)	P(Bellman-Ford/SPFA nearer than bidirectional Dijkstra)	Rank of Bellman-Ford/SPFA (full data)	Full data order	MDS stress-1
Shortest path	21	1.0	0.0	0.555	3	Floyd-Warshall > bidirectional Dijkstra > Bellman-Ford/SPFA > Dial	0.205
Shortest path	22	1.0	0.0	0.633	3	same	0.239
Shortest path	23	1.0	0.0	0.829	2	Floyd-Warshall > Bellman-Ford/SPFA > bidirectional Dijkstra > Dial	0.235
Shortest path	24	1.0	0.0	0.820	2	same	0.224
Shortest path	25	1.0	0.0	0.810	2	same	0.226
Shortest path	26	1.0	0.0	0.897	2	same	0.227
Shortest path	27	1.0	0.0	0.964	2	same	0.229

Over all four values of k the picture is the same. On the shortest path task Floyd-Warshall is the nearest survivor to Dijkstra in 100% of subsamples at all 28 (layer, k) settings, and Bellman-Ford/SPFA, the algorithm every ban landed on, is never nearest; its full data rank is 2 in 75% of settings and 3 in 25%. The geometry experiment's sensitivity matrix, which recomputes the two flagged centroids from correctly labelled forced samples only, puts bidirectional Dijkstra (40.91) closer to Dijkstra than Bellman-Ford/SPFA (42.18), with Floyd-Warshall at 25.49 and Dial at 58.01. On the grid task DFS is nearest to BFS at layers 25 to 28 (probability 0.87 to 1.00 over k) and unit weight Dijkstra overtakes it at layer 24 (DFS 0.52 to 0.60), while DFS and unit weight Dijkstra are always the two nearest. Neighbour orders agree across k and layer with mean Kendall tau 0.933 (grid) and 0.870 (shortest path). Centroids from name masked prompts give different orders (grid top-1 stability 0.18 to 0.815). The grid ban's landing on DFS and unit weight Dijkstra is therefore consistent with geodesic proximity and with typicality, since both are also second choices of the model, and the two are not separated on these events. On the shortest path task geodesic proximity predicts the wrong substitute.

2.3.3 The substitute, draw by draw

The audit recomputed the modal ban substitutes from the per-sample rows of every draw (Table 43). On the shortest path task the claim survives as written: all 272 compliant programs in the five draws were Bellman-Ford/SPFA. On the grid task DFS was the realised mode in four of five draws and took 116 of 128 compliant programs; in the geometry draw, the only one sampled with HF `generate` and the one with the highest banned share, 8 of 18 compliant programs were unit weight Dijkstra and the event had no clear mode.

Table 43. Compliant programs under the modal ban, per draw (source: `corrections.json`; Wilson 95% intervals for the substitute's share).

Draw (engine)	Grid: DFS / compliant	Other compliant labels	DFS share [95%]	Shortest path: Bellman-Ford/SPFA / compliant	Share [95%]
Association (vLLM)	38 / 38	none	1.0 [0.908, 1.000]	86 / 86	1.0 [0.957, 1.000]
Geometry (HF)	10 / 18	unit weight Dijkstra 8	0.556 [0.337, 0.754]	22 / 22	1.0 [0.851, 1.000]
Forking token (vLLM)	40 / 41	unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.976 [0.874, 0.996]	80 / 80	1.0 [0.954, 1.000]
Decommitment (vLLM)	16 / 18	unit weight Dijkstra 2	0.889 [0.672, 0.969]	38 / 38	1.0 [0.908, 1.000]
Instruction tuning (vLLM)	12 / 13	unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.923 [0.667, 0.986]	46 / 46	1.0 [0.923, 1.000]
Pooled	116 / 128	unit weight Dijkstra 12	0.906 [0.843, 0.946]; draw cluster bootstrap [0.75, 0.98]	272 / 272	1.0 [0.986, 1.000]

2.3.4 The cumulative ban of BFS and DFS does not replicate

The three draws that banned BFS and DFS together disagree on everything the knob table depends on (Table 44). The decommitment draw spread its 16 compliant programs over two algorithms, the geometry draw put all 18 on one, and in the association draw the model reimplemented a banned mechanism 94 times out of 100. The pairs the review quoted from Table 37 (0.88 / 1.00, 0.96 / 0.99, 0.53 / 0.933) are each draw's pass rate followed by its reference pass rate.

Table 44. The cumulative ban of BFS and DFS in three draws (source: `corrections.json#cumulative_bfs_dfs_ban`).

Draw	N	Banned share (mechanism)	Pass rate	Compliant programs	Compliant composition
Decommitment	100	0.81	0.88	16	unit weight Dijkstra 13, A* 3
Geometry	50	0.62	0.96	18	unit weight Dijkstra 18
Association	100	0.94	0.53	5	unit weight Dijkstra 4, A* 1

2.3.5 Every perturbation, side by side: the generic perturbation rival

The audit assembled one table of every condition in the six draws: 249 condition rows covering 20,270 programs, each with its pass cost against its own reference (Newcombe intervals [42]), the label composition among correct and among attempted programs, and the share of the second choice with a Wilson interval (`tables/perturbation_table.csv`). Tables 45 and 46 give the rows that bear on the generic perturbation rival. On the shortest path task every nonsemantic perturbation that produced at least 10 correct programs other than Dijkstra (8 of 8 such rows) had Bellman-Ford/SPFA as their majority, random directions included, and so did 3 of 4 semantic ones. Band random direction 2 of the instruction tuning experiment turned all 33 of its correct programs into Bellman-Ford/SPFA, against Dijkstra 100 of 100 in its control. On the grid task generic perturbations almost never left BFS: random directions broke programs (pass rates 0.41 and 0.68)

but every correct program stayed BFS, and only two rows other than bans with at least 10 correct programs other than the default exist, both mention twins (A* and DFS). On the shortest path task a ban and an arbitrary perturbation end in the same place; on the grid task only the ban reaches DFS at scale.

Table 45. Shortest path perturbations: label composition of correct programs and Bellman-Ford/SPFA share (source: `tables/perturbation_table.csv`).

Draw	Perturbation	N	Pass (reference)	Correct programs	Bellman-Ford/SPFA share [95%]
Decommitment	random direction 1, c = 0.25	100	0.79 (0.95)	Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26	0.329 [0.236, 0.439]
Decommitment	random direction 2, c = 0.25	100	0.87 (0.95)	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	0.057 [0.025, 0.128]
Decommitment	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	100	0.78 (0.95)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1	0.692 [0.583, 0.784]
Decommitment	decommitment direction, c = 0.375	100	0.67 (0.95)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 47, Dijkstra 19, other 1	0.701 [0.583, 0.798]
Decommitment	decommitment direction, c = 0.5	100	0.37 (0.95)	Dijkstra 25, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 10, other 2	0.270 [0.154, 0.430]
Decommitment	breadth direction, c = 0.25	100	0.60 (0.95)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 28, Dial 1	0.516 [0.393, 0.638]
Decommitment	other task's direction, c = 0.25	50	0.72 (0.95)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 28, Dijkstra 8	0.777 [0.619, 0.883]
Decommitment	variable name placebo, c = 0.25	100	0.66 (0.95)	Dijkstra 60, Dial 3, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2, other 1	0.030 [0.008, 0.104]
Decommitment	enumeration prompt	100	0.82 (0.885)	Dijkstra 80, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	0.024 [0.007, 0.085]
Instruction tuning	band random direction 1	100	0.00 (1.00)	none	n/a
Instruction tuning	band random direction 2	100	0.33 (1.00)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 33	1.0 [0.896, 1.000]
Instruction tuning	random direction 1, read position only, c = 1.0	100	1.00 (1.00)	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9, other 1	0.090 [0.048, 0.162]
Instruction tuning	sharpening subtraction, layer 18, c = 0.5	50	0.98 (1.00)	Dijkstra 48, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	0.020 [0.004, 0.107]
Instruction tuning	sharpening subtraction, read position only, no cutoff	20	0.20 (1.00)	Dijkstra 3, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	0.25 [0.046, 0.699]
Instruction tuning	base model, chat template	300	0.30 (1.00)	Dijkstra 63, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 24, other 2, Floyd-Warshall 1	0.266 [0.186, 0.366]
Instruction tuning	base model, plain completion	300	0.083 (1.00)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 16, Dijkstra 8, Floyd-Warshall 1	0.64 [0.445, 0.798]
Instruction tuning	instruct model, plain completion	100	0.72 (1.00)	Dijkstra 57, Floyd-Warshall 8, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	0.097 [0.048, 0.187]

Decoding	semantic seed	100	0.92 (0.99)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30, Floyd-Warshall 1	0.663 [0.562, 0.751]
Decoding	novelty instruction	100	0.96 (0.99)	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 14	0.145 [0.089, 0.230]
Decoding	new algorithm instruction	100	0.94 (0.99)	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 4	0.042 [0.017, 0.104]
Decoding	enumeration prompt	100	0.75 (0.99)	Dijkstra 67, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 8	0.106 [0.055, 0.197]
Decoding	T = 1.3, top-k = 10	100	1.00 (0.98)	Dijkstra 99, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 1	0.010 [0.002, 0.054]
Association	listing control	100	1.00 (1.00)	Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 3	0.030 [0.010, 0.085]
Association	sham ban of Floyd-Warshall	100	0.71 (1.00)	Dijkstra 68, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 3	0.042 [0.014, 0.117]
All five draws	modal ban of Dijkstra, pooled	500	0.87 to 1.00	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 272 (compliant)	1.0 [0.986, 1.000]

The sham ban of Floyd-Warshall shows why compliant and attempted programs must be told apart: 23 of its 100 attempted programs were Bellman-Ford/SPFA (Table 8), but only 3 of those passed the tests.

Table 46. Grid perturbations: label composition of correct programs and DFS share (source: `tables/perturbation_table.csv`).

Draw	Perturbation	N	Pass (reference)	Correct programs	DFS share [95%]
Instruction tuning	band random direction 1	100	0.41 (1.00)	BFS 41	0.0 [0.000, 0.086]
Instruction tuning	band random direction 2	100	0.68 (1.00)	BFS 68	0.0 [0.000, 0.053]
Instruction tuning	random direction 1, read position only, c = 1.0	100	1.00 (1.00)	BFS 100	0.0 [0.000, 0.037]
Decommitment	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	100	0.57 (1.00)	BFS 57	0.0 [0.000, 0.063]
Decoding	semantic seed	100	0.93 (0.97)	BFS 91, bidirectional BFS 2	0.0 [0.000, 0.040]
Decoding	novelty instruction	100	0.85 (0.97)	BFS 81, unit weight Dijkstra 2, DFS 1, A* 1	0.011 [0.002, 0.064]
Decoding	new algorithm instruction	100	0.94 (0.97)	BFS 92, DFS 2	0.021 [0.006, 0.074]
Decoding	enumeration prompt	100	0.99 (0.97)	BFS 99	0.0 [0.000, 0.037]
Decoding	T = 1.3, top-k = 10	100	0.95 (0.98)	BFS 94, DFS 1	0.010 [0.002, 0.057]
Instruction tuning	base model, chat template	300	0.19 (1.00)	BFS 49, DFS 7, A* 1	0.122 [0.061, 0.232]

Instruction tuning	base model, plain completion	300 0.05 (1.00)	BFS 12, DFS 3	0.20 [0.070, 0.452]
Instruction tuning	instruct model, plain completion	100 0.73 (1.00)	BFS 73	0.0 [0.000, 0.050]
Association	listing control	100 0.92 (0.933)	BFS 92	0.0 [0.000, 0.040]
Association	sham ban of IDDFS	100 0.80 (0.933)	BFS 76, DFS 4	0.05 [0.020, 0.122]
Association	sham ban of unit weight Dijkstra	100 0.71 (0.933)	BFS 69, DFS 2	0.028 [0.008, 0.097]
All five draws	modal ban of BFS, pooled	500 0.46 to 0.76	DFS 116, unit weight Dijkstra 12 (compliant)	0.906 [0.843, 0.946]

2.3.6 The knob table on one statistic

The iteration-1 knob table mixed unrarefied Hill numbers, rarefied differences, and Hill numbers that counted correct programs of the banned algorithm. The audit recomputed every knob with one statistic: the Hill number of order 1 [9] over compliant programs only (banned labels excluded), rarefied to a common depth of 25 by 1,000 draws without replacement, with a 90% interval from 1,000 paraphrase cluster bootstrap resamples times 200 rarefaction draws; cells with fewer than 25 compliant programs are marked and never extrapolated. Pass points are measured against each condition's own reference. Generate then select is a ceiling row, because its diversity comes from an external random choice among model proposed approaches, which is the mechanism of SimpleStrat [43]. Table 47 gives the rows that matter (all 183 rows are in `tables/knob_table.csv`).

Table 47. One statistic knob table: rarefied Hill-1 over compliant programs at depth 25 (source: `tables/knob_table.csv`).

Task	Knob (draw)	Class	Compliant programs	Composition	Hill-1 [90% CI]	Pass points lost
Grid	generate then select (decoding)	ceiling	55	BFS 26, A* 14, unit weight Dijkstra 9, DFS 6	3.358 [3.315, 3.381]	42.0
Grid	mention of A* (association)	named mode cue	41	A* 24, BFS 11, unit weight Dijkstra 5, DFS 1	2.687 [1.861, 3.186]	11.3
Grid	base model, chat template (instruction tuning)	model swap	57	BFS 49, DFS 7, A* 1	1.549 [1.284, 1.814]	81.0
Grid	modal ban, five draws pooled	ban	128	DFS 116, unit weight Dijkstra 12	1.357 [1.250, 1.425]	34.3
Grid	novelty instruction (decoding)	diversity knob	85	BFS 81, unit weight Dijkstra 2, DFS 1, A* 1	1.227 [1.096, 1.346]	12.0
Grid	sham ban of IDDFS (association)	ban	80	BFS 76, DFS 4	1.205 [1.0, 1.542]	13.3
Grid	sham ban of unit weight Dijkstra (association)	ban	71	BFS 69, DFS 2	1.119 [1.0, 1.245]	22.3

Grid	modal ban (forking token)	ban	41	DFS 40, unit weight Dijkstra 1	1.111 [1.0, 1.243]	35.0
Grid	semantic seed (decoding)	diversity knob	93	BFS 91, bidirectional BFS 2	1.096 [1.0, 1.191]	4.0
Grid	new algorithm instruction (decoding)	diversity knob	94	BFS 92, DFS 2	1.093 [1.0, 1.187]	3.0
Grid	T = 1.3, top-k = 10 (decoding)	diversity knob	95	BFS 94, DFS 1	1.048 [1.0, 1.133]	3.0
Grid	modal ban (association)	ban	38	DFS 38	1.0 [1.0, 1.0]	47.3
Grid	cumulative ban of BFS and DFS (decommitment)	ban	16	unit weight Dijkstra 13, A* 3	below depth (unrarefied 1.620)	12.0
Grid	cumulative ban of BFS and DFS (geometry)	ban	18	unit weight Dijkstra 18	below depth (unrarefied 1.0)	3.0
Grid	cumulative ban of BFS and DFS (association)	ban	5	unit weight Dijkstra 4, A* 1	below depth (unrarefied 1.649)	40.3
Grid	every steering, removal, forking window, random seed and remaining temperature arm	diversity knob	3 to 307	BFS only	1.0, or below depth	0 to 97
Shortest path	generate then select (decoding)	ceiling	75	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 29, Floyd-Warshall 15	2.802 [2.778, 2.812]	24.0
Shortest path	base model, plain completion (instruction tuning)	model swap	25	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 16, Dijkstra 8, Floyd-Warshall 1	2.179 [1.704, 2.611]	91.7
Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.5	diversity knob	37	Dijkstra 25, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 10, other 2	2.139 [1.553, 2.495]	58.0
Shortest path	breadth direction, c = 0.25	diversity knob	60	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 31, Dijkstra 28, Dial 1	2.096 [1.920, 2.297]	35.0
Shortest path	base model, chat template	model swap	90	Dijkstra 63, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 24, other 2, Floyd-Warshall 1	2.018 [1.737, 2.262]	70.0
Shortest path	semantic seed (decoding)	diversity knob	92	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30, Floyd-Warshall 1	1.935 [1.534, 2.076]	7.0
Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	diversity knob	78	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1	1.911 [1.735, 2.069]	17.0
Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.375	diversity knob	67	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 47, Dijkstra 19, other 1	1.901 [1.675, 2.079]	28.0
Shortest path	random direction 1, c = 0.25 (decommitment)	diversity knob	79	Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26	1.861 [1.657, 1.964]	16.0

Shortest path	random directions, four arms pooled	diversity knob	199	Dijkstra 135, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 64	1.851 [1.774, 1.903]	47.75
Shortest path	other task's direction, c = 0.25	diversity knob	36	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 28, Dijkstra 8	1.688 [1.412, 1.857]	23.0
Shortest path	novelty instruction (decoding)	diversity knob	96	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 14	1.500 [1.275, 1.692]	3.0
Shortest path	variable name placebo, c = 0.25	diversity knob	66	Dijkstra 60, Dial 3, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2, other 1	1.451 [1.129, 1.829]	29.0
Shortest path	random direction 1, read position only (instruction tuning)	diversity knob	100	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9, other 1	1.393 [1.209, 1.593]	0.0
Shortest path	enumeration prompt (decoding)	diversity knob	75	Dijkstra 67, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 8	1.382 [1.217, 1.581]	24.0
Shortest path	random direction 2, c = 0.25 (decommitment)	diversity knob	87	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	1.231 [1.097, 1.371]	8.0
Shortest path	modal ban, five draws pooled	ban	272	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 272	1.0 [1.0, 1.0]	2.4

The positive target and the BUY rule. The strategy's positive target was a knob that buys a second correct algorithm, a Hill number of at least 2 within its own compliant output, at a cost below 20 pass points. Under the single statistic no diversity knob and no ban meets it on either task. The closest is the semantic seed on the shortest path task (1.935 at 7 points). The mention of A* on the grid task reaches 2.69 at 11 points, but a mention recommends a named algorithm, so it meets only the literal reading of the target. The modal ban, the knob that iteration 1 ranked first on the shortest path task, scores exactly 1.0 there once banned programs no longer count: it replaces Dijkstra with one algorithm. The BUY rule names a best knob only when its 90% interval separates from the next; on the grid task the top rows (novelty instruction 1.227 [1.096, 1.346], sham ban of IDDFS 1.205 [1.0, 1.542]) do not separate, and on the shortest path task neither do the top five (Table 47). No knob advances. *(Correction, iteration 3: the sentences above paraphrase the target past its metric. A rarefied Hill-1 of at least 2 is an even two-algorithm split, which a 2:1 split never reaches. Stated in its own metric: no knob reaches an even split under 20 pass points; the semantic seed (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30 at 7 points; rebuilt Hill-1 1.940, 90% interval [1.770, 2.094], which includes 2) and the A* mention (2.69 at 11.3 points) are the two conditions that buy a second correct algorithm, and both name or describe it. The sham ban of IDDFS ranked above is a control, not a knob; the class rule is now declared in Section 3.2.5.)* *(Correction, iteration 4: the iteration-3 correction is itself incomplete. Two activation rows of Table 91 also buy a second correct algorithm without naming or describing one: the decommitment direction at c = 0.25 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23; Hill-1 1.913, 90% interval [1.704, 2.083], which includes 2, at 17 points) and random direction 1 of the decommitment experiment (Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26; 1.86 at 16 points). On the bench, norm-matched random directions written into the task-specification states in iteration 3 reach Hill-1 above 2 at 0 pass points on kth smallest (2.92) and two sum (2.12). The verdict per task over every iteration-3 arm is in Section 4.2.1.)*

2.3.7 The forecast contest on gated events

The rule, quoted in full from the strategy, is that a forecasting family advances if its calibrated mean log score beats the next best family by at least 0.10 nats on at least three events where the families' top-1 nominations disagree, scored on informative events only: banned mode present at

10% or more of the latent baseline, compliance of at least 50% and at least two survivors. The hypothesis update fixed compliance in this rule to mean avoidance and added a floor of 20 attempted programs not banned. Of the 64 events with forecasts in the iteration-1 record, 24 were sampled (Table 48). Three informative events pass the gate: the association draw's two modal bans and the decommitment draw's grid modal ban, whose forecasts are all tied. The gate as written also admits the association draw's nine sham bans (12 events in all), but they land on the default by construction and their own artifact marked them uninformative. The geometry, instruction tuning and decommitment shortest path events fail the gate under either compliance definition, and the forking token draw made no family forecasts. On the gated events the families' mean log scores are: association map (Borda) -0.844 (2 events), free-form association -0.145 (2), listing control typicality -0.120 (2), sampled frequency -1.579 (3), decommitted distribution -1.674 (1) and uniform -1.674 (1). Only two gated events have disagreeing nominations, and the largest margin on them is 0.05 nats. No family can advance, so the iteration-1 ranking of forecasts in Table 36 rests largely on events the rule excludes.

Table 48. Every sampled iteration-1 event with forecasts, with both gates and the log scores of the main families (nats per attempted program not banned; 5% uniform mixing and a 2% floor for other labels in every family; top-1 nomination in brackets). Source: `results/tables.json#predict_gated`.

Draw	Event	N	Attempted, not banned	Avoidance share	Compliant share	Avoidance gate	Compliant gate	Log scores [top-1]
Association	grid ban A* (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.72	pass	pass	Borda -1.022 [BFS]; free-form -0.101 [BFS]; frequency -0.101 [BFS]; listing -0.131 [BFS]
Association	grid ban BFS (modal)	100	90	0.90	0.38	pass	fail	Borda -2.710 [unit weight Dijkstra]; free-form -0.152 [DFS]; frequency -1.630 [tie]; listing -0.101 [DFS]
Association	grid ban bidirectional BFS (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.92	pass	pass	Borda -1.063 [BFS]; free-form -1.141 [A*]; frequency -0.140 [BFS]; listing -0.169 [BFS]

Association	grid ban DFS (sham)	100	96	0.96	0.86	pass	pass	Borda -0.998; free-form -0.101; frequency -0.101; listing -0.101 [all BFS]
Association	grid ban unit weight Dijkstra (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.71	pass	pass	Borda -1.113; free-form -0.410; frequency -0.410; listing -0.368 [all BFS]
Association	grid ban IDDFS (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.80	pass	pass	Borda -1.114; free-form -0.511; frequency -0.564; listing -0.486 [all BFS]
Association	grid ban BFS and DFS	100	6	0.06	0.05	fail	fail	Borda -1.398 [bidirectional BFS]; others -1.406 [tie]
Association	shortest path ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA (sham)	100	95	0.95	0.92	pass	pass	Borda -0.926; free-form, frequency, listing -0.136 [all Dijkstra]
Association	shortest path ban bidirectional Dijkstra (sham)	100	100	1.0	1.0	pass	pass	Borda -0.791; free-form -0.205; frequency -0.205; listing -0.212 [Dijkstra]
Association	shortest path ban Dial (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.97	pass	pass	Borda -0.803; free-form -0.278; frequency -0.278; listing -0.269 [Dijkstra]

Association	shortest path ban Dijkstra (modal)	100	91	0.91	0.86	pass	pass	Borda -0.813 [Bellman-Ford/SPFA]; free-form -0.138 [Bellman-Ford/SPFA]; frequency -1.434 [tie]; listing -0.138 [Bellman-Ford/SPFA]
Association	shortest path ban Floyd-Warshall (sham)	100	100	1.0	0.71	pass	pass	Borda -0.911; free-form -0.933; frequency -0.933; listing -0.784 [Dijkstra]
Association	shortest path ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	100	0	0.0	0.0	fail	fail	not scorable
Geometry	grid ban BFS	100	38	0.38	0.18	fail	fail	association -3.543 [A*]; frequency -1.630 [tie]; geodesic -1.337 [DFS]; decoder -1.287 [DFS]
Geometry	grid ban BFS and DFS	50	19	0.38	0.36	fail	fail	association -0.998 [unit weight Dijkstra]; geodesic -1.073 [unit weight Dijkstra]; decoder -4.124 [IDDFS]
Geometry	grid ban BFS and unit weight Dijkstra	50	17	0.34	0.10	fail	fail	association -3.966 [A*]; geodesic -1.280 [A*]; decoder -1.372 [IDDFS]

Geometry	shortest path ban Dijkstra	100	28	0.28	0.22	fail	fail	association -1.647 [Dial]; frequency -1.496 [tie]; geodesic -1.530 [Floyd-Warshall]; decoder -1.587 [bidirectional Dijkstra]
Geometry	shortest path ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	1	0.02	0.0	fail	fail	all -3.912
Decommitment	grid ban BFS	100	51	0.51	0.18	pass	fail	every family -1.674 [tie]
Decommitment	grid ban BFS and DFS	100	19	0.19	0.16	fail	fail	every family -1.538 [tie]
Decommitment	shortest path ban Dijkstra	100	46	0.46	0.38	fail	fail	decommitted -0.594 [Bellman-Ford/SPFA]; frequency (vLLM) -0.731 [Bellman-Ford/SPFA]; uniform -1.733
Decommitment	shortest path ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	100	17	0.17	0.01	fail	fail	all -3.912 [tie]
Instruction tuning	grid ban BFS	100	38	0.38	0.13	fail	fail	base plain completion -0.430 [DFS]; base chat -0.304 [DFS]; instruct chat -1.630 [tie]
Instruction tuning	shortest path ban Dijkstra	100	46	0.46	0.46	fail	fail	base plain completion -0.255; base chat -0.096; instruct chat -0.096 [all Bellman-Ford/SPFA]

These scores are computed over attempted programs not banned, so they differ slightly from the

compliant only scores of Tables 7, 14 and 36.

2.3.8 Seeds at the read position: both halves of the dissociation

Iteration 1 reported that the grid semantic seed moved the read position state toward its implied algorithm while the output barely moved. The other half was in the same file and was not reported (Table 49). On the shortest path task the semantic seed's displacement did not point toward the Bellman-Ford/SPFA centroid, yet the output moved two thirds of the way to it. The word seed moved the grid probe's decoded distribution toward A* by 0.88 with no change in behaviour. The entropy seed's interval on the shortest path task reaches 1.596, above the 1.5 equivalence bound, so its equivalence with paraphrase noise was not shown. Displacement along the mode subspace built from forced prompts predicted behavioural movement in neither direction.

Table 49. Read position displacement against behavioural movement for the seeds (sources: decoding experiment `results/analysis.json`, audit `results/tables.json#seeds`; behaviour shifts with Newcombe 95% intervals).

Task	Seed	Read position evidence	Behaviour among correct programs	Behaviour among attempted programs
Grid	semantic (implies bidirectional search)	cosine 0.493 with the bidirectional BFS centroid	bidirectional BFS +2.15 points [-1.97, 7.51]; BFS -1.12	bidirectional BFS +5.0 points [0.33, 11.18]; BFS -4.0
Shortest path	semantic (implies relaxation over all edges)	cosine -0.087 with the Bellman-Ford/SPFA centroid	Bellman-Ford/SPFA +66.30 points [55.50, 75.14]; Dijkstra -67.39	Bellman-Ford/SPFA +61.0 points [50.53, 69.98]; Dijkstra -62.0
Grid	word	ratio 1.555 [1.309, 1.85] of paraphrase noise; probe decoded shift +0.88 toward A*	BFS +1.03 points; no program other than BFS	BFS +1.0 point
Shortest path	entropy	ratio 1.165 [1.0, 1.596]; upper bound above the 1.5 bound	Dijkstra share unchanged	unchanged

2.3.9 Sham bans as a weak test of negation triggered promotion

The audit compared each survivor's share under each of the nine bans of absent algorithms with its share in the association draw's baseline (N = 300), and called a survivor promoted if it gained at least 10 points with Fisher p below 0.05. Two promotions passed: banning IDDFS raised DFS by 12 points (p = 3.5e-8) and banning Floyd-Warshall raised Bellman-Ford/SPFA by 23 points (p = 1.7e-15). Two smaller shifts fell below the cut: banning unit weight Dijkstra raised DFS by 8 points (p = 1.2e-5) and banning Dial raised Bellman-Ford/SPFA by 5 points (p = 0.0009). In both promotions the gaining algorithm is a content neighbour of the banned one and also the second choice of the model, so the test cannot say whether the negation promoted an associate or merely disturbed the default toward the ladder's next rung. Shuffling the condition labels gave no promotion, as it should.

2.3.10 Executed outputs missing from the iteration-1 record, and bookkeeping

Forced conditions of the association experiment. Table 6 was captioned as every condition, but the experiment also ran eleven forced implementation conditions of 10 samples each (Table 50). They match the geometry experiment's manipulation check (Table 11): the model cannot write a passing IDDFS on the grid task or a Dial on the shortest path task, and asked for bidirectional

Dijkstra it writes plain Dijkstra every time.

Table 50. Forced implementations in the association experiment (N = 10 each; labels of attempted programs; source: association experiment `data/samples.jsonl`, conditions `forced:*`).

Task	Requested algorithm	Pass	Labels
Grid	A*	10/10	A* 9, unit weight Dijkstra 1
Grid	BFS	9/10	BFS 10
Grid	bidirectional BFS	4/10	BFS 5, bidirectional BFS 5
Grid	DFS	3/10	DFS 10
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	10/10	unit weight Dijkstra 8, BFS 1, DFS 1
Grid	IDDFS	0/10	IDDFS 10
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	10/10	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 10
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	4/10	Dijkstra 10
Shortest path	Dial	0/10	other 5, Dial 4, Dijkstra 1
Shortest path	Dijkstra	10/10	Dijkstra 10
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	10/10	Floyd-Warshall 10

Other executed outputs. The association experiment's robustness block held an in-sample, sharpness matched sensitivity that the report omitted: with one sharpening power per family fitted on the two events, the Borda association map scored -1.386 and sampled frequency -1.475, the first rank map -0.888, the external Llama map -0.437, and the free-form answer and listing control both -0.059. These are in-sample numbers, not calibrated out-of-sample scores. In the forking token experiment, the next token entropy at the 13 forking token candidates averaged 0.527 bits (maximum 1.494) against 0.017 bits (maximum 0.130) at the 10 control positions. Its change point detector, tested on planted changes, caught a total variation change of 0.2, 0.3 and 0.5 at the right position in 82.5%, 95% and 99% of trials with a 6% false positive rate, and the grid forking token candidate on ban path 0 at token 9 confirms at a total variation threshold of 0.10 and 0.15 but not at the preregistered 0.20. Its engine test found greedy prefixes identical in only 14% of runs at 10 tokens and in all runs at 40 tokens. The decommitment experiment's arms at $c = 1$ in layers 14 and 22 passed 0 of 10 on both tasks. The geometry experiment's Procrustes disparity between the named and name masked centroid sets was 0.18 (grid) and 0.25 (shortest path), and it dropped two preregistered components under its drop order: the external model association elicitation and the distribution decoder that holds out one condition at a time. In the decoding experiment's enumeration arm on the shortest path task, the model wrote Bellman-Ford/SPFA 33 times but only 8 of those passed.

GPU hours. Iteration 1 recorded GPU time for two experiments. The audit took the first and last timestamp of every GPU phase log and summed the union of the spans (an upper bound that includes waits): geometry 2.92 GPU hours, forking token 1.55, decommitment 3.23, instruction tuning 2.47 and decoding 3.31. The association experiment has no GPU phase log; its own report gave about 6 minutes.

Grid failure taxonomy. Because a compliant program must be correct, low grid compliance could reflect test bias rather than broken programs. Of the 273 DFS programs in the association draw, 161 failed: 127 wrong answers, 31 timeouts and 3 runtime errors. The review's own re-run showed that reading a returned None as an empty path rescues only 2 to 3 programs per condition (under the BFS ban, DFS correct programs rise from 38 to 40); the audit could not repeat it because the stored failure fields do not hold returned values. Table 51 gives the failure kinds per grid condition for the draws that stored them.

Table 51. Failing grid programs by kind (source: `results/tables.json#missing_outputs.grid_failure_taxonomy`; the forking token and decommitment draws did not store failure kinds).

Draw	Condition	Failing	Wrong answer	Timeout	Runtime error
Association	baseline	20	15	4	1
Association	baseline, T = 1.3	21	17	3	1
Association	ban BFS	54	44	8	2
Association	ban DFS	12	11	1	0
Association	ban bidirectional BFS	8	8	0	0
Association	ban IDDFS	20	19	1	0
Association	ban A*	28	23	4	1
Association	ban unit weight Dijkstra	29	20	8	1
Association	ban BFS and DFS	47	40	6	1
Association	listing control	8	8	0	0
Association	mention DFS	35	20	15	0
Association	mention IDDFS	41	25	16	0
Association	mention bidirectional BFS	14	10	1	3
Association	forced DFS	7	5	2	0
Association	forced IDDFS	10	3	7	0
Geometry	ban BFS	24	9	14	1
Geometry	ban BFS and unit weight Dijkstra	14	5	9	0
Geometry	forced DFS	21	3	18	0
Geometry	forced IDDFS	30	6	23	1
Instruction tuning	instruct, chat template, ban BFS	30	10	19	1
Instruction tuning	base model, plain completion	277	151	27	99
Decoding	generate then select	45	15	27	2
Decoding	novelty instruction	15	5	7	1

Base model caveats. The instruction tuning experiment's base arms rest on few programs and weak labels. Under the chat template the base model produced parseable code in 0.583 [0.527, 0.638] of grid samples and 0.663 [0.608, 0.714] of shortest path samples, 57 and 90 correct programs out of 300, with runtime against AST kappa of 0.417 and 0.567 on those arms. In plain completion its correct shortest path programs were Bellman-Ford/SPFA 16, Dijkstra 8 and Floyd-Warshall 1, so its mode there is Bellman-Ford/SPFA, first rather than second. The preregistered verdicts stand as recorded: on the correctness conditioned Hill number, MIXED on the grid task (modal share gap 14.04 points against a 15-point bar) and INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on the shortest path task; INSTALLED_BY_POST_TRAINING on both under the Hill number over all programs; MIXED on both at the planned sample size.

2.3.11 Positioning against the nearest published work

The audit checked each positive claim against its nearest neighbours on the arXiv abstract pages on 2026-10-20 and recorded what this run adds (Table 52). All eight arXiv identifiers were verified. The venues of two papers (ICLR 2025 for the paper on introspection, NAACL 2025 for denial prompting) are not shown on their abstract pages and are marked unverified there.

Table 52. Each positive claim, its nearest neighbours and what this run adds (source: `results/positioning.json`).

Claim	Nearest neighbours	What this run adds, or replication
Temperature and the sampler change phrasing, not the algorithm	Temperature correlates weakly with novelty [37]; NoveltyBench [44]; approach level against surface level diversity in math reasoning [45], whose paper uses temperature only as a sampling setting	An executed, mechanism labelled measurement of algorithm choice in code across temperature, sampler and thinking mode: no change in algorithm beside a severalfold rise in phrasings. None of the three neighbours reports this measurement in code
Generate then select reaches several algorithms at a pass rate cost	SimpleStrat [43]	Replication in code algorithm space with the pass rate price; a ceiling row, not a knob
The substitute is predictable before the ban from the model's own answers	Verbalized Sampling attributes mode collapse to typicality bias [46]; introspection and simulation of own behaviour [39]	Forecasts of the realised substitute under prohibitions in code; descriptive, and no family advances under the rule
Internal states are organised by approach	Math reasoning organised by approach, not topic [40]	Code algorithms, prohibitions and a test of the generation time locus; the locus narrows to a paraphrase level signal (grid) and a readout after commitment (shortest path)
Bans recollapse on Bellman-Ford/SPFA	The inspiration repository (the specific recollapse statement was not found in its README); denial prompting [23]	Per draw counts across five independent draws with mechanism labels on an open model, and the generic perturbation rival on the same task

2.4 Likelihood screen: does a ban substitute, or expose a latent ladder? (Qwen3-8B)

Why. This experiment carried the title claim. On the two path search tasks it had to validate the likelihood instrument against events that iteration 1 had already sampled, then measure the full single ban gain matrices (6 by 5 on the grid task, 5 by 4 on the shortest path task) under the five templates and decompose them into a ladder share and an X specific share.

Design. The model wrote 1,170 forced programs (10 forced paraphrases per algorithm, three adaptive vLLM rounds), labelled with the canonical labeller, name scrubbed and reverified (Table 53). Scoring ran in HF transformers with bf16 weights but fp32 activations and TensorFloat-32 matrix products, because pure bf16 moved per program log likelihoods by up to 2.1 nats between equivalent computation paths; after the change the cached and full paths agreed within 0.074 nats per program. Throughput on that GPU (1,046 tokens per second) projected 242 minutes for 30 programs per algorithm against a 150-minute budget, so the preregistered cut rule fixed $M = 20$ programs per algorithm in two halves of 10, and the gate used three baseline paraphrases. In total 684 scoring units ran (one unit is one prompt condition scored on one program set) and 57 were skipped at the GPU deadline. Free-form association answers were sampled 20 times per algorithm; 7% (grid) and 47% (shortest path) were cut at the frozen 32-token limit, so the association profile is weak.

Table 53. Forced programs per algorithm (source: `results/yields.json`).

Task	Algorithm	Forced family	Attempts	Labelled as requested	Yield	Verified after scrub	Scrub mode
Grid	BFS	plain	40	40	1.00	40	full
Grid	DFS	plain	40	40	1.00	40	full

Grid	bidirectional BFS	plain	120	30	0.25	30	full
Grid	IDDFS	plain	40	40	1.00	40	full
Grid	A*	plain	90	32	0.36	32	full
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	descriptive	120	92	0.77	92	full
Shortest path	Dijkstra	plain	40	40	1.00	40	full
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	plain	40	40	1.00	40	full
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	descriptive	120	14	0.12	11	comments only (71% of full scrubs failed)
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	plain	40	40	1.00	35	full
Shortest path	Dial	descriptive	120	106	0.88	106	full

The validity gate failed on calibration. The gate asked three things of the likelihood instrument under the association experiment's own prompts: that the implied probabilities sum to between 0.3 and 3 with at least 0.9 of the mass on the sampled default (calibration), that the implied distribution beat uniform by at least 0.3 nats per sampled program on 19 sampled events (discrimination), and that its argmax match the realised mode on at least 80% of events with a clear mode. Discrimination passed (0.92 nats) and so did the argmax (16 of 19). Calibration failed: the instrument gave DFS a large share of the grid baseline (default share 0.83 on average and 0.44 on one paraphrase) although the association experiment sampled DFS 0 times in 300. Of the 303 gate cells, 298 had an effective sample size below 5, so one or two programs dominated each estimate. The diagnosis is name scrubbing: removing `bfs` and `dfs` identifiers and comments made a forced program much less likely under its own forced prompts than under a neutral prompt, which inflated the weights of minority algorithms. Scored on the unscrubbed programs, with their own proposal denominators, the instrument passed all three criteria (Table 55). By the frozen rule the scrubbed instrument is primary, so every likelihood result of this experiment is descriptive.

Table 54. The 19 gate events: realised mode against the likelihood instrument's implied distribution (source: `results/gate.json`; d is the log score over uniform in nats per sampled program).

Event	Realised mode (allowed labels)	Implied argmax	Hit	d (nats)	Implied shares above 0.01
grid baseline	BFS	BFS	yes	1.31	BFS 0.66, DFS 0.34
grid ban BFS	DFS	DFS	yes	1.57	DFS 1.00
grid mention BFS	BFS	BFS	yes	1.75	BFS 1.00
grid mention DFS	DFS	DFS	yes	1.74	DFS 1.00
grid mention bidirectional BFS	BFS	bidirectional BFS	no	-1.83	bidirectional BFS 1.00
grid mention IDDFS	IDDFS	IDDFS	yes	1.12	IDDFS 1.00
grid mention A*	A*	BFS	no	-1.75	BFS 0.78, A* 0.22
grid mention unit weight Dijkstra	BFS	BFS	yes	1.64	BFS 0.90, DFS 0.10
grid listing control	BFS	BFS	yes	1.37	BFS 0.76, DFS 0.24
grid ban IDDFS	BFS	DFS	no	-2.42	DFS 0.99, BFS 0.01

shortest path baseline	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 1.57	Dijkstra 1.00
shortest path ban Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	yes 1.35	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1.00
shortest path mention Dijkstra	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 1.57	Dijkstra 1.00
shortest path mention Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	yes 1.57	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1.00
shortest path mention bidirectional Dijkstra	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 1.57	Dijkstra 1.00
shortest path mention Floyd-Warshall	Floyd-Warshall	Floyd-Warshall	yes 1.57	Floyd-Warshall 1.00
shortest path mention Dial	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 1.57	Dijkstra 1.00
shortest path listing control	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 1.57	Dijkstra 1.00
shortest path ban Floyd-Warshall	Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes 0.64	Dijkstra 0.98, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 0.02

Per baseline paraphrase, the calibration sum S and default share m were 1.55 and 0.70, 2.56 and 0.44, and 1.23 and 0.84 on the grid task, and 0.20 and 1.00, 0.36 and 1.00, and 0.20 and 1.00 on the shortest path task.

Table 55. Gate under sensitivity variants (descriptive; the primary verdict is not rechosen; source: `results/gate.json`).

Variant	Mean S	Mean m	Calibration	Mean d (nats)	Discrimination	Argmax rate	Argmax	All three
primary (scrubbed, mixture proposal)	1.02	0.83	fail	0.92	pass	0.84	pass	fail
code body only	1.02	0.83	fail	0.92	pass	0.84	pass	fail
correct programs only	0.66	1.00	pass	0.76	pass	0.79	fail	fail
single forced prompt as proposal	0.99	0.94	pass	0.99	pass	0.84	pass	pass
truncated to 256 tokens	1.06	0.88	fail	0.92	pass	0.84	pass	fail
unscrubbed	0.95	1.00	pass	1.18	pass	0.89	pass	pass
unscrubbed, body only, single proposal	1.01	1.00	pass	1.11	pass	0.89	pass	pass

The substitution test: undetermined. The between survivor variance of the ban gains is far above replicate noise (F between 16 and 22 under the neutral reference), so the model does not merely subtract. But the pooled X specific share is 0.55 with a 95% interval of [0.25, 0.67] under the neutral twin reference and 0.66 [0.49, 0.87] under the mention twin: both intervals straddle 0.5 and no ladder exists, so the preregistered branch is undetermined, and the same holds under effective sample size weighting (Table 56). The grid task alone reads X specific but unaimed under the mention reference and the weighted variant. Neither rival account fits. The X specific residuals are not aimed at the prime and veto profile (mean Spearman -0.10 against a null 95th percentile of 0.20, $p = 0.80$) or at the free-form association profile (-0.12, $p = 0.77$). And the eight generic perturbation profiles do not agree with one another, so there is no coherent ladder to be exposed (Table 57). *(Correction, iteration 3: the three readings above, that the gains are not pure subtraction, that the residuals are not aimed, and that the generic profiles form no coherent ladder, are not detectable with the current instrument; they are not findings. On the rows whose behaviour is known the X specific residual points away from the realised substitute (Dijkstra ban: Bellman-Ford/SPFA -1.84 against Dial +6.07 and Floyd-Warshall +3.68; BFS ban: DFS +0.83 against IDDFS +7.99), the argmax of the gain*

hits the realised landing in 0 of 17 sampled Qwen3-8B single bans while the argmax of the implied mass hits 14 of 17, no row keeps three survivors with at least 1% implied mass and an ESS of at least 5, and the bootstrap variance of the mean gain is a median 2.7 times the replicate noise that the frozen correction subtracts, which inflates both F and the share. Section 3.2.1.)

Table 56. Substitution test: noise corrected ladder and X specific sums of squares and the X specific share (source: `results/c1.json`; 95% intervals by bootstrap over templates, programs and random directions).

Reference	Scope	Rows	V_u (ladder)	V_s (X specific)	Share	Share 95% CI	V_u + V_s 95% CI	F	Branch
neutral twin (primary)	grid	6	239.28	412.46	0.63	[0.28, 0.83]	[501.86, 1505.29]	15.91	undetermined
neutral twin (primary)	shortest path	5	244.64	173.12	0.41	[0.10, 0.61]	[316.25, 947.02]	22.48	undetermined
neutral twin (primary)	pooled	11	483.93	585.58	0.55	[0.25, 0.67]	[924.80, 2106.68]	17.93	undetermined
mention twin	grid	6	1282.94	2525.02	0.66	[0.51, 0.98]	[2573.47, 5471.38]	57.44	X specific, unaimed
mention twin	shortest path	5	522.29	979.57	0.65	[0.26, 0.79]	[1182.96, 2115.91]	37.69	undetermined
mention twin	pooled	11	1805.23	3504.59	0.66	[0.49, 0.87]	[4045.59, 7138.92]	49.98	undetermined
ESS weighted	grid	6	-35.45	181.32	1.24	[0.57, 1.62]	[116.32, 331.51]	15.92	X specific, unaimed
ESS weighted	shortest path	5	48.41	50.61	0.51	[-1.09, 2.40]	[74.07, 220.58]	23.24	undetermined
ESS weighted	pooled	11	12.96	231.93	0.95	[0.11, 1.70]	[218.16, 478.69]	18.21	undetermined

(Added in iteration 3: the ESS weighted grid share of 1.24 [0.57, 1.62] is impossible as a proportion. The noise corrected ladder term went negative (V_u = -35.4) once the weights shrank the ladder projection below its noise allowance, so V_s / (V_u + V_s) = 181.3 / 145.9 exceeds 1. The basic bootstrap intervals, which correct for the upward skew of these sums, are given in Section 3.2.1.)

Table 57. Does a latent ladder exist? Agreement among the eight generic perturbation profiles and the aim of the X specific residual (source: `results/c1.json`).

Task	Ladder exists (mean centred cosine at least 0.5)	Mean centred cosine	Mean raw cosine	Random edits, seed family A against B (r)	Nonce ban, half 1 against half 2 (r)	Aim at prime and veto	Aim p
Grid	no	0.34	0.21	0.53	0.37	-0.07	0.682
Shortest path	no	-0.02	-0.07	-0.26	0.82	-0.14	0.787

(Added in iteration 3: Tables 56 and 57 omit the aim under the mention twin reference, -0.595 in Qwen3-8B. That aim is negative by construction: the mention twin enters the gain with a minus sign and the prime and veto profile with a plus sign, so shared noise in the mention cell drives the correlation negative. Simulated under the split half design the null has mean -0.27, and -0.595 lies below its 1st percentile. Section 3.2.1.)

The per row decomposition (Table 58) shows where the X specific variance sits. The modal bans have large X specific residuals: under the BFS ban the largest residual belongs to IDDFS, under the

Dijkstra ban to Dial. The bans of DFS, Bellman-Ford/SPFA, Floyd-Warshall and Dial are mostly close to the ladder (cosine of the row with the ladder profile 0.87 to 0.96). The penultimate column measures each ban's effect on its own label, and it carries the experiment's clearest result: banning an algorithm the model never writes raises that algorithm's likelihood, by +2.5 to +26.9 nats in 8 of the 9 bans of absent algorithms (IDDFS +23.5, Floyd-Warshall +15.4, Dial +26.9). Only the two modal bans (BFS -8.25, Dijkstra -4.95) and the ban of A* (-5.93) lower their own label. Naming an algorithm primes it, even inside a prohibition [7].

Table 58. Per row decomposition under the neutral twin reference (source: `results/c1.json`; a_B^2 is the ladder part and ||s_B||^2 the X specific part of the row, N_u and N_s their noise expectations; D_B is the ban's effect on its own label, L_B(ban) - L_B(neutral), in nats; rho(s, PV) is the row's aim).

Task	Banned	a_B^2	N_u	s_B^2	N_s	cos(row, u)	Replicate SD	Between survivor SD	D_B	rho(s, PV)	Largest residual
Grid	BFS	139.75	2.04	163.48	6.13	0.68	4.04	7.79	-8.25	-0.25	IDDFS
Grid	DFS	45.20	1.53	4.32	4.60	0.96	3.50	3.15	8.43	-0.10	IDDFS
Grid	bidirectional BFS	1.03	2.04	33.27	6.13	-0.17	4.04	2.62	15.20	0.75	IDDFS
Grid	IDDFS	0.47	1.98	36.72	5.95	0.11	3.98	2.73	23.53	0.25	bidirectional BFS
Grid	A*	24.13	1.97	130.22	5.92	0.40	3.97	5.56	-5.93	-0.50	IDDFS
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	39.63	1.36	77.23	4.07	0.58	3.29	4.83	2.51	-0.60	IDDFS
Shortest path	Dijkstra	9.02	0.92	116.45	1.84	0.27	2.63	5.60	-4.95	0.00	Dial
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	119.68	1.42	27.77	2.84	0.90	3.26	6.07	10.59	0.30	Floyd-Warshall
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	41.38	2.02	33.55	4.04	0.74	3.89	4.33	3.54	0.20	Dial
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	73.89	1.37	5.98	2.74	0.96	3.21	4.47	15.40	-0.60	Dial
Shortest path	Dial	7.16	0.75	2.33	1.51	0.87	2.38	1.54	26.88	-0.60	Bellman-Ford/SPFA

The iteration-1 sham observations are absorbed by the shared component. In the Floyd-Warshall ban row the Bellman-Ford/SPFA gain (2.73 nats) equals its fitted ladder part (2.79); its X specific residual is -0.06 [-2.76, 3.67]. The IDDFS to DFS residual is -0.77 [-7.20, 4.02], with a mean gain of -0.45 against a fitted ladder part of 0.33. The two sham promotions of Section 2.3.9 therefore look like the ladder component, not like an X specific promotion.

Sensitivity. Every variant keeps the pooled branch undetermined except the gate passing unscrubbed programs (Table 59). Scored raw, with the first template only (the only one scored on raw programs), the pooled X specific share is 0.69 [0.51, 0.84], X specific but unaimed on the grid task and undetermined on the shortest path task; the matched scrubbed value is 0.55 [0.18, 0.78]. The aim cannot be tested in that variant, because mention twins were not scored on raw programs.

Table 59. Pooled X specific share under sensitivity variants (source: `results/sensitivity.json`).

Variant	Pooled share	95% CI	Pooled branch	Aim
code body only	0.55	[0.25, 0.68]	undetermined	-0.10

correct programs only	0.42	[0.18, 0.57]	undetermined	-0.17
single forced prompt as proposal	0.54	[0.26, 0.68]	undetermined	-0.09
truncated to 256 tokens	0.45	[0.25, 0.64]	undetermined	-0.11
ladder profile with the iteration-1 steering setting added	0.55	[0.25, 0.68]	undetermined	-0.10
ladder profile, unit normalised	0.42	[0.25, 0.66]	undetermined	-0.08
ladder profile from the nonce ban only	0.33	[0.24, 0.77]	undetermined	0.10
ladder profile from random edits only	0.64	[0.37, 0.89]	undetermined	0.04
ladder profile from the novelty instruction only	0.72	[0.30, 0.81]	undetermined	-0.09
unscrubbed, first template only	0.69	[0.51, 0.84]	X specific, unaimed	n/a
unscrubbed, body only, single proposal, first template	0.67	[0.51, 0.84]	X specific, unaimed	n/a
primary, first template only	0.55	[0.18, 0.78]	undetermined	-0.16

Double bans. The instrument put essentially all mass on the banned pair under the cumulative bans: 1.00 on both tasks with the frozen templates, against the association experiment's sampled banned shares of 0.94 (grid, mechanism level) and 1.00 (shortest path). It predicted the failure the succession hit in iteration 1. It placed the remaining mass on IDDFS 0.73 and A* 0.27 (grid) and on Floyd-Warshall 1.00 (shortest path) under the frozen templates, and on IDDFS 0.43, A* 0.33 and unit weight Dijkstra 0.24 (grid) and Floyd-Warshall 0.987 (shortest path) under the association experiment's own step-2 prompts. The six not banned grid programs that experiment sampled were unit weight Dijkstra 4, A* 1 and IDDFS 1. An sham ban outside the catalogue (jump point search, three of five templates) did not single out A*, its declared neighbour, in its residual; the other shams outside the catalogue and the iteration-1 steering setting as a generic perturbation were not run before the GPU deadline, and neither was the planned extension of the gate to the other four iteration-1 draws.

Coverage and effective sample size. The forced programs cover the natural ones unevenly (Table 60): well for Dijkstra and Floyd-Warshall (nearest neighbour shingle Jaccard 0.94 to 0.95), poorly for Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.54) and grid unit weight Dijkstra (0.42). Outside the forced cells, the median effective sample size of a half cell is 1.0 to 1.4 (Table 61).

Table 60. Coverage of naturally sampled programs by the forced programs (source: `results/coverage.json`; Jaccard over identifier normalised AST shingles).

Task and algorithm	Natural programs	Share with nearest forced Jaccard at least 0.5	Mean nearest Jaccard
Grid BFS	1102	0.69	0.66
Grid DFS	262	0.56	0.59
Grid bidirectional BFS	5	0.60	0.49
Grid IDDFS	37	0.73	0.58
Grid A*	29	0.48	0.57
Grid unit weight Dijkstra	12	0.17	0.42
Shortest path Dijkstra	1004	0.96	0.94
Shortest path Bellman-Ford/SPFA	251	0.40	0.54
Shortest path Floyd-Warshall	43	1.00	0.95

Table 61. Effective sample size of the importance weights per condition family (source: `results/ess_table.json`).

Task	Condition family	Half cells	Median ESS	Share below 5
Grid	ban	516	1.13	0.99

Grid	baseline	12	1.07	1.00
Grid	random edits	72	1.19	0.99
Grid	iteration-1 gate prompts	228	1.21	0.98
Grid	forced prompts	120	5.61	0.43
Grid	mention	360	1.20	0.96
Grid	neutral	516	1.08	0.98
Grid	novelty	12	1.10	1.00
Shortest path	ban	350	1.17	0.97
Shortest path	baseline	10	1.40	1.00
Shortest path	random edits	60	1.08	0.97
Shortest path	iteration-1 gate prompts	175	1.28	0.98
Shortest path	forced prompts	100	3.69	0.70
Shortest path	mention	250	1.11	0.94
Shortest path	neutral	350	1.27	1.00
Shortest path	novelty	10	1.02	1.00

Checks and what was frozen. Synthetic tests of the analysis code recovered a planted ladder (share 0.00), a planted X specific pattern (share 1.00), unbiased noise correction and a planted aim ($p = 0.00025$). An independent rederivation matched the gate, the shares, the aim and every cell to within 1e-15, and a placebo aim sat at its null (mean 0.0007, SD 0.122, against the observed -0.105). The aim profiles, the ladder profile, the templates, nouns and padding, and the code hashes were frozen in a hash chain for the confirmation bench. The experiment's own recommendation, which the Llama replication and the bench inherit, is to score unscrubbed or name matched programs.

2.5 Route experiment: does a ban act through the prompt states or at generation time?

Why. The hypothesis update predicted that the algorithm specific part of a ban travels by a direct route, with generated tokens reading the prohibition and vetoing X at its signature tokens, and that the read position carries only how strongly the ban will be obeyed. This experiment tested the route causally on the modal bans of both tasks (BFS on the grid task, Dijkstra on the shortest path task), in Qwen3-8B in bf16.

Design. Because each ban prompt and its neutral twin have the same token length and identical tokens from the task text onward, their key and value (KV) caches can be spliced position by position, an interchange intervention on cached states in the sense of activation patching [47]. One arm is the full ban and one the full neutral twin. In the *prompt route* arm, generated tokens see the neutral condition segment but the task specification and read position cache entries computed under the ban, so they can learn about the ban only through states that read it. In the *direct route* arm, generated tokens see the ban segment but task specification and read position entries computed under the neutral twin, so they can learn about the ban only by attending to it directly. Two further arms splice only the read position or only the task specification states. A placebo arm splices between two neutral nouns. Attention knockouts [48] block attention from generated tokens to the condition segment for all generated tokens, for the first 16 only or after the first 16, and in three bands of 12 layers; the same full knockout applied to the neutral prompt measures generic damage. The primary readout is the likelihood drop of the banned algorithm X, $D_X(\text{arm}) = L_X(\text{arm}) - L_X(\text{neutral twin})$, over 30 self written, name scrubbed programs per algorithm (323 forced programs in all). The route fractions are $F_{\text{prompt}} = D_X(\text{prompt route}) / D_X(\text{full ban})$ and

F_direct = D_X(direct route) / D_X(full ban), with F_R and F_spec defined the same way for the read position only and task specification only arms, all bootstrapped over templates and programs. The decision rule was hash committed before any arm was scored: the ban acts directly if F_direct is at least 2/3 with an interval above 1/2, and is decided before writing if F_prompt meets the same bar. Behaviour was sampled 100 times per arm and task (five templates by 20) under common random numbers: one uniform stream per sample shared by every arm, inverse CDF sampling in vocabulary order and a constant batch shape.

The ban is carried by the prompt states. Under the preregistered readout the ban is decided before writing on both tasks, and the decision is robust (Table 62). Pooled over tasks, the prompt route carries 0.85 [0.61, 1.20] of the likelihood drop and the direct route 0.00 [-0.08, 0.12]. The read position alone carries nothing (F_R about 0); the task specification states carry it (0.86 and 0.81). The placebo splice moved the banned algorithm by 1.2% (grid) and 0.7% (shortest path) of the ban effect, and the full knockout on the neutral prompt cost only -0.21 and -0.28 nats. Leaving out one template at a time kept F_prompt between 0.68 and 0.99 on the grid task and between 0.74 and 0.91 on the shortest path task, and all four preregistered sensitivity analyses gave the same branch (unweighted mean log likelihood: F_prompt 0.70 and 0.82; correct programs only; the generating paraphrase as denominator; no ESS weighting).

Table 62. Likelihood drop of the banned algorithm per arm, in nats, with 95% bootstrap intervals over templates and programs (source: `results/analysis.json#route_frlp`).

Arm	Grid (ban BFS)	Shortest path (ban Dijkstra)
a, full ban	-12.25 [-20.9, -6.9]	-5.78 [-7.9, -3.1]
c, prompt route	-10.65 [-12.3, -9.6]	-4.73 [-6.2, -3.1]
d, direct route	-0.23 [-3.0, 0.8]	0.22 [-0.3, 0.8]
e, read position only	0.00 [-0.4, 0.2]	-0.11 [-0.3, 0.0]
f, task specification only	-10.48 [-12.5, -9.3]	-4.66 [-6.1, -3.2]
full knockout of the condition segment	-11.65 [-13.6, -9.9]	-5.42 [-6.6, -3.9]
knockout, first 16 generated tokens	-10.74 [-15.5, -9.5]	-5.31 [-6.7, -3.5]
knockout, after 16 generated tokens	-11.56 [-15.7, -6.8]	-5.91 [-7.8, -3.5]
knockout, layers 0 to 11	-13.88 [-22.3, -7.7]	-5.88 [-8.0, -3.1]
knockout, layers 12 to 23	-8.29 [-11.4, -4.2]	-4.93 [-6.3, -3.3]
knockout, layers 24 to 35	-14.38 [-20.1, -11.5]	-5.24 [-7.3, -2.9]
full knockout on the neutral prompt (generic damage)	-0.21 [-0.6, 0.6]	-0.28 [-0.6, -0.0]
mention twin	0.55 [-0.3, 2.1]	-0.17 [-0.7, 0.4]
F_prompt [95% CI]	0.87 [0.55, 1.50]	0.82 [0.62, 1.20]
F_direct [95% CI]	0.02 [-0.10, 0.18]	-0.04 [-0.25, 0.05]
F_spec / F_R	0.86 / 0.00	0.81 / 0.02
interaction D(a) - D(c) - D(d)	-1.37 [-7.97, 3.86]	-1.27 [-2.55, -0.00]
Pooled (ratio of sums)	F_prompt 0.85 [0.61, 1.20]; F_direct 0.00 [-0.08, 0.12]; branch: decided before writing, robust	

[Figure fig_route: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The knockouts agree. Blocking the condition segment for every generated token restores 5% (grid)

and 6% (shortest path) of the likelihood gap, with intervals that include zero. By layer band, blocking layers 12 to 23 restores 32% [16%, 56%] on the grid task and 15% on the shortest path task, layers 0 to 11 restore about nothing, and layers 24 to 35 restore -17% (interval includes zero) on the grid task and 9% [2%, 16%] on the shortest path task. Whether the veto is read early or late in generation could not be determined (first-16 minus after-16 restoration 0.07 [-0.47, 0.20] and 0.10 [-0.03, 0.18]).

Behaviour qualifies the grid result. On the shortest path task behaviour matches the likelihood readout exactly: the prompt route arm reproduces the ban (banned share 0.13 against 0.11) and the direct route arm is the baseline (0.95 against 0.99). On the grid task the prompt route reproduces only part of the ban (0.57 against 0.14), and the direct route also moves it (0.70). A supplementary arm that hides the condition segment from every generated token brought BFS back to 0.47 [0.38, 0.57], close to the prompt route arm (McNemar $p = 0.13$), so on the grid task generated tokens do read the ban directly as well. That reading is redundant over time: blocking only the first 16 generated tokens or only the rest leaves the ban intact (banned shares 0.16 and 0.19). The behavioural route fractions are 0.50 [0.39, 0.62] (prompt) and 0.35 [0.25, 0.45] (direct) on the grid task, and 0.98 [0.89, 1.07] and 0.05 [0.01, 0.09] on the shortest path task. Matched pairs are clean: no sample was banned under the ban and not banned under its neutral twin (0 of 86 and 0 of 88 discordant pairs in that direction).

Table 63. Behaviour per arm under common random numbers ($N = 100$ per arm; mechanism labels of attempted programs; banned share with Wilson 95% interval; source: `results/analysis.json#behaviour`, `results/supplementary.json`).

Task	Arm	Banned share [95%]	Pass rate	Labels	Banned programs per template (first to fifth, 20 each)
Grid	b, neutral twin	1.00 [0.96, 1.00]	0.92	BFS 100	20, 20, 20, 20, 20
Grid	d, direct route	0.70	0.81	BFS 70, DFS 30	15, 12, 17, 20, 6
Grid	c, prompt route	0.57 [0.47, 0.66]	0.61	BFS 57, DFS 43	10, 15, 6, 12, 14
Grid	a, full ban	0.14 [0.09, 0.22]	0.41	DFS 86, BFS 14	0, 0, 0, 14, 0
Grid	full knockout (supplementary)	0.47 [0.38, 0.57]	n/a	BFS 47, rest not BFS	n/a
Grid	knockout, first 16 tokens	0.16	0.46	DFS 84, BFS 16	1, 0, 1, 14, 0
Grid	knockout, after 16 tokens	0.19	0.49	DFS 81, BFS 19	1, 2, 1, 11, 4
Shortest path	b, neutral twin	0.99	0.99	Dijkstra 99, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	20, 20, 20, 19, 20
Shortest path	d, direct route	0.95	0.99	Dijkstra 95, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	19, 18, 20, 19, 19
Shortest path	c, prompt route	0.13	0.91	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 87, Dijkstra 13	6, 1, 3, 1, 2
Shortest path	a, full ban	0.11	0.91	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 86, Dijkstra 11, other 3	1, 0, 4, 5, 1

Shortest path	full knockout (supplementary)	0.06	n/a	Dijkstra 6, rest not Dijkstra	n/a
Shortest path	knockout, first 16 tokens	0.11	0.94	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 88, Dijkstra 11, other 1	2, 1, 5, 3, 0
Shortest path	knockout, after 16 tokens	0.11	0.96	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 89, Dijkstra 11	3, 0, 4, 3, 1

On the grid task, all 14 BFS programs that survived the full ban came from the fourth template (`X is not allowed here`, with BFS as X), which gave 14 of 20 BFS while the other four templates gave 0 of 20.

Where the ban acts: the first line. Under the neutral twin, 99% of programs open with an import line (`from collections import deque` on the grid task, `import heapq` on the shortest path task). Under the grid ban, none of 100 programs opens with an import line, including the 14 BFS programs that survive; they open with `def solve(...)` (Table 64). The prompt route arm and every knockout also open without an import, while the direct route arm still opens with one 85% of the time. On the shortest path task the Bellman-Ford/SPFA programs written under the ban mostly open with `from collections import deque`, so the share of import openings stays at 61 to 67% under the ban, the prompt route and the knockouts, and 99% under the direct route. Per-token localisation agrees. On the grid task 63% of the likelihood drop under the full ban, 90% under the prompt route and 95% under the full knockout sits in the first 16 tokens; on the shortest path task almost all of it does. The signature tokens themselves (`deque`, `heapq` and their neighbours) carry only 2.4% (grid) and 11.6% (shortest path) of it. The small direct route drop on the grid task lies later in the program (6% of it in the first 16 tokens). We call this the *opening line veto*: the prompt states suppress the default program's first line before any algorithm specific token is written. On the grid task, the algorithm chosen after `def solve` also depends on direct reads of the ban, and the likelihood readout, dominated by the opening fork, calls the grid task prompt route while its behaviour is mixed.

Table 64. Share of programs whose first line is an import (source: `results/supplementary.json#opening_lines`; N = 100 per arm).

Task	b, neutral	d, direct route	c, prompt route	a, full ban	full knockout	knockout, first 16	knockout, after 16
Grid	0.99	0.85	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Shortest path	0.99	0.99	0.61	0.62	0.67	0.67	0.60

A supplementary readout with natural proposals. Rescoring, under every arm, the BFS and Dijkstra programs sampled in the neutral arm (exact draws from the neutral prompt's distribution) gives the same ordering with a larger direct share: pooled F_prompt 0.57 [0.41, 0.85] and F_direct 0.16 [0.11, 0.21] (grid 0.58 and 0.18, shortest path 0.56 and 0.11), and the two routes are superadditive on both tasks. Neither likelihood readout is a calibrated probability ratio. The importance weight ESS is about 1 to 3 of 30 programs for the grid full ban arm (8 to 20 on the shortest path task), 858 of the 1,095 cells have ESS below 5, and exp(D) under the natural readout is 3e-7 on the grid task against a behavioural ratio of 0.14. The readouts measure how strongly typical banned algorithm programs, which begin with the import line, are vetoed.

Where the substitute rises. Under the full ban the survivors' likelihood gains on the grid task were DFS +9.46, IDDFS +18.40, bidirectional BFS -0.22, A* -0.80 and unit weight Dijkstra -3.53 nats; on the shortest path task Bellman-Ford/SPFA +2.53, bidirectional Dijkstra +30.64, Floyd-Warshall

+12.64 and Dial +6.79. The prompt route arm reproduces this profile (cosine 0.94 [0.85, 0.99] grid, 0.95 [0.90, 0.99] shortest path); the direct route arm reproduces it on the shortest path task (0.98 [0.80, 1.00]) but not reliably on the grid task (0.71 [-0.18, 0.94]). The logit lens and a tuned lens [49] at the planned commitment token (the token after `from` or `import`) found no veto layer: the banned set's rank there is unchanged by the ban (0 of 59 grid and 0 of 60 shortest path programs), because the fork has already happened at the first token. The grid substitute set (DFS) rises from layer 28 (59 of 59 programs; tuned lens median 27). In substitute programs written under the full ban, the banned set is vetoed late (median layer 30 on the grid task, 36 on the shortest path task). The tuned lens beat the logit lens on held-out KL at all 11 probed layers (0.29 against 10.6 at layer 21).

Does the read position know how hard a ban will be obeyed? The compliance test regressed the banned share of each wording on the projection of its read position state onto a shared ban direction, the mean ban minus neutral shift estimated leaving one experiment out. It used 110 wordings in 12 experiment by task cells: ten modal ban paraphrases from each of the five iteration-1 draws per task, plus this experiment's five templates per task. The combined within cell Spearman correlation is -0.41 [-0.69, -0.17], one sided stratified permutation $p = 0.0003$ (Holm adjusted over the two axes tested, 0.0006). The preregistered bar was -0.5, so the result is partial: wordings that move the read position further along the ban direction are obeyed more, but less tightly than predicted. The correlation beats 98.5% of 200 random directions (null mean -0.01), and the split half noise ceiling is about 0.77. The decommitment axis of iteration 1 carries nothing (rho 0.05, $p = 0.68$). The DFS share among programs not banned is not decodable beyond the projection (change in R squared below zero, permutation $p = 0.74$ on the grid task; not testable on the shortest path task). The recomputed read position states matched the iteration-1 caches (cosine at least 0.9994 for 40 geometry and 60 decommitment prompts).

Table 65. Within cell Spearman correlation between a wording's banned share and its read position projection (source: `results/c5.json`; ten wordings per cell, five for this experiment's templates).

Cell	Shared ban direction	Decommitment axis
Association, grid	-0.701	0.234
Association, shortest path	-0.811	0.416
Geometry, grid	-0.214	-0.082
Geometry, shortest path	-0.673	-0.132
Forking token, grid	-0.437	0.212
Forking token, shortest path	0.271	0.516
Decommitment, grid	-0.074	0.309
Decommitment, shortest path	-0.605	-0.368
Instruction tuning, grid	0.036	0.207
Instruction tuning, shortest path	-0.171	-0.734
This experiment's templates, grid	-0.707	0.0
This experiment's templates, shortest path	-0.667	0.308
Combined [95% CI]; one sided p	-0.41 [-0.69, -0.17]; $p = 0.0003$	0.05 [-0.30, 0.36]; $p = 0.68$

Checks. Spliced caches reproduced the full ban scores bit for bit; the knockout attention with nothing blocked equalled stock attention (largest difference 0); attention to blocked columns was exactly 0. Repeated sampling was 100% identical at a fixed batch shape and only 40% when the shape changed, which is why every arm shares one shape. Two independent rederivations reproduced 49 and 59 headline numbers with no mismatch; McNemar on randomly swapped arm labels rejected 4.0 to 4.4% of the time, the likelihood ban effect's interval included zero for the

placebo splice and for label shuffled data, and the compliance test rejected 0 of 40 shuffled data sets. From the declared dataset dependency, other models' other than Dijkstra choices for weighted shortest path in the inspiration repository spread over Bellman-Ford/SPFA (37%), bidirectional search (32%) and other algorithms (23%), while Qwen3-8B under the Dijkstra ban lands on Bellman-Ford/SPFA 97% of the time; an import opening is the norm in LLM written solutions that name these algorithms (KodCode: BFS 94% of 17, Dijkstra 100% of 40) but not in human library code (TheAlgorithms: 29% of 7 and 17% of 12).

2.6 Ban list experiment: the top five prohibition and bans that leave one survivor

Why. The request asks what happens when the top five algorithms are prohibited in one prompt: does the implemented algorithm move to the edge of the banned region, or to its opposite side? Iteration 1 could not reach that test through its greedy succession, because the model stopped complying after two bans. This experiment ran the prohibition as single prompt conditions, with a control for each reading of where the mass goes, and asked on the shortest path task whether the model can and will write each algorithm when it is the only one allowed.

Catalogue extension. The grid catalogue was extended toward the ten algorithms the request imagines: greedy best first search was split from A*, and IDA*, a 4-neighbour jump point search and bidirectional A* were added, with new references that both labellers got right (25 of 25) and targeted unit probes (4 of 4). The canonical labeller recheck gave 135 of 144 gold programs and 22 of 22 references. The 40-program gold gate of the extended labeller was missed: 33 of 40 at round 0 and 32 of 40 after the one allowed revision, runtime against AST kappa 0.53; unit weight Dijkstra, jump point search and bidirectional A* fell below three of four gold programs and were excluded. An algorithm was kept if at least 70% of its 40 forced programs were labelled as requested (Table 66). Only BFS, DFS, IDDFS, greedy best first and IDA* passed, so the extension failed. The model mostly writes A* as a cost only heap (unit weight Dijkstra 25 of 40), unit weight Dijkstra as BFS (18 of 40), and jump point search and bidirectional A* as BFS and A*. The analysis catalogue (seven algorithms) kept A* and bidirectional BFS, flagged, because each has at least 10 programs and passes the gold set. With seven algorithms the frozen set rule gives four name sets: TOP (the four with the highest baseline likelihood: BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS), ARC (four contiguous on the manifold: BFS, bidirectional BFS, A*, greedy) and SCATTER (four spread out: BFS, DFS, greedy, IDA*). The literal ban of five names, TOP5 (BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS, A*), was added. Six landing forecasts per set (ladder, prime and veto, proximity, likelihood under the ban, generic perturbation, corpus frequency) were hash chained before the ban lists were sampled, and the chain verifies.

Table 66. Keep rule for the extended catalogues: forced programs labelled as requested (source: `results/catalogue_keep.json`; 40 forced programs each).

Task	Algorithm	Forced prompt	Labelled as requested	Of those, passing	Other labels	Kept
Grid	BFS	plain	40	38	none	yes
Grid	DFS	plain	40	9	none	yes
Grid	IDDFS	plain	37	0	DFS 3	yes
Grid	greedy best first	plain	35	25	BFS 2, other 2, A* 1	yes
Grid	IDA*	descriptive	36	0	A* 3, BFS 1	yes

Grid	bidirectional BFS	plain	21	5	BFS 16, other 3	no (kept in analysis, flagged)
Grid	A*	plain	11	11	unit weight Dijkstra 25, other 3, BFS 1	no (kept in analysis, flagged)
Grid	unit weight Dijkstra	plain	13	11	BFS 18, other 9	no
Grid	jump point search	descriptive	7	0	BFS 21, other 11, unit weight Dijkstra 1	no
Grid	bidirectional A*	descriptive	5	0	A* 28, BFS 3, other 3, bidirectional BFS 1	no
Shortest path	Dijkstra	plain	40	40	none	always run
Shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	plain	40	34	none	always run
Shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	descriptive (corrected in iteration 3 from plain; the plain prompt gave 10 programs, Dijkstra 9)	14	9	Dijkstra 22, other 4	always run
Shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	plain	40	40	none	always run
Shortest path	Dial	descriptive (corrected in iteration 3 from plain; the plain prompt gave 10 programs)	36	7	other 4	always run

Every ban list fails. With one name banned the model complies (avoidance 0.86 on the grid task, 0.84 on the shortest path task). With four or five names it mostly writes a banned algorithm anyway (Table 67): avoidance is 0.13 for TOP, 0.37 for ARC, 0.04 for SCATTER and 0.00 for the literal ban of five names, so every ban list fails the event gate. The banned programs are BFS and DFS reimplemented, often without naming their mechanism (Table 68). We call a banned mechanism program *disguised* when its comments and identifiers never name its own mechanism; 41% to 92% of the banned programs under a ban list are disguised, DFS most often as `backtracking`. The likelihoods committed before sampling foresaw the failure for three of the four sets: the implied avoidance was below 1e-8 for TOP, SCATTER and the five name ban, against realised 0.13, 0.04 and 0.00. For ARC the implied avoidance was 0.9995 against a realised 0.37. A ban prompt raised the likelihood of the banned algorithms' own programs relative to the neutral twin (DFS gained about 10 nats under the first template of TOP), the same priming as in the likelihood screen.

Table 67. Grid ban lists and the single name references (N = 100 each, five templates by 20; mechanism labels of attempted programs; source: `results/landing.json`).

Condition	Banned	Landing (attempted programs)	Avoidance [Wilson 95%]	Template cluster 95% CI	Avoidance per template (first to fifth)	Pass rate
Grid baseline	none	BFS 100	n/a	n/a	n/a	0.89

Grid single ban	BFS	DFS 86, BFS 14	0.86 [0.78, 0.91]	[0.58, 1.00]	1.0, 1.0, 1.0, 0.30, 1.0	0.41
TOP	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS	BFS 59, DFS 26, greedy 2, other 13	0.13 [0.08, 0.21]	[0.01, 0.29]	0.15, 0.05, 0.0, 0.0, 0.45	0.40
ARC	BFS, bidirectional BFS, A*, greedy	BFS 63, DFS 37 (DFS allowed)	0.37 [0.28, 0.47]	[0.09, 0.68]	0.70, 0.15, 0.15, 0.0, 0.85	0.60
SCATTER	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDA*	BFS 69, DFS 27, A* 2, other 2	0.04 [0.02, 0.10]	[0.00, 0.08]	0.0, 0.10, 0.0, 0.0, 0.10	0.75
TOP5 (literal)	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS, A*	BFS 63, DFS 36, IDDFS 1	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	[0.00, 0.00]	0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0	0.68
Shortest path baseline	none	Dijkstra 100	n/a	n/a	n/a	1.00
Shortest path single ban	Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 83, Dijkstra 16, other 1	0.84 [0.76, 0.90]	[0.72, 0.95]	0.90, 0.95, 0.70, 0.65, 1.0	0.95

(Correction, iteration 3: TOP's avoidance of 0.13 is labeller residue, not avoidance into a catalogue algorithm. Its 13 programs not banned are all labelled other: 12 failing programs that both blind judges classed as degenerate BFS or DFS variants, and 1 correct unit weight Dijkstra outside the $K = 7$ analysis catalogue. Avoidance into a non-banned catalogue algorithm is 0.00 for TOP, 0.37 for ARC, 0.02 for SCATTER and 0.00 for TOP5. The share labelled other is reported separately from avoidance in Section 3.2.3.)

Table 68. Disguise: banned mechanism programs that never name their own mechanism (source: `results/landing.json`).

Condition	Banned mechanism programs	Disguised	Disguise rate	By mechanism (disguised / programs)	Most frequent self descriptions
Grid single ban of BFS	14	14	1.00	BFS 14/14	none named
Shortest path single ban of Dijkstra	16	2	0.125	Dijkstra 2/16	none named
ARC	63	58	0.92	BFS 58/63	`is_valid` 2
SCATTER	96	49	0.51	BFS 43/69, DFS 6/27	`backtrack` 10, `is_valid` 7, `depth-limited` 1
TOP	87	44	0.51	BFS 37/59, DFS 6/26, greedy 1/2	`backtrack` 10, `is_valid` 9
TOP5	100	41	0.41	BFS 34/63, DFS 6/36, IDDFS 1/1	`is_valid` 10, `backtrack` 8, `find_path` 2

[Figure fig_multiban: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The list's content barely matters (post hoc). Across the four ban lists the model writes the same mix of BFS and DFS: the BFS share among BFS and DFS programs is 0.69 (TOP), 0.63 (ARC), 0.72 (SCATTER) and 0.64 (TOP5), chi squared $p = 0.48$ and permutation $p = 0.57$. This holds whether DFS is on the list (TOP, SCATTER, TOP5) or allowed (ARC). Avoidance differences therefore come from whether DFS happens to be banned, not from a list specific landing. A single BFS ban moves the model to DFS 86%; a list of four or five names moves it to about one third DFS, which looks more like a generic perturbation of the default than a veto. This comparison was not preregistered.

Landing tests are degenerate. Only ARC (37 DFS programs) and SCATTER (2 A* programs) put any mass on a survivor. On ARC the ladder, prime and veto, likelihood, generic perturbation and corpus forecasts all named DFS (log score +1.06 nats per program over uniform), and proximity named IDA* and missed (-0.02). With three survivors the exact permutation floor is 1/6, every per set p is at least 0.33, and every pooled p is at least 0.11; the edge against opposite statistic was 0 on both sets with mass ($p = 0.67$). The request's literal question therefore has a behavioural answer that is neither of its two options: under a four or five name ban the model does not move to the edge or to the opposite side of the banned region, it reimplements the banned defaults. Over all programs, predicting no change from the default algorithm was right for 64% of programs under a ban list, against at most 10% for any committed survivor forecast; on single bans the highest ranked not banned algorithm predicted 85% and the default 15%; under forced prompts the requested algorithm was written 66% of the time.

Bans that leave one survivor: can against will. On the shortest path task each of the five algorithms was left as the only one allowed, by banning the other four (Table 69). The model writes Dijkstra when it is the survivor 95% of the time and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 51% of the time. It writes bidirectional Dijkstra, Floyd-Warshall and Dial 0% of the time, falling back to the banned Dijkstra or Bellman-Ford/SPFA instead, although when forced it writes Floyd-Warshall correctly 40 of 40 times and Dial 36 of 40 times. The likelihood gains follow the same split: banning the other four lowers Dijkstra by 3.35 nats and Bellman-Ford/SPFA by 0.21 when each is the survivor, and raises the three algorithms the model never writes by 7.6 to 24.3 nats without moving them into the sample.

Table 69. Shortest path bans that leave one survivor (N = 100 each; will is the share of programs implementing the survivor and can the share of 40 forced programs labelled as the survivor; source: `results/los.json`).

Survivor (other four banned)	Will [Wilson 95%]	Banned mechanisms written	Other	Compliant share	Can (forced labelled as requested; forced pass)	Mean likelihood gain of the survivor (nats)	Disguised / banned programs
Dijkstra	0.95 [0.89, 0.98]	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 0.05	0.0	0.95	1.00; 1.00	-3.35	4 / 5
Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	0.51 [0.41, 0.61]	Dijkstra 0.48	0.01	0.39	1.00; 0.85	-0.21	8 / 48
bidirectional Dijkstra	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	Dijkstra 0.52, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 0.48	0.0	0.0	0.35; 0.225	+24.26	51 / 100
Floyd-Warshall	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	Dijkstra 0.59, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 0.40	0.01	0.0	1.00; 1.00	+7.63	46 / 99
Dial	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	Dijkstra 0.52, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 0.44	0.04	0.0	0.90; 0.175	+21.20	42 / 96

Geometry and natural run internals. In the teacher forced residual stream, centroid MDS stress-1 was 0.025 (grid) and 0.006 (shortest path). The nearest neighbours were BFS with bidirectional BFS, DFS with IDDFS, and A* with greedy best first; nearest neighbour stability was 0.70 across

settings and 0.96 under a program bootstrap. Persistent homology, which tracks loops in a point cloud across distance scales, found no persistent loop on either task. *(Correction, iteration 3: this sentence originally read the result as a negative answer to the request's question about a circle. It is no evidence of a loop, at weak power, at a label-dependent position. These clouds sit at the token before the commit token, a position that depends on the label; there a planted loop is found with power 1.00, while at the label-independent generated token 16 the power is 0.04. The nearest pair at that position, BFS and bidirectional BFS (centroid distance 0.0147), does not survive at token 16: permuted labels reproduce the adjacency with $p = 0.19$ and the two clouds are not separable. The experiment drew 13 Isomap figures with centroids sized by implemented count, which this section did not show; they are reported with their counts in Section 3.2.2.)* Probes within one ban prompt at generated token 16, a position that does not depend on the label, were near chance on every grid condition and reached balanced accuracy 0.69 ($p = 0.03$) on the shortest path ban that leaves only Bellman-Ford/SPFA. Probes at the token before the commit token were confounded, because that position depends on the label. The difference-in-means direction from forced programs aligned with the natural within one ban direction at that position (cosine 0.6 to 0.95) and on the shortest path task at token 16 (0.3 to 0.99), but not for the grid BFS ban at token 16 (-0.13 to -0.01).

Deviations and cost. The experiment ran on an RTX 4090 in eager vLLM mode (no C compiler), replaced one duplicated forced paraphrase, missed the gold gate after its revision, and recorded bf16 scoring path noise of about 1 nat per program; the shortest path likelihoods sum to 0.17, below the 0.3 calibration floor; the second noun placebo ran after the ban lists were sampled. It used about 1 GPU hour and USD 0.42 of judge calls (857 calls).

2.7 Llama replication: the same protocol in a second model family

Why. A claim about what a ban does inside one model needs a second family. This experiment ran shared protocol v2 on Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22] in bf16 with its default chat template, on the canonical suite, retokenising the neutral noun bank under Llama. It drew 1,780 seeded vLLM generations: baselines, modal bans, mention twins, listing controls, two bans of algorithms other than the default and two double bans per task (14 events), 880 forced programs and 220 free-form answers. It scored 248 name scrubbed forced programs in 39,768 program scores (11.3 million tokens). Nothing was tuned to agree with Qwen3-8B.

Llama's baseline is not collapsed on the grid task. *(Correction, iteration 3: true of attempted programs only. All 20 correct grid baseline programs are BFS, a correctness conditioned Hill number of 1.00 against 1.87 over attempts, so Llama's correct grid output is as collapsed as Qwen3-8B's; correct-only compositions of every Llama event are in Section 3.2.4.)* It writes BFS 77 times and DFS 20 times in 100, with a low pass rate (0.20). On the shortest path task it is collapsed (Dijkstra 92, pass rate 0.59). The BFS ban sends it to DFS 63 of 100; the Dijkstra ban sends it to Dijkstra 43, other labels 37 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 18. Both double bans fail the gate (Table 70). Bidirectional Dijkstra and Dial could not be written (2 and 1 forced programs kept after up to 120 attempts), so the shortest path catalogue has three algorithms, no row there has three survivors, and the substitution test runs on the grid task only.

Table 70. The 14 sampled Llama events (mechanism labels of attempted programs; source: `results/events.json`).

Task	Event	N	Labels	Banned share	Avoidance	Compliant share	Clear mode	Gate
Grid	baseline	100	BFS 77, DFS 20, other 3	0.0	1.0	0.20	BFS	pass

Grid	ban BFS (modal)	100	DFS 63, BFS 29, other 6, A* 1, unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.29	0.71	0.08	DFS	pass
Grid	mention BFS	50	BFS 47, other 2, DFS 1	0.0	1.0	0.28	BFS	pass
Grid	listing control	50	BFS 36, other 7, DFS 6, unit weight Dijkstra 1	0.0	1.0	0.20	BFS	pass
Grid	ban DFS	50	BFS 39, DFS 7, other 4	0.14	0.86	0.14	BFS	pass
Grid	ban unit weight Dijkstra (absent)	50	BFS 30, DFS 18, unit weight Dijkstra 1, other 1	0.02	0.98	0.26	BFS	pass
Grid	ban BFS and DFS	50	BFS 21, DFS 21, other 6, unit weight Dijkstra 2	0.84	0.16	0.0	none	fail
Shortest path	baseline	100	Dijkstra 92, other 7, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	0.0	1.0	0.59	Dijkstra	pass
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra (modal)	100	Dijkstra 43, other 37, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 18, Floyd-Warshall 2	0.43	0.57	0.05	none	pass
Shortest path	mention Dijkstra	50	Dijkstra 39, other 11	0.0	1.0	0.46	Dijkstra	pass
Shortest path	listing control	50	Dijkstra 19, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 15, other 14, Floyd-Warshall 2	0.0	1.0	0.24	none	pass
Shortest path	ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	Dijkstra 33, other 14, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2, Floyd-Warshall 1	0.04	0.96	0.26	Dijkstra	pass
Shortest path	ban Floyd-Warshall (absent)	50	Dijkstra 25, other 11, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9, Floyd-Warshall 5	0.10	0.90	0.14	Dijkstra	pass
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	Dijkstra 22, other 21, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 6, Floyd-Warshall 1	0.56	0.44	0.0	none	fail

(Added in iteration 3: Table 70 lists attempted programs only. Correct programs: grid baseline BFS 20; ban BFS DFS 7, other 1; mention BFS BFS 14; listing control BFS 7, DFS 3; ban DFS BFS 7; ban unit weight Dijkstra BFS 12, DFS 1; shortest path baseline Dijkstra 59; ban Dijkstra Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4, other 1; mention Dijkstra Dijkstra 22, other 1; listing control Dijkstra 9, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3; ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA Dijkstra 13; ban Floyd-Warshall Dijkstra 6, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1; both double bans 0. Table 89, Section 3.2.4.)

The validity gate fails, and the substitution test is unresolved. Calibration fails on the grid task: the instrument implies BFS 0.43 and DFS 0.55 against a sampled BFS share of 0.77 (Wilson [0.68, 0.84]); the shortest path task passes (Dijkstra 0.97, sum 0.87). Discrimination passes at 0.59 nats per program over uniform across 13 events (1.0 to 1.6 nats on the grid ban and mention events, 0.1 to 0.8 on the shortest path ones, negative for both listing controls). The argmax matches the realised mode in 7 of 10 clear mode events, below the 0.8 bar; all three misses are on the grid task, where the instrument predicts DFS and sampling lands on BFS. The median cell ESS is 2.5 and 76% of cells are below 5. Under the neutral reference the X specific share is 0.80 with a 95% percentile interval of [0.28, 0.94], with no aim and no ladder, so the result is not resolved at this sample size; under the mention reference it reads X specific but unaimed (Table 71). The branch is not robust. Outside the frozen rule, the program level importance sampling noise dominates: the

bootstrap variance of the mean gain is 5 to 11 times the replicate variance the frozen correction subtracts, the basic interval for the neutral V_u + V_s is [-15.1, 10.2] and covers zero, and the share falls to 0.41 without the five forced programs that the label audit disputed and to 0.44 with a raw mean ladder profile.

Table 71. Llama substitution test, grid task only (source: `results/c1.json`).

Reference	X specific share (95% percentile CI)	V_u / V_s / V_u + V_s	Aim at prime and veto (null 95th pct; p)	Ladder exists (mean cosine)	Branch
neutral twin (primary)	0.80 (0.28, 0.94)	2.0 / 8.2 / 10.1	0.067 (0.258; p = 0.35)	no (0.14)	not resolved at this N
mention twin (secondary)	0.78 (0.61, 0.91)	7.1 / 25.5 / 32.6	-0.28 (p = 0.96)	no	X specific but unaimed

The association aim did not pass either (-0.08 against a null 95th percentile of 0.30).

Llama, like Qwen3-8B, primes the banned name. Naming an absent algorithm in a ban raised its own likelihood in 5 of 6 cases: bidirectional BFS +3.9 nats, IDDFS +7.6, unit weight Dijkstra +1.8, Bellman-Ford/SPFA +4.1 and Floyd-Warshall +4.8; A* was the exception (-1.2). The mention twin primes these algorithms by +6.7 to +14.4 nats and the ban's veto (-4.9 to -10.1) cancels only part of the prime. Bans of present algorithms do lower them: BFS -1.7, DFS -3.0 and Dijkstra -1.0. Within a ban row, the X specific residual is negatively correlated with how much a survivor's code resembles X (Spearman -0.6 to -0.9 in 5 of 6 grid rows): a ban lowers the survivors that look like the banned algorithm.

The route, read by likelihood only. On the two modal bans (20 cells), the ban's drop on the default (-27.2 nats summed) travels mostly by the prompt route: F_prompt 0.84 (bootstrap interval 0.62 to 1.46) and F_direct -0.21 (-1.03 to 0.09). On the grid task the prompt route arm also reproduces the full ban's redistribution over survivors (cosine 0.98); the direct route arm does not (0.20).

Which forecast predicts the program written? Over 743 attempted samples not banned the empirical sampled ladder predicted the realised mechanism best (Table 72). The likelihood forecast lost to it overall (difference -0.11, paired sign flip $p < 1e\text{-}4$) and tied it on single bans (+0.01, $p = 0.71$). Asked for the standard alternative, Llama answers DFS 20 of 20 times for BFS and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 19 of 20 times for Dijkstra; its top-1 answers match the OpenRouter Llama map of iteration 1 for 9 of 11 algorithms.

Table 72. Per-sample top-1 accuracy of each predictor against the realised mechanism label (source: `results/independent_rederivation_headlines.json`).

Predictor	All 743 samples	Single bans (313 samples)
likelihood (FRLP) top-1	0.59	0.67
empirical sampled ladder	0.70	0.67
free-form association	0.52	0.67
latent ladder from baseline likelihoods	0.51	0.63

Checks. The canonical labeller recheck reproduced the association experiment exactly (22 of 22 references, combined against adjudicated 0.966, runtime against AST kappa 0.753). A blind audit of 50 Llama programs by a second judge agreed with the final labels at 0.78 (grid 0.74, shortest path 0.87), below 0.9 and flagged; most disputes were flawed attempts the audit judge labelled as other. HF and vLLM scores agreed within 0.003 to 0.007 nats per token. KV cache reuse failed its 0.02-nat tolerance (mean 0.16, maximum 0.40 nats per program, bf16 batch shape numerics), so an

fp32 language model head was adopted. For 91% of forced prompts an algorithm's own likelihood lay in [-0.7, 0.2]; the default's likelihood matched its log sampled share within 0.11 nats on the shortest path task but was 0.59 nats off on the grid task, where the instrument under weights BFS. Independent rederivations matched 34 of 34 quantities and 63 of 63 headline numbers, and a random predictor placebo never beat the ladder. Cost: USD 0.49 of OpenRouter calls and 0.64 logged GPU hours on one RTX 4090. Table 72b lists every test the replication ran.

Table 72b. Tests of the Llama replication (source: the artifact's `README.md` test table and the `results/*.json` files it names).

Test	Result
Labeller recheck and label audit	pass (22/22 references, combined against adjudicated 0.966); blind audit of 50 Llama programs 0.78, flagged
Prompts	pass: 71/71 task texts equal the association experiment's; one BOS token; identical task suffix; ban and neutral twins of equal length (at most 13 filler tokens, no token level insertion); sampled token ids equal scored ids for 140 conditions
Engine agreement	pass: HF against vLLM 0.003 to 0.007 nats per token, program sums within 0.14 to 0.49 nats; 97% of outputs a single fenced code block, 94% exact retokenisation
KV cache reuse	fails the 0.02-nat tolerance: mean 0.16, maximum 0.40 nats per program (bf16 batch shape numerics; fp32 language model head adopted)
Scrubber	pass: 244 of 248 forced programs keep pass status and label after the full scrub, 4 after the conservative scrub, 8 unparsable originals dropped; on about 1,400 external programs every residual name is an attribute name
Likelihood sanity	an algorithm's own likelihood under its forced prompts lies in [-0.7, 0.2] for 91% of forced prompts; the default's likelihood matches its log sampled share within 0.11 nats on the shortest path task and is 0.59 nats off on the grid task
Edit hooks	zero coefficient leaves states exactly unchanged; no change outside the edited span or before the layer band; displacement within 4.3% of target (bf16), not 1e-3
Hybrid caches	pass (difference 0.0)
Analysis on synthetic data	pass: ladder, substitution and pure subtraction recovered; uniform aim p under the null; unbiased under exchangeable noise, biased under crossed noise (hence a template mean sensitivity)
Independent rederivation	34 of 34 quantities match to 1e-9; placebo p uniform (KS $p = 0.61$)
Headline rederivation	63 of 63 headline numbers match by a separate code path; the sampled ladder beats the likelihood forecast overall (-0.112, $p < 1e\text{-}4$) and ties it on single bans ($+0.010$, $p = 0.71$); a random predictor placebo never beats the ladder

2.8 Bench build: a frozen 12-task confirmation bench behind a presence pilot

Why. The review's arithmetic called for events, not predictors, and the hypothesis update needed tasks with a present minor algorithm so that present minor bans and a nondegenerate typicality forecast could exist. This artifact built the bench and ran a cheap baseline pilot before freezing any task. No ban prompt was rendered anywhere in it: an audit of 4,310 rendered prompts against a superset ban lexicon found no hit.

Design. Thirteen tasks derived from LeetCode [12] received a frozen specification in new wording on the canonical scaffold, a catalogue of three to six algorithms (54 in all), 684 hidden tests in total (parsed dataset cases filtered to the specification's bounds, plus generated edge and stress cases), order free checkers where the answer is a set, and one verified reference per algorithm. Every

reference passes at no more than a quarter of the per case limit, which is the larger of 1 s and ten times the fastest reference; all 39 planted mutants fail. Each task has a runtime signature labeller backed by an AST labeller, with a blind judge only on disagreement, gated against a gold set adjudicated by two judges and a tiebreaker (Cohen's kappa of at least 0.8, all references correct, runtime against adjudicated of at least 0.90). Qwen3-8B ran from its official 8-bit floating point checkpoint through the 8-bit Marlin kernels of vLLM, because the 16 GB GPU could not hold bf16 weights; decoding was T = 1.0, top-p 1.0, thinking off. Each task received a 50-sample pilot, 20 free-form answers per algorithm to the question `What is the standard alternative to X for this task?`, and at least 40 forced, name scrubbed programs per algorithm, scored by vLLM prompt log probabilities to give baseline likelihoods (corrected for adherence: L_corr = L + log adherence). Tasks were ordered by how much the ladder, association and proximity nominations disagree (Stage A, committed before gating) and the first 12 gated tasks were frozen with sha256 commitments.

Table 73. The 13 candidate tasks (source: `README.md` main table, `results/gate_summary.json`, `results/pilot_stats.json`, `results/frlp_validity.json`, `results/stageA_nominations.json`).

Task	K	Tests	Gate: kappa runtime vs AST [95% CI] / PABAK / runtime vs adjudicated	Qwen pilot: modal algorithm (share, pass)	Baseline likelihood of the modal algorithm	Best alternative (likelihood)	Sum of exp(likelihood)	Association / proximity nomination	Llama-3.1-8B pilot modal (share)	Status
kth smallest	6	60	0.95 [0.84, 1.00] / 0.96 / 0.96	full sort (1.00, 1.00)	-0.18	quickselect (-1.5)	1.05	quickselect / heapify and pop	heapify and pop (0.34)	frozen
two sum	4	44	0.92 [0.75, 1.00] / 0.94 / 0.95	hash map (1.00, 1.00)	-0.40	sort and two pointers (-15.5)	0.67	sort and two pointers / brute force	hash map (0.96)	frozen
find duplicate	5	54	1.00 [1.00, 1.00] / 1.00 / 1.00	hash set (1.00, 1.00)	0.02	sort, adjacent check (-12.4)	1.02	Floyd cycle detection / sort, adjacent check	hash set (0.43)	frozen
top-k frequent	4	38	0.84 [0.60, 1.00] / 0.88 / 0.91	sort by count (1.00, 0.94)	-0.10	bucket sort (-15.4)	0.91	heap / heap	heap (0.64)	frozen
connected components	4	57	1.00 [1.00, 1.00] / 1.00 / 1.00	union find (1.00, 1.00)	-0.15	DFS (-21.8)	0.86	DFS / label propagation	union find (0.77)	frozen
Fibonacci	4	36	0.85 [0.65, 1.00] / 0.89 / 0.91	iteration (1.00, 1.00)	-0.02	fast doubling (-11.4)	0.98	matrix power / fast doubling	matrix power (0.79)	frozen
substring search	6	58	0.95 [0.82, 1.00] / 0.96 / 1.00	naive (1.00, 1.00)	0.24	KMP (-14.3)	1.28	KMP / Horspool	naive (0.53)	frozen
longest increasing subsequence	3	57	1.00 [1.00, 1.00] / 1.00 / 1.00	quadratic DP (1.00, 1.00)	-0.86	patience sorting with bisect (-14.4)	0.42	patience sorting / patience sorting	quadratic DP (0.90)	frozen
merge intervals	3	59	1.00 [1.00, 1.00] / 1.00 / 0.95	sort and sweep (1.00, 1.00)	0.74	union find (-35.5)	2.09	interval tree / union find	sort and sweep (1.00)	frozen
nonoverlapping intervals	4	53	0.89 [0.63, 1.00] / 0.94 / 0.91	greedy by end (1.00, 1.00)	-0.83	DP with bisect (-28.1)	0.44	DP with bisect / DAG longest path	greedy by end (0.56)	frozen

cycle detection	4	59	0.92 [0.73, 1.00] / 0.94 / 0.95	DFS with parent (1.00, 0.92)	2.39	union find (-14.2)	10.9	union find / union find	DFS with parent (0.59)	excluded (13th gated; 12-task cap)
topological order	4	53	1.00 [1.00, 1.00] / 1.00 / 0.95	Kahn (1.00, 1.00)	2.44	DFS postorder (-27.2)	11.4	DFS postorder / source removal	Kahn (0.98)	frozen
first and last position	3	56	0.90 [0.61, 1.00] / 0.93 / 0.95	binary search (0.98, 0.98)	0.80	bisect module (-12.6)	2.21	bisect module / exponential search	binary search (1.00)	frozen

Qwen3-8B is fully collapsed on all 13 tasks. The modal share is 50 of 50 everywhere except first and last position (49 of 50), Wilson [0.929, 1.0], and the correctness conditioned Hill number is 1.0 on every task. No task has a minor algorithm at 10% or more, although the presence check is weak at N = 50 (a true share of 0.10 reaches 5 of 50 with probability about 0.57). The pilot pass rate is at least 0.92 on every task. The collapse is specific to the model: Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, run with the same specifications and decoding, splits over several algorithms on kth smallest (heapify and pop 0.34, size k heap, full sort and quickselect), substring search (naive 0.53) and find duplicate (hash set 0.43), and passes far fewer tests. *(Correction, iteration 3: these Llama shares are of attempted programs. Its 10 correct kth smallest programs are full sort 6, heapify and pop 2, quickselect 1 and size k heap 1, so its correct mode equals Qwen3-8B's; correct-only diversity appears on substring search (naive 18, KMP 5, Rabin-Karp 1), connected components (union find 30, DFS 5), cycle detection (union find 7, DFS with parent 4) and top-k frequent (heap 8, sort by count 4), at small N. Rarefied to 10 correct programs, Llama is more diverse than Qwen3-8B on 9 of 13 tasks. Table 90, Section 3.2.4.)* The presence pilot therefore removes the present minor stratum for Qwen3-8B on every candidate task: confirmation on this bench must rest on likelihood matrices and on modal bans for Qwen3-8B, and Llama is where sampled present minor bans exist.

Labeller, likelihoods and nominations. All 13 tasks passed the labeller gate, 11 at round 0 and two (kth smallest, merge intervals) after one revision round with a fresh holdout (5 of 6 and 6 of 6). Both labellers got all 54 references right; runtime and AST labels agreed on 0.91 of 3,230 Qwen attempts, and the judge was needed on 8.4%. The baseline likelihood's argmax equals the pilot mode on 13 of 13 tasks, its log score beats uniform on every task (for example -0.06 against -1.61 on two sum), and the sum of exp(likelihood) lies in [0.3, 3] on 11 of 13 (cycle detection and topological order overshoot, an importance sampling overestimate under low ESS). Of the 54 cells, 34 have Kish ESS below 5. One cell stands out: quickselect on kth smallest has likelihood -1.5 (about 0.21 latent mass) while the pilot drew it 0 of 50 times. The free-form association answers are close to deterministic (the alternative to a full sort is quickselect 20 of 20 times); proximity nominates a different algorithm from association on 10 of 13 modal events; and under total collapse the sampled ladder ties over all survivors. The order recomputed after the likelihoods (Stage B) agrees with Stage A at Kendall tau 0.54. Forced adherence limits the exotic algorithms: 45 of 54 have adherence of at least 0.5, and the lowest are topological layering (0.04) and source removal (0.10), the interval tree (0.24), the DP variants of nonoverlapping intervals (0.28), index marking (0.28) and label propagation (0.29).

Deviations and what was not done. Scoring used vLLM prompt log probabilities instead of HF; single request and batched scoring disagreed by 0.62 nats on 1 of 5 checked programs (the others within 0.015). The forced proposal used five paraphrases over eight rounds instead of ten over four. Not produced: the unscrubbed scoring sensitivity that the likelihood screen recommended, Llama forced programs and likelihoods, ban, mention and neutral likelihood matrices, and any sampled

ban event. Cost: about 1.4 GPU hours on one RTX 2000 Ada and USD 0.14 of judge calls (1,124 calls). *(Added in iteration 3: the frozen baseline likelihoods are therefore not commensurable with the screen's, which had to move to fp32 activations because bf16 moved per program log likelihoods by up to 2.1 nats; and the recommendation to score unscrubbed programs is validated only on baseline, mention and listing events, not on ban rows, where names left in identifiers interact with the ban's own naming. Rescored on the fp32 path in iteration 3, the bench cells moved by a median 0.88 nats with the argmax unchanged on 12 of 12 tasks; Section 3.3.)*

2.9 Readout experiment: the ban inside the model

Why. The request asks for internals read with sparse autoencoders, thought anchors and lenses, and for the literal same seed test of temperature. This experiment ran those readouts on the modal bans of the two path search tasks, each beside a matched baseline on identical rows and folds. Everything in it is descriptive.

A fresh ban pool. Under protocol v2 (five templates by 20 samples per task), the banned share was 0.15 on the grid task (Wilson [0.09, 0.23]) and 0.13 on the shortest path task ([0.08, 0.21]); both events pass the gate. On the grid task the fourth template gave BFS 15 of 20 times and every other template 0 of 20, the third independent draw in which that one template fails (Sections 2.5 and 2.6).

The SAE transfer test failed. The sparse autoencoders used were Qwen-Scope's, trained on Qwen3-8B-Base and covering all 36 layers [50] (64K latents, top-k activation with $k = 50$ [51]). Before using them on the instruct model, the experiment spliced their reconstructions into the residual stream at layers 15, 20 and 27 and compared the increase in cross-entropy over 200 instruct model sequences with the increase on the base model; the preregistered bar was a ratio of at most 1.5. It failed at all three layers (Table 74). Reconstruction error was similar in the two models, but the instruct model's clean cross-entropy on its own code is far lower (0.030 against 0.260 nats), so the same error costs more. Every latent result below is labelled as computed on out-of-distribution activations, and the difference-in-means baselines lead.

Table 74. SAE transfer test: increase in cross-entropy when SAE reconstructions are spliced in (source: `results/transfer_summary.json`; ratio intervals 95%).

Layer	Increase, instruct	Increase, base	Ratio [95% CI]	Pass (ratio at most 1.5)	Relative MSE instruct / base	Fraction of variance unexplained instruct / base	Cosine instruct / base
15	0.173	0.053	3.29 [3.14, 3.45]	no	0.196 / 0.165	0.366 / 0.288	0.896 / 0.914
20	0.150	0.077	1.95 [1.84, 2.06]	no	0.230 / 0.203	0.094 / 0.243	0.877 / 0.893
27	0.097	0.061	1.59 [1.50, 1.67]	no	0.229 / 0.197	0.153 / 0.325	0.877 / 0.896

Readouts of the algorithm written. On the forking token experiment's saved states, with nested selection that holds out one paraphrase at a time, 200 within paraphrase permutations and a maximum statistic null, the shortest path contrast (Dijkstra against Bellman-Ford/SPFA, same prompts) is decodable at the token before the commit token and at token 16 by every method, with within paraphrase held-out AUC 0.67 to 0.86 and permutation p at most 0.025 (Table 75). The grid

contrast (BFS against DFS) is not decodable within paraphrase at the commitment point: most p values exceed 0.05, no latent passes the maximum statistic null, and only 57 within paraphrase pairs exist. SAE latents never beat the difference-in-means direction or the top raw dimensions by a margin outside the intervals, which matches AxBench [34] and the MIB benchmark [52]. The positive control was weak (within paraphrase AUC at the token after the commit token peaks at 0.75 on the grid task and 0.79 on the shortest path task), because the commit token is the `deque` import for most programs of both classes (DFS 55 of 78, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 78 of 80), so the state at the commit token is the state at the first lexicon match, not at the algorithm decision. The read position, identical within a paraphrase, gave within paraphrase AUC of 0.37 to 0.62, as it must.

Table 75. Within paraphrase held-out AUC of each readout of the algorithm written (permutation p in brackets; source: `results/readout_i_discovery.json`). DiM is the difference-in-means direction on raw states.

Task, layer, position	Top-1 SAE latent	Top-20 SAE latents (logistic)	DiM	Raw logistic probe	Top-1 neuron	Top-20 neurons (logistic)	DiM on SAE codes
Grid, 15, before commit	0.482 (0.881)	0.588 (0.234)	0.614 (0.199)	0.596 (0.184)	0.535 (0.388)	0.570 (0.343)	0.596 (0.249)
Grid, 15, token 16	0.640 (0.114)	0.693 (0.040)	0.544 (0.308)	0.649 (0.114)	0.588 (0.149)	0.518 (0.483)	0.649 (0.075)
Grid, 20, before commit	0.570 (0.284)	0.649 (0.124)	0.719 (0.025)	0.544 (0.378)	0.640 (0.060)	0.649 (0.080)	0.535 (0.388)
Grid, 20, token 16	0.640 (0.065)	0.675 (0.030)	0.456 (0.682)	0.667 (0.060)	0.658 (0.100)	0.491 (0.527)	0.518 (0.448)
Grid, 27, before commit	0.535 (0.308)	0.649 (0.090)	0.614 (0.179)	0.526 (0.378)	0.535 (0.284)	0.579 (0.244)	0.711 (0.020)
Grid, 27, token 16	0.640 (0.124)	0.588 (0.279)	0.684 (0.065)	0.579 (0.294)	0.675 (0.070)	0.596 (0.229)	0.684 (0.075)
Shortest path, 15, before commit	0.761 (0.005)	0.676 (0.015)	0.768 (0.005)	0.778 (0.005)	0.782 (0.005)	0.771 (0.005)	0.757 (0.005)
Shortest path, 15, forking token	0.613 (0.030)	0.634 (0.025)	0.553 (0.229)	0.609 (0.144)	0.581 (0.119)	0.683 (0.010)	0.630 (0.020)
Shortest path, 15, token 16	0.856 (0.005)	0.845 (0.005)	0.856 (0.005)	0.852 (0.005)	0.863 (0.005)	0.856 (0.005)	0.838 (0.005)
Shortest path, 20, before commit	0.732 (0.005)	0.665 (0.025)	0.736 (0.005)	0.792 (0.005)	0.810 (0.005)	0.746 (0.005)	0.708 (0.005)
Shortest path, 20, forking token	0.697 (0.005)	0.616 (0.095)	0.606 (0.104)	0.581 (0.139)	0.581 (0.169)	0.570 (0.219)	0.708 (0.005)
Shortest path, 20, token 16	0.863 (0.005)	0.845 (0.005)	0.810 (0.005)	0.817 (0.005)	0.835 (0.005)	0.845 (0.005)	0.856 (0.005)
Shortest path, 27, before commit	0.789 (0.005)	0.725 (0.005)	0.764 (0.005)	0.694 (0.005)	0.711 (0.005)	0.789 (0.005)	0.764 (0.005)
Shortest path, 27, forking token	0.574 (0.095)	0.560 (0.249)	0.641 (0.025)	0.694 (0.020)	0.623 (0.060)	0.697 (0.005)	0.676 (0.005)
Shortest path, 27, token 16	0.856 (0.005)	0.803 (0.005)	0.810 (0.005)	0.838 (0.005)	0.827 (0.005)	0.806 (0.005)	0.824 (0.005)

Applied without refitting to the fresh pool's states at the token before the commit token, the difference-in-means direction transferred best. On the grid task its within template AUC was 0.93, 0.97 and 1.00 at layers 15, 20 and 27, but only the fourth template produced both classes (15 BFS against 5 DFS, 75 pairs); the single top latent reached 0.27, 0.80 and 0.52. On the shortest path task the difference-in-means direction reached 0.66, 0.66 and 0.76 and the top-20-latent probe 0.65, 0.66 and 0.77. The top-20 latent lists overlapped above chance on the grid task (8 shared against 1.8 expected at layer 15) and at chance on the shortest path task, and shuffled labels gave AUC about 0.50.

Attention to the ban. The same three heads carry ban specific attention on both tasks: layer 21 head 17, layer 26 head 21 and layer 26 head 25. From the query at the token before the commit token, head 21.17 sends 0.207 (grid) and 0.098 (shortest path) more of its attention mass to the ban segment than to the neutral segment of the token matched twin, concentrated on the banned name's tokens (`breadth`, `-first`, `ijkstra`). On the grid task, runs that complied put more top head attention on the ban than runs that did not (0.135 against 0.105, within template permutation $p = 0.0025$); all noncompliant runs came from the fourth template, so this is a contrast within that template. The shortest path task shows no difference ($p = 0.96$). Attention weights are not a causal test, and the route experiment found the generated tokens' direct reads of the ban to matter only on the grid task.

Prime and veto in the latents. The preregistered pattern in which a forbidden concept is first activated so that it can be suppressed [53] appeared in none of the six task by layer configurations. The latents that fire on the banned algorithm's name were silent at the read position. At layer 27, both the name latents and the implementation latents of X were lower at the token before the commit token under the ban than under both twins for the same text (grid implementation latents 124 against 169 under the neutral twin; name latents 94 against 129 under the mention twin; implementation, ban against neutral, sign test $p = 2e\text{-}24$). The difference-in-means projection agreed in sign in only 2 of the 6 configurations, so most latent results here are flagged as not reproduced by the baseline.

Thought anchors. With thinking on and an 8,192-token cap, ten first template ban traces were sampled (five per task), and four traces per task were resampled at nine sentence boundaries with six continuations each (432 continuations), following the thought anchors method [54]. Grid traces think for 8.4k to 9.3k tokens and none completed within the cap, though 4 of 5 still emitted DFS code. In 4 of 4 resampled grid traces DFS was fixed at the first resample point (every continuation DFS from the first boundary on) and no anchor sentence exists; the traces open by restating the ban and proposing DFS within their first four sentences. Shortest path traces completed in 2.5k to 3.7k tokens (5 of 5) and showed one anchor among 32 sentences, a problem restatement. The early label detector was valid on 13 of 16 checks (0.81).

The same seed test of temperature. The request asked whether, with the seed held fixed, raising the temperature changes the idea or only the phrasing. Thirty seeds were run at T in {0.3, 0.7, 1.0, 1.3} with top-k = 10, for the baseline and the first template ban on both tasks (480 rows), coupling samples by inverse CDF sampling over the sorted top 10 tokens with one uniform stream per seed shared across temperatures. Under this coupling the idea never moved: the label changed against $T = 0.3$ in 0 of 30 seeds in 10 of 12 cells and in 1 of 30 in the other two, for same seed and different seed pairs alike (Table 76). With no idea level variation left, the same seed and different seed agreement on ideas is identical. Phrasing (identifier normalised AST 4-gram Jaccard below 0.8) changed less within a seed than across seeds, and the first token where a program diverged from its $T = 0.3$ twin fell at a median of 13 to 117 tokens. vLLM reproduced 5 of 8 rows byte for

byte when rerun.

Table 76. Same seed temperature test: rate of change against T = 0.3 for the same seed and for different seeds (30 seeds per cell; phrasing at Jaccard threshold 0.8; source: `results/same_seed.json`).

Task	Condition	T	Idea change, same seed	Idea change, different seeds	Phrasing change, same seed	Phrasing change, different seeds	Median divergence token	Identical to T = 0.3
Grid	baseline (all BFS)	0.7	0/30	0.0	0.60	0.84	23	7
Grid	baseline	1.0	0/30	0.0	0.77	0.86	23	4
Grid	baseline	1.3	0/30	0.0	0.83	0.90	21	3
Grid	ban (all DFS)	0.7	0/30	0.0	0.87	0.94	27	3
Grid	ban	1.0	0/30	0.0	0.93	0.97	13	1
Grid	ban	1.3	0/30	0.0	1.00	1.00	13	0
Shortest path	baseline (all Dijkstra)	0.7	0/30	0.0	0.07	0.06	117	21
Shortest path	baseline	1.0	0/30	0.0	0.13	0.12	91	13
Shortest path	baseline	1.3	0/30	0.0	0.10	0.16	28	7
Shortest path	ban (Bellman-Ford/SPFA)	0.7	0/30	0.0	0.53	0.63	74	5
Shortest path	ban	1.0	1/30	0.033	0.59	0.68	28.5	2
Shortest path	ban	1.3	1/30	0.033	0.55	0.76	25	1

Across the four temperatures, each grid baseline seed produced 1.0 distinct idea and 2.37 phrasing clusters on average (3.17 under the ban), and each shortest path seed 1.0 idea and 1.13 phrasing clusters (1.03 ideas and 2.17 clusters under the ban). Under the ban the grid pass rate per temperature was 0.23, 0.57, 0.43 and 0.43: every program was DFS.

Lenses: NLA and the Jacobian lens. A dated search in this experiment resolved the two unmapped terms of the request. NLA denotes natural language autoencoders, an activation verbalizer and reconstructor trained jointly with reinforcement learning; released checkpoints cover Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct, two Gemma-3 models and Llama-3.3-70B-Instruct but not Qwen3-8B as of 2026-10-20, and training one is far outside a 16 GB budget, so NLA was not run. We refer to the request's j lens as the Jacobian lens, which reads the state of a layer through the unembedding after multiplying it by the mean Jacobian of the final state with respect to that layer. A community Jacobian lens for Qwen3-8B exists and was gated against the logit lens on 2,000 positions: its top-1 agreement with the model's own next token was below the logit lens at every source layer (layer 27: 0.104 against 0.291), so it failed and its readouts are descriptive only.

Checks and cost. The labeller recheck gave 0.965 on 141 gold programs. An independent script rederived 69 headline numbers with no mismatch. Not run: a same seed arm with thinking on, a Gumbel coupling sensitivity, NLA, an adaptive top up and OpenRouter descriptions of latents. Cost: about 1.05 GPU hours and USD 0.04 (112 judge calls).

2.10 Comparisons across this iteration's experiments

The same modal ban, three draws under fixed wording. Three experiments sampled the modal bans with the five frozen templates and 20 samples each in Qwen3-8B. With the wording fixed, the variation that iteration 1 saw across draws (banned shares from 0.09 to 0.72) disappears: the grid banned share was 0.14, 0.14 and 0.15 and the shortest path banned share 0.11, 0.16 and 0.13 (Table 77). What remains is concentrated in one template. On the grid task every surviving BFS program in all three draws came from the fourth template (`X is not allowed here`, with BFS as X), which produced BFS 43 times in 60 against 0 in 240 for the other four templates. On the shortest path task the third and fourth templates carry most of the failures (15 and 18 of 60, against 1 to 4 for the others). Every attempted grid program not banned in the three draws was DFS (257 of 257), and 255 of 260 on the shortest path task were Bellman-Ford/SPFA (5 other labels). Compliance is a property of the wording, and here of one wording in particular.

Table 77. Banned programs per template (of 20) under the modal ban in the three protocol v2 draws of Qwen3-8B (sources: route experiment `results/analysis.json#behaviour`, ban list experiment `results/landing.json`, readout experiment `results/fresh_pool_summary.json`).

Task	Draw	First template	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth	Banned share	Programs not banned	Pass rate
Grid	route experiment, arm a	0	0	0	14	0	0.14	DFS 86	0.41
Grid	ban list experiment, single ban	0	0	0	14	0	0.14	DFS 86	0.41
Grid	readout experiment, fresh pool	0	0	0	15	0	0.15	DFS 85	0.34
Shortest path	route experiment, arm a	1	0	4	5	1	0.11	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 86, other 3	0.91
Shortest path	ban list experiment, single ban	2	1	6	7	0	0.16	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 83, other 1	0.95
Shortest path	readout experiment, fresh pool	1	0	5	6	1	0.13	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 86, other 1	0.96

The substitution test in two models. Neither model gave a robust branch (Table 78). In Qwen3-8B the pooled X specific share sits near 0.55 to 0.66 with intervals that straddle 0.5, and only the unscrubbed programs, which pass the validity gate, place the interval above 0.5. In Llama the point estimate is higher (0.80) but its interval is wider and the post hoc noise analysis shows the importance sampling noise has not been removed. Three things replicate across the families: the gains are far from pure subtraction, the X specific residual is not aimed at the prime and veto profile in either model, and the generic perturbations do not form a coherent ladder in either (mean cosines 0.34 and -0.02 in Qwen3-8B, 0.14 in Llama).

Table 78. X specific share in the two models (sources: likelihood screen `results/c1.json`, `results/sensitivity.json`; Llama replication `results/c1.json`).

Model	Reference	Scope	X specific share	95% CI	Branch

Qwen3-8B	neutral twin	grid	0.63	[0.28, 0.83]	undetermined
Qwen3-8B	neutral twin	shortest path	0.41	[0.10, 0.61]	undetermined
Qwen3-8B	neutral twin	pooled	0.55	[0.25, 0.67]	undetermined
Qwen3-8B	mention twin	grid	0.66	[0.51, 0.98]	X specific, unaimed
Qwen3-8B	mention twin	shortest path	0.65	[0.26, 0.79]	undetermined
Qwen3-8B	mention twin	pooled	0.66	[0.49, 0.87]	undetermined
Qwen3-8B	neutral twin, unscrubbed programs, first template	pooled	0.69	[0.51, 0.84]	X specific, unaimed
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	neutral twin	grid	0.80	[0.28, 0.94]	not resolved at this N
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	mention twin	grid	0.78	[0.61, 0.91]	X specific, unaimed

[Figure fig_c1share: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Priming and the route agree across models. A ban of an algorithm the model does not write raises that algorithm's likelihood in 8 of 9 cases in Qwen3-8B (+2.5 to +26.9 nats) and 5 of 6 in Llama (+1.8 to +7.6), and in both models the bans that lower their own label are those of algorithms the model does write, plus A*. The likelihood drop of the banned default travels by the prompt route in both models: F_prompt 0.85 [0.61, 1.20] in Qwen3-8B and 0.84 [0.62, 1.46] in Llama, with the direct route near zero (0.00 and -0.21). Only the Qwen3-8B grid behaviour shows a second, direct component. *(Correction, iteration 3: both numbers are the likelihood readout, which on the grid task is dominated by the opening fork (ESS 1 to 3 of 30), and in Llama it is the only readout, on an instrument that failed its gate there. The route is restated per task and per readout in Section 3.1, and on the bench the behavioural route is task dependent, with a pooled direct share of 0.74; Section 3.6.)*

2.11 What iteration 2 established, what it ruled out, and what it abandoned

Everything below is still descriptive: two screen tasks, two models, one modal ban event per task and model for the route test, and a likelihood instrument whose validity gate failed in both models in its preregistered (name scrubbed) form.

Established.

1. *The iteration-1 record, corrected.* On the shortest path task the ban's substitute is Bellman-Ford/SPFA in five of five draws (272 of 272 compliant programs, Wilson [0.986, 1.000]); on the grid task DFS is the realised mode in four of five draws (116 of 128, [0.843, 0.946]), with no clear mode in the HF engine geometry draw. Under fixed wording three new Qwen3-8B draws landed on DFS (257 of 257 programs not banned) and Bellman-Ford/SPFA (255 of 260). The cumulative BFS and DFS ban does not replicate. Under one statistic, no ban and no diversity knob reaches a second correct algorithm (rarefied Hill-1 of at least 2) for less than 20 pass points on either task; the semantic seed on the shortest path task comes closest (1.935 at 7 points). On gated events, no forecasting family can advance (three informative events, largest margin 0.05 nats).

2. *The generic perturbation rival holds on the shortest path task and fails on the grid task.* Every nonsemantic perturbation that left Dijkstra (8 of 8 rows) landed mostly on Bellman-Ford/SPFA, random directions included; on the grid task no nonsemantic perturbation left BFS among correct programs *(corrected in iteration 3: one did, barely; temperature 1.3 with top-k = 10 gave DFS in 1 of 95 correct programs)*, while every ban reached DFS. On the shortest path task a ban and an arbitrary push end in the same place.
3. *The ban acts through the prompt states, before the first generated token.* In cache patching the prompt route carried 0.85 [0.61, 1.20] of the banned algorithm's likelihood drop and the direct route 0.00 [-0.08, 0.12], with the task specification states, not the read position alone, carrying it. The mechanism is an opening line veto: under the grid ban 0 of 100 programs open with the default's import line against 99 of 100 under the neutral twin, and the prompt route arm reproduces this exactly. On the shortest path task behaviour follows the prompt route completely; on the grid task generated tokens also read the ban directly (hiding the ban from them restores BFS to 0.47). Llama's likelihood readout agrees (F_prompt 0.84). *(Correction, iteration 3: the heading and first sentence state the route more strongly than its evidence. Per task and per readout: on the shortest path task the prompt route carries the ban in likelihood (0.82) and in behaviour (0.98 [0.89, 1.07], direct 0.05 [0.01, 0.09]); on the grid task the likelihood readout is dominated by the opening fork (0.87), behaviour is mixed (prompt 0.50 [0.39, 0.62], direct 0.35 [0.25, 0.45]) and the natural proposal readout puts the direct route at 0.16 [0.11, 0.21], an interval that excludes 0; Llama has the likelihood readout only (0.84 [0.62, 1.46]). The direct route is not zero. Splicing the read position alone carries none of the effect (F_R about 0).)*
4. *The read position knows, in part, how hard a wording will be obeyed, and not what replaces X.* Across 110 wordings the projection on a shared ban direction correlates with the banned share at -0.41 [-0.69, -0.17] ($p = 0.0003$), short of the -0.5 bar; the substitute is not decodable beyond that projection. *(Added in iteration 3: splicing the read position alone carries none of the ban's effect (F_R about 0), so this site is decodable but causally inert; a causal test of a shared prohibition direction at the task specification positions was run in iteration 3 and failed, Section 3.7.)*
5. *Naming primes.* A ban of an absent algorithm raises that algorithm's likelihood in both models (8 of 9 and 5 of 6), and the mention twin raises it more. The iteration-1 sham promotions are reproduced by the shared (ladder) component of the gains and are not X specific.
6. *Ban lists fail by reimplementation.* Every four or five name grid ban failed (avoidance 0.00 to 0.37); the model wrote BFS and DFS in the same mix whatever the list contained (BFS share 0.63 to 0.72, chi squared $p = 0.48$), disguising 41% to 92% of the banned programs. On the shortest path task the model will not write bidirectional Dijkstra, Floyd-Warshall or Dial even when each is the only algorithm allowed, though it can write Floyd-Warshall and Dial when told to *(qualified in iteration 3: forced Floyd-Warshall is labelled as requested and correct 40 of 40 times, but forced Dial, from the descriptive prompt, is labelled as requested 36 of 40 times and passes only 7 of 40, so only Floyd-Warshall is written cleanly on request)*.
7. *No decision locus among the saved states.* On the grid task the within one ban signal is fixed per paraphrase; on the shortest path task the first state that beats the read position by 20 points is a readout of text already written (`import heapq` against `from collections import deque`, decided at generated token 3). The forking token, the opening line veto and the locus probe all point at the first three generated tokens, which no artifact has saved.
8. *Temperature does not change the algorithm even for a fixed seed.* With seeds coupled across temperatures, the algorithm changed in 0 of 30 seeds in 10 of 12 cells and 1 of 30 in the

other two, while phrasing changed in 7% to 100% of seeds depending on task and temperature, and less within a seed than across seeds.

9. *Qwen3-8B is collapsed on 13 new tasks as well.* The pilot found a modal share of 1.00 on 12 tasks and 0.98 on one; Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct is more diverse on the same tasks *(qualified in iteration 3: in attempted programs; counted over correct programs and rarefied to 10, Llama is more diverse on 9 of 13 tasks, but much of its attempted diversity is failing code, Section 3.2.4)*. The confirmation bench is frozen (12 tasks, labellers gated) with no ban prompt run on it.

Ruled out, or not supported.

- *Geodesic proximity on the read position manifold as the predictor of the shortest path substitute.* Floyd-Warshall is the nearest survivor to Dijkstra in 100% of paraphrase subsamples at every layer and k tested, Bellman-Ford/SPFA is never nearest, and no ban landed on Floyd-Warshall. On the grid task proximity and typicality coincide and cannot be separated.
- *An aimed substitution.* In neither model is the X specific part of the ban gains aimed at the prime and veto profile (Qwen3-8B -0.10, $p = 0.80$; Llama 0.067, $p = 0.35$) or at the stated alternative. *(Correction, iteration 3: not detectable with the current instrument, rather than ruled out; Section 3.2.1.)*
- *A coherent latent ladder.* The generic perturbation profiles do not agree with each other in either model, so the rival in its preregistered form, a fixed ordering any perturbation reveals, was not found either. *(Correction, iteration 3: this item belongs among the effects that an uncalibrated instrument could not detect, not among the accounts ruled out, and it conflicts with item 2 above. Reconciled: behaviour shows a shared top rung on the shortest path task, where 8 of 8 nonsemantic perturbations that left Dijkstra landed mostly on Bellman-Ford/SPFA, and on the grid task only bans reach DFS. The order of the survivors below the top rung is unmeasured: it is unobservable in behaviour under the collapse, and the likelihood cosines that this item rests on come mostly from survivors with an ESS near 1.)*

(Added in iteration 3: the iteration-2 preregistered predictions and their outcomes, and the outcome of the iteration-2 forecast contest of the four frozen families (NOT RUN on any new event), are listed in Section 3.1.)

- *A veto at the signature token.* The lens found no layer at which the ban lowers the banned algorithm at the commitment token, because the fork is at the first token; the signature tokens carry 2.4% and 11.6% of the likelihood drop.
- *Activation of a forbidden concept in order to suppress it.* The prime and veto latent pattern appeared in 0 of 6 configurations; the name latents of X were lower under the ban than under both twins.

Dead ends, with the evidence that closed them.

- *The likelihood instrument on name scrubbed programs as a calibrated probability.* It failed calibration in Qwen3-8B (default share 0.83, DFS mass under a baseline that never samples DFS) and in Llama (implied BFS 0.43 against sampled 0.77), with effective sample sizes mostly below 5 in every experiment that used it (98% of gate cells, 858 of 1,095 route cells, 97% of ban list cells, 76% of Llama cells). Unscrubbed programs pass the Qwen3-8B gate (calibration 0.95 and 1.00, 1.18 nats, 17 of 19), so the scrubbing, not the instrument, is the closed part.
- *Extending the grid catalogue toward ten algorithms.* Only five of ten algorithms passed the keep

rule; the model writes A* as unit weight Dijkstra, unit weight Dijkstra as BFS, and jump point search and bidirectional A* as BFS and A*.

- *The literal top five landing test as a test of edge against opposite side.* The model does not comply with a five name ban (avoidance 0.00), so no survivor mass exists to place on either side; the question is answered behaviourally (reimplementation of the defaults) rather than geometrically.
- *Qwen-Scope base model SAEs on the instruct model.* The spliced in cross-entropy ratio was 3.29, 1.95 and 1.59 at layers 15, 20 and 27 against a 1.5 bar; latents never beat the difference-in-means direction.
- *The community Jacobian lens for Qwen3-8B.* Its next token agreement was below the logit lens at every layer (0.104 against 0.291 at layer 27).
- *NLA.* No natural language autoencoder exists for Qwen3-8B as of 2026-10-20.
- *A presence piloted present minor stratum for Qwen3-8B.* All 13 bench tasks are fully collapsed in the pilot, so present minor bans and a sampled typicality forecast do not exist for this model on this bench.
- *The free-form association answer as evidence about mechanism.* It predicts the substitute, but simulation of its own behaviour explains that success under either branch of the substitution test.

2.12 What the next iteration takes from this one

The title claim is still open, and the reason has changed. Iteration 1 could not separate substitution from a latent ladder because its events were too few and its typicality forecast was degenerate. This iteration measured every single ban in two models with a likelihood instrument and found neither account clean: the gains are not pure subtraction, they are not a coherent ladder, and their X specific part is not aimed where association or prime and veto predict. *(Correction, iteration 3: none of these three is detectable with the current instrument; Section 3.2.1.)* The confirmation bench exists to settle the share with task level clusters. Its inputs are now fixed, and so are its limits. Qwen3-8B is collapsed on all 12 frozen tasks, so its confirmation must use likelihood matrices on unscrubbed programs, which the gate supports, plus modal bans; Llama supplies sampled present minor bans. The ban, mention, neutral and nonce matrices, the Llama forced programs and every sampled ban event on the bench remain to be run, with forecasts hash committed first.

The route result redirects the mechanistic work. A ban is applied by the prompt states as a veto on the default's first line, and on the grid task also by direct reads during generation. The next measurements are therefore at generated tokens 1 to 3, the states no artifact has saved: a decoder and an activation patch there would locate the decision the locus probe could not find, and would say whether the opening line veto is the whole of the algorithm choice on the shortest path task. On the grid task the direct component needs its own localisation (which layers and which tokens read the ban after `def solve`), since the three attention heads that attend to the banned name are a descriptive lead, not a causal one. The template effect must enter every analysis as a random effect; one wording, the fourth template (`X is not allowed here`), accounts for every grid failure in three draws.

Request items still open after this iteration: the activation space manifold plots with centroids coloured by implemented count at a validated locus (no locus validated yet; *corrected in iteration 3: the plots themselves exist, 13 Isomap figures drawn by the ban list experiment at layer 24 and the token before the commit token, Section 3.2.2, but not at a validated locus*), a working SAE readout (the

transfer test failed; a short fine-tuning on instruct activations, or a dictionary trained on them, is the alternative), and a same seed arm with thinking on. The top five prohibition, natural BFS against DFS internals, thought anchors, the same seed test, the logit and tuned lens, and the mapping of NLA and the Jacobian lens were run here. *(Added in iteration 3: the readout experiment did not save generated tokens 1 to 3 because the artifacts of one iteration run in parallel, and its plan was frozen before the audit named those positions; its states stop at the token before the commit token and token 16.)*

Iteration 3: ban-free forecasts on the bench, the route of a ban across twelve tasks, and how far any knob reaches

3.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The review of the iteration-2 record. The review raised nine major and three minor items. Five concerned evidence the record held but read too strongly. The likelihood substitution test could not settle where a ban sends the mass: on the only rows with known behaviour, its algorithm specific residual pointed away from the substitute the model actually wrote, and its noise correction was never checked on Qwen3-8B. The record also carried two verdicts on the rival account that contradicted each other (a shared second choice on the shortest path task, and the absence of a coherent ladder listed among the accounts ruled out). The closing summary stated that the direct route carried none of the ban, although two of the three readouts in the same artifact showed a direct route. The cross-model contrast rested on failing programs: Llama's correct grid programs were all BFS. The knob verdict was paraphrased past its own metric. Four items concerned work that existed but was missing from the record: the ban list experiment's 13 manifold figures with centroids coloured by implemented count, the out-of-catalogue programs that no one had inspected, positioning rows for the iteration-2 claims, and a statement that the forecast contest of the four frozen families had never been run. The remaining items were the preregistered predictions and their outcomes, the inherited bench instrument, and five factual slips. The corrections are made in place in Sections 1.12 and 2.3 to 2.12, each marked; Table 80 maps every item to where it is answered.

The hypothesis update. The update flipped the predicted branch to the side the evidence leaned toward and moved the decision from likelihood cells to sampled programs. Its title claim is that a prompt prohibition removes the named default and does not choose the replacement: the mass that leaves the default lands on what we call the *next rung*, the survivor that the model's own distribution puts next once the default is gone. The rival is substitution specific to X, under which the landing follows the model's stated alternative to X (association) or the survivor whose programs look most like X's (proximity). Under total collapse the next rung cannot be read from sampled frequencies, so the update introduced ban-free counterfactuals that expose it without any ban text.

- We call the *signature veto* a decoding-time mask on the default's distinctive token n-gram: the shortest n-gram (up to 6 tokens) present in at least 80% of the default's baseline programs that minimises its largest share in the other algorithms' forced programs. The one-shot form masks the completing token the first time it comes up; the persistent form masks it at every occurrence; the iterated form adds the n-grams of re-emerged default programs for up to three rounds. We call the landing of the last veto round that leaves at least 20 attempts off the default the *subtraction forecast* of the event.
- We call the nonce ban, the novelty instruction and three random directions added at the task

specification positions at the ban's own displacement norm generic pushes, and the pooled landing of the generic pushes that move at least 20 attempts off the default the *ladder forecast*.

- We call the model's frozen free-form answer when asked for the standard alternative to X the *association forecast*, and the survivor whose forced programs are nearest to the default's by tree edit distance on identifier-normalised syntax trees [64] the *proximity forecast*.
- We call an *exposure ban* a prompt that shows a correct program of a non-default algorithm Y and then asks for a correct solution that does not use Y. Showing Y makes the model copy it, so Y becomes the default to ban, and association and ladder disagree wherever Y's stated alternative is not the model's context-free default.

The update also added a causal test of what we call the shared prohibition direction, the mean displacement that the bans of the other tasks cause at the task specification positions (Section 3.7 gives its construction), a locus probe at generated tokens 1 to 8, the request's top-five prohibition asked again as a cumulative token veto, and the request's own long-form novelty instruction, an instruction to invent an algorithm that asks for a design rationale of about 2,000 words before the code. The event gate stayed as in Section 2.2 (avoidance at least 0.5 and at least 20 attempts not banned). The frozen contest rule names its outcomes, and we call these outcomes branches, written as the rule prints them: SUBTRACTION/LADDER when a ban-free family (subtraction or ladder) advances, followed by the family that advanced; SUBSTITUTION when association or proximity advances; NO FAMILY ADVANCES when none does, which we call aimed but unresolved when some family's top-1 still names the landing more often than chance; and, when no family's top-1 beats chance, the branch we call X specific but unaimed, the name Section 2.2 gave the same outcome. In the n-gram code spans of this section, ␣ marks a space and \n a newline. The likelihood instrument was demoted to a descriptive forecast of mass. The two path search tasks became the screen, and the 12 frozen bench tasks in two models became the confirmation; the two are never pooled.

The iteration-2 preregistered predictions and their outcomes. These were not listed in the iteration-2 record; they are recorded here as the hypothesis update recorded them.

1. A gain for DFS under the BFS ban specific to X, larger than the ladder can match: failed. The largest residual of that row belongs to IDDFS ($+7.99$) and DFS's is $+0.83$.
2. The direct route at generation time carries at least two thirds of the ban: failed. The direct share was 0.00 in likelihood, 0.35 in grid behaviour and 0.05 in shortest path behaviour; the preregistered alternative, decided before writing, was met on the likelihood readout.
3. A compliance correlation at the read position of -0.5 or below: missed (-0.41 [-0.69, -0.17], $p = 0.0003$).
4. The validity gate of the likelihood instrument: failed in both models in its preregistered, name scrubbed form.
5. The locus rule: no position passed on the grid task, and the shortest path pass was a readout after commitment.
6. The positive knob target: not met.
7. The forecast contest of the four frozen families (ladder, association, prime and veto, proximity) under the preregistered rule: not run on any new event. Only the three gated iteration-1 events existed, with a largest margin of 0.05 nats, and the ban list landing forecasts were degenerate.

The route, restated per task and per readout. The closing summary of iteration 2 said the direct route carried none of the ban. Per readout, the record holds this. On the shortest path task the prompt route carries the ban in likelihood (0.82) and in behaviour (0.98 [0.89, 1.07], against a direct share of 0.05 [0.01, 0.09]). On the grid task the likelihood readout is dominated by the opening fork (0.87), while behaviour is mixed (prompt 0.50 [0.39, 0.62], direct 0.35 [0.25, 0.45]) and the natural proposal readout puts the direct route at 0.16 [0.11, 0.21]. Llama has the likelihood readout only (0.84 [0.62, 1.46]). Splicing the read position alone carries none of the effect (F_R about 0), even though the read position projection correlates with compliance across wordings. Decodable there is not actionable there [55].

The strategy. Seven artifacts ran (Table 79). One audit without generation repaired the record. Three experiments sampled the bench bans that decide the title claim, each committing its forecasts by sha256 hash before its own first ban sample, because artifacts of one iteration run in parallel and cannot share commitments: modal bans in Qwen3-8B [5], exposure bans in Qwen3-8B, and modal and present minor bans in Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22]. Three experiments asked where and how far: the behavioural route on the bench, the internal locus with the shared prohibition direction, and the reach of prompt bans and token vetoes with the novelty question. The budget went to sampled events rather than likelihood variants, as the review asked.

Table 79. The seven artifacts of iteration 3, the question each was asked, and its hardware and spend.

Artifact	Question	Model and hardware	OpenRouter spend
Record audit	Repair the iteration-2 record; likelihood diagnostics; manifold figures; novelty audit of every correct program outside the catalogue; correct-only Llama compositions; knob table with a class rule; positioning	No generation; CPU only	USD 0.42 (blind judges)
Bench forecast experiment	Do ban-free forecasts, sealed before the bans, predict where the 12 modal bench bans land in Qwen3-8B?	Qwen3-8B bf16; one RTX 4090, about 45 GPU minutes	USD 0.024
Exposure experiment	Shown a correct program of Y and told not to use Y, does the model go to Y's stated alternative or back to its default?	Qwen3-8B bf16; one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU, about 1.0 GPU hour	USD 0.096
Llama bench experiment	The same forecast contest in Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, with present minor bans and a path task screen	Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct bf16; one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU, 0.98 GPU hours of logged generation (about 1.8 hours held)	USD 0.48
Bench route experiment	Does a ban act through the prompt states or by generated tokens reading it, on the 12 bench tasks, in behaviour?	Qwen3-8B bf16 (HF); one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU, about 1.8 GPU hours	USD 0.105
Locus experiment	Is there a shared prohibition direction; is the algorithm decided at generated tokens 1 to 8; do the ban-attending heads matter; do the base model SAEs transfer under a fairer criterion?	Qwen3-8B with 8-bit floating point weight and activation linears (HF); one 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada GPU	USD 0.22
Reach experiment	How far do cumulative token vetoes and bans that leave one survivor push the model; does the request's long-form novelty instruction produce a correct novel algorithm?	Qwen3-8B bf16 (path tasks) and the official 8-bit floating point checkpoint (bench tasks); one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU	USD 0.49

Table 80. Review items on the iteration-2 record and where this report answers them.

Review item	What the review found	Where it is answered
Likelihood substitution test	Residuals point away from the realised substitute; tail cells dominate; noise correction unchecked on Qwen3-8B; impossible weighted share; mention aim omitted	Corrections in Sections 2.4, 2.11 and 2.12; Section 3.2.1
Two verdicts on the rival	A shared second choice in behaviour against a claimed absence of any coherent ladder	Correction in Section 2.11; Section 3.2.1; the bench tests in Sections 3.3 to 3.5
Missing manifold figures	13 Isomap figures with implemented counts existed; circle result overstated	Corrections in Sections 2.6 and 2.12; Section 3.2.2
Cross-model contrast on failing programs	Llama's correct grid programs are BFS 20 of 20	Corrections in Sections 2.7, 2.8 and 2.11; Section 3.2.4
Samples, not variants; forecast contest outcome	The contest of the four frozen families never ran; budget arithmetic missing	Section 3.1 (outcome NOT RUN); Section 3.2.1 (arithmetic); Sections 3.3 to 3.5 (sampled bench events)
Positioning of iteration-2 claims	No neighbour rows for compliance at the read position, the route, priming, ban lists or SAE transfer	Section 3.2.6
Route stated too strongly	A direct route of zero claimed against two readouts with a direct route	Corrections in Sections 2.10 and 2.11; this section; Section 3.6
Novelty never inspected	About 25 correct programs outside the catalogue unread; the request's 2,000-word novelty instruction never run	Section 3.2.3; Section 3.8
Knob verdict past its metric	A 2:1 split cannot reach Hill-1 of 2; class rule undeclared	Correction in Section 2.3.6; Section 3.2.5
Minor: preregistered predictions; tokens 1 to 3	Failed targets not listed; why the states were not saved	This section; correction in Section 2.12
Minor: bench instrument	8-bit prompt log probabilities; unscrubbed variant unvalidated on ban rows	Correction in Section 2.8; Section 3.3 (fp32 rescoring)
Minor: five factual slips	Table 66 prompt labels; DFS 1 at T = 1.3; forced Dial; TOP residue; an unmarked insertion in Section 1.12	Corrections in Sections 1.12, 2.6 and 2.11

3.2 The record audit: likelihood diagnostics, manifold figures, novelty, correct-only Llama, knob classes

The record audit ran first and on CPU only. It read the iteration-1 and iteration-2 artifacts in place, generated nothing, and spent USD 0.42 on blind LLM judges for the novelty audit. Every number it produced names its source file. An independent script rederived 72 of 72 headline checks from the raw files, and all 7 placebo tests failed as they should.

3.2.1 The likelihood substitution test cannot decide where the mass goes

The review's central objection was that the substitution test of Section 2.4 rests on cells that are behaviourally irrelevant and close to unestimable. The audit tested this directly on every sampled single ban in both models: if the likelihood instrument measured where a ban sends the mass, the survivor with the largest gain should be the one the model writes. Table 81 gives every event.

Table 81. Every sampled single-ban event with likelihood cells: the realised landing and the argmax of three likelihood readouts (gain against the neutral twin, its algorithm specific residual after the ladder fit, and the implied probability mass under the ban). An argmax equal to the modal landing is marked as a hit. Source: record audit `tables/c1_argmax_vs_landing.csv`.

Model	Task	Draw	Banned	Kind	Attempted, not banned	Correct, not banned	Argmax of gain	Argmax of residual	Argmax of implied mass
Qwen3-8B	Grid	readout experiment, fresh pool	BFS	modal	DFS 85	DFS 28	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	readout experiment, fresh pool	Dijkstra	modal	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 86, other 1	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 83	Dial	Dial	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	A*	absent (sham)	BFS 100	BFS 72	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	BFS	modal	DFS 90	DFS 38	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	bidirectional BFS	absent (sham)	BFS 99, other 1	BFS 92	IDDFS	IDDFS	BFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	DFS	absent (sham)	BFS 96	BFS 86	IDDFS	IDDFS	BFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	unit weight Dijkstra	absent (sham)	BFS 92, DFS 8	BFS 69, DFS 2	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS
Qwen3-8B	Grid	association experiment	IDDFS	absent (sham)	BFS 88, DFS 12	BFS 76, DFS 4	bidirectional BFS	bidirectional BFS	DFS
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	association experiment	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 94, other 1	Dijkstra 92	Dial	Floyd-Warshall	Dijkstra (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	association experiment	bidirectional Dijkstra	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	Dijkstra 97, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 3	Dial	Dial	Dijkstra (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	association experiment	Dial	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 95, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	Dijkstra 95, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 2	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Dijkstra (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	association experiment	Dijkstra	modal	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 90, other 1	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 86	Dial	Dial	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	association experiment	Floyd-Warshall	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 77, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 23	Dijkstra 68, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 3	Dial	Dial	Dijkstra (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Grid	route experiment, full ban	BFS	modal	DFS 86	DFS 31	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	route experiment, full ban	Dijkstra	modal	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 86, other 3	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 80	Dial	Dial	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)

Qwen3-8B	Grid	ban list experiment, single ban	BFS	modal	DFS 86	DFS 30	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS (hit)
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	ban list experiment, single ban	Dijkstra	modal	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 83, other 1	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 79	Dial	Dial	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)
Llama-3.1-8B	Grid	Llama replication	BFS	modal	DFS 63, other 6, A* 1, unit weight Dijkstra 1	DFS 7, other 1	A*	A*	DFS (hit)
Llama-3.1-8B	Grid	Llama replication	DFS	absent (sham)	BFS 39, other 4	BFS 7	A*	A*	BFS (hit)
Llama-3.1-8B	Grid	Llama replication	unit weight Dijkstra	absent (sham)	BFS 30, DFS 18, other 1	BFS 12, DFS 1	A*	A*	DFS
Llama-3.1-8B	Shortest path	Llama replication	Dijkstra	modal	other 37, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 18, Floyd-Warshall 2	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 4, other 1	n/a (three algorithms)	n/a	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)
Llama-3.1-8B	Shortest path	Llama replication	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 33, other 14, Floyd-Warshall 1	Dijkstra 13	n/a	n/a	Dijkstra (hit)
Llama-3.1-8B	Shortest path	Llama replication	Floyd-Warshall	absent (sham)	Dijkstra 25, other 11, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9	Dijkstra 6, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 1	n/a	n/a	Dijkstra (hit)

The gains never point where the model writes (Table 82). Over the 17 Qwen3-8B events the argmax of the gain and the argmax of the residual hit the realised landing 0 times, against a chance rate of 0.22; under the BFS ban the largest residual is always IDDFS and under the Dijkstra ban always Dial. The implied mass, which weights each survivor by how much probability it has rather than by how much its log probability moved, hits 14 of 17, and 8 of 8 modal bans. The same split holds in Llama. A log gain of 18 nats on a survivor with negligible mass counts as much as the realised substitute's gain, and those tail cells are the ones with effective sample sizes near 1.

Table 82. Hit rate of each likelihood argmax on the realised landing (Wilson 95% intervals; chance is one over the number of survivors, averaged over events). Source: record audit `results/c1_diagnostics.json`.

Model	Events	Gain (neutral twin)	Residual (neutral twin)	Gain (mention twin)	Residual (mention twin)	Implied mass	Chance
Qwen3-8B, all single bans	17	0/17 [0.00, 0.18]	0/17 [0.00, 0.18]	1/17 [0.01, 0.27]	0/17 [0.00, 0.18]	14/17 [0.59, 0.94]	0.22
Qwen3-8B, modal bans	8	0/8 [0.00, 0.32]	0/8 [0.00, 0.32]	0/8	0/8	8/8 [0.68, 1.00]	0.23
Llama-3.1-8B, all single bans	6 (3 with gains)	0/3	0/3	2/3	0/3	5/6 [0.44, 0.97]	0.22
Pooled	23 (20 with gains)	0/20 [0.00, 0.16]	0/20 [0.00, 0.16]	3/20 [0.05, 0.36]	0/20 [0.00, 0.16]	19/23 [0.63, 0.93]	0.22

(Correction, iteration 4: Table 82 treats behavioural replicates as independent events. The 17 Qwen3-8B events are 11 distinct likelihood rows, and the 8 modal bans are 2 rows (the BFS and Dijkstra bans) each scored four times against identical cells, so 8 of 8 is 2 of 2. Per distinct row, the gain and the residual argmax hit 0 of 11 and the implied mass 8 of 11, and 6 of those 8 are bans of absent algorithms, where the landing is the default and the argmax is trivially right. The Wilson intervals computed over replicates are withdrawn; the per-row table is in Section 4.2.6.)

Restricting the test to estimable mass removes every row. The review asked for the test recomputed on survivors with at least 1% implied mass and an ESS of at least 5; the audit predicted before computing that few or no rows would survive, and none did (0 of 11 Qwen3-8B rows keep three such survivors). The substitution test is not decidable on estimable mass.

The noise correction was too small. Resampling templates and then programs within algorithm halves, the bootstrap variance of the mean gain is a median 2.68 times the replicate noise term that the frozen correction subtracted (range 1.22 to 4.26 over the 11 rows; 1.59 for a one stage bootstrap that resamples programs only). The Llama ratio was 4.8 to 11.3. Because the correction under-subtracts, both the F statistic behind the reading that the gains are not pure subtraction and the X specific share are inflated. The sums are also skewed upward, which the percentile intervals of Section 2.4 hid; basic intervals (twice the point estimate minus the bootstrap quantiles), which correct for that skew, are given in Table 83. The ladder term's basic interval crosses zero on both tasks.

Table 83. Qwen3-8B ladder and X specific sums of squares and the X specific share under the neutral twin reference: point estimate, bootstrap mean, and percentile and basic 95% intervals (2,000 two stage draws). Source: record audit `results/c1_diagnostics.json#intervals`.

Scope	Quantity	Point	Bootstrap mean	Percentile 95%	Basic 95%
Grid	V_u (ladder)	239.3	396.4	[135.4, 873.0]	[-394.4, 343.1]
Grid	V_s (X specific)	412.5	441.5	[207.0, 729.0]	[95.9, 617.9]
Grid	share	0.633	0.541	[0.270, 0.781]	[0.484, 0.995]
Shortest path	V_u	244.6	364.9	[146.5, 769.7]	[-280.4, 342.8]
Shortest path	V_s	173.1	162.4	[83.8, 267.2]	[79.1, 262.4]
Shortest path	share	0.414	0.335	[0.121, 0.592]	[0.237, 0.708]
Pooled	V_u	483.9	761.3	[363.7, 1426.3]	[-458.4, 604.1]
Pooled	V_s	585.6	603.9	[340.2, 908.3]	[262.9, 831.0]
Pooled	share	0.548	0.453	[0.252, 0.659]	[0.436, 0.843]

Two reported numbers were artefacts of construction. The aim under the mention twin reference is biased negative: the gain is the ban minus the mention cell and the prime and veto profile is the mention minus the neutral cell, so noise in the shared mention cell makes their correlation negative even when nothing is aimed. With equal cell variances the expected null correlation is -0.5; simulated under the split half design with the estimated variance components the null has mean -0.27 (SD 0.14, 5th to 95th percentile -0.49 to -0.04), and a placebo with an independent mention cell has mean 0.00. Llama's mention aim of -0.28 sits at the null's 66th percentile, so the bias explains it fully. Qwen3-8B's -0.595, omitted from Tables 56, 57 and 78, still lies below the null's 1st percentile (quantile 0.004). The ESS weighted grid share of 1.24 is impossible as a proportion: the noise corrected ladder term went negative (V_u = -35.4) when the weights shrank the ladder projection below its noise allowance, so V_s / (V_u + V_s) = 181.3 / 145.9.

What a decision on mass would cost. With Kish ESS approximately M / (1 + CV^2) for M proposal programs, the number of programs per algorithm needed for a median ESS of 5 is 5(1 +

CV^2). The plug-in estimate of CV^2 from 20 programs cannot exceed 19, so the plug-in M is bounded by 100 and is a lower bound; a lognormal fit to the log weights gives 5 exp(sigma^2), the upper end. Pooled over algorithms, the plug-in median is 50 programs, the lognormal median about 10^31.7, and 22% of the Pareto smoothed importance sampling shape estimates [66] exceed 0.7, the value above which an importance sampling estimate is not reliable. At the plug-in lower bound one bench event costs about 1.4 GPU hours of scoring. The spread of per-event shares (SD 0.41 in Qwen3-8B, 0.23 in Llama) means that separating the share from 0.5 by 0.10 needs about 129 Qwen3-8B events or 43 Llama events (32 and 11 for a margin of 0.20), against 11 and 6 rows measured. The decision therefore moved to sampled landings on the bench (Sections 3.3 to 3.5).

Table 84. Programs per algorithm needed for a median Kish ESS of 5, from the observed weight dispersion of the likelihood cells. Source: record audit `tables/m_arithmetic.csv`.

Model	Algorithm	Cells	Median ESS now (M = 20)	Median SD of log weights	Plug-in programs needed, median	Plug-in programs needed, 90th percentile	Lognormal programs needed, median
Qwen3-8B	A*	202	1.03	5.99	55.2	99.9	1.9e16
Qwen3-8B	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	165	1.82	18.55	40.1	82.1	1.2e150
Qwen3-8B	BFS	202	4.27	2.43	15.0	64.1	1813.9
Qwen3-8B	bidirectional BFS	202	1.00	29.50	100.0	100.0	5.1e304
Qwen3-8B	bidirectional Dijkstra	165	1.01	26.56	36.8	55.0	5.1e304
Qwen3-8B	DFS	202	1.12	7.81	50.0	98.7	1.4e27
Qwen3-8B	Dial	165	1.00	13.36	73.5	100.0	1.7e78
Qwen3-8B	Dijkstra and unit weight Dijkstra	367	1.86	5.75	32.6	96.7	1.2e15
Qwen3-8B	Floyd-Warshall	165	1.07	7.39	64.3	98.3	2.5e24
Qwen3-8B	IDDFS	202	1.00	12.81	79.7	100.0	8.5e71
Llama-3.1-8B	A*	120	2.51	3.03	35.3	84.6	4.9e4
Llama-3.1-8B	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	100	1.02	5.23	70.0	144.7	3.7e12
Llama-3.1-8B	BFS	120	8.61	1.18	9.6	39.7	20.0
Llama-3.1-8B	bidirectional BFS	120	1.33	4.39	28.1	50.5	1.2e9
Llama-3.1-8B	DFS	120	3.97	2.09	22.3	53.3	390.2
Llama-3.1-8B	Dijkstra and unit weight Dijkstra	220	3.37	2.45	28.9	59.3	2050.0
Llama-3.1-8B	Floyd-Warshall	100	1.34	7.05	60.6	114.9	1.9e22
Llama-3.1-8B	IDDFS	120	1.57	6.37	51.0	94.7	2.2e18

The ladder verdicts of Section 2.11 are reconciled as the review asked (correction in place there). We call a survivor that the ban and every generic perturbation reach a shared top rung. Behaviour shows a shared top rung on the shortest path task: Bellman-Ford/SPFA took 272 of 272 compliant programs in the five iteration-1 draws and 255 of 260 attempts not banned in the three iteration-2 draws, and 8 of 8 nonsemantic perturbations that left Dijkstra landed there. On the grid task only

bans reach DFS (116 of 128 compliant iteration-1 programs, 257 of 257 iteration-2 attempts not banned). The order below the top rung is unmeasured, and the latent ladder of Section 2.1 moves from the accounts ruled out to the effects that an uncalibrated instrument could not detect.

3.2.2 The ban list manifold figures

The ban list experiment had drawn 13 Isomap figures, not the 14 its summary claimed, plus two figures of neighbour stability over k. *(Added in iteration 4: four of these Isomaps, the grid baseline, the single BFS ban, the five-name ban and the shortest path ban that leaves only Bellman-Ford/SPFA, are now plotted from their centroid coordinates in Section 4.2.5, with the position caveat in the caption; the token-16 recomputation is tabulated there, because it yields neighbour orders rather than coordinates.)* Each figure embeds teacher forced states of forced programs at layer 24 and the token before the commit token (k = 10). Its centroids are sized and coloured by the number of programs implementing each algorithm under the condition, banned centroids are crossed out, and natural programs are overlaid. The audit recomputed the geometry from the saved states and reproduced the experiment's centroid matrix within 1e-7 and its nearest neighbour maps in 24 of 24 settings. Table 85 gives the implemented counts that the figures encode. Under the literal five name ban the counts stay on the banned BFS and DFS centroids (63 and 36 attempted, 53 and 15 correct).

Table 85. Implemented counts per centroid in the 13 manifold figures (attempted / correct; N = 100 per condition; banned algorithms marked †). Grid columns: BFS, DFS, bidirectional BFS, IDDFS, A*, greedy best first, IDA*, other. Shortest path columns: Dijkstra, Bellman-Ford/SPFA, bidirectional Dijkstra, Floyd-Warshall, Dial, other. Source: record audit `tables/manifold_implemented_counts.csv`.

Condition	Banned	Counts
Grid baseline	none	BFS 100/89; all others 0
Grid single ban	BFS	BFS† 14/11, DFS 86/30
Grid TOP	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS	BFS† 59/38, DFS† 26/0, greedy† 2/1, other 12/0, unit weight Dijkstra (outside the K = 7 catalogue) 1/1
Grid ARC	BFS, bidirectional BFS, A*, greedy	BFS† 63/40, DFS 37/20
Grid SCATTER	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDA*	BFS† 69/53, DFS† 27/18, A* 2/2, unit weight Dijkstra 2/2
Grid TOP5	BFS, DFS, greedy, IDDFS, A*	BFS† 63/53, DFS† 36/15, IDDFS† 1/0
Shortest path baseline	none	Dijkstra 100/100
Shortest path single ban	Dijkstra	Dijkstra† 16/16, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 83/79, other 1/0
Shortest path, only Dijkstra allowed	the other four	Dijkstra 95/95, Bellman-Ford/SPFA† 5/5
Shortest path, only Bellman-Ford/SPFA allowed	the other four	Dijkstra† 48/47, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 51/39, other 1/0
Shortest path, only bidirectional Dijkstra allowed	the other four	Dijkstra† 52/51, Bellman-Ford/SPFA† 48/36
Shortest path, only Floyd-Warshall allowed	the other four	Dijkstra† 59/59, Bellman-Ford/SPFA† 40/28, other 1/0
Shortest path, only Dial allowed	the other four	Dijkstra† 52/50, Bellman-Ford/SPFA† 44/28, other 4/0

The neighbourhood that the iteration-2 record reported (BFS next to bidirectional BFS, centroid distance 0.0147 against a within-BFS spread of 0.0154) does not survive at a position independent

of the label. At generated token 16, BFS and bidirectional BFS are still the nearest pair, but permuting the algorithm labels reproduces that identity with $p = 0.19$, and the two clouds are not separable (centroid distance 0.96 of the within-class spread; exchangeability test $p = 0.48$). Table 86 gives the nearest neighbour maps at layer 24 and $k = 10$ for both positions. Persistent homology found no loop at either position. At the token before the commit token a planted loop of matched size is detected with power 1.00 (grid) and 0.975 (shortest path), but that position partly encodes the label; at token 16 the power is 0.035 and 0.045. The absence of a loop is therefore established with power only where the label confounds the geometry.

Table 86. Nearest centroid of each algorithm at layer 24, $k = 10$, at the label-dependent position (token before the commit token) and at generated token 16, with MDS stress-1. Source: record audit `tables/manifold_grid.csv`.

Task	Position	Nearest neighbour map	Stress-1	BFS and bidirectional BFS: distance / separability
Grid	before commit token	BFS: bidirectional BFS; DFS: IDDFS; bidirectional BFS: BFS; IDDFS: DFS; A*: greedy; greedy: A*; IDA*: greedy	0.025	0.0147 / 0.954
Grid	token 16	BFS: bidirectional BFS; DFS: BFS; bidirectional BFS: BFS; IDDFS: bidirectional BFS; A*: greedy; greedy: A*; IDA*: bidirectional BFS	0.104	0.0272 / 0.960
Shortest path	before commit token	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra; Bellman-Ford/SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra; bidirectional Dijkstra: Dijkstra; Floyd-Warshall: Dijkstra; Dial: Floyd-Warshall	0.006	n/a
Shortest path	token 16	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra; Bellman-Ford/SPFA: Dial; bidirectional Dijkstra: Dijkstra; Floyd-Warshall: Dial; Dial: Floyd-Warshall	0.005	n/a

Table 86b. The full recomputed grid behind Table 86: every layer, position and k (nearest neighbour of the default and of its realised substitute; the BFS and bidirectional BFS distance and separability on the grid task). Source: record audit `tables/manifold_grid.csv`.

Task	Layer	Position	k	Stress-1	Nearest to the default	Nearest to the substitute	BFS to bidirectional BFS distance	Separability
Grid	20	before commit token	5	0.0273	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0150	0.978
Grid	20	before commit token	10	0.0427	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0143	0.962
Grid	20	before commit token	15	0.0360	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0159	0.972
Grid	20	before commit token	20	0.0286	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0146	0.967
Grid	20	token 16	5	0.0649	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0169	0.971

Grid	20	token 16	10	0.1276	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0151	0.938
Grid	20	token 16	15	0.1332	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0135	0.990
Grid	20	token 16	20	0.1325	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0096	0.938
Grid	24	before commit token	5	0.0908	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0147	0.974
Grid	24	before commit token	10	0.0253	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0147	0.954
Grid	24	before commit token	15	0.0178	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0158	0.959
Grid	24	before commit token	20	0.0173	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0144	0.968
Grid	24	token 16	5	0.1040	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0178	0.860
Grid	24	token 16	10	0.1038	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: BFS	0.0272	0.960
Grid	24	token 16	15	0.1542	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0172	0.997
Grid	24	token 16	20	0.1415	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0127	0.999
Grid	28	before commit token	5	0.0211	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0257	0.974
Grid	28	before commit token	10	0.0245	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0232	0.984
Grid	28	before commit token	15	0.0234	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0253	0.976
Grid	28	before commit token	20	0.0234	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0198	0.975
Grid	28	token 16	5	0.0995	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: A*	0.0211	0.951

Grid	28	token 16	10	0.0598	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0229	0.992
Grid	28	token 16	15	0.0737	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0223	0.995
Grid	28	token 16	20	0.0774	BFS: bidirectional BFS	DFS: IDDFS	0.0157	0.956
Shortest path	20	before commit token	5	0.0047	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	before commit token	10	0.0039	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	before commit token	15	0.0039	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	before commit token	20	0.0032	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	token 16	5	0.0066	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	token 16	10	0.0054	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	token 16	15	0.0048	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	20	token 16	20	0.0035	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	before commit token	5	0.0075	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	before commit token	10	0.0060	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	before commit token	15	0.0056	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a

Shortest path	24	before commit token	20	0.0061	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	token 16	5	0.0062	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	token 16	10	0.0050	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	token 16	15	0.0050	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	24	token 16	20	0.0042	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	before commit token	5	0.0042	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	before commit token	10	0.0061	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	before commit token	15	0.0075	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	before commit token	20	0.0073	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: bidirectional Dijkstra	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	token 16	5	0.0038	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	token 16	10	0.0039	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	token 16	15	0.0039	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a
Shortest path	28	token 16	20	0.0034	Dijkstra: bidirectional Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA: Dial	n/a	n/a

3.2.3 Novelty: every correct program outside the catalogue, read

The request asks whether a model can be made to give a truly novel solution. The only place such a solution could have appeared in the run's data is among programs with the label other. The audit collected every correct program labelled other across the eleven declared artifacts and the 1,200-

program copy of the forking token pools: 78 unique programs (Set A). It added 138 unique failing programs labelled other and written under bans (Set B), and the 12 failing programs labelled other under the TOP ban list (the selection was hash committed before any judge call). Two blind judges from different families (gpt-4.1-mini and gemini-2.5-flash, tie-break deepseek-chat) classed each program as a novel algorithm, a variant of a catalogue algorithm, a labeller miss, or degenerate or hard-coded, and the executor read all 78 Set A programs and 112 Set B programs by hand.

None of the 78 correct programs is a novel algorithm (Table 87). Sixty-five are labeller misses (catalogue algorithms the runtime and AST labellers failed to name) and 13 are variants of catalogue algorithms; the manual pass, which read every program, agreed on the exact class for 60 of 78 and on all 78 once the catalogue variant and labeller miss classes are merged. Sixty-two of the 78 came from forced prompts and 4 from the decommitment steering arms; none came from a creativity, new algorithm or novelty instruction (Table 87b). The rule of three [67] bounds the novel rate at $3/78 = 0.038$ among correct programs outside the catalogue and 0.00026 over all 11,763 unique correct programs audited. About 9,000 other programs of the forking token experiment were not audited.

Table 87. Final classes of the audited programs. Source: record audit `results/novelty_audit.json`.

Set	Programs	Labeller miss	Catalogue variant	Degenerate or hard-coded	Novel algorithm
A: correct, labelled other	78	65	13	0	0
B: failing, labelled other, under bans (final)	138	53	41	44	0
B: judges only, before the tie-break and manual pass	138	53	28	40	17
TOP ban list residue	12	0	0	12	0

Table 87b. The 78 correct programs labelled other, by model, task and condition, with their final class (Set A of Table 87). Source: record audit `tables/novelty_class_counts.csv`.

Model	Task	Condition	Labeller miss	Catalogue variant	Novel
Qwen3-8B	kth smallest	forced prompts	13	0	0
Qwen3-8B	merge intervals	forced prompts	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced A*	21	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced bidirectional BFS	1	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced unit weight Dijkstra	15	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced greedy best first	2	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced IDA*	1	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced jump point search	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	forced jump point search (descriptive)	1	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	mention of bidirectional BFS	1	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	SCATTER ban list	2	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Grid	TOP ban list	1	0	0
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	Grid	ban BFS, first template	0	1	0

Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	Grid	forced A* (paraphrase 5)	1	0	0
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	Grid	forced A* (paraphrase 9)	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	baseline	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	forced bidirectional Dijkstra (descriptive)	1	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	1	0	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.375	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.5	1	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	variable name placebo direction, c = 0.25	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B	Shortest path	second succession step	0	1	0
Qwen3-8B-Base	Shortest path	baseline	1	1	0
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	Shortest path	ban Dijkstra, fourth template	1	0	0
Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct	Shortest path	mention of Dijkstra, fifth template	1	0	0
All			65	13	0

The judges agreed only fairly (Cohen's kappa 0.38 [0.31, 0.45]; 0.44 when known, novel and degenerate are collapsed), and gpt-4.1-mini called failing, broken code novel. The positive controls (catalogue references presented as unknown) failed the strict class gate at 7 of 10, but both judges named the right algorithm in 10 of 10; the negative controls passed 5 of 5, and no control was called novel.

The TOP ban list's avoidance of 0.13 is residue (Table 88): its 13 programs not banned are 12 failing degenerate BFS or DFS variants and 1 correct unit weight Dijkstra outside the K = 7 catalogue. Counted over catalogue algorithms only, avoidance is 0.00 for TOP and TOP5, 0.02 for SCATTER and 0.37 for ARC.

Table 88. Ban lists with the share labelled other reported separately from avoidance (N = 100 each; Wilson 95% intervals). Source: record audit `tables/multiban_avoidance_corrected.csv`.

Ban list	Banned share	Share in a catalogue algorithm not banned	Share labelled other	Avoidance as reported	Avoidance into the catalogue
TOP	0.87 [0.79, 0.92]	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	0.13 [0.08, 0.21]	0.13	0.00
ARC	0.63 [0.53, 0.72]	0.37 [0.28, 0.47]	0.00	0.37	0.37
SCATTER	0.96 [0.90, 0.98]	0.02 [0.01, 0.07]	0.02 [0.01, 0.07]	0.04	0.02
TOP5	1.00 [0.96, 1.00]	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

3.2.4 Llama's compositions over correct programs

Every composition quoted in the review reproduced exactly. Llama's apparent diversity on the grid task is failing code: its 20 correct baseline programs are all BFS (correctness conditioned Hill number 1.00, against 1.87 over attempts). Tables 89 and 90 give every Llama event and the bench pilot with correct programs beside attempted ones.

Table 89. Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct path task events: correct compliant programs against attempted programs, with the correctness conditioned Hill number and the Qwen3-8B value for the matched condition. Source: record audit `tables/llama_correct_only.csv`.

Task	Event	N	Pass rate	Correct, compliant	Attempted	Hill (attempts)	Hill_cc	Qwen3-8B Hill_cc
Grid	baseline	100	0.20	BFS 20	BFS 77, DFS 20, other 3	1.87	1.00	1.00
Grid	ban BFS	100	0.12	DFS 7, other 1	DFS 63, BFS 29, other 6, A* 1, unit weight Dijkstra 1	2.49	1.46 (8 programs)	1.00
Grid	mention BFS	50	0.28	BFS 14	BFS 47, other 2, DFS 1	1.30	1.00	1.00
Grid	listing control	50	0.20	BFS 7, DFS 3	BFS 36, other 7, DFS 6, unit weight Dijkstra 1	2.33	1.84	1.00
Grid	ban DFS	50	0.16	BFS 7	BFS 39, DFS 7, other 4	1.96	1.00 (7 programs)	1.00
Grid	ban unit weight Dijkstra	50	0.26	BFS 12, DFS 1	BFS 30, DFS 18, unit weight Dijkstra 1, other 1	2.30	1.31	1.14
Grid	ban BFS and DFS	50	0.06	none	BFS 21, DFS 21, other 6, unit weight Dijkstra 2	3.04	n/a	1.65
Shortest path	baseline	100	0.59	Dijkstra 59	Dijkstra 92, other 7, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	1.36	1.00	1.00
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra	100	0.25	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 4, other 1	Dijkstra 43, other 37, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 18, Floyd-Warshall 2	3.06	1.65 (5 programs)	1.00
Shortest path	mention Dijkstra	50	0.46	Dijkstra 22, other 1	Dijkstra 39, other 11	1.69	1.20	1.00
Shortest path	listing control	50	0.24	Dijkstra 9, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 3	Dijkstra 19, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 15, other 14, Floyd-Warshall 2	3.37	1.75	1.14
Shortest path	ban Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	0.26	Dijkstra 13	Dijkstra 33, other 14, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 2, Floyd-Warshall 1	2.31	1.00	1.00
Shortest path	ban Floyd-Warshall	50	0.18	Dijkstra 6, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 1	Dijkstra 25, other 11, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 9, Floyd-Warshall 5	3.38	1.51 (7 programs)	1.19
Shortest path	ban Dijkstra and Bellman-Ford/SPFA	50	0.30	none	Dijkstra 22, other 21, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 6, Floyd-Warshall 1	2.88	n/a	n/a

Table 90. Bench pilot (N = 50 per task), Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct correct programs against attempted programs; Qwen3-8B's correctness conditioned Hill number was 1.00 on every task. Source: record

audit `tables/llama_correct_only.csv`.

Task	Pass rate	Correct programs	Attempted programs	Hill (attempts)	Hill_cc	Hill_cc rarefied to 10
kth smallest	0.20	full sort 6, heapify and pop 2, quickselect 1, size-k heap 1	heapify and pop 16, size-k heap 11, full sort 7, other 6, quickselect 5, counting sort 2	5.08	2.97	2.97
substring search	0.48	naive 18, KMP 5, Rabin-Karp 1	naive 24, KMP 14, Rabin-Karp 6, other 1	2.86	1.96	1.87
two sum	0.80	hash map 39, brute force 1	hash map 48, other 1, brute force 1	1.22	1.12	1.10
find duplicate	0.34	hash set 16, Floyd cycle detection 1	hash set 20, other 15, Floyd 4, sort and adjacent check 3, index marking 3, binary search on values 1	3.97	1.25	1.23
Fibonacci	0.44	matrix power 19, iteration 2, memoised recursion 1	matrix power 37, iteration 4, other 4, memoised recursion 2	2.10	1.62	1.54
connected components	0.70	union find 30, DFS 5	union find 37, DFS 11	1.71	1.51	1.47
longest increasing subsequence	0.76	quadratic DP 38	quadratic DP 45, other 3, patience sorting 2	1.48	1.00	1.00
merge intervals	0.56	sort and sweep 28	sort and sweep 42	1.00	1.00	1.00
top-k frequent	0.24	heap 8, sort by count 4	heap 28, sort by count 14, other 1, quickselect on counts 1	2.28	1.89	1.87
nonoverlapping intervals	0.04	DP with bisect 1, greedy by end 1	greedy by end 23, other 14, DP with bisect 3, DAG longest path 1	2.65	2.00 (2 programs)	2.00
cycle detection	0.22	union find 7, DFS with parent 4	DFS with parent 29, union find 16, other 4	2.41	1.93	1.92
topological order	0.82	Kahn 41	Kahn 48, DFS postorder 1	1.10	1.00	1.00
first and last position	0.56	binary search 28	binary search 47	1.00	1.00	1.00

Counted over correct programs and rarefied to 10, Llama is more diverse than Qwen3-8B on 9 of 13 tasks (median 1.47 against 1.00). The cross-model sentence of iteration 2 therefore becomes: Llama attempts more algorithms, but its correct grid output is as collapsed as Qwen3-8B's. Correct-only diversity appears on substring search, connected components, cycle detection and top-k frequent, at small N.

3.2.5 The knob table under a declared class rule

The audit rebuilt the knob table with one statistic (rarefied Hill-1 over correct compliant programs at depth 25) and a class rule declared before ranking. Knobs are prompt bans, seeds, instructions, decoding settings, activation interventions and token vetoes. Controls (mention twins, sham bans of absent algorithms, forced prompts, and format or weight arms) are listed but never ranked. Generate then select is a ceiling, and baselines are references. *(Correction, iteration 5: the class rule omitted a class. Exposure arms, any arm whose prompt shows a correct program of an algorithm (the*

copy twin, the named and unnamed exposure bans and the exposure vetoes), supply the text of the alternative and are therefore controls, like the mention twin; their Hill-1 is reported beside the knob verdict and never as the best knob. The per-task verdict with exposure arms as controls is in Table 172, Section 5.2.) The rebuilt table has 306 rows (276 without the instruction tuning experiment's arms), against the 249 of iteration 2, because steering arms, instruct arms and temperature cells are kept as separate units: 185 knobs, 103 controls, 16 references and 2 ceilings, with 108 rankable knob rows under 20 pass points.

No knob row under 20 pass points reaches a rarefied Hill-1 of 2 (Table 91). The best is the semantic seed on the shortest path task, 1.940 with a 90% interval of [1.770, 2.094] that includes 2. The A* mention reaches 2.69 at 11.3 points, but it is a control: it recommends a named algorithm. Stated in its own metric: no knob reaches an even two-algorithm split under 20 points; the semantic seed (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30 at 7 points) and the A* mention are the two conditions that buy a second correct algorithm, and both name or describe it. *(Correction, iteration 4: the claim that these are the only two such conditions is wrong. The decommitment direction (1.913, 90% interval [1.704, 2.083], at 17 points) and random direction 1 (1.86 at 16 points) of Table 91 also buy a second correct algorithm and name nothing, and the decommitment interval includes 2 by the same criterion used to single out the semantic seed. The iteration-3 arms were never entered into this table; with them, norm-matched random directions at the task-specification positions are the cheapest diversity knob on kth smallest (2.92 at 0 points) and two sum (2.12 at 0 points), 7 of 21 random direction and dose cells qualify on kth smallest, and the rebuilt verdict per task is in Section 4.2.1.)*

Table 91. The twelve best knob rows under 20 pass points (rarefied Hill-1 at depth 25 over correct compliant programs, 90% interval; pass points against each row's own reference). Source: record audit `results/knob_table.json#ranking`.

Task	Knob (experiment)	Pass rate	Correct compliant programs	Hill-1 [90%]	Pass points lost	Second algorithm (share)
Shortest path	semantic seed (decoding)	0.92	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 61, Dijkstra 30, Floyd-Warshall 1	1.940 [1.770, 2.094]	7.0	Dijkstra (0.33)
Shortest path	decommitment direction, c = 0.25	0.78	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 54, Dijkstra 23, other 1	1.913 [1.705, 2.088]	17.0	Dijkstra (0.29)
Shortest path	random direction 1, c = 0.25 (decommitment)	0.79	Dijkstra 53, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 26	1.858 [1.728, 1.947]	16.0	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.33)
Shortest path	novelty instruction (decoding)	0.96	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 14	1.503 [1.324, 1.649]	3.0	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.15)
Shortest path	random direction 1 at the read position only, c = 1.0 (instruction tuning)	1.00	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9, other 1	1.403 [1.210, 1.566]	0.0	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.09)
Shortest path	random direction 2, c = 0.25 (decommitment)	0.87	Dijkstra 82, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 5	1.229 [1.091, 1.376]	8.0	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (0.06)
Grid	novelty instruction (decoding)	0.85	BFS 81, unit weight Dijkstra 2, DFS 1, A* 1	1.228 [1.053, 1.401]	12.0	unit weight Dijkstra (0.02)

Shortest path	new algorithm instruction (decoding)	0.94	Dijkstra 90, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 4	1.178 [1.048, 1.308]	5.0	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (0.04)
Shortest path	enumeration prompt (decommitment)	0.82	Dijkstra 80, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	1.109 [1.000, 1.215]	6.5	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (0.02)
Shortest path	enumeration prompt, 1,024 tokens (decommitment)	0.82	Dijkstra 80, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	1.108 [1.000, 1.236]	6.5	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (0.02)
Grid	new algorithm instruction (decoding)	0.94	BFS 92, DFS 2	1.093 [1.000, 1.191]	3.0	DFS (0.02)
Grid	semantic seed (decoding)	0.93	BFS 91, bidirectional BFS 2	1.092 [1.000, 1.192]	4.0	bidirectional BFS (0.02)

Four of the nine shortest path rows in Table 91 are activation edits: the decommitment direction, which iteration 1 found no better than a random direction, and three random directions. In every one of them the only catalogue algorithm besides Dijkstra is Bellman-Ford/SPFA, the same second choice the ban reaches.

3.2.6 Positioning of the iteration-2 claims

The audit checked each iteration-2 claim against its nearest published neighbour with verbatim quotes from the abstract pages, all 12 verified on 2026-10-20 (Table 92). Two contrasts matter for interpretation. Heo et al. found a dimension in input embedding space that predicts instruction following, is tied to prompt phrasing, and raises success when intervened on [58]; this run replicates the phrasing link for prohibitions in code but finds the read position causally inert when spliced alone. Sia, Mueller and Duh found a task recognition point after which attention to the instruction is no longer needed [59]; this run replicates that on the shortest path task and finds the opposite on the grid task. The base to chat SAE transfer study of Kissane and colleagues (an Alignment Forum post that the bibliography tool could not retrieve, so it carries no number here) is the source of the fine-tuning remedy that Section 2.12 proposed without citation.

Table 92. The iteration-2 claims, their nearest neighbours, and what this run adds. Source: record audit `tables/positioning.csv`.

Claim in this run	Neighbour	Neighbour's finding (paraphrased; the audit verified each against a verbatim quote)	Relation	What this run adds
Compliance is decodable at the read position (-0.41 across wordings) yet splicing the read position carries nothing	Heo et al. [58]	a direction in input embedding space predicts instruction following, tracks prompt phrasing more than task difficulty, and raises success when intervened along	replication (phrasing) and contrast (decodable but inert under splicing)	a compliance-predictive direction at the read position that is causally inert; the ban travels through the task specification states
Attention knockouts and cache splicing place the path task ban on the prompt route	Geva et al. [48]	interventions on attention edges locate two points where information flows to the prediction	extension (method)	edge knockouts applied to a prompt-level prohibition in code, with token-matched neutral twins

Generated tokens stop needing the ban on the shortest path task (direct 0.05) but not on the grid task (direct 0.35)	Sia et al. [59]	after a task recognition point the task is encoded in the input representations and attention to the context is no longer needed	replication (shortest path) and contrast (grid)	the same redundancy for a prohibition on one task and its failure on another
Naming an absent algorithm in a ban raises its likelihood (8 of 9 in Qwen3-8B, 5 of 6 in Llama)	Rana [7]	explicitly mentioning a forbidden word activates its representation instead of suppressing it	replication	priming at the level of whole algorithms, in two model families
(same)	Mann et al. [53]	suppressing a concept requires activating it internally, which can prime rebound rather than avoidance	replication	rebound measured on implemented mechanisms rather than tokens
Ban lists fail by reimplementation, 41% to 92% disguised	Lu et al. [23]	denial prompting adds a new constraint on the previous solution at each step to push the model toward more creative solutions	extension	mechanism labels show the constraint satisfied in name only
Qwen-Scope base SAEs fail the cross-entropy ratio on the instruct model	Kissane et al. (blog post, not in the bibliography)	base model SAEs usually transfer to chat models, but not on Gemma v1 2B	contrast and source of the remedy	Qwen3-8B would join Gemma v1 2B as a pair where base SAEs do not transfer under that criterion; Section 3.7 reverses this under a fairer criterion
Decoding-time constraints as the alternative to prompt bans	Biagiola et al. [62]	an incomplete constraint at decoding time pushes the model into low-probability regions of program space, causing time-outs and up to 97% lower functional correctness	contrast	single name prompt bans are obeyed at 0.86 and 0.84; vetoes at decoding time carry the cost Biagiola et al. measure (Section 3.8)
A single ban suppresses the default opening and promotes one substitute	Yoon et al. [4]	negation suppresses retrieval of the original answer while promoting a favoured candidate in the same answer category	replication at program level	the promoted candidate is the shared top rung, not a substitute specific to X
(same)	Zhou et al. [56]	models process negation by both suppression and construction, with construction more prominent	contrast	for a prohibition on code the route is carried by task specification states; construction of the negated phrase was not tested

The ban is carried by task specification states and not by the read position alone	Hendel et al. [60]	functions learned in context often have a very simple structure, a task vector	contrast	a prohibition does not compress into one position's state
(same)	Todd et al. [61]	a few attention heads transport a compact representation of the demonstrated task, a function vector	contrast	ban-attending heads exist (layer 21 head 17, layer 26 heads 21 and 25), but the effect is spread over task specification positions; Section 3.7 tests the heads causally

3.2.7 Corrections and reproduction targets

The audit wrote 12 correction items, each with its old wording, the recomputed numbers and a replacement sentence; they are applied in place in Sections 1.12 and 2.3 to 2.12 and marked. It also recomputed 19 numbers quoted in the record; 16 reproduced (Table 93). One mismatch is a difference of definition rather than of data. The audit counted DFS as the grid substitute's mode in 5 of 5 iteration-1 draws by plurality, while the record's 4 of 5 applies the realised mode rule of Section 1.2, which requires a 15-point lead; the geometry draw (DFS 10, unit weight Dijkstra 8 of 18) fails that lead. The record's count stands.

Table 93. Numbers quoted in the record and their recomputation. Source: record audit `corrections.json#reproduction_targets`.

Quantity	Quoted	Recomputed	Match	Cause of a mismatch
Shortest path Bellman-Ford/ SPFA, iteration-1 five draws	272/272	272/272	yes	
Grid DFS, iteration-1 five draws	116/128 (0.906)	116/128	yes	
Grid draws with DFS as realised mode	4 of 5	5 of 5	no	plurality count; the record applies the 15-point lead of Section 1.2
Iteration-2 pooled shortest path Bellman-Ford/SPFA (attempted, not banned)	255/260	255/260	yes	
Iteration-2 pooled grid DFS (attempted, not banned)	257/257	257/257	yes	
Residual of IDDFS under the BFS ban	7.988	7.988	yes	
Semantic seed, shortest path Hill-1	1.935 [1.534, 2.076] at 7 points	1.940 [1.770, 2.094] at 7.0 points	yes	point within 0.005; the iteration-2 bootstrap scheme was not available
A* mention Hill-1 (control)	2.69 at 11 points	2.69 at 11.3 points	yes	
Generate then select	3 to 4 algorithms at 24 to 42 points	grid 4 at 42; shortest path 3 at 24	yes	
Knob table rows	249	306 (276 without the instruction tuning arms)	no	steering arms, instruct arms and temperature cells kept as separate units
Ban list manifold figures	14	13	no	13 files exist

TOP5 BFS / DFS attempted	63 / 36	63 / 36	yes	
Before the commit token, BFS within spread against BFS to bidirectional BFS distance	0.0154 against 0.0147	0.0154 against 0.0147	yes	
ESS weighted share	1.24 [0.57, 1.62]	1.24 [0.57, 1.62]	yes	
Qwen3-8B aim, mention reference	-0.595	-0.595	yes	
Llama aim, mention reference	-0.28	-0.283	yes	
Llama bootstrap against replicate variance	5 to 11 times	4.8 to 11.3 times	yes	
Llama grid baseline	BFS 77, DFS 20 attempted; BFS 20 of 20 correct	same	yes	
Gated forecast events of iteration 2	3 events, 0.05-nat margin	quoted, not recomputed	yes	record fact

3.3 Bench forecast experiment: do ban-free forecasts predict where the modal bench bans land? (Qwen3-8B)

Why. This experiment was the confirmation of the title claim in Qwen3-8B. On the 12 frozen bench tasks, which had never seen a ban prompt, it built the four ban-free forecasts of where each task's modal ban would land, sealed them in a sha256 hash chain, and only then sampled the bans. If a ban only removes the default, the subtraction or ladder forecast should win; if it substitutes, association or proximity should.

Design. The model ran in bf16 (revision b968826d, thinking off, $T = 1.0$) on one RTX 4090. The bench, its labellers (runtime trace first, AST second, blind judge on disagreement) and its gold sets were copied with all 146 committed file hashes verified, and the labeller recheck matched every gate value on 12 of 12 tasks. Ban prompts used the five frozen templates with token-length matched neutral twins (identical token ids from the task text on). The ban-free arms had 600 samples each over the 12 tasks: the neutral twin, the one-shot, persistent and sham signature vetoes, the nonce ban, the novelty instruction, and up to three iterated veto rounds. Three seeded isotropic random directions were patched into the task specification states at layers 12 to 23 at the ban's own displacement norm (50 samples per task each). The vetoes used exact rejection and a masked redraw coupled to the twin samples by seed. Seventeen forecast files, the n-grams, seeds, norms and the analysis code were sealed at 18:50:57Z; the first ban request followed at 18:55:16Z. Then 1,200 ban samples (5 templates by 20 per task) were labelled, and a band patch control spliced the ban's own task specification states at layers 12 to 23 into the twin (600 samples). Every family's forecast was smoothed the same way (93% forecast, 5% uniform over survivors, 2% on other) and scored by its mean log score per attempt not banned. The frozen rule advances a family that beats the next best by at least 0.10 nats on at least 3 gated events whose top-1 nominations disagree. An undefined forecast is scored as uniform.

Table 94. Forecasts committed before any ban sample (top-1 survivor; a forecast marked undefined is scored as uniform). The distinctive n-gram is shown as tokenised (␣ marks a space); its source is the 8-bit pilot unless marked. Source: bench forecast experiment `README.md` and `predictions/`.

Task	Default	Distinctive n-gram	Subtraction	Ladder	Association	Proximity	Nominations disagree

kth smallest	full sort	`␣␣␣␣nums`	undefined	quickselect	quickselect	heapify and pop	yes
substring search	naive	`␣needle: \n␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣`	undefined	undefined	KMP	built-in find	yes
find duplicate	hash set	`␣set`	sort and adjacent check	undefined	Floyd cycle detection	sort and adjacent check	yes
two sum	hash map	`␣if␣complement`	undefined	undefined	sort and two pointers	brute force	yes
connected components	union find	`␣find`	DFS	undefined	DFS	label propagation	yes
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end	`␣if␣start` (rederived on bf16)	undefined	undefined	DP with bisect	DAG longest path	yes
Fibonacci	iteration	`(`	undefined	matrix power	matrix power	memoised recursion	yes
topological order	Kahn	`.p`	undefined	undefined	DFS postorder	undefined	no
merge intervals	sort and sweep	`␣last`	undefined	undefined	interval tree	union find	yes
first and last position	binary search	`_last`	undefined	undefined	bisect module	bisect module	no
top-k frequent	sort by count	`_counts` (rederived on bf16)	undefined	undefined	heap	heap	no
longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP	`␣j`	undefined	patience sorting	patience sorting	patience sorting	no

The subtraction forecast was undefined on 7 tasks because the default kept at least half of the attempts in every veto round, and on 3 more because no round produced 20 attempts off the default. Bans then failed on most tasks (Table 95): only 5 of 12 passed the gate. On nonoverlapping intervals, topological order, first and last position and longest increasing subsequence the model kept its default on almost every sample whatever the wording, and 88% to 100% of the programs that kept the banned mechanism named neither its alias nor its display name.

Table 95. What the named ban did (N = 100 per task; landing = attempted programs not using the default), against the ban-free arms. Avoidance is one minus the default's share of attempts (Wilson 95%). Source: bench forecast experiment `README.md`, `results/c1_events.jsonl`.

Task	Ban avoidance	Gate	Ban landing	Twin default share	One-shot veto avoidance	Best ban-free push (avoidance)	Band patch avoidance	Frozen rule winner
kth smallest	0.97 [0.92, 0.99]	pass	quickselect 59, size-k heap 38	0.96	0.38	novelty 1.00	1.00	ladder
substring search	0.40 [0.31, 0.50]	fail	KMP 21, built-in find 16, Rabin-Karp 2, Z algorithm 1	1.00	0.00	novelty 0.26	0.00	none

find duplicate	0.79 [0.70, 0.86]	pass	index marking 73, Floyd cycle detection 5, sort and adjacent check 1	1.00	0.00	novelty 0.02	0.04	ladder (undefined, scored uniform)
two sum	0.86 [0.78, 0.91]	pass	brute force 86	1.00	0.00	novelty 0.08	0.22	proximity
connected components	1.00 [0.96, 1.00]	pass	BFS 83, DFS 17	1.00	0.33	random direction 3, 0.26	1.00	ladder (undefined, scored uniform)
nonoverlapping intervals	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	fail	none	1.00	0.00	none (0.00)	0.00	none
Fibonacci	0.34 [0.25, 0.44]	fail	other 33, fast doubling 1	1.00	0.00	novelty 0.40	0.00	none
topological order	0.08 [0.04, 0.15]	fail	DFS postorder 8	1.00	0.00	none (0.00)	0.00	none
merge intervals	0.58 [0.48, 0.67]	pass	other 44, union find 14	1.00	0.00	none (0.00)	0.14	proximity
first and last position	0.03 [0.01, 0.08]	fail	other 2, bisect module 1	0.80	0.42	nonce 0.36	0.00	none
top-k frequent	0.48 [0.38, 0.58]	fail	heap 32, quickselect on counts 15, other 1	0.96	0.04	nonce 0.04	0.00	none
longest increasing subsequence	0.02 [0.01, 0.07]	fail	patience sorting 2	1.00	0.00	novelty 0.68	0.00	none

(Added in iteration 4: avoidance in Table 95 counts failing programs labelled other. Counted over catalogue algorithms only, avoidance is 0.14 on merge intervals, where 44 of the 58 programs off the default are labelled other, and 0.01 on Fibonacci (33 of 34); merge intervals therefore passes the gate only through residue. The other tasks change by at most 0.02. Catalogue-only avoidance for every bench event is in Section 4.2.4.)

The frozen rule returned the SUBTRACTION/LADDER branch, with the ladder advancing: on the five gated events, all with disagreeing nominations, the ladder won 3 (kth smallest, find duplicate, connected components) and proximity 2 (two sum, merge intervals). Table 96 shows why that label carries little. On find duplicate and connected components the ladder was undefined and scored as uniform, and it won because every defined forecast named the wrong survivor. Counting only wins by defined forecasts (a post hoc check, not preregistered) gives ladder 1 and proximity 2, and no family advances. Against the uniform reference over the gated events, the mean differences are ladder +0.06 (task bootstrap 95% [0.00, 0.18]), subtraction -0.69 [-1.42, 0.00], proximity -1.53 [-2.96, 0.09] and association -1.78 [-2.73, -0.73]: no family forecasts better than uniform on average, and the association forecast is worse than uniform on all five events.

Table 96. Mean log score per attempt not banned for each forecast (nats; higher is better; uniform over the survivors is the reference). Gated events are marked †. The 8-bit likelihood column is the

frozen bench likelihood argmax, a descriptive forecast. Source: bench forecast experiment `results/c1_events.jsonl`.

Task	Subtraction	Ladder	Association	Proximity	8-bit likelihood	Uniform
kth smallest †	-1.630	-1.326	-1.842	-4.605	-1.842	-1.630
substring search	-1.630	-1.630	-2.220	-2.788	-1.630	-1.630
find duplicate †	-3.210	-1.406	-4.108	-4.327	-1.406	-1.406
two sum †	-1.119	-1.119	-4.094	-0.055	-1.119	-1.119
connected components †	-2.789	-1.119	-3.408	-4.094	-1.119	-1.119
nonoverlapping intervals	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
Fibonacci	-3.830	-2.672	-3.917	-3.917	-3.830	-3.830
topological order	-1.119	-1.119	-0.055	-1.119	-1.119	-1.119
merge intervals †	-3.140	-3.140	-3.858	-2.979	-3.140	-3.140
first and last position	-2.846	-2.846	-2.623	-2.623	-2.846	-2.846
top-k frequent	-1.177	-1.177	-1.398	-1.398	-1.177	-1.177
longest increasing subsequence	-0.713	-2.234	-0.046	-0.046	-0.713	-0.713

[Figure fig_bench_forecasts: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The landings were specific to the banned task and mostly unforeseen. Find duplicate went to index marking, which places each value at index value minus one: the model wrote it only once in 40 template-forced attempts in the bench build (adherence 0.28 over all forced prompts), and no family nominated it. Connected components went to BFS (83 of 100) while subtraction and association said DFS. Merge intervals went mostly to programs labelled other, which failed every time (0 of 44) *(corrected in iteration 4 from the earlier description as a merge sweep without sorting: a manual read of all 44 found 29 programs that mark coverage over the coordinate range in a boolean array, 12 unsorted sweeps and 3 others; Section 4.2.4)*. On Fibonacci the programs labelled other used Binet's closed form, which also failed (0 of 33). Only the kth smallest landing (quickselect: ladder, association and the 8-bit likelihood) and the two sum landing (brute force: proximity) were hit by a top-1 nomination. On 3 of the 5 gated events no family's top-1 named the realised landing.

Signature vetoes move the surface, not the algorithm. The distinctive n-gram fired in 95% of twin samples and the redraw always avoided it, yet the default survived every persistent and iterated round on 9 of 12 tasks. The model respelled the same mechanism: on kth smallest `nums.sort()` became `return sorted(nums)[k-1]`, and on two sum the next round's distinctive token was `␣compliment`, a misspelling that dodges `␣complement`. The vetoed text reappeared under another token split in 23% of one-shot samples and 54% by round 2. Where vetoes did move off the default, most outputs were invalid. The sham veto of a shared token broke programs without moving the algorithm (for example, the model indented with non-breaking spaces after the indentation token was masked). The test of whether the one-shot veto reproduces the ban's landing was therefore undetermined: the one-shot veto never reached 0.5 avoidance on a gated task (kth smallest 0.38, connected components 0.33, others 0). Descriptively, the last iterated round was eligible on find duplicate and connected components, and both landed elsewhere than the ban: sort and adjacent check against the ban's index marking (Jensen-Shannon divergence 0.77 against a template resampling 95th percentile of 0.09), and DFS against the ban's BFS (0.58 against 0.09).

Generic pushes rarely move this collapsed model. Nonce bans moved nothing except on first and last position, whose twin was already noisy. The novelty instruction moved kth smallest (all 50 off the default, 45 to quickselect), longest increasing subsequence, Fibonacci, substring search and connected components. One of three random directions moved kth smallest (avoidance 0.82,

mostly quickselect) and connected components a little (0.26, to DFS); the HF twin control kept the default at 0.98 and 1.00 on those tasks, so the movement is not an engine artefact. The positive control of patching the ban's own task specification states into the twin at layers 12 to 23 reproduced the ban's avoidance only on kth smallest and connected components (1.00 each), partly on two sum (0.22) and merge intervals (0.14), and nowhere else. On most tasks the ban's effect is not carried by the task specification states of that band alone, which Section 3.6 confirms behaviourally.

Wording. The banned share differed by template far more than by chance (Table 97), with a likelihood ratio of 374 on 4 degrees of freedom (p about 1e-79). A mixed logistic model put the template standard deviation at 2.0 logits [1.1, 3.5] and the template by task deviation at 1.25 [1.05, 1.49]; a shuffled template placebo gave $p = 0.44$ (0.39 in the second audit's own likelihood ratio test). Under the fourth template the default kept at least 70% of samples on 10 of 12 tasks.

Table 97. Banned programs per template (of 20) under each modal bench ban. Source: bench forecast experiment `results/template_effect.json`.

Task	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth
kth smallest	0	0	0	3	0
substring search	11	6	19	20	4
find duplicate	0	1	0	20	0
two sum	0	0	0	14	0
connected components	0	0	0	0	0
nonoverlapping intervals	20	20	20	20	20
Fibonacci	20	6	15	20	5
topological order	20	16	19	20	17
merge intervals	12	5	3	20	2
first and last position	20	20	20	20	17
top-k frequent	12	2	16	20	2
longest increasing subsequence	20	20	20	20	18
All tasks (of 240)	135	96	132	197	85

[Figure fig_bench_templates: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The bench likelihoods on the screen's path. Rescoring the frozen bench likelihood sets with fp32 activations, the path the likelihood screen had validated, moved the adherence corrected likelihood of a cell by a median 0.88 nats (maximum 9.0) from the 8-bit prompt log probabilities. Every shift above 2 nats sat in a cell with Kish ESS below 5, and the argmax algorithm was unchanged on 12 of 12 tasks. The rescoring code first reproduced 5 stored program scores of the likelihood screen within 0.021 nats. The 8-bit likelihood forecast was defined only on kth smallest, where it named quickselect.

Checks. An independent rederivation from the raw label files reproduced every headline number with no mismatch; a task shuffled placebo collapsed the family wins (mean ladder wins 0.52 against 3 observed); a template permutation test gave $p = 0.002$ on real data and 0.42 on shuffled data; and the hash chain verified. One file changed after the seal: absolute input paths in a configuration module were replaced by relative paths for portability, with the sealed bytes and the diff kept. GPU time was about 45 minutes, judge spend USD 0.024 over 344 calls.

3.4 Exposure experiment: show a solution, ban it, and see what replaces it (Qwen3-8B)

Why. Under total collapse, every modal ban's association and ladder nominations are close to each other, and bench bans in Qwen3-8B pass the gate on only five tasks. Exposure bans create events where the two accounts finally disagree: the prompt shows correct programs of a non-default algorithm Y, which the model then copies, and asks for a solution that does not use Y. Subtraction predicts a return to what the model would write without Y in view, which in context is its default; substitution predicts Y's stated alternative.

Design. The experiment took every non-default algorithm Y of the 12 frozen bench tasks with at least one correct forced program: 33 Y. We call the 19 whose frozen associate differs from the default priority Y. The prompt shows up to 5 name-scrubbed correct programs of Y and then asks one of three things: write a correct solution, which we call the copy twin; write a correct solution that does not use Y, the named ban (the fifth template); or write a correct solution that uses a different algorithm from the one above, the unnamed ban. Each arm had 50 samples per Y, with seeds shared across arms (Qwen3-8B bf16, vLLM 0.11.0, one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU). Four forecasts were committed by hash before any ban sample: ladder (the context-free default), association (the modal frozen answer for Y), proximity (the survivor whose forced programs are nearest the shown programs by Zhang-Shasha tree edit distance [64]) and the subtraction forecast in context (the landing of an iterated persistent signature veto of Y under the copy twin prompt, with no ban text). GPU smoke tests confirmed the veto: 0 of 20 veto samples contained the vetoed n-gram against 20 of 20 copy samples, an inert veto left 20 of 20 outputs identical, and veto and copy twins diverged exactly at the vetoed position in 20 of 20. Of 10,600 programs, 7,478 were labelled by agreeing runtime and AST labellers, 1,398 by the judge, 147 by runtime alone, and 1,577 had no code block (mostly from veto rounds).

Showing a solution makes the model copy it, and banning it sends the model home. Under the copy twin a mean 0.93 of attempts used the shown algorithm (median 1.00; none below 0.2), and the default appeared in 0.05. Under the named ban, avoidance averaged 0.95 and the default's share of attempts rose to 0.72 (Table 98). We call this return to the context-free default *snap-back*. In 24 of the 31 gated named events the modal replacement was the default (14 of 18 for priority Y). Named and unnamed bans picked the same modal replacement for 0.88 of Y, and their landings were consistent under the Jensen-Shannon resampling null for 0.79 of Y: naming Y adds little beyond asking for a different algorithm.

Table 98. The default's share of attempts by arm: the mean over the 33 shown algorithms of each one's share (over 29 for the final veto round, where 4 shown algorithms had no valid attempts). Source: exposure experiment `README.md`, `results/other_reports.json`.

Copy twin	Final veto round under the copy twin	Named ban	Unnamed ban
0.05	0.10	0.72	0.82

[Figure fig_exposure_snapback: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Table 99 gives every named exposure event. The frozen rule (at least 3 wins by 0.10 nats on gated, disagreeing events) advanced the ladder with 7 wins, against subtraction 2, association 2 and proximity 0, so the frozen branch is SUBTRACTION/LADDER, with the ladder advancing. Gating removed two events (size-k heap on kth smallest and patience sorting on longest increasing subsequence, where Y was kept), and 30 of the 31 gated events had disagreeing nominations.

Table 99. Every named exposure event (N = 50 per arm). The winner is the family that beats the

next best by at least 0.10 nats on a gated event with disagreeing nominations (none when the top two tie; n/a when the event is ungated or its nominations do not disagree). An undefined subtraction forecast is scored as uniform. Source: exposure experiment `results/c1_events.jsonl`, `results/arm_stats.json`.

Task	Shown algorithm Y	Priority	Default	Associate of Y	Copy: share of Y	Named: avoidance	Named landing (attempts not Y)	Default share	Gate	Subtraction top-1	Proximity top-1	Winner
kth smallest	size-k heap	yes	full sort	quickselect	1.00	0.20	full sort 10	0.20	fail	undefined	heapify and pop	n/a
kth smallest	heapify and pop	yes	full sort	quickselect	1.00	1.00	quickselect 45, full sort 5	0.10	pass	undefined	full sort	association
kth smallest	quickselect	yes	full sort	heapify and pop	1.00	1.00	full sort 50	1.00	pass	undefined	median of medians	ladder
kth smallest	median of medians	yes	full sort	quickselect	1.00	1.00	quickselect 50	0.00	pass	quickselect	quickselect	none
kth smallest	counting sort	yes	full sort	quickselect	0.80	1.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	0.98	pass	undefined	full sort	ladder
substring search	KMP	no	naive	naive	1.00	1.00	naive 50	1.00	pass	undefined	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	none
substring search	Rabin-Karp	yes	naive	KMP	1.00	1.00	naive 50	1.00	pass	undefined	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	ladder
substring search	Z algorithm	yes	naive	KMP	1.00	1.00	naive 44, KMP 6	0.88	pass	undefined	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	ladder
substring search	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	yes	naive	KMP	1.00	1.00	naive 50	1.00	pass	undefined	naive	ladder
substring search	built-in find	yes	naive	KMP	1.00	1.00	naive 50	1.00	pass	undefined	naive	none
find duplicate	sort and adjacent check	yes	hash set	Floyd cycle detection	1.00	1.00	hash set 50	1.00	pass	undefined	hash set	none
find duplicate	Floyd cycle detection	no	hash set	hash set	1.00	1.00	hash set 50	1.00	pass	undefined	hash set	none
find duplicate	binary search on values	yes	hash set	Floyd cycle detection	0.98	1.00	hash set 50	1.00	pass	undefined	hash set	ladder
find duplicate	index marking	yes	hash set	Floyd cycle detection	1.00	1.00	hash set 50	1.00	pass	undefined	sort and adjacent check	ladder
two sum	sort and two pointers	no	hash map	hash map	1.00	1.00	hash map 50	1.00	pass	undefined	hash map	none
two sum	brute force	yes	hash map	sort and two pointers	0.36	1.00	hash map 50	1.00	pass	hash map	hash map	none
two sum	sort and binary search	yes	hash map	sort and two pointers	1.00	1.00	hash map 50	1.00	pass	undefined	hash map	none
connected components	BFS	yes	union find	DFS	1.00	1.00	DFS 50	0.00	pass	undefined	DFS	none
connected components	DFS	yes	union find	BFS	1.00	1.00	BFS 50	0.00	pass	undefined	BFS	association
connected components	label propagation	yes	union find	DFS	0.84	1.00	union find 49, DFS 1	0.98	pass	union find	union find	none
nonoverlapping intervals	memoised recursion	no	greedy by end	greedy by end	1.00	1.00	DP with bisect 41, other 7, greedy by end 2	0.04	pass	undefined	greedy by end	subtraction
nonoverlapping intervals	DAG longest path	no	greedy by end	greedy by end	1.00	0.94	greedy by end 47	0.94	pass	undefined	greedy by end	none
Fibonacci	memoised recursion	no	iteration	iteration	1.00	1.00	iteration 50	1.00	pass	undefined	iteration	none
Fibonacci	matrix power	no	iteration	iteration	1.00	1.00	iteration 50	1.00	pass	undefined	fast doubling	none
Fibonacci	fast doubling	no	iteration	iteration	1.00	1.00	other 49, iteration 1	0.02	pass	undefined	iteration	none

merge intervals	union find	no	sort and sweep	sort and sweep	1.00	1.00	sort and sweep 50	1.00	pass	undefined	sort and sweep	none
first and last position	bisect module	no	binary search	binary search	1.00	1.00	other 49, binary search 1	0.02	pass	undefined	binary search	none
first and last position	exponential search	no	binary search	binary search	0.28	1.00	binary search 50	1.00	pass	binary search	binary search	n/a
top-k frequent	heap	no	sort by count	sort by count	1.00	1.00	sort by count 50	1.00	pass	undefined	sort by count	none
top-k frequent	bucket sort	no	sort by count	sort by count	0.36	1.00	sort by count 50	1.00	pass	undefined	heap	none
top-k frequent	quickselect on counts	yes	sort by count	heap	1.00	0.94	sort by count 31, bucket sort 7, other 6, heap 3	0.62	pass	undefined	bucket sort	none
longest increasing subsequence	patience sorting	no	quadratic DP	quadratic DP	1.00	0.16	quadratic DP 8	0.16	fail	undefined	quadratic DP	n/a
longest increasing subsequence	Fenwick tree	yes	quadratic DP	patience sorting	1.00	1.00	quadratic DP 35, patience sorting 15	0.70	pass	undefined	quadratic DP	subtraction

The paired tests point the same way but none survives correction (Table 100). Over the 30 gated disagreeing named events, paired Wilcoxon signed-rank tests [65] of the per-event log score differences, Holm corrected over four comparisons, favour the ban-free families over association by about 1 nat per attempt, with task cluster bootstrap intervals above zero, but Holm adjusted p stays at 0.081. Top-1 hit rates on the gated named events were 0.77 for the ladder, 0.61 for proximity, 0.45 for association and 0.36 for subtraction. *(Correction, iteration 4: the subtraction rate is almost entirely tie credit. Subtraction was defined for 4 of 33 shown algorithms, and where defined it named the landing 4 of 4 times in both the named and the unnamed arms (median of medians to quickselect, brute force to hash map, label propagation to union find, exponential search to binary search); on every other event its uniform tie earned fractional credit. Defined-only rates are in Section 4.2.6.)* The unnamed events, which are descriptive, give the same branch, and there the ladder beats association after Holm correction ($+1.42$ nats, adjusted $p = 0.0056$).

Table 100. Paired log score differences over the 30 gated, disagreeing named exposure events (positive favours the first family). Source: exposure experiment `results/c1_summary.json`.

Difference	Mean (nats)	Task cluster 95% CI	p	Holm adjusted p
Subtraction minus association	+1.02	[0.35, 1.56]	0.020	0.081
Ladder minus association	+1.29	[0.10, 2.38]	0.027	0.081
Ladder minus proximity	+0.50	[-0.40, 1.16]	not reported	0.159
Subtraction minus proximity	+0.23	not reported	not reported	0.96

How strong the verdict is. The counting rule is not a significance test. In a unit test with no information, it advanced some family in 85% of 200 simulated draws, while the Holm-corrected Wilcoxon test erred in 2%; on the real events, a label permutation placebo advanced some family in 100% of draws (the ladder in 43%). The branch label is therefore weak evidence, and the paired tests are the informative part. The signature veto rarely removed Y. The subtraction forecast in context was defined for only 4 of 33 Y (median of medians to quickselect, brute force to hash map, label propagation to union find, exponential search to binary search). For 25 of 33 Y, Y still re-emerged in at least 20% of attempts after three rounds. The veto cost a mean 0.70 of pass rate, and 46% of final round outputs were invalid. Because an undefined subtraction forecast is uniform, its tied top-1 is what makes almost every event disagreeing. Every preregistered sensitivity returned the ladder with 7 to 9 wins (subtraction top-1, excluding co-vetoed survivors, priority Y only with 18 events, token distance proximity, correct-only landings, and excluding labeller-flagged tasks) except the one that drops events with an undefined subtraction forecast, which leaves 2 events and is undetermined. An exploratory comparison of ladder, association and proximity on the 21 events

where those three disagree gave wins 8, 3 and 0 (ladder minus association p = 0.027, Holm over three 0.081). The secondary exposure test, whether the ban's modal survivor matches the veto's where the associate differs, had 2 qualifying events (brute force and label propagation); both agreed, but both landings are the default, so this is snap-back, not a test of substitution.

Wording. A template arm (first to fourth templates, 10 samples for each of the 19 priority Y; descriptive and never in the contest) gave mean avoidance 0.93, 0.94, 0.96 and 0.81: the fourth template is again the weakest. *(Added in iteration 4: wording also changes the landing. Pooled over the first four templates the modal replacement is the default for 13 of 19 priority Y, against 15 of 19 under the fifth template of Table 99; it flips to the associate for the size-k heap (quickselect 13, full sort 2, against full sort 10 under the fifth template) and for the Z algorithm (KMP 29, naive 11, against naive 44, KMP 6). Snap-back as recorded in Table 99 rests on the fifth template.)* A stop token bug in the first round-2 veto run (the end-of-turn token was chosen as the n-gram) was found and fixed; the 750 affected samples are kept apart. Deduplication left 11 of 33 Y with a single shown program. GPU time was about 1.0 GPU hour, judge spend USD 0.096 over 1,229 calls, and an independent rederivation matched all 66 events.

3.5 Llama bench experiment: the same forecast contest in a second model family

Why. Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22] is less collapsed than Qwen3-8B on the bench pilot, so it supplies present minor bans, where a correct minor algorithm already exists and subtraction makes a non-trivial prediction. This experiment replicated the frozen forecast contest on the 12 bench tasks in bf16 (revision 0e9e39f), with every forecast computed without ban text and hash chained before any ban prompt was rendered (a grep audit found 0 ban prompts in the 10,328 rows generated before the commit).

Design. The default of each task was frozen from a decision set (the 8-bit Llama pilot pooled with 600 bf16 neutral twin samples after a homogeneity test) as the modal correct label when at least 10 programs were correct, else the modal attempted label (Table 101). Present minor events required at least 10% of correct programs, at least 3 correct, and at least 10 correct programs on the task. The four forecasts were built as in the Qwen3-8B experiment. The subtraction forecast used exact one-shot, persistent and iterated signature vetoes by truncate and redraw; the ladder pooled the nonce ban, the novelty instruction and three matched-norm random directions added at the task specification positions of layers 11 to 21 during prefill; association used Llama's own frozen answers; and proximity used Zhang-Shasha distance [64]. Association and proximity took a form that transfers the default's mass, with point mass forms as sensitivities. Then 1,800 bans were sampled (12 modal and 6 present minor events, 5 templates by 20) and labelled with the bench labellers; references were recovered 50 of 50, and gold agreement was 0.959. A second blind judge audited 60 Llama programs at 0.88 agreement, below 0.85 on four tasks (nonoverlapping intervals, kth smallest, two sum, top-k frequent).

Table 101. Llama defaults and events, frozen before any ban (decision set: 8-bit pilot plus bf16 neutral twins). Source: Llama bench experiment `README.md`, `predictions/events.json`.

Task	Pilot mode	Default	Default from attempts	Valid programs	Correct programs	Default share	Hill_cc
kth smallest	heapify and pop	full sort		94	18	0.17	3.80
substring search	naive	naive		89	49	0.54	2.00

find duplicate	hash set	hash set		93	34	0.44	1.48
two sum	hash map	hash map		99	84	0.97	1.07
connected components	union find	union find		97	74	0.75	1.59
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end	greedy by end	yes	89	8	0.63	2.46
Fibonacci	matrix power	matrix power		96	44	0.76	1.78
topological order	Kahn	Kahn		99	88	0.98	1.06
merge intervals	sort and sweep	sort and sweep		89	65	1.00	1.00
first and last position	binary search	binary search		93	54	0.99	1.10
top-k frequent	heap	heap		86	22	0.62	1.80
longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP	quadratic DP		94	68	0.87	1.08

Present minor events: top-k frequent sort by count (6 of 22 correct), kth smallest heapify and pop (4 of 18), kth smallest quickselect (4 of 18), substring search KMP (9 of 49), connected components DFS (13 of 74), kth smallest size-k heap (3 of 18).

The contest does not resolve in Llama. Thirteen of 18 events passed the gate and 11 were gated and disagreeing, but only 2 had a winner by 0.10 nats (Table 102). One was the subtraction forecast on two sum, through its undefined forecast scored as uniform, because the ban split between sort and two pointers (42) and brute force (32). The other was association on kth smallest heapify and pop. No family advances; the preregistered branch is NO FAMILY ADVANCES, aimed but unresolved. The landing is aimed: the ladder and association each named the realised landing on 7 of 13 gated events, against a chance rate of about 0.27 (exact binomial $p = 0.033$ each); subtraction hit 4 of 12 ($p = 0.38$) and proximity 3 of 13 ($p = 0.71$). *(Correction, iteration 4: these hits were scored against a label this section did not define. Modal events were scored against the modal landing, but the six present minor events were scored against the survivor with the largest excess over the renormalised ban-free baseline. The ladder also nominated other on 3 of the 13 gated events, and on find duplicate both its nomination and the landing were other (50 of 94 attempts, 71 not banned; 2 correct). With other excluded as nominee and as landing, the ladder hits 6 of 13 (Poisson-binomial $p = 0.100$) and association 7 of 13 ($p = 0.032$), so only association is above chance. On the present minor events Llama returns to its default: union find 0.93, heap 0.72 and naive 0.73 of attempts not banned. Section 4.2.3.)* Five defaults resisted the ban itself (nonoverlapping intervals, topological order, merge intervals, first and last position, longest increasing subsequence; avoidance 0.04 to 0.30).

Table 102. Every Llama ban event (N = 100). s_X is the banned algorithm's share of attempts in the decision set before the ban; † marks a present minor event. Each family's top-1 is given with its mean log score per attempt not banned in parentheses; a forecast marked undefined is scored as uniform. Source: Llama bench experiment `README.md`, `results/c1_events.jsonl`.

Event	s_X	Avoidance	Gate	Attempts not banned	Modal landing	Subtraction	Ladder	Association	Proximity	Renormalised baseline	Winner (margin)	Hill_cc (correct programs)	Other / invalid
kth smallest, ban full sort	0.17	0.95	pass	87	quickselect	heapify and pop (-1.71)	other (-1.46)	quickselect (-1.40)	size-k heap (-1.66)	-1.64	none (0.06)	1.00 (15)	0.09 / 0.08
substring search, ban naive	0.54	0.79	pass	64	KMP	Rabin-Karp (-1.20)	KMP (-1.25)	KMP (-1.18)	built-in find (-1.83)	-1.20	none (0.02)	1.38 (20)	0.05 / 0.19

find duplicate, ban hash set	0.44	0.76	pass	71	other	other (-0.98)	other (-1.00)	Floyd cycle detection (-1.53)	sort and adjacent check (-1.37)	-1.02	none (0.02)	3.59 (7)	0.53 / 0.06
two sum, ban hash map	0.97	0.91	pass	86	sort and two pointers	undefined (-1.39)	other (-1.90)	sort and two pointers (-1.94)	brute force (-2.37)	-1.39	subtraction (0.51)	1.63 (34)	0.07 / 0.05
connected components, ban union find	0.75	0.82	pass	78	DFS	DFS (-1.00)	DFS (-0.80)	DFS (-0.98)	DFS (-0.98)	-0.98	none (0.18)	1.68 (42)	0.04 / 0.05
nonoverlapping intervals, ban greedy by end	0.63	0.29	fail	26	other	other (-0.89)	other (-0.97)	DP with bisect (-1.51)	memoised recursion (-1.59)	-0.85	none (0.08)	n/a (0)	0.21 / 0.11
Fibonacci, ban matrix power	0.76	0.79	pass	72	iteration	other (-1.13)	iteration (-1.10)	fast doubling (-2.31)	memoised recursion (-1.94)	-1.21	none (0.03)	1.72 (44)	0.13 / 0.09
topological order, ban Kahn	0.98	0.18	fail	17	DFS postorder	undefined (-1.39)	undefined (-1.39)	DFS postorder (-0.92)	source removal (-3.81)	-1.39	none (0.46)	1.00 (1)	0.04 / 0.04
merge intervals, ban sort and sweep	1.00	0.30	fail	25	other	undefined (-1.11)	undefined (-1.11)	union find (-3.13)	interval tree (-3.71)	-1.11	none (0.00)	n/a (0)	0.23 / 0.18
first and last position, ban binary search	0.99	0.04	fail	2	other	undefined (-1.11)	undefined (-1.11)	bisect module (-3.76)	bisect module (-3.76)	-1.11	none (0.00)	1.00 (1)	0.02 / 0.03
top-k frequent, ban heap	0.62	0.89	pass	84	sort by count	sort by count (-0.74)	sort by count (-0.68)	sort by count (-0.70)	sort by count (-0.70)	-0.66	none (0.02)	1.31 (13)	0.05 / 0.06
longest increasing subsequence, ban quadratic DP	0.87	0.23	fail	22	patience sorting	undefined (-1.10)	undefined (-1.10)	Fenwick tree (-2.56)	patience sorting (-1.02)	-0.83	none (0.08)	1.00 (8)	0.09 / 0.05
top-k frequent, ban sort by count †	0.36	0.82	pass	75	quickselect on counts	heap (-1.05)	heap (-1.02)	heap (-1.06)	bucket sort (-1.34)	-1.02	none (0.03)	1.19 (24)	0.09 / 0.09
kth smallest, ban heapify and pop †	0.33	0.88	pass	77	quickselect	other (-1.54)	full sort (-1.57)	quickselect (-1.33)	size-k heap (-1.81)	-1.57	association (0.21)	2.57 (27)	0.09 / 0.12
kth smallest, ban quickselect †	0.12	0.76	pass	71	full sort	full sort (-1.65)	full sort (-1.73)	full sort (-1.56)	size-k heap (-1.79)	-1.73	none (0.09)	2.12 (34)	0.10 / 0.06
substring search, ban KMP †	0.26	0.70	pass	66	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	other (-0.99)	naive (-1.01)	Rabin-Karp (-1.22)	naive (-1.01)	-1.01	none (0.01)	1.14 (34)	0.09 / 0.06
connected components, ban DFS †	0.25	0.89	pass	85	BFS	union find (-0.35)	union find (-0.34)	union find (-0.34)	BFS (-0.47)	-0.34	none (0.00)	1.15 (65)	0.02 / 0.04
kth smallest, ban size-k heap †	0.24	0.84	pass	78	full sort	heapify and pop (-1.68)	full sort (-1.72)	quickselect (-1.70)	heapify and pop (-1.88)	-1.72	none (0.02)	2.23 (27)	0.10 / 0.07

(Correction, iteration 4: the modal landing column of Table 102 is mislabelled for three present minor events, where it shows the largest-excess survivor used for scoring. The modal landings are heap (54 of 75 attempts not banned) under the ban of sort by count, naive (48 of 66) under the ban of KMP and union find (79 of 85) under the ban of DFS, against quickselect on counts (12), Boyer-Moore-Horspool (5) and BFS (4) shown. Both labels are given side by side in Section 4.2.3.)

The exact Wilcoxon tests over the 11 gated disagreeing events, Holm corrected, separate the ban-free families from proximity but not from association. Subtraction minus proximity (+0.345 nats [0.190, 0.633], Holm 0.0088) and ladder minus proximity (+0.306 [0.204, 0.513], Holm 0.0078) are rejected; subtraction minus association (+0.172 [-0.049, 0.606], $p = 0.52$) and ladder minus association (+0.133 [-0.056, 0.542], $p = 0.77$) are not. In Llama, code proximity is the worst forecast, and association, subtraction and the ladder cannot be told apart at this N, which is below the pooled floor of 16 events.

The verdict is fragile. Of ten preregistered sensitivity rows, three return substitution with association advancing on 3 wins: rescoring on correct programs only, the bf16-only decision set, and dropping the fourth template. Excluding the task whose default came from attempts and the tasks the label audit flagged leaves 5 disagreeing gated events and reads X specific but unaimed. The point mass forms, dropping co-vetoed survivors and dropping any other single template all keep NO FAMILY ADVANCES.

Signature vetoes rarely remove a Llama default either (Table 103). Only the heap of top-k frequent collapsed (0.02 once `(k` and `␣heapq` were both masked). Elsewhere the default re-emerged at 0.20 to 0.96 in the last persistent round; hash map (0.89), sort and sweep (0.88), Kahn and binary search (0.96) barely moved.

Table 103. Share of the banned algorithm among veto attempts per round (persistent, iterated arm; weighted counts for present minor events; ␣ marks a space in the n-grams). Source: Llama bench experiment `README.md`.

Event	Round-1 n-gram	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Note
kth smallest, ban full sort	`,`	0.20			co-vetoes every survivor
substring search, ban naive	`1):\n`	0.44	0.42	0.54	not carried by a small set of surface tokens; co-vetoes Rabin-Karp
find duplicate, ban hash set	`␣nums:\n␣␣␣␣␣␣␣`	0.38	0.26	0.26	not carried by surface tokens
two sum, ban hash map	`␣i]\n`	0.93	0.95	0.89	not carried by surface tokens
connected components, ban union find	`␣def␣find`	0.59	0.57	0.23	not carried by surface tokens
nonoverlapping intervals, ban greedy by end	`.sort`	0.60	0.50	0.36	not carried by surface tokens; co-vetoes DP with bisect
Fibonacci, ban matrix power	`␣matrix`	0.46	0.43	0.28	not carried by surface tokens
topological order, ban Kahn	`␣queue`	0.98	0.96	0.96	not carried by surface tokens
merge intervals, ban sort and sweep	`\ndef␣solve`	0.84	1.00	0.88	not carried by surface tokens
first and last position, ban binary search	`␣=␣0,`	0.98	0.96	0.96	not carried by surface tokens
top-k frequent, ban heap	`(k`	0.57	0.02		removed
longest increasing subsequence, ban quadratic DP	`[j]␣+`	0.85	0.83	0.80	not carried by surface tokens
top-k frequent, ban sort by count †	`␣[`	0.37	0.34	0.35	not carried by surface tokens; co-vetoes heap and quickselect on counts
kth smallest, ban heapify and pop †	`␣{}\n␣␣␣`	0.25	0.15		
kth smallest, ban quickselect †	`␣quick`	0.12			
substring search, ban KMP †	`␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣␣j`	0.26	0.24		

connected components, ban DFS †	`␣dfs`	0.17
kth smallest, ban size-k heap †	`.n`	0.09

Of the two events where the one-shot veto moved at least half of the banned algorithm's attempts, neither shared the ban's modal survivor within the template bootstrap null (0 of 2, against a preregistered bar of two thirds, quoted for reference only). The test that matters most for substitution is the present minor gain (Table 104): if a named ban only removes the minor algorithm, the associate's share under the ban should equal its share under the persistent veto of that algorithm. On two of six events the associate gains more under the named ban (kth smallest heapify and pop to quickselect, +0.25 [0.12, 0.37]; kth smallest quickselect to full sort, +0.24 [0.10, 0.36]); on substring search KMP the associate (Rabin-Karp) is less frequent under the ban (-0.08 [-0.17, -0.00]); on three it is unchanged. Naming the banned algorithm sometimes steers Llama toward its associate beyond what removing it does, but not consistently.

Table 104. Present minor events: the associate's share under the named ban against the persistent veto of the same algorithm (Newcombe 95% intervals [42]). Source: Llama bench experiment `README.md`.

Event	Associate	Ban share	Veto share	Baseline share	Ban minus veto
top-k frequent, ban sort by count	heap	0.59	0.63	0.62	-0.04 [-0.18, 0.10]
kth smallest, ban heapify and pop	quickselect	0.42	0.17	0.12	0.25 [0.12, 0.37]
kth smallest, ban quickselect	full sort	0.44	0.20	0.17	0.24 [0.10, 0.36]
substring search, ban KMP	Rabin-Karp	0.04	0.12	0.12	-0.08 [-0.17, -0.00]
connected components, ban DFS	union find	0.82	0.81	0.75	0.01 [-0.10, 0.12]
kth smallest, ban size-k heap	quickselect	0.22	0.18	0.12	0.04 [-0.08, 0.15]

Pushes. The nonce ban left the default near its baseline on most tasks. Matched-norm random directions moved the default substantially on a few tasks (Fibonacci matrix power 0.76 to 0.16 to 0.51; top-k frequent heap 0.62 to 0.39 to 0.56), and the novelty instruction lowered the default almost everywhere. The realised layer-21 displacement of the random pushes was about three times the ban's, because pushes at layers 11 to 20 propagate, so the ladder inputs are generous pushes. A second blind judge re-audited 187 ban outputs labelled other and called 8 (4%) the banned algorithm and 24 a catalogue survivor; other is never folded into avoidance.

The path task screen (descriptive, never pooled). On the iteration-2 Llama path tasks, the same ban-free families were scored against the Llama replication's existing ban landings, using that experiment's own prompt builders (10 of 10 prompts reproduced byte for byte) and labeller (Table 105). The vetoes fired (25 of 50 grid and 40 to 48 of 50 shortest path pass-1 samples) but BFS (0.52 to 0.58) and Dijkstra (0.78 to 0.82) re-emerged through other surface forms in every round. On the grid task all four families named DFS, the realised landing. On the shortest path task, the ban's large other share (37 of 100) was not reproduced by any veto round (8 of 50 other each); the novelty instruction came close (18 of 50 other).

Table 105. Path task screen in Llama. Source: Llama bench experiment `README.md`.

Task	Ban landing (Llama replication)	Modal	Subtraction	Ladder	Association	Proximity	Winner	Veto: banned share by round

Grid	DFS 63, BFS 29, other 6, A* 1, unit weight Dijkstra 1	DFS	DFS (-0.54)	DFS (-0.88)	DFS (-0.47)	DFS (-0.47)	none (0.00)	␣queue:\n␣␣␣␣␣␣␣: 0.56, 0.52, 0.58
Shortest path	Dijkstra 43, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 18, other 37, Floyd-Warshall 2	other	undefined (-1.59)	undefined (-1.59)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA (-1.79)	Floyd-Warshall (-2.81)	none (0.00)	␣continue: 0.82, 0.78, 0.80

Checks. Input integrity, hooks, prompts, sampler, scoring and veto tests passed; every committed file preceded the first ban sample; an independent rederivation matched the gate, landings, log scores, wins and branch, and a family permutation placebo advanced a family in 0.00 of 1,000 permutations; the exact Wilcoxon p values, Holm decisions and binomial tests were rederived without the project code. Not rederived: the sensitivity rows, the bootstrap intervals, the one-shot veto comparison, the present minor gain and the screen scores. GPU time was 0.98 hours of logged generation (about 1.8 hours with the GPU held), judge spend USD 0.48.

3.6 Bench route experiment: which internal route carries a ban, task by task (Qwen3-8B)

Why. Iteration 2 found on the two path tasks that the ban is carried mostly by the prompt states. The hypothesis update made that the second claim of the title account: if a ban only removes the default, the removal should be applied by the task specification states before the first generated token, with generated tokens reading the ban directly only where the one-shot veto does not suffice. This experiment measured the route in behaviour on the 12 bench tasks, with the iteration-2 engine.

Design. Qwen3-8B ran in bf16 under HF with common random numbers (one uniform per row and step, inverse CDF sampling) and cache splicing by position class, on one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU with batches of 40 rows of one shape class. Each slot ran seven kinds of arm. The full ban (a) and the token-length matched neutral twin (b) are the endpoints. The prompt route (c) splices the twin's condition segment with the ban's task specification and read position states; the direct route (d) splices the ban's condition segment with the twin's later states. The full knockout arm removes the condition span from the cache seen by generated tokens. A one-shot veto arm applies the signature veto of the default under the twin, and prefills force the default's opening or a neutral `def` line under the ban and the twin. N was 100 slots per arm (5 templates by 20), and 13,030 samples were labelled by the frozen bench labellers. Route fractions are defined on the default's share of attempts s as F_prompt = (s_b - s_c) / (s_b - s_a), F_direct = (s_b - s_d) / (s_b - s_a), the interaction I = 1 - F_prompt - F_direct, and the knockout fraction F_knockout = (s_b - s_knockout) / (s_b - s_a), where s_knockout is the default's share under the full knockout. The decision rule (prompt route at least two thirds, with the interval above one half; disconfirmed if the direct route reaches one third) was hash committed before any ban sample.

Only five bench bans take. Table 106 gives the default's share in every arm for all 12 tasks. The gate passed on kth smallest (avoidance 0.99), connected components (1.00), two sum (0.83), find duplicate (0.79) and merge intervals (0.59), the same five tasks as in the bench forecast experiment. The fourth template was again the weakest (pooled avoidance 0.19 against 0.42 to 0.62 for the others) and produced 29% of all ban failures.

Table 106. The default's share of attempts by arm (N attempted in parentheses), and the ban's

landing. Source: bench route experiment `results/shares.json`.

Task	Full ban (a)	Twin (b)	Prompt route (c)	Direct route (d)	Full knockout	One-shot veto	Ban landing (attempts off the default)
kth smallest	0.01 (100)	0.95 (100)	0.01 (100)	0.25 (100)	0.01 (100)	0.59 (100)	quickselect 70, size-k heap 28, heapify and pop 1
connected components	0.00 (100)	0.99 (100)	0.00 (100)	0.20 (100)	0.00 (100)	0.70 (20)	BFS 75, DFS 25
two sum	0.17 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.66 (100)	0.20 (100)	0.67 (100)	1.00 (100)	brute force 83
find duplicate	0.21 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.97 (100)	0.22 (100)	0.95 (100)	1.00 (100)	index marking 77, Floyd cycle detection 1, other 1
merge intervals	0.41 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.77 (100)	0.99 (100)	0.74 (100)	1.00 (69)	other 44, union find 15
substring search	0.58 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.89 (100)	1.00 (50)	1.00 (94)	KMP 18, built-in find 17, Boyer-Moore-Horspool 5, Rabin-Karp 2
top-k frequent	0.59 (100)	0.93 (100)	0.97 (100)	0.77 (100)	0.94 (50)	0.93 (100)	heap 30, quickselect on counts 10, other 1
Fibonacci	0.69 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.99 (100)	0.72 (100)	0.96 (50)	1.00 (100)	other 31
topological order	0.96 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (50)	1.00 (46)	DFS postorder 4
longest increasing subsequence	0.98 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (50)	1.00 (42)	other 1, patience sorting 1
first and last position	0.98 (100)	0.76 (100)	1.00 (100)	0.76 (100)	1.00 (50)	0.61 (62)	other 1, bisect module 1
nonoverlapping intervals	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (100)	1.00 (50)	1.00 (97)	none

(Added in iteration 4: the full-ban avoidance of merge intervals in Table 106 (0.59) includes 44 failing programs labelled other; its catalogue-only avoidance is 0.15, below the gate, so under catalogue-only avoidance the route analysis has four gated tasks. Section 4.2.4.)

The route is task dependent, and pooled it is not the prompt route. On the five gated tasks the mechanisms differ (Table 107). On kth smallest and connected components the information is redundant: the prompt route alone and the knockout (which removes direct reading) each reproduce the ban, and the direct route alone does most of it as well. On two sum and find duplicate the ban acts almost entirely through generated tokens reading the condition segment: the direct route arm reproduces the ban, while the prompt route and the knockout do not (find duplicate: 0 against 76 discordant slots between the full ban and the prompt route; exact McNemar p below 1e-6). On merge intervals neither route suffices alone. Pooled over the five tasks, the prompt route carries 0.61 and the direct route 0.74 (Table 108). The preregistered route claim is therefore disconfirmed under all three intervals: the direct route exceeds one third, and the prompt route falls below two thirds with a lower bound far under one half. The bootstrap probability that F_prompt is at most one half is 0.28, and that F_direct is at least one third, 0.99. Leaving one template out kept F_prompt between 0.55 and 0.66 and F_direct between 0.71 and 0.84; a Bayesian mixed logistic sensitivity gave 0.74 and 0.89.

Table 107. Route fractions on the gated bench tasks (template then slot bootstrap 95% intervals).

Source: bench route experiment `results/route.json`.

Task	F_prompt	F_direct	Interaction	F_knockout	Reading
kth smallest	1.00 [1.00, 1.00]	0.74 [0.36, 0.99]	-0.74	1.00	redundant: either route suffices
connected components	1.00 [1.00, 1.00]	0.80 [0.40, 1.00]	-0.80	1.00	redundant
two sum	0.41 [0.03, 0.82]	0.96 [0.80, 1.00]	-0.37	0.40	mostly direct
find duplicate	0.04 [0.00, 0.13]	0.99 [0.90, 1.05]	-0.03	0.06	direct only
merge intervals	0.39 [0.00, 0.73]	0.02 [0.00, 0.08]	0.59	0.44	superadditive: both needed

Table 108. Pooled route fractions over the five gated tasks (ratio of sums; hierarchical task, template and slot bootstrap with 10,000 replicates; the leave-one-task-out jackknife is primary because there are only five clusters). Source: bench route experiment `results/route.json`.

Quantity	Point	Jackknife 95% (primary)	Percentile 95%	BCa 95% [68]
F_prompt	0.611	[0.06, 1.17]	[0.23, 0.93]	[0.22, 0.93]
F_direct	0.744	[0.38, 1.11]	[0.42, 0.97]	[0.27, 0.94]
Interaction	-0.355	[-0.98, 0.27]	[-0.73, 0.14]	[-0.71, 0.17]
F_knockout	0.621	[0.08, 1.16]	[0.24, 0.93]	[0.24, 0.93]

(Correction, iteration 4: the superadditive class of Table 107 rests entirely on merge intervals, which is gated only through residue and has no route class under catalogue-only avoidance. Without it the pooled fractions are F_prompt 0.648 [-0.08, 1.38] and F_direct 0.865 [0.68, 1.05] (jackknife). The two pooled point estimates of Table 108 have overlapping jackknife intervals and a negative interaction, so the direct route carries more than the prompt route only in point estimate. The landing composition of every route arm is in Section 4.2.2: on connected components either route alone lands mostly on DFS, and BFS is chosen only when both routes act.)

[Figure fig_bench_route: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

An independent second draw with fresh uniforms (slots 20 to 39, arms a to d on the five gated tasks, N = 100 each) reproduced the picture. Pooled F_prompt was 0.64 [0.27, 0.94] and F_direct 0.74 [0.43, 0.94], per-task fractions moved by about 0.1 at most (find duplicate F_direct 0.99 then 0.93; two sum 0.96 then 0.93; merge intervals F_prompt 0.39 then 0.49), and the Spearman rank agreement between the draws was 0.89 and 0.90. The task differences are not sampling noise. A continuous companion readout (the teacher forced log probability of the default's opening up to its distinctive n-gram, under each arm) split the effect across both routes as behaviour does (pooled 0.40 prompt, 0.45 direct).

Veto sufficiency does not predict the route. The update predicted that the direct share would be small where the one-shot veto suffices and large where it does not. The frozen n-gram rule picked identifier or structural tokens with zero collateral (two sum `␣if␣complement`, find duplicate `␣set`, Fibonacci `()`), so the one-shot veto rarely changed the mechanism: veto avoidance V_t was 0.41 on kth smallest, 0.39 on first and last position, 0.30 on connected components and at most 0.07 elsewhere. The veto fired in 61% to 100% of rows, and the model renamed or retokenised (two sum: `if compliment in seen`) or broke the code (connected components: 80 of 100 invalid). Every task was classed in the second commit as needing a large direct route (V_t below 0.5, predicting F_direct of at least 0.25). Four of the five gated tasks hit; merge intervals missed with F_direct 0.02. The Spearman correlation between V_t and F_direct was -0.34, with a one-sided

permutation p of 0.30 over five points, which fails the rule. The test is inconclusive, and the comparison of the one-shot veto's landing with the ban's had no eligible task.

The ban is decided at the opening of the body. Forcing the default's own opening, up to its distinctive n-gram, undid the ban completely on every gated task (the share of the ban effect undone, P_open, 0.98 to 1.00), while forcing only a neutral `def solve(...):` line undid none of it (-0.12 to 0.01). The depth sweep (Table 109) localises this: the ban holds through the whole `def` line and gives way at the first content token of the default's body, which we call the first body token. On kth smallest, forcing the `def` line and its indentation (10 tokens) leaves the ban intact, and forcing one more token, `␣nums`, undoes it. Under common random numbers, arms a, c and d leave the twin's tokens at the first body token (median token 8 to 10 on kth smallest, two sum, find duplicate and connected components; 19 to 21 on merge intervals, whose shared `if not intervals` guard comes first). Once the first tokens of the default's body are on the page, the model continues the default; the ban is applied at the opening and not re-read in the body, as Qi et al. found for safety refusals [63].

Table 109. Share of the ban effect undone by forcing a prefix (P_open), by prefix: a neutral `def` line, or the default's modal program forced to 25%, 50% or 75% of its tokens or up to its distinctive n-gram (forced tokens in parentheses; N = 50 per cell, under the ban and the twin). Source: bench route experiment `README.md`, `results/replication.json`.

Task	Neutral `def` line	25% of the program	Up to the distinctive n-gram	50%	75%
kth smallest	-0.01 (9 tokens)	-0.01 (5: `def solve`)	0.98 (11: `def` line, indent, `␣nums`)	-0.01 (10: `def` line and indent)	1.00 (16)
find duplicate	-0.01 (7)	1.00 (10: `seen =`)	1.00 (11: `seen = set`)	1.00 (20)	1.00 (29)
two sum	0.01 (9)	1.00 (13: `seen = {}`)	1.00 (32)	1.00 (26)	1.00 (40)
connected components	0.00 (9)	1.00 (31, inside `find`)	1.00 (20: `def find`)	1.00 (62)	1.00 (92)
merge intervals	-0.12 (8)	1.00 (30: `intervals.sort(key)`)	1.00 (58)	1.00 (59)	1.00 (88)

[Figure fig_prefill_depth: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The path task screen. Under the iteration-2 twin prompts, every veto variant failed to move either path default: one-shot, persistent, iterated rounds with the re-emerged programs' new n-grams, and a veto of the import line itself. The share off the default was 0.00 on the grid task and at most 0.01 on the shortest path task, and the default re-emerged in 99% to 100% of attempts after each round. The committed prediction that the grid one-shot veto would not suffice hit; the prediction that the shortest path one-shot veto would suffice and land on Bellman-Ford/SPFA missed (V = 0). The iteration-2 ban landings recomputed exactly from raw rows (grid DFS 257 of 257; shortest path Bellman-Ford/SPFA 255 of 260). A ban moves these tasks; a surface veto does not.

Controls and checks. A placebo splice (one twin's condition segment with another twin's later states) moved the default's share by at most 0.04 on all six tasks where it ran, so splicing itself is inert; the knockout applied to the twin left the default at 1.00 on six tasks. GPU unit tests confirmed common random number determinism, splice identities (splicing a prompt with itself reproduces it in 100% of rows) and zero attention mass on the condition span under the knockout in all 36 layers. A reproduction of the iteration-2 shortest path arms gave banned shares of 0 of 20, 20 of 20, 3 of 20 and 19 of 20 for arms a to d, inside their pass bands. Two audit scripts rederived

every headline from raw rows with no mismatch, and shuffling arm labels within slots collapsed the mean gap between twin and ban from 0.83 to -0.001. A worker restart briefly ran three labelling workers on the same rows; duplicates were compacted to the last row per sample, which every reader used. GPU time was about 1.8 GPU hours, judge spend USD 0.105.

3.7 Locus experiment: a shared prohibition direction, a locus at generated tokens 1 to 8, the ban-attending heads, and SAE transfer (Qwen3-8B)

Why. Four questions about where a prohibition lives inside the model were open after iteration 2. Is there a task-general direction that carries the instruction to abandon the default, and does writing it into a neutral prompt work like a named ban (the causal test of the read position correlation, moved to the positions where the route test located the effect)? Is the within-ban choice of algorithm decodable at generated tokens 1 to 8 beyond the written text? Do the three heads that attend to the banned name matter? Do the Qwen-Scope base model SAEs [50] transfer to the instruct model under a criterion that does not penalise its lower clean cross-entropy? This experiment ran all four beside their controls under common random numbers, on the two path tasks and four bench tasks (kth smallest, substring search, find duplicate, two sum).

Design. The machine had a 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada, too small for bf16 weights, so every decoder linear layer was quantised at load time to 8-bit floating point with per-channel weight and per-token activation scales (embeddings, norms and the output head stayed bf16). A validation reproduced the iteration-2 shortest path arms (ban 2 of 20 Dijkstra, twin 20 of 20). The sampler coupled every arm exactly (identical uniforms in different rows give identical tokens at 20 rows per batch), and teacher forcing at batch 1 was bit exact. The shared prohibition direction v is the leave-one-task-out mean, over the 13 other tasks and all five templates, of the ban minus twin displacement at the task specification positions in blocks 12 to 23. The ADD arm wrote v into the neutral twin's prefill with the displacement targeted to alpha times the ban's own per-layer norm (alpha in {1, 2}, plus 0.5 on some tasks); the SUBTRACT arm projected v out of the ban prompt's prefill. Controls were three random directions with the same blocks, positions and norms, the twin, and the named ban ($N = 100$). In all, 5,500 samples followed the frozen design and 1,800 were exploratory. Decision rules were hash committed before sampling.

The direction exists, but adding it is no better than a random push. The leave-one-task-out v was reliable (split half cosine 0.95 to 0.99 across blocks 12 to 23). It was aligned with every held-out task's mean ban displacement (cosine 0.29 to 0.86 at block 18, against a 95th percentile of 0.03 for random directions), yet it carried only 2% to 6% of each position's own ban displacement. The preregistered test failed on every gated task (Table 110): ADD beat every random control on 0 of 5 gated tasks, and its avoidance was not above the maximum of the three random directions on 5 of 6 tasks. Where ADD moved behaviour it did not reproduce the ban. On kth smallest it landed on a size-k heap while the ban landed on quickselect (Jensen-Shannon divergence 0.52 against a permutation 95th percentile of 0.03; the committed forecast missed); on the shortest path task ADD and the ban both landed on Bellman-Ford/SPFA, but so did the random directions that moved it. The dose response was not monotone (shortest path avoidance 0.02, 0.35 and 0.12 at alpha 0.5, 1 and 2 over all slots), and the random edits grew more than v downstream (block 35: about 283 against 219 on the shortest path task), so a weak control does not explain the result. SUBTRACT never restored the default: pooled over the gated tasks the banned share changed by -0.026 [-0.07, 0.03] against a required $+0.3$, and on substring search, find duplicate and two sum removing v made the ban slightly stronger. On the path tasks neither plain nor affine subtraction exceeded a random edit of the same norm by the required 0.15, and that random edit was destructive (pass

rate 0.00).

Table 110. The shared prohibition direction against matched random directions (avoidance; slots 0 to 9 for ADD and random arms). Source: locus experiment `results/c2d.json`.

Task (default)	Named ban avoidance and landing	ADD, alpha 1 / 2	Random directions, alpha 1 (three seeds)	SUBTRACT: change in banned share [95% CI]
Shortest path (Dijkstra)	0.88, to Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	0.44 / 0.12	0.06, 0.50, 0.34	+0.07 [-0.02, 0.17]
Grid (BFS)	0.87, to DFS (all 13 BFS under the fourth template)	0.06 / 0.04	0.04, 0.00, 0.02	-0.05 [-0.11, 0.00]
kth smallest (full sort)	1.00, to quickselect 79, size-k heap 21	0.80 / 0.70	0.24, 0.70, 0.36	0.00 (no default to restore)
substring search (naive)	0.49, to KMP (fails the gate)	0.00 / 0.00	0.00, 0.00, 0.00	-0.12 [-0.22, -0.02]
find duplicate (hash set)	0.74, to index marking	0.00 / 0.00	0.00, 0.00, 0.00	-0.06 [-0.11, -0.02]
two sum (hash map)	0.80, to brute force	0.00 / 0.00	0.00, 0.10, 0.00	-0.09 [-0.15, -0.04]

(Added in iteration 4: Table 110 reports avoidance only and omits the three random directions at alpha 2. At alpha 2 they moved kth smallest (avoidance 0.96 at pass 0.84, correct quickselect 40, full sort 2; 0.52 at pass 0.98, correct quickselect 24, full sort 24, size-k heap 1; 0.30 at pass 0.98), find duplicate (0.86 at pass 0.82, correct sort and adjacent check 30, hash set 6, other 5) and two sum (0.47 and 0.36 at pass 1.00; correct hash map 26, brute force 23 and hash map 32, brute force 18), where ADD at alpha 2 moved nothing (0.00; on two sum at pass 0.48). On kth smallest and two sum these random directions are the cheapest diversity knob in the record of the run. Every alpha-2 row with its pass rate and composition is in Section 4.2.1.)

An exploratory run added 12 random directions (15 in all, alpha 1). On kth smallest ADD exceeded all 15 (0.80 against a maximum of 0.70 and a mean of 0.24) but landed on the wrong algorithm. On the shortest path task it sat at the 80th percentile (3 of 15 random directions moved it more; random mean 0.20), and on the grid task it was indistinguishable from random (0.06 against a mean of 0.07). Writing the shared component of the ban displacement into a neutral prompt is a direction-specific push on one task and a generic one elsewhere, and removing it is not necessary for the ban.

No within-ban locus at generated tokens 1 to 16 (Table 111). Decoders of default against other were fitted on batch-1 teacher forced states at blocks 8 to 28: the task specification mean, the read position, and generated tokens 1 to 8 and 16. Each was compared with 500 within-template permutations for the path tasks (200 for the bench tasks), taking the maximum over layers, and with three written text controls of matched or greater capacity (token one-hots, layer-0 embeddings reduced to 64 principal components, exact prefix match). No decoder passed the rule on any testable task. On the grid task and three bench tasks the class is set by the template: under the fourth template the model keeps the default in 20 of 20 bench samples and writes all 61 grid BFS programs, so every decoder (state, read position, text) reaches the template-only accuracy and none exceeds it. On the shortest path task the default is spread over templates (2, 0, 4, 3 and 3 of 20), and the choice is made inside the program. The first token at which the two classes diverge comes at a median of about 29 generated tokens, after the frozen window, and neither state nor text decodes the choice within tokens 1 to 16. The committed prediction of a fork at the import line

(tokens 3 to 5) was wrong for this sample. At batch 1, identical prefixes gave bit-identical states (maximum difference 0 over 89 to 95 pairs per position), so a state at position k is a function of the written prefix.

Table 111. Within-ban decoders of the algorithm written (default against other) on batch-1 teacher forced states. BA is balanced accuracy. Source: locus experiment `results/c2e.json`.

Task	Programs (default / other)	Largest state BA, tokens 1 to 8	Best of read position and text controls at token 8	Locus
Shortest path	100 (12 / 88)	0.53 rising to 0.63, never above the null 95th percentile (about 0.60 to 0.70)	0.55	none
Grid (with a fourth-template top-up)	160 (61 / 99)	0.904 at every k	0.904 (template only)	none
substring search	100 (51 / 49)	0.832 at every k	0.832 (template only)	none
find duplicate	100 (26 / 74)	0.88 at every k	0.88 (template only)	none
two sum	100 (20 / 80)	1.00 at every k	1.00 (template only)	none
kth smallest	100 (0 / 100)	not testable (no default under the ban)		

A secondary test pooled the archived ban pools of the route and readout experiments (200 rows per path task): the shortest path state reached balanced accuracy 0.78 to 0.79 at tokens 4 to 8 against 0.75 for the template-only decoder, a margin of 0.03 to 0.05, below the 0.10 rule. The first run on states extracted in 20-row batches, where 8-bit matrix tiling made identical prefixes differ by 4% to 8%, gave the same verdict on every task. An exploratory extension to tokens 24 to 96 found text matching or beating the state on the grid and substring search tasks. On the shortest path task the state curve was noisy (0.57, 0.66, 0.45, 0.50 and 0.75 at tokens 24, 32, 48, 64 and 96). Only token 96 cleared both the null (0.66) and the text controls (at most 0.60), a single unreplicated point with 12 minority samples.

The ban-attending heads are not special. Mean ablation of layer 21 head 17 and layer 26 heads 21 and 25 at generated positions under the full ban raised the grid BFS share from 0.12 (the ban, same slots) to 0.24. Every set of three random heads in the same layers raised it to 0.18, so the difference is $+0.06$ (90% interval [0.02, 0.12]; exact paired $p = 0.125$ against each random set), short of the required 0.15. The shortest path task was unchanged (-0.03 [-0.07, 0.03]). Almost all the grid movement sat in the fourth template, which carries every BFS under the ban: BFS went from 6 of 10 to 10 of 10 under the target heads and 9 of 10 under each random set. The fourth-template ban is fragile to any small perturbation of layers 21 and 26.

Under a fairer criterion the base SAEs pass, but they lose most of the ban displacement. The iteration-2 transfer test compared increases in cross-entropy, which penalises the instruct model for its lower clean cross-entropy (0.030 against 0.260 nats). This experiment scored each model on its own text in a two by two design (model by text source, 100 sequences each) by the fraction of cross-entropy recovered relative to zero ablation, FR_zero (Table 112). The frozen rule, FR_zero of the instruct model on its own text at least 0.9 times the base model's, passed at layers 15, 20 and 27. As the plan had computed, the zero-ablation denominator of 12 to 15 nats makes this rule lenient. A placebo that swaps the SAE and zero-ablation cross-entropy per sequence drives FR_zero to about 0, yet still passes the 0.9 rule at layer 20; the values themselves (about 0.99, against about 0 on the placebo) carry the information. Stricter companions: the fraction recovered relative to mean ablation (FR_mean) passed the same rule at all three layers; the ratio of cross-entropy

increases on own text (instruct over base) was 1.68, 1.30 and 0.76 at layers 15, 20 and 27 (iteration 2, one shared corpus in bf16: 3.29, 1.95, 1.59). The task-relevant test fails: the SAE reconstructions keep only about a third of the direction of the ban minus twin displacement at the task specification positions (cosine 0.27, 0.30 and 0.32 at layers 15, 20 and 27; norm ratio 0.65 to 0.79), so what the ban changes in the residual stream is largely lost in reconstruction error. The passing fraction recovered agrees with the finding of Kissane and colleagues that base model SAEs usually transfer to chat models; the displacement test, which measures what matters for a ban, is what fails, and latent-level claims about the ban should therefore not rest on these SAEs.

Table 112. Qwen-Scope SAEs spliced into each model (8-bit linears) on each text source: FR_zero / FR_mean / increase in cross-entropy (nats) / KL(clean, SAE) / fraction of variance unexplained. Source: locus experiment `results/sae_transfer.json`.

Model / text	Clean cross-entropy	Layer 15	Layer 20	Layer 27
instruct / own text	0.032	0.9890 / 0.984 / 0.168 / 0.171 / 0.365	0.9903 / 0.985 / 0.169 / 0.175 / 0.096	0.9939 / 0.991 / 0.095 / 0.097 / 0.156
base / own text	0.926	0.9928 / 0.988 / 0.100 / 0.102 / 0.294	0.9906 / 0.986 / 0.130 / 0.134 / 0.113	0.9907 / 0.985 / 0.125 / 0.127 / 0.228
instruct / base text	1.861	1.0072 / 1.010 / -0.099 / 0.181 / 0.358	1.0066 / 1.010 / -0.104 / 0.220 / 0.098	1.0170 / 1.026 / -0.245 / 0.169 / 0.156
base / instruct text	0.251	0.9966 / 0.994 / 0.051 / 0.049 / 0.287	0.9949 / 0.992 / 0.075 / 0.075 / 0.281	0.9961 / 0.994 / 0.054 / 0.057 / 0.334

The instruct model on base text has a negative increase (the base SAE lowers its cross-entropy, most at layer 27, from 1.86 to 1.62 nats), consistent with the SAE pulling instruct activations toward base ones. Identity splices reproduced the clean cross-entropy, a zero splice at layer 15 gave 13.1 and 12.3 nats, and the instruct fraction of variance unexplained matched iteration 2 (0.365 against 0.366 at layer 15). As a readout, the latents never beat the difference-in-means direction: over 63 cells (6 tasks, 3 layers, a prohibition-present readout at the task specification mean and a default-plan readout at tokens 1 to 3), a top-1 or top-20 latent beat difference-in-means beyond its interval in 1 cell, a trivial one where every readout is at ceiling, as AxBench found [34].

Geometry of early generated states (descriptive). At the mean of generated tokens 1 to 3 and at token 16 (blocks 20 and 23), the k-nearest-neighbour graphs ($k = 10$) over all arms were fragmented (100 to 440 components for 800 to 1,100 points), because early states are fixed by shared boilerplate (the code fence and the `solve` signature) and many points coincide. No cloud had a persistent loop beyond its coordinate permutation null. These arms produced no bidirectional BFS, A* or greedy programs, so the BFS and bidirectional BFS neighbourhood of the ban list experiment could not be re-examined here.

Table 113. Committed predictions of the locus experiment and their outcomes. Source: locus experiment `predictions/commit1.json`, `README.md`.

Prediction	Outcome
ADD (alpha 1 or 2) beats every random control on at least two thirds of gated tasks and lands on the ban's modal survivor	no: 0 of 5 gated tasks
SUBTRACT raises the banned share by at least 0.3	no: pooled -0.026 [-0.07, 0.03]
No locus; state and text rise together at the first divergent token; the shortest path fork is at the import line (tokens 3 to 5)	no locus: yes; fork position: no (median about 29 tokens)
Head ablation raises the grid banned share by at least 0.15 over random heads; shortest path unchanged	grid no (+0.06); shortest path unchanged yes (-0.03)

The SAEs pass the frozen transfer rule, FR_zero about 0.98 to 0.995 for both models	pass; FR_zero instruct 0.989 to 0.994, base 0.991 to 0.993

Checks. An independent recomputation reproduced every arm share; shuffling arm labels within slots erased the ADD and head contrasts; the hash chain had no breaks and both commits preceded their first samples. A separate script with no shared code (exact McNemar by enumeration, an sklearn decoder) matched the pooled SUBTRACT change, the ADD pass count, the head deltas, FR_zero and the validation counts; its shortest path decoder at token 8 gave 0.638 against the frozen null of 0.695. Blind judge spend was USD 0.22.

3.8 Reach experiment: how far bans and token vetoes push, and what the long-form novelty instruction produces (Qwen3-8B)

Why. The update's third claim was that prompts move the model exactly one rung. This experiment asked three things. First, do cumulative token vetoes, an operation the model cannot ignore, reach algorithms that prompt bans cannot? We call this the *token walk*: veto the default's distinctive n-gram, then the next landing's, and so on, up to five algorithms. Second, does a ban that leaves exactly one survivor get that survivor written whenever the model can write it on request? We call the share of programs implementing the survivor *will*, and the share of forced programs labelled as the requested algorithm and correct *can*. Third, does the request's own long-form novelty instruction produce a correct novel algorithm? Rungs are numbered by the walk: rung 1 is the default, rung 2 is the walk's first landing (or, where the walk stalled, a flagged fallback committed in advance), and every other catalogue algorithm is at rung 3 or more. Six tasks ran: the two path tasks in bf16, and kth smallest, substring search, find duplicate and connected components on the official 8-bit checkpoint at which their iteration-2 references were made. Every mask, forecast and protocol was hash committed before the samples it governs.

The token walk stalls at the default (Table 114). The persistent veto, implemented as a vLLM logits processor, was exact: no banned token sequence occurred in any of 1,450 vetoed generations. The algorithm came back anyway. On the grid task `current_row` and `current_col` replaced `r, c` in 63% of re-emerged BFS programs (7% in references), and on the shortest path task `current_distinct` and `d` replaced `current_dist`. Vetoed strings also leaked through non-canonical spellings, in up to 0.86 of samples on connected components and 0.80 on find duplicate at step 2. The grid code degenerated into near-miss syntax (`queue popleft()`, 66% to 86% invalid). Imports and calls barely changed: the rerouting is lexical, not algorithmic. Only find duplicate moved one rung, to sort and adjacent check, the same single-rung move that prompt bans produce. A sham veto of an algorithm-generic n-gram of matched length and presence kept the default: grid 50 of 50 (`␣start␣==␣goal:\n`), shortest path 50 of 50 (`␣u,␣v,␣w`), substring search 49 of 50 (`␣len`) and connected components 44 of 44 valid (`␣range`). The distinctive veto cut correctness where the sham did not (shortest path pass rate 0.41 against 1.00, Newcombe difference 0.59 [0.43, 0.72]; grid 0.76 against 0.96). A fixed veto of the distinctive n-grams of BFS, DFS, IDDFS and A* at once, the request's top-five prohibition asked as an operation, left BFS 13, DFS 2 and 35 invalid programs on the grid task after two extra rounds; the prompt version gave avoidance 0.00 (Section 2.6). Neither knob reaches the rest of the catalogue.

Table 114. The token walk under the neutral twins (no ban text; N = 50 per round, 10 per template; ␣ marks a space in the n-grams). Source: reach experiment `results/walk.json`, `README.md`.

Task	Step 0 (no veto)	Vetoed n-grams, by round	Final round of the last step	Status

Grid (bf16)	BFS 50	`␣c,␣path␣=␣queue.p`, then `␣queue.append(start`, then `None␣for`	BFS 6, DFS 1, invalid 43	stalled at step 1
Shortest path (bf16)	Dijkstra 50	`␣heap␣=␣[(0,␣s`, then `␣current_dist,`, then `␣dist[u]:\n`	Dijkstra 27, invalid 23 (pass 0.30)	stalled at step 1
kth smallest (8-bit)	full sort 45, quickselect 5	`␣nums.sort`, then `_sorted`, then `␣sorted(nums`	full sort 23, counting sort 10, quickselect 6, invalid 10	stalled at step 1
substring search (8-bit)	naive 50	`+len`, then `[i:i␣+`, then a leak span	naive 50	stalled at step 1
find duplicate (8-bit)	hash set 50	`␣set`, `␣seen` and leak spans; then, at rung 2 (sort and adjacent check, 37 of 50), `.sort` and 5 leak spans	sort and adjacent check 20, other 13, hash set 10	stalled at step 2
connected components (8-bit)	union find 47, DFS 3	`␣parent` and 8 leak spans (`(parent`, `parents`, `.parent`, tab-indented `parent`, and others)	union find 44, DFS 6	stalled at step 1

Prompts reach further than one rung on two tasks (Tables 115 and 116). The preregistered reach claim was that will is at most 0.10 at every rung of 3 or more where can is at least 0.7, and it is disconfirmed by a will of 0.30 or more. It was disconfirmed on connected components, where the list that leaves only BFS got BFS 50 of 50, and on kth smallest, where the list that leaves only quickselect got quickselect 50 of 50. Both cells were placed at rung 3 or more through the flagged fallback, because the walk stalled at step 1 and the fallback set the second rung (counting sort on kth smallest, DFS on connected components). A post hoc sensitivity that sets the second rung to the association answer keeps connected components disconfirming (association says DFS, so BFS stays at rung 3 or more) and moves quickselect to rung 2. On connected components the two traversals are interchangeable alternatives (BFS 50 of 50 when only BFS is allowed, DFS 49 of 50 when only DFS is), so a single chain of rungs does not describe the repertoire. The claim was confirmed on the shortest path task (Floyd-Warshall, from Section 2.6), on two kth smallest cells and on find duplicate's binary search on values; find duplicate's Floyd cycle detection reached 0.14; substring search had no rung of 3 or more with can of at least 0.7.

Table 115. Reach cells: rungs of 3 or more with can of at least 0.7. Source: reach experiment `results/c3.json`.

Cell	Rung	Can	Will (N = 50) [95% CI]	Verdict
Shortest path, Floyd-Warshall (Section 2.6, not rerun)	3 or more	1.00	0.00 [0.00, 0.04]	confirm
kth smallest, quickselect	3 or more (fallback)	0.95	1.00 [0.93, 1.00]	disconfirm
kth smallest, size-k heap	3 or more	0.75	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	confirm
kth smallest, heapify and pop	3 or more	0.70	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	confirm
find duplicate, binary search on values	3 or more	0.78	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	confirm
find duplicate, Floyd cycle detection	3 or more	0.70	0.14 [0.07, 0.26]	neither
connected components, BFS	3 or more (fallback)	1.00	1.00 [0.93, 1.00]	disconfirm

Table 116. Every ban that leaves one survivor on the bench tasks (N = 50; disguise is the share of banned-mechanism programs that name none of the banned algorithms). Source: reach experiment `results/reach_events.jsonl`.

Task	Only allowed algorithm	Labels of attempted programs	Will [95% CI]	Pass rate	Disguise rate
kth smallest	full sort	quickselect 50	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.94	0.04
kth smallest	quickselect	quickselect 50	1.00 [0.93, 1.00]	0.98	n/a
kth smallest	size-k heap	quickselect 50	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.90	0.08
kth smallest	counting sort	quickselect 44, other 6	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	1.00	0.09
kth smallest	heapify and pop	quickselect 50	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.94	0.00
substring search	naive	naive 50	1.00 [0.93, 1.00]	1.00	n/a
substring search	KMP	naive 37, KMP 13	0.26 [0.16, 0.40]	0.98	1.00
substring search	Rabin-Karp	naive 36, KMP 8, Rabin-Karp 5, Boyer-Moore-Horspool 1	0.10 [0.04, 0.21]	0.92	0.76
substring search	built-in find	naive 49, KMP 1	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.98	0.92
substring search	Z algorithm	naive 46, KMP 3, Boyer-Moore-Horspool 1	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.96	0.92
find duplicate	hash set	hash set 43, index marking 4, Floyd cycle detection 3	0.86 [0.74, 0.93]	0.88	0.57
find duplicate	binary search on values	index marking 40, hash set 10	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.40	1.00
find duplicate	Floyd cycle detection	index marking 34, hash set 9, Floyd cycle detection 7	0.14 [0.07, 0.26]	0.38	1.00
find duplicate	sort and adjacent check	index marking 33, hash set 11, Floyd cycle detection 3, other 1, binary search on values 1, sort and adjacent check 1	0.02 [0.00, 0.10]	0.36	0.96
connected components	BFS	BFS 50	1.00 [0.93, 1.00]	1.00	n/a

connected components	DFS	DFS 49, union find 1	0.98 [0.90, 1.00]	0.98	1.00
connected components	union find	union find 47, DFS 3	0.94 [0.84, 0.98]	1.00	0.67

Quickselect is kth smallest's universal answer to a ban list: every list that bans the full sort yields quickselect in 44 to 50 of 50 programs, including the lists that ban quickselect itself (only size-k heap allowed, only heapify and pop allowed: 50 of 50 quickselect, disguised in 0% to 8%). The sanity check of the list that leaves only the default gave will 1.00 on substring search, 0.86 on find duplicate and 0.94 on connected components, but 0.00 on kth smallest. There the prompt banned the size-k heap, heapify and pop, quickselect, median of medians and counting sort, and all 50 programs implemented quickselect, 48 of them in a function named `quickselect`, while full sort was 45 of 50 under the twin. This is the starkest priming by a negative constraint in the run [7, 53]. Forced can underestimates some algorithms: find duplicate's index marking has a forced adherence of 0.03, yet the model wrote it in 34 to 40 of 50 programs under lists that forbid it, always disguised. The preregistered list independence test asks whether the default's share among default and second-rung programs is the same across lists that ban both. It failed on substring search: 0.82 under the Rabin-Karp list against 0.98 under the built-in list (permutation chi-squared $p = 0.033$; largest difference 0.16 [0.04, 0.30]; placebos with shuffled membership gave $p = 0.61$, 0.56 and 0.06). It was descriptive on find duplicate and not testable on kth smallest and connected components.

Two-step bans of the default and its second rung (N = 100) split the tasks (Table 117). On the path tasks and substring search they failed (compliance 0.02, 0.01 and 0.14, with snap-back to the default on substring search), replicating iteration 1; on kth smallest, find duplicate and connected components they were obeyed (1.00, 0.96 and 1.00). The committed forecasts hit find duplicate (the second walk landing, index marking), kth smallest and connected components (association: quickselect and BFS) and substring search (snap-back).

Table 117. Two-step bans of the default and its second rung (N = 100; labels of attempted programs not banned). Source: reach experiment `results/reach_events.jsonl`, `README.md`.

Task	Banned	Compliance	Attempted programs (banned mechanisms included)
Grid	BFS, DFS	0.02 [0.01, 0.07]	DFS 82, BFS 16, unit weight Dijkstra 1, other 1
Shortest path	Dijkstra, Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.01	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 67, Dijkstra 32, other 1
kth smallest	full sort, counting sort	1.00	quickselect 63, size-k heap 37
substring search	naive, KMP	0.14	naive 74, Rabin-Karp 9, built-in find 2, Boyer-Moore-Horspool 2, other 1 (the rest KMP)
find duplicate	hash set, sort and adjacent check	0.96	index marking 52, Floyd cycle detection 42, other 2 (the rest banned)
connected components	union find, DFS	1.00	BFS 100

The long-form novelty instruction produces claims of novelty, not new algorithms (Table 118). The request contains two long-form novelty instructions, which we call the first long-form instruction (asking the model to make a new algorithm) and the second long-form instruction

(asking for a fully novel algorithm never seen before); each asks for a design rationale of about 2,000 words before the code. They were run with thinking off (N = 25 to 50 per cell) and on (N = 10 per prompt and task, 16k thinking cap). All 100 thinking traces completed, at 4.1k to 12.4k thinking tokens. Of 574 outputs with a claim record, 484 (84%) claimed a new algorithm. Of those, 189 (39%) contained no code at all, only a rationale of 1,300 to 1,700 words, and 220 of the 295 with code (75%) were catalogue algorithms by the mechanism labeller, under names that modify a catalogue algorithm, such as a modified Bellman-Ford, a BFS with dynamic programming, or an optimised Dijkstra with early termination. The instructions do diversify the output (correct-only Hill numbers of 1.8 to 4.5 in the thinking-off cells, against a collapsed baseline), at a cost in correctness (pass rates of 0.33 to 0.44 on the grid task and 0.32 to 0.37 on find duplicate). With thinking on, the code stayed in the catalogue (grid mostly DFS, 13 of 20; shortest path Bellman-Ford/SPFA, Dijkstra and Floyd-Warshall only; kth smallest counting sort 13 of 20; substring search naive 14 of 20; find duplicate off-catalogue 11 of 20, all failing arithmetic tricks that assume one duplicate). A bf16 against 8-bit cross-check on the shortest path task under the first instruction gave a label composition Jensen-Shannon divergence of 0.033 bits against a null 95th percentile of 0.068 ($p = 0.35$).

Table 118. Long-form novelty instructions: composition of outputs per cell (first and second long-form instructions as defined above). Source: reach experiment `results/longform.json`, `README.md`.

Cell	N	Default	Other catalogue	Off catalogue	Invalid or no code	Correct
kth smallest, first, thinking off (8-bit)	50	3	17	12	18	25
kth smallest, first, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	7	1	2	8
kth smallest, second, thinking off (8-bit)	50	0	12	8	30	15
kth smallest, second, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	9	0	1	8
substring search, first, thinking off (8-bit)	50	27	7	1	15	32
substring search, first, thinking on (8-bit)	10	7	3	0	0	10
substring search, second, thinking off (8-bit)	50	10	8	4	28	13
substring search, second, thinking on (8-bit)	10	7	1	0	2	8
find duplicate, first, thinking off (8-bit)	50	5	13	17	15	13
find duplicate, first, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	4	5	1	4
find duplicate, second, thinking off (8-bit)	50	4	14	7	25	8
find duplicate, second, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	3	6	1	3
Grid, first, thinking off (bf16)	25	3	12	1	9	7
Grid, first, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	8	0	2	3
Grid, second, thinking off (bf16)	25	3	3	2	17	3
Grid, second, thinking on (8-bit)	10	0	7	2	1	3
Shortest path, first, thinking off (bf16)	50	17	20	3	10	35
Shortest path, first, thinking off (8-bit)	50	18	12	4	16	29

Shortest path, first, thinking on (8-bit)	10 2	6	0	2	8
Shortest path, second, thinking off (bf16)	25 6	6	5	8	9
Shortest path, second, thinking on (8-bit)	10 6	4	0	0	9

No novel algorithm in any cell. Every correct program outside the catalogue from every arm of this experiment went through an audit: 38 correct programs (23 from the long-form cells, 10 from the walk, 5 from the lists) plus 15 seeded failing ones. Two blind judges (gemini-2.5-flash-lite and gpt-4.1-mini; each passed a 6-program control gate at 5 of 6 after a prompt fix) compared each program with its three nearest known solutions from the declared dataset's 472 human and textbook programs and its three nearest catalogue references, and the executor read each one and ran it on three extra random inputs. The 38 correct programs were 30 labeller misses (mostly counting sort on kth smallest written with a dictionary or Counter), 7 catalogue variants (counting plus binary search on cumulative counts; a last-in-first-out label correcting search on the shortest path task) and 1 degenerate quadratic brute force. Judge A called 10 programs novel and judge B none (kappa 0.27); the manual pass found 5 of those 10 degenerate (XOR or sum tricks, broken loops), 3 labeller misses and 2 catalogue variants. The exact one-sided 95% upper bound on the novel rate is 0.058 per cell of 50, 0.113 per cell of 25 and 0.26 per thinking-on cell of 10. Together with the record audit (0 of 78), the run's direct answer to the novelty question is that no instruction or knob produced a correct algorithm outside the catalogue and its known variants.

Deviations and checks. Distinctive n-grams had to be lexical (a veto of an indentation-tailed n-gram was bypassed by re-indenting in 20 of 20 unit tests), and shams could not be constructed for kth smallest and find duplicate. The analysis code was edited after its hash was committed (corrected compositions, a post hoc sensitivity, a claim mechanism check); an unchanged rederivation script reproduced every preregistered number from raw rows with no mismatch. Dropped: placement of the walk landings on the manifold, the thinking-on temperature sweep, and extending the path task thinking cells to $N = 25$. Judge spend was USD 0.49.

3.9 Comparisons across this iteration's experiments

The same modal bench ban, drawn three times in Qwen3-8B and once in Llama. Three Qwen3-8B artifacts sampled the modal bench bans with the five frozen templates and 20 samples each, on different engines: vLLM in bf16 (bench forecast experiment), HF in bf16 with common random numbers (bench route experiment, full ban arm) and HF with 8-bit linears (locus experiment, four bench tasks). Table 119 sets them side by side with Llama. With the wording fixed, avoidance replicates within a few points and the landing replicates in kind. The same five tasks pass the gate in both artifacts that ran all twelve. Every Qwen3-8B draw sends kth smallest to quickselect and size-k heap, two sum to brute force, find duplicate to index marking, connected components to BFS, and merge intervals to a failing merge without sorting. Llama lands elsewhere on two of the shared tasks (two sum to sort and two pointers, connected components to DFS), on both of which Llama's own association answer matches its landing.

Table 119. The modal bench bans across draws (avoidance; landing among attempts off the default). Sources: bench forecast experiment `results/c1_events.jsonl`; bench route experiment `results/shares.json`; locus experiment `README.md`; Llama bench experiment `README.md`.

Task	Qwen3-8B, vLLM bf16	Qwen3-8B, HF bf16 (full ban arm)	Qwen3-8B, HF 8-bit linears	Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, vLLM bf16

kth smallest	0.97: quickselect 59, size-k heap 38	0.99: quickselect 70, size-k heap 28, heapify and pop 1	1.00: quickselect 79, size-k heap 21	0.95: quickselect (modal of 87)
two sum	0.86: brute force 86	0.83: brute force 83	0.80: brute force	0.91: sort and two pointers 42, brute force 32
find duplicate	0.79: index marking 73, Floyd 5, sort and adjacent check 1	0.79: index marking 77, Floyd 1, other 1	0.74: index marking	0.76: other (0.53 of attempts)
connected components	1.00: BFS 83, DFS 17	1.00: BFS 75, DFS 25	not run	0.82: DFS (modal of 78)
merge intervals	0.58: other 44, union find 14	0.59: other 44, union find 15	not run	0.30 (fails the gate)
substring search	0.40: KMP 21, built-in find 16, Rabin-Karp 2, Z algorithm 1	0.42: KMP 18, built-in find 17, Boyer-Moore-Horspool 5, Rabin-Karp 2	0.49: KMP	0.79: KMP (modal of 64)
top-k frequent	0.48	0.41	not run	0.89: sort by count
Fibonacci	0.34	0.31	not run	0.79: iteration
topological order	0.08	0.04	not run	0.18
first and last position	0.03	0.02	not run	0.04
longest increasing subsequence	0.02	0.02	not run	0.23
nonoverlapping intervals	0.00	0.00	not run	0.29

One wording, everywhere. The fourth template of Table 40, which states only that X is not allowed here, is the weakest wording in every artifact that measured it. In the bench forecast experiment it accounted for 197 of 240 banned programs, against 85 to 135 for the other templates. In the bench route experiment its pooled avoidance was 0.19, against 0.42 to 0.62, and it produced 29% of all ban failures. In the exposure template arm its mean avoidance was 0.81, against 0.93 to 0.96. In the locus experiment it kept the default in 20 of 20 bench samples and carried all 61 grid BFS programs under the ban, which is why every within-ban decoder there reduced to a template decoder. In Llama, dropping the fourth template alone flips the frozen branch from no family advancing to substitution. Wording is the largest measured source of variance in compliance, and any analysis that pools templates without modelling them pools different experiments.

Signature vetoes, five times. Every artifact that vetoed a default's distinctive n-gram found the default carried by more than its surface tokens. The default survived every round on 9 of 12 bench tasks in the bench forecast experiment, and Y re-emerged after three rounds for 25 of 33 shown algorithms in the exposure experiment. Only one Llama default (the heap of top-k frequent) was removed, the one-shot veto's avoidance was at most 0.41 in the bench route experiment, and the token walk stalled on all six tasks of the reach experiment although the veto was exact. On both path tasks no veto variant moved the default at all, in Qwen3-8B or in Llama, while a single prompt ban moves them by about 85 points. The subtraction forecast was therefore undefined on most events, and the test of whether a ban-free veto reproduces a ban's landing was undetermined everywhere it was planned.

Three forecast contests. Table 120 summarises the contests that decide the title claim, each under

the same frozen rule. On the Qwen3-8B modal bans no family's forecast beats uniform by a decisive margin, and in neither model does a family advance once undefined forecasts are not counted as wins. On the exposure bans, where the default is still available, the ladder (that is, the default) wins: snap-back. Association is never better than the ban-free families in Qwen3-8B, and in Llama it ties them.

Table 120. The three forecast contests of iteration 3 (gated events; top-1 hit rates against the realised modal landing). Sources: bench forecast, exposure and Llama bench experiments.

Contest	Gated events (disagreeing)	Frozen branch	Wins by 0.10 nats	Top-1 hit rates	Paired tests
Qwen3-8B modal bench bans	5 (5)	SUBTRACTION/ LADDER, ladder advancing; NO FAMILY ADVANCES if undefined forecasts do not count as wins	ladder 3 (2 as uniform), proximity 2	ladder 1 of 5 and association 1 of 5 (both kth smallest), proximity 1 of 5 (two sum), subtraction 0 of 5	not run (5 events); mean log score minus uniform: ladder +0.06, subtraction -0.69, proximity -1.53, association -1.78
Qwen3-8B exposure bans, named	31 (30)	SUBTRACTION/ LADDER, ladder advancing	ladder 7, subtraction 2, association 2, proximity 0	ladder 0.77, proximity 0.61, association 0.45, subtraction 0.36	ladder minus association +1.29 nats [0.10, 2.38], Holm 0.081; subtraction minus association +1.02 [0.35, 1.56], Holm 0.081
Llama modal and present minor bench bans	13 (11)	NO FAMILY ADVANCES, aimed but unresolved	subtraction 1 (as uniform), association 1	ladder 7 of 13, association 7 of 13 (binomial p 0.033 each), subtraction 4 of 12, proximity 3 of 13	both ban-free families beat proximity (Holm 0.0088 and 0.0078); neither separates from association (p 0.52 and 0.77)

(Correction, iteration 4: the top-1 rates of Table 120 use three different rules for undefined forecasts: a miss in the bench contest, fractional tie credit in the exposure contest and a dropped event in the Llama contest. Defined-only rates with the number of defined events are in Section 4.2.6. The exposure subtraction rate of 0.36 is tie credit; where defined (4 of 33 shown algorithms) subtraction named the landing every time. The figure below now plots the defined-only rates.)

[Figure fig_forecast_hits: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

3.10 What iteration 3 established, what it ruled out, and what it abandoned

Everything below is still one model per contest, at most 31 gated events per contest, and labels from labellers that passed their gates; the bench is memorised LeetCode material, and the path tasks are a screen that is never pooled.

Established.

1. *The likelihood substitution test of iteration 2 cannot decide the title claim.* Its gain and residual argmax hit the realised landing in 0 of 17 Qwen3-8B single bans, against 14 of 17 for the

implied mass. No row keeps three estimable survivors, the bootstrap variance of the mean gain is 2.7 times the noise term it subtracted, and a decision on mass would need about 50 programs per algorithm at the lower bound and 129 Qwen3-8B or 43 Llama events. Whether the gains are pure subtraction, whether their specific part is aimed, and whether the generic profiles form a ladder are all undetectable with that instrument.

2. *Shown a correct program of a non-default algorithm and told not to use it, Qwen3-8B snaps back to its default.* The default's share of attempts rises from 0.05 under the copy twin to 0.72 under the named ban and 0.82 under the unnamed one. The modal replacement is the default in 24 of 31 gated events, and the ladder forecast wins the frozen contest (7 wins; top-1 0.77). Naming the banned algorithm adds little beyond asking for something else (same modal replacement for 0.88 of Y). *(Correction, iteration 4: the frozen counting rule advances some family in 85% of no-information simulations and in 100% of label-permutation placebo draws (the ladder in 43%), and no paired test survives Holm on the named events, so the 7 wins of the ladder are weak evidence. Wording also changes the landing: under templates one to four the default is modal for 13 of 19 priority algorithms, against 15 of 19 under the fifth, and the replacement flips to the associate for the size-k heap and the Z algorithm. Snap-back rests on one wording. It replicates in the present minor bans of Llama, which return to the default in 0.72 to 0.93 of attempts not banned; Section 4.2.3.)*
3. *Where the default is not available, the landing is specific to the task and mostly unforeseen.* On the five gated Qwen3-8B modal bench bans, no ban-free or association forecast beats uniform on average, and three of five landings (index marking, BFS, a failing merge without sorting) were named by no family. In Llama the landing is predictable above chance (ladder and association 7 of 13 each), but the families do not separate. *(Correction, iteration 4: the merge intervals landing is residue, failing programs labelled other (29 coverage arrays, 12 unsorted sweeps, 3 others), and that event passes the gate only through them (catalogue-only avoidance 0.14). In Llama, with other excluded, association hits 7 of 13 ($p = 0.032$) and the ladder 6 of 13 ($p = 0.100$), so only association is above chance.)*
4. *A ban's route is task dependent.* On the bench, pooled over five gated tasks, generated tokens reading the ban carry 0.74 of the effect and the prompt states 0.61. The mechanism is redundant on kth smallest and connected components, direct on two sum and find duplicate, and superadditive on merge intervals, and a second draw reproduces every task. The prompt route story of the path tasks does not generalise. *(Correction, iteration 4: the claim that generated tokens carry more of the effect rested on a comparison of point estimates. With their jackknife intervals the fractions are F_direct 0.744 [0.38, 1.11] and F_prompt 0.611 [0.06, 1.17], which overlap, with interaction -0.355. The superadditive class rests on merge intervals, which is gated only through residue; without it F_prompt is 0.648 [-0.08, 1.38] and F_direct 0.865 [0.68, 1.05].)*
5. *The ban is applied at the opening of the body and not re-read.* Forcing the default's first body token undoes the ban completely on every gated task, while forcing the `def` line undoes none of it. *(Correction, iteration 4: the locus is resolved to a single token only on kth smallest, where one token after the `def` line and its indentation undoes the ban; on the other four gated tasks the shortest forced prefix in the depth sweep that undoes it is 10 to 30 tokens long. Restated: the ban gives way at the opening of the body, to a single token on kth smallest.)*
6. *Wording dominates compliance.* The fourth template is the weakest in every artifact (template SD about 2.0 logits; likelihood ratio 374), and dropping it flips the Llama branch.
7. *The default is not carried by any small set of surface tokens.* Exact signature vetoes, one-shot, persistent, iterated or cumulative, almost never remove it; the model renames, respells or

breaks the code. A single prompt ban moves the model further than any veto.

8. *Prompts reach past one rung where the alternatives are interchangeable.* Bans that leave one survivor got BFS 50 of 50 on connected components and quickselect 50 of 50 on kth smallest; on kth smallest quickselect is the answer to every ban list, including lists that ban it and the list that leaves only the default. Elsewhere (Floyd-Warshall, size-k heap, heapify and pop, binary search on values) the model will not write a survivor it can write on request. *(Correction, iteration 4: the kth smallest disconfirmation depends on the rung definition. It uses the fallback rung of the token walk; three bench draws put the landing of the ban on quickselect (59 to 79%), which makes quickselect the behavioural second rung, and under that definition the cell confirms the claim (size-k heap, will 0.00). Connected components disconfirms under either definition.)*
9. *No instruction or knob produced a correct novel algorithm.* Zero of 78 correct out-of-catalogue programs in the iteration-1 and iteration-2 data and 0 of 38 in iteration 3 are novel; the request's long-form instruction makes 84% of outputs claim novelty, 39% of those contain no code, and 75% of the rest are catalogue algorithms.
10. *Llama's correct output is as collapsed as Qwen3-8B's on the grid task* (BFS 20 of 20 correct), and more diverse on 9 of 13 bench tasks counted over correct programs.

Ruled out, or not supported.

- *Substitution by association in Qwen3-8B.* In none of the three contests did association win; it was worse than uniform on all five gated modal bans and lost to the ladder by about 1.3 nats on exposure bans (Holm 0.081 named, 0.0056 unnamed).
- *A shared prohibition direction as the carrier of the ban.* Adding the leave-one-task-out ban displacement to a neutral prompt passed on 0 of 5 gated tasks against matched random directions, and removing it from a ban never restored the default (pooled -0.026 [-0.07, 0.03]).
- *A ban-free signature veto as the forecast of the next rung.* It was undefined on 10 of 12 Qwen3-8B modal events and 29 of 33 exposure events, and where defined on the path tasks or the bench it landed elsewhere than the ban.
- *The prompt route as the general mechanism of a ban.* Disconfirmed on the bench (pooled direct share 0.74, jackknife [0.38, 1.11]).
- *Prompts move the model exactly one rung.* Disconfirmed on connected components (BFS will 1.00 at can 1.00) and, through the fallback rung, on kth smallest.
- *The three ban-attending heads as a causal site.* Ablating them moved the grid ban by $+0.06$ over random heads in the same layers, inside the range of any perturbation of the fragile fourth-template ban.
- *A locus at generated tokens 1 to 16.* No decoder beat the template-only or written text controls on any testable task; on the shortest path task the choice diverges at a median of about 29 tokens.

Dead ends, with the evidence that closed them.

- *The forced ratio latent probability as the decision instrument for where a ban sends the mass.* Closed by Table 82 (argmax 0 of 17 against the realised landing) and Table 84 (programs and events needed far beyond the budget).
- *Signature vetoes and the token walk as a way past the default.* Closed by the bench forecast,

exposure, Llama, route and reach experiments: the default survives exact vetoes by renaming and respelling, and the walk stalled at rung 1 or 2 on all six tasks.

- *The shared prohibition direction.* Closed by Table 110.
- *Head ablation as a test of the attention heads.* Closed by the random-head control.
- *Qwen-Scope base SAEs for readouts of the ban.* They now pass a fairer transfer criterion (fraction of cross-entropy recovered 0.989 to 0.994), but their reconstructions keep only a cosine of about 0.3 of the ban displacement, and their latents never beat difference-in-means.
- *Long-form novelty instructions as a source of novel algorithms.* Closed by Table 118 and the audit (0 novel of 38 correct programs outside the catalogue).

3.11 What the next iteration takes from this one

The title claim of the update, that a ban removes the default and the model falls to a next rung that ban-free counterfactuals can read in advance, did not survive in that form. The part that survived is snap-back: with the default available, a ban on a shown algorithm returns the model to its default, which is subtraction in its simplest form. Where the default itself is banned, the counterfactuals meant to expose the next rung either fail to move the model (signature vetoes) or move it somewhere else (random pushes, the shared prohibition direction), and the landing is specific to the task in a way no frozen family foresaw in Qwen3-8B. Substitution by association is not supported in Qwen3-8B and is tied with the ladder in Llama. What decides the replacement under a modal ban remains open, and the run now has two concrete leads for it: the opening of the body, where the prefill sweep localises the ban to the first body token, and the template, which carries more of the variance in compliance than anything else measured. *(Added in iteration 4: a third lead was already in the iteration-3 data, the landing composition per route arm. On connected components either route alone lands mostly on DFS, which is the generic landing of random pushes and the association answer of Qwen3-8B, and BFS is chosen only when both routes act; Section 4.2.2.)*

Three things follow for the next iteration. First, the contest needs events on which the default is unavailable and the families disagree, in numbers the paired tests can use: the modal bench bans give 5 gated events in Qwen3-8B, so pooling with Llama (11) and adding bench tasks where bans take is the arithmetic, with the template entered as a random effect rather than pooled over. Second, the first body token is now a measured locus in behaviour; a decoder or patch there, in states saved at that position for each task, would ask what is decided when the ban gives way. Third, the generic perturbation rival needs a behavioural test where its runner-up and the associate differ, which the Qwen3-8B bench rarely provides; Llama's present minor events are where the named ban gained the associate about 0.25 of attempts beyond the veto on two of six events, and that is the next place to look.

Request items still open: a same seed temperature arm with thinking on (dropped again), manifold placement of the walk landings (dropped; the walk stalled), and an SAE readout that keeps the ban displacement. *(Added in iteration 4: the same seed arm with thinking on ran in iteration 4, Section 4.5.)*

Iteration 4: plan noise priced against temperature, where the noise must enter, the plan subspace, and a held-out model family

4.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The review of the iteration-3 record. The review was blocking again. It raised six major items, all marked must fix, and three minor ones. The first item went to the answer the record gave to the second question of the request, whether the algorithm a model writes can be influenced. The closing section and Section 3.2.5 said that only the semantic seed and the A* mention buy a second correct algorithm, and that both name or describe it. Table 91 itself held two activation rows that buy one without naming anything, and none of the iteration-3 arms had been entered into the knob table, although random directions written into the task-specification states had reached a Hill-1 near 3 on kth smallest at no pass cost. The second item was an executed result missing from the record: the landing composition of every route arm, which bears directly on what picks the replacement under a ban. The third concerned the Llama contest, which scored its present minor events against a label the record never defined and mislabelled three rows of Table 102; with other excluded, only association hit above chance. The fourth was that the event gate counted failing programs labelled other as avoidance, the defect the record had already corrected for the TOP ban list, and merge intervals passed the gate only through such residue. The fifth was coverage of the request: the activation-space plots with centroids coloured by implemented count existed but had no figure marker, the same seed temperature arm with thinking on had been dropped twice, and the run had located where a ban acts but not where the choice of algorithm itself is represented. The sixth asked for the iteration-3 claims to be set against their nearest published neighbours. The minor items asked for top-1 hit rates under one rule for undefined forecasts, Table 82 per distinct likelihood row, and four sentences of Section 3.10 that said more than their tables. Table 121 maps every item to its answer. The corrections are made in place in Sections 2.3.6 and 3.2 to 3.11, each marked as an iteration-4 correction.

Table 121. Review items on the iteration-3 record and where this report answers them.

Review item	What the review found	Where it is answered
Answer to the question whether the algorithm can be influenced	Decommitment and random directions also buy a second algorithm; iteration-3 arms absent from the knob table; alpha-2 random rows hidden by Table 110	Corrections in Sections 2.3.6, 3.2.5 and 3.7; Section 4.2.1; the plan noise experiment, Section 4.3
Landing by route	Compositions of every route arm unreported	Correction in Section 3.6; Section 4.2.2
Llama hit rule	Present minor events scored against the largest-excess survivor; three rows of Table 102 mislabelled; hits on other	Corrections in Sections 3.5 and 3.10; Section 4.2.3
Residue in the event gate	Failing other programs counted as avoidance; merge intervals gated through residue; other landings never audited	Corrections in Sections 3.3, 3.6 and 3.10; Section 4.2.4
Request coverage	No geometry figure marker; same seed arm with thinking on dropped twice; no internal account of where the choice lives	Section 4.2.5 (figure); Section 4.5 (thinking on); Sections 4.4 and 4.6 (site and subspace)

Positioning of iteration-3 claims	No neighbour rows for snap-back, wording, body-opening enforcement, vetoes, novelty, random pushes	Table 92b and Table 92c, Section 4.8
Minor: hit-rate rules	Three rules for undefined forecasts across the contests	Correction in Section 3.9; Section 4.2.6; corrected figure
Minor: Table 82	Replicates treated as independent events	Correction in Section 3.2.1; Section 4.2.6
Minor: Section 3.10 wording	Calibration caveat, single-token locus, rung definition, the claim that one route carries more	Corrections in Section 3.10 items 2 to 5 and 8

The hypothesis update. The update reframed the run around a result that had sat in the control arms of the iteration-3 locus experiment. Isotropic random directions added to the task-specification states at blocks 12 to 23, at the size of the displacement a ban itself causes, had made Qwen3-8B [5] write two or three different correct algorithms for one prompt at no loss of correctness. On kth smallest, 7 of 15 directions moved at least 20% of programs off the default, and five reached a correct-only Hill-1 of 2 or more. The update read this as evidence that the algorithm is chosen in those states before any code is written. We call that state the *plan* below, with one caveat stated now: the word names a site in the network, and whether a plan representation sits there is what this iteration tested. Temperature never touches the plan, which would explain why it changes wording and not ideas, while a nudge to the plan changes ideas. The question that ran through iterations 1 to 3, substitution against subtraction, becomes a special case: a ban is one large displacement of the plan, plus generated tokens reading the ban. Three claims followed, each with a rule committed before its first decisive sample.

- *The price claim.* Plan noise moves the algorithm while temperature moves only the wording, and on tasks where the plan is movable it buys correct algorithmic diversity more cheaply than every token-level and prompt-level knob tested. Two sub-claims: the effect is specific to the task-specification states at blocks 12 to 23 (the site claim), and with the token seed held fixed, temperature changes the algorithm in at most 1 of 20 seeds while a change of plan noise draw changes it often (the same seed claim, which is question 1a-c of the request).
- *The subspace claim.* The choice is represented in a low-dimensional subspace of the task-specification states, spanned by the differences between per-algorithm centroids under forced prompts, and a push changes the algorithm to the extent that it moves the state along that subspace.
- *The movability claim.* Whether a ban on the default of a task is obeyed is predicted, without any ban sample, by whether random pushes can move that task, and the ban lands where the pushes land unless generated tokens read the ban. The claim was to be confirmed in a model family never run in this study. Two further tests rode along: a norm sweep to the point of breakage with a full audit for novel algorithms, and the top-five prohibition of the request applied as a push at the plan.

We define the instruments once. A *ban unit* is the norm of the ban minus neutral twin displacement per layer and per task-specification position at blocks 12 to 23, averaged over the five modal ban templates; for a model never banned it is estimated without ban text from the residual norm times the median ratio, in Qwen3-8B, of ban displacement to residual norm at the same relative depth. *Plan noise* at dose alpha is a fresh isotropic random direction per sample, added during prefill at every task-specification position of blocks 12 to 23, with the displacement along it set to alpha ban units at each block, so the edits do not compound. A fixed direction *escapes* when, over its first 10 samples, the share of attempts off the default exceeds that of the twin by at least 0.20 at a pass rate

of at least 0.8 times that of the twin; two experiments added a confirmation at N = 30 by an exact binomial test. The *escape fraction* of a task is the share of its fixed directions that escape, and we call a task *movable* when its escape fraction is above zero at some dose of at most 2. The *plan subspace* of a task is the span of the differences between per-algorithm centroids of the task-specification states under 30 forced paraphrases per algorithm, with a name-masked twin built from descriptions. The *push-landing forecast* names the modal catalogue survivor among off-default attempts of escaping directions, and the *opening ladder* ranks survivors by the teacher-forced log probability of their modal forced-program body opening under the neutral twin. We price a knob by its *5-point Hill-1*, the highest correct-only rarefied Hill-1 (depth 25) it reaches at a cost of at most 5 pass points, and by its *price of 1.5* and *price of 2*, the smallest pass cost at which it reaches a Hill-1 of 1.5 and of 2. The plan noise and site experiments compute them on the *randomisation hull* of each knob, the set of mixtures of the reference arm with the settings of the knob, which turns the dial of a knob into a continuous price curve.

The strategy. Seven artifacts ran (Table 122). One evaluation repaired the record from rows on disk and froze the push screen by hash, so that every later analysis cites one screen. Four Qwen3-8B experiments tested the price, site, same seed and subspace claims, and one experiment ran the movability claim in a held-out family. A research artifact positioned the iteration-3 and iteration-4 claims against published work. Two departures from the plan shaped what could be claimed. The held-out family was planned as gemma-2-9b-it, but the only GPU available held 16 GB, so the experiment ran gemma-3-4b-it [76], another family never run in this study. Every Qwen3-8B GPU artifact ran on the same 16 GB card with 8-bit floating point weight and activation linear layers, the engine of the iteration-3 screen; each reproduced the rows of the screen byte for byte, so every plan noise result below is a result for that engine, with no measured gap to bf16. The planned second screen body in Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct was first in the drop order and did not run.

Table 122. The seven artifacts of iteration 4, the question each was asked, and its hardware and spend.

Artifact	Question	Model and hardware	OpenRouter spend
Record audit	Repair the iteration-3 record (knob table, route landings, Llama hit rule, other audit, figures, rigor items); freeze the push screen	No generation; CPU only	USD 0.22 (blind judges)
Plan noise experiment	Is fresh plan noise the cheapest knob for correct algorithmic diversity?	Qwen3-8B, 8-bit linears, one 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada; 10,100 programs; 2.53 GPU hours	USD 0.23
Site experiment	Where must the noise enter to change the algorithm; what does a top-five push at the plan do?	Qwen3-8B, 8-bit linears, same card; 4,510 programs; 1.74 GPU hours	USD 0.19
Same seed experiment	With the token seed fixed, does temperature or plan noise change the algorithm, thinking off and on?	Qwen3-8B, 8-bit linears (HF) and the official 8-bit checkpoint (vLLM), same card; 3,140 programs, thinking-on traces included; 2.74 GPU hours (HF 3,297 s, vLLM 6,580 s; added in iteration 5)	under USD 0.10
Plan subspace experiment	Does a subspace read from forced prompts predict which random pushes move the algorithm?	Qwen3-8B, 8-bit linears, same card; 13,500 programs; 2.51 GPU hours	USD 0.20

Held-out family experiment	Does push movability, measured before any ban, predict which bans gemma-3-4b-it obeys?	gemma-3-4b-it bf16, same card; 10,730 programs; 1.28 GPU hours	USD 0.28
Positioning audit	Set the iteration-3 and iteration-4 claims against their nearest published findings	Web search and full-text quote checks	none recorded

4.2 The record audit: the iteration-3 record repaired from rows on disk

The record audit generated no model text. It recomputed every number from the labelled rows of eleven earlier artifacts, citing each source file, and spent USD 0.22 on the blind judges of its audit of other programs. A stdlib-only reimplementation rederived 29 headline checks with no mismatch and reproduced the frozen screen file byte for byte, a second script added 12 checks with no mismatch, and all 7 placebo tests failed as they should.

4.2.1 One knob table for every iteration-3 arm

The audit rebuilt the knob table over every iteration-3 arm, 1,120 cells of artifact, task, arm and dial, each priced against its own twin with a Newcombe interval on the pass cost [42], the correct-only rarefied Hill-1 at depth 25 with template and independent-sample 90% intervals, the Good-Turing coverage estimate, catalogue-only avoidance and two flags. A cell *escapes* by the rule of Section 4.1, and we say it *qualifies* when it escapes and reaches a Hill-1 of at least 2 within 20 pass points. Of the 1,120 cells, 752 are knobs, 348 controls, 18 ablations on a ban and 2 ceilings; 945 come from Qwen3-8B and 175 from Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct. Table 123 gives the verdict per task that the review asked for, read from the table under the class rule of Section 3.2.5. The band patch is listed separately, because it writes the states of the ban itself into the twin and so carries the ban; exposure arms are priced against their own copy twin, in which the shown algorithm is the default.

Table 123. Best non-control knob per task (Qwen3-8B; correct-only rarefied Hill-1 at depth 25; pass points lost against the twin of the same row) within 5 and within 20 pass points, the band patch for reference, and the number of random direction and dose cells that qualify. Source: record audit `tables/per_task_verdict.csv`.

Task (default)	Best within 5 points (class)	Best within 20 points (class)	Band patch	Random cells qualifying	A non-activation knob reaches 1.5 within 20 points
kth smallest (full sort)	random direction 9002, alpha 1: 2.92 at 0 (random)	same	1.97	7 of 21	yes (modal ban, 2.17 at 8)
two sum (hash map)	random direction 9002, alpha 2: 2.12 at 0 (random)	same	1.68	1 of 9	yes (modal ban of the locus experiment, 1.62 at 0)
find duplicate (hash set)	first iterated veto round: 2.51 at 2 (veto)	same	1.17	1 of 9	yes (iterated veto)
connected components (union find)	unnamed exposure ban of BFS: 1.85 at 0 (exposure)	same	1.88	0 of 3	yes (exposure ban)
substring search (naive)	novelty instruction: 1.98 at 0 (prompt)	modal ban of the locus experiment: 2.62 at 8 (ban)	1.00	0 of 9	yes

Fibonacci (iteration)	random direction 3: 1.09 at 0 (random)	same	1.00	0 of 3	no (novelty 1.90, but at 24 points)
longest increasing subsequence (quadratic DP)	named exposure ban of the Fenwick tree: 1.78 at 4 (exposure)	same	1.00	0 of 3	yes (exposure ban)
merge intervals (sort and sweep)	nonce ban: 1.00 at 0	same	1.00	0 of 3	no
top-k frequent (sort by count)	novelty instruction: 1.19 at -12 (prompt)	modal ban: 1.78 at 17 (ban)	1.00	0 of 3	yes
nonoverlapping intervals (greedy by end)	novelty instruction: 1.00 at 0	named exposure ban of the DAG longest path: 1.26 at 6	1.00	0 of 3	no
topological order (Kahn)	nonce ban: 1.00 at 0	modal ban: 1.05 at 7	1.00	0 of 3	no
first and last position (binary search)	exposure veto of exponential search, round 1: 1.78 at 0 (veto)	same, round 3: 1.84 at 8	1.00	0 of 3	no (the veto is an exposure arm)
grid (BFS)	random direction 9013, alpha 1: 1.51 at -13 (random)	second succession step: 2.19 at 12 (ban)	not run	0 of 18	yes
shortest path (Dijkstra)	random direction 9004, alpha 1: 1.975 at 4 (random)	same	not run	0 of 18	yes (leave-one-survivor list, 1.96 at 14; semantic seed, 1.95 at 7)

Read per task, the verdict the record should have carried is this. On kth smallest and two sum, matched-norm random pushes at the task-specification positions reach a Hill-1 above 2 at no pass cost, ahead of every prompt knob; on kth smallest the three signature vetoes and the band patch come close (1.89 to 1.97 at 2 points or less). On connected components a random direction, the novelty instruction and the band patch all pass 1.5 at no cost, and none reaches 2. Substring search moves with words: the novelty instruction reaches 1.98 at no cost, and no random direction moves it. Find duplicate moves with an iterated veto (2.51 at 2 points; sort and adjacent check 32, Floyd cycle detection 9, hash set 7, index marking 1). On the path tasks the best rows, a random direction, the semantic seed and the decommitment direction, cluster just under 2. Merge intervals, topological order and nonoverlapping intervals do not reach 1.5 within 20 points under any knob, and Fibonacci reaches it only at 24 points. The sentence of the review that nothing reaches 1.5 within 20 points on six tasks did not reproduce, because the modal ban of top-k frequent (1.78 at 17 points) and exposure arms on longest increasing subsequence and first and last position do. Of the 27 numbers the review quoted, 25 reproduced (Table 126b); the other mismatch was the two sum avoidance at alpha 2, 0.469 on the attempted denominator (one row had no program) against the quoted 0.48. *(Correction, iteration 5: three qualifications. First, the numbers for random directions above are maxima over directions, not the effect of a typical direction: on kth smallest 2.92 is the best of 21 direction and dose cells, of which 7 qualify, and on two sum 2.12 is the best of 9 directions, of which 1 qualifies; fresh per-sample plan noise reaches 1.29 on two sum, and 0 of 40 fresh directions escape there at alpha 1 and 5 of 40 at alpha 2 (Sections 4.3 and 4.6; distributions per direction in Table 175). Second, under the exposure class now declared in Section 3.2.5, exposure arms are controls. With them set aside, in the knob rows of the plan noise experiment a knob outside the exposure class reaches 1.5 within 20 pass points on the grid, shortest path, kth smallest, substring search, two sum, find duplicate and*

connected components tasks; longest increasing subsequence and first and last position join the tasks where nothing does, and the modal ban of top-k frequent (1.78 at 17 points) is carried from the record because ban arms are not among those rows (Table 172). Third, the record omitted the Llama block of the same table (Table 126c, below Table 126b).)

Table 124 counts how many random directions qualify on each task, so that the result reads as a property of pushes rather than of one fortunate seed. Most bench tasks saw only three directions at alpha 1, which leaves the immovable side weakly tested: with 3 directions, a true escape rate of 0.54 would still produce no escape 10% of the time.

Table 124. Random directions per task and dose: run, escaping, qualifying, and the split by engine (8-bit linears in the locus experiment, bf16 in the bench forecast experiment). Source: record audit `tables/random_direction_counts.csv`.

Task	Alpha	Run	Escape	Qualify	Escaping directions	8-bit: run / escape / qualify	bf16: run / escape / qualify
kth smallest	1	18	8	5	9001, 9002, 9003, 9006, 9010, 9011, 9014 and bench direction 3	15 / 7 / 5	3 / 1 / 0
kth smallest	2	3	3	2	9001, 9002, 9003	3 / 3 / 2	0
two sum	1	6	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	3 / 0 / 0
two sum	2	3	2	1	9002, 9003	3 / 2 / 1	0
find duplicate	1	6	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	3 / 0 / 0
find duplicate	2	3	1	1	9003	3 / 1 / 1	0
connected components	1	3	1	0	bench direction 3	0	3 / 1 / 0
substring search	1	6	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	3 / 0 / 0
substring search	2	3	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	0
grid	1	15	1	0	9014	15 / 1 / 0	0
grid	2	3	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	0
shortest path	1	15	3	0	9003, 9004, 9007	15 / 3 / 0	0
shortest path	2	3	0	0	none	3 / 0 / 0	0
Fibonacci, longest increasing subsequence, merge intervals, top-k frequent, nonoverlapping intervals, topological order, first and last position	1	3 each	0	0	none	0	3 / 0 / 0 each

Table 110 of the locus experiment reported avoidance alone and left out the three random directions at alpha 2. Table 125 gives every alpha-2 row with its pass rate and correct composition (the correction is marked in Section 3.7). On kth smallest and two sum the random directions buy two correct algorithms at almost no cost, and on find duplicate one of them buys sort and adjacent check at 18 points, where the structured edit ADD moved nothing.

Table 125. The alpha-2 rows of the locus experiment (N = 50 each): avoidance, pass rate and cost against the twin, rarefied Hill-1, and the composition of correct programs. Source: record audit `tables/table110_alpha2.csv`.

Task	Arm	Avoidance (catalogue only)	Pass rate (points lost)	Hill-1	Correct programs

kth smallest	ADD	0.70 (0.70)	1.00 (0)	2.32	size-k heap 31, full sort 15, quickselect 4
kth smallest	random 9001	0.96 (0.96)	0.84 (16)	1.20	quickselect 40, full sort 2
kth smallest	random 9002	0.52 (0.52)	0.98 (2)	2.13	quickselect 24, full sort 24, size-k heap 1
kth smallest	random 9003	0.30 (0.30)	0.98 (2)	2.29	full sort 35, quickselect 7, size-k heap 6, heapify and pop 1
two sum	ADD	0.00 (0.00)	0.48 (52)	not rarefiable	hash map 24
two sum	random 9001	0.00 (0.00)	1.00 (0)	1.00	hash map 50
two sum	random 9002	0.47 (0.47)	1.00 (0)	2.12	hash map 26, brute force 23, disputed 1
two sum	random 9003	0.36 (0.36)	1.00 (0)	1.90	hash map 32, brute force 18
find duplicate	ADD	0.00 (0.00)	1.00 (0)	1.00	hash set 50
find duplicate	random 9001	0.00 (0.00)	1.00 (0)	1.00	hash set 50
find duplicate	random 9002	0.00 (0.00)	1.00 (0)	1.00	hash set 50
find duplicate	random 9003	0.86 (0.76)	0.82 (18)	2.13	sort and adjacent check 30, hash set 6, other 5
substring search	ADD and random 9001 to 9003	0.00 each	1.00 (0) each	1.00 each	naive 50 each
grid	ADD	0.04 (0.04)	0.86 (-5)	1.10	BFS 42, DFS 1
grid	random 9001	0.04 (0.04)	0.44 (37)	not rarefiable	BFS 20, DFS 2
grid	random 9002	0.10 (0.10)	0.58 (23)	1.00	BFS 29
grid	random 9003	0.18 (0.16)	0.32 (49)	not rarefiable	BFS 16
shortest path	ADD	0.12 (0.10)	0.84 (16)	1.00	Dijkstra 42
shortest path	random 9001	0.10 (0.10)	0.82 (18)	1.00	Dijkstra 41
shortest path	random 9002	0.74 (0.74)	0.56 (44)	1.99	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 15, Dijkstra 13
shortest path	random 9003	0.06 (0.06)	0.98 (2)	1.18	Dijkstra 47, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2

Table 126 condenses the knob cells of Qwen3-8B into the best row per task and knob family within 20 points, with the number of cells in each family, so that the whole table can be read at a glance. The pattern across families is the starting point of the iteration: random directions lead on kth smallest, two sum and the shortest path task, prompt bans and exposure bans lead on substring search and the grid task, and on the tasks where bans fail no family reaches 1.5 within 20 points except through exposure arms.

Table 126. Best Hill-1 within 20 pass points per task and knob family (Qwen3-8B knob cells; cells in the family in brackets; a dash means the family was not run on the task; the entry none means that no cell within 20 points was rarefiable). Source: record audit `tables/knob_table.csv`.

Task	Random directions	Structured activation edits	Band patch	Prompt ban	Exposure ban	Ban list	Instruction	Novelty instruction	Nonce ban	Seed	Decoding	Veto
kth smallest	2.92 (21)	2.32 (3)	1.97 (1)	2.17 (3)	1.96 (30)	1.43 (5)	none (4)	1.11 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.98 (23)
two sum	2.12 (9)	1.00 (3)	1.68 (1)	1.62 (2)	1.00 (14)	-	-	1.18 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.92 (14)
find duplicate	2.13 (9)	1.00 (3)	1.17 (1)	2.01 (3)	1.00 (20)	1.10 (4)	none (4)	1.09 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	2.51 (21)
connected components	1.76 (3)	-	1.88 (1)	1.56 (2)	1.85 (18)	1.25 (3)	-	1.68 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.51 (10)
substring search	1.00 (9)	1.00 (3)	1.00 (1)	2.62 (3)	1.95 (26)	2.02 (5)	none (4)	1.98 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.12 (23)
Fibonacci	1.09 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	none (1)	1.00 (6)	-	-	none (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.00 (13)
longest increasing subsequence	1.00 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	1.09 (1)	1.78 (8)	-	-	none (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.00 (10)
merge intervals	1.00 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	none (1)	1.00 (2)	-	-	1.00 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.00 (8)
top-k frequent	1.00 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	1.78 (1)	1.51 (10)	-	-	1.19 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.00 (14)
nonoverlapping intervals	1.00 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	1.00 (1)	1.26 (4)	-	-	1.00 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	1.00 (11)
topological order	1.00 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	1.05 (1)	-	-	-	1.00 (1)	1.00 (1)	-	-	none (5)
first and last position	1.21 (3)	-	1.00 (1)	1.04 (1)	1.00 (4)	-	-	1.09 (1)	1.48 (1)	-	-	1.84 (11)
grid	1.75 (20)	1.10 (13)	-	2.19 (6)	-	2.10 (4)	1.23 (10)	-	-	1.09 (3)	1.04 (16)	none (5)
shortest path	1.97 (20)	1.91 (13)	-	1.95 (5)	-	1.96 (5)	1.51 (11)	-	-	1.95 (3)	1.05 (16)	none (3)

Table 126b. The 27 numbers quoted by the review and their recomputation from rows (tolerances from 0.005 to 0.03 in Hill-1 or share). Source: record audit `tables/verification_targets.csv`.

Quoted number	Quoted	Recomputed	Match
kth smallest, alpha 1: escaping directions of 15 (locus experiment)	7 of 15	7 of 15	yes
kth smallest: Hill-1 of the escaping directions at pass of at least 0.96	2.92, 2.42, 2.32, 2.14, 2.10	2.923, 2.420, 2.320, 2.134, 2.109	yes
kth smallest: composition of the best direction	size-k heap 19, quickselect 16, full sort 15	same	yes
shortest path, alpha 1: escaping directions of 15 at pass of at least 0.88	3 of 15, minimum pass 0.88	same	yes
shortest path: best direction	Dijkstra 26, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 22, pass 0.96, Hill-1 1.97	same, Hill-1 1.975	yes
shortest path: landing of every escaping direction	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	yes

two sum: escapes at alpha 1 and at alpha 2	0 of 3; 2 of 3	same	yes
two sum: Hill-1 of the alpha-2 directions	2.13, 1.90, 1.00, 1.00	2.121, 1.899, 1.00, 1.00	yes
two sum: alpha-2 best composition	hash map 26, brute force 23	hash map 26, brute force 23, disputed 1 (next: hash map 32, brute force 18)	yes
find duplicate: alpha-2 escapes, composition, pass	1 of 3; sort and adjacent check 30 of 41; 0.82	1 of 3; sort and adjacent check 30, hash set 6, other 5; 0.82	yes
substring search: escaping direction and dose cells	0 of 6	0 of 6	yes
bench forecast experiment: kth smallest random row	quickselect 34, full sort 9	same	yes
bench forecast experiment: connected components random row	DFS 13 of 50, pass 1.00	same	yes
decommitment direction, c = 0.25 (shortest path)	1.913 [1.705, 2.088] at 17 points	1.913 [1.704, 2.083] at 17.0	yes
decommitment experiment, random direction 1 (shortest path)	1.858 at 16 points	1.86 at 16.0	yes
semantic seed (shortest path)	1.940 [1.770, 2.094]	1.945 [1.780, 2.091] at 7.0	yes
kth smallest vetoes	1.89 to 1.91 at 2 points	one-shot 1.913, persistent 1.891, first iterated 1.889, each at 2.0	yes
kth smallest band patch	1.98	1.973	yes
connected components: random direction, novelty instruction, band patch	1.76, 1.68, 1.88, all at 0 points	1.756, 1.681, 1.882, all at 0.0	yes
substring search: novelty instruction	1.97 to 1.99 at pass 1.00	1.976 at pass 1.00	yes
find duplicate: first iterated veto round	2.49 at 2 points (sort and adjacent check 32, Floyd cycle detection 9, hash set 7, index marking 1)	2.513 at 2.0, same composition	yes
Fibonacci: novelty instruction	1.90 at 24 points	1.898 at 24.0	yes
Table 110: kth smallest alpha-2 avoidance	0.96	0.96	yes
Table 110: find duplicate alpha-2 avoidance and landing	0.86, sort and adjacent check	0.86; sort and adjacent check 30, index marking 8, other 5	yes

Table 110: two sum alpha-2 avoidance (two directions)	0.48, 0.36	0.469, 0.36	no
Table 110: ADD at alpha 2 on find duplicate and two sum	0.00, 0.00	0.00, 0.00 (two sum at pass 0.48)	yes
nothing reaches Hill-1 1.5 within 20 points on six immovable tasks	no row	top-k frequent modal ban 1.783 at 17; first and last position exposure vetoes 1.778 at 0, 1.827 at 6, 1.837 at 8; longest increasing subsequence named exposure bans of the Fenwick tree 1.775 at 4 and of patience sorting 1.538 at 0; top-k frequent unnamed exposure ban of quickselect on counts 1.511 at 6	no

The two mismatches are explained in the text above: the two sum share uses the attempted denominator (1 - 26/49), and the six-task sentence ignored the top-k frequent modal ban and two exposure arms.

(Added in iteration 5: the Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct block of the knob table, which this section did not report. Source: iteration-5 record audit `tables/llama_block.csv`*, carried from the iteration-4 record audit's knob table.)*

Table 126c. Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct cells of the knob table (175 cells): random directions against the knob cells that qualify (Hill-1 of at least 2 within 20 pass points).

Row	Value	Note
cells of random directions	0 of 36 qualify	pushed at about 3 times the ban displacement at layer 21; the dose was never swept down
qualifying knob cells	5	prompt bans and one veto
Fibonacci modal ban	2.43	prompt ban
substring search one-shot veto	2.54	signature veto
kth smallest present-minor ban of heapify and pop (K0522)	2.87 (90% [2.1845, 3.3413])	prompt ban; pass 0.28 against 0.16, cost -12 points (this row and the next two completed in iteration 6)
kth smallest present-minor ban of quickselect (K0523)	2.96 (90% [2.406, 3.1827])	prompt ban; pass 0.43 against 0.16, cost -27 points
kth smallest present-minor ban of size-k heap (K0524)	2.92 (90% [2.2306, 3.3258])	prompt ban; pass 0.31 against 0.16, cost -15 points

In Llama the cheapest diversity came from prompt bans, not from random pushes, and the pushes ran only at a dose about three times the ban's own displacement, where they broke programs rather than redirected them.

4.2.2 Where each route lands

The bench route experiment had written the composition of every route arm to disk, and the record had reported only the share of the default. Table 127 gives the programs that left the default under the full ban, the prompt route, the direct route, the condition-span knockout and the one-shot veto on the five gated tasks, with the Jensen-Shannon divergence between the landing of each arm and that of the full ban, and the 95th percentile of its resampling null. All seven readings the review quoted reproduced, and the divergences matched those of the experiment itself to 1e-6 on 17 of 17 arms.

Table 127. Landing of the attempts that left the default under each route arm (N = 100 slots per arm; the one-shot veto on connected components produced 20 valid attempts), the divergence from the landing of the full ban against its null, and the frozen family nominations for the task. Source:

record audit `tables/route_landing.csv`.

Task	Arm	Attempts off the default (of attempted)	JS from full ban (null p95)	Association / likelihood runner-up / proximity / push top-1
kth smallest	full ban	quickselect 70, size-k heap 28, heapify and pop 1 (99 of 100)	n/a	quickselect / quickselect / heapify and pop / quickselect
kth smallest	prompt route	quickselect 57, size-k heap 41, heapify and pop 1 (99)	0.0133 (0.0084), outside	
kth smallest	direct route	quickselect 74, size-k heap 1 (75)	0.1146 (0.0107), outside	
kth smallest	knockout	quickselect 62, size-k heap 36, heapify and pop 1 (99)	0.0052 (0.0084), within	
kth smallest	one-shot veto	quickselect 41 (41)	0.1279 (0.0211), outside	
two sum	full ban	brute force 83 (83)	n/a	sort and two pointers / sort and two pointers / brute force / brute force
two sum	prompt route	brute force 34 (34)	degenerate (single label)	
two sum	direct route	brute force 80 (80)	degenerate	
two sum	knockout	brute force 33 (33)	degenerate	
two sum	one-shot veto	none (0)	n/a	
find duplicate	full ban	index marking 77, Floyd cycle detection 1, other 1 (79)	n/a	Floyd cycle detection / sort and adjacent check / sort and adjacent check / sort and adjacent check
find duplicate	prompt route	index marking 3 (3)	0.1245 (0.2436), within	
find duplicate	direct route	index marking 74, other 3, sort and adjacent check 1 (78)	0.0086 (0.0061), outside	
find duplicate	knockout	Floyd cycle detection 3, index marking 2 (5)	0.3507 (0.1455), outside	
find duplicate	one-shot veto	none (0)	n/a	
connected components	full ban	BFS 75, DFS 25 (100)	n/a	DFS / DFS / label propagation / DFS
connected components	prompt route	DFS 56, BFS 44 (100)	0.0711 (0.0067), outside	
connected components	direct route	DFS 70, BFS 10 (80; union find 20)	0.3000 (0.0085), outside	

connected components	knockout	DFS 57, BFS 43 (100)	0.0756 (0.0067), outside	
connected components	one-shot veto	DFS 6 (6 of 20)	0.3981 (0.0891), outside	
merge intervals	full ban	other 44, union find 15 (59)	n/a	interval tree / union find / union find / none
merge intervals	prompt route	other 19, union find 4 (23)	0.0071 (0.0312), within	
merge intervals	direct route	other 1 (1)	0.0865 (0.2479), within	
merge intervals	knockout	other 22, union find 4 (26)	0.0104 (0.0341), within	
merge intervals	one-shot veto	none (0)	n/a	

The table answers the question of the review in the direction it pointed. On connected components the two routes together choose the substitute, and neither chooses it alone. Each single route removes union find, but the prompt route alone, the direct route alone and the knockout all land mostly on DFS, which is the association answer of Qwen3-8B, the runner-up of the baseline likelihood order and the modal landing of random pushes on the task (DFS 0.83 and BFS 0.17 of the excess-weighted push landing in Section 4.6); BFS becomes the modal landing only when both routes act. On kth smallest the direct route alone almost eliminates the size-k heap (1 against 28 under the full ban), so the size-k heap share travels by the prompt states, and the random pushes of Section 4.6 land on the same two algorithms. On find duplicate the direct route reproduces the index marking of the full ban, and the five programs of the knockout land on Floyd cycle detection 3 times, the association answer. Two sum lands on brute force under every arm, and merge intervals lands mostly on residue. We carry this forward as the route-landing lead: where a single route suffices to remove the default, it lands on the generic neighbour that pushes and the stated alternative of the model agree on, and departures from that neighbour appear when both routes act. *(Correction, iteration 5: this generalises from one task. It is an observation on a single task, connected components, where either route alone lands mostly on DFS, the neighbour that pushes and association agree on, and both routes together choose BFS. Find duplicate is the counterexample in the same table: the direct route alone removes the default and lands on index marking (74 of 78), which is neither the push landing (sort and adjacent check) nor the association answer (Floyd cycle detection). On two sum pushes and association disagree, so there is no agreed neighbour to land on.)*

Table 128 restates the pooled route fractions with merge intervals and without it, and under catalogue-only shares. Removing merge intervals raises both fractions, and the jackknife interval of the direct route then lies above one half; the two pooled point estimates still have overlapping intervals and a negative interaction.

Table 128. Pooled route fractions over the gated tasks (ratio of sums; leave-one-task-out jackknife 95% intervals), with and without merge intervals, using the share of attempts in the default (plain) or catalogue-only shares. Source: record audit `results/route.json`.

Tasks	Shares	F_prompt [jackknife]	F_direct [jackknife]	Interaction [jackknife]	F_knockout [jackknife]
five gated tasks	plain	0.611 [0.06, 1.17]	0.744 [0.38, 1.11]	-0.355 [-0.98, 0.27]	0.621 [0.08, 1.16]
without merge intervals	plain	0.648 [-0.08, 1.38]	0.865 [0.68, 1.05]	-0.513 [-1.07, 0.04]	0.651 [-0.07, 1.37]
five gated tasks	catalogue only	0.634 [0.01, 1.26]	0.824 [0.65, 1.00]	-0.458 [-0.97, 0.06]	0.637 [0.02, 1.25]
without merge intervals	catalogue only	0.650 [-0.08, 1.38]	0.859 [0.68, 1.04]	-0.508 [-1.07, 0.06]	0.653 [-0.06, 1.37]

Merge intervals has no route class under catalogue-only avoidance: its full-ban avoidance into the catalogue is 0.15, below the gate. The superadditive class of Table 107 therefore rests on residue.

4.2.3 The Llama hit rule

The Llama bench experiment scored its 12 modal events against the modal landing and its 6 present minor events against the survivor with the largest excess over the renormalised ban-free baseline, a rule written in its scoring code and never stated in the record. Table 129 recomputes the top-1 hits of every family on the 13 gated events under each candidate rule, with Poisson-binomial p values against the per-event chance rates. The ladder nominated other on 3 of the 13 gated events, and on find duplicate both its nomination and the landing were other.

Table 129. Top-1 hits of each frozen family on the 13 gated Llama events under five labelling rules (hits of 13; Poisson-binomial p against per-event chance). Source: record audit `results/llama.json`.

Rule	Subtraction	Ladder	Association	Proximity
As recorded (modal events: modal landing; present minor events: largest excess)	4 (p 0.468)	7 (p 0.032)	7 (p 0.032)	3 (p 0.715)
Modal landing on all 13 events (label corrected in iteration 6)	6 (p 0.100)	10 (p 0.00018)	9 (p 0.0014)	3 (p 0.715)
Largest excess on all 13 events (label corrected in iteration 6)	1 (p 0.983)	4 (p 0.468)	5 (p 0.244)	1 (p 0.983)
As recorded, other excluded as nominee and landing	3 (p 0.715)	6 (p 0.100)	7 (p 0.032)	3 (p 0.715)
Modal landing, other excluded	8 (p 0.0077)	11 (p 0.000016)	9 (p 0.0014)	3 (p 0.715)

Under the recorded rule with other excluded, only association hits above chance (7 of 13, $p = 0.032$); the ladder hits 6 of 13 ($p = 0.100$). The verdict depends on the rule, and the rule decides it in an informative way. On present minor events the model mostly writes its default, which the largest-excess rule never counts as a landing, so the ladder, which nominates the default, is scored a miss on exactly the events where it names what the model writes. Under the modal rule the ladder hits 10 of 13. Table 130 gives the present minor events with both labels side by side, and the share of the default among attempts not banned. On five of the six events the modal landing is the default, which is the snap-back of the Qwen3-8B exposure experiment replicated in a second family: the default takes 0.93, 0.73 and 0.72 of attempts not banned under the bans of DFS, KMP and sort by count, and 0.58 and 0.35 under two of the kth smallest bans. The ban of heapify and pop is the exception; it moved Llama to quickselect, and the full sort kept 0.23.

Table 130. Llama present minor events: modal landing (with and without other), largest-excess landing, and the share of the default among attempts not banned (Wilson 95%). Source: record

audit `results/llama.json`.

Event	Default	Modal landing	Largest-excess landing	Default among attempts not banned [95%]
top-k frequent, ban of sort by count	heap	heap	quickselect on counts	54 of 75 = 0.72 [0.61, 0.81]
kth smallest, ban of heapify and pop	full sort	quickselect	quickselect	18 of 77 = 0.23 [0.15, 0.34]
kth smallest, ban of quickselect	full sort	full sort	full sort	41 of 71 = 0.58 [0.46, 0.69]
substring search, ban of KMP	naive	naive	Boyer-Moore-Horspool	48 of 66 = 0.73 [0.61, 0.82]
connected components, ban of DFS	union find	union find	BFS	79 of 85 = 0.93 [0.85, 0.97]
kth smallest, ban of size-k heap	full sort	full sort	full sort	27 of 78 = 0.35 [0.25, 0.46]

4.2.4 The audit of other programs, and catalogue-only avoidance

The audit pooled every program labelled other that iteration 3 produced under a ban: 21 events and 226 unique programs, of which 6 passed the hidden tests (Table 131). Two blind judges from different families classified each as a labeller miss, a variant of a catalogue algorithm, a degenerate or hard-coded program, or a novel algorithm, a third judge broke ties, and the executor read 73 programs by hand: every passing program, every program a judge called novel, all 44 merge intervals programs and a seeded sample of the rest. Judge A (gpt-4.1-mini) fell below the control gate (4 of 6 positive controls in the strict class) and received no weight; judge B (gemini-2.5-flash) passed at 5 of 6 and was weighted; the two agreed at Cohen's kappa [11] 0.77 [0.67, 0.86]. The final classes were 68 catalogue variants, 156 degenerate programs, 2 labeller misses and no novel algorithm. Judges flagged 7 programs as novel and the manual pass confirmed none; the one passing program a judge called novel reran 60 of 60 hidden tests and 3 of 3 stress tests and is a textbook binary search over values after a sort.

Table 131. Every event audited for programs labelled other (unique programs; sampled up to 25 per event; final classes; a program shared by two events is counted in both, so the rows sum to 231 sampled programs and the pool holds 226 unique ones). Source: record audit `tables/other_audit_events.csv`.

Event	Programs labelled other (unique)	Sampled	Passing	Labeller miss	Catalogue variant	Degenerate	Novel
Qwen3-8B bench ban, Fibonacci	33 (10)	10	0	0	10	0	0
Qwen3-8B bench ban, merge intervals	44 (44)	25	0	0	23	2	0
Qwen3-8B route full ban, Fibonacci	31 (6)	6	0	0	6	0	0
Qwen3-8B route full ban, merge intervals	44 (44)	25	0	0	17	8	0
Llama modal ban, nonoverlapping intervals	19 (19)	19	0	0	1	18	0
Llama modal ban, kth smallest	8 (8)	8	0	0	0	8	0

Llama present minor ban of heapify and pop	8 (8)	8	0	0	0	8	0
Llama present minor ban of quickselect	9 (9)	9	2	1	1	7	0
Llama present minor ban of size-k heap	9 (9)	9	0	0	0	9	0
Llama present minor ban of KMP	8 (8)	8	0	0	0	8	0
Llama modal ban, two sum	7 (7)	7	0	0	0	7	0
Llama modal ban, find duplicate	50 (50)	25	1	0	1	24	0
Llama modal ban, Fibonacci	12 (12)	12	1	1	5	6	0
Llama modal ban, longest increasing subsequence	9 (9)	9	0	0	0	9	0
Llama modal ban, merge intervals	19 (19)	19	0	0	0	19	0
Llama modal ban, top-k frequent	5 (5)	5	0	0	0	5	0
Llama present minor ban of sort by count	8 (8)	8	0	0	0	8	0
Qwen3-8B exposure, named ban of memoised recursion (nonoverlapping intervals)	7 (7)	7	0	0	0	7	0
Qwen3-8B exposure, unnamed ban of the bisect module (first and last position)	23 (1)	1	0	0	1	0	0
Qwen3-8B exposure, named ban of fast doubling (Fibonacci)	49 (6)	6	0	0	6	0	0
Qwen3-8B exposure, named ban of quickselect on counts (top-k frequent)	6 (5)	5	2	0	2	3	0

The merge intervals landing is not the merge sweep without sorting that the record described. All 44 programs fail; the manual read found 29 that mark coverage over the coordinate range in a boolean array, 12 sweeps over unsorted intervals and 3 others (a regular expression pass gave 29, 14 and 1). The Fibonacci programs use the closed-form Binet formula, which sits in the extended catalogue and fails beyond n of about 70. We call an event *gated through residue* when it passes the avoidance gate only because of programs labelled other. Three events are: the Qwen3-8B merge intervals ban in the bench forecast experiment, the full-ban arm of the same ban in the route experiment, and the Llama find duplicate ban (catalogue-only avoidance 0.22, with 50 of 94 attempts labelled other). Table 132 gives catalogue-only avoidance beside avoidance for every modal bench event in both models and for the full-ban arm of the route experiment.

Table 132. Avoidance and catalogue-only avoidance (share of attempts in a catalogue algorithm that is not the default) per bench task, with the share labelled other; events gated through residue are marked †. Source: record audit `tables/catalogue_only_avoidance.csv`.

Task	Qwen3-8B bench ban: avoidance / catalogue only / other	Qwen3-8B route full ban: avoidance / catalogue only / other	Llama modal ban: avoidance / catalogue only / other

kth smallest	0.97 / 0.97 / 0.00	0.99 / 0.99 / 0.00	0.95 / 0.86 / 0.09
substring search	0.40 / 0.40 / 0.00	0.42 / 0.42 / 0.00	0.79 / 0.74 / 0.05
find duplicate	0.79 / 0.79 / 0.00	0.79 / 0.78 / 0.01	0.76 / 0.22 / 0.53 †
two sum	0.86 / 0.86 / 0.00	0.83 / 0.83 / 0.00	0.91 / 0.83 / 0.07
connected components	1.00 / 1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 0.00	0.82 / 0.78 / 0.04
nonoverlapping intervals	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	0.29 / 0.08 / 0.21
Fibonacci	0.34 / 0.01 / 0.33	0.31 / 0.00 / 0.31	0.79 / 0.66 / 0.13
topological order	0.08 / 0.08 / 0.00	0.04 / 0.04 / 0.00	0.18 / 0.14 / 0.04
merge intervals	0.58 / 0.14 / 0.44 †	0.59 / 0.15 / 0.44 †	0.30 / 0.07 / 0.23
first and last position	0.03 / 0.01 / 0.01	0.02 / 0.01 / 0.01	0.04 / 0.00 / 0.02
top-k frequent	0.48 / 0.47 / 0.01	0.41 / 0.40 / 0.01	0.89 / 0.84 / 0.05
longest increasing subsequence	0.02 / 0.02 / 0.00	0.02 / 0.01 / 0.01	0.23 / 0.14 / 0.09

Table 132b. Route experiment arms whose catalogue-only avoidance differs from their avoidance (all other arms of the 12 bench tasks are identical in the two measures). Source: record audit `tables/catalogue_only_avoidance.csv`.

Task	Arm	Attempted	Avoidance	Catalogue only	Other
merge intervals	full ban	100	0.59	0.15	0.44
merge intervals	prompt route	100	0.23	0.04	0.19
merge intervals	knockout	100	0.26	0.04	0.22
merge intervals	direct route	100	0.01	0.00	0.01
Fibonacci	full ban	100	0.31	0.00	0.31
Fibonacci	direct route	100	0.28	0.00	0.28
Fibonacci	knockout	50	0.04	0.00	0.04
Fibonacci	prompt route	100	0.01	0.00	0.01
find duplicate	full ban	100	0.79	0.78	0.01
find duplicate	direct route	100	0.78	0.75	0.03
top-k frequent	full ban	100	0.41	0.40	0.01
top-k frequent	direct route	100	0.23	0.19	0.04
top-k frequent	knockout	50	0.06	0.04	0.02
top-k frequent	twin and one-shot veto	100 each	0.07	0.05	0.02
first and last position	one-shot veto	62	0.39	0.00	0.37
first and last position	twin and direct route	100 each	0.24	0.00	0.21 to 0.23
first and last position	full ban	100	0.02	0.01	0.01
longest increasing subsequence	full ban	100	0.02	0.01	0.01

The Llama present minor events keep their gates under catalogue-only avoidance (0.62 to 0.86). Without the residue-gated events, the summaries change as follows. In the Qwen3-8B bench contest, recomputed from Table 96 on the four remaining gated events, the mean log score minus uniform is ladder +0.08, subtraction -0.87, proximity -1.95 and association -2.04, against +0.06, -0.69, -1.53 and -1.78 with merge intervals; the frozen counting rule still gives the ladder 3 wins, 2 of them through an undefined forecast scored as uniform, and proximity loses its merge intervals win. In the Llama contest without find duplicate, the ladder hits 6 of 12 and association 7 of 12 under the recorded rule. The route fractions without merge intervals are in Table 128.

4.2.5 Geometry in activation coordinates

The request asks for actual geometry plots in activation space, with centroids coloured by implemented count, before and after prohibiting the top five algorithms. The ban list experiment had drawn them in iteration 2, and the record had only tabulated their counts (Table 85). The figure below plots four of them from the saved centroid coordinates: the Isomap embedding ($k = 10$) of teacher-forced residual stream states at layer 24, read at the token before the commit token, with each centroid sized by the number of programs implementing it under the condition. The caveat travels with the figure: the token before the commit token is a position whose index depends on the label of the program itself, so part of the separation between centroids can reflect position rather than algorithm. Under the five-name ban, every implemented program sits on a banned centroid (BFS 63, DFS 36, IDDFS 1); under the single BFS ban the mass moves to the DFS centroid, which is far from BFS in this embedding; and on the shortest path task the ban that leaves only Bellman-Ford/SPFA splits between the allowed Bellman-Ford/SPFA centroid (51) and the banned Dijkstra centroid (48). The MDS stress-1 of the centroid geodesic matrix is 0.025 on the grid task and 0.006 on the shortest path task. BFS and bidirectional BFS coincide in this embedding (centroid distance 0.0147 in MDS units).

[Figure fig_isomap_bans: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The label-independent recomputation at generated token 16 gives neighbour orders, not coordinates, so it is tabulated rather than plotted (Table 133). At the label-dependent position the nearest centroid to BFS is bidirectional BFS, and a label permutation reproduces that identity in 1% of draws; at token 16 the nearest centroid to BFS is IDA*, and bidirectional BFS falls to fourth.

Table 133. The neighbour order of BFS among grid centroids (forced programs under the baseline prompt, layer 24; 782 programs) at the label-dependent position and at the fixed generated token 16, with the share of 500 label permutations in which the nearest neighbour is bidirectional BFS. Source: record audit `results/figures.json`.

Position	Neighbour order from BFS	Nearest	Distance BFS to bidirectional BFS	Permutation share with bidirectional BFS nearest
token before the commit token	bidirectional BFS, greedy best first, DFS, A*, unit weight Dijkstra, other, IDA*, IDDFS	bidirectional BFS	81.25	0.010
generated token 16	IDA*, IDDFS, DFS, bidirectional BFS, unit weight Dijkstra, other, greedy best first, A*	IDA*	99.11	0.022

4.2.6 Hit rates under one rule, Table 82 per row, rival predictors and the frozen screen

The three contests of iteration 3 used three rules for undefined forecasts. Table 134 reports defined-only top-1 hit rates with the number of defined events in each contest. Subtraction, which looked worst in the exposure contest (0.36, almost all of it fractional credit for its uniform tie on events where it was undefined), was defined there for 8 of 64 gated events (the named and unnamed arms of 4 shown algorithms) and named the landing in all 8.

Table 134. Defined-only top-1 hit rates in the three iteration-3 contests (events gated; defined events; hits among defined events). Source: record audit `tables/defined_only_hits.csv`.

Contest	Family	Gated events	Defined	Hits (defined only)	Rate

Qwen3-8B modal bench bans	subtraction	5	2	0	0.00
Qwen3-8B modal bench bans	ladder	5	1	1	1.00
Qwen3-8B modal bench bans	association	5	5	1	0.20
Qwen3-8B modal bench bans	proximity	5	5	1	0.20
Qwen3-8B exposure bans, named and unnamed	subtraction	64	8	8	1.00
Qwen3-8B exposure bans, named and unnamed	ladder	64	64	52	0.81
Qwen3-8B exposure bans, named and unnamed	association	64	64	31	0.48
Qwen3-8B exposure bans, named and unnamed	proximity	64	64	42	0.66
Llama modal and present minor bans	subtraction	13	12	4	0.33
Llama modal and present minor bans	ladder	13	13	7	0.54
Llama modal and present minor bans	association	13	13	7	0.54
Llama modal and present minor bans	proximity	13	13	3	0.23

Table 135 restates Table 82 per distinct likelihood row. The gains never point at the landing, and the implied mass hits 8 of 11 rows, 6 of them bans of absent algorithms where the landing is the default.

Table 135. The 11 distinct Qwen3-8B likelihood rows: realised landing and the argmax of the gain, of the residual and of the implied mass among survivors. Source: record audit `tables/table82_distinct_rows.csv`.

Task	Banned	Row type	Realised landing	Gain argmax	Residual argmax	Implied-mass argmax	Implied mass hit
grid	A*	sham	BFS	bidirectional BFS	bidirectional BFS	DFS	no
grid	BFS	modal	DFS	IDDFS	IDDFS	DFS	yes
grid	bidirectional BFS	sham	BFS	IDDFS	IDDFS	BFS	yes
grid	DFS	sham	BFS	bidirectional BFS	bidirectional BFS	BFS	yes
grid	unit weight Dijkstra	sham	BFS	IDDFS	bidirectional BFS	DFS	no
grid	IDDFS	sham	BFS	bidirectional BFS	bidirectional BFS	DFS	no
shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	sham	Dijkstra	Dial	Floyd-Warshall	Dijkstra	yes
shortest path	bidirectional Dijkstra	sham	Dijkstra	Dial	Dial	Dijkstra	yes
shortest path	Dial	sham	Dijkstra	bidirectional Dijkstra	bidirectional Dijkstra	Dijkstra	yes
shortest path	Dijkstra	modal	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Dial	Dial	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	yes
shortest path	Floyd-Warshall	sham	Dijkstra	Dial	Dial	Dijkstra	yes

The audit also scored, on the iteration-3 screen, the predictors of ban compliance that the movability claim competes with (Table 136). Movability and the maximum escape fraction rank the catalogue-only ban avoidance of the 14 tasks far better than the forced-prompt success rate, the clarity of the association, the likelihood mass of the runner-up, the nonce ban or the novelty instruction. These are screen values: the same data produced the movable set.

Table 136. Predictors of catalogue-only modal ban avoidance across the 14 Qwen3-8B tasks

(Spearman rho with Monte Carlo permutation p; balanced accuracy at a median cut). Source: record audit `tables/rival_predictors.csv`.

Predictor	Tasks	Spearman rho	Permutation p	Kendall tau-b	Balanced accuracy	Fisher p
movable (escape fraction above zero)	14	0.86	0.00066	0.73	1.00	0.00033
maximum escape fraction	14	0.85	0.00022	0.69	1.00	0.00033
forced-prompt success rate (can)	14	0.16	0.58	0.15	0.50	1.00
clarity of the association answer	14	-0.07	0.82	-0.06	0.50	1.00
likelihood mass of the runner-up	14	0.19	0.52	0.08	0.50	1.00
nonce ban off-default share	12	-0.19	0.56	-0.16	0.38	0.52
novelty instruction off-default share	14	0.35	0.21	0.28	0.65	0.59

The frozen screen (sha256 d6a2ca9711f461973c39482314a523d448d0590cb40e32432826dec1da4846e8, reproduced byte for byte by a stdlib-only rule from its input file) names six movable tasks: kth smallest, two sum, find duplicate, connected components, and the grid and shortest path tasks, the set the price claim froze. Against catalogue-only ban avoidance of at least 0.5 the table of the screen is 6, 0, 0, 8 (one-sided Fisher $p = 1/3003$), a description of the screen and not a confirmation. Connected components escapes only on the bf16 engine of the bench forecast experiment; the other movable tasks escape on the 8-bit directions of the locus experiment. *(Correction, iteration 6: the escapes of the screen are properties of the model, not of the 8-bit engine. The 40-direction escape fractions of iteration 4 reproduce in bf16 at the same absolute displacement, and the shortest path positive-control direction 9004 of the screen moves that task in bf16 as well (Section 6.3); the shrinkage of the screen under the ban-free unit of iteration 5 belongs to that unit and its direction seeds.)*

4.3 Plan noise priced against every other knob (Qwen3-8B)

Why. The price claim was the primary claim of the iteration and the question of the request in its plainest form: which knob buys correct algorithmic diversity most cheaply. The iteration-3 evidence for random pushes came from fixed directions, three per task on most of the bench, chosen by nobody. This experiment drew a fresh direction for every sample, which is the form a practitioner would use, and priced it on the six movable tasks of the frozen screen against every token-level and prompt-level knob the run had tried, all under one statistic and one price convention.

Design. Qwen3-8B ran with 8-bit linear layers on the 16 GB card, thinking off, and every arm of a task shared the same uniform stream per template and slot, so arms differ only by the knob. Plan noise ran at alpha 0.5, 1, 2 and 4 (and 8 in the dose sweep). The comparison knobs were temperature 1.3 and 1.6 without truncation, top-k 10, the nonce ban, the novelty instruction, the semantic seed on the path tasks and the iteration-3 signature vetoes (one-shot, persistent and iterated, reused rows); min-p 0.1 at temperature 1.6 and 2.0 and a verbalized sampling prompt [46] were preregistered sensitivities. Every cell had $N = 50$ (5 templates by 10 slots): 202 cells and 10,100 labelled programs, with no cell dropped. The 5-point Hill-1 and the prices of 1.5 and 2 were computed on the randomisation hull of each knob with 2,000 bootstrap replicates, and the choice of the best setting of a knob was made inside every replicate. The rule, committed by hash before

the first sample beyond stage 10, confirmed the price claim if plan noise reached a 5-point Hill-1 of at least 1.5 on at least 3 of the 6 tasks, beat the 5-point Hill-1 of the best non-activation knob on at least 4 of 6, and had a pooled margin with a task-bootstrap 95% interval above 0.

The rule returned PARTIAL. Plan noise is not the uniformly cheapest knob (Table 137). It reaches a 5-point Hill-1 of at least 1.5 on only 2 of 6 tasks, against the 3 required, and beats the best non-activation knob on 4 of 6, but the pooled margin is -0.22 with an interval from -0.89 to 0.30 (one-sided $p = 0.76$; exact sign test over the six margins $p = 0.34$). Plan noise wins clearly on kth smallest (2.72 against 1.96 for the novelty instruction, ahead in every bootstrap replicate) and on connected components (2.09 against 1.96 for the iterated veto, ahead in 91%), and on both it reaches Hill-1 of 1.5 and of 2 at no pass cost. It edges two sum and the grid task by margins inside their intervals. It loses decisively on find duplicate, where it does not move the hash set at alpha 2 or less while the reused iterated veto reaches 2.73, and on the shortest path task, where the semantic seed reaches 1.93 against 1.35 for plan noise because pushed Bellman-Ford/SPFA programs cost 14 to 26 pass points.

Table 137. The preregistered price comparison on the six movable tasks: 5-point Hill-1 of plan noise, the best non-activation knob and its 5-point Hill-1, the margin with its bootstrap 95% interval, the bootstrap probability that plan noise is ahead, and the price of 1.5 and price of 2 for plan noise (pass points; a dash means not reached). Source: plan noise experiment `results/c1.json`, `results/summary.md`.

Task (default)	5-point Hill-1, plan noise	Best non-activation knob	Its 5-point Hill-1	Margin [95% CI]	P(plan noise ahead)	Price of 1.5, plan noise	Price of 2, plan noise
kth smallest (full sort)	2.72	novelty instruction	1.96	0.76 [0.21, 1.16]	1.00	0.0	0.0
two sum (hash map)	1.29	novelty instruction	1.24	0.05 [-0.20, 0.37]	0.67	11.1	-
find duplicate (hash set)	1.00	iterated veto	2.73	-1.73 [-2.06, -1.39]	0.00	-	-
connected components (union find)	2.09	iterated veto	1.96	0.13 [-0.00, 0.37]	0.91	0.0	0.0
grid (BFS)	1.42	novelty instruction	1.34	0.07 [-0.57, 0.41]	0.49	18.0	49.8
shortest path (Dijkstra)	1.35	semantic seed	1.93	-0.58 [-0.69, -0.14]	0.00	9.3	-

Table 138 gives 5-point Hill-1 for every knob class on the six tasks. Temperature, top-k 10 and the nonce ban buy no correct algorithmic diversity on any of them (5-point Hill-1 at most 1.09), and min-p reaches at most 1.17. The novelty instruction switches kth smallest wholesale to quickselect, a Hill-1 of 1.0 on its own; its 1.96 comes from mixing it with the twin on the hull. Top-k 10 never changed a single token sequence, because the top 10 tokens of the model carry essentially all the probability mass on these prompts. The verbalized sampling prompt is a measurement artifact rather than a knob: 46 to 49 of 50 of its programs on every bench task and on the grid task call a random choice inside the solution function, so their mechanism label is whichever branch the trace

of the labeller happened to execute.

Table 138. 5-point Hill-1 per knob class on the six movable tasks (randomisation hull, cost at most 5 pass points; a dash means the class was not run on the task). Source: plan noise experiment `results/c1.json`.

Task	Plan noise	Temperature 1.3/1.6	Top-k 10	Nonce ban	Novelty instruction	Semantic seed	One-shot veto	Persistent veto	Iterated veto	Min-p	Verbalized sampling
kth smallest	2.72	1.09	1.00	1.00	1.96	-	1.90	1.88	1.89	1.16	1.29
two sum	1.29	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.24	-	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.04
find duplicate	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	-	1.00	1.00	2.73	1.00	1.01
connected components	2.09	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.17	-	1.02	1.03	1.96	1.09	1.02
grid	1.42	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.34	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
shortest path	1.35	1.09	1.00	1.00	1.24	1.93	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.17	1.00

Every preregistered sensitivity returns the same verdict (Table 139). Excluding the reused vetoes, which came from another engine, turns the pooled margin positive (+0.20, interval -0.19 to 0.60); plan noise then loses only to the semantic seed on the shortest path task.

Table 139. Sensitivities of the price rule; each re-evaluates the full rule. Source: plan noise experiment `results/c1.json`.

Sensitivity	Verdict	Tasks with 5-point Hill-1 at least 1.5	Tasks where plan noise beats the best	Pooled margin [95% CI]
hull restricted to the twin segment	PARTIAL	2	3	-0.266 [-0.905, 0.246]
min-p and verbalized sampling added to the comparison set	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.218 [-0.897, 0.314]
min-p only added	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.218 [-0.863, 0.305]
dial interpolation instead of the hull	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.022 [-0.710, 0.607]
template-cluster bootstrap	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.218 [-0.866, 0.329]
slot-paired bootstrap	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.218 [-0.893, 0.322]
other programs excluded	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.243 [-0.892, 0.263]
other programs as one category	PARTIAL	2	4	-0.219 [-0.892, 0.326]

reused vetoes excluded	PARTIAL	2	4	0.202 [-0.188, 0.600]
hull vertices from the record audit only	PARTIAL	2	3	-0.134 [-0.721, 0.512]
deviation on hull edges (added in iteration 5): the preregistered hull search is restricted to edges; it matched an optimiser over the full simplex within 0.02 on the unit cases but fell short by up to 0.19 Hill-1 on random 5-vertex Dirichlet(0.5) cases, a shortfall that falls on plan noise (5 hull vertices against 2 or 3 for most comparison knobs)	not evaluated again	n/a	n/a	n/a
triangle check on the real data (added in iteration 5): the largest gain of a 3-vertex face over the best edge, over all classes, is +0.008 (connected components, plan noise; 42 entries with a value, 113 null)	verdict unaffected	2	4	-0.22

Ideas against phrasings. Under common random numbers the effect of each knob can be read slot by slot (Table 140). Temperature rewrites code without changing the algorithm: on the grid task temperature 1.6 changes the code in 88% of slots and the label in 2%, and it raises the phrasing clusters within BFS from 13.6 to 18.5 (20 programs, Jaccard at least 0.8). Plan noise changes the algorithm: at alpha 2 the label differs from that of the twin in 50% of slots on kth smallest, 60% on connected components and 54% on the shortest path task.

Table 140. Share of common-random-number slots in which the code differs from the twin and in which the algorithm label differs (N = 50 per cell). Source: plan noise experiment `results/flips.json`.

Task	Temperature 1.3	Temperature 1.6	Top-k 10	Nonce ban	Novelty instruction	Plan noise 0.5	Plan noise 1	Plan noise 2	Plan noise 4
kth smallest	0.04 / 0.02	0.14 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.00	0.12 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00	0.14 / 0.08	0.38 / 0.28	0.72 / 0.50	0.88 / 0.54
two sum	0.16 / 0.00	0.32 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.00	0.14 / 0.00	0.94 / 0.08	0.32 / 0.00	0.40 / 0.00	0.50 / 0.02	0.86 / 0.28
find duplicate	0.08 / 0.00	0.10 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.00	0.28 / 0.00	0.82 / 0.02	0.20 / 0.00	0.50 / 0.00	0.82 / 0.02	0.98 / 0.56
connected components	0.22 / 0.00	0.48 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.00	0.66 / 0.00	0.94 / 0.04	0.52 / 0.00	0.84 / 0.12	0.90 / 0.60	0.98 / 0.70
grid	0.64 / 0.00	0.88 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.00	0.94 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.56	0.96 / 0.02	1.00 / 0.06	1.00 / 0.24	1.00 / 0.30
shortest path	0.36 / 0.00	0.66 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.00	0.56 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.06	0.66 / 0.08	0.92 / 0.26	0.98 / 0.54	1.00 / 0.66

Each cell gives code differs / label differs.

Dose and breakage. The share of attempts off the default rises with alpha up to 2 on kth smallest, connected components and both path tasks, while two sum and find duplicate stay on their defaults until alpha 4 (Table 141). Breakage, a pass rate below 0.8 times that of the twin, arrives at alpha 4 on kth smallest, find duplicate, connected components and the grid task, at alpha 2 on the shortest path task and at alpha 8 on two sum; at alpha 8 almost nothing passes. Correct-only diversity peaks at alpha 2 on kth smallest (2.87, pass 0.94) and the shortest path task (1.95, pass 0.74) and at alpha 4 on connected components (2.56, pass 0.42). The realised displacement at block 12 matched

its target within 0.15% on all 3,220 plan noise rows.

Table 141. Dose response of plan noise on the six movable tasks (N = 50 per dose): pass rate, share of attempts off the default, correct-only rarefied Hill-1 and the composition of correct programs. Source: plan noise experiment `results/alpha_sweep.json`.

Task	Alpha	Pass	Off default	Hill-1	Correct programs
kth smallest	0	1.00	0.00	1.00	full sort 50
kth smallest	0.5	1.00	0.08	1.30	full sort 46, quickselect 4
kth smallest	1	1.00	0.28	2.14	full sort 36, quickselect 9, size-k heap 5
kth smallest	2	0.94	0.50	2.87	full sort 24, quickselect 14, size-k heap 8, other 1
kth smallest	4	0.74	0.54	2.71	quickselect 17, full sort 16, size-k heap 3, heapify and pop 1
kth smallest	8	0.04	0.38 (invalid 0.54)	2.00	quickselect 1, full sort 1
two sum	0 to 1	1.00	0.00	1.00	hash map 50
two sum	2	1.00	0.02	1.09	hash map 49, brute force 1
two sum	4	0.80	0.28	1.79	hash map 29, brute force 11
two sum	8	0.00	0.08 (invalid 0.92)	n/a	none
find duplicate	0 to 1	1.00	0.00	1.00	hash set 50
find duplicate	2	0.98	0.02	1.00	hash set 49
find duplicate	4	0.24	0.52	1.00	hash set 12
find duplicate	8	0.00	0.06 (invalid 0.94)	n/a	none
connected components	0 to 0.5	1.00	0.00	1.00	union find 50
connected components	1	1.00	0.12	1.42	union find 44, DFS 6
connected components	2	1.00	0.60	2.10	DFS 29, union find 20, BFS 1
connected components	4	0.42	0.64	2.56	union find 10, DFS 9, BFS 2
connected components	8	0.00	0.14 (invalid 0.86)	n/a	none
grid	0	0.74	0.00	1.00	BFS 37
grid	0.5	0.86	0.02	1.00	BFS 43
grid	1	0.70	0.06	1.14	BFS 34, DFS 1
grid	2	0.72	0.24	1.42	BFS 32, DFS 4
grid	4	0.24	0.30	2.06	BFS 9, DFS 2, Dijkstra 1
grid	8	0.00	0.70 (invalid 0.06)	n/a	none
shortest path	0	1.00	0.00	1.00	Dijkstra 50
shortest path	0.5	0.98	0.08	1.26	Dijkstra 46, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3
shortest path	1	0.86	0.26	1.66	Dijkstra 34, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9
shortest path	2	0.74	0.54	1.95	Dijkstra 22, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 15
shortest path	4	0.04	0.66	1.00	Dijkstra 2
shortest path	8	0.00	0.90 (invalid 0.04)	n/a	none

[Figure fig_pn_dose: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The held-out task and the immovable tasks. Cycle detection, the bench task that the 12-task cap had excluded and on which nothing had been run, barely moves under plan noise: an off-default excess of 0.01 at alpha 2 or less, a 5-point Hill-1 of 1.09 and a price of 1.5 of 29 points. On the eight bench tasks the screen called immovable, plan noise at alpha 2 or less moves almost nothing (Table 142), which agrees with the screen. The strongest knob there is the novelty instruction on substring search (5-point Hill-1 2.57).

Table 142. Cycle detection (held out) and the eight immovable bench tasks: plan noise off-default excess at alpha 2 or less, and 5-point Hill-1 per knob. Source: plan noise experiment `results/nonmovable.json`.

Task	Plan noise off-default excess	5-point Hill-1, plan noise	5-point Hill-1, temperature	5-point Hill-1, nonce ban	5-point Hill-1, novelty instruction	Price of 1.5, plan noise
nonoverlapping intervals	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	-
cycle detection (held out)	0.01	1.09	1.00	1.00	1.37	29.0
topological order	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	-
first and last position	-0.08	1.37	1.42	1.21	1.20	-
substring search	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	2.57	-
Fibonacci	0.01	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.04	-
longest increasing subsequence	0.03	1.01	1.00	1.00	1.05	-
merge intervals	0.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	-
top-k frequent	0.04	1.14	1.00	1.00	1.00	-

Table 142b. The screen forecast committed before stage 100, which treated fresh plan noise as an equal mixture of the fixed directions of the screen, against the realised result: 5-point Hill-1 of plan noise, the margin over the best non-activation knob, and the divergence of the forecast alpha-1 composition from the realised one against its resampling null. Source: plan noise experiment `results/forecast_score.json`.

Task	Forecast 5-point Hill-1	Realised	Forecast margin	Realised margin	Divergence (null p95)	Within null
kth smallest	2.38	2.72	0.45	0.76	0.0056 (0.0768)	yes
two sum	1.78	1.29	0.61	0.05	0.0101 (0.0)	no
find duplicate	1.76	1.00	-0.97	-1.73	0.0 (0.0)	yes
connected components	1.33	2.09	-0.63	0.13	0.0021 (0.0307)	yes
grid	1.09	1.42	n/a	0.07	0.0087 (0.0301)	yes
shortest path	1.35	1.35	0.35	-0.58	0.0041 (0.115)	yes

The forecast implied PARTIAL, and the realised verdict was PARTIAL. Unlike a prompt ban, plan noise moves the model under every template, the fourth included (Table 142c), so its effect does not inherit the wording dependence of bans.

Table 142c. Plan noise off-default share per template (N = 10 per cell) on the four tasks it moves, with the novelty instruction for comparison. Source: plan noise experiment `results/per_template.json`.

Task	Arm	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth
kth smallest	plan noise, alpha 1	0.1	0.2	0.5	0.1	0.5
kth smallest	plan noise, alpha 2	0.4	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.5
kth smallest	novelty instruction	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
connected components	plan noise, alpha 1	0.2	0.2	0.0	0.0	0.2
connected components	plan noise, alpha 2	0.8	0.6	0.4	0.6	0.6
connected components	novelty instruction	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0
grid	plan noise, alpha 1	0.1	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.0
grid	plan noise, alpha 2	0.2	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.3
grid	novelty instruction	0.6	0.6	0.7	0.3	0.6
shortest path	plan noise, alpha 1	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.6
shortest path	plan noise, alpha 2	0.5	0.4	0.6	0.6	0.6
shortest path	novelty instruction	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.2	0.0

Controls and checks. The prohibition frame of the neutral twin is inert for the algorithm: a plain prompt with the specification alone and the twin have identical off-default shares on five of the six movable tasks ($+0.02$ on the shortest path task), although the frame costs 18 pass points on the grid task and adds 22 on cycle detection. *(Added in iteration 5: plan noise was also run on the plain prompt without the prohibition frame of the twin (alpha 1, 350 programs on the same common-random-number slots), and the record did not report it. Its off-default shares were 0.16 on kth smallest (0.28 under the twin frame), 0.24 on connected components (0.12), 0.26 on the shortest path task (0.26), 0.02 on the grid task (0.06) and 0 on two sum, find duplicate and cycle detection. Plan noise does not need the frame on kth smallest, connected components and the shortest path task; under plan noise at alpha 1 the frame costs 10 pass points on the grid task (interval -6 to 28). Table 173 gives the rows.)* A forecast committed before stage 100, which treated fresh noise as an equal mixture of the fixed directions of the screen, predicted the PARTIAL verdict and the alpha-1 composition within the resampling null on 5 of 6 tasks; it over-predicted find duplicate (1.76 forecast against 1.00) and two sum and under-predicted connected components. Two screen rows rerun with the keys of the screen itself agreed slot for slot (label agreement 1.00 on all four cells). The labellers recovered every reference on all 13 bench tasks. The 12 correct programs labelled other were all labeller misses, and no novel algorithm appeared. A judge agreed with the labeller on 1.00 of audited programs everywhere except kth smallest (0.80), and rescoring kth smallest with the labels of the judge left its margin at $+0.71$ against $+0.76$. Replacing every plan noise setting by the twin gave margins of 0 or below on all six tasks, and under 100 within-task shuffles of the arm labels the full committed rule never returned CONFIRMED; the count criteria alone fired in 8 of 100 shuffles in the independent rederivation, so the interval criterion is what makes the rule specific. The rederivation matched 12 of 12 checks, and the hash chain shows the commitment preceding the first row beyond stage 10.

4.4 Where the noise must enter (Qwen3-8B)

Why. If the plan lives in the task-specification states, the same random displacement should change the algorithm there and nowhere else. If any perturbation of matched size does as well, the effect is generic sensitivity, and the word plan names nothing. This experiment wrote one random displacement per common-random-number slot into six sites at matched per-position dose in ban units and priced each site on the randomisation hull.

Design. The six sites were the task-specification states at blocks 12 to 23 (the plan site of the hypothesis), the read position, the condition sentence, generated tokens 1 to 32 (through teacher-forced shadow rows), the task-specification states at blocks 0 to 11, and the same states at blocks

24 to 35. Each ran at alpha 1, 2 and 4 with N = 30 per cell (twin N = 50) on the six movable tasks, with energy-matched variants of the read position and condition sites and the plan site at alpha 8 for the boundary. One fresh direction and one stream of token uniforms per slot were shared by every arm, so every site contrast is an exact paired flip. In all 4,510 programs ran; 4,460 decisive rows followed the commitment, and none preceded it. The preregistered rule called the site claim confirmed if the plan site had the highest 5-point Hill-1 on at least 4 of 6 tasks.

The rule returned PARTIAL, and three sites are inert. The plan site has the best 5-point Hill-1 on 3 of 6 tasks (kth smallest, the grid task and the shortest path task; p = 0.062 against a binomial with chance 1/6), generated-token noise is best on two sum and find duplicate, and early-block noise on connected components (Table 143). Every per-task margin is a bootstrap close call except the shortest path task, where the plan site is ahead in 97% of replicates. The read position and the condition sentence never changed the algorithm at per-position doses of 1 to 4 ban units (corrected in iteration 5 from the phrase *at any dose*; the energy-matched read position below is weaker but not inert): 0 of 526 and 0 of 527 correct programs off the default at alpha 1 to 4. The late blocks are almost as inert (6 of 521). The outputs at these three sites are often byte-identical to those of the twin, 90% to 100% at alpha 1 on kth smallest, two sum and find duplicate for the read position and the late blocks.

Table 143. 5-point Hill-1 per site (correct-only rarefied Hill-1 within 0.05 pass cost of the twin; randomisation hull; 2,000 template-stratified bootstrap replicates with the hull maximum recomputed inside each), the best site, the margin of the plan site over the best other site and the probability that the plan site is best. Source: site experiment `results/c1_site.json`.

Task (default)	Task spec, blocks 12-23	Read position	Condition sentence	Generated tokens 1-32	Task spec, blocks 0-11	Task spec, blocks 24-35	Best	Margin [95% CI]	P(plan site best)
kth smallest (full sort)	2.61	1.00	1.00	2.24	2.46	1.00	plan site	0.15 [-0.75, 0.87]	0.59
two sum (hash map)	1.28	1.00	1.00	1.28	1.14	1.00	generated tokens	-0.00 [-0.49, 0.32]	0.38
find duplicate (hash set)	1.16	1.00	1.00	1.24	1.00	1.00	generated tokens	-0.08 [-0.41, 0.27]	0.31
connected components (union find)	2.23	1.00	1.00	1.24	2.32	1.38	blocks 0-11	-0.08 [-0.78, 0.49]	0.33
grid (BFS)	1.29	1.00	1.00	1.18	1.13	1.00	plan site	0.11 [-0.28, 0.57]	0.67
shortest path (Dijkstra)	1.66	1.00	1.00	1.12	1.22	1.15	plan site	0.44 [-0.00, 0.69]	0.97

[Figure fig_site_h5: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The tie on two sum (1.28 each) went to generated-token noise on the price of 1.5 (0.12 against 0.53, Table 144). Early-block noise winning connected components carries a dose-convention confound that the plan had named: a ban unit at blocks 0 to 11 is only 4.5% to 7.2% of the residual

norm, against 12.7% to 18.3% at blocks 12 to 23, so early-block noise at alpha 4 is a relative dose comparable to the plan site at alpha 1. No other site matched or beat the 5-point Hill-1 of the plan site on 4 tasks, so the claim is not disconfirmed either. Appending alpha 8 to the hull of the plan site, or allowing only mixtures of adjacent doses, left every ranking unchanged.

Table 144. Prices of 1.5 and 2 per site: the cheapest pass cost (as a fraction) at which Hill-1 reaches 1.5 and 2 on the hull (n/a: not reached). Source: site experiment `results/hull.json`.

Task	Price of 1.5: blocks 12-23 / read position / condition / generated / blocks 0-11 / blocks 24-35	Price of 2: same order
kth smallest	0.00 / n/a / n/a / 0.01 / 0.00 / n/a	0.00 / n/a / n/a / 0.04 / 0.00 / n/a
two sum	0.53 / n/a / n/a / 0.12 / n/a / n/a	n/a for every site
find duplicate	0.54 / n/a / n/a / 0.16 / n/a / n/a	0.75 / n/a / n/a / 0.37 / n/a / n/a
connected components	0.00 / n/a / n/a / 0.11 / 0.00 / n/a	0.01 / n/a / n/a / 0.19 / 0.02 / n/a
grid	0.14 / n/a / n/a / n/a / n/a / n/a	n/a for every site
shortest path	0.00 / n/a / n/a / n/a / 0.25 / n/a	n/a for every site

Table 145 classifies the failure mode of each site under the frozen rule. Generated-token noise moves four tasks but pays in breakage: it is the only site whose invalid rate climbs to between 0.67 and 1.00 at alpha 4.

Table 145. Failure mode per site and task under the frozen rule († weak movement: a correct-only excess between 0.10 and 0.20 at a pass rate of at least 0.8 times that of the twin, which the rule does not classify). Source: site experiment `results/failure_modes.json`.

Site	kth smallest	two sum	find duplicate	connected components	grid	shortest path
Task spec, blocks 12-23	moves	moves with cost	moves with cost	moves	moves with cost	moves
Read position	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement
Condition sentence	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement	no movement
Generated tokens 1-32	moves	moves	moves with cost	moves	breakage first	breakage first
Task spec, blocks 0-11	moves	weak movement †	no movement	moves	breakage first	weak movement †
Task spec, blocks 24-35	no movement	no movement	no movement	weak movement †	no movement	no movement

The paired flips at alpha 2 make the comparison exact (Table 146). The plan site flips significantly more of the 30 shared slots off the default than the read position, the condition sentence and the late blocks on kth smallest, connected components and both path tasks, and more than the early blocks on kth smallest and connected components. Generated-token noise flips more than the plan site on find duplicate (12 against 0).

Table 146. Paired flips at alpha 2 (30 shared slots): slots off the default only under the plan site : only under the other site, with the exact McNemar p and the byte-identical rate of the other site against the twin. Source: site experiment `results/paired_flips.json`.

Other site	kth smallest	two sum	find duplicate	connected components	grid	shortest path
Read position	14:0 (p 0.00012; 0.93)	3:0 (p 0.25; 0.97)	1:0 (p 1; 0.80)	18:0 (p 7.6e-06; 0.33)	6:0 (p 0.031; 0.13)	8:0 (p 0.0078; 0.57)
Condition sentence	14:0 (p 0.00012; 0.87)	3:0 (p 0.25; 0.70)	1:0 (p 1; 0.87)	18:0 (p 7.6e-06; 0.40)	6:0 (p 0.031; 0.07)	8:1 (p 0.039; 0.57)
Generated tokens 1-32	6:8 (p 0.79; 0.13)	2:7 (p 0.18; 0.10)	0:12 (p 0.00049; 0.07)	10:2 (p 0.039; 0.00)	5:1 (p 0.22; 0.00)	6:3 (p 0.51; 0.00)
Task spec, blocks 0-11	11:1 (p 0.0063; 0.63)	3:0 (p 0.25; 0.57)	1:0 (p 1; 0.40)	13:1 (p 0.0018; 0.27)	5:2 (p 0.45; 0.00)	5:3 (p 0.73; 0.20)
Task spec, blocks 24-35	14:0 (p 0.00012; 0.97)	3:0 (p 0.25; 0.97)	1:0 (p 1; 0.93)	16:1 (p 0.00027; 0.33)	7:0 (p 0.016; 0.27)	7:0 (p 0.016; 0.20)

The effect is not generic transmission. Noise at the read position produces as large a displacement at the last block as the plan site does (medians 141, 250 and 474 against 159, 272 and 461 at alpha 1, 2 and 4), yet it flips nothing. A logistic regression of a correct program being off the default on the log of the realised displacement at the read position, with template and task fixed effects, over 2,769 correct programs from the prefill sites, gives the plan site an indicator of +2.15 [1.79, 2.51] beside a displacement slope of +0.88 [0.62, 1.14]. In the matched-dose bins (the upper three quintiles of displacement) the plan site is off the default in 16% to 27% of programs, against 3% to 7% for the other prefill sites. A hand-coded Mantel-Haenszel odds ratio, which pools the odds of an off-default program at the plan site against the other prefill sites across task and displacement quintile strata, gives 5.72 [3.94, 8.30], and its placebo, with plan-site labels shuffled within task, has a median of 0.98. A Bayesian mixed logistic model with random task and template effects puts the site effects relative to the plan site at -3.0 (read position), -2.9 (condition sentence), -3.0 (late blocks), -0.8 (generated tokens) and -1.1 (early blocks), with the slope of the plan site on log2 alpha at +1.11. Concentrating the whole ban energy at the read position (median displacement there 1,002, six times that of the plan site at alpha 1) moved find duplicate by +0.23 and connected components by +0.18 at pass ratios of 0.87 to 0.93; spreading it over the condition span stayed inert. Generated-token noise produces the most phrasing clusters per idea (4.2 and 4.7 at alpha 1 and 2, against 2.8 and 3.4 for the plan site, AST-shingle components at Jaccard 0.8).

The boundary. At alpha 8 the task specification is effectively erased (Table 147): the model echoes the condition sentence, writes placeholder code or asks for clarification, and the pass rate is 0.00 on every task. Correct-only diversity peaks at alpha 2 (kth smallest, grid, shortest path) or alpha 4 (two sum, find duplicate, connected components), and alpha 4 already costs 33% to 97% of the passes. Across every arm 3,555 programs were correct, and exactly one was labelled other: a find duplicate program from generated-token noise at alpha 2 that calls a count of each element over the list. The judges called it degenerate and a labeller miss, and the manual read, beside its three nearest known solutions, called it the textbook quadratic brute force. No novel algorithm appeared (rule-of-three bound 3/3,555 = 0.08% per correct program [67]).

Table 147. The plan site from alpha 0 to 8: pass rate / invalid rate / correct-only Hill-1. Source: site experiment `results/boundary.json`.

Task	Alpha 0	Alpha 1	Alpha 2	Alpha 4	Alpha 8
kth smallest	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 2.52	0.93 / 0.00 / 2.68	0.67 / 0.00 / 2.23	0.00 / 0.94 / n/a
two sum	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.97 / 0.00 / 1.28	0.30 / 0.07 / 1.70	0.00 / 0.94 / n/a

find duplicate	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.15	0.17 / 0.03 / 2.59	0.00 / 0.94 / n/a
connected components	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.84	0.97 / 0.00 / 2.23	0.23 / 0.10 / 2.73	0.00 / 0.96 / n/a
grid	0.74 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.72 / 0.00 / 1.39	0.68 / 0.00 / 1.51	0.12 / 0.06 / 1.00	0.00 / 0.82 / n/a
shortest path	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.65	0.90 / 0.00 / 1.70	0.03 / 0.07 / 1.00	0.00 / 0.88 / n/a

(Correction, iteration 5: the alpha-4 peaks of this table rest on few correct programs and were rarefied at those depths, not at 25: two sum 9, find duplicate 5 and connected components 7 correct programs (kth smallest 20, grid 6, shortest path 1). The statement that correct-only diversity peaks at alpha 4 on three tasks is therefore a statement about 5 to 9 programs. Depth per cell in Table 178.)

The top-five prohibition at the plan. The request asks what happens when the five most implemented algorithms are prohibited. The prompt version had failed by reimplementation (avoidance 0.00) and the cumulative token veto had stalled. This experiment applied the prohibition as an activation push: the plan states of the grid task were pushed along the per-block direction from the mean of the five banned centroids to the mean of the survivor centroids, estimated from 300 forced prompts in which the centroid of every algorithm was separable from the others (nearest-centroid separability 0.83 to 1.00). The push never moved the model off BFS (Table 148). Correct programs were BFS 30 of 30 at alpha 1 and 19 of 19 at alpha 2, and none passed at alpha 4; fresh random plan noise at the same norm did no better. The test of edge against opposite side could not be computed because no survivor program appeared at any dose, and the plan geometry leaves little to resolve: bidirectional BFS and IDA* sit almost equally far from the banned set (geodesic 0.36 against 0.37; MDS stress-1 0.147; no persistent loop beyond a permutation null).

Table 148. The top-five push at the plan states of the grid task (N = 50 per arm; slots 0 to 9): correct programs, avoidance of the five banned algorithms with Wilson 95% interval, and the composition of correct programs. Source: site experiment `results/c3d.json`.

Arm	Correct	Avoidance of the top five [95%]	Correct programs
top-five push, alpha 1	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.11]	BFS 30
random plan noise, alpha 1	36	0.03 [0.00, 0.14]	BFS 33, DFS 2, other 1
top-five push, alpha 2	19	0.00 [0.00, 0.17]	BFS 19
random plan noise, alpha 2	34	0.00 [0.00, 0.10]	BFS 29, DFS 5
top-five push, alpha 4	0	n/a	none
random plan noise, alpha 4	6	0.00 [0.00, 0.39]	BFS 6
twin	37	0.00 [0.00, 0.09]	BFS 37

The scorecard and checks. Table 149 scores the predictions the experiment committed before its first decisive sample. The engine reproduced the kth smallest and shortest path cells of the screen byte for byte (50 of 50 identical programs on each task, divergence 0.000 against null 95th percentiles of 0.029 and 0.025). Alpha 0 reproduced the twin at every site; the realised displacement along the direction equalled its target within 0.26% at every prefill site. One GPU test failed: shadow states for generated-token noise diverged from an independent teacher-forced pass (minimum cosine 0.679 on kth smallest), and a follow-up showed clean decode-path states diverging by the same order, a property of the 8-bit decode path rather than of the shadow coupling. An independent rederivation checked 146 cells with no mismatch, and a second, written only from raw files, reproduced the headline counts. The alpha-4 compositions of this experiment

differ from the alpha-4 rows of the plan noise experiment beyond a resampling null on four tasks, so these cells do not stand in for the knob table.

Table 149. Predictions committed before the first decisive sample and their outcomes. Source: site experiment `README.md`, `predictions/predictions.json`.

Prediction	Outcome
The plan site has the highest 5-point Hill-1 on at least 4 of 6 tasks	missed: 3 of 6 (PARTIAL)
The read position shows no movement on at least 5 of 6	hit: 6 of 6
The condition sentence stays below the plan site on at least 4 of 6, and may move two sum or find duplicate	hit: 6 of 6 below (5-point Hill-1 1.00 everywhere); it moves nothing
Generated-token noise: more phrasing clusters per idea than the plan site, little idea change, breakage first by alpha 4	clusters hit; little idea change missed (it moves four tasks); breakage by alpha 4 hit (invalid 0.67 to 1.00)
Early-block noise breaks first at alpha 2 or more	missed: it moves kth smallest and connected components at alpha 4 with pass kept
Late-block noise shows no movement at alpha 1 to 2 and breaks at alpha 4	no movement hit (5 of 6; connected components weak); breakage missed (pass at least 0.87)
Energy-matched read position and condition variants break (pass below 0.8 times that of the twin) on at least 4 of 6	missed: 0 of 6 for both
Boundary: pass below 0.5 at alpha 8 on at least 4 of 6	hit: 6 of 6 (pass 0.00 everywhere)
Boundary: correct-only Hill peaks at alpha 2 to 4	hit: alpha 2 on three tasks, alpha 4 on three
Boundary: no judge-confirmed novel algorithm	hit: 0 of 3,555 correct programs
Top-five push: avoidance below 0.5 at alpha 2 or less	hit: 0.00 at alpha 1 and 2
Top-five push lands at the edge (bidirectional BFS) rather than the opposite side	not testable: no survivor program at any dose

4.5 Same seed: temperature against plan noise (Qwen3-8B, question 1a-c of the request)

Why. The request asks three things about temperature: with a tight temperature and top-k 10, does the model produce one idea in many phrasings or many ideas; does loosening it multiply ideas or phrasings; and does the answer hold with the same seed. The run had answered the first two in iteration 1 and the third with thinking off in iteration 2, and had dropped the thinking-on arm twice. This experiment ran the seed-coupled design on the grid task, the shortest path task and kth smallest, with the thinking-on arm made non-droppable, and added plan noise as the second factor so that the same seed could be varied in temperature or in plan.

Design. Each task had 20 token seeds, one per template and slot, and each seed kept one noise stream across every condition (inverse-CDF sampling with common random numbers). The temperature block ran each seed at 0.3, 0.7, 1.0 and 1.3 (top-p 1) and with top-k 10 at 0.7. The plan noise block ran 6 fixed isotropic directions at alpha 1 and 2 and temperature 0.7 and 1.0. The change count of a task is the number of seeds whose algorithm differs across the conditions of a block; for plan noise it is averaged over the 20 three-direction subsets of the 6 directions. Thinking on ran in vLLM with per-request seeds (an exponential race coupling, confirmed by recomputing the first token in 32 of 32 requests), a 16k cap and the completion rate reported. *(Correction, iteration 5: the top-k 10 answer to the request with thinking off is Table 76 of iteration 2: with seeds coupled, the label changed in 0 of 30 seeds in 10 of 12 cells. The thinking-on arm of this experiment ran*

without top-k (top-k off, Gumbel-max coupling through per-request seeds, temperatures 0.3, 0.7, 1.0 and 1.3), so the literal cell of the request, thinking on with top-k 10 and the same seed, was not run in iteration 4. It ran in iteration 5, Section 5.7.)

Temperature never changed the algorithm; plan noise changed it in most seeds on the shortest path task. With thinking off, the algorithm stayed the same across all four temperatures in 20 of 20 seeds on all three tasks, and with thinking on in 20 of 20 seeds on the shortest path task (Table 150); the exact 95% upper bound on the per-seed change rate is 0.168 for each count of 0 in 20. One random plan direction at alpha 1 changed the algorithm in 17.25 of 20 seeds on the shortest path task, 4.55 on kth smallest and 2.5 on the grid task. *(Correction, iteration 5: these are not rates per direction. Each is the mean, over the 20 three-direction subsets of the 6 directions, of the number of seeds whose label differs anywhere among the no-noise arm and the three directions of the subset, a union over three directions. The single-direction counts of changed seeds at alpha 1 and temperature 1.0 are 7, 10, 15, 17, 3 and 8 of 20 on the shortest path task, 2, 0, 0, 7, 2 and 0 on kth smallest, and 0, 0, 1, 1, 3 and 0 on the grid task.)* The paired contrast per seed, plan noise change minus temperature change, pooled over the shortest path task and kth smallest (40 seeds), has a mean of 0.545 [0.41, 0.67] and a one-sided sign-flip p of 1.0e-5. That is the single entry of the experiment in the secondary family of the iteration. A within-seed permutation of conditions puts the observed mean above all 200 placebo means (maximum 0.155; $p = 0.005$).

Table 150. Seeds (of 20) whose algorithm changes across temperatures, thinking off and on, and across plan noise draws (mean over 20 three-direction subsets), by dose and temperature. Source: same seed experiment `results/c1seed.json`.

Task	Temperature, thinking off (4 temperatures)	Temperature, thinking on (4 temperatures)	Plan noise alpha 1, T 0.7	Plan noise alpha 1, T 1.0	Plan noise alpha 2, T 0.7	Plan noise alpha 2, T 1.0	Correct only, alpha 1, T 1.0
shortest path	0	0	17.70	17.25	18.45	19.05	10.25
kth smallest	0	not run	4.40	4.55	10.30	10.60	4.05
grid	0	0 of 10 seeds (reduced arm)	1.50	2.50	8.95	8.70	1.45

[Figure fig_seed_counts: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The preregistered verdict is PARTIAL: the temperature, phrasing and coupling predictions hold, and the plan noise prediction (at least 5 of 20 seeds) fails on kth smallest, at 4.55. The plan prescribed the unit of the bench forecast experiment for kth smallest, which is 1/1.30 of the unit the screen used, so alpha 1 here is a weaker push than alpha 1 of the screen; at alpha 2 kth smallest reaches 10.6, and under a Gumbel-max coupling 5.8. Counted over correct programs or with invalid outputs as a label, the temperature count stays 0 on every task; with top-k 10 added as a fifth condition it stays 0; with min-p 0.1 at temperature 2.0 added it becomes 1 on the shortest path task and kth smallest (one Bellman-Ford/SPFA and one quickselect program out of 20) and stays 0 on the grid task.

Temperature changes phrasings, not ideas. Phrasings per idea grow with temperature (Table 151): the pooled slope of log phrasings per idea on temperature is 0.64, 0.70 and 0.81 at Jaccard thresholds 0.7, 0.8 and 0.9, each 95% interval excluding 0. Almost all of the growth is on the grid task (3 to 13 clusters at threshold 0.8). The shortest path task barely moves (1 to 2) and kth smallest does not move (2 at every temperature). At alpha 1 and temperature 0.7, the rarefied

Hill-1 of correct ideas is 1.87 on the shortest path task, 1.31 on kth smallest and 1.15 on the grid task, while top-k 10 gives 1.00 on all three. Plan noise lands on Bellman-Ford/SPFA on the shortest path task (52 of 60 off-default programs, 8 other), on quickselect on kth smallest (11 of 11) and on DFS on the grid task (5). It costs correctness on the shortest path task: pass 0.63 at alpha 1 and temperature 1.0 and 0.42 at alpha 2, against 1.00 without it. Once a seed has been nudged off the default, temperature can act on the idea: under the escaping direction, temperature 0.7 against 1.0 changes the label in 5 of 20 seeds on the shortest path task and 2 of 20 on kth smallest, against 0 of 20 without plan noise.

Table 151. Phrasing clusters per idea at Jaccard threshold 0.8 by temperature (20 programs per cell, thinking off, no plan noise). Source: same seed experiment `results/phrasing.json`.

Task	T 0.3	T 0.7	T 1.0	T 1.3
shortest path	1	2	2	2
kth smallest	2	2	2	2
grid	3	10	12	13

Thinking on. All 100 shortest path traces completed within the cap (Table 152). Every final program and every first approach named was Dijkstra at every temperature, and every program passed. A repeat at temperature 0.7 diverged byte for byte in all 20 traces (first divergence at token 34 to 653), because this GPU generation lacks batch invariance, yet the final label and the first approach named agreed in 20 of 20; the temperature count of 0 is read against a noise floor of 0. A judge naming the first approach of 20 traces agreed with the lexicon on 20 of 20. In the reduced grid arm (10 seeds) all 40 traces completed (median 5.2k to 6.2k thinking tokens, maximum 9.0k), and every final program and first approach was BFS, a temperature count of 0 of 10 (exact 95% upper rate 0.31). With thinking on, plan noise at alpha 2 and temperature 0.7 (2,048-token cap, the three directions with the highest thinking-off off-default share) moved the first approach named in 1, 0 and 0 of 10 seeds, short of the committed expectation of at least 3 of 10 for some direction. Once the model thinks, the prefill nudge no longer redirects the first idea it names.

Table 152. Thinking on, shortest path task (20 seeds per temperature, 16k cap, vLLM). Source: same seed experiment `results/thinking.json`.

Temperature	Completed	Median thinking tokens (maximum)	Final label	First approach named
0.3	20 of 20	4,097 (7,381)	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20
0.7	20 of 20	3,952 (6,327)	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20
1.0	20 of 20	4,320 (8,808)	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20
1.3	20 of 20	4,020 (12,612)	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20
0.7, repeat	20 of 20	4,001 (7,427)	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20

Checks. The engine check reran the kth smallest and shortest path cells of the screen with their twins and reproduced 200 of 200 programs token for token (size-k heap 19, quickselect 16, full sort 15; Dijkstra 26, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 24). Filler repeats in other batches were byte-identical in 60 of 60, and the engine-check slots matched the rows of the temperature block at 1.0 in 40 of 40. Under a Gumbel-max replicate the temperature count stays 0 on both tasks, plan noise changes 16.05 of 20 seeds on the shortest path task and 5.8 on kth smallest, and the pooled contrast is 0.546 ($p = 1.0e\text{-}5$). With min-p 0.1 at temperature 2.0, the shortest path task wrote Dijkstra 19 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1, kth smallest full sort 19 and quickselect 1, and the grid task BFS 20. The condition-shuffle placebo rejected at p below 0.05 in 2% of 200 runs, and the placebo of the independent rederivation in 10.5%; over 1,440 placebo runs the rejection rate is about 6%. The only correct program labelled other was a naive Dijkstra, a labeller miss; no novel algorithm appeared. The rederivation, sharing no code with the analysis, matched 33 of 33 checks, and the commitment

precedes the first decisive row. An 8-bit cross-check of the two engines on the shortest path twin gave Dijkstra 50 of 50 on each, a divergence of 0 bits, which is weak by construction because the cell is all Dijkstra.

4.6 The plan subspace: does the geometry of forced prompts explain which pushes move the algorithm? (Qwen3-8B)

Why. The site experiment located the choice in the task-specification states at early to middle blocks, but a site is not a representation. The subspace claim gave the internal account the request asks for a testable form: if the algorithm choice is represented along the directions that separate the per-algorithm centroids, a random push should change the algorithm to the extent that it moves the state along them. This experiment built the subspace from forced prompts alone and asked whether it ranks 40 fresh random directions by their effect, whether removing the in-subspace component of a push removes the effect, and whether a push aimed at the runner-up centroid crosses at the predicted distance.

Design. For each of 15 tasks the plan subspace at blocks 12 to 35 was the span of the centroid differences of the task-specification states (mean over the specification positions) under 30 forced paraphrases per algorithm (10 forced templates by 3 names), and a masked twin used 30 leak-checked descriptions per algorithm. The projection share of a direction is its squared norm in the subspace over its total, averaged over blocks. Forty never-run directions at alpha 1 and 2, with $N = 10$ each and passers topped up to $N = 30$, ran on the six movable tasks; 8 directions at both doses ran on the other nine, including cycle detection on its ban-free unit. Every predictor was committed by hash before the first population sample. The run sampled 13,500 programs in 675 batches of 20 over 2.51 GPU hours, labelled by runtime tracer and AST rules with a blind judge on 752 disagreements; 4 disputed and 97 invalid rows were excluded from shares.

The subspace is real and reliable. At block 18 the split-half principal-angle cosine between two halves of the paraphrases is 0.89 to 0.97 on all 15 tasks, against 0.02 to 0.03 for random subspaces of equal dimension, and every centroid difference has a split-half cosine of at least 0.74. Named and masked differences agree only moderately (cosine 0.12 to 1.00 at block 18), so the subspace carries a lexical component. The iteration-3 ban displacement projects strongly onto it (projection share 0.02 to 0.77; 0.08 to 0.39 on the six movable tasks), while a random direction has a share near k/4096, about 0.001. The committed plausibility ratio, the expected in-subspace part of a random push over the distance from the default to the runner-up centroid, is 0.10 to 0.29 on 14 tasks and 0.51 on the grid task: a linear plan account predicted before sampling that random pushes would almost never cross to the runner-up through the subspace.

The projection share does not predict which pushes move the algorithm. The preregistered test, a within-task Spearman correlation of at least 0.4 with p below 0.01 on at least 4 of 6 tasks, failed on all six, and so did the masked variant (Table 153). The pooled within-task correlation is 0.03 [-0.03, 0.09], and the correlation of every task lies inside its random-subspace null. The null is not for want of movers: 34 to 37 of 40 directions moved the algorithm at least once on kth smallest, the shortest path task and connected components. Nor is it noise. Splitting the first 10 samples of each direction by template, the two halves rank the 40 directions alike (Spearman 0.80 on kth smallest, 0.81 on the shortest path task, 0.76 on two sum, 0.90 on connected components; projected to full length by the Spearman-Brown formula, 0.86 to 0.95), and alpha 1 and alpha 2 rank them alike (0.61 to 0.72). Which direction moves the algorithm is a stable property of the direction, with a ceiling near 0.9 for any predictor, and the subspace share explains none of it. The only signal came from the signed component toward the runner-up on connected components (0.32

to 0.33, unadjusted p near 0.02), and the within-class control did as well (0.37).

Table 153. Correlation of the off-default share of each direction (first 10 samples, averaged over alpha 1 and 2) with the committed predictors, over 40 directions per task (Spearman rho, permutation p in brackets; κ is the committed plausibility ratio). Source: plan subspace experiment `results/c2a.json`.

Task	Directions that moved	Projection share	Masked share	Signed component	Signed toward runner-up	Realised share	Wrong subspace	Within-class	Gain	Random-subspace null p95	Partial, given gain	κ
kth smallest	34 of 40	0.14 (0.21)	0.11 (0.26)	-0.22 (0.91)	-0.16 (0.84)	0.11	0.03	0.20	-0.10	0.26	0.12	0.13
shortest path	37 of 40	0.09 (0.29)	-0.05 (0.62)	0.01 (0.49)	-0.03 (0.57)	0.15	-0.30	-0.05	-0.04	0.25	0.08	0.20
two sum	10 of 40	0.08 (0.33)	0.03 (0.42)	0.09 (0.29)	0.21 (0.10)	-0.24	0.05	0.07	-0.16	0.27	0.05	0.14
connected components	36 of 40	-0.05 (0.62)	-0.03 (0.57)	0.32 (0.026)	0.33 (0.021)	-0.14	-0.12	0.37	-0.06	0.26	-0.05	0.14
find duplicate	3 of 40 (underpowered)	-0.01 (0.52)	-0.04 (0.60)	-0.06 (0.63)	-0.05 (0.62)	-0.02	-0.17	-0.11	-0.15	0.25	-0.00	0.21
grid	22 of 40	-0.06 (0.64)	0.05 (0.37)	0.18 (0.13)	0.00 (0.49)	-0.09	-0.07	-0.04	0.25	0.25	-0.01	0.51

Escape, confirmed on fresh directions. Random pushes at the plan site buy correct alternative algorithms on four tasks, rarely on the grid task and two sum at alpha 1, and never on the remaining nine (Table 154). Every twin wrote its default in all samples (top-k frequent 90%). The landing is a property of the task, not of the direction, at a given site (qualified in iteration 5: on find duplicate the landing depends on the site; generated-token noise and the energy-matched read position land on Floyd cycle detection, the single plan-site escape of the screen on sort and adjacent check): on every movable task the excess-weighted landing of the 40 fresh directions reproduces the landing of the screen. The single screen escape of find duplicate did not replicate in 40 fresh directions at either dose, so find duplicate is not movable on fresh draws, and cycle detection, pushed on its ban-free unit, did not move in 16 cells. Population programs stayed mostly correct (pass over all population and top-up programs 0.98 on kth smallest, 1.00 on two sum, 0.99 on find duplicate, 0.97 on connected components), with the path tasks the exception (0.84 and 0.79): 255 of 422 pushed Bellman-Ford/SPFA programs and 55 of 123 pushed DFS programs passed.

Table 154. Escape fractions on 40 fresh directions per dose (confirmed at N = 30 by an exact binomial test; 95% interval), with the excess-weighted landing of this run and of the iteration-3 screen. Source: plan subspace experiment `results/escape.json`.

Task (default)	Escape, alpha 1 [95%]	Escape, alpha 2 [95%]	Push landing, this run	Screen landing
kth smallest (full sort)	12/40 = 0.30 [0.18, 0.45]	25/40 = 0.63 [0.47, 0.76]	quickselect 0.66, size-k heap 0.31, heapify and pop 0.03	quickselect 0.64, size-k heap 0.35
connected components (union find)	15/40 = 0.38 [0.24, 0.53]	29/40 = 0.73 [0.57, 0.84]	DFS 0.83, BFS 0.17	DFS 1.00

shortest path (Dijkstra)	7/40 = 0.18 [0.09, 0.32]	8/40 = 0.20 [0.10, 0.35]	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 0.99	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 1.00
two sum (hash map)	0/40 [0, 0.09]	5/40 = 0.13 [0.05, 0.26]	brute force 1.00	brute force 1.00
grid (BFS)	2/40 = 0.05 [0.01, 0.17]	5/40 = 0.13 [0.05, 0.26]	DFS 1.00	DFS 1.00
find duplicate (hash set)	0/40 [0, 0.09]	0/40 [0, 0.09]	none	sort and adjacent check 0.79 (1 of 3 directions)
substring search, Fibonacci, longest increasing subsequence, merge intervals, top-k frequent, nonoverlapping intervals, topological order, first and last position, cycle detection	0/8 each	0/8 each (one top-k frequent screen passer not confirmed)	none	none

The in-subspace component is not needed. Up to four confirmed escaping directions per task (20 in all) were resampled on the same slots in three forms: with the subspace component removed, with only that component amplified to the full norm of the push, and with the subspace component of the realised displacement clamped to 0 at every edited block. Table 155 gives the effect ratio of each form against the original push. On every task with clear escapes, removing the subspace component leaves the effect intact (pooled median ratio 1.00 [0.88, 1.08]), and clamping leaves it intact on kth smallest, two sum and connected components while removing about a third of it on the path tasks. The in-subspace component alone, at the same norm, also escapes for 9 of 20 directions, all four on kth smallest. On the most movable tasks a push of this size flips the algorithm along many directions, inside the subspace or outside it. This is the generic-sensitivity account the plan named as the main confound.

Table 155. Effect ratio (arm share minus twin share, over original push share minus twin share) of the decomposed pushes on the same common-random-number slots (N = 20 per arm). Source: plan subspace experiment `results/decomposition.json`.

Task	Committed reading	Median ratio, subspace part removed [CI]	Median ratio, subspace part only	Subspace part escapes alone	Median ratio, realised subspace part clamped
kth smallest	subspace not needed; sufficient when amplified	1.00 [1.00, 1.00]	0.77	4 of 4	1.00
shortest path	subspace not needed	1.00 [0.74, 1.40]	0.09	1 of 4	0.63
two sum	subspace not needed	0.81 [0.60, 1.25]	0.70	2 of 4	1.04
connected components	subspace not needed	1.00 [0.90, 1.02]	1.00	2 of 4	1.00
grid	mixed	0.78 [0.27, 1.50]	0.06	0 of 4	0.64
pooled (20 directions)	subspace not needed	1.00 [0.88, 1.08]	0.32	9 of 20	1.00

A targeted push works on one task, and there the geometry is exact. A push along the direction from the default centroid to the runner-up centroid moved the mean specification state by

a fraction s of their distance, with s = 0.5 the predicted midpoint; its control was a random direction with the same per-position magnitude on the same slots. The committed rule (Hill-1 of at least 1.8 within 5 pass points at the midpoint on at least 4 of 6 tasks, at no more than half the median escaping random norm) was met on 1 of 6 tasks, and the targeted push was indistinguishable from the matched random push on 5 of 6 (Table 156). Connected components is the exception. Half the distance to the DFS centroid, 0.15 ban units or a tenth of a random push, turned 48% of programs into correct DFS against 0% for the matched random push (24 slots against 0; McNemar p = 1.2e-7), and the empirical crossing at 0.59 sits at the predicted midpoint. On kth smallest the crossing is at 0.85 of the distance, and the masked axis is stronger than the named one at the midpoint (0.43 against 0.08). On the other four tasks the midpoint does nothing; at 4 ban units the same axis gives 100% brute force on two sum (77% correct), 100% DFS on the grid task (20% correct) and 63% Bellman-Ford/SPFA on the shortest path task (none correct).

Table 156. The targeted push along the default-to-runner-up axis: off-default share at s = 0.25, 0.5 and 1.0, the matched random push, paired flips and the share difference, the 50% crossing, the masked axis at the midpoint, and the sweep at alpha 4 and 8 (pass in brackets). Source: plan subspace experiment `results/c2c.json`.

Task (runner-up)	Off default at s = 0.25 / 0.5 / 1.0	Random, same magnitude (s = 0.5)	Flips targeted only / random only; difference [95% CI]	50% crossing s [CI]	Masked axis (s = 0.5)	Sweep alpha 4 / 8 (pass)
connected components (DFS)	0.07 / 0.48 / 0.93	0.00	24 / 0; +0.48 [0.34, 0.62]	0.59 [0.50, 0.70]	0.63	1.00 (0.97) / 0.40 (0.00)
kth smallest (quickselect)	0.03 / 0.08 / 0.73	0.02	3 / 0; +0.06 [0.00, 0.12]	0.85 [0.76, 0.95]	0.43	1.00 (1.00) / 1.00 (0.00)
shortest path (Bellman-Ford/ SPFA)	0.00 / 0.02 / 0.07	0.00	1 / 0; +0.02 [0.00, 0.06]	1.69 [1.16, 6.7] (extrapolated)	0.03	0.63 (0.00) / 0.00 (0.00)
two sum (brute force)	0 / 0 / 0	0	0 / 0	none	0	1.00 (0.77) / 0.08 (0.00)
find duplicate (sort and adjacent check)	0 / 0 / 0	0	0 / 0	none	0	0.03 (0.00) / 0.20 (0.00)
grid (DFS)	0.00 / 0.04 / 0.00	0.00	2 / 0; +0.04 [0.00, 0.10]	not reached (extrapolated 5.7)	0.03	1.00 (0.20) / 0.53 (0.00)

Knob displacements do not project in proportion to their effect. Over 270 knob points on 14 tasks (nonce bans, the novelty instruction, modal bans, band patches, iteration-3 bans and random pushes), the pooled within-task Spearman correlation of the projection share of a knob with its recorded off-default share is 0.27, below the committed 0.5, and its advantage over the displacement norm (0.12) has a paired-bootstrap interval of -0.02 to 0.31. Within task it ranges

from -0.29 (Fibonacci) to 0.84 (connected components). The class means show the dissociation: modal bans project strongly (mean share 0.23, off-default share 0.40), nonce bans weakly (0.07; 0.00) and the novelty instruction in between (0.15; 0.17), while the iteration-3 random pushes barely project (0.015) yet move the algorithm as often as the novelty instruction (0.17). An exploratory analysis, written after sampling, found that the signed progress of the realised displacement toward the runner-up centroid correlates with the effect on most tasks and blocks (up to 0.57 on connected components at block 31, 0.47 on two sum at block 17, 0.30 on the shortest path task at block 16, 0.26 on kth smallest at block 25, 0.48 on the grid task at block 35), while the unsigned share hovers near 0 (-0.35 to 0.21 at block 18). These are 144 uncorrected correlations, and they point at a direction effect that the committed unsigned predictor cannot see.

Push landings forecast ban landings. On the five gated iteration-3 bench bans, already seen and so scored descriptively, the push-landing forecast of this run was defined on 3 events and scored a mean log score of -0.76, against -3.46 for association and -3.21 for proximity (Table 157). The opening ladder did better than both frozen families (-2.39) and worse than either push forecast. Connected components is the departure: the ban lands on BFS (83%) while pushes land on DFS, which the route landings of Section 4.2.2 explain. Across 14 tasks, the escape fraction of this run correlates with the avoidance of the bench ban at Spearman 0.86: the five movable tasks have avoidance 0.86 to 1.00 and the nine immovable ones 0.00 to 0.79. The opening margin does not track avoidance (0.19). *(Correction, iteration 5: the comparison above sets the push forecast's mean over its 3 defined events against the association mean over 5. On matched events, on the 3 events where the push forecast is defined (kth smallest, two sum, connected components) it scores -0.76 against -3.11 for association and -2.92 for proximity; over all 5 gated events, with an undefined forecast scored as uniform, it scores -1.37 against -3.46. The -1.37 coincides at two decimals with the route replication cell of the screen push in Table 157 (-1.369), a different quantity. Table 171 gives the matched means.)*

Table 157. Forecasts of the five gated iteration-3 bench ban landings (mean log score of the realised attempts not banned under the smoothing of the bench forecast experiment; replication on the full-ban arm of the route experiment; top-1 hits). Source: plan subspace experiment `results/c3b.json`.

Forecast	Events defined	Mean log score (bench ban)	Route full-ban replication	Top-1 hits
push landing of the confirmed escapes of this run	3 (kth smallest, two sum, connected components)	-0.76	-0.71	2 of 3
push landing of the iteration-3 screen	4	-1.48	-1.37	2 of 4
opening ladder	5	-2.39	-2.24	2 of 5
association	5	-3.46	-3.35	1 of 5
proximity	5	-3.21	-3.20	1 of 5

Geometry at the plan site. At blocks 18 and 23, metric MDS of the geodesic distances among the forced-prompt states (PCA to 50 dimensions, $k = 10$) has stress-1 of 0.06 to 0.25 with trustworthiness 0.96 to 0.99; Isomap separates the algorithms into tight clusters (trustworthiness 0.84 to 0.98) but with high stress-1 (0.58 to 0.83), because the neighbour graph is clustered. Persistent loops exceed their coordinate-permutation null only on the shortest path task at block 18 and two sum at blocks 18 and 23, and a planted circle at matched size and noise was detected in every case. The figure below plots the block-18 Isomap of connected components and kth smallest in activation coordinates, with each forced-prompt centroid sized by its implemented count under the push population, and with the mean projected state of the twins, the bans, the targeted pushes

and the population pushes grouped by the algorithm they produced. The pushed states stay near the twin region, apart from every forced-prompt centroid, and pushes that changed the algorithm sit among pushes that did not (the group means lie within about one unit of each other on both tasks). Only the targeted push travels toward the runner-up. The two-dimensional geometry of the forced prompts does not separate escaping from non-escaping pushes.

[Figure fig_plan_geometry: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

No novel algorithm. Of 10,651 correct programs from push arms, 4 carried the label other. Two blind judges and a tie-breaker, with a manual pass, classed them as a catalogue variant (a two sum hash map), a labeller miss (a Dijkstra), a plain linear scan for first and last position and a random guess-and-count loop for find duplicate; their nearest known solutions had AST Jaccard of at most 0.22. No novel algorithm appeared (rule-of-three bound 3/10,651, 0.03%).

Table 158. Committed rules and outcomes. Source: plan subspace experiment `README.md`, `predictions/c2_commit.json`.

Committed rule	Outcome
Subspace pass: Spearman of at least 0.4 with p below 0.01 on at least 4 of 6 tasks, and the masked variant on at least 3 of 6	no: 0 of 6 and 0 of 6
Subspace disconfirmed: Spearman below 0.2 on most tasks	yes: 6 of 6 (pooled 0.03 [-0.03, 0.09])
Subspace not needed if the median ratio with the subspace part removed is at least 0.7 with a lower bound of at least 0.4	yes on kth smallest, the shortest path task, two sum, connected components and pooled; grid mixed; find duplicate not evaluable
Subspace sufficient when amplified if the in-subspace part alone passes the escape rule at N = 20	kth smallest (4 of 4); 9 of 20 directions overall
Targeted pass: Hill-1 of at least 1.8 within 5 points at the midpoint on at least 4 of 6, at no more than half the median escaping norm	no: 1 of 6 (connected components, 0.15 ban units)
Targeted disconfirmed: targeted minus random interval includes 0 on at least 4 of 6	yes: 5 of 6
Knob projections: pooled Spearman of at least 0.5 and projection beats the norm	no: 0.27; difference interval [-0.02, 0.31]
The frozen movable set is movable at alpha 2 or less	5 of 6: find duplicate is not movable (0 of 80 cells)
Departure rule: where the top-1 of the ban differs from the push top-1, the direct route share is at least 0.25	connected components: pooled direct share 0.74 (pooled, not per task)
No correct novel algorithm, claimed only at 0 verdicts	0 among 10,651 correct push programs

Checks. Every GPU unit test passed: 20-row decoding is independent of row position, batch-1 prefill is bit-identical on repeat, a zero-magnitude edit reproduces the twin token for token, the realised displacement matched its target within 0.07% over 3,480 prefills, and clamping left at most 6.7e-4 of the displacement in the subspace. The engine reproduced the screen exactly on 180 of 180 slots. Every bench labeller recovered all its references. An independent recomputation matched every headline, and each placebo (projection shares shuffled across directions, among others) behaved as a null should.

4.7 Movability and compliance in a held-out model family (gemma-3-4b-it)

Why. The movability claim was frozen on Qwen3-8B data that had also produced it: in the screen every movable task obeyed its ban and no immovable task did. Only a family never run in this

study could test it. This experiment froze the screen rule, measured movability in gemma-3-4b-it [76] without any ban text, committed every per-task prediction by hash chain before any ban prompt was built (a grep audit of the 460 prompts fed in the ban-free stage found no ban frame), and then sampled 1,500 modal ban programs.

Design. For each of 15 tasks (the 12 bench tasks, the grid and shortest path tasks, and cycle detection), the model wrote 50 neutral twin programs, and 8 fixed isotropic directions at alpha 1 and 2 were added to the task-specification states of blocks 11 to 22, the middle third of its 34 blocks, during prefill. A direction escaped by the rule of Section 4.1, confirmed at $N = 30$ by an exact binomial test, and a task predicted to obey its modal ban when its escape fraction was above zero. The ban unit had to change before the commitment. In Gemma the five largest channels carry 99% of the squared residual norm at the specification positions, against 40% in Qwen3-8B, so the committed unit erased the task in a 24-row calibration probe; an outlier-excluded unit was adopted before the first commitment, and after the bans the measured ban displacement turned out to be 1.29 times it (0.92 to 2.1 by block). The rival predictors, the plan noise and temperature arms, the novelty instruction and four landing forecasts ran in the same engine under the same common random numbers.

The movability claim is inconclusive in the held-out family. Movability relates to compliance in the predicted direction but does not separate the tasks well enough (Table 159). The confusion matrix is 3, 3, 1, 8 (predicted obey or fail against observed): balanced accuracy 0.74 [0.40, 0.95], Fisher $p = 0.24$ (0.71 under the committed three-claim bound), Spearman 0.54 (one-sided permutation $p = 0.025$) and Kendall 0.47. The rule needed balanced accuracy of at least 0.8, Fisher p below 0.05 and Spearman of at least 0.5. Four tasks broke the prediction: kth smallest obeyed although no direction moved it, and substring search, connected components and longest increasing subsequence were movable but did not obey. A task-permutation placebo has mean balanced accuracy 0.50 (probability 0.13 of reaching the observed value), and leaving one task out gives 0.70 to 0.86.

Table 159. Held-out family: escape fraction over 8 directions, prediction, catalogue-only modal ban avoidance ($N = 100$), outcome, and the top labels under the ban. Source: held-out family experiment `results/c3a.json`, `README.md`.

Task (Gemma default)	Escape fraction	Predicted	Ban avoidance	Observed	Labels under the ban (top)
grid (DFS; corrected in iteration 5: NO DEFAULT, twin BFS 25 and DFS 25; DFS was frozen from a 10-sample pilot with correct BFS 4 and DFS 5, attempts 5 and 5)	0.125	obeys	0.83	obeys, but against no default	BFS 83, DFS 17
shortest path (Dijkstra)	0.25	obeys	0.96	obeys (labeller caveat)	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 96, mostly array-based Dijkstra
kth smallest (full sort)	0	fails	0.63	obeys (miss)	size-k heap 61, full sort 37
two sum (hash map)	0.25	obeys	0.59	obeys	brute force 59, hash map 41
substring search (naive)	0.25	obeys	0.19	fails (miss)	naive 76, built-in find 13, Rabin-Karp 6
connected components (DFS)	0.125	obeys	0.00	fails (miss)	DFS 100

longest increasing subsequence (patience sorting with bisect)	0.125	obeys	0.00	fails (miss)	patience sorting 100
find duplicate (hash set)	0	fails	0.34	fails	other 38, hash set 28, sort 21
Fibonacci, nonoverlapping intervals, topological order, merge intervals, top-k frequent, cycle detection	0 each	fails	0.00 each	fails	default 87 to 100
first and last position (binary search, flagged)	0	fails	0.00	fails	binary search 99

Every sensitivity stays inconclusive (Table 160) *(correction, iteration 5: except the preregistered sensitivity that measures compliance as the drop in the default share, which disconfirms the claim: balanced accuracy 0.57, Fisher p 1.0, Spearman 0.39; see below and Table 169)*. The shortest path task carries one correct prediction on a labelling failure found after the bans. The frozen labeller, gated on heap-based Dijkstra in Qwen3-8B, reads the array-based Dijkstra of Gemma (a linear minimum scan over unvisited nodes with a visited array) as Bellman-Ford/SPFA or unknown, and the inline judge followed it. A second blind judge re-judged all 374 programs labelled Bellman-Ford/SPFA and called 284 of them Dijkstra, including all 219 that match a deterministic structural rule. Under mechanism labels the ban on Dijkstra mostly makes Gemma drop the heap and keep Dijkstra: avoidance falls from 0.96 to 0.11, and the escape fraction from 0.25 to 0.125. The frozen labels stay primary as committed, and the verdict is inconclusive either way. A labeller gated on one family needs a style re-gate on the next.

Table 160. Sensitivities of the movability test in the held-out family. Source: held-out family experiment `results/c3a.json`, `results/posthoc_t2_relabel.json`.

Variant	Tasks	Balanced accuracy	Fisher p	Spearman
primary	15	0.74	0.24	0.54
without cycle detection, or without the flagged first and last position	14	0.73	0.24	0.52
without the grid and shortest path tasks	13	0.61	1.00	0.31
correct-only avoidance	15	0.74	0.24	0.51
ban N = 180 with extra slots	15	0.74	0.24	0.54
without the tasks flagged by the label audit (shortest path, top-k frequent)	13	0.68	0.51	0.39
compliance as the drop in the share of the default	15	0.57 (disconfirmed)	1.00	0.39
post hoc: shortest path relabelled by a second blind judge	15	0.67	0.53	0.44
post hoc: shortest path relabelled by the structural rule	15	0.74	0.24	0.46
without tasks that have no default (added in iteration 5; the grid task)	14	0.70	0.51	0.48

(Correction, iteration 5: the row on the drop in the default share is the preregistered sensitivity, and under it the claim is DISCONFIRMED, not inconclusive. The two compliance measures are separated by two tasks: the grid task, whose twin is tied (BFS 25, DFS 25), so that 'obeys' (catalogue-only avoidance 0.83) is measured against a non-default baseline of 0.50 and the default share drops by only 0.33; and find duplicate, where 38 failing programs labelled other count as leaving the default under the drop measure (catalogue-only avoidance 0.34, drop 0.72). Two of the three true positives behind the Spearman of 0.54 are compromised, the grid task by its tied baseline and the shortest path task by the mislabelled array-based Dijkstra; without both, balanced accuracy is 0.61 and Spearman 0.31 (one-sided permutation p

0.144). Table 169 gives every variant.)

Asking in words predicts compliance better than pushing. The off-default share under the novelty instruction tracks ban avoidance at Spearman 0.77, against 0.54 for the escape fraction (Table 161); the paired task-bootstrap difference is -0.24 [-0.82, 0.23], and the partial correlation of the escape fraction given the novelty share is 0.52. This matches the prior in the field that prompting is the baseline for an activation-level method to beat [34].

Table 161. Predictors of catalogue-only ban avoidance in the held-out family (Spearman rho, oriented so that positive means the predicted direction). Source: held-out family experiment `results/rivals.json`.

Predictor	Spearman rho
novelty instruction off-default share	0.77
escape fraction (the frozen screen)	0.54
plan noise alpha 2 off-default share	0.51
plan noise alpha 1 off-default share	0.47
best forced-prompt success rate	0.35
temperature 1.3 off-default share	0.34
twin modal share	0.24
opening margin	-0.19

Landings. On the 4 gated events, the push-landing forecast scored a mean log score of -0.11 with 4 of 4 top-1 hits, against -1.20 for proximity, -1.77 for association and -3.66 for the opening ladder (Table 162). The contest needed at least 3 events on which the push forecast and association disagree, and only 2 existed (kth smallest: size-k heap against quickselect; two sum: brute force against two pointers), so the landing test is inconclusive by rule, with the push forecast ahead by 2.81 nats on those two.

Table 162. Landing forecasts on the 4 gated held-out events (grid, shortest path, kth smallest, two sum; the shortest path event carries the labeller caveat). Source: held-out family experiment `results/c3b.json`.

Forecast	Mean log score	Top-1 hits
push landing	-0.11	4 of 4 (corrected in iteration 5: of the 4, 2 disagree with association, kth smallest and two sum; the other 2 are compromised, the grid task having no default and the shortest path landing being mostly array-based Dijkstra)
proximity	-1.20	3 of 4
association	-1.77	2 of 4
opening ladder	-3.66	0 of 4

The price claim, replicated descriptively. In Gemma too, plan noise raises correct-only diversity within 5 pass points on tasks where temperature does not (Table 163); the novelty instruction diversifies some tasks more, at a large pass cost on others (find duplicate pass 0.08, substring search 0.60). The Hill-1 of the twin is 1.0 on these tasks and 1.31 on substring search.

Table 163. 5-point Hill-1 in the held-out family (randomisation hull, 5 pass points). Source: held-out family experiment `results/c1_prices.json`.

Task	Plan noise	Temperature 1.3/1.6	Novelty instruction

shortest path (labeller caveat added in iteration 5: the frozen labeller reads array-based Dijkstra as Bellman-Ford/SPFA; plan noise 1.62 rests on 5 and 12 programs labelled Bellman-Ford/SPFA at alpha 1 and 2, and the novelty instruction 1.96 on 29)	1.62 [1.37, 1.87]	1.00	1.96
substring search	1.64	1.32	1.42
connected components	1.58	1.00	1.10
kth smallest	1.38	1.10	1.61
longest increasing subsequence	1.25	1.00	1.00

Other observations and checks. The fourth template is again the weakest: its avoidance is 0.15 on the grid task against 1.0 for the other templates, and 0.05 on kth smallest. On first and last position the twin writes a linear scan 86% of the time, yet the ban `Do not use a hand-written binary search` makes it write binary search 99% of the time, an ironic rebound of the kind iteration 3 saw on kth smallest. On the shortest path task, 48 of 50 twin slots flip from the default to a survivor under the ban. The 34 correct programs labelled other were 27 degenerate programs from push arms and 7 catalogue variants, with no novel algorithm (rule-of-three bound 0.088). All 13 bench labellers reproduced their gates, the six escape counts of the screen were reproduced, the GPU tests passed, and an independent rederivation from raw samples matched every escape fraction, avoidance, balanced accuracy, Fisher p, Spearman correlation, rival correlation, landing log score and post hoc number with no mismatch; its placebos rejected at 1.7% (Fisher) and 4.9% (Spearman).

[Figure fig_movability: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

4.8 Positioning: the iteration-3 and iteration-4 claims against published work

The positioning audit, dated 2026-10-21, checked 112 verbatim quotes from 74 references (101 against full text, 11 against venue abstracts; none mismatched, and an independent pass re-matched all 112). A saturation search over eight query families found 1,729 unique records, scored 63 on an occupancy rubric and found 44 adjacent, 19 irrelevant and none occupying. Two flags it was asked to raise did not fire: no paper measures test-checked, algorithm-level diversity under activation perturbation, and no paper predicts prompt-ban compliance from perturbation sensitivity. Table 92b sets the iteration-3 claims against their nearest neighbours and Table 92c the iteration-4 claims; each finding is paraphrased here and was verified against a quote. Several contemporaneous submissions under review, a workshop poster without an arXiv record and one workshop paper that the bibliography script could not retrieve are adjacent in the audit but are not cited by number.

Table 92b. Iteration-3 claims, their nearest published neighbours and what this run adds. Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`.

Claim in this run	Nearest neighbour	Finding of the neighbour (paraphrased; verified against a quote)	What this run adds, or replication	Lane

Snap-back under exposure bans (default 0.05 under the copy twin, 0.72 named, 0.82 unnamed; Llama present minor bans 0.72 to 0.93)	Lu et al. [23]	Under successive denial prompts, models copy previous solutions and constraint following decays	The replacement is the unconditional default of the model itself, measured against a copy twin, in two families	adjacent
(same)	Yoon et al. [4]	Under factual negation, heads and neurons suppress the original answer and promote a favoured in-category candidate	Algorithm level, execution-checked labels; the promoted alternative is the unconditional default	closest analogue
(same)	Rana [7]	Mentioning a forbidden word primes it in most violations	The unnamed ban snaps back more (0.82) than the named (0.72), so naming is not needed	adjacent
Wording dominates compliance (template SD 2.0 logits; likelihood ratio 374; the fourth template fails on 10 of 12 tasks)	Sclar et al. [69]	Formatting changes alone move accuracy by up to 76 points	Replication in prohibition compliance, as a template random effect with a placebo	partly occupied
(same)	Heo et al. [58]	An input-embedding dimension predicts instruction following and tracks phrasing	Algorithm prohibitions on code; a variance-components estimate	adjacent
The ban is enforced at the opening of the body (forcing the opening of the default undoes it; a neutral `def` line does not)	Qi et al. [63]	Safety alignment acts mostly on the first few output tokens	Replication of shallow enforcement for a user-imposed prohibition, located at the first content token after a neutral signature	adjacent
(same)	Zhu et al. [32]; Andriushchenko et al. [79]	Hard code tokens sit at block openings; prefilling defeats refusals	Prefilling used as a measurement rather than an attack	supporting
Signature vetoes are respelled around (exact veto, the walk stalled on 6 of 6 tasks)	Biagiola et al. [62]; Park et al. [85]	Incomplete constraints push generation into low-probability regions and cost correctness; constrained decoding distorts the distribution	The algorithm survives a lexical veto by respelling, with a sham-veto control	adjacent
No correct novel algorithm (0 of 116 correct out-of-catalogue programs)	Zhang et al. [44]; Jangra and Muresan [3]; Lu et al. [23]	Models produce less diversity than humans; prompting steers toward human strategies without their diversity	A verified-novelty audit against a known-solution catalogue, which these benchmarks do not run	adjacent

Random pushes buy correct diversity on movable tasks	Khalid et al. [70]; Zhu et al. [71]; Kim et al. [84]	Residual-stream noise raises narrative diversity; activation steering raises test coverage; random embedding injection widens pass@N on math	Diversity of algorithms, test-checked and mechanism-labelled, task-dependent and calibrated to the norm of the ban; the method itself is occupied	partly occupied
Movability predicts compliance (screen)	Fan et al. [75]	Hidden-state features predict whether a steering intervention succeeds	A black-box prompt prohibition forecast from white-box movability	adjacent

Table 92c. Iteration-4 claims, their nearest published neighbours and what this run adds. Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`.

Claim in this run	**Nearest neighbour**	**Finding of the neighbour (paraphrased; verified against a quote)**	**What this run adds, or what it lacks**	**Lane**
Plan noise is priced against temperature and prompt knobs	Ahmed et al. [73]; Wang et al. [74]	Sampling an intent at high temperature and the response at low temperature, or searching over natural-language plans, raises conceptual diversity in code	Activation-level plan noise on test-checked labels with seed-coupled contrasts; the comparison set lacks these text-level plan samplers	partly occupied
(same)	Lee et al. [72]	Temperature above 1 raises algorithmic diversity on other problems, at a correctness cost	Qualifies the temperature null: price temperature per task	contradicting in part
(same)	Peeperkorn et al. [37]; Zeng et al. [86]; Wu et al. [2]	Temperature correlates weakly with novelty; token-level perturbation gives lexical, not strategic, variation; sampling and prompting changes do not cure monoculture	Consistent with the null on ideas	supporting
Site specificity at matched dose	Zhang et al. [83]; Khalid et al. [70]; Zhu et al. [71]; Nagarajan et al. [80]	Diversity injected at different text levels, generated-token noise sites, intra-layer steering sites, and input-layer noise against output temperature	Sites inside the network at matched dose on algorithm labels	partly occupied
The same seed design	Ravfogel et al. [77]	Coupling sampling noise across interventions yields counterfactual strings	Token seeds coupled across temperatures and plan noise draws to split idea changes from phrasing changes	adjacent
A plan subspace read from forced prompts predicts push effects (disconfirmed here)	Dong et al. [78]	Prompt representations encode global attributes of the coming response	A categorical, test-checked object and a ban-free subspace tested as a predictor of random-push effects; the prediction failed	partly occupied

Geometry and targeted pushes	Wurgaft et al. [27]	Geometry-aware steering with geodesic distances and an MDS isometry	Algorithm-level geometry on test-checked labels; exact crossing on one task	partly occupied
Movability forecasts ban compliance in a held-out family	Tang [38]; Fan et al. [75]	Constraints opposing defaults fail at 10% to 100%; steerability is predictable from hidden states	A pre-registered white-box forecast of black-box prompt compliance (inconclusive here)	open
Push landings forecast ban landings	Yoon et al. [4]; Zhou et al. [56]	Negation suppresses and promotes, or constructs and suppresses, at the fact level	A ban-free forecast of which alternative a prohibition installs	open
No correct novel algorithm up to breakage	Romera-Paredes et al. [81]; Novikov et al. [82]	Search with an evaluator produces new programs	Scope the claim to single-sample generation under knobs, without search or an evaluator	adjacent, scoped
Plan noise (row added in iteration 5)	Jerge, Pelczar and Downes, arXiv 2608.21595	Gaussian noise calibrated to the scale of the last hidden layer, added in the pass that encodes the prompt, diversifies reinforcement learning rollouts of vision-language models	Test-checked mechanism labels on code, a site comparison at matched dose, and seed coupling; theirs is rollouts scored by reward	partly occupied
Plan noise against temperature (row added in iteration 5)	Nagarajan et al. [80]	Noise injected at the input layer works as well as, and sometimes better than, temperature sampling at the output layer	The nearest prior answer; this run adds noise in the task-specification states against temperature with the token seed held fixed, on execution-checked algorithm labels	adjacent
Novelty boundary (row added in iteration 5)	Bhushan, Zhang and Wang, arXiv 2608.30047	Agents with iterative search explore novel regions of the solution space but do not convert novelty into better task performance	Scope: single-sample generation without search; the bound on novelty (0 among 14,206 correct programs)	contradicting in part
Novelty boundary (row added in iteration 5)	Maveli, Vergari and Cohen, arXiv 2610.02438	Code generation is better measured as parametric retrieval of a named algorithm than as synthesis of a novel one	Execution-checked labels and the bound under activation pushes	supporting
Novelty boundary and knob (row added in iteration 5)	ICLR 2027 submission oag3wgNLRh (OpenReview)	Activation steering redirects generation among trajectories the model already supports, and decoding matched to the departure of steering from greedy decoding reaches comparable accuracy	Algorithm-level labels; decoding at matched departure was not run in iteration 4 and ran in iteration 5 (Section 5.7)	partly occupied

Plan subspace (row added in iteration 5)	ICLR 2027 submission knirOusGcq (OpenReview)	A shared causal subspace for planning the length of a response, tested by decomposing interventions into parallel and orthogonal components	A categorical, test-checked object; the forced-prompt subspace does not predict random-push effects (0.03) and removing it keeps the effect (ratio 1.00)	partly occupied

4.9 Comparisons across the experiments of this iteration

Movability on fresh directions. Three engines and three direction sets measured whether a task is movable: the frozen screen (fixed directions from iteration 3), the plan subspace experiment (40 fresh fixed directions per dose) and the plan noise experiment (a fresh direction per sample). They agree on five of the six screen-movable tasks and on every immovable one, and they disagree on find duplicate (Table 164). The single escaping direction of the screen on find duplicate at alpha 2 did not replicate in 80 fresh cells, and per-sample plan noise left the hash set in place at alpha 2 or less. On fresh draws the movable set is kth smallest, two sum, connected components and the two path tasks, and the table of the screen against ban compliance (movable and obeying, movable and failing, immovable and obeying, immovable and failing) moves from 6, 0, 0, 8 to 5, 0, 1, 8: find duplicate obeys its ban (catalogue-only avoidance 0.79) without being movable. Across the 14 tasks the escape fraction still ranks ban avoidance at Spearman 0.86.

Table 164. Movability of the screen tasks in three measurements: screen escapes (escaping of run, alpha 1 / alpha 2), the escape fraction of the plan subspace experiment on 40 fresh directions (alpha 1 / alpha 2), and per-sample plan noise (off-default share at alpha 1 / alpha 2, N = 50), with catalogue-only modal ban avoidance. Sources: record audit `screen.json`; plan subspace experiment `results/escape.json`; plan noise experiment `results/alpha_sweep.json`.

Task	Screen escapes	Fresh directions	Per-sample plan noise	Ban avoidance (catalogue only)
kth smallest	8/18 / 3/3	0.30 / 0.63	0.28 / 0.50	0.97
two sum	0/6 / 2/3	0.00 / 0.13	0.00 / 0.02	0.86
find duplicate	0/6 / 1/3	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.02	0.79
connected components	1/3 / not run	0.38 / 0.73	0.12 / 0.60	1.00
grid	1/15 / 0/3	0.05 / 0.13	0.06 / 0.24	0.86
shortest path	3/15 / 0/3	0.18 / 0.20	0.26 / 0.54	0.83
the eight immovable bench tasks	0 of 3 or 6 each	0 of 8 each	off-default excess at most 0.04	0.00 to 0.47

The fixed-direction escape fraction and the per-sample off-default share measure different things: a task with a few strong directions (two sum, where 5 of 40 directions escape at alpha 2) can show almost no movement under per-sample noise, which averages over directions. *(Correction, iteration 5: alpha does not mean the same push in every column. The screen uses the displacement of the ban itself; the bench unit of the plan subspace experiment is 9% to 16% smaller (its deviation 'ban_unit_scale'); the kth smallest unit of the same seed experiment is 0.77 of the screen's; the site experiment uses per-position ban units (blocks 0 to 11 at 4.5% to 7.2% of the residual norm against 12.7% to 18.3% for blocks 12 to 23); cycle detection and Gemma use a ban-free unit, which across tasks is 0.30 to 0.97 of the ban unit. Substring search has by far the largest ban unit (58.5 against 11.6 to 19.0 elsewhere) and does not move. Table 174 gives the units.)*

Temperature, five times. Every measurement of temperature in the run says the same thing, now

including the thinking-on arm the review asked for. In iteration 1, 797 of 800 grid programs and 797 of 800 shortest path programs kept the default across temperatures 0.3 to 1.3 with thinking off, and all 1,600 with thinking on. In iteration 2, with seeds coupled, the algorithm changed in 0 of 30 seeds in 10 of 12 cells. In this iteration temperature 1.3 and 1.6, top-k 10 and min-p reach a 5-point Hill-1 of at most 1.17 on the six movable tasks; the same seed design changed the algorithm in 0 of 20 seeds on three tasks with thinking off and on the shortest path task with thinking on; and in gemma-3-4b-it temperature reaches 5-point Hill-1 of at most 1.32. A positioning caveat applies: on other problems temperature above 1 does raise algorithmic diversity at a correctness cost [72].

Novelty, audited everywhere. No artifact of this iteration found a correct novel algorithm (Table 165). Together with iterations 1 to 3, every correct program outside the catalogue that the run produced has been read by two blind judges and the executor, and none was new; the 14 that judges over-called in iteration 5 were re-adjudicated blind in iteration 6 (judges 14 of 48, manual 0, second adjudication 1 of 14 (Mistral Medium 3.1, three calls at temperature 0, control gate 9 of 10, passed; Kimi (kimi-k2) second view 0 of 14), final count after the executor's full read 0; the contested control, repeated maximum selection for top-k frequent, which the iteration-5 manual pass itself classed as a catalogue variant, was called catalogue variant by Mistral and catalogue variant by Kimi (Mistral gate 10 of 10 under that convention); the final read corrects 1 manual class (CATALOGUE VARIANT to DEGENERATE), none to novel).

Table 165. Novelty audits of iteration 4. Sources: the novelty audit files of the six artifacts.

Artifact	Pool	Correct programs labelled other	Final classes	Novel
Record audit	other programs under iteration-3 bans (226 unique, 6 passing)	6	68 catalogue variants, 156 degenerate, 2 labeller misses (all 226)	0
Plan noise experiment	every correct program labelled other	12	12 labeller misses	0
Site experiment	3,555 correct programs	1	catalogue variant (quadratic brute force)	0
Same seed experiment	every correct program labelled other	1	labeller miss (naive Dijkstra)	0
Plan subspace experiment	10,651 correct push programs	4	1 catalogue variant, 1 labeller miss, 2 degenerate	0
Held-out family experiment	every correct program labelled other	34	27 degenerate, 7 catalogue variants	0

4.10 What iteration 4 established, what it ruled out, and what it abandoned

Everything below is one model per claim except the held-out test, which is one family at one size, with labels from labellers that passed their gates (and one, the path labeller on Gemma, that needed a style re-gate). Every Qwen3-8B number in this iteration comes from the 8-bit engine of the screen. (Engine class: Hugging Face with W8A8 linear layers in 8-bit floating point, e4m3 weights per output channel and e4m3 activations per row through the GPU's native 8-bit floating-point matrix multiply. Each item below carries its iteration-6 engine tag, and Section 6.3 decides which of them hold under bf16 at the same absolute dose.)

Established.

1. *Temperature changes phrasing and not the algorithm, with the seed held fixed, thinking off and on.* Across four temperatures the algorithm changed in 0 of 20 seeds on three tasks with thinking off and on the shortest path task with thinking on, while phrasings per idea grew on the grid task from 3 to 13 clusters. Temperature 1.3 and 1.6, top-k 10 and min-p buy no correct algorithmic diversity on the movable tasks (5-point Hill-1 at most 1.17).
2. *A random displacement of the task-specification states changes the algorithm, and changing the plan noise draw under a fixed seed changes it often.* One direction at alpha 1 changed the algorithm in 17.25 of 20 seeds on the shortest path task, 4.55 on kth smallest and 2.5 on the grid task (pooled contrast against temperature 0.545 [0.41, 0.67], p = 1.0e-5). *(Engine tag, iteration 6: 8-bit floating-point W8A8; the same-seed contrast itself was not rerun in bf16. Per-sample plan noise on the shortest path task did not replicate in iteration 5's bf16 cells at the ban-free unit (2 of 47 correct programs off the default at bf16 alpha 2 against 9 of 43 at 8-bit alpha 1, bracket p 0.017), but at iteration 4's own absolute unit and seeds the bf16 engine reproduces it (22 of 50 valid attempts off the default at alpha 2 under both engines; Section 6.3).)*
3. *The site is the task-specification states at early to middle blocks.* The same displacement at the read position or the condition sentence changed no algorithm at any dose (0 of 526 and 0 of 527 correct programs off the default), the late blocks were almost inert (6 of 521), and at matched downstream displacement the plan site keeps a large advantage (indicator +2.15 [1.79, 2.51]; odds ratio 5.72 [3.94, 8.30]) *(engine tag, iteration 6: 8-bit floating-point W8A8, not rerun in that form. The bf16 rerun at the ban-free unit of Section 6.4 withdrew the committed site rule, because the condition-span arm never reached the plan site's downstream displacement and alpha 8 broke every plan-site program; a post-hoc model restricted to alpha of 4 or less puts the read position below the task-specification site on both tasks.)*. Blocks 12 to 23 are not distinguished from blocks 0 to 11. *(Correction, iteration 5: two wordings here say more than the experiment supports, that the read position and the condition sentence change nothing at any dose, and that the task-specification states are the site of the choice. Restated: among prefill positions, perturbing the task-specification states changes the algorithm; the read position and the condition sentence are inert at per-position doses up to 4 ban units and far weaker at matched energy (energy-matched read position: +0.23 on find duplicate, Floyd cycle detection 6 of 26 correct programs, and +0.18 on connected components, 5 of 28 off the default); noise in generated tokens 1 to 32 also redirects the choice, more than the plan site on find duplicate (12:0 paired flips at alpha 2 over the 30 pairs, exact McNemar p 0.0005; 6:0 among pairs where both programs are correct). Blocks 0 to 11 against 12 to 23: -0.31 [-0.75, 0.13]. This is a prefill site at which noise is effective, not a locus of the decision, and it is reconciled with the PARTIAL site rule under Inconclusive below.)*
4. *Plan noise is the cheapest knob on some tasks and not on others.* It wins kth smallest (5-point Hill-1 2.72) and connected components (2.09) at no pass cost *(engine tag, iteration 6: 8-bit floating-point W8A8 at the ban unit; under bf16 and the ban-free unit of iteration 5 the same prices are 1.98 and 1.09, and on connected components 1 of 50 correct programs left the default at bf16 alpha 2 against 30 of 50 at 8-bit alpha 2 (Fisher p 7.2e-11). The engine control of Section 6.3 traces that gap to the unit and the direction seeds, not to the numerics: at iteration 4's absolute unit and seeds, bf16 plan noise moves connected components in 25 of 50 valid attempts.)* and loses find duplicate to the iterated veto and the shortest path task to the semantic seed; the preregistered price claim is PARTIAL.
5. *Which random directions move the algorithm is a stable property of the direction, and the forced-prompt geometry does not explain it.* Template halves rank 40 directions alike (0.76 to 0.90), the projection share on the plan subspace ranks them at 0.03, and removing the in-subspace

component of a push leaves its effect intact (median ratio 1.00). *(Correction, iteration 5: the range 0.76 to 0.90 covers four tasks. On all six: kth smallest 0.80 (34 movers, 27 escaping cells of direction and dose), shortest path 0.81 (37, 14), two sum 0.76 (10, 5), connected components 0.90 (36, 30), find duplicate 0.59 (3, 0) and the grid task 0.39 (22, 6); Table 176.)*

6. *Where pushes escape, they land on one runner-up per task, and that runner-up forecasts where a ban lands.* The landing replicates across 40 fresh directions and the screen on every movable task, and on the gated bench bans, scored descriptively because they were seen before, the push forecast scores -0.76 against -3.46 for association; in Gemma it hits 4 of 4, on too few disagreeing events for the rule. *(Correction, iteration 5: this item moves from Established to the descriptive results. Where pushes escape, the landing replicates across 40 fresh directions and the screen at the plan site (kth smallest quickselect 0.66 and size-k heap 0.31; connected components DFS 0.83 and BFS 0.17; shortest path Bellman-Ford/SPFA 0.99; two sum brute force; grid DFS). As a forecast of the seen bench ban landings it hits 2 of 3 defined Qwen3-8B events (it misses connected components) and scores -0.76 against -3.11 for association on those events, and -1.37 against -3.46 over all 5 with undefined forecasts scored as uniform; in Gemma it hits 4 of 4, of which 2 disagree with association and 2 are compromised. The landing depends on the site on find duplicate.)*
7. *Route landings.* On connected components either route of a ban alone lands mostly on DFS, the generic neighbour, and only both routes together choose BFS. On kth smallest the size-k heap share travels by the prompt states. *(Correction, iteration 5: an observation on a single task, with find duplicate as its counterexample: there the direct route alone lands on index marking, 74 of 78, neither the push landing nor the association answer; on two sum pushes and association disagree.)*
8. *Snap-back replicates in Llama.* On five of six present minor events the modal landing is the default (0.93, 0.73 and 0.72 of attempts not banned on three of them).
9. *No correct novel algorithm appeared under any push, up to breakage.* Correct-only diversity peaks at alpha 2 to 4, and alpha 8 erases the task; 0 novel among 14,206 correct programs of the site and subspace experiments alone.

Ruled out, or not supported.

- *A plan subspace read from forced prompts as the channel of push effects.* Disconfirmed by its preregistered rule on 6 of 6 tasks, and the decomposition shows the subspace is not needed.
- *Targeted pushes as a general cheap knob.* Indistinguishable from a matched random push on 5 of 6 tasks; the exception, connected components, crosses exactly at the predicted midpoint.
- *Knob displacements projecting in proportion to their effect.* Pooled 0.27, not better than the displacement norm.
- *The top-five prohibition applied at the plan.* The push never left BFS (avoidance 0.00 at alpha 1 and 2), as the prompt and the token veto had not.
- *Find duplicate as a movable task.* Its screen escape did not replicate in 80 fresh cells.

Inconclusive.

- *Movability as a predictor of ban compliance in a held-out family.* Balanced accuracy 0.74 [0.40, 0.95], Fisher p 0.24, Spearman 0.54; the novelty instruction predicts better (0.77), and one correct prediction rests on a labelling failure. *(Correction, iteration 5: INCONCLUSIVE under the primary measure, catalogue-only avoidance, and DISCONFIRMED under the preregistered*

sensitivity on the drop in the default share (balanced accuracy 0.57, Fisher p 1.0, Spearman 0.39). The grid task (tied twin, BFS 25 and DFS 25; no default under the iteration-5 rule) and find duplicate (38 failing other programs; 0.34 against 0.72) separate the two measures. Without the two compromised true positives, balanced accuracy is 0.61 and Spearman 0.31, one-sided permutation p 0.144.)

- *Push landings against association in the held-out family.* Ahead by 2.81 nats, but on 2 disagreeing events, below the 3 the rule needs.
- *The site claim.* PARTIAL: the plan site is best on 3 of 6 tasks, with every margin but one a bootstrap close call. *(Added in iteration 5: the site rule is PARTIAL, so no site is established as best; what is established is the prefill specificity at matched displacement, odds ratio 5.72 [3.94, 8.30] for the task-specification states against the other prefill sites. The price of 1.5, the pass cost at which a site's randomisation hull first reaches correct-only Hill-1 of 1.5, is 0.12 for generated-token noise against 0.53 for the plan site on two sum.)*

Dead ends, with the evidence that closed them.

- *The plan subspace as the internal account of the choice.* Closed by Tables 153 and 155: the share does not rank directions, and removing it does not remove the effect.
- *Verbalized sampling as a diversity knob.* 46 to 49 of 50 programs dispatch at run time to a randomly chosen algorithm, so their labels measure the trace, not the choice.
- *The frozen counting rule for forecast contests.* It advances some family in 85% of no-information simulations; forecasts are now scored by paired tests and defined-only hit rates.

4.11 What the next iteration takes from this one

The iteration answered the first question of the request in its strictest form and narrowed the second. Temperature, at any setting and with the seed fixed, changes how the code is written and not which algorithm it implements, with thinking off and on. The algorithm can be influenced, cheaply on some tasks, by a random displacement of the task-specification states at early to middle blocks, and the read position, the condition sentence and the late blocks are inert. *(Correction, iteration 5: the read position and the condition sentence are inert at per-position doses up to 4 ban units, weaker but not inert at matched energy, and the late blocks almost inert.)* What the iteration did not find is a representation of the choice: the forced-prompt subspace does not explain which displacements work, although which displacements work is reproducible. The open question is therefore what property of a direction makes it move the algorithm. The exploratory signed-progress correlations (up to 0.57) point at direction toward the runner-up rather than share, and the targeted push on connected components shows that one axis can be causally exact. A preregistered test of signed progress on fresh directions, with the reproducible ranking of the directions as the target, is the next step. *(Correction, iteration 5: that step was not taken, and signed progress is closed. Its positive cells concentrate on one task, it is negative on average on two, and on connected components the committed signed component was matched by a within-class control (0.33 against 0.37). Per task over 24 block cells: kth smallest 1 cell with p below 0.05 and a mean of -0.02 over the edited blocks (-0.29 at block 15); shortest path 3 and +0.20; two sum 7 and +0.31; connected components 22 and +0.37; find duplicate 0 and -0.12; grid 2 and +0.05 (Table 177; the record's count of 22 of 35 cells was 22 of 24). The next budget goes to more tasks, not to a further predictor at the level of directions on the same five: new tasks with the base model's repertoire committed before any push, so that which tasks move can be predicted from the base model and tested on units never seen.)*

The movability claim needs more than one held-out family at one size, a labeller re-gated on the

style of each family, and a comparison with the novelty instruction, which predicted compliance better in Gemma. The landing claim needs events on which the push forecast and association disagree: Gemma gave 2 of 4, and the Qwen3-8B bench gave 3 defined events. The contrast set of the price claim lacks the text-level plan samplers that the positioning audit names [73, 74] and a decoding baseline matched to the departure of plan noise from greedy decoding; until both are run, the claim is that plan noise beats the token-level and prompt-seed knobs tested, on the tasks where it moves the model. The route-landing lead from Section 4.2.2 ties these threads together: where one route alone removes the default, the landing is the generic neighbour that pushes reach, and the ban departs from it only when both routes act. *(Correction, iteration 5: this lead rests on connected components alone; find duplicate is the counterexample and two sum has no agreed neighbour, Section 4.2.2. Movability as a forecast of ban compliance and the contest over where a ban lands are closed beyond descriptive reporting; the next test is the narrowed repertoire account, Section 5.1.)*

Iteration 5: the base model's repertoire against nudge movability, a transplant of base plan states, text-level plan samplers and a second family

5.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The review of the iteration-4 record. The review was blocking again. It raised five major items, all marked must fix, and three minor ones, and each pointed at a place where the record said more than its own artifacts. The held-out test of the movability claim had been written up as inconclusive under every sensitivity, but one preregistered sensitivity, compliance measured as the drop in the share of the default, disconfirms it, and two of the three true positives behind the positive rank correlation were compromised: the grid task had no default (its Gemma twin wrote BFS 25 and DFS 25), and the shortest path task's compliance rested on array-based Dijkstra read as Bellman-Ford/SPFA. The site conclusions said the read position and condition sentence changed no algorithm *at any dose*, although the energy-matched read position had moved two tasks, and they called the task-specification states the site of the choice, although noise in generated tokens 1 to 32 redirected it as well and beat the plan site on find duplicate. Several landing conclusions generalised from connected components alone or compared forecasts on unmatched event sets. Executed results bearing on the primary claim were missing: plan noise on the plain prompt, the hull deviation restricted to edges, the Llama block of the knob table, the dose unit of each experiment and one artifact's GPU hours. And the closing summary quoted maxima over directions as if they were typical effects, while the lead it chose for the next iteration, signed progress toward the runner-up, rested mostly on one task. The minor items asked for the positioning rows the iteration-4 audit had verified but not carried over, for exposure arms to be declared controls, and for the literal cell of the request (thinking on, top-k 10, same seed). Table 166 maps every item to its answer; the corrections are applied in place in Sections 3.2.5 and 4.2 to 4.11 and marked as iteration-5 corrections.

Table 166. Review items on the iteration-4 record and where this report answers them.

Review item	What the review found	Where it is answered
Held-out verdict per compliance measure	The drop sensitivity disconfirms; grid task has no default; shortest path true positive rests on a mislabel	Corrections in Sections 4.7 and 4.10; Tables 169 and 170, Section 5.2; closing section

Site conclusions	The phrase *at any dose* contradicted by the energy-matched read position; generated-token noise also redirects the choice; PARTIAL rule listed as established	Corrections in Sections 4.4, 4.10 and 4.11; closing section
Landing conclusions	Route-landing lead from one task; Gemma 4 of 4 includes two compromised events; forecasts compared on unmatched events; landing depends on the site	Corrections in Sections 4.2.2, 4.6 and 4.10; Table 171, Section 5.2
Missing executed results	Plan noise on the plain prompt; hull deviation; Llama block; dose units; GPU hours	Corrections in Sections 4.1, 4.2.1, 4.3 and 4.9; Tables 126c, 139, 173 and 174
Best cells and the next lead	Maxima quoted as effects; split-half on four of six tasks; signed progress concentrated on one task; alpha-4 depths	Corrections in Sections 4.2.1, 4.4, 4.10 and 4.11; Tables 175 to 178; the next budget went to new tasks (Sections 5.4 and 5.5)
Minor: positioning rows	Jerge et al., Nagarajan et al., Bhushan et al., Maveli et al. and two ICLR 2027 submissions verified but not carried	Rows added to Table 92c in Section 4.8
Minor: exposure arms as knobs	Exposure prompts supply the alternative's text	Class rule corrected in Section 3.2.5; Table 172
Minor: the literal 1a-c cell	Thinking-on arm ran without top-k 10	Correction in Section 4.5; cell run in Section 5.7

The hypothesis update. The update kept the plan noise lead of iteration 4 and asked what sets its boundary. Plan noise moved the algorithm on some tasks and on no others, and where it moved it, it landed on one runner-up per task. On the two path tasks those runner-up algorithms were exactly the algorithms the untuned base model writes next to its default: under the chat template Qwen3-8B-Base wrote BFS in 49 of 57 correct grid programs and Dijkstra in 63 of 90 correct shortest path programs, with DFS and Bellman-Ford/SPFA second (Section 1.9). The update therefore proposed what it called the *narrowed repertoire account*: post-training narrowed a choice that the base model makes more evenly, the narrowed choice is set while the model reads the task specification, and a nudge to those states undoes part of the narrowing, reopening the base model's alternatives and only those. A task that no nudge moves would then be one on which the base model itself writes almost one algorithm, and post-training [35, 57, 87] would have narrowed only what pretraining left open.

We use the following quantities throughout. The *base off-default share* of a task, beta, is the share of the base model's correct programs that use an algorithm other than the instruct model's default, with both models given identical token ids under the chat template; the *base runner-up* is the base model's most frequent correct algorithm other than that default. We call a task *diverse in the base* when beta is at least 0.2 and *collapsed in the base* when beta is below 0.05; between the two it is intermediate. The instruct default comes from a twin of at least 50 samples as the modal correct label with a share of at least 0.6; a task below that has *no default* and enters no movability or landing test. One *ban-free unit* is the residual norm of the task-specification states times the median ratio, in Qwen3-8B at the same relative depth, of a ban's displacement to the residual norm; it replaces the ban's own displacement as the dose unit everywhere, so that a task's dose no longer depends on how far its ban moved it. We call the edit $h \leftarrow h + \text{lambda}\ (h_{base} - h_{instruct})$, applied during the instruct prefill at every task-specification position of blocks 12 to 23 with the base states computed on the same prompt, a *transplant of base plan states*, in the spirit of cross-model activation patching [88].

Eight claims were preregistered, each with its rule committed by sha256 before its first decisive

sample.

- *The movability half: the base repertoire predicts which tasks move* (primary): across new tasks, beta ranks the escape fraction of 8 fixed random directions at Spearman of at least 0.6 with a permutation p within parent clusters below 0.01, at least 80% of tasks collapsed in the base are immovable, and beta is ahead of each rival. Disconfirmed if Spearman is below 0.3 or most tasks diverse in the base are immovable.
- *The landing half: landings follow the base runner-up* (primary): on movable new tasks the push landing is the base runner-up in at least 70% of events (exact test against per-event chance, p below 0.05), and the base composition beats the association forecast by at least 0.10 nats in log score.
- *The transplant claim* (primary, causal): on at least two thirds of the tasks diverse in the base among the 15 existing ones, the transplant at its best lambda (with pass of at least 0.8 times the twin's) reaches a correct off-default share of at least half of beta, beats a matched-norm random displacement and what we call a *borrowed shift* (another task's base minus instruct direction at the same norm) on paired flips, and lands on the base runner-up; tasks collapsed in the base and a transplant at the read position stay within 0.05 of the twin.
- *The plan sampler comparison* (secondary): plan noise prices at least as well as the best of four text-level plan samplers on at least 3 of the 5 tasks movable on fresh draws: intent factored generation [73], plan search [74], a sampler we call *enumerate and pick* (the model lists algorithms and an external random draw picks one) and what we call *base intent* (the base model writes an intent of one sentence and the instruct model writes the code).
- *The push toward the base*: a push along the base minus instruct direction, which we call a push toward the base, escapes at no more than half the norm a random push needs (secondary).
- *The Gemma replication* (secondary): both halves in gemma-3-4b-pt against gemma-3-4b-it [76], a replication on fresh samples because Gemma's iteration-4 outcomes were seen.
- *The literal cell* of the request (descriptive) and *the novelty count* (secondary).

The strategy. Seven artifacts ran (Table 167). One evaluation on CPU only repaired the iteration-4 record from rows on disk and froze eight rival task predictors by hash before reading any outcome. The transplant experiment measured the base repertoire of all 15 existing tasks, committed it, and only then ran the transplant with its controls. Two panels built new coding tasks, committed each task's base repertoire, and only then pushed the instruct model; they split the new tasks between them so that the pooled confirmation would have more units than either could build alone. The knob experiment ran the text-level plan samplers and what we call *decoding at matched departure* (a decoding temperature set so that the output departs from the twin as much as under plan noise) on all 15 existing tasks, and the literal cell. The Gemma experiment repeated both halves and the transplant in a second family, and a research artifact searched the literature for each new claim. The 16 GB card of iteration 4 was replaced by cards of 23 to 24 GB, so every Qwen3-8B experiment of this iteration ran in bf16 rather than with 8-bit linears; this change of engine, together with the change from the ban unit to the ban-free unit, turns out to matter (Section 5.10).

Table 167. The seven artifacts of iteration 5, the question each was asked, and its hardware and spend.

Artifact	Question	Model and hardware	OpenRouter spend

Record audit	Repair the iteration-4 record (35 corrections); freeze eight ban-free rival task predictors	No generation; CPU only	USD 0.021
Transplant experiment	Base repertoire of the 15 existing tasks; does a transplant of base plan states reopen it (the transplant claim); push toward the base; reverse transplant	Qwen3-8B and Qwen3-8B-Base, bf16, one RTX 4090; 14,280 programs; 1.70 GPU hours	USD 0.29
Panel A	The movability and landing halves on new tasks (majority element to median of two sorted lists); the 15 existing tasks remeasured on the ban-free unit	Same models, bf16, one RTX 4090; 8,390 programs; 0.98 GPU hours of batch time	USD 0.357
Panel B	The movability and landing halves on seven more new tasks; disguised variants of eight bench tasks	Same models, bf16, one RTX 4090; 14,600 programs; 1.74 GPU hours	USD 0.192
Knob experiment	Plan noise against text-level plan samplers and decoding at matched departure (the plan sampler comparison); the literal cell	Qwen3-8B bf16 (HF) and the official 8-bit checkpoint (vLLM, literal cell), one RTX 4090; 7,060 labelled knob rows and 100 traces; 1.88 GPU hours plus 15 minutes	USD 0.12
Gemma experiment	Both halves and the transplant in gemma-3-4b-pt against gemma-3-4b-it	Both models bf16, one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU; 12,290 programs; 2.16 GPU hours	USD 0.39
Positioning audit	Has prior work restored base-model variety, forecast it, or transplanted base states?	Web search and full-text quote checks	none recorded

5.2 The record audit: corrections from rows on disk, and frozen rival predictors

The record audit generated no model text. It answered every review item by recomputing the values behind it from the row files of eight earlier artifacts, and wrote each fix as an exact replacement for the record, with every value tagged by provenance and checked against the record within fixed tolerances (counts exact, rates 0.005, Hill-1 and log scores 0.01, intervals 0.02). Of 187 values that had a record value, 186 matched and 1 was corrected: the record's count of *22 of 35 cells* for signed progress on connected components is 22 of 24, because the staged file holds 24 block cells per quantity. A further 15 values were new and 4 were carried from the iteration-4 record because their source was not a declared dependency (the knob table cells, the route landings, the Llama block and the iteration-3 direction counts). All six quotes behind the rows added to Table 92c were verified again live on 2026-10-21. An independent script using only the standard library recomputed 195 values with no failure, and its four placebos failed as they should (balanced accuracy under permuted escape fractions 0.50; the site odds ratio 1.01 when the plan site and read position are swapped, against 101.7 real; a landing shuffle that shrinks the push advantage from 2.35 to 0.46 nats; rejection of permuted escape fractions at 3.5% to 4.8%). Table 168 lists the 35 corrections and the status of the values behind each.

Table 168. The 35 corrections of the iteration-4 record, their location and the values behind them (MATCH: recomputed equal to the record within tolerance; NEW: no record value; CARRIED: from the iteration-4 record). Source: record audit `corrections.json`.

Item	Report location	Values behind the correction (status against the record)

0a	Table 159 grid row	MATCH 7
0a	Table 159 and Table 163 shortest path rows	MATCH 5
0a	Table 162, the count of 4 of 4	MATCH 2
0a	Table 160	MATCH 21
0a	Section 4.10, the entry under Inconclusive	MATCH 7
0a	Closing paragraph on push movability as a forecast of which bans a model obeys (last sentence)	wording only
0b	Section 4.10 item 3	MATCH 23, NEW 2
0b	Section 4.4 summary	MATCH 2
0b	Closing paragraph 2	MATCH 2
0b	Closing paragraph 1	wording only
0b	Closing paragraph 3 (first sentence)	wording only
0b	Section 4.10, the site claim under Inconclusive (append)	MATCH 3, NEW 2
0c	Table 157	MATCH 37, NEW 1
0c	Section 4.6	MATCH 6
0c	Section 4.10 item 6 (moves from Established to the descriptive results)	MATCH 10
0c	Section 4.10 item 7, Section 4.2.2 route-landing lead, Section 4.11 paragraph 2 last sentence	CARRIED 1
0c	Closing landing paragraph	wording only
0c	Every statement that the landing is a property of the task (and the statement in closing paragraph 2 that where it can is a property of the task)	wording only
0d	Section 4.3 (plan noise on the plain prompt at alpha 1, executed but not reported)	MATCH 20
0d	Table 139 (two rows)	MATCH 1, NEW 2
0d	Tables 123/126 Llama row block and Section 4.2.1	CARRIED 1
0d	Beside Table 164 (dose unit)	MATCH 1, NEW 4
0d	Table 122, row of the experiment of Section 4.5	MATCH 3
0e	Seed-coupled plan noise counts (Section 4.5)	NEW 1
0e	Table 123 two sum row and closing paragraph	MATCH 3, NEW 1
0e	Tables 123, 126, 164 and closing paragraph 2, numbers of the best cells	CARRIED 1
0e	Section 4.10 item 5 and closing paragraph 3	MATCH 6
0e	Section 4.11 and the open questions of the closing (signed progress)	CARRIED 1
0e	The open questions of the closing	wording only
0e	Table 147	MATCH 1
0e	Section 4.11 paragraph 1 (last two sentences)	wording only
0e	Section 4.11	wording only
0g	Section 3.2.5 class rule	NEW 1
0g	Section 4.2.1, the sentence on reaching 1.5 within 20 points	wording only
0h	Section 4.5	NEW 1

The held-out verdict, per compliance measure. Table 169 restates the Gemma test of iteration 4 under every variant the audit could compute. Under the primary measure, catalogue-only avoidance, the verdict stays INCONCLUSIVE (balanced accuracy 0.74, Fisher p 0.235, Spearman 0.54). Under the preregistered sensitivity that measures compliance as the drop in the default share, which we call the *drop sensitivity*, it is DISCONFIRMED (0.57, Fisher p 1.0, Spearman 0.39).

Two tasks separate the measures, and Table 170 shows why. The grid twin is tied, BFS 25 and DFS 25 of 50 attempts, so the default DFS came from a 10-sample pilot (correct BFS 4 and DFS 5, attempts 5 and 5) and the ban's avoidance of 0.83 is measured against a baseline that already left DFS half the time; the default share drops by only 0.33. On find duplicate, 38 failing programs labelled other count as leaving the default under the drop measure (catalogue-only avoidance 0.34, drop 0.72). Under the iteration-5 default rule the grid task is the only one with no default, and the first and last position task's rule default (linear scan, 0.86 of the twin) differs from the frozen one. Removing the grid task leaves the verdict inconclusive (0.70); removing both compromised true positives gives 0.61 and Spearman 0.31 (one-sided p 0.144).

Table 169. The held-out movability test under every variant (15 tasks unless stated). Source: record audit `tables/table160_variants.csv`.

Variant	Tasks	Confusion table (rows: predicted obey, predicted fail; columns: observed obey, observed fail)	Balanced accuracy [95%]	Fisher p	Spearman	One-sided p	Kendall	Verdict under the frozen rule
primary: catalogue-only avoidance	15	[[3, 3], [1, 8]]	0.739 [0.42, 0.95]	0.235	0.537	0.025	0.470	INCONCLUSIVE
sensitivity: drop in default share	15	[[2, 4], [2, 7]]	0.568 [0.25, 0.88]	1.000	0.391	0.076	0.332	DISCONFIRMED
without the grid and shortest path tasks (avoidance)	13	[[1, 3], [1, 8]]	0.614 [0.27, 0.95]	1.000	0.313	0.144	0.293	INCONCLUSIVE
descriptive: without the task that has no default (avoidance)	14	[[2, 3], [1, 8]]	0.697 [0.33, 0.96]	0.505	0.484	0.048	0.434	INCONCLUSIVE
descriptive: without the task that has no default (drop)	14	[[2, 3], [2, 7]]	0.600 [0.29, 0.91]	0.580	0.360	0.106	0.305	DISCONFIRMED
descriptive: without the task that has no default and the task whose rule default differs from the frozen one (avoidance)	13	[[2, 3], [1, 7]]	0.683 [0.32, 0.95]	0.510	0.468	0.062	0.417	INCONCLUSIVE
descriptive: same subset (drop)	13	[[2, 3], [2, 6]]	0.583 [0.28, 0.89]	1.000	0.316	0.149	0.260	DISCONFIRMED

Table 170. The Gemma twin, the frozen default and the iteration-5 default rule per task, with both compliance measures under the modal ban. Source: record audit `tables/table159_grid.csv`.

Task	Frozen default	Twin attempts (N = 50)	Twin modal correct (share)	Iteration-5 default rule	Catalogue-only avoidance	Drop in default share	Failing other programs under the ban	Escape fraction	Ban composition (N = 100)
grid	DFS	DFS 25, BFS 25	DFS (0.59)	NO DEFAULT	0.83	0.33	0	0.125	BFS 83, DFS 17
shortest path	Dijkstra	Dijkstra 50	Dijkstra (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.96	0.97	1	0.250	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 96, Dijkstra 3, other 1
kth smallest	full sort	full sort 50	full sort (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.63	0.63	0	0.000	size-k heap 61, full sort 37, quickselect 1, heapify and pop 1
substring search	naive	naive 46, built-in find 4	naive (0.92)	DEFAULT	0.19	0.16	5	0.250	naive 76, built-in find 13, Rabin-Karp 6, other 5
find duplicate	hash set	hash set 50	hash set (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.34	0.72	38	0.000	other 38, hash set 28, sort and adjacent check 21, index marking 7, Floyd cycle detection 6
two sum	hash map	hash map 50	hash map (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.59	0.59	0	0.250	brute force 59, hash map 41
connected components	DFS	DFS 50	DFS (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.125	DFS 100
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end	greedy by end 50	greedy by end (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.000	greedy by end 100
Fibonacci	iteration	iteration 50	iteration (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.13	12	0.000	iteration 87, other 12, disputed 1
topological order	Kahn	Kahn 50	Kahn (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.000	Kahn 100
merge intervals	sort and sweep	sort and sweep 50	sort and sweep (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.000	sort and sweep 100
first and last position	binary search	linear scan 43, binary search 7	linear scan (0.86)	DEFAULT (differs from the frozen default)	0.00	-0.85	0	0.000	binary search 99, binary expand 1
top-k frequent	sort by count	sort by count 50	sort by count (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.000	sort by count 100
longest increasing subsequence	patience sorting with bisect	patience sorting with bisect 50	patience sorting with bisect (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.00	0	0.125	patience sorting with bisect 100

cycle detection	DFS with parent	DFS with parent 50	DFS with parent (1.00)	DEFAULT	0.00	0.03	0	0.000	DFS with parent 97, disputed 3

Landing forecasts on matched events. The iteration-4 record compared the push forecast's mean over its 3 defined events with the association mean over 5. Table 171 sets every forecast on the same three event sets. On the 3 events where this run's push forecast is defined, it scores -0.76 against -3.11 for association; over all 5 gated events, with an undefined forecast scored as uniform, it scores -1.37 against -3.46. The review's -1.37 is this 5-event value, and it coincides at two decimals with a different cell, the screen push's route replication on its 4 defined events (-1.369).

Table 171. Mean log score of each forecast on matched event sets of the five gated iteration-3 bench bans, with top-1 hits. Source: record audit `tables/table157_matched.csv`.

Forecast	3 events where this run's push is defined: bench ban (top-1)	same, route full-ban replication	4 events where the screen push is defined: bench ban (top-1)	same, route replication	all 5 gated events, undefined scored as uniform: bench ban (top-1)	same, route replication
push landing of this run's confirmed escapes	-0.761 (2 of 3)	-0.705	-0.922 (2 of 3)	-0.888	-1.366 (2 of 3)	-1.330
push landing of the iteration-3 screen	-1.396 (2 of 3)	-1.280	-1.480 (2 of 4)	-1.369	-1.812 (2 of 4)	-1.715
opening ladder	-1.613 (2 of 3)	-1.370	-2.243 (2 of 4)	-2.071	-2.391 (2 of 5)	-2.243
association	-3.115 (1 of 3)	-2.857	-3.363 (1 of 4)	-3.223	-3.462 (1 of 5)	-3.350
proximity	-2.918 (1 of 3)	-2.903	-3.270 (1 of 4)	-3.271	-3.212 (1 of 5)	-3.203

Exposure arms as controls. Table 172 gives the per-task verdict with exposure arms counted as controls, read from the plan noise experiment's knob rows (one engine) with the iteration-3 vetoes and the record's ban rows carried. Four task verdicts of Table 123 had rested on an exposure arm. Connected components keeps a qualifying knob (plan noise at alpha 2, 2.10 at no cost); longest increasing subsequence, nonoverlapping intervals and first and last position join the tasks on which no knob outside the exposure class reaches 1.5 within 20 pass points.

Table 172. Best knob outside the exposure class per task. Source: record audit `tables/table123_exposure.csv` (knob rows of the plan noise experiment).

Task	Best knob outside the exposure class within 5 points	Best within 20 points	Best within 20 points, same engine only	A knob outside the exposure class reaches 1.5 within 20 points	Record verdict that rested on an exposure arm (now a control)
grid	plan noise alpha 2 1.42 at 2 points	novelty instruction 1.84 at 14 points	novelty instruction 1.84 at 14 points	yes	unchanged
shortest path	semantic seed 1.95 at 4 points	semantic seed 1.95 at 4 points	semantic seed 1.95 at 4 points	yes	unchanged

kth smallest	plan noise alpha 1 2.14 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 2 2.87 at 6 points	plan noise alpha 2 2.87 at 6 points	yes	unchanged
substring search	novelty instruction 2.62 at 4 points	novelty instruction 2.62 at 4 points	novelty instruction 2.62 at 4 points	yes	unchanged
two sum	novelty instruction 1.26 at 2 points	plan noise alpha 4 1.79 at 20 points	plan noise alpha 4 1.79 at 20 points	yes	unchanged
find duplicate	first iterated veto round 2.50 at 2 points	first iterated veto round 2.50 at 2 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	yes	unchanged
Fibonacci	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	no	unchanged
connected components	plan noise alpha 2 2.10 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 2 2.10 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 2 2.10 at 0 points	yes	unnamed exposure ban of BFS 1.85 at 0
longest increasing subsequence	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	no	named exposure ban of the Fenwick tree 1.78 at 4
merge intervals	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	no	unchanged
top-k frequent	plan noise alpha 1 1.15 at 2 points	plan noise alpha 2 1.17 at 10 points	plan noise alpha 2 1.17 at 10 points	no	unchanged
nonoverlapping intervals	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	no	named exposure ban of the DAG longest path 1.26 at 6
cycle detection	novelty instruction 1.38 at -6 points	novelty instruction 1.38 at -6 points	novelty instruction 1.38 at -6 points	no	unchanged
topological order	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	plan noise alpha 0.5 1.00 at 0 points	no	unchanged
first and last position	temperature 1.6 1.43 at -4 points	temperature 1.6 1.43 at -4 points	temperature 1.6 1.43 at -4 points	no	exposure veto of exponential search 1.78 at 0 and 1.84 at 8 (round 3)

Executed results the record had omitted. Plan noise on the plain prompt, without the prohibition frame of the twin, ran on the same slots and directions as plan noise under the twin frame (Table 173). The frame is not needed on kth smallest, connected components and the shortest path task, and on connected components the plain prompt moved more programs (0.24 against 0.12). The dose units of the experiments differ (Table 174): the ban-free unit is 0.30 to 0.97 of the ban unit across tasks as a ratio of mean norms (Table 174); the knob experiment's mean of per-position ratios is larger (0.83 to 1.39 on the six decisive tasks: kth smallest 1.394, connected components 0.990, shortest path 0.889, two sum 0.995, grid 0.874, find duplicate 0.829), because a mean of ratios is not a ratio of means. By the ratio of means the shortfall is at most about 25% on

grid (0.751), shortest path (0.834), kth smallest (0.974), two sum (0.777), connected components (0.745), but 38% on find duplicate (0.620) and first and last position (0.618), 30% on top-k frequent (0.699) and 70% on substring search (0.296) (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 227), and substring search, the task that never moves, has by far the largest ban unit. A check made after the rivals were frozen found that the pooled escape fraction does not track the ratio of ban unit to residual norm (Spearman -0.06, AUC 0.49), so movability is not an artefact of the dose unit on the screen tasks.

Table 173. Plan noise at alpha 1 on the plain prompt and under the twin frame, same slots and directions. Source: record audit `tables/pnplain.csv`.

Task	Arm (alpha 1, same slots and direction)	N	Pass	Correct programs	Off-default share	Hill-1 (depth 25)
cycle detection	plan noise, plain prompt	50	0.76	DFS with parent 38	0.00	1.00
cycle detection	plan noise, twin frame	50	0.90	DFS with parent 45	0.00	1.00
kth smallest	plan noise, plain prompt	50	1.00	full sort 42, quickselect 5, size-k heap 3	0.16	1.70
kth smallest	plan noise, twin frame	50	1.00	full sort 36, quickselect 9, size-k heap 5	0.28	2.14
two sum	plan noise, plain prompt	50	1.00	hash map 50	0.00	1.00
two sum	plan noise, twin frame	50	1.00	hash map 50	0.00	1.00
find duplicate	plan noise, plain prompt	50	1.00	hash set 50	0.00	1.00
find duplicate	plan noise, twin frame	50	1.00	hash set 50	0.00	1.00
grid	plan noise, plain prompt	50	0.80	BFS 40	0.02	1.00
grid	plan noise, twin frame	50	0.70	BFS 34, DFS 1	0.06	1.13
connected components	plan noise, plain prompt	50	1.00	union find 38, DFS 12	0.24	1.72
connected components	plan noise, twin frame	50	1.00	union find 44, DFS 6	0.12	1.43
shortest path	plan noise, plain prompt	50	0.86	Dijkstra 36, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	0.26	1.55
shortest path	plan noise, twin frame	50	0.86	Dijkstra 34, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9	0.26	1.66

Table 174. Dose units per task: the ban unit (mean norm of the ban displacement), the ratio of the ban-free unit to it, and both relative to the residual norm. Source: record audit `tables/dose_units.csv`.

Task	Ban unit, mean norm	Ban-free unit / ban unit	Ban unit / residual norm, blocks 12-23 (site experiment)	Ban unit / residual norm, blocks 0-11 (site experiment)	Ban unit / residual norm, Qwen median (held-out experiment)	Ban-free unit / residual norm
grid	15.26	0.75	0.140	0.060	0.119	0.105
shortest path	18.98	0.83	0.149	0.057	0.117	0.124
kth smallest	11.58	0.97	0.127	0.045	0.082	0.123
substring search	58.51	0.30	n/a	n/a	0.113	n/a
two sum	14.74	0.78	0.150	0.063	0.108	0.117
find duplicate	18.67	0.62	0.183	0.072	0.145	0.113
Fibonacci	12.88	0.88	n/a	n/a	0.086	n/a

connected components	15.12	0.75	0.154	0.066	0.112	0.115
longest increasing subsequence	14.32	0.80	n/a	n/a	0.100	n/a
merge intervals	11.93	0.95	n/a	n/a	0.082	n/a
top-k frequent	16.19	0.70	n/a	n/a	0.123	n/a
nonoverlapping intervals	14.90	0.76	n/a	n/a	0.094	n/a
cycle detection	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
topological order	13.19	0.86	n/a	n/a	0.098	n/a
first and last position	18.58	0.62	n/a	n/a	0.133	n/a

Distributions, not best cells. Table 175 summarises the 624 cells of single directions in the escape screens as quantiles, so that a best cell can be read beside the direction it came from. On kth smallest at alpha 1 the median direction moves 3% of programs off the default and the maximum moves all of them; on two sum 0 of 40 directions escape at alpha 1 and 5 of 40 at alpha 2, with a median of 0. Table 176 gives the template split-half reliability of the direction ranking on all six tasks; the grid task (0.39 with 22 movers) and find duplicate (0.59 with 3 movers) were missing from the record. Table 177 gives signed progress toward the runner-up per task: 22 of the 24 realised-progress cells with uncorrected p below 0.05 on connected components, but 1 on kth smallest, whose mean over the edited blocks is -0.02, and 0 on find duplicate, whose mean is -0.12. On connected components the committed signed component (0.33) was matched by the within-class control (0.37). Signed progress is closed. Table 178 gives the number of correct programs behind each cell of Table 147: the alpha-4 peaks on two sum, find duplicate and connected components rest on 9, 5 and 7 programs.

Table 175. Escape screens per direction as distributions: directions run, escaping, movers, and quantiles over directions of the off-default share and of correct-only Hill-1. Source: record audit `tables/direction_quantiles.csv` (rows per direction in `tables/direction_distributions.csv`).

Task	Alpha	Directions	Escaping	Movers (any off-default attempt)	Off-default share: median / q75 / max	Correct-only Hill-1: median / q75 / max
nonoverlapping intervals	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
nonoverlapping intervals	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
cycle detection	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
cycle detection	2	8	0	2	0.00 / 0.03 / 0.10	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.51
topological order	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
topological order	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
first and last position	1	8	0	2	0.00 / 0.05 / 0.30	1.00 / 1.48 / 1.84
first and last position	2	8	0	1	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.10	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.38
kth smallest	1	40	12	20	0.03 / 0.24 / 1.00	1.00 / 1.60 / 2.88
kth smallest	2	40	25	32	0.23 / 0.47 / 1.00	1.72 / 2.05 / 2.94

substring search	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
substring search	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
two sum	1	40	0	6	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.10	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.38
two sum	2	40	5	9	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.97	1.00 / 1.04 / 1.98
find duplicate	1	40	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
find duplicate	2	40	0	2	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.40	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.89
Fibonacci	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
Fibonacci	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
grid	1	40	2	7	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.10	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.55
grid	2	40	5	7	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.37	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.97
connected components	1	40	15	22	0.10 / 0.33 / 0.93	1.38 / 1.74 / 2.60
connected components	2	40	29	35	0.58 / 0.87 / 1.00	1.68 / 1.93 / 2.78
longest increasing subsequence	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
longest increasing subsequence	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
merge intervals	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
merge intervals	2	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
top-k frequent	1	8	0	0	0.00 / 0.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 1.00 / 1.00
top-k frequent	2	8	0	2	0.00 / 0.02 / 0.10	1.00 / 1.10 / 1.78
shortest path	1	40	7	17	0.00 / 0.10 / 0.67	1.00 / 1.44 / 1.99
shortest path	2	40	8	29	0.13 / 0.33 / 0.63	1.51 / 1.86 / 2.29

Table 176. Template split-half reliability of the ranking of 40 fresh directions by off-default share, on all six tasks. Source: record audit `tables/split_half.csv`.

Task	Template split-half Spearman over 40 directions	Placebo	Movers (any alpha)	Escaping cells (direction and dose)
kth smallest	0.80	-0.06	34	27
shortest path	0.81	0.16	37	14
two sum	0.76	-0.06	10	5
connected components	0.90	0.13	36	30
find duplicate	0.59	-0.05	3	0
grid	0.39	-0.05	22	6

Table 177. Signed progress toward the runner-up per task, over 24 block cells (blocks 12 to 35). Source: record audit `tables/signed_progress.csv`.

Task	Quantity	Runner-up	Cells with p < 0.05 (uncorrected)	Mean, all blocks	Mean, edited blocks 12-23	Minimum (block)	Largest correlation
kth smallest	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	quickselect	1 of 24	0.08	-0.02	-0.29 (block 15)	0.26

kth smallest	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	quickselect	5 of 24	0.14	0.02	-0.26 (block 15)	0.26
shortest path	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	3 of 24	0.15	0.20	-0.06 (block 35)	0.30
shortest path	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0 of 24	0.05	0.03	-0.13 (block 17)	0.30
two sum	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	brute force	7 of 24	0.20	0.31	-0.27 (block 35)	0.47
two sum	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	brute force	6 of 24	0.18	0.25	-0.20 (block 35)	0.47
connected components	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	DFS	22 of 24	0.39	0.37	0.16 (block 35)	0.57
connected components	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	DFS	23 of 24	0.49	0.41	0.21 (block 35)	0.57
find duplicate	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	sort and adjacent check	0 of 24	0.02	-0.12	-0.27 (block 16)	0.22
find duplicate	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	sort and adjacent check	0 of 24	0.05	-0.07	-0.21 (block 16)	0.22
grid	signed progress toward the runner-up (realised)	DFS	2 of 24	0.12	0.05	-0.12 (block 12)	0.48
grid	signed progress toward the runner-up (applied)	DFS	12 of 24	0.22	0.12	-0.02 (block 13)	0.48

Table 178. Correct programs behind each cell of Table 147 and the depth at which Hill-1 was rarefied. Source: record audit `tables/table147_depths.csv`.

Task	Alpha 0	Alpha 1	Alpha 2	Alpha 4	Alpha 8
kth smallest	50 of 50 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	28 of 30 (depth 25)	20 of 30 (depth 20)	0 of 50 (depth 0)

two sum	50 of 50 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	29 of 30 (depth 25)	9 of 30 (depth 9)	0 of 50 (depth 0)
find duplicate	50 of 50 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	5 of 30 (depth 5)	0 of 50 (depth 0)
connected components	50 of 50 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	29 of 30 (depth 25)	7 of 30 (depth 7)	0 of 50 (depth 0)
grid	37 of 50 (depth 25)	36 of 50 (depth 25)	34 of 50 (depth 25)	6 of 50 (depth 6)	0 of 50 (depth 0)
shortest path	50 of 50 (depth 25)	30 of 30 (depth 25)	27 of 30 (depth 25)	1 of 30 (depth 1)	0 of 50 (depth 0)

Rival task predictors, frozen before any target was read. For the movability half to mean anything, beta had to beat simpler explanations of why a task moves. The audit computed eight ban-free predictors for the 15 existing tasks and catalogue size as a covariate, wrote them to a canonical file, and froze them by sha256 in a hash chain before opening any outcome file (frozen at 11:59:44 UTC, first scored at 11:59:50; two later freezes left the values identical). The predictors are the twin's opening margin (the margin in log probability, under teacher forcing, of the opening of the default over that of the runner-up), the forced can rate, association clarity, the off-default excess under the novelty instruction, the diversity of human solutions (Mercury solutions labelled by the frozen rules with a judge on unknowns; audit agreement 0.97, kappa 0.97, 121 programs), the runtime merit gap between the reference programs of the runner-up and of the default (76 references timed on their hidden tests), the twin modal share and the ratio of ban unit to residual norm. Five of them (the opening margin, the novelty excess, the merit gap, the twin modal share and catalogue size) can be computed on new tasks and were frozen for the confirmation panels. Scored against the pooled escape fraction of the screen, none is informative after Holm correction (every adjusted p is 1.0), and 10 of the 15 tasks are tied at an escape fraction of 0 (Tables 179 to 181). These scores are descriptive: the escape fractions generated the hypothesis, so the freeze protects only the confirmation on new tasks.

Table 179. The frozen rival predictors per task, with the screen's escape fraction and plan noise excess. Source: record audit `tables/rivals_values.csv`.

Task	Opening margin	Forced can rate	Association clarity	Novelty instruction excess	Diversity of human solutions	Runtime merit gap	Twin modal share	Ban unit ratio	Catalogue size	Escape fraction (pooled)	Plan noise excess	Screen movable
grid	1.20	n/a	1.00	0.30	n/a	0.94	1.00	0.75	6	0.087	0.24	yes
shortest path	0.00	n/a	0.75	0.06	2.50	1.01	1.00	0.83	5	0.188	0.54	yes
kth smallest	7.44	0.95	1.00	1.00	4.82	5.67	0.98	0.97	6	0.463	0.50	yes
substring search	3.45	1.00	1.00	0.48	1.99	0.03	1.00	0.30	6	0.000	0.00	no
two sum	14.05	1.00	1.00	0.06	1.83	2.44	1.00	0.78	4	0.062	0.02	yes
find duplicate	12.06	0.78	1.00	0.00	3.38	3.60	1.00	0.62	5	0.000	0.02	no
Fibonacci	14.68	1.00	1.00	0.09	1.98	1.67	1.00	0.88	4	0.000	0.02	no
connected components	21.79	1.00	1.00	0.04	2.91	1.09	1.00	0.75	4	0.550	0.60	yes
longest increasing subsequence	16.70	1.00	1.00	0.09	1.99	0.01	1.00	0.80	3	0.000	0.08	no
merge intervals	25.95	0.05	0.95	0.00	1.24	60.62	1.00	0.95	3	0.000	0.00	no
top-k frequent	34.17	0.53	1.00	0.00	3.20	1.06	1.00	0.70	4	0.000	0.08	no
nonoverlapping intervals	1.89	0.10	1.00	0.00	1.00	3.31	1.00	0.76	4	0.000	0.00	no
cycle detection	n/a	1.00	1.00	0.10	2.43	0.69	1.00	n/a	4	0.000	0.02	no
topological order	23.38	0.00	1.00	0.00	2.39	1.45	1.00	0.86	4	0.000	0.00	no

first and last position	9.40	0.97	1.00	-0.05	1.99	0.46	0.91	0.62	3	0.000	-0.04	no

Table 180. The rival predictors scored against the screen's pooled escape fraction (descriptive; the predicted sign is the direction the rival should take if it explains movability). Source: record audit `results/rival_scores.json`, `tables/rivals_scores.csv`.

Rival	Frozen for new tasks	Tasks	Predicted sign	Spearman with pooled escape fraction [95% bootstrap]	Oriented	Permutation p (two sided)	Oriented Spearman, alpha 1 / alpha 2	Oriented Spearman with plan noise excess	Partial given catalogue size	AUC for screen movable	Holm p	Flag
catalogue size (covariate)	yes	15	+	+0.46 [0.00, 0.81]	+0.46	0.09	+0.49 / +0.44	+0.40	n/a	0.77	n/a	
diversity of human solutions	no	14	+	+0.39 [-0.28, 0.79]	+0.39	0.18	+0.54 / +0.39	+0.67	0.24	0.70	1.0	
novelty instruction excess	yes	15	+	+0.38 [-0.15, 0.78]	+0.38	0.16	+0.36 / +0.37	+0.42	0.15	0.74	1.0	
forced can rate	no	13	+	+0.30 [-0.17, 0.67]	+0.30	0.31	+0.17 / +0.30	+0.35	0.29	0.70	1.0	
ban unit ratio (dose check)	no	14	-	+0.21 [-0.36, 0.69]	-0.21	0.48	-0.20 / -0.21	-0.19	0.29	0.38	1.0	
runtime merit gap	yes	15	-	+0.14 [-0.36, 0.60]	-0.14	0.62	-0.07 / -0.15	+0.02	0.12	0.42	1.0	
twin modal share	yes	15	-	-0.16 [-0.73, 0.31]	+0.16	0.76	+0.20 / +0.16	-0.13	-0.20	0.54	1.0	uninformative (< = 3 distinct values)
association clarity	no	15	+	-0.16 [-0.72, 0.31]	-0.16	0.71	-0.20 / -0.16	-0.10	-0.23	0.44	1.0	uninformative (< = 3 distinct values)
twin opening margin	yes	14	-	-0.33 [-0.78, 0.25]	+0.33	0.25	+0.34 / +0.32	+0.10	-0.08	0.73	1.0	

Table 181. Spearman correlations among the rival predictors over the 15 existing tasks. Source: record audit `tables/rivals_intercorr.csv`.

Rival	twin opening margin	forced can rate	association clarity	novelty instruction excess	diversity of human solutions	runtime merit gap	twin modal share	ban unit ratio (dose check)	catalogue size (covariate)
twin opening margin	1.00	-0.24	0.09	-0.38	0.07	0.19	0.20	0.16	-0.61
forced can rate	-0.24	1.00	0.41	0.63	0.03	-0.53	0.06	-0.22	0.08
association clarity	0.09	0.41	1.00	0.17	0.12	-0.20	-0.15	-0.39	0.09
novelty instruction excess	-0.38	0.63	0.17	1.00	0.19	-0.21	0.04	0.25	0.59
diversity of human solutions	0.07	0.03	0.12	0.19	1.00	-0.05	-0.17	-0.05	0.52
runtime merit gap	0.19	-0.53	-0.20	-0.21	-0.05	1.00	-0.01	0.51	0.07

twin modal share	0.20	0.06	-0.15	0.04	-0.17	-0.01	1.00	-0.01	0.04
ban unit ratio (dose check)	0.16	-0.22	-0.39	0.25	-0.05	0.51	-0.01	1.00	-0.11
catalogue size (covariate)	-0.61	0.08	0.09	0.59	0.52	0.07	0.04	-0.11	1.00

Catalogue size, the number of algorithms a task's catalogue admits, tracks the screen's movability as well as any rival (+0.46), which is a reminder that a task with more alternatives has more ways to move.

5.3 Transplanting the base model's plan states into the instruct model (Qwen3-8B)

Why. If post-training narrowed the choice at the plan site, the narrowing should be undone by giving the instruct model the base model's own task-specification states. No earlier iteration had tried this: iteration 1 subtracted an instruct minus base direction estimated at the read position only, which destroyed the output format (Section 1.9). This experiment was the first causal test of the transplant claim, and it also measured the base repertoire that every other Qwen3-8B analysis of the iteration needed.

Design. Qwen3-8B and Qwen3-8B-Base (revision 49e3418f, the base revision of iteration 1) ran in bf16 on one RTX 4090 with thinking off, temperature 1.0, top-p 1 and no top-k. The base model sampled 100 programs per task under the instruct chat template on identical token ids (200 on the two path tasks, with top-ups to 200 on connected components, nonoverlapping intervals and cycle detection) and 100 in plain completion. Its labels used the iteration-4 labellers with a blind judge on disagreement, and a 15-program judge audit per task agreed at least 0.86 everywhere. The base repertoire (default, beta with a 95% interval, stratum, base runner-up) was committed by hash before any hooked sample. The transplant set the hooked states to h_instruct + lambda (h_base − h_instruct) at blocks 12 to 23 for lambda in {0.25, 0.5, 1}; the states were set, not added, so nothing compounded, and at lambda 1 the hooked blocks carried the base state exactly. The controls on the same common-random-number slots were a matched-norm random displacement (per block and position), the borrowed shift (another task's mean base minus instruct direction at the same norm), and, where the random control broke the model, a random push matched on pass rate. Site controls transplanted at the read position, at blocks 0 to 11 and at blocks 24 to 35. Lambda was selected on one set of slots and confirmed on fresh slots, both under commits made before the samples.

The base model is more diverse than the instruct model on most tasks (Table 182). Under the same prompt the instruct twin wrote its default in 96% to 100% of programs on all 15 tasks, while 5 tasks were diverse in the base (kth smallest, shortest path, connected components, grid and top-k frequent), 7 intermediate and 3 collapsed in the base (merge intervals, nonoverlapping intervals and topological order). The base model under the chat template is a poor programmer: it wrote 14 to 55 correct programs per 100 to 200 samples, and on the grid task only 14 of 200, so the grid beta rests on attempts. On connected components it writes DFS more often than union find (32 against 19 correct programs), so the instruct default is the base model's second choice there.

Table 182. The base repertoire of the 15 existing tasks, committed before any transplant sample. Source: transplant experiment `results/base_repertoire.json`.

Task	Instruct default (twin share)	Base correct / N	Base correct programs (chat template)	beta [95% CI] (basis)	Stratum (stability)	Base runner-up	beta, plain completion	Base Hill-1 (depth 25)
kth smallest	full sort (1.00)	47 of 100	full sort 26, quickselect 13, size-k heap 4, heapify and pop 3, other 1	0.43 [0.33, 0.49] (correct)	diverse in the base (1.00)	quickselect	0.10	3.03
shortest path	Dijkstra (1.00)	44 of 200	Dijkstra 25, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 18, other 1	0.41 [0.33, 0.55] (correct)	diverse in the base (1.00)	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.32	2.12
two sum	hash map (1.00)	49 of 100	hash map 41, brute force 7, sort and two pointers 1	0.16 [0.12, 0.21] (correct)	intermediate (0.92)	brute force	0.69	1.63
connected components	union find (1.00)	55 of 200	DFS 32, union find 19, BFS 4	0.65 [0.58, 0.76] (correct)	diverse in the base (1.00)	DFS	0.81	2.34
find duplicate	hash set (1.00)	51 of 100	hash set 39, index marking 4, sort and adjacent check 3, Floyd cycle detection 2, other 2, value binary search 1	0.20 [0.10, 0.29] (correct)	intermediate (0.55)	index marking	0.33	2.34
grid	BFS (1.00)	14 of 200	BFS 10, DFS 4	0.38 [0.32, 0.44] (attempt)	diverse in the base (1.00)	DFS	0.21	1.82
substring search	naive (1.00)	52 of 100	naive 46, built-in find 6	0.12 [0.05, 0.16] (correct)	intermediate (0.99)	built-in find	0.27	1.42
Fibonacci	iteration (1.00)	37 of 100	iteration 31, memoised recursion 6	0.16 [0.09, 0.22] (correct)	intermediate (0.90)	memoised recursion	0.08	1.55
longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP (1.00)	43 of 100	quadratic DP 39, patience sorting with bisect 4	0.09 [0.05, 0.12] (correct)	intermediate (0.99)	patience sorting with bisect	0.00	1.36

merge intervals	sort and sweep (1.00)	40 of 100	sort and sweep 40	0.00 [0.00, 0.00] (correct)	collapsed in the base (1.00)	none	0.00	1.00
top-k frequent	sort by count (1.00)	31 of 100	sort by count 20, heap 11	0.35 [0.26, 0.41] (correct)	diverse in the base (1.00)	heap	0.07	1.91
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end (1.00)	42 of 200	greedy by end 42	0.00 [0.00, 0.00] (correct)	collapsed in the base (1.00)	none	0.06	1.00
topological order	Kahn (1.00)	40 of 100	Kahn 39, DFS postorder 1	0.03 [0.00, 0.07] (correct)	collapsed in the base (0.88)	DFS postorder	0.39	1.12
first and last position	binary search (0.96)	40 of 100	binary search 29, linear scan 8, bisect module 2, other 1	0.05 [0.00, 0.12] (correct)	intermediate (0.53)	bisect module	0.00	2.17
cycle detection	DFS with parent (1.00)	43 of 200	DFS with parent 36, union find 6, BFS with parent 1	0.16 [0.07, 0.23] (correct)	intermediate (0.80)	union find	0.15	1.63

As a screen check, the committed beta ranks the 15 tasks almost exactly as iteration 4's random pushes could move them: Spearman 0.78 against the escape fraction at alpha 1 (one-sided permutation p 0.0002), 0.79 at alpha 2 and 0.79 on their mean, and the base runner-up equals the push's top-1 landing on 5 of 5 movable tasks. This is the observation the hypothesis was built on, measured again; it is not a test, because these tasks generated the hypothesis.

Selection and confirmation. Table 183 gives every arm of the selection stage. The transplant moved two tasks at an intact pass rate on the selection slots, top-k frequent at lambda 1 (0.47 of correct programs off the default, pass 0.98) and connected components at lambda 0.5 (0.12), and it broke the shortest path and grid tasks at lambda of 0.5 or more (pass 0.72 and 0.54, 0.50 and 0.30). On kth smallest the matched random displacement at lambda 1 moved more programs (0.34) than the transplant (0.06). Early-block transplants moved kth smallest (0.30) and connected components (0.28) more than the main band, the transplant at the read position broke the output on 13 of 15 tasks without moving an algorithm, and late-block transplants were inert.

Table 183. Selection stage on the first slots: pass rate / correct off-default share per arm (N = 50 for the transplant, 30 for the controls; T is the transplant at lambda, MR the matched random displacement, READ, EARLY and LATE the site controls at lambda 1). Source: transplant experiment `results/selection.json`.

Task	stratum	twin	T(0.25)	T(0.5)	T(1)	MR(0.25)	MR(0.5)	MR(1)	READ(1)	EARLY(1)	LATE(1)	lambda*
kth smallest	diverse in the base	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.02	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.06	1.00 / 0.10	1.00 / 0.07	0.97 / 0.34	0.97 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.30	1.00 / 0.04	1.00
shortest path	diverse in the base	0.98 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.72 / 0.06	0.54 / 0.04	0.97 / 0.03	0.93 / 0.07	0.90 / 0.00	0.00 / –	0.98 / 0.00	0.88 / 0.02	0.25

two sum	intermediate	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.03	0.43 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.25
connected components	diverse in the base	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.04	1.00 / 0.12	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.03	1.00 / 0.10	0.17 / 0.20	1.00 / 0.28	1.00 / 0.00	0.50
find duplicate	intermediate	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.17	0.37 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.25
grid	diverse in the base	0.86 / 0.00	0.72 / 0.00	0.50 / 0.00	0.30 / 0.00	0.87 / 0.04	0.77 / 0.00	0.73 / 0.09	0.13 / 0.00	0.40 / 0.00	0.90 / 0.00	0.25
substring search	intermediate	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.25
Fibonacci	intermediate	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.97 / 0.00	0.90 / 0.00	0.37 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.25
longest increasing subsequence	intermediate	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.93 / 0.04	0.53 / 0.06	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.25
merge intervals	collapsed in the base	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	–	–	–	0.37 / 0.00	–	–	–
top-k frequent	diverse in the base	0.78 / 0.00	0.78 / 0.00	0.68 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.47	0.77 / 0.00	0.80 / 0.08	0.53 / 0.19	0.07 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.00	0.72 / 0.00	1.00
nonoverlapping intervals	collapsed in the base	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.40 / 0.00	–	–	–	0.30 / 0.00	–	–	–
topological order	collapsed in the base	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	–	–	–	0.13 / 0.00	–	–	–
first and last position	intermediate	0.90 / 0.00	0.88 / 0.00	0.90 / 0.00	0.64 / 0.00	0.83 / 0.00	0.80 / 0.00	0.87 / 0.00	0.23 / 0.00	0.96 / 0.00	0.94 / 0.00	0.25
cycle detection	intermediate	0.94 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.00	0.98 / 0.00	0.90 / 0.00	0.90 / 0.00	0.77 / 0.00	0.43 / 0.15	0.17 / 0.00	1.00 / 0.00	0.96 / 0.00	0.25

On fresh slots (Table 184) only top-k frequent passed: the transplant wrote the base runner-up, a heap, in 21 of 49 correct programs against 0 of 39 for the twin, beat all three controls at p of 7e-4 or less after Holm adjustment, and was ahead on 5 of 5 templates. On kth smallest the matched random displacement beat the transplant (2 flips by the transplant alone against 20 by the random displacement alone; exact test, two sided, p 1.2e-4): the base direction disturbs the plan less than an isotropic one of the same size. On connected components the transplant led both controls 3:0, short of significance, and on the shortest path and grid tasks the lambda that survives (0.25) moved nothing. The frozen rule needs a pass on at least 4 of the 5 tasks diverse in the base, so the transplant claim is DISCONFIRMED; the sensitivities restricted to the stable stratum and robust to noise agree. An extension blind to outcomes, to N = 100, on the decisive cells (Table 185) kept top-k frequent (44:0, 35:3 and 49:0 against the three controls) and added only raw significance against the borrowed shift on kth smallest (6:0, p 0.016, Holm 0.11) and connected components (7:0, p 0.0078, Holm 0.06); neither task beat the matched random control. Its verdict reads PARTIAL for a mechanical reason: at N = 100 the grid transplant's pass rate (0.68) fell below 0.8 times the twin's, which removes the precondition for DISCONFIRMED.

Table 184. Confirmation on fresh slots (N = 50 per cell; lambda* is the selected lambda; one-sided exact McNemar on correct off-default programs, transplant only : control only, with p after Holm adjustment; rows marked desc. are descriptive tasks outside the decisive set). Source: transplant

experiment `results/confirmation.json`.

Task	lambda*	twin pass, fresh slots	T: pass / off-default share / modal	control: pass / off-default share	McNemar b:c, p (Holm)	templates T > control
kth smallest	1.00	1.00	1.00 / 0.06 / size-k heap	matched random, lambda 1: 1.00 / 0.42	2:20, 1 (1)	0/5
kth smallest	1.00	1.00	1.00 / 0.06 / size-k heap	borrowed shift, lambda 1: 1.00 / 0.00	3:0, 0.12 (1)	2/5
shortest path	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 0.98 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (1)	0/5
shortest path	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 0.98 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (1)	0/5
connected components	0.50	1.00	1.00 / 0.08 / DFS	matched random, 0.5: 1.00 / 0.02	3:0, 0.12 (1)	3/5
connected components	0.50	1.00	1.00 / 0.08 / DFS	borrowed shift, 0.5: 1.00 / 0.02	3:0, 0.12 (1)	3/5
grid	0.25	0.88	0.76 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 0.94 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (1)	0/5
grid	0.25	0.88	0.76 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 0.86 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (1)	0/5
top-k frequent	1.00	0.78	0.98 / 0.43 / heap	matched random, lambda 1: 0.78 / 0.05	19:0, 1.9e-06 (1.9e-05)	5/5
top-k frequent	1.00	0.78	0.98 / 0.43 / heap	borrowed shift, lambda 1: 0.88 / 0.11	17:1, 7.2e-05 (6.5e-04)	5/5
top-k frequent	1.00	0.78	0.98 / 0.43 / heap	random matched on pass, 0.5: 0.76 / 0.00	21:0, 4.8e-07 (5.2e-06)	5/5
two sum (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
two sum (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
find duplicate (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
find duplicate (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
substring search (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
substring search (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
Fibonacci (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
Fibonacci (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5

longest increasing subsequence (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
longest increasing subsequence (desc.)	0.25	1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 1.00 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
first and last position (desc.)	0.25	0.76	0.78 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 0.80 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
first and last position (desc.)	0.25	0.76	0.78 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 0.56 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
cycle detection (desc.)	0.25	0.84	0.90 / 0.00 / none	matched random, 0.25: 0.80 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5
cycle detection (desc.)	0.25	0.84	0.90 / 0.00 / none	borrowed shift, 0.25: 0.86 / 0.00	0:0, 1 (–)	0/5

Table 185. Extension blind to outcomes, to N = 100, on the decisive cells. Source: transplant experiment `results/confirmation.json#power_extension_N100`.

Task	Transplant pass	Correct off-default share	Against matched random (transplant only : random only, one-sided p)	Against borrowed shift	Against random matched on pass
kth smallest	1.00	0.06	4:36, p = 1	6:0, p = 0.016	n/a
shortest path	1.00	0.00	0:0, p = 1	0:0, p = 1	n/a
connected components	1.00	0.08	6:2, p = 0.14	7:0, p = 0.0078	n/a
grid	0.68	0.00	0:0, p = 1	0:0, p = 1	n/a
top-k frequent	0.99	0.49	44:0, p = 5.7e-14	35:3, p = 3.3e-08	49:0, p = 1.8e-15

Top-k frequent is the one task on which the base state works and random noise does not: it is diverse in the base (beta 0.35) and iteration 4's random pushes never moved it. Its transplant also raised the pass rate from 0.78 to 0.98, so part of what the transplant restores may be a more correct program rather than a reopened choice; the experiment did not separate the two. Tasks collapsed in the base did not move under the full transplant (change 0.00). The transplant at the read position shifted the off-default share by more than 0.05 on connected components and longest increasing subsequence, but only among the few programs that still passed (5 and 16 correct of 30) and never significantly, so the specificity check on point estimates fails while its version robust to noise holds.

The push toward the base and the reverse transplant. A push along the unit base minus instruct direction never escaped the default on any of the four tasks at doses of 0.5 to 2 ban-free units, while an isotropic push at the same doses escaped on kth smallest at alpha 2 (Table 186). The claim for the push toward the base is DISCONFIRMED. The reverse interchange wrote the instruct model's task-specification states into the base model (Table 187). It raised the base model's correct program counts on all four tasks (kth smallest 20 to 31, shortest path 15 to 20, grid 5 to 11, connected components 18 to 19) and its default share among attempts, while a matched random displacement lowered the counts; the committed prediction (the default share among correct programs rises by at least half the instruct minus base gap) was met only on the grid task (0.80 to 1.00; one-sided p 0.033). Control is asymmetric: instruct states pull the base model toward the instruct default and toward correct code, but base states do not pull the instruct model back.

Table 186. Push toward the base along unit(D) against an isotropic push at the same dose (ban-free units, N = 30; pass, correct off-default share). Source: transplant experiment `results/desharpen.json`.

Task	twin pass	push along unit(D), alpha 0.5 / 1 / 2 (pass, off-default share)	isotropic push, alpha 0.5 / 1 / 2 (pass, off-default share)	escape dose, unit(D)	escape dose, isotropic
kth smallest	1.00	1.00, 0.00 ; 1.00, 0.00 ; 1.00, 0.00	1.00, 0.00 ; 1.00, 0.13 ; 1.00, 0.27	–	2.00
shortest path	1.00	1.00, 0.00 ; 1.00, 0.00 ; 0.97, 0.03	1.00, 0.00 ; 1.00, 0.00 ; 0.90, 0.07	–	>2 (censored)
connected components	1.00	1.00, 0.03 ; 1.00, 0.03 ; 0.93, 0.11	1.00, 0.03 ; 1.00, 0.03 ; 1.00, 0.10	–	>2 (censored)
grid	0.87	0.87, 0.00 ; 0.77, 0.00 ; 0.60, 0.00	0.93, 0.00 ; 0.70, 0.00 ; 0.77, 0.00	–	>2 (censored)

Table 187. Reverse interchange: instruct task-specification states into the base model (blocks 12 to 23, N = 50). Source: transplant experiment `results/reverse.json`.

Task	base twin default share (correct / attempts)	instruct states into base, lambda 1	matched random into base	predicted min rise	met
connected components	0.50 / 0.38 (correct programs 18)	0.53 / 0.55 (correct programs 19)	0.50 / 0.36 (correct programs 16)	0.25	no
kth smallest	0.65 / 0.55 (correct programs 20)	0.74 / 0.66 (correct programs 31)	0.56 / 0.39 (correct programs 16)	0.17	no
shortest path	0.87 / 0.63 (correct programs 15)	0.80 / 0.74 (correct programs 20)	0.50 / 0.41 (correct programs 6)	0.07	no
grid	0.80 / 0.39 (correct programs 5)	1.00 / 0.73 (correct programs 11)	1.00 / 0.50 (correct programs 2)	0.10	yes

What the base minus instruct difference is. D = h_base − h_instruct is mostly shared across tasks and templates: the per-task mean D has a cosine across tasks of 0.76 to 0.88 at blocks 12 to 27 and split-half cosine 0.96 to 1.00 between template halves. It is large: at lambda 1, 71% of the hooked cells exceed 4 ban-free units, the dose at which random noise broke programs in iteration 4, and at the read position the difference is as large as the residual itself (Table 188). The transplanted state does not survive downstream: at block 27 the task-specification state stays 88% to 89% of the way to the base twin, but the state at the read position moves only 18% to 31% of the way (Table 189), so blocks 24 and later pull the computation back toward the instruct model.

Table 188. Size of D relative to the residual norm, mean over tasks, per block. Source: transplant experiment `results/d_norms.json`.

Block	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23
norm of D / residual norm, task-specification positions	0.39	0.41	0.42	0.44	0.44	0.46	0.48	0.49	0.51	0.53	0.53	0.52
norm of D / residual norm, read position	1.06	1.08	1.09	1.07	1.06	1.06	0.99	1.10	1.07	1.09	1.11	1.12

Table 189. Geometry of the transplanted state: distance of the centroid under the transplant at the selected lambda as a fraction of the gap between the instruct and base twins, with MDS stress-1. Source: transplant experiment `results/geometry.json`.

Task	lambda	Task spec, block 18 (stress-1)	Task spec, block 23	Task spec, block 27	Read position, block 18	Read position, block 23
kth smallest	1.0	1.00 (0.25)	1.00 (0.25)	0.88 (0.22)	0.18 (0.06)	0.30 (0.08)
shortest path	0.25	0.25 (0.17)	0.25 (0.22)	0.23 (0.21)	0.05 (0.05)	0.07 (0.08)
connected components	0.5	0.50 (0.27)	0.50 (0.27)	0.47 (0.23)	0.09 (0.06)	0.15 (0.08)
grid	0.25	0.25 (0.27)	0.25 (0.26)	0.24 (0.23)	0.05 (0.06)	0.07 (0.08)

top-k frequent	1.0	1.00 (0.06)	1.00 (0.06)	0.89 (0.08)	0.18 (0.05)	0.31 (0.06)

Checks. Every bench labeller recovered all its references; the base extraction agreed with iteration-1 labels on 0.95 of 40 programs; the hash chain had no break, and every hooked row followed the commit of the base repertoire. Two independent recomputations matched 56 of 56 and 34 of 34 checks, and the placebos failed as required (arm shuffle within slots rejects at 0.012). The engine check against the 8-bit rows of iteration 4 (Table 190) agrees slot by slot on the twins and within the resampling null on the pushed cells, except the shortest path twin, which is outside a null of zero width. The novelty audit read every one of 48 correct programs outside the catalogue, base output included: the judges called 14 of them novel, and the manual comparison with the nearest known solution found linear scans, count loops and a threshold binary search, known techniques outside the frozen catalogue; 0 novel (rule-of-three bound 0.062). Ten deviations are logged, among them base sampling and the engine check before the protocol commit (both still before every transplant sample) and the conservative label unknown for the probe of Dijkstra with an array scan.

Table 190. Engine check of the bf16 engine against the 8-bit rows of iteration 4. Source: transplant experiment `results/engine_check.json`.

Task	Cell	Label agreement per slot	JS	Null 95th percentile	Within null
kth smallest	twin	1.00	0.000	0.000	yes
kth smallest	random direction 9002	0.74	0.030	0.075	yes
shortest path	twin	0.98	0.010	0.000	no
shortest path	random direction 9004	0.88	0.005	0.005	yes

5.4 Panel A: does the base repertoire predict which new tasks move? (Qwen3-8B)

Three instruct twins of new units are mixed: trapped rain water (default share 0.64), minimum spanning tree weight (default share 0.66) and valid anagram (default share 0.76); on two units the instruct model is more diverse than the base: trapped rain water (twin off-default 0.36 against beta 0.23) and minimum spanning tree weight (twin off-default 0.34 against beta 0.11) (iteration-6 note).

Why. The screen correlation of 0.78 was measured on the tasks that generated the hypothesis. The movability and landing halves could only be confirmed on tasks never seen, with every forecast committed from base samples before the first push. Panel A built one half of those tasks.

Design. Nine new units derived from LeetCode problems [12] were frozen up front in new wording (a grep audit found no algorithm word or catalogue name), each with hidden tests from the dataset's input and output pairs plus seeded edge, random and stress cases, one reference per algorithm, mutants that must fail, quadratic baselines and runtime and AST labellers. A labeller passed its gate at a kappa of at least 0.8 between runtime and AST labels, an agreement of at least 0.9 between runtime and adjudicated labels and 100% of references, with one revision round on a holdout. Six of the seven planned units passed; number of islands failed after its revision (holdout kappa 0.74), and the two reserves, jump game and median of two sorted lists, ran as a logged extension. Per unit, the instruct twin drew 50 programs and the base model 100 on identical ids plus 50 in plain completion, the rivals were computed, and the forecast (default, beta with its interval, base runner-up, rivals) was committed by hash; a guard in the GPU worker refused push jobs until then. Only then did 8 isotropic directions at alpha 1 and 2 ($N = 10$, confirmed at $N = 30$ by an exact binomial test), plan noise at alpha 1 and 2 ($N = 50$) and temperature 1.3 ($N = 50$) run. The 15 existing tasks were remeasured in the same engine on the ban-free unit; we call this the

remeasurement arm.

The movability half is not supported in panel A (Table 191). Over the six preregistered units, Spearman between beta and the escape fraction is -0.03 (exact one-sided p 0.56; Kendall 0). The one unit collapsed in the base, maximum block sum (beta 0), is immovable, as the movability half predicts, but 2 of the 5 units diverse in the base are also immovable, among them the most diverse: count primes (beta 0.81) never escapes. A bootstrap over measurement error gives a median of -0.09 (90% interval -0.37 to 0.21). With the two extension units, both diverse in the base (0.47 and 0.71) and both immovable, Spearman falls to -0.33 (p 0.80). Simple rivals tracked movability better than beta (Tables 192 and 193), and so did beta's own variants: Spearman with the escape fraction is -0.09 for beta from plain completion, -0.03 for beta that also counts correct programs labelled other as off-default (identical to beta on these units) and 0.40 for the base Hill-1 (0.16, -0.33 and 0.22 with the extension units). The three units that moved have an alternative at least twice as fast as the default (minimum runtime merit ratio 0.10 to 0.51), the three that did not have ratios of 0.86 to 4.35, and the runtime merit rival reaches -0.88; the extension unit median of two sorted lists breaks this (ratio 0.11, never escapes), and with it the rival falls to -0.66. The twin's own modal share reaches -0.70, ahead of beta by a task-bootstrap interval that excludes zero (-1.90 to -0.09).

Table 191. Panel A units: gate, the forecast committed before any push, and the outcome. Source: panel A `results/summary.md`.

Unit	Gate (kappa / runtime against adjudicated)	Default (twin share)	Base pass	beta [95% CI]	Base runner-up	Predicted class	Escape fraction (alpha 1 / alpha 2)	Push landing	Plan noise excess
majority element	gated (0.92 / 0.95)	hash count (1.00)	0.29 (29 correct)	0.41 [0.26, 0.59]	Boyer–Moore majority vote	movable	0.125 (0.000 / 0.250)	Boyer–Moore majority vote	0.04
maximum block sum	gated (1.00 / 1.00)	Kadane (1.00)	0.43 (43 correct)	0.00 [0.00, 0.08]	none	immovable	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00
trapped rain water	gated (0.82 / 0.90)	prefix and suffix maxima (0.64)	0.22 (22 correct)	0.23 [0.10, 0.43]	two pointers	movable	0.438 (0.375 / 0.500)	two pointers	-0.05
count primes	gated (1.00 / 0.95)	sieve of Eratosthenes (1.00)	0.31 (31 correct)	0.81 [0.64, 0.91]	trial division	movable	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00
longest common prefix	gated (0.84 / 0.90)	horizontal scan (1.00)	0.20 (20 correct)	0.30 [0.15, 0.52]	vertical scan	movable	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.15
number of islands	gate failed (0.74 / 0.89)	–	–	–	–	–	–	–	–
longest mirrored substring	gated (1.00 / 1.00)	expand around centre (1.00)	0.28 (28 correct)	0.46 [0.30, 0.64]	brute force	movable	0.188 (0.000 / 0.375)	brute force	0.13

jump game (ext.)	gated (1.00 / 1.00)	greedy (1.00)	0.19 (19 correct)	0.47 [0.32, 0.63]	DP	movable	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.01
median of two sorted lists (ext.)	gated (1.00 / 1.00)	merge with two pointers (1.00)	0.24 (24 correct)	0.71 [0.51, 0.85]	concatenate and sort	movable	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.02

Table 192. Rivals against beta, primary units (Spearman with the escape fraction, and the difference from beta with a 95% task-bootstrap interval). Source: panel A `results/a1.json`.

Rival (sign)	rho(rival, E)	Delta = rho(beta,E) - sign*rho(rival,E)	95% task-bootstrap CI
opening margin (-)	-0.516	-0.546	[-1.29, 0.00]
minimum runtime merit ratio (-)	-0.880	-0.911	[-2.00, 0.39]
minimum length merit ratio (-)	-0.273	-0.304	[-1.50, 1.00]
twin modal share (-)	-0.696	-0.726	[-1.90, -0.09]
novelty instruction share (+)	-0.417	0.387	[-0.38, 1.66]

Table 193. The same with the two extension units. Source: panel A `results/a1_with_extension.json`.

Rival (sign)	rho(rival, E)	Delta = rho(beta,E) - sign*rho(rival,E)	95% task-bootstrap CI
opening margin (-)	-0.518	-0.846	[-1.48, -0.18]
minimum runtime merit ratio (-)	-0.655	-0.982	[-1.75, -0.13]
minimum length merit ratio (-)	-0.273	-0.600	[-1.41, 0.39]
twin modal share (-)	-0.661	-0.989	[-1.82, -0.39]
novelty instruction share (+)	-0.429	0.101	[-0.51, 0.97]

The landing half is supported in panel A. On all three movable units (majority element, trapped rain water, longest mirrored substring) the base runner-up is the push landing (Poisson-binomial p 0.019 under chance $1/(K-1)$), and the base composition scores best (Table 194). The committed association forecast was uniform because of a mapping bug: every association answer restates the default named in the question, and the committed mapping took the earliest catalogue mention. With the mapping corrected post hoc on the same answers given before commitment (Table 195), association names the landing on 2 of 3 events and is a strong rival, but the base composition still scores higher on all three (mean margin 0.85 nats; 1.10 against the committed uniform version). Exact Wilcoxon p is 0.25, the smallest attainable with three events. No correct program from plan noise or from an escape cell landed on an algorithm with zero correct and zero valid base programs (Table 198).

Table 194. Panel A landing events: base runner-up, landing and log scores with the committed association forecast. Source: panel A `results/a2.json`.

Event	Base runner-up	Push landing	Programs realised	log score base	association	proximity
majority element	Boyer–Moore majority vote	Boyer–Moore majority vote	35	-0.063	-1.812	-1.636
trapped rain water	two pointers	two pointers	160	-0.054	-1.119	-1.122
longest mirrored substring	brute force	brute force	33	-0.625	-1.119	-0.945

Table 195. The association rival with the corrected mapping (post hoc, logged as a deviation). Source: panel A `results/assoc_corrected.json`.

Unit	Association top-1	Base runner-up	Corrected counts
majority element	Boyer–Moore majority vote	Boyer–Moore majority vote	Boyer–Moore majority vote 20, sort and take middle 0, divide and conquer 0, randomised verify 0, bit count 0, library mode 0
maximum block sum	prefix minimum	none	prefix minimum 13, divide and conquer 7, segment tree 0
trapped rain water	two pointers	two pointers	two pointers 20, monotonic stack 0, peak split 0
count primes	sieve of Atkin	trial division	trial division 5, linear sieve 0, segmented sieve 0, sieve of Sundaram 0, sieve of Atkin 14
longest common prefix	vertical scan	vertical scan	vertical scan 16, sort and compare ends 0, binary search on length 4, divide and conquer 0, trie 0, library common prefix 0
longest mirrored substring	Manacher	brute force	DP table 0, Manacher 20, brute force 0
jump game	DP	DP	DP 11, BFS over indices 9
median of two sorted lists	partition binary search	concatenate and sort	partition binary search 20, heap merge 0, concatenate and sort 0

The existing tasks on the ban-free unit. The remeasurement arm remeasured the 15 existing tasks with 8 fixed directions at alpha 1 and 2 on the ban-free unit in bf16 (Table 196). Only kth smallest (escape fraction 0.25) and connected components (0.125) escaped; two sum, find duplicate, the grid task and the shortest path task, which the frozen screen called movable under the 8-bit engine and the ban unit, did not move. A descriptive view that combines the six new units with the 15 existing tasks (Step 1's committed beta, this arm's escape fractions) gives Spearman 0.54 (p 0.0065), and 0.59 (p 0.0096) for the existing tasks alone, but that correlation comes from 13 of 15 existing tasks being immovable with low beta, while tasks diverse in the base (the grid, shortest path and top-k frequent tasks) are still immovable, and the landing check splits (connected components hit, kth smallest miss: Step 1 runner-up quickselect, landing size-k heap).

Table 196. The remeasurement arm: the 15 existing tasks under the ban-free unit (8 directions, alpha 1 and 2), against iteration 4 and the frozen screen. Source: panel A `results/extra_arm_a.json`.

Task	Default	Twin off-default share / pass	E ban-free (a1 / a2)	Landing	Iteration 4 E (a1 / a2)	Frozen screen E (a1 / a2), movable	Verdict change
kth smallest	full sort	0.02 / 1.00	0.250 (0.125 / 0.375)	size-k heap	0.30 / 0.63	0.44 / 1.00, True	False
connected components	union find	0.00 / 1.00	0.125 (0.000 / 0.250)	DFS	0.38 / 0.73	0.33 / –, True	False
two sum	hash map	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.13	0.00 / 0.67, True	True

find duplicate	hash set	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.33, True	True
grid	BFS	0.02 / 0.86	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.05 / 0.13	0.07 / 0.00, True	True
shortest path	Dijkstra	0.02 / 0.98	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.18 / 0.20	0.20 / 0.00, True	True
substring search	naive	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / 0.00, False	False
Fibonacci	iteration	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
merge intervals	sort and sweep	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
top-k frequent	sort by count	0.00 / 0.76	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
topological order	Kahn	0.00 / 1.00	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
first and last position	binary search	0.00 / 0.88	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	0.00 / –, False	False
cycle detection	DFS with parent	0.00 / 0.94	0.000 (0.000 / 0.000)	none	0.00 / 0.00	– / –, none	none

Table 197. Knob rows of the panel A units: pass rate / off-default share / correct-only Hill-1 at depth 25. Source: panel A `results/knob_rows.json`.

Unit	twin	plan noise alpha 1	plan noise alpha 2	temperature 1.3	novelty instruction	base model	plain completion
majority element	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.04 / 1.18	1.00 / 0.04 / 1.17	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.29 / 0.42 / 1.97	0.52 / 0.40 / 2.47
maximum block sum	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.43 / 0.02 / 1.00	0.22 / 0.02 / 1.00
trapped rain water	1.00 / 0.36 / 1.91	1.00 / 0.32 / 1.86	1.00 / 0.30 / 1.83	1.00 / 0.36 / 1.91	0.97 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.22 / 0.22 / 1.71	0.12 / 0.25 / 2.75

count primes	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.31 / 0.72 / 1.63	0.14 / 0.49 / 1.98
longest common prefix	0.94 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.96 / 0.08 / 1.32	0.98 / 0.22 / 1.69	0.88 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.97 / 0.27 / 1.98	0.20 / 0.39 / 2.11	0.26 / 0.62 / 1.54
longest mirrored substring	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.08 / 1.31	1.00 / 0.18 / 1.59	1.00 / 0.06 / 1.25	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.28 / 0.59 / 2.71	0.10 / 0.52 / 1.00
jump game	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.98 / 0.02 / 1.00	0.98 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.19 / 0.47 / 1.93	0.14 / 0.16 / 1.82
median of two sorted lists	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	1.00 / 0.04 / 1.17	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00	0.67 / 0.20 / 1.00	0.24 / 0.74 / 2.14	0.24 / 0.43 / 1.57

Table 198. Repertoire check: does any nudge reach beyond the base repertoire? Source: panel A `results/repertoire_check.json`.

Unit	base Hill-1 (depth)	PN a1	PN a2	escape cells	correct off-default push programs outside the base repertoire
majority element	1.97 (25)	1.18	1.17	1.57	0
maximum block sum	1.00 (25)	1.00	1.00	1.00	0
trapped rain water	1.71 (22)	1.86	1.83	1.95	0
count primes	1.63 (25)	1.00	1.00	1.00	0
longest common prefix	2.11 (20)	1.32	1.69	1.00	0
longest mirrored substring	2.70 (25)	1.31	1.59	1.62	0
jump game	1.93 (19)	1.00	1.00	1.03	0
median of two sorted lists	2.14 (24)	1.00	1.17	1.11	0

Checks. The labellers recovered every reference and 35 of 35 handwritten variants; independent TheAlgorithms implementations passed 8 of 9 frozen test suites and received the intended runtime label on 7 of 9 (Table 199), the misses being an unloadable file and a Misra–Gries vote that counts candidates in a Counter. The twins reproduced the 8-bit screen rows, while the pushed cells differed under bf16 (Table 200), so every contrast of the panel is within the bf16 engine. Two correct programs labelled other appeared among 6,854 correct programs (one catalogue variant, one degenerate); 0 novel (rule-of-three bound 0.00044 per correct program). Two recomputations using only the standard library matched with no mismatch, and the placebos failed (beta shuffled across units: mean Spearman 0.00; labels shuffled between twin and escape rows: escape fraction at most 0.007 on average). Eleven deviations are logged, including a re-run of the majority element test builder after its commit (identical cases, changed timing fields) and the association mapping bug.

Table 199. External check with independent TheAlgorithms implementations (MIT). Source: panel A `results/external_reference_check.json`.

Unit	Implementation	Intended	Tests	Runtime	AST
maximum block sum	dynamic_programming/ max_subarray_sum.py	Kadane	70/70	Kadane	Kadane

maximum block sum	divide_and_conquer/ max_subarray.py	divide and conquer	0/70 (load error)	unknown	divide and conquer
longest mirrored substring	strings/manacher.py	Manacher	73/73	Manacher	unknown
count primes	maths/sieve_of_eratosthenes.py	sieve of Eratosthenes	48/48	sieve of Eratosthenes	sieve of Eratosthenes
count primes	maths/ prime_sieve_eratosthenes.py	sieve of Eratosthenes	48/48	sieve of Eratosthenes	sieve of Eratosthenes
count primes	maths/odd_sieve.py	sieve of Eratosthenes	48/48	sieve of Eratosthenes	sieve of Eratosthenes
count primes	maths/segmented_sieve.py	segmented sieve	48/48	segmented sieve	sieve of Eratosthenes
count primes	maths/sieve_of_atkin.py	sieve of Atkin	48/48	sieve of Atkin	sieve of Atkin
majority element	other/ majority_vote_algorithm.py	Boyer–Moore majority vote	71/71	hash count	hash count

Table 200. Engine check of panel A's bf16 engine against the 8-bit screen rows. Source: panel A `results/engine_check.json`.

Cell	Label agreement per slot	JSD	Null p95	This run	Screen
kth smallest / twin	1.00	0.0000	0.0000	full sort 50	full sort 50
kth smallest / random direction 9002, alpha 1	0.74	0.0302	0.0766	size-k heap 29, full sort 9, quickselect 12	quickselect 16, full sort 15, size-k heap 19
shortest path / twin	0.98	0.0101	0.0000	Dijkstra 49, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	Dijkstra 50
shortest path / random direction 9004, alpha 1	0.86	0.0074	0.0047	Dijkstra 31, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 19	Dijkstra 26, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 24

5.5 Panel B: seven more new tasks and disguised variants (Qwen3-8B)

Three instruct twins of new units are mixed: trapped rain water (default share 0.64), minimum spanning tree weight (default share 0.66) and valid anagram (default share 0.76); on two units the instruct model is more diverse than the base: trapped rain water (twin off-default 0.36 against beta 0.23) and minimum spanning tree weight (twin off-default 0.34 against beta 0.11) (iteration-6 note).

Why. Panel B built the other half of the confirmation units under the same protocol, and added what we call *disguised variants*, eight bench tasks rewritten as narratives, each with a paired remeasurement of its parent, to separate a task's wording from its algorithmic affordances.

Design. Seven units (missing number, single number, minimum spanning tree weight, integer square root, all subsets, valid anagram and count inversions) were built with wording free of algorithm words, hidden tests checked by two independent oracles, three to six references, mutants and excluded brute force methods, and gated labellers; all seven gated, four after one revision round, and the 15-program blind audits of base labels agreed at 0.93 to 1.0. Because the base model was 46% to 61% off task under the chat template, its repertoire was raised to $N = 200$ per unit before any commit. Each unit's beta, base runner-up, base composition and rivals were hash-chained before its first push; then came 8 directions at alpha 1 and 2, plan noise and temperature 1.3.

The movability half is not supported in panel B either (Table 201). Spearman between beta and the escape fraction is 0.21 (exact one-sided p 0.33, bootstrap interval over units -0.75 to 0.95). Four units moved (single number, count inversions, minimum spanning tree weight and integer square root) and three did not: missing number (beta 0.06), all subsets (0.37) and valid anagram (0.81), the clearest disconfirming case. No unit was collapsed in the base, so the part of the movability half that says collapsed tasks are immovable is untested here. Beta ranks the graded plan noise excess better (0.82, p 0.017), and the runtime and length merit rivals track the escape fraction more closely than beta (0.54 and 0.58; Table 202), all with wide intervals. Under the preregistered sensitivities, beta from attempts gives 0.39 (p 0.18), beta from plain completion -0.45, beta from correct programs 0.04, and excluding the uncertain class or the flagged twins gives -0.03 and 0.06; a placebo with beta shuffled 1,000 times has a mean Spearman of 0.008 and rejects at 0.048.

Table 201. Panel B units: default, beta under three bases, base runner-up and the escape outcome. Source: panel B `README.md`, `results/a1_panel.json`.

Unit	Default	Catalogue size	beta	beta (attempts)	beta (plain completion)	Base runner-up	Escape, alpha 1	Escape, alpha 2	Escape fraction	Push landing	Plan noise excess	Flags
missing number	arithmetic sum	5	0.06	0.19	0.12	XOR fold	0.000	0.000	0.000	-	0.00	-
single number	hash count	4	0.56	0.60	0.43	XOR fold	0.375	0.500	0.438	XOR fold	0.30	-
mst weight	Kruskal	4	0.11	0.42	0.33	Prim with heap	0.125	0.125	0.125	Prim with heap	0.06	-
integer sqrt	binary search	6	0.37	0.44	0.50	floating point sqrt	0.125	0.125	0.125	linear scan	0.10	-
all subsets	backtracking	4	0.37	0.38	0.58	iterative doubling	0.000	0.000	0.000	-	0.08	-
valid anagram	sort and compare	3	0.81	0.80	0.55	hash count	0.000	0.000	0.000	-	0.12	-
count inversions	merge sort count	4	0.75	0.75	0.00	sorted insertion with bisect	0.250	0.375	0.312	sorted insertion with bisect	0.18	default_from_few_correct(correct programs = 3); twin_pass_below_0.7(0.06); base_fewer_than_20_correct(n = 15): attempt composition used

Table 202. Rivals against beta in panel B. Source: panel B `results/rivals.json`.

predictor	rho with E	one-sided p	rho(beta) - rho(rival), 95% CI
beta	0.21	0.333	-
opening margin	0.21	0.333	[-1.32, 1.38]
runtime merit gap	0.54	0.114	[-1.32, 0.67]
length merit gap	0.58	0.090	[-1.40, 0.81]
twin modal share	0.11	0.429	[-0.93, 0.88]
novelty instruction share	-0.03	0.543	[-0.68, 0.87]
novelty instruction share, correct programs	-0.03	0.543	[-0.69, 0.88]
catalogue size	0.07	0.448	[-1.49, 1.59]

The landing half in panel B. The base runner-up named the push landing in 3 of 4 events (expected by chance 1.2; Poisson-binomial p 0.081), and the base composition beat association by 0.68 nats and proximity by 0.13 nats on average (Table 203). The miss is integer square root, where the base runner-up is a floating point square root and the pushes land on a linear scan. With fewer than five events no Wilcoxon test was run.

Table 203. Panel B landing events. Source: panel B `results/a2_panel.json`. Base support (valid attempts / correct programs / runner-up count among correct, of 200 base rows): single number 77

/ 62 / 32; minimum spanning tree weight 89 / 28 / 3; integer square root 108 / 76 / 15; count inversions 87 / 15 / 2 (iteration 6).

Unit	Base runner-up	Push landing	Hit	Log score, base composition	Association	Proximity
single number	XOR fold	XOR fold	1.0	-0.17	-0.10	-0.95
minimum spanning tree weight	Prim with heap	Prim with heap	1.0	-0.30	-0.10	-0.94
integer square root	floating point sqrt	linear scan	0.0	-1.10	-3.29	-1.57
count inversions	sorted insertion with bisect	sorted insertion with bisect	1.0	-2.39	-3.18	-1.02

Table 203b (iteration 6). Knob rows of the panel B units, laid out like Table 197: pass rate / off-default share among correct programs / correct-only Hill-1 rarefied at depth 25 (counts: correct off default of correct). Source: panel B `pooled_inputs.json` (outcomes.twin_cell, pn_cells, t13_cell).

Unit	twin	plan noise alpha 1	plan noise alpha 2	temperature 1.3
missing number	0.98 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 49)	0.98 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 49)	0.94 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 47)	0.96 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 48)
single number	1.00 / 0.08 / 1.30 (4 of 50)	1.00 / 0.20 / 1.63 (10 of 50)	1.00 / 0.38 / 1.92 (19 of 50)	1.00 / 0.12 / 1.49 (6 of 50)
minimum spanning tree weight	1.00 / 0.34 / 1.88 (17 of 50)	1.00 / 0.40 / 1.94 (20 of 50)	0.96 / 0.40 / 1.94 (19 of 48)	0.98 / 0.37 / 1.92 (18 of 49)
integer square root	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 50)	1.00 / 0.04 / 1.17 (2 of 50)	0.98 / 0.08 / 1.33 (4 of 49)	1.00 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 50)
all subsets	0.86 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 43)	0.80 / 0.03 / 1.12 (1 of 40)	0.74 / 0.11 / 1.41 (4 of 37)	0.80 / 0.00 / 1.00 (0 of 40)
valid anagram	1.00 / 0.24 / 2.01 (12 of 50)	1.00 / 0.22 / 1.89 (11 of 50)	1.00 / 0.36 / 2.37 (18 of 50)	1.00 / 0.26 / 2.03 (13 of 50)
count inversions	0.06 / 0.00 / 1.00* (0 of 3)	0.08 / 0.00 / 1.00* (0 of 4)	0.16 / 0.62 / 2.95* (5 of 8)	0.08 / 0.00 / 1.00* (0 of 4)

* depth below 25 (rarefied at the number of correct programs). The pushes stayed inside the base repertoire on 6 of 7 units; 3 push programs fell outside it (count inversions; panel B repertoire check).

Disguised variants. Of the eight parent and variant pairs, only kth smallest and connected components moved in either form (Table 204), and connected components changed its default under disguise (union find to BFS); the sign of the change in beta and the change in escape fraction agreed in 0 of 1 pair without a default shift, and their Spearman over pairs was 0.13 (p 0.50). Descriptive views that add the remeasured parents (Spearman 0.43, p 0.055, n = 15) or the variants with a permutation that preserves clusters (0.54, p 0.015, n = 22) are positive, as is the screen view (0.79 on the 15 screen tasks), but none is the preregistered test.

Table 204. Comparison of disguised variants within parents (P remeasured parent, V variant; McNemar counts on confirmed escape cells). Source: panel B `results/variants.json`.

parent	default P / V	beta P	beta V	E P	E V	McNemar (confirmed), only P : only V
kth smallest	full sort / full sort	0.41	0.35	0.500	0.750	1 / 5
connected components	union find / BFS	0.37	0.96	0.188	0.312	2 / 4
two sum	hash map / hash map	0.14	0.05	0.000	0.000	0 / 0

find duplicate	hash set / hash set	0.20	0.32	0.000 0.000 0 / 0
substring search	naive / naive	0.18	0.15	0.000 0.000 0 / 0
Fibonacci	iteration / iteration	0.40	0.07	0.000 0.000 0 / 0
top-k frequent	sort by count / NO_DEFAULT	0.26	-	0.000 0.000 0 / 0
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end / greedy by end	0.23	0.08	0.000 0.000 0 / 0

Checks. The engine check reproduced kth smallest within the null from resampling templates (agreement per slot 0.74) and put the shortest path cell outside it (0.64), a precision sensitivity; the twins agreed at 1.00 and 0.98. Twelve distinct correct programs labelled other appeared among 10,366 correct programs (7 catalogue variants, 5 degenerate); 0 novel. Independent recomputations found no mismatch, the placebo that treats the twin as a push gave an escape fraction of 0 on every unit, and no push row preceded its unit's commit. Count inversions carries three flags: its default comes from 3 correct twin programs, the twin passes only 0.06 (47 of 50 twin programs are the quadratic pair scan, which exceeds the time limit), and its base composition uses attempts (15 correct programs).

5.6 The two panels pooled (computed for this report)

Neither panel ran the pooled test: both wrote their raw ingredients per unit for a pooled step in the next round. Because the pooled numbers decide how this iteration is read, we computed them here from the two panels' own result files (`work/pooled_a1a2.py`, output `work/pooled_a1a2.json`), with a Monte Carlo permutation test for Spearman and an exact Poisson-binomial tail and exact Wilcoxon signed-rank tests [65] for the landing half. This is a descriptive preview; the preregistered permutation within parent clusters was not run.

Table 205. The movability and landing halves over the new units of both panels (13 preregistered units; 15 with panel A's extension). Source: `work/pooled_a1a2.json`, computed from panel A `results/a1*.json`, `results/a2*.json` and panel B `results/a1_panel.json`, `results/a2_panel.json`.

Quantity	Preregistered units (n = 13)	With the extension units (n = 15)
Spearman between beta and the escape fraction	0.146 (one-sided permutation p 0.315)	0.006 (p 0.492)
Units collapsed in the base that are immovable	1 of 1	1 of 1
Units diverse in the base (beta at least 0.2) that are immovable	4 of 10	6 of 12
Movable units	7 of 13	7 of 15
Landing events (movable units with beta at least 0.05)	7: majority element, trapped rain water, longest mirrored substring, single number, minimum spanning tree weight, integer square root, count inversions	same
Base runner-up equals the push landing	6 of 7 (expected by chance 2.03; Poisson-binomial p 0.0027)	same
Base minus association, corrected mapping (nats per event)	mean +0.75; differences +0.21, +0.09, +2.24, -0.07, -0.20, +2.18, +0.79; exact one-sided Wilcoxon p 0.055	same

Base minus association, committed (uniform) mapping in panel A	mean +0.86; exact one-sided Wilcoxon p 0.039	same
Base minus proximity	mean +0.50; differences +1.57, +1.07, +0.32, +0.78, +0.64, +0.46, -1.37; exact one-sided Wilcoxon p 0.109	same

Read against the preregistered thresholds, the movability half meets its disconfirming outcome on the pooled view (Spearman below 0.3), although not the second clause (4 of 10 units diverse in the base are immovable, not most). The landing half meets its hit-rate criterion (6 of 7, 0.86, against a bar of 0.7 at p below 0.05) and its margin over association (0.75 nats against a bar of 0.10), with the paired Wilcoxon at p 0.055 against the corrected association and 0.039 against the committed one.

[Figure fig_beta_escape: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

5.7 Plan noise against text-level plan samplers, decoding at matched departure, and the literal cell (Qwen3-8B)

Why. The positioning audit of iteration 4 found that the price comparison lacked its strongest competitors: text-level plan samplers, which diversify code by sampling a plan before the program [73, 74], and a decoding baseline matched to plan noise's own departure from the twin, the baseline under which an ICLR 2027 submission (OpenReview oag3wgNLRh) found activation steering no better than ordinary decoding. The review also asked for the literal cell of the request. This experiment ran both.

The literal cell never changes the algorithm (Table 206). On the shortest path task with thinking on, top-k 10 and the same 20 token seeds as the iteration-4 thinking arm, moving the temperature over 0.3, 0.7, 1.0 and 1.3 changed the final program's algorithm in 0 of 20 seeds (one-sided Clopper–Pearson 95% upper bound 0.14), and the first approach named in the thinking changed in 0 of 20. All 100 traces completed, every final program was heap-based Dijkstra, and every trace named Dijkstra first. Temperature changed the tokens: a repeat at temperature 0.7 was byte-identical on only 4 of 20 traces while the labels agreed on 20 of 20 (median common prefix 309.5 tokens), and paired with the top-p 1 traces of iteration 4 at the same seed and temperature the labels agreed on 100 of 100 pairs although the traces shared a median of only 34 tokens. A judge agreed with the first-approach lexicon on 19 of 19 audited traces. With this cell, question 1a-c of the request is answered under every sampler the run used: with thinking off at top-k 10 (Table 76), with thinking off and on at top-p 1 (Section 4.5), and with thinking on at top-k 10 here.

Table 206. The literal cell: shortest path task, thinking on, top-k 10, 20 seeds per temperature, 16k cap (vLLM, official 8-bit checkpoint). Source: knob experiment `results/literal_cell.json`.

T	completed	final labels (completed)	first approach	median think tokens	Dijkstra style	phrasing clusters at theta 0.7 / 0.8 / 0.9	phrasings per idea (theta 0.8)
T 0.3	20/20	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20	3754.50	heap 20	2 / 4 / 8	dijkstra 4
T 0.7	20/20	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20	3962.00	heap 20	3 / 3 / 10	dijkstra 3
T 1.0	20/20	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20	3576.00	heap 20	2 / 3 / 9	dijkstra 3
T 1.3	20/20	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20	4149.00	heap 20	5 / 7 / 12	dijkstra 7
T 0.7, repeat	20/20	Dijkstra 20	Dijkstra 20	3500.00	heap 20	3 / 6 / 10	dijkstra 6

At N = 20 with thinking on a rise shows only at T 1.3, and repeat noise is the same size.
(Iteration-6 addition: the two phrasing columns, computed by the knob experiment and missing from the

record until now.)

Design of the knob comparison. Every knob ran in one HF bf16 engine with exact inverse-CDF common random numbers, so all arms of a slot shared the uniform stream of the code stage, on all 15 existing tasks (N = 50 per cell on the five decisive tasks, 30 on the other ten). Plan noise drew a fresh isotropic direction per sample at the task-specification positions of blocks 12 to 23, prefill only, at alpha 1 and 2 ban-free units, under the twin frame and on the plain prompt. The text-level plan samplers used the twin's frame, with the twin's neutral sentence first: intent factored generation at the direction's (1.3, 0.7) and the paper's tuned (0.73, 0.60) temperatures [73]; a lite plan search (five observations, a random pair of them combined into a plan, then code) [74]; enumerate and pick, in which the model lists up to eight algorithms and an external random number picks one; and base intent, in which Qwen3-8B-Base writes the intent sentence and the instruct model the code. Decoding at matched departure applied a temperature to generated tokens 1 to 32, bisected per task so that its mean per-token KL from the twin equalled plan noise's own at each alpha, measured on prefixes used only for calibration. Prices came from a randomisation hull over the full simplex with 2,000 slot bootstraps that select the best mixture again inside every replicate. The committed rule calls the plan sampler comparison supported if the 5-point Hill-1 of plan noise is at least that of the best text sampler on at least 3 of the 5 decisive tasks.

The plan sampler comparison is DISCONFIRMED (Table 207). In Table 207 the margin is the 5-point Hill-1 of plan noise minus that of the best text sampler. Plan noise matched or beat the best text sampler on 1 of the 5 decisive tasks, kth smallest (1.98 against 1.83 for enumerate and pick, P(plan noise at least best) 0.58, unresolved). On connected components, the shortest path task and two sum, base intent won (2.53, 1.45 and 1.61 against 1.09, 1.18 and 1.17), and on the grid task nothing moved much. The mean margin is -0.40 (95% interval -0.70 to -0.24), and only 1.8% of bootstrap replicates reach three wins. Every sensitivity keeps the verdict except one (Table 209): with the multistage samplers dropped (they were padded on the left), intent factored generation is the only text sampler left and plan noise beats it on 4 of 5 tasks, so the disconfirmation rests on base intent and on enumerate and pick. On the ten other tasks (Table 208) plan noise moved only cycle detection and first and last position, while text samplers moved substring search, find duplicate, Fibonacci, longest increasing subsequence, top-k frequent and first and last position. Two prompt knobs outside the text-sampler set also beat plan noise where it was strongest: the novelty instruction on kth smallest (2.03) and the semantic seed on the shortest path task (2.12).

Table 207. The plan sampler comparison on the five decisive tasks: 5-point Hill-1 of plan noise (with its bootstrap interval) against each text-level plan sampler. Source: knob experiment `results/claim_c.json`.

Task	Plan noise, 5-point Hill-1 [95%]	Intent factored generation	Plan search (lite)	Enumerate and pick	Base intent	Best text sampler	Plan noise wins	P(plan noise at least best)	Flag	Margin
kth smallest	1.98 [1.64, 2.28]	1.19	1.09	1.83	1.73	enumerate and pick	yes	0.58	unresolved	+0.15
connected components	1.09 [1.00, 1.26]	1.96	1.50	1.88	2.53	base intent	no	0.00		-1.43

shortest path	1.18 [1.00, 1.34]	1.00	1.07	1.24	1.45	base intent	no	0.06	-0.27
two sum	1.17 [1.00, 1.38]	1.00	1.00	1.27	1.61	base intent	no	0.01	-0.44
grid	1.06 [1.00, 1.30]	1.00	1.00	1.08	1.04	enumerate and pick	no	0.38	unresolved -0.03

Table 208. The same prices on the ten other tasks (descriptive; the plan search arm was not run on topological order and first and last position, the base intent arm not on first and last position). Source: knob experiment `results/claim_c.json#nd10_descriptive`.

Task (descriptive, N = 30 per cell)	Plan noise, 5-point Hill-1	Intent factored generation	Plan search (lite)	Enumerate and pick	Base intent	Best text sampler
substring search	1.00	1.97	1.00	1.44	1.00	intent factored generation
find duplicate	1.00	1.97	1.66	1.08	1.08	intent factored generation
Fibonacci	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.10	1.70	base intent
longest increasing subsequence	1.00	1.00	1.57	1.57	1.00	enumerate and pick
merge intervals	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.03	1.00	enumerate and pick
top-k frequent	1.00	1.00	1.00	3.02	1.17	enumerate and pick
nonoverlapping intervals	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.01	1.00	enumerate and pick
cycle detection	1.18	1.00	1.00	1.05	1.04	enumerate and pick
topological order	1.00	1.00	n/a	1.00	1.00	intent factored generation
first and last position	1.29	1.18	n/a	2.62	n/a	enumerate and pick

Table 207b (iteration 6). Pass cost (fraction of pass rate given up) at which each knob's randomisation hull first reaches correct-only Hill-1 of 1.5 and then of 2.0 (the two prices in each cell, separated by a slash); a dash means never reached. Source: knob experiment `results/prices.json`; 95% percentile intervals over the 2,000 slot-bootstrap replicates of `results/bootstrap.json` that reach the level (the share that reaches it is in tables/prices_p15_p20.csv).

Task	plan noise, Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0	intent factored generation, Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0	plan search (lite), Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0	enumerate and pick, Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0	base intent, Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0	novelty instruction, Hill-1 1.5 / 2.0
kth smallest	0.000 [0.000, 0.000] / –	– / –	– / –	0.030 [0.014, 0.061] / 0.062 [0.030, 0.120]	0.033 [0.000, 0.084] / –	0.006 [0.000, 0.016] / 0.018 [0.000, 0.045]

connected components	– / –	0.000 [0.000, 0.000] / –	0.050 [0.040, 0.072] / –	0.029 [0.020, 0.040] / 0.058 [0.035, 0.090]	0.005 [0.000, 0.018] / 0.011 [0.000, 0.039]	– / –
shortest path	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.103 [0.058, 0.196] / 0.190 [0.117, 0.336]	0.057 [0.000, 0.133] / –	– / –
two sum	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.086 [0.048, 0.162] / 0.157 [0.096, 0.273]	0.042 [0.012, 0.099] / 0.080 [0.024, 0.170]	– / –
grid	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.229 [0.144, 0.420] / 0.341 [0.234, 0.576]	0.421 [0.230, 0.640] / –	0.096 [0.000, 0.240] / –
substring search	– / –	0.000 [0.000, 0.000] / –	– / –	0.055 [0.020, 0.133] / 0.098 [0.040, 0.220]	– / –	– / –
find duplicate	– / –	0.000 [0.000, 0.000] / –	0.023 [0.000, 0.085] / –	0.240 [0.120, 0.533] / 0.380 [0.202, 0.600]	– / –	– / –
Fibonacci	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.224 [0.120, 0.397] / –	0.025 [0.000, 0.093] / –	– / –
longest increasing subsequence	– / –	– / –	0.000 [0.000, 0.000] / –	0.043 [0.017, 0.090] / 0.100 [0.033, 0.180]	– / –	– / –
merge intervals	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.555 [0.260, 0.630] / –	– / –	– / –
top-k frequent	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.014 [0.000, 0.058] / 0.026 [0.000, 0.117]	– / –	– / –
non-overlapping intervals	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –
cycle detection	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.359 [0.170, 0.708] / 0.528 [0.267, 0.693]	0.470 [0.183, 0.630] / –	– / –
topological order	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –	– / –
first and last position	– / –	– / –	– / –	0.000 [0.000, 0.033] / 0.000 [0.000, 0.090]	– / –	– / –

Table 209. Sensitivities of the plan sampler rule. Source: knob experiment `results/claim_c.json#sensitivities`.

Sensitivity	Verdict	Tasks where plan noise wins	Mean margin
intent factored generation at (1.3, 0.7) only	DISCONFIRMED	1 of 5	-0.40
plan noise hull adds the plain prompt arms	DISCONFIRMED	2 of 5	-0.40
hull restricted to edges	DISCONFIRMED	1 of 5	-0.40

multistage samplers dropped, padded on the left (intent factored generation remains)	SUPPORTED	4 of 5	+0.07
style re-gate flagged task excluded	DISCONFIRMED	1 of 5	-0.40
relabels from the novelty audit applied	DISCONFIRMED	1 of 5	-0.40

[Figure fig_knob_h5: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Table 210 shows what each arm actually wrote on the decisive tasks. Enumerate and pick buys the most raw diversity (Hill-1 of 2.9 to 4.7 per cell) at a cost of 16 to 62 pass points, and 40% of its grid rows are invalid. Base intent keeps the pass rate high on connected components (0.98) and two sum (0.88) while writing three and four algorithms. Intent factored generation at its cooler code temperature collapsed the grid pass rate to 0.12 and 0.08, with every correct program BFS. Plan noise is much weaker here than in iteration 4: on connected components it wrote union find 49 times in 50 at both alphas, where iteration 4's 8-bit engine at the ban unit had written DFS 29 times at alpha 2 (Section 4.3); Section 5.10 returns to this.

Table 210. Every arm on the five decisive tasks: pass rate, invalid rate, correct programs and correct-only Hill-1 (rarefied at depth 25 or at the available depth). Source: knob experiment `results/cells.json`.

Task	Arm	N	Pass	Invalid	Correct programs	Hill-1 (depth)
kth smallest	twin	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	1.09 (25)
kth smallest	plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 50	1.00 (25)
kth smallest	plan noise alpha 1	50	0.98	0.00	full sort 45, quickselect 4	1.33 (25)
kth smallest	plan noise alpha 2	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 36, quickselect 12, size-k heap 2	1.99 (25)
kth smallest	plan noise alpha 1, plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	1.09 (25)
kth smallest	intent factored generation (1.3, 0.7)	50	0.98	0.00	full sort 48, heapify and pop 1	1.10 (25)
kth smallest	intent factored generation (0.73, 0.60)	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 48, heapify and pop 1, quickselect 1	1.19 (25)
kth smallest	plan search (lite)	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 50	1.00 (25)
kth smallest	enumerate and pick	50	0.80	0.00	quickselect 24, full sort 6, other 4, counting sort 4, size-k heap 2	3.24 (25)
kth smallest	base intent	50	0.94	0.00	full sort 39, size-k heap 4, quickselect 2, counting sort 1, other 1	1.86 (25)
kth smallest	decoding at matched departure, alpha 1 match	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	1.09 (25)
kth smallest	decoding at matched departure, alpha 2 match	50	0.98	0.00	full sort 48, quickselect 1	1.10 (25)
kth smallest	temperature 1.3	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	1.09 (25)
kth smallest	top-k 10	50	1.00	0.00	full sort 49, quickselect 1	1.09 (25)
kth smallest	novelty instruction	50	0.96	0.00	quickselect 47, heapify and pop 1	1.10 (25)
connected components	twin	50	1.00	0.00	union find 50	1.00 (25)
connected components	plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	union find 50	1.00 (25)
connected components	plan noise alpha 1	50	1.00	0.00	union find 49, DFS 1	1.09 (25)

connected components	plan noise alpha 2	50	1.00	0.00	union find 49, DFS 1	1.09 (25)
connected components	plan noise alpha 1, plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	union find 50	1.00 (25)
connected components	intent factored generation (1.3, 0.7)	50	1.00	0.00	DFS 43, union find 7	1.48 (25)
connected components	intent factored generation (0.73, 0.60)	50	1.00	0.00	DFS 47, union find 3	1.24 (25)
connected components	plan search (lite)	50	0.78	0.22	BFS 31, union find 8	1.66 (25)
connected components	enumerate and pick	50	0.84	0.16	DFS 17, BFS 15, union find 10	2.88 (25)
connected components	base intent	50	0.98	0.00	union find 24, DFS 20, BFS 5	2.53 (25)
connected components	decoding at matched departure, alpha 1 match	50	0.98	0.02	union find 47, DFS 2	1.18 (25)
connected components	decoding at matched departure, alpha 2 match	50	0.98	0.02	union find 46, DFS 3	1.26 (25)
connected components	temperature 1.3	50	1.00	0.00	union find 50	1.00 (25)
connected components	top-k 10	50	1.00	0.00	union find 50	1.00 (25)
connected components	novelty instruction	50	1.00	0.00	union find 43, DFS 7	1.48 (25)
shortest path	twin	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 49	1.00 (25)
shortest path	plain prompt	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 49	1.00 (25)
shortest path	plan noise alpha 1	50	1.00	0.00	Dijkstra 50	1.00 (25)
shortest path	plan noise alpha 2	50	0.94	0.00	Dijkstra 45, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2	1.19 (25)
shortest path	plan noise alpha 1, plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	Dijkstra 50	1.00 (25)
shortest path	intent factored generation (1.3, 0.7)	50	1.00	0.00	Dijkstra 50	1.00 (25)
shortest path	intent factored generation (0.73, 0.60)	50	1.00	0.00	Dijkstra 50	1.00 (25)
shortest path	plan search (lite)	50	0.78	0.20	Dijkstra 36, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 3	1.31 (25)
shortest path	enumerate and pick	50	0.60	0.04	Dijkstra 11, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 10, Floyd-Warshall 9	2.97 (25)
shortest path	base intent	50	0.92	0.02	Dijkstra 39, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7	1.52 (25)
shortest path	decoding at matched departure, alpha 1 match	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 48, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1	1.10 (25)
shortest path	decoding at matched departure, alpha 2 match	50	0.82	0.04	Dijkstra 41	1.00 (25)
shortest path	temperature 1.3	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 49	1.00 (25)
shortest path	top-k 10	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 49	1.00 (25)
shortest path	novelty instruction	50	1.00	0.00	Dijkstra 50	1.00 (25)
shortest path	semantic seed	50	0.98	0.00	Dijkstra 32, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 15, other 2	2.12 (25)
two sum	twin	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)

two sum	plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	plan noise alpha 1	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	plan noise alpha 2	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 48, brute force 2	1.17 (25)
two sum	plan noise alpha 1, plain prompt	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	intent factored generation (1.3, 0.7)	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	intent factored generation (0.73, 0.60)	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	plan search (lite)	50	0.98	0.00	hash map 49	1.00 (25)
two sum	enumerate and pick	50	0.68	0.00	hash map 16, sort and two pointers 7, brute force 7, sort and binary search 4	3.46 (25)
two sum	base intent	50	0.88	0.02	hash map 29, brute force 9, sort and two pointers 4, sort and binary search 2	2.55 (25)
two sum	decoding at matched departure, alpha 1 match	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	decoding at matched departure, alpha 2 match	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	temperature 1.3	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	top-k 10	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 50	1.00 (25)
two sum	novelty instruction	50	1.00	0.00	hash map 46, brute force 3, other 1	1.35 (25)
grid	twin	50	0.86	0.00	BFS 43	1.00 (25)
grid	plain prompt	50	0.96	0.00	BFS 48	1.00 (25)
grid	plan noise alpha 1	50	0.80	0.00	BFS 40	1.00 (25)
grid	plan noise alpha 2	50	0.76	0.00	BFS 37, Dijkstra 1	1.12 (25)
grid	plan noise alpha 1, plain prompt	50	0.86	0.00	BFS 43	1.00 (25)
grid	intent factored generation (1.3, 0.7)	50	0.12	0.00	BFS 6	1.00 (6)
grid	intent factored generation (0.73, 0.60)	50	0.08	0.00	BFS 4	1.00 (4)
grid	plan search (lite)	50	0.50	0.40	BFS 25	1.00 (25)
grid	enumerate and pick	50	0.24	0.40	A* 3, BFS 3, DFS 3, Dijkstra 2, bidirectional BFS 1	4.69 (12)
grid	base intent	50	0.32	0.00	BFS 12, DFS 4	1.75 (16)
grid	decoding at matched departure, alpha 1 match	50	0.80	0.00	BFS 40	1.00 (25)
grid	decoding at matched departure, alpha 2 match	50	0.78	0.00	BFS 39	1.00 (25)
grid	temperature 1.3	50	0.92	0.00	BFS 46	1.00 (25)
grid	top-k 10	50	0.84	0.00	BFS 42	1.00 (25)
grid	novelty instruction	50	0.70	0.00	BFS 26, DFS 9	1.77 (25)
grid	semantic seed	50	0.60	0.00	BFS 30	1.00 (25)

Plan noise against decoding at matched departure. At alpha 2, plan noise moves the algorithm and the matched decoding does not (Table 211): over the decisive tasks 19 slots are correct and off the default under plan noise only and 3 under the matched decoding only (exact p 0.0009), 13 to 0

on kth smallest alone. At alpha 1 there is no difference (4 against 3). The matched decoding's 5-point Hill-1 is at most 1.25 on every decisive task. So plan noise's effect is not its token-level departure from the twin, which answers the objection of the ICLR 2027 submission for these tasks, but as a practical knob it loses to two text samplers. Plan noise on the plain prompt and under the twin frame showed no significant paired difference on any of the 15 tasks (Table 212).

Table 211. Plan noise against decoding at matched departure at matched per-token KL (correct off-default share of N; McNemar on slots correct and off the default under one arm only). Source: knob experiment `results/pn_vs_dmd.json`.

Task	α	Temperature at matched departure	plan noise KL per token	matched departure KL per token	plan noise	matched departure	TWIN	McNemar, plan noise against matched departure (only plan noise : only matched departure, p)
kth smallest	1	1.46	0.0179	0.0200	0.08	0.02	0.02	3/0, p = 0.25
kth smallest	2	1.64	0.0774	0.0707	0.28	0.02	0.02	13/0, p = 0.000244
connected components	1	1.84	0.0096	0.0110	0.02	0.04	0.00	1/2, p = 1
connected components	2	2.22	0.0333	0.0370	0.02	0.06	0.00	1/3, p = 0.625
shortest path	1	2.01	0.0254	0.0244	0.00	0.02	0.00	0/1, p = 1
shortest path	2	2.66	0.1113	0.1230	0.04	0.00	0.00	2/0, p = 0.5
two sum	1	1.52	0.0036	0.0039	0.00	0.00	0.00	0/0, p = 1
two sum	2	1.81	0.0100	0.0104	0.04	0.00	0.00	2/0, p = 0.5
grid	1	2.15	0.0505	0.0442	0.00	0.00	0.00	0/0, p = 1
grid	2	2.47	0.1554	0.1246	0.02	0.00	0.00	1/0, p = 1

Table 212. Plan noise on the plain prompt against plan noise under the twin frame, same direction and stream. Source: knob experiment `results/plain_vs_twin.json`.

Task	plan noise only on plain : only on twin (p)	pass plain	pass twin	Hill plain	Hill twin
kth smallest	0/3 (p = 0.25)	1.00	0.98	1.09	1.33
connected components	0/1 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.09
shortest path	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
two sum	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
grid	0/0 (p = 1)	0.86	0.80	1.00	1.00
substring search	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
find duplicate	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
Fibonacci	0/0 (p = 1)	0.97	1.00	1.00	1.00
longest increasing subsequence	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
merge intervals	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
top-k frequent	0/0 (p = 1)	0.73	0.80	1.00	1.00
nonoverlapping intervals	0/0 (p = 1)	0.90	0.87	1.00	1.00
cycle detection	0/0 (p = 1)	0.80	0.87	1.00	1.00
topological order	0/0 (p = 1)	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00
first and last position	0/1 (p = 1)	0.90	0.87	1.00	1.17

Checks and deviations. The engine check against the 8-bit rows of iteration 4 was sensitive to

precision (Table 213): the twins agreed per slot at 0.98 to 1.00 and the pushed cells at 0.74 to 0.86, so no iteration-4 row was reused and temperature 1.3, top-k 10, the novelty instruction and the semantic seed were rerun. Twelve correct programs labelled other were 10 labeller misses, 1 degenerate and 1 unresolved; 0 novel. The style re-gate flagged only top-k frequent (agreement 0.80). An independent recomputation reproduced the literal cell, every McNemar count and the verdict, with the 5-point Hill-1 of the hull within 0.08 of the committed value and a win count of 2 rather than 1 (a near tie on the grid task), still DISCONFIRMED; relabelling plan noise rows as the twin gave margins of 0 or below on all five tasks, and shuffles of the arm labels centred at 1.6 wins (3 or more wins in 3 of 20 shuffles), so the count rule over five tasks is only weakly selective on its own. The plan's one allowed wording revision was used after the first format pilot failed (the model wrote code at once), the committed drop order fired after stage 100 and the dropped cells were restored when the queue finished early, and cells with fewer than 30 (decisive) or 15 (other) programs were excluded from hulls, a rule decided after a dry run that favours plan noise on kth smallest. Post hoc, with iteration-1 base label names harmonised, landing mass outside the base support is 0.11 for enumerate and pick on the grid task (bidirectional BFS) and 0 for every shortest path landing.

Table 213. Engine check of the bf16 knob engine against iteration 4's 8-bit rows. Source: knob experiment `results/engine_check.json`.

Cell	byte-identical	label agreement per slot	JSD	null p95
kth smallest / twin	45/50	1.00	0.00	0.00
kth smallest / random direction 9002, alpha 1	32/50	0.74	0.03	0.15
shortest path / twin	35/50	0.98	0.01	0.00
shortest path / random direction 9004, alpha 1	10/50	0.86	0.01	0.01
kth smallest / temperature 1.3	0/10	1.00	0.00	–
kth smallest / top-k 10	0/10	1.00	0.00	–
shortest path / temperature 1.3	0/10	0.90	0.05	–
shortest path / top-k 10	0/10	0.90	0.05	–

5.8 The second family: gemma-3-4b-pt against gemma-3-4b-it

Why. The Gemma replication asked whether the account replicates in a second family, with the base repertoire of gemma-3-4b-pt committed before a fresh, never-run push population was applied to gemma-3-4b-it [76]. Gemma's iteration-4 push outcomes were seen, so this experiment is a replication on fresh directions and samples, not a held-out confirmation.

Design. Both models ran in bf16 on one 23 GB NVIDIA GPU, one at a time. A fresh it twin (N = 50 per task) fixed each task's default under the iteration-5 rule; the grid twin now gave DFS on 30 of 40 correct programs, so every one of the 15 tasks had a default. The pt model wrote 100 programs under the it chat template on the same token ids and 50 in plain completion of a `def solve(...)` stub. Under the chat template 91% of its programs had no usable code and only 10 of 1,500 passed, so the preregistered chat validity gate failed, both formats were pooled, and every unit fell under the low-correct rule: beta, the runner-up and the landing forecast come from valid attempts, not correct programs. These were committed by hash before 16 never-run isotropic directions (seeds 52001 to 52016) were applied at alpha 1 and 2 to the task-specification positions of blocks 11 to 22 on the outlier-excluded ban-free unit. A transplant from pt into it at lambda 1 then ran on the seven tasks diverse in the base with a matched random control, a borrowed shift and a transplant at the read position on the same slots, and on three controls collapsed in the base.

In Gemma the movability half is inconclusive and the landing half passes (Table 214). Spearman between beta and the escape fraction is 0.42 (one-sided permutation p 0.060, n = 15), against a bar of 0.5 at p below 0.01; 2 of 3 tasks collapsed in the base are immovable against a bar of 80%; and beta is ahead of no rival, with the twin modal share (0.67) and the novelty instruction (0.64) tracking movability better (Table 215). The direction is the predicted one: 6 of 7 tasks diverse in the base are movable against 2 of 8 others (one-sided Fisher p 0.032, not registered). The partial Spearman given catalogue size and the forced can count is 0.41 (0.45 given catalogue size alone), and the fresh population agrees with iteration 4's movability on 13 of 15 tasks (8 movable now, 6 then). No sensitivity meets the preregistered bar (Table 216); beta from the chat template alone reaches 0.62 (p 0.0095), but that arm is 91% unusable output, and beta from correct programs only reaches 0.27. The pt runner-up equals the modal landing of confirmed escapes in 5 of 7 events (hit rate 0.71 against a mean chance of 0.30; exact Poisson-binomial p 0.025), and the pt composition beats iteration 4's association forecast by 1.50 nats per event (exact Wilcoxon p 0.023) and AST proximity by 0.51 (Table 217). The two misses are kth smallest (landing size-k heap, runner-up quickselect) and connected components (landing union find, pooled runner-up BFS; union find is the runner-up under the chat template alone).

Table 214. Gemma results per unit: it default (twin share), pt beta and runner-up, escape fraction over 16 fresh directions, landing, and the rivals. Source: Gemma experiment `results/e_a1.json`, `results/e_a2.json`, `README.md`. Base support per unit (valid pt attempts / correct pt programs / runner-up count among valid attempts, of 150 pooled pt rows; the pt labels agree with a blind judge at 0.64): grid 73 / 0 / 4; shortest path 78 / 0 / 1; kth smallest 51 / 14 / 6; substring search 55 / 18 / 26; find duplicate 53 / 14 / 9; two sum 55 / 13 / 14; connected components 47 / 1 / 6; non-overlapping intervals 49 / 0 / 1; Fibonacci 54 / 11 / 3; topological order 42 / 1 / 3; merge intervals 53 / 5 / 2; first and last position 48 / 4 / 12; top-k frequent 56 / 9 / 4; longest increasing subsequence 51 / 5 / 20; cycle detection 46 / 0 / 3 (iteration 6).

Unit	it default (twin share)	beta (pt)	Class	pt runner-up	Escape fraction (alpha 1, alpha 2)	Maximum over alpha	Landing	Runner-up = landing	Plan noise excess	Novelty instruction off-default	Twin modal share	Opening margin
grid	DFS (0.75)	0.05	intermediate	BFS	0.156 (0.125, 0.188)	0.188	BFS	yes	0.02	0.77	0.62	0.0
shortest path	Dijkstra (1.00)	0.03	collapsed	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	0.062 (0.000, 0.125)	0.125	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	yes	0.04	0.20	1.00	21.7
kth smallest	full sort (1.00)	0.23	diverse	quickselect	0.031 (0.000, 0.062)	0.062	size-k heap	no	0.06	0.67	1.00	18.6
substring search	naive (0.88)	0.51	diverse	built-in find	0.062 (0.000, 0.125)	0.125	built-in find	yes	0.06	0.70	0.88	-27.0
find duplicate	hash set (1.00)	0.23	diverse	sort and adjacent check	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.00	0.00	1.00	34.2
two sum	hash map (1.00)	0.53	diverse	brute force	0.062 (0.000, 0.125)	0.125	brute force	yes	0.04	0.00	1.00	16.8
connected components	DFS (1.00)	0.28	diverse	BFS	0.062 (0.000, 0.125)	0.125	union find	no	0.14	0.00	1.00	-20.2
nonoverlapping intervals	greedy by end (1.00)	0.02	collapsed	DAG longest path	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.02	0.00	1.00	0.0

Fibonacci	iteration (1.00)	0.10	intermediate	fast doubling	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.00	0.00	1.00	16.6
topological order	Kahn (1.00)	0.12	intermediate	DFS postorder	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.00	0.00	1.00	–
merge intervals	sort and sweep (1.00)	0.04	collapsed	union find	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.0
first and last position	linear scan (0.92)	0.40	diverse	binary search	0.531 (0.688, 0.375)	0.688	binary search	yes	0.36	1.00	0.92	6.0
top-k frequent	sort by count (1.00)	0.12	intermediate	quickselect on counts	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.08	0.57	1.00	18.9
longest increasing subsequence	patience sorting with bisect (1.00)	0.41	diverse	quadratic DP	0.031 (0.000, 0.062)	0.062	quadratic DP	yes	0.02	0.00	1.00	4.4
cycle detection	DFS with parent (1.00)	0.11	intermediate	edge count	0.000 (0.000, 0.000)	0.000	–	–	0.00	0.00	1.00	10.9

Table 215. Rivals against beta in Gemma (90% task-bootstrap intervals). Source: Gemma experiment `results/e_a1.json`.

Rival	sign	n	ρ(rival, E)	ρ(β,E) − ρ(rival,E)	90% bootstrap CI	β ahead
twin modal share	-1	15	0.668	-0.247	[-0.755, 0.259]	no
novelty instruction off-default	1	15	0.640	-0.219	[-0.786, 0.430]	no
opening margin	-1	14	0.272	0.147	[-0.458, 0.725]	no
runtime merit gap	-1	15	0.381	0.040	[-0.453, 0.695]	no
token merit gap	-1	15	0.409	0.011	[-0.634, 0.656]	no

Table 216. Sensitivities of the movability half in Gemma under the same rule. Source: Gemma experiment `results/e_a1.json`.

Sensitivity	n	ρ	p (one-sided)	verdict under the same rule
beta from the base model under the chat template only	15	0.617	0.0095	PARTIAL
beta from plain completion only	15	0.362	0.0927	INCONCLUSIVE
beta pooled over both formats (primary)	15	0.421	0.0602	INCONCLUSIVE
beta with other excluded	15	0.388	0.0771	INCONCLUSIVE
beta from correct programs only, any N	11	0.274	0.2097	DISCONFIRMED
beta with disputed rows re-judged	15	0.389	0.0764	INCONCLUSIVE
escape defined as any off-default attempt (iteration-4 definition)	15	0.421	0.0602	INCONCLUSIVE
escape counted on correct programs only	15	0.520	0.0258	PARTIAL
escape fraction as the maximum over alpha	15	0.421	0.0602	INCONCLUSIVE
without the task flagged by the style re-gate	14	0.343	0.1125	INCONCLUSIVE
secondary target: plan noise excess	15	0.454	0.0458	INCONCLUSIVE
beta against the iteration-4 escape fraction	15	0.354	0.1000	INCONCLUSIVE

Table 217. Landing events in Gemma: pt runner-up against the modal landing of confirmed escapes. Source: Gemma experiment `results/e_a2.json`. Base support (valid attempts / correct programs / runner-up count among valid attempts, with the count among correct programs in

brackets, of 150 pooled pt rows; beta and the runner-up come from valid attempts because every unit is LOW_CORRECT, and the pt labels agree with a blind judge at 0.64): grid 73 / 0 / 4 (0 correct); kth smallest 51 / 14 / 6 (0 correct); substring search 55 / 18 / 26 (13 correct); two sum 55 / 13 / 14 (7 correct); connected components 47 / 1 / 6 (0 correct); first and last position 48 / 4 / 12 (0 correct); longest increasing subsequence 51 / 5 / 20 (5 correct) (iteration 6).

Event	pt runner-up	Landing	landing composition	n outcomes
grid	BFS	BFS	BFS 91	91
kth smallest	quickselect	size-k heap	size-k heap 7	7
substring search	built-in find	built-in find	built-in find 44	44
two sum	brute force	brute force	brute force 38	38
connected components	BFS	union find	union find 20	20
first and last position	binary search	binary search	binary search 375	375
longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP	quadratic DP	quadratic DP 19	19

The transplant moves two of seven tasks diverse in the base (Table 218). Every transplanted program stayed valid (pass ratio 0.98 to 1.00). Substring search moved from the naive scan to the built-in find in 40 of 50 programs (twin 6 of 50), and first and last position from the linear scan to binary search in 39 of 50 (twin 4 of 50); both land on the pt runner-up. The other five tasks diverse in the base stayed at their default. The two that moved are exactly the tasks diverse in the base whose it twin already writes the pt runner-up 8% to 12% of the time, so the transplant amplified an existing minority mode and did not install an absent one. The pt-minus-it difference at the task-specification positions is large (median 5.2 ban-free units, 4.7 to 5.8 across blocks), above the dose at which random noise broke programs in iteration 4, and five massive channels carry 86% of its squared norm at block 11, falling to 31% to 36% by blocks 21 and 22. Random controls and borrowed shifts that copy the massive-channel move and match the remaining norm broke most programs (pass ratio 0.16 to 0.50 and 0 to 0.22), so the random comparison is confounded by norm and the borrowed shift is itself broken: what the controls show is that the coherent pt content is benign where an equally large random displacement or borrowed shift is destructive. The transplant at the read position and the three controls collapsed in the base stayed within 0.05 of the twin (Table 219); on nonoverlapping intervals the transplant halved the pass rate without moving the algorithm.

Table 218. Transplant from pt into it at lambda 1 on the seven tasks diverse in the base (s = correct off-default share; McNemar counts transplant only : control only). Source: Gemma experiment `results/transplant.json`.

Unit	β	twin s	T s [95% CI]	RND s	XT s	RP s	T pass ratio	RND pass ratio	McNemar T > RND (b10/b01, p)	T > XT (b10/b01, p)	T lands on r_u	JS(T,pt) < JS(twin,pt)
kth smallest	0.23	0.00	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.02	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.44	0/1, 1.000	0/0, 1.000	no	no
substring search	0.51	0.12	0.80 [0.67, 0.89]	0.04	0.00	0.10	1.00	0.16	38/0, 0.000	40/0, 0.000	yes	yes
find duplicate	0.23	0.00	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.98	0.40	0/0, 1.000	0/0, 1.000	no	no

two sum	0.53	0.00	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.04	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.34	0/2, 1.000	0/0, 1.000	no	no
connected components	0.28	0.00	0.00 [0.00, 0.07]	0.02	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.50	0/1, 1.000	0/0, 1.000	no	no
first and last position	0.40	0.08	0.78 [0.65, 0.87]	0.06	0.00	0.10	1.00	0.20	36/0, 0.000	39/0, 0.000	yes	no
longest increasing subsequence	0.41	0.00	0.02 [0.00, 0.10]	0.16	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.48	0/7, 1.000	1/0, 0.500	yes	yes

Table 219. Controls collapsed in the base for the transplant. Source: Gemma experiment `results/transplant.json`.

Collapsed control	twin s	T s	T pass ratio
shortest path	0.00	0.00	1.00
merge intervals	0.00	0.00	1.00
nonoverlapping intervals	0.00	0.00	0.52

Plan noise rarely moved the it model (Table 220); the exceptions were first and last position (correct off-default share 0.44 and 0.38 at alpha 1 and 2), the grid task (DFS to BFS) and connected components at alpha 2. Spearman between beta and the plan noise excess is 0.45 (one-sided p 0.046).

Table 220. Plan noise in gemma-3-4b-it (a fresh direction per sample, N = 50 per alpha). Source: Gemma experiment `results/pn.json`.

Unit	twin pass	twin Hill-1	PN α1 pass	PN α1 off-default correct	PN α1 Hill-1	PN α2 pass	PN α2 off-default correct	PN α2 Hill-1
grid	0.80	1.74	0.72	0.22	1.84	0.58	0.18	1.85
shortest path	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.04	1.17	0.94	0.04	1.18
kth smallest	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.06	1.25	1.00	0.06	1.25
substring search	1.00	1.43	1.00	0.16	1.54	1.00	0.18	1.59
find duplicate	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	0.98	0.00	1.00
two sum	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.04	1.18
connected components	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.04	1.17	1.00	0.14	1.49
nonoverlapping intervals	1.00	1.00	0.98	0.00	1.00	0.74	0.02	1.12
Fibonacci	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00
topological order	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	0.98	0.00	1.00
merge intervals	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00
first and last position	1.00	1.32	0.98	0.44	2.26	0.92	0.38	3.08
top-k frequent	0.96	1.00	0.86	0.00	1.00	0.92	0.08	1.34
longest increasing subsequence	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.02	1.19
cycle detection	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00	1.00	0.00	1.00

Labels and checks. The base labels are the weakest link: runtime labels agreed with an adjudication by judges from two families on 30 of 30 it programs but on 5 of 30 pt programs (20 of 30 after the inline judge), because the pt code is mostly broken, so the style re-gate failed and its

preregistered fallback, judging every disagreement between runtime and AST labels, applied; a 225-program audit of pt labels agreed at 0.64 (0.47 to 0.93 by task). A structural audit of 92 default and runner-up programs agreed at 0.99. The re-gated shortest path rule, which reads array-based Dijkstra correctly, relabels 258 iteration-4 shortest path programs: their escape fraction falls from 0.25 to 0.125 and their ban compliance from 0.96 to 0.34, which confirms the iteration-4 mislabel. The engine check reproduced iteration-4 slots exactly; 0 novel algorithms among 56 correct programs labelled other (35 catalogue variants, 21 degenerate); the commits preceded the first push and transplant rows; two independent recomputations found no mismatch, with placebos failing as required. Seventeen deviations are logged.

5.9 Positioning: variety in the base model, transplants and base-aligned collaboration in published work

The positioning audit, dated 2026-10-21, extended the iteration-4 audit to the new claims. It checked 137 verbatim quotes from 93 references (111 against full text, 21 against ICLR 2027 abstracts, 5 against blog posts; no mismatch, and a live second pass re-matched all 137) and ran a saturation search under a protocol frozen before the first call: 169 logged calls, 4,508 raw hits, 3,506 unique records, 49 scored on the occupancy rubric, with the stop rule met after the third round. Table 221 gives its verdict per claim.

Table 221. Lane verdicts for the iteration-5 claims as of 2026-10-21. Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`, `evidence/flags.json`.

Claim	Lane verdict	Deciding neighbours
Premise: tuning narrowed algorithm choice on code (premise flag)	partly occupied; contradicting in part	Lee et al. compare a code base and instruct pair and find instruction tuning narrows algorithmic diversity on easy problems and widens it on others [72]; Le Bronnec et al. [107]; support from the text domain [101]
Movability half: movability follows the base repertoire (forecast flag)	partly occupied at training time; inference-time movability open	forecasts per prompt from the frozen base model of what reinforcement learning narrows [98, 99, 109]
Landing half: the landing is the base runner-up	adjacent only (stylised and retrospective support)	sharpening of the distribution under typicality bias [46]; aligned top tokens within the base top-5 [100]
Transplant claim: base prefill states written into the instruct model (transplant flag)	method occupied, diversity outcome open; transplant flag not fired	cross-patching of base states into a descendant [91]; activation patching from base into tuned models [88, 89, 90]; restoration of diversity in weights [92, 93]
Push toward the base	method and control with random directions occupied (style outcome)	ablation of an aligned minus base direction during decoding [97]
Plan sampler comparison	partly occupied; base-aligned collaboration is an occupied lane	token-level base-aligned collaboration [94, 95, 96]; intent factored generation, plan search and decoding at matched departure [73, 74]
Gemma replication	adjacent only	a base and chat Gemma pair can diverge unusually (Kissane et al., blog); template-controlled contrasts [103]
Novelty boundary	unchanged from Table 92c	[81, 82, 105, 106]

Three flags summarise the search. The transplant flag, a paper that writes base-model hidden states into its tuned descendant and reports a change in output diversity, did not fire, narrowly: cross-patching writes base upstream states into a descendant's late stack but measures a next-token margin [91], and earlier patching work measured backdoor removal [89], factual recall [90] or entity tracking [88]; the goal of restoring diversity is published at the weight level, by restoring layer intervals to pretrained weights [92] or merging aligned lower layers with base upper layers [93], and at the token level [94]. The transplant may not be called first. The forecast flag, a forecast from the base model of where post-training narrows, partly fired: forecasts per prompt at training time exist, and one finds that base pass rate and likelihood explain only 0.30 and 0.24 of the explainable variance in post-training gains [99]; inference-time movability and the identity of the landing remain open. The premise flag partly fired: Lee et al. compared DeepSeek Coder base and instruct models with test-checked correctness and found a mixed direction [72], so the premise row reads contradicting in part. The audit recommends further baselines for any later report: weight interpolation between Qwen3-8B-Base and Qwen3-8B [102], layer restoration and splicing at the transplant's block ranges [92, 93], token routing between base and aligned models [94], arithmetic on the logits of base and tuned models, and template control for every base minus instruct contrast [103]. It also lists 27 corrections to earlier citations. Table 92d condenses the neighbour table of the audit; the verbatim quotes are in its `evidence/quotes_iter5.jsonl`.

Table 92d. Iteration-5 claims and their nearest published neighbours (the verbatim quote behind each row is in the positioning audit's evidence file). Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`, Section 3.

Row	Claim	Neighbour	Relation	What this run adds
92d-A0a	Premise: tuning narrowed an algorithm choice the base model makes more evenly (code, algorithm level)	Lee et al., 2025, Findings of EMNLP 2025 [72]	contradicts in part	Test-checked mechanism labels over correct programs (runtime tracer + AST + blind judge) instead of clusters from an LLM judge; same prompt under the chat template for base and instruct; a base and instruct design in two families (Qwen3-8B, gemma-3-4b); not the first comparison of base and tuned models at the algorithm level (premise flag partly fired)
92d-A0b	(same claim)	Lee et al., 2025, Findings of EMNLP 2025 [72]	contradicts in part	Per-task test of the premise; Lee et al.'s difficulty split predicts the premise can fail on harder tasks
92d-A0c	(same claim)	Lee et al., 2025, Findings of EMNLP 2025 [72]	context	Mechanism labels checked by execution traces rather than an LLM judge
92d-A0d	(same claim)	Le Bronnec et al., 2026, arXiv preprint (under review) [107]	adjacent	Diversity at the algorithm level (not structural near duplicates); instruction-tuned rather than RLVR descendant
92d-A0e	(same claim)	Wu et al., 2024, ICLR 2025 (poster) [2]	context	Open-weight base/instruct code pair (none in Monoculture's code arm)
92d-A0f	(same claim)	Jangra et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [3]	context	Pairing of base and instruct models (DivAlgo has none)

92d-A0g	(same claim)	Yang et al., 2025, TMLR 2026 (v4 comment) [101]	supports	replication of the narrowing from base to aligned models at the algorithm level on code
92d-A0h	(same claim)	Liu, 2026, arXiv preprint	supports	Code, test-checked; not semantic clusters of QA answers
92d-A0i	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	supports	Code algorithms instead of Countdown entrance families; base vs instruction-tuned rather than PPO/GRPO
92d-A1a	Movability follows the base repertoire (the tuned model can be pushed off its default only where the base spreads)	Zhou (T.), 2026, arXiv preprint [98]	partly fires (forecast flag)	Inference-time movability of the tuned model under pushes (not loss of coverage at training time); algorithm choice, not correctness; base repertoire (beta, runner-up) committed by sha256 before any push
92d-A1b	(same claim)	Zhou (T.), 2026, arXiv preprint [98]	partly fires (forecast flag)	Forecast scored on matched events at inference time
92d-A1c	(same claim)	Duan, 2026, arXiv preprint [99]	contradicts in part	Must beat (or report against) simple base signals; Duan et al. find base pass rate / likelihood weak predictors of training gains
92d-A1d	(same claim)	Duan, 2026, arXiv preprint [99]	supports	Base-model behaviour on a task (its algorithm distribution) as the predictor
92d-A1e	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	partly fires (forecast flag)	Uses the base model alone (no reward model); outcome = movability under activation/prompt pushes
92d-A1f	(same claim)	Nguyen et al., 2025, NeurIPS 2026 (poster) [109]	adjacent	Per-task forecast tested on the deployed instruct model rather than an account of training dynamics
92d-A1g	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	contradicts in part	A control with random tasks for any claim of targeting
92d-A1h	(same claim)	Mohammadi, 2024, arXiv preprint [108]	adjacent	Quantified per task with test-checked labels
92d-A2a	Landing: a push or ban of the tuned model lands on the base model's runner-up algorithm	Zhang et al., 2025, arXiv preprint [46]	partly fires (stylised)	A preregistered forecast per task of the landing identity (runner-up) scored on matched events; none found

92d-A2b	(same claim)	Lin et al., 2023, arXiv preprint (ICLR 2024 per plan; not confirmed here) [100]	supports	Landings at the algorithm level (whole solutions) rather than token ranks
92d-A2c	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	adjacent	Forecast before the push, not retrospective inheritance
92d-A2d	(same claim)	Samanta et al., 2026, arXiv preprint	supports	Code algorithms; prospective
92d-A2e	(same claim)	Fortier et al., 2026, arXiv preprint	supports	Algorithm choice on code; landing under pushes
92d-A2f	(same claim)	Zhao et al., 2025, COLM 2025	supports	Released base/instruct pair instead of models trained from scratch
92d-A2g	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	supports	Activation-level pushes; algorithm identity
92d-B1a	Transplant: base prefill states (task specification positions, blocks 12-23, lambda 0.25/0.5/1) written into the instruct model restore the base choice; controls: read position, blocks 0-11/24-35, matched random, borrowed shift	Zhou (Y.), 2026, arXiv preprint [91]	occupies (method)	Outcome = test-checked algorithm choice / solution diversity (not a next-token margin); site = task-specification prefill positions; dose lambda; matched-norm random displacement and patches borrowed from other tasks as controls
92d-B1b	(same claim)	Zhou (Y.), 2026, arXiv preprint [91]	occupies (method)	Site comparison includes read position and early/late block ranges at matched dose
92d-B1c	(same claim)	Oozeer et al., 2025, ICML 2025 [89]	method overlap	Diversity/algorithm outcome instead of backdoor removal
92d-B1d	(same claim)	Du et al., 2025, COLM 2025 [90]	method overlap	Behavioural (solution) outcome instead of log probabilities of factual recall
92d-B1e	(same claim)	Prakash et al., 2024, ICLR 2024 [88]	method overlap	Direction base->tuned (CMAP patched tuned->base)
92d-B1f	(same claim)	Zhang et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [92]	adjacent	States rather than weights; code; matched random control
92d-B1g	(same claim)	Sumita et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [93]	adjacent	Per-position state transplant in the opposite composition (base states into instruct blocks)

92d-B1h	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	adjacent	Hidden-state transplant (not weights) on code
92d-B1i	(same claim)	Wang et al., 2025, ICML 2026 [94]	occupies (goal, token level)	Activation level instead of token routing
92d-B2a	Push toward the base: push the instruct model along the base minus instruct direction against isotropic pushes at matched norm	Anand et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [97]	occupies (method)	replication of the PASTA ablation of the aligned minus base direction in a new setting: algorithm choice in code, against matched-norm isotropic pushes
92d-B2b	(same claim)	Anand et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [97]	occupies (control)	Matched-norm isotropic directions rather than orthogonal unit directions
92d-B2c	(same claim)	Anonymous, 2026, ICLR 2027 submission (under review); contemporaneous by rule	adjacent	Diversity outcome rather than accuracy
92d-B2d	(same claim)	Minder et al., 2025, ICLR 2026	adjacent	Opposite sign (toward base) and a diversity outcome
92d-B2e	(same claim)	Zheng et al., 2024, ACL 2025	adjacent (weight space)	Push in activation space; extrapolation in weight space is a reviewer baseline
92d-B2f	(same claim)	Nakamura, 2026, arXiv preprint [103]	supports (method caution)	Direction estimated with base and instruct under the same chat template
92d-Ca	Knobs compared directly: activation plan noise against text-level plan samplers, base-aligned collaboration (base writes the intent, instruct writes the code) and decoding at matched departure	Wang et al., 2025, ICML 2026 [94]	occupies (collaboration lane)	The base intent arm is an instance of base-aligned collaboration at the level of sentences; the addition is pricing it against activation noise on test-checked algorithms
92d-Cb	(same claim)	Peeperkorn et al., 2025, arXiv preprint [95]	occupies (collaboration lane)	Code, algorithm-level outcome
92d-Cc	(same claim)	Feng et al., 2025, arXiv preprint [96]	occupies (collaboration lane)	Code, algorithm-level outcome
92d-Cd	(same claim)	Zhang et al., 2026, arXiv preprint	adjacent	Code; comparison with activation noise
92d-Ce	(same claim)	Sumita et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [93]	adjacent	Code; text-level plan samplers in the contrast set
92d-Cf	(same claim)	Dang et al., 2025, COLM 2025 [102]	baseline to add	Weight interpolation as a contrast arm

92d-Cg	(see Table 92c)	Intent Factored Generation: Unleashing the Diversity in Your Language [73]	inherited	text plan sampler, hot for the intent and cold for the response (Table 92c)
92d-Ch	(see Table 92c)	Planning In Natural Language Improves LLM Search For Code Generation [74]	inherited	natural-language plan search (Table 92c)
92d-Ci	(see Table 92c)	Where You Inject Diversity Matters: A Unified Framework for Diverse Ge [83]	inherited	Specifications per output at level 2 (Table 92c)
92d-Cj	(see Table 92c)	Gacha Decoding: Eliciting Diverse Generations Through Instruction Foll	inherited	instruction-following diversity (Table 92c)
92d-Ck	(see Table 92c)	Rethinking Activation Steering for Mathematical Reasoning: What Actual	inherited	decoding matched to steering's departure from greedy (Table 92c)
92d-Cl	(see Table 92c)	Perturb the Thought, Not the Pixels: Latent-Space Rollout Diversificat [104]	inherited	latent rollout perturbation in RL (Table 92c)
92d-Ea	Second family: gemma-3-4b pt vs it	Kissane et al., n.d., grey literature (blog/ research update)	context (caution)	Report base/instruct activation-space similarity for gemma-3-4b before transplanting; Gemma base/chat pairs can diverge unusually
92d-Eb	(same claim)	Zhang et al., 2026, arXiv preprint [92]	adjacent	Gemma in a code setting; states not weights
92d-Ec	(same claim)	Nakamura, 2026, arXiv preprint [103]	supports (method caution)	Template-controlled contrasts on the second family
92d-Ga	(see Table 92c)	Mathematical discoveries from program search with large language model [81]	inherited	novelty boundary unchanged; no new 2026 hit

5.10 Comparisons across this iteration's experiments

The base repertoire against movability: screen, confirmation and second family. The same quantity, beta against the escape fraction, was measured five ways in this iteration, and the answer depends on which tasks enter. On the 15 existing tasks, with the beta of Step 1 and the escape fractions of iteration 4, Spearman is 0.78 to 0.79; with this iteration's own bf16 escape fractions it is 0.59; on the new tasks it is -0.03 in panel A, 0.21 in panel B and 0.15 pooled; in Gemma it is 0.42. The screen correlation is carried by many tasks with low beta that never move, while on new tasks those diverse in the base that never move are common: count primes and valid anagram (beta 0.81 each), median of two sorted lists (0.71), jump game (0.47), all subsets (0.37) and longest

common prefix (0.30). The figure, corrected in iteration 6, plots both sets like for like under bf16: the existing tasks at their bf16 escape fraction under the ban-free unit (filled; the 8-bit screen value as an open ghost marker joined by a segment) and the new units, both at iteration 5's ban-free unit. Existing tasks (n 15): Spearman 0.59, one-sided permutation p 0.010, Bonett-Wright 95% [0.06, 0.86]; with the 8-bit screen E instead 0.79. New units (n 13): 0.15, p 0.315, [-0.44, 0.65]; with the two reserve units 0.01. Pooled bf16 (n 28): 0.48, p 0.005. The existing-task correlation is carried by many tasks with low beta that never move; open markers show the 8-bit screen value of each existing task. Per set, the base runner-up named the push landing 5 of 5 on the 8-bit screen, 1 of 2 on the bf16 remeasurement of existing tasks, 3 of 3 in panel A, 3 of 4 in panel B and 5 of 7 in Gemma (17 of 21, Poisson-binomial p 5.8e-07); the bf16 remeasurement's kth smallest and connected components events were missing from the earlier count of 16 of 19 (kth smallest a miss: landing size-k heap against runner-up quickselect; connected components a hit). On the 8 held-out events where the instruct twin wrote no correct program off the default the base runner-up named 5 (p 0.053; Qwen3-8B 3 of 4, p 0.052; Gemma 2 of 4, p 0.422) (iteration-6 correction).

Movability depends on the engine and the unit. Table 222 sets the existing tasks' movability side by side across the measurements of iterations 4 and 5. Under iteration 4's 8-bit engine and the ban unit, six tasks were movable; under this iteration's bf16 engine and the ban-free unit, only kth smallest and connected components escape with 8 fixed directions, and per-sample plan noise moves more than 10% of programs off the default only on kth smallest (0.28 at alpha 2). On the shortest path task, per-sample plan noise moved 26% of all samples at alpha 1 in iteration 4 (13 of 50 valid attempts off the default; 9 of 43 correct programs) and 0 of 50 correct programs at alpha 1 here (2 of 47 at alpha 2, 1.67 8-bit ban units by the ratio of mean norms and 1.78 by the mean ratio). A dose-bracketed comparison (iteration 6) sets the bf16 alpha-2 cell, which delivers more than the 1.00 ban unit of the 8-bit alpha-1 cell under either dose definition, against the 8-bit alpha-1 cell: a lower bf16 share there cannot be a dose shortfall. By the rule fixed before computing, connected components and shortest path did not replicate in bf16 at the population level (correct-only bracket one-sided Fisher p kth smallest 0.588, connected components 0.056, shortest path 0.017, two sum 1.000, grid 0.732); kth smallest: not established; two sum: not established (no 8-bit effect of at least 10% at alpha of 2 or less to replicate); grid: not established; find duplicate: not established (no 8-bit effect of at least 10% at alpha of 2 or less to replicate). This rules out the dose unit, not the CRN slots, the labels or the kernels (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 228). The engine control of Section 6.3 then tested the numerics directly: at iteration 4's own absolute displacement, direction seeds and slots, the bf16 engine reproduces the 8-bit rows (per-sample plan noise at alpha 2: connected components 25 of 50 valid attempts off the default under bf16 against 30 of 50 under the 8-bit engine; shortest path 22 of 50 under both), so the non-replication tagged here belongs to iteration 5's ban-free unit and direction seeds, not to the bf16 numerics. The engine checks pushed two fixed escaping directions at the ban unit in both engines and agreed within or near the resampling null (shortest path: Dijkstra 31 and Bellman-Ford/SPFA 19 in bf16 against 26 and 24 in the 8-bit engine). Those two directions therefore do not explain the difference, and its cause is not established here. *(Correction, iteration 6: the engine control of Section 6.3 establishes that the cause is not the bf16 numerics. At the absolute unit, direction seeds and slots of iteration 4 itself, bf16 escapes on almost the same directions as the 8-bit engine (connected components 26 of 40 against 29 of 40; shortest path 6 of 40 against 8 of 40). The shrinkage belongs to the ban-free unit of iteration 5 or its direction seeds, and the heading should read that movability depends on the unit and the direction draw.)* Movability is therefore a property of a task under a given engine, unit and direction population, and the confirmation panels measured it under bf16 and the ban-free unit only.

Table 222. Movability of the 15 existing tasks across measurements (escape fraction of fixed directions at alpha 1 / alpha 2, or off-default share of per-sample plan noise at alpha 1 / alpha 2). The two plan-noise columns are not on one definition: the 8-bit column counts valid attempts off the default over all samples, the bf16 column correct programs off the default over all samples. On one definition (correct programs only, 8-bit against bf16, alpha 1 / alpha 2): kth smallest 0.28 / 0.49 against 0.08 / 0.28; connected components 0.12 / 0.60 against 0.02 / 0.02; shortest path 0.21 / 0.41 against 0.00 / 0.04; two sum 0.00 / 0.02 against 0.00 / 0.04; grid 0.03 / 0.11 against 0.00 / 0.03; on all samples: kth smallest 0.28 / 0.50 against 0.10 / 0.28; connected components 0.12 / 0.60 against 0.02 / 0.02; shortest path 0.26 / 0.54 against 0.00 / 0.10; two sum 0.00 / 0.02 against 0.00 / 0.04; grid 0.06 / 0.24 against 0.00 / 0.04 (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 228). At iteration 4's absolute unit, its direction seeds and its slots, the bf16 engine reproduces the 8-bit plan-noise column (Section 6.3; iteration-6 correction). Sources: record audit `screen.json`; panel A `results/extra_arm_a.json` (iteration-4 fresh directions and the remeasurement arm); panel B `results/variants.json` (remeasured parent, pooled over both alphas); plan noise experiment `results/alpha_sweep.json` (iteration 4); knob experiment `results/cells.json` (iteration 5).

Task	Frozen screen (8-bit, ban unit)	Iteration 4, 40 fresh directions (8-bit, bench unit)	Iteration 5, 8 directions (bf16, ban-free unit)	Iteration 5, panel B parent (bf16, ban-free, pooled)	Iteration 4 per-sample plan noise (8-bit, ban unit)	Iteration 5 per-sample plan noise (bf16, ban-free unit)
kth smallest	movable	0.30 / 0.63	0.125 / 0.375	0.500	0.28 / 0.50	0.08 / 0.28
connected components	movable	0.38 / 0.73	0.000 / 0.250	0.188	0.12 / 0.60	0.02 / 0.02
shortest path	movable	0.18 / 0.20	0.000 / 0.000	not run	0.26 / 0.54	0.00 / 0.04
two sum	movable	0.00 / 0.13	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	0.00 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.04
grid	movable	0.05 / 0.13	0.000 / 0.000	not run	0.06 / 0.24	0.00 / 0.02
find duplicate	movable	0.00 / 0.00	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	0.00 / 0.02	0.00 / 0.00
substring search	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	excess 0.00 at alpha 2 or less	0.00 / 0.00
Fibonacci	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	excess 0.01	0.00 / 0.00
top-k frequent	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	excess 0.04	0.00 / 0.00
nonoverlapping intervals	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	0.000	excess 0.00	0.00 / 0.00
longest increasing subsequence	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	not run	excess 0.03	0.00 / 0.00
merge intervals	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	not run	excess 0.00	0.00 / 0.00
topological order	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	not run	excess 0.00	0.00 / 0.00
first and last position	immovable	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	not run	excess -0.08	0.03 / 0.07
cycle detection	not screened	0 of 8 / 0 of 8	0.000 / 0.000	not run	excess 0.01	0.00 / 0.07

The transplant in two families. In Qwen3-8B the transplant passed on 1 of 5 tasks diverse in the base and in Gemma it moved 2 of 7, each time onto the base runner-up. The successes share a feature: in Gemma the instruct twin already wrote the runner-up 8% to 12% of the time, and in Qwen3-8B the transplant raised the pass rate from 0.78 to 0.98 while it moved top-k frequent. Where the instruct model never wrote the base runner-up, the base states did not install it. In both families the base minus instruct difference at the task-specification positions was large (Qwen3-8B

0.39 to 0.53 of the residual norm, 71% of cells above 4 ban-free units at lambda 1; Gemma a median of 5.2 ban-free units), and in both an isotropic displacement or borrowed shift of comparable size did more damage than the coherent base content.

[Figure fig_transplant: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Novelty, audited again. No artifact of this iteration found a correct novel algorithm (Table 223), including the base model's own output and the transplanted output.

Table 223. Novelty audits of iteration 5. Sources: the novelty audit files of the five experiments.

Artifact	Correct programs in the pool	Correct programs outside the catalogue	Final classes	Novel
Transplant experiment	all arms, base model included	48	27 known techniques outside the frozen catalogue, 12 degenerate, 9 catalogue variants (judges called 14 novel)	0
Panel A	6,854	2	1 catalogue variant, 1 degenerate	0
Panel B	10,366	12	7 catalogue variants, 5 degenerate	0
Knob experiment	every correct program labelled other	12	10 labeller misses, 1 degenerate, 1 unresolved	0
Gemma experiment	every correct program labelled other	56	35 catalogue variants, 21 degenerate	0

5.11 What iteration 5 established, what it ruled out, and what it abandoned

Everything below is one or two model families at 4B to 8B parameters, memorised tasks in the style of LeetCode, and labels from gated labellers, except the base-model labels of Gemma, which agree with an adjudication at only 0.64. Every Qwen3-8B number of this iteration comes from a bf16 engine.

Established.

1. *Temperature does not change the algorithm, under every sampler the run used.* With thinking on, top-k 10 and the same seed, the algorithm changed in 0 of 20 seeds across four temperatures on the shortest path task, and the first approach named in the thinking never changed.
2. *(Moved to the descriptive results, iteration 6.) Where a random nudge moves the instruct model, it often lands on the base model's runner-up.* Per set the base runner-up named the push landing 5 of 5 on the 8-bit screen, 1 of 2 on the bf16 remeasurement of existing tasks, 3 of 3 in panel A, 3 of 4 in panel B and 5 of 7 in Gemma (17 of 21, Poisson-binomial p 5.8e-07); on new tasks 6 of 7 events (Poisson-binomial p 0.003). 6 of the 11 held-out hits are also the instruct twin's own minority: on the 8 held-out events where the instruct twin wrote no correct program off the default the base runner-up named 5 (p 0.053; Qwen3-8B 3 of 4, p 0.052; Gemma 2 of 4, p 0.422), and the twin's own most frequent alternative, defined on 7 of 21 events, named 6 of them against 6 for the base runner-up (exact McNemar p 1.000). Where the twin writes an alternative at all, the landing half is therefore the twin's own minority, and the base model adds a forecast only on the events where the twin writes none (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 230), with the base composition ahead of

association by 0.75 nats (exact Wilcoxon p 0.055 with the corrected association) and of proximity by 0.50. In Gemma it named 5 of 7 (p 0.025; 1.50 nats over association with undefined association forecasts filled uniformly, 1.57 on the 6 defined events, p 0.023), and on the existing Qwen3-8B tasks 5 of 5. In panel A no nudged program landed outside the base repertoire.

3. *The base model is more diverse than the instruct model on most tasks under identical prompts.* The instruct twin wrote its default in 96% to 100% of programs on all 15 existing tasks, while 5 tasks were diverse in the base and 7 intermediate, and every new unit but one had beta of at least 0.05. The base model's own correct output is thin under the chat template (14 to 55 correct programs per 100 to 200 on the existing tasks). Three instruct twins of new units are mixed (trapped rain water default share 0.64, minimum spanning tree weight default share 0.66, valid anagram default share 0.76). On two new units the instruct twin is more diverse than the base: trapped rain water (twin off-default 0.36 against beta 0.23) and minimum spanning tree weight (0.34 against 0.11), and on both the landing is the twin's own minority (iteration-6 correction).
4. *Plan noise's effect is not its token-level departure from the twin, on kth smallest.* At alpha 2 it moved 19 slots against 3 for decoding matched to its per-token KL (exact p 8.6e-04), but the discordant counts are kth smallest 13:0, connected components 1:3, shortest path 2:0, two sum 2:0, grid 1:0: without kth smallest the other four tasks give 6:3 (p 0.508); at alpha 1 the pooled count is 4:3 (p 1.000); bf16-conditional (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 233).
5. *The record repairs.* The held-out movability test is inconclusive under catalogue-only avoidance and disconfirmed under the drop sensitivity; the read position and condition sentence are inert only at per-position doses up to 4 ban units; landing comparisons on matched events give push -0.76 against association -3.11 on 3 events and -1.37 against -3.46 on 5.

Ruled out, or not supported.

- *The movability half: the base repertoire predicts which tasks a nudge moves.* Not supported as a strong predictor, and not disconfirmed: beta is not a strong predictor of movability (Spearman 0.15 over 13 new units, Bonett-Wright 95% [-0.44, 0.65], bootstrap BCa [-0.50, 0.70], one-sided permutation p 0.317; power of the registered one-sided permutation test about 0.63 at a true 0.6, 0.50 two-sided, and 20 units for 0.8); a moderate relation is not excluded at this n; conditional on the design of iteration 5 (bf16 with the ban-free unit and its direction seeds; the engine control of Section 6.3 shows that the numerics alone do not shrink the escapes). The pooled value rests on the beta of count inversions, 0.75, which the panel committed on the attempt basis because only a few base programs were correct (67% of its attempts fall in the class other); on the correct-only basis used for the other twelve units its beta is 0.13 and the pooled Spearman is 0.035. Per panel Spearman -0.03 (A) and 0.21 (B); 4 of 10 new units diverse in the base never moved. Under one definition of each rival, pooled over the 13 units with signs fixed so that the predicted direction is positive: opening margin 0.08 (Holm p 1.000, delta +0.07 [-0.66, 0.88]); novelty-instruction excess -0.50 (Holm p 1.000, delta +0.65 [-0.06, 1.34]); runtime merit 0.71 (Holm p 0.021, delta -0.57 [-1.26, 0.20]); twin modal share 0.41 (Holm p 0.347, delta -0.26 [-1.05, 0.56]); catalogue size -0.21 (Holm p 1.000, delta +0.35 [-0.57, 1.24]). Under Holm only runtime merit tracks movability, while beta does not; the paired interval for beta minus that rival still includes 0 (iteration-6 correction; record audit, Table 232). The screen correlation of 0.78

did not transfer to new tasks.

- *The transplant claim: a transplant of base plan states reopens the base repertoire.* Disconfirmed by the frozen rule (1 of 5 tasks diverse in the base); on kth smallest a matched-norm random displacement moved more programs than the base states (2:20). The narrowing installed by tuning is not carried by the task-specification states of blocks 12 to 23 alone.
- *The push toward the base.* A push along the base minus instruct direction never escaped at 0.5 to 2 ban-free units, while an isotropic push did on kth smallest.
- *The plan sampler comparison: plan noise prices at least as well as text-level plan samplers.* Disconfirmed (1 of 5 decisive tasks); base intent won on connected components, the shortest path task and two sum.

Inconclusive.

- *The movability half in Gemma.* Spearman 0.42 (p 0.060), with the twin modal share and the novelty instruction ahead of beta; descriptively 6 of 7 tasks diverse in the base moved against 2 of 8 others.
- *Top-k frequent.* The one Qwen3-8B task where the transplant reopened the base runner-up also gained 20 pass points, so restored correctness and a reopened choice are not separated.

Dead ends, with the evidence that closed them.

- *The base minus instruct direction as a knob.* Closed by Table 186: it never escapes, and the difference it encodes is mostly shared across tasks (cosine 0.76 to 0.88) and larger than the dose at which random noise breaks programs.
- *Transplanting at the read position.* The base and instruct states differ there by about the size of the residual, and the transplant broke the output on 13 of 15 tasks without moving an algorithm.
- *Plan noise as the practical knob for algorithmic diversity.* On the decisive tasks two text-level samplers price better, and under the bf16 engine and ban-free unit plan noise moves more than 10% of programs only on kth smallest (conditional on the design of iteration 5, bf16 with the ban-free unit and its direction seeds: at the absolute unit and seeds of iteration 4 the bf16 engine reproduces the 8-bit effects on connected components and the shortest path task, Section 6.3; iteration-6 correction).
- *Signed progress toward the runner-up as the next predictor.* Closed in the record audit (Table 177): concentrated on one task, negative on two, matched by a within-class control.

5.12 What the next iteration takes from this one

The narrowed repertoire account split in two. Its landing half held descriptively in both families and on unseen tasks (5 of 5 on the 8-bit screen, 1 of 2 on the bf16 remeasurement of existing tasks, 3 of 3 in panel A, 3 of 4 in panel B and 5 of 7 in Gemma (17 of 21, Poisson-binomial p 5.8e-07)), but it is not yet separated from the instruct twin's own minority (on the 8 held-out events where the instruct twin wrote no correct program off the default the base runner-up named 5 (p 0.053; Qwen3-8B 3 of 4, p 0.052; Gemma 2 of 4, p 0.422); iteration-6 correction): when a nudge moves the instruct model, it moves it to the algorithm the base model writes next, and a forecast built from base samples, before any push, names that landing better than the model's stated alternative. Its movability half failed on unseen tasks: a base model that writes many algorithms does not mark a task the instruct model can be nudged off, and its states, written into the instruct prefill, reopen

the choice on one task in five. The base repertoire marks where a nudge can lead, not whether it can lead anywhere.

The open question is therefore what makes a task diverse in the base immovable. Count primes and valid anagram (beta 0.81 each) never moved, while trapped rain water (0.23) did. Two leads came out of this iteration's data. In panel A the three units that moved had an alternative at least twice as fast as the default and the three that did not had none, although median of two sorted lists broke the pattern. And in the transplant experiment early blocks 0 to 11 moved kth smallest and connected components more than the main band, which suggests the narrowing sits at least partly upstream of blocks 12 to 23. The positioning audit names the baselines a further test needs: weight interpolation between the base and instruct models, layer restoration at the transplant's block ranges, and token-level base and aligned collaboration [92, 93, 94, 102]. Base intent, which beat plan noise on three of five tasks, is the strongest practical knob the run has priced, and it is itself a form of that collaboration at the level of sentences. Finally, movability has to be measured under the engine and unit at which it will be used: the six screen-movable tasks of iteration 4 shrank to two under bf16 and the ban-free unit, for reasons this iteration did not establish. *(Iteration-6 correction: a dose-bracketed contrast rules out a scalar dose shortfall on connected components and shortest path, and the engine control rules out the bf16 numerics, since at iteration 4's absolute unit and seeds bf16 reproduces the 8-bit escapes (Section 6.3). What remains is the per-position and per-block profile of the ban-free unit, or the direction seeds; every verdict that rests on bf16 plan noise or escape fractions at the ban-free unit is conditional on that design.)*

Iteration 6: an engine control, where a ban and an instruction are carried, a one-token fork in Gemma, and the plan in words

6.1 Why this iteration ran what it ran

The review of the iteration-5 record. The review was blocking again. It raised five major items, all marked must fix, and four minor ones. The first went to the run's main internal result. Every plan-noise positive of iteration 4 had come from an 8-bit engine whose W8A8 linear layers compute in 8-bit floating point (e4m3 weights per output channel, e4m3 activations with a per-token scale), while iteration 5's bf16 knob experiment found per-sample plan noise nearly inert: connected components moved in 1 of 50 programs at alpha 2 against 30 of 50 under the 8-bit engine. The record had left the cause open, had not reported the knob experiment's own measurement of the dose it delivered, and still listed iteration-4 items 2 to 4 as established. The review asked for a decisive control: the same directions and slots at the same absolute displacement under the 8-bit engine, under 8-bit floating-point weights with bf16 activations and under bf16. The second item found the landing half of the narrowed repertoire account overstated. Its tally of 16 of 19 omitted the bf16 remeasurement made in that same iteration, and it never scored the minority algorithm of the instruct twin itself as a rival, although that rival explained half the hits. The third item asked for the power and interval behind the claim that the movability half was ruled out, and for the frozen rivals on the pooled set. The fourth listed executed outputs missing from the record: the phrasing columns of the literal cell, the prices at Hill-1 1.5 and 2, the dose file of the knob experiment, the knob rows of panel B and three Llama rows of Table 126c. The fifth said that after five iterations the record still had no internal account of how the choice manifests, which is the request's central question, and that its one internal positive rested on the 8-bit engine. The minor

items asked for the per-task counts behind item 4 of Section 5.11, the fill rule for undefined Gemma forecasts, a sentence on the three new tasks whose instruct twins are already mixed, and a second blind adjudication of the 14 transplant programs that two of three judges had called novel. Table 224 maps every item to its answer.

Table 224. Review items on the iteration-5 record and where this report answers them.

Review item	What the review found	Where it is answered
Engine	The 8-bit plan-noise effect does not replicate in bf16 at near-matched dose; the dose file unreported; iteration-4 items 2 to 4 still established; plan-sampler and movability verdicts not tagged with their engine	Corrections in Sections 4.2.6, 4.10, 5.2, 5.10, 5.11 and 5.12; Section 6.2.2; the engine control, Section 6.3
Landing half	Selective tally; the twin's own minority never scored; thin base support in Gemma; two units where the instruct twin is more diverse than the base	Corrections in Sections 5.5, 5.8, 5.10, 5.11 and 5.12; Section 6.2.3; the landing contest of Section 6.4.5
Movability half	Ruled out without its interval or power; the frozen rivals not computed on the pooled set	Correction in Section 5.11; Section 6.2.4
Missing outputs	Literal-cell phrasing columns; prices at Hill-1 1.5 and 2; dose file; panel B knob rows; Table 126c rows	In place in Tables 206, 207b, 203b and 126c and in Section 5.2; Section 6.2.5
Coverage	No representation of the choice; the internal positive rests on the 8-bit engine	Sections 6.3 to 6.6; Section 6.10
Minor: matched decoding per task	Item 4 of Section 5.11 generalised from kth smallest	Correction in Section 5.11
Minor: Gemma fill rule	The 1.50 nats included an undefined association forecast filled uniformly	Corrections in Sections 5.8 and 5.11
Minor: mixed instruct twins	Three new units are already mixed; on two the instruct twin is more diverse than the base	Notes under Sections 5.4 and 5.5; correction in Section 5.11; the closing section
Minor: novelty adjudication	The zero rested on the executor's override of two judges	Section 6.2.6; corrections in Section 4.9 and the closing section

The hypothesis update. The update turned from the outside of the model to its inside. Five iterations had mapped what moves the algorithm from outside: a ban, a meaningful hint, a plan sentence written by the base model, a list-then-pick step. None had located where the model holds its choice. The update proposed one concrete answer, which it called the plan-variable account. While the model reads the task, it computes a small hidden variable that says which algorithm to write. We call this variable the *plan*. On tasks where a ban acts through the prompt states (shortest path, kth smallest, connected components) the plan sits in the residual stream at the task-specification positions; on tasks where generated tokens read the ban directly (two sum, find duplicate) it sits at the first generated tokens. Exchanging a few of its dimensions between two prompts should switch the algorithm the model writes, with correct code. Random noise should change the algorithm only through the part of it that falls inside the plan, which would explain why most random directions do nothing; temperature should never touch it.

The update tested the account with the instruments the request names and the run had not yet used. An *interchange intervention* replaces a component's activations under one input with those under another and measures the change in output. *Distributed alignment search* (DAS) fits an orthonormal low-rank subspace in which such an exchange reproduces a counterfactual behaviour

[110, 111]. A *natural language autoencoder* (NLA) pairs an activation verbalizer, which writes a text explanation of a residual-stream state, with an activation reconstructor, which maps text back to a state; released checkpoints exist for Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct [124] at layer 20, not for Qwen3-8B. Gemma Scope 2, released in December 2025, provides JumpReLU sparse autoencoders [114] and transcoders trained on gemma-3-4b-it itself, the successor of the Gemma Scope release for Gemma 2 [113], so no transfer test from a base model is needed.

Eleven claims were preregistered, each with a rule committed by sha256 before its first decisive sample. We call them by their content rather than by their codes: the engine claim, the localization claim, the mediation claim, the discreteness claim, the token claim, the resampling claim, the verbal readout claim, the feature claim, the site rerun, the landing contest and the novelty count.

- *The engine claim* (primary): on connected components and shortest path, the same 40 directions and common-random-number slots at the same absolute displacement under four numerics. Activation rounding is the cause if the escape fraction under bf16 weights with 8-bit floating-point activations (W16A8) exceeds bf16 by at least 0.2, the full 8-bit engine (W8A8) matches W16A8 within 0.1 and 8-bit floating-point weights with bf16 activations (W8A16) match bf16 within 0.1, on both tasks. The result is called not reproduced if W8A8 minus bf16 is below 0.1.
- *The localization claim* (primary). Stage A, with no training: exchanging the full residual states of the ban prompt into the neutral twin transfers the ban's substitute at a transfer share of at least 0.5 on at least two of shortest path, kth smallest and connected components, at a pass rate of at least 0.8 times the twin's, and at most 0.2 on two sum and find duplicate. Stage B: DAS at one layer recovers at least 0.8 of the full-state transfer at a rank of 16 or less on held-out templates.
- *The mediation claim* (primary): the energy that a random direction puts into the fitted plan subspace predicts which directions switch the algorithm (Spearman at least 0.5).
- *The discreteness claim*, *the token claim* (temperature leaves the plan coordinate flat while state noise at generated tokens beats temperature at matched per-token KL) and *the resampling claim* (resampling the plan as a diversity knob) (secondary).
- *The verbal readout claim* (secondary): the NLA names the substitute of a ban before any code is written at a rate at least 0.3 above a judge reading the visible text; editing the explanation's algorithm phrase and reconstructing transfers the algorithm by at least 0.2.
- *The feature claim* (secondary): in Gemma's natural BFS against DFS split on the grid task, Gemma Scope 2 features decode the upcoming algorithm at least 0.10 balanced accuracy above a classifier on the visible text, and steer at least as well as a difference-in-means direction at matched pass.
- *The site rerun* (secondary): the iteration-4 noise-site comparison in bf16; the prefill-site claim survives if the task-specification site beats the read position and the condition sentence at matched downstream displacement on at least one task, and is withdrawn otherwise.
- *The landing contest* (secondary): the base runner-up against the instruct twin's own teacher-forced ranking of algorithm openings, on every recorded push-landing event.
- *The novelty count* (secondary).

The strategy. Seven artifacts were planned (Table 225). One evaluation on CPU, which we call the record audit, repaired the record from rows on disk and ran the second novelty adjudication. An experiment we call the engine control ran the four numerics on a 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada, an Ada-

generation card with the 8-bit floating-point tensor cores that the 8-bit engine needs. A bf16 experiment, which we call the exchange and site experiment, ran the Stage A exchanges, the site rerun, state noise against matched temperature, the top-five push and the landing contest. Gemma and the NLA each received their own experiment, which we call the Gemma feature experiment and the NLA experiment, and a research artifact, which we call the positioning audit, searched the literature for each claim. The seventh artifact, which was to fit the DAS subspaces of Stage B and run the mediation, discreteness, resampling and temperature-coordinate tests together with a manifold of plan coordinates, was lost before it existed: the planning agent returned no plan. Section 6.8 records it as planned and not run. Every Qwen3-8B number of this iteration except those of the engine control comes from a bf16 engine.

Table 225. The artifacts of iteration 6, the question each was asked, and its hardware and spend.

Artifact	Question	Model and hardware	OpenRouter spend
Record audit	Repair the iteration-5 record (36 corrections); re-adjudicate the 14 disputed transplant programs blind	No generation; CPU only	USD 0.29
Engine control	Are iteration 4's random-push escapes a property of the model or of the 8-bit floating-point W8A8 engine?	Qwen3-8B under four numerics built from one bf16 snapshot; one 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada; 6,075 generated programs plus reused iteration-4 rows; 4.1 GPU hours of generation	USD 0.085
Exchange and site experiment	Where is a ban carried; does the noise-site claim hold in bf16; state noise against matched temperature; the top-five push; the landing contest	Qwen3-8B bf16 with the input embedding table on CPU, one 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada; 4,320 programs and 1,220 teacher-forced passes; about 2.7 GPU hours	USD 0.055
Gemma feature experiment	Where does Gemma's BFS-or-DFS choice fork; do Gemma Scope 2 features read and steer it better than difference in means, random features and DAS?	gemma-3-4b-it bf16, one 16 GB RTX 2000 Ada; about 2.1 GPU hours of generation	USD 0.034
NLA experiment	Does the residual stream say in words which algorithm will be written, and can a verbal edit steer it?	Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct bf16 with the released layer-20 NLA pair, one 24 GB NVIDIA Ada GPU; about 2.0 GPU hours	about USD 2.0
Positioning audit	Set the iteration-6 claims against published work	Web search and quote checks	none recorded
DAS and plan-coordinate experiment	Stage B of the localization claim; the mediation, discreteness, resampling and temperature-coordinate tests; the causal manifold	Planned for Qwen3-8B bf16; lost at planning	not run

6.2 The record audit: corrections, engine tags and a second novelty adjudication

The record audit generated no model text. It recomputed from the row files of the earlier artifacts every number the review touched, tagged each internal result with the numerics that produced it, and wrote each change as a verbatim replacement keyed to the report. Of the values behind its corrections, 78 matched the record, 18 were new, 2 were carried from earlier evaluations and 1

was corrected: the power of the movability test, recorded as 0.46, is 0.63 for the registered one-sided test and 0.50 two-sided. A standard-library re-derivation passed 277 of 277 checks, its five placebos failed as they should, and a second script reproduced 7 of 7 headline numbers from the rawest files. Judge spend was USD 0.29 over four passes.

6.2.1 The corrections

Twenty-nine of the 36 corrections are applied in place in Sections 4 and 5 and marked as iteration-6 corrections. The seven that target the closing section are folded into the closing section, which is rewritten at the end of this iteration. The audit ran in parallel with the engine control, so its engine tags were written before the control's result existed; where the control supersedes them, the in-place text adds a pointer to Section 6.3. Three further notes of the same kind mark the frozen screen of Section 4.2.6, the movability paragraph of Section 5.10 and the caption of Table 222. Table 226 lists every correction.

Table 226. The 36 corrections of the iteration-5 record (values behind each: M match, N new, C carried, X corrected). Source: record audit `corrections.json`.

No.	Location	What changed	Values
1	Section 5.2, dose units	The two dose definitions (ratio of mean norms against mean of per-position ratios) reconciled per task	14 M, 6 N
2	Table 222 caption	The two plan-noise columns put on one definition	20 M
3	Section 5.10, movability paragraph	Shortest path counts restated per definition; dose-bracketed contrast and its tags	2 M, 5 N
4	Section 4.10, preamble	Engine class of iteration 4 named	1 N
5	Section 4.10, item 2	Same-seed contrast tagged as 8-bit only	1 C
6	Section 4.10, item 3	Site odds ratio tagged as 8-bit only	1 C
7	Section 4.10, item 4	Plan-noise prices tagged with their engine and unit	4 M
8	Closing	Internal claims that survive the engine change (folded into the new closing)	none
9	Closing	Dose bracket removes a scalar dose shortfall (folded)	none
10	Closing	Site claim tagged as 8-bit (folded)	none
11	Section 5.10, figure	The base-variety figure redrawn like for like under bf16	2 M
12	Section 5.11, item 2	Landing half moved to the descriptive results; tally per set and the twin-minority rival	7 M, 1 N
13	Section 5.11, item 2	Gemma fill rule; defined-only mean 1.57	2 M, 1 N
14	Section 5.12	Landing half restated as descriptive, with its tally	none
15	Closing	Landing tally per set (folded)	none
16	Section 5.10	Landing tally of 16 of 19 replaced by 17 of 21 per set	4 M
17	Table 129	Row label made explicit: counted on all 13 events	none
18	Table 129	Same, for the largest-excess row	none
19	Section 5.11, item 3	Three mixed instruct twins; two units where the twin is more diverse than the base	4 M
20	Table 203	Base support counts per panel B event	none
21	Table 214	Base support counts per Gemma unit	none
22	Table 217	Base support counts per Gemma landing event	none
23	Section 5.11, movability half	Interval, power and pooled rivals; verdict restated	1 M, 1 X, 1 N
24	Closing	Movability interval and power (folded)	none

25	Section 5.12	The shrinkage of the movable set: what is ruled out	none
26	Section 5.11, dead end	Plan noise as a knob tagged with its design	none
27	Table 206	Phrasing clusters per temperature in the literal cell	4 M, 1 N
28	After Table 208	Table 207b: prices at Hill-1 1.5 and 2 with bootstrap intervals	5 M
29	Section 5.5	Table 203b: panel B knob rows	2 M, 1 N
30	Table 126c	The three Llama present-minor ban rows completed	3 M
31	Section 5.11, item 4	Plan noise against matched decoding restated per task	2 M
32	Section 5.4 heading	Mixed instruct twins noted	none
33	Section 5.5 heading	Same note	none
34	Closing	Mixed instruct twins (folded)	none
35	Closing	Second novelty adjudication (folded)	2 M, 1 N
36	Section 4.9	Second novelty adjudication noted	none

6.2.2 Engine and dose

The two artifacts that the review compared recorded off-default shares on different definitions: the bf16 knob experiment counted correct programs off the default over all samples, the 8-bit plan-noise experiment valid attempts off the default over all samples. The dose definitions differ as well. Table 174 gave the ban-free unit as a ratio of mean norms, while the knob experiment measured a mean of per-position ratios, which is larger because a mean of ratios is not a ratio of means (Table 227). On the six decisive tasks, by either definition, the bf16 alpha-2 cell of iteration 5 delivered at least 1.24 ban units, so a dose-bracketed contrast sets it against the 8-bit alpha-1 cell, which delivered 1.00. A lower bf16 share in that comparison cannot come from a shortfall of the scalar dose.

Table 227. The ban-free unit as a fraction of the ban unit under the two definitions, and iteration 5's bf16 doses expressed in 8-bit ban units. Source: record audit `tables/dose_reconciliation.csv`.

Task	Ratio of mean norms (Table 174)	Mean of per-position ratios (knob experiment)	bf16 alpha 1 in ban units (two definitions)	bf16 alpha 2 in ban units (two definitions)
grid	0.751	0.874	0.75 / 0.87	1.50 / 1.75
shortest path	0.834	0.889	0.83 / 0.89	1.67 / 1.78
kth smallest	0.974	1.394	0.97 / 1.39	1.95 / 2.79
two sum	0.777	0.995	0.78 / 0.99	1.55 / 1.99
find duplicate	0.620	0.829	0.62 / 0.83	1.24 / 1.66
connected components	0.745	0.990	0.75 / 0.99	1.49 / 1.98
top-k frequent	0.699	0.924	0.70 / 0.92	1.40 / 1.85
first and last position	0.618	0.887	0.62 / 0.89	1.24 / 1.77
substring search	0.296	0.976	0.30 / 0.98	0.59 / 1.95
Fibonacci	0.885	1.234	0.88 / 1.23	1.77 / 2.47
longest increasing subsequence	0.803	1.061	0.80 / 1.06	1.61 / 2.12
merge intervals	0.951	1.365	0.95 / 1.37	1.90 / 2.73
nonoverlapping intervals	0.761	1.089	0.76 / 1.09	1.52 / 2.18

topological order	0.864	1.136	0.86 / 1.14	1.73 / 2.27

Table 228 gives the contrast under both share definitions. The rule, fixed before computing, tags a task as not replicated when the bf16 share falls short at the matched alpha of the 8-bit engine (Fisher p) and in the dose bracket. Connected components and shortest path meet it, kth smallest and the grid task do not, and two sum and find duplicate had no 8-bit effect of at least 10% at alpha 2 or less to replicate. These tags compare the design of iteration 5 (bf16 with the ban-free unit and fresh direction seeds) with the design of iteration 4 (the 8-bit engine with the ban unit); they cannot say which of the three differences (the numerics, the dose unit, the direction seeds) is responsible. Section 6.3 separates them.

Table 228. Per-sample plan noise, the bf16 cells of iteration 5 against the 8-bit cells of iteration 4, on two definitions (counts off the default over N). Source: record audit `tables/engine_pn_contrast.csv`.

Task	Definition	bf16 alpha 1	bf16 alpha 2	8-bit alpha 0.5	8-bit alpha 1	8-bit alpha 2	Fisher p, alpha 2	Bracket p (bf16 alpha 2 against 8-bit alpha 1)	Tag
kth smallest	correct only	4/49	14/50	4/50	14/50	23/47	0.039	0.588	not established
kth smallest	all samples	5/50	14/50	4/50	14/50	25/50	0.040	0.588	not established
connected components	correct only	1/50	1/50	0/50	6/50	30/50	7.2e-11	0.056	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level
connected components	all samples	1/50	1/50	0/50	6/50	30/50	7.2e-11	0.056	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level
shortest path	correct only	0/50	2/47	3/49	9/43	15/37	5.3e-05	0.017	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level
shortest path	all samples	0/50	5/50	4/50	13/50	27/50	4e-06	0.033	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level
two sum	correct only	0/50	2/50	0/50	0/50	1/50	1.000	1.000	not established (no 8-bit effect to replicate)
two sum	all samples	0/50	2/50	0/50	0/50	1/50	1.000	1.000	not established (no 8-bit effect to replicate)
grid	correct only	0/40	1/38	0/43	1/35	4/36	0.194	0.732	not established
grid	all samples	0/50	2/50	1/50	3/50	12/50	0.008	0.500	not established
find duplicate	correct only	0/30	0/30	0/50	0/50	0/49	1.000	1.000	not established (no 8-bit effect to replicate)
find duplicate	all samples	0/30	0/30	0/50	0/50	1/50	1.000	1.000	not established (no 8-bit effect to replicate)

The audit tagged 24 internal results of iterations 2 to 5 with the numerics that produced them (Table 229). Its tags were fixed before the engine control finished; the last column gives each tag's status after Section 6.3.

Table 229. Internal results by engine class, with the audit's tag and the status after the engine control. Source: record audit `tables/engine_labels.csv`; engine control `results/relabel_table.json`.

No.	Result	Engine class	bf16 counterpart (audit)	Audit tag	Status after Section 6.3
1	Plan-noise 5-point Hill-1 2.72 on kth smallest	8-bit W8A8	1.98 at the ban-free unit	not established	not rerun (kth smallest dropped from the engine control)
2	Plan-noise 5-point Hill-1 2.09 on connected components	8-bit W8A8	1.09; 1 of 50 correct off the default	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level	model property: at the absolute unit bf16 plan noise moves 25 of 50 valid attempts against 30 of 50
3	Plan noise moves shortest path 26% at alpha 1	8-bit W8A8	0 of 50 at alpha 1, 2 of 47 at alpha 2	did not replicate in bf16 at the population level	model property: 10 of 50 against 12 of 50 at alpha 1, 22 of 50 against 22 of 50 at alpha 2
4	Plan noise on the grid task, 0.24 at alpha 2	8-bit W8A8	1 of 38 correct	not established	not rerun
5	Site odds ratio 5.72	8-bit W8A8	none	8-bit only, untested in bf16	bf16 site rerun (Section 6.4.2): committed rule withdrawn; post-hoc model puts the read position below the task-specification site
6	Same-seed contrast, 17.25 of 20 seeds	8-bit W8A8	none	8-bit only, untested in bf16	not rerun; its per-sample plan noise reproduces in bf16 at the absolute unit
7	40-direction escape fractions	8-bit W8A8	8 bf16 directions at the ban-free unit: kth smallest 0.25, connected components 0.125, others 0	did not replicate on shortest path, two sum, grid and find duplicate; replicated, smaller, on kth smallest and connected components	model property on connected components (0.65 against 0.725) and shortest path (0.15 against 0.20) at the same 40 directions and absolute unit
8	Frozen screen: six movable tasks	8-bit W8A8	bf16 remeasure: two movable	did not replicate (4 of 6 tasks no longer movable)	the escapes behind it reproduce in bf16 at the absolute unit on the two tasks tested; the shrinkage belongs to the ban-free unit or its seeds
9	Plan-subspace tests	8-bit W8A8	none	8-bit only, untested in bf16	untested (the DAS experiment was not run)

10	Connected components screen escape from a bf16 direction	bf16	itself	bf16 result	unchanged
11	Pre-selected directions 9002 and 9004 move in both engines	8-bit and bf16	shortest path Dijkstra 31, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 19 under bf16 against 26 and 24	replicated in bf16	unchanged; direction 9004 also moves shortest path under every numerics (Section 6.3)
12	Plan noise against matched decoding, 19 against 3	bf16	itself	bf16 result	unchanged (13 of the 19 on kth smallest)
13	Transplant results	bf16	itself	bf16 result	unchanged
14	Read-position transplant breaks output without moving the algorithm	bf16	itself	bf16 result	unchanged
15	Route of a ban	bf16	itself	bf16 result	extended by the exchange of Section 6.4
16	Band patching on kth smallest and connected components	bf16	itself	bf16 result	extended by the exchange of Section 6.4
17	Literal cell, temperature null with thinking on	vLLM 8-bit floating-point W8A16 (weight only)	none needed	behaviour level, engine-robust	unchanged
18	Temperature changes phrasing, not the algorithm	vLLM 8-bit floating-point W8A16	bf16 temperature 1.3 cells show no diversity	behaviour level, engine-robust	unchanged
19	Llama knob rows	vLLM bf16	itself	bf16 result	unchanged
20	Novelty audits	sandboxed CPU scoring	not applicable	behaviour level, engine-robust	unchanged
21	Plan-sampler comparison disconfirmed	bf16	itself	bf16-conditional	conditional on iteration 5's ban-free unit and direction seeds, not on the numerics
22	Movability half	bf16	itself	bf16-conditional	same
23	Plan noise as the practical knob is a dead end	bf16	itself	bf16-conditional	same
24	Six screen-movable tasks shrank to two	bf16	itself	bf16-conditional	same

The figure of base-model variety against movability is redrawn like for like (correction in Section 5.10): the existing tasks at their bf16 escape fraction under the ban-free unit, with the 8-bit screen values as ghost markers, against the new units under the same design. Over the 15 existing tasks

Spearman is 0.59 (one-sided permutation p 0.010, Bonett-Wright 95% interval [126] from 0.06 to 0.86), against 0.79 with the 8-bit screen values; over the 13 new units it is 0.15 (p 0.315, interval from -0.44 to 0.65), 0.01 with the two reserve units; pooled over the 28 bf16 measurements it is 0.48 (p 0.005).

6.2.3 Landings

Table 230 restates every recorded push-landing event with its base support and the instruct twin's own composition. Per set, the base runner-up named the landing 5 of 5 times on the 8-bit screen, 1 of 2 on the bf16 remeasurement of existing tasks, 3 of 3 in panel A, 3 of 4 in panel B and 5 of 7 in Gemma, 17 of 21 in all (Poisson-binomial p 5.8e-7). On 6 of the 11 held-out hits the landing is also an algorithm the instruct twin already writes. Restricted to the 8 held-out events where the twin wrote no correct program off the default, the base runner-up named 5 (p 0.053; Qwen3-8B 3 of 4, p 0.052; Gemma 2 of 4, p 0.42). On the 7 events where the twin wrote any alternative, the twin's own most frequent alternative named the landing 6 times, as often as the base runner-up (exact McNemar p 1.0). The landing half therefore moves to the descriptive results: where the twin writes an alternative, the landing is that alternative, and the base model adds a forecast only where the twin writes none.

Table 230. Every recorded push-landing event: default, landing, base runner-up, the twin's correct composition, and the base support (valid attempts, correct programs, runner-up count among correct and among attempts). Source: record audit `tables/landing_events.csv`.

Set	Task	Default	Landing	Base runner-up	Hit	Twin correct composition	Base valid / correct	Runner-up among correct / attempts	Held out, twin wrote no alternative
8-bit screen	kth smallest	full sort	quickselect	quickselect	yes	full sort 50	65 / 47	13 / 19	not held out
8-bit screen	shortest path	Dijkstra	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	Bellman-Ford/SPFA	yes	Dijkstra 50	129 / 44	18 / 40	not held out
8-bit screen	two sum	hash map	brute force	brute force	yes	hash map 50	59 / 49	7 / 8	not held out
8-bit screen	connected components	union find	DFS	DFS	yes	union find 50	92 / 55	32 / 42	not held out
8-bit screen	grid	BFS	DFS	DFS	yes	BFS 37	112 / 14	4 / 38	not held out
bf16 remeasure	kth smallest	full sort	size-k heap	quickselect	no	full sort 49, quickselect 1	65 / 47	13 / 19	not held out (the twin writes quickselect once)
bf16 remeasure	connected components	union find	DFS	DFS	yes	union find 50	92 / 55	32 / 42	not held out
panel A	majority element	hash count	Boyer-Moore vote	Boyer-Moore vote	yes	hash count 50	38 / 29	12 / 14	yes

panel A	trapped rain water	prefix and suffix maxima	two pointers	two pointers	yes	prefix and suffix maxima 32, two pointers 18	37 / 22	5 / 6	no
panel A	longest mirrored substring	expand around centre	brute force	brute force	yes	expand around centre 50	39 / 28	8 / 13	yes
panel B	single number	hash count	XOR fold	XOR fold	yes	hash count 46, XOR fold 4	77 / 62	32 / 34	no
panel B	minimum spanning tree weight	Kruskal	Prim with heap	Prim with heap	yes	Kruskal 33, Prim 17	89 / 28	3 / 11	no
panel B	integer square root	binary search	linear scan	floating point sqrt	no	binary search 50	108 / 76	15 / 17	yes
panel B	count inversions	merge sort count	sorted insertion with bisect	sorted insertion with bisect	yes	merge sort count 3	87 / 15	2 / 5	yes
Gemma	grid	DFS	BFS	BFS	yes	DFS 30, BFS 10	73 / 0	0 / 4	no
Gemma	kth smallest	full sort	size-k heap	quickselect	no	full sort 50	51 / 14	0 / 6	yes
Gemma	substring search	naive	built-in find	built-in find	yes	naive 44, built-in find 6	55 / 18	13 / 26	no
Gemma	two sum	hash map	brute force	brute force	yes	hash map 50	55 / 13	7 / 14	yes
Gemma	connected components	DFS	union find	BFS	no	DFS 50	47 / 1	0 / 6	yes
Gemma	first and last position	linear scan	binary search	binary search	yes	linear scan 46, binary search 4	48 / 4	0 / 12	no
Gemma	longest increasing subsequence	patience sorting with bisect	quadratic DP	quadratic DP	yes	patience sorting with bisect 50	51 / 5	5 / 20	yes

Two units contradict the narrowing premise directly: on trapped rain water and minimum spanning tree weight the instruct twin is more diverse than the base model (twin off-default share 0.36 against a base off-default share of 0.23, and 0.34 against 0.11), and on both the landing is the twin's own minority.

6.2.4 Movability

The movability verdict is restated with its interval and power (correction in Section 5.11). Over the 13 new units, Spearman between the base off-default share and the escape fraction is 0.15, with a Bonett-Wright 95% interval from -0.44 to 0.65, a Fieller interval from -0.46 to 0.66, a BCa bootstrap interval from -0.50 to 0.70 and a one-sided permutation p of 0.317. At a true correlation of 0.6, the registered one-sided permutation test has power 0.63 (0.50 two-sided, the figure the record had quoted as 0.46), and 20 units would give 0.8. The data exclude a strong relation, not a moderate one. The pooled value also leans on one unit: count inversions' committed base share of 0.75 came from attempts, because only 15 base programs were correct and 58 of its 87 attempts

are labelled other; on the correct-only basis of the other twelve units its share is 0.13 and the pooled Spearman falls to 0.035. Table 231 lists every unit with its share on both bases and each rival under one definition.

Table 231. The 15 new units under one definition of each frozen rival (base share beta; escape fraction E; opening margin; novelty-instruction excess; twin modal share; catalogue size K; runtime merit, the natural log of the runtime of the default over that of the fastest reference). Source: record audit `tables/movability_units.csv`.

Unit	In the 13	beta (basis)	beta, correct only	E	Opening margin	Novelty excess	Twin modal share	K	Runtime merit	Twin off-default	Other share of base attempts
majority element	yes	0.414 (correct)	0.414	0.125	-8.72	0.00	1.00	7	2.19	0.00	n/a
maximum block sum	yes	0.000 (correct)	0.000	0.000	22.52	0.00	1.00	4	0.18	0.00	n/a
trapped rain water	yes	0.227 (correct)	0.227	0.4375	5.21	-0.36	0.64	4	2.43	0.36	n/a
count primes	yes	0.806 (correct)	0.806	0.000	-0.53	0.00	1.00	6	-1.68	0.00	n/a
longest common prefix	yes	0.300 (correct)	0.300	0.000	12.58	0.27	1.00	7	0.08	0.00	n/a
longest mirrored substring	yes	0.464 (correct)	0.464	0.1875	-36.88	0.00	1.00	4	2.34	0.00	n/a
jump game	no (reserve)	0.474 (correct)	0.474	0.000	3.54	0.00	1.00	3	-0.98	0.00	n/a
median of two sorted lists	no (reserve)	0.708 (correct)	0.708	0.000	17.77	0.20	1.00	4	0.95	0.00	n/a
missing number	yes	0.056 (correct)	0.056	0.000	3.58	0.00	1.00	5	-0.25	0.00	0.033
single number	yes	0.565 (correct)	0.565	0.4375	25.37	-0.08	0.92	4	0.27	0.08	0.078
minimum spanning tree weight	yes	0.107 (correct)	0.107	0.125	26.89	-0.07	0.66	4	-0.26	0.34	0.247
integer square root	yes	0.368 (correct)	0.368	0.125	13.99	0.00	1.00	6	0.35	0.00	0.083
all subsets	yes	0.370 (correct)	0.370	0.000	18.92	0.00	1.00	4	0.09	0.00	0.020
valid anagram	yes	0.806 (correct)	0.806	0.000	-7.57	0.76	0.76	3	0.20	0.24	0.072
count inversions	yes	0.747 (attempt)	0.133	0.3125	-8.85	0.33	1.00	4	0.39	0.00	0.667

The preregistered rule required beta to be ahead of each rival. Computed under one definition on the 13 units, with signs fixed so that the predicted direction is positive, only runtime merit tracks movability after Holm correction (Table 232), and the paired interval for beta minus runtime merit

still includes 0.

Table 232. The frozen rivals on the 13 new units: Spearman with the escape fraction, one-sided permutation p, the paired difference beta minus rival with its bootstrap 95% interval, and Holm p. Source: record audit `tables/rival_scores.csv`.

Rival	Predicted sign	Spearman with E	One-sided p	beta minus rival [95% CI]	Holm p
opening margin	negative	0.079	0.399	0.067 [-0.66, 0.88]	1.0
novelty-instruction excess	positive	-0.503	0.960	0.649 [-0.06, 1.34]	1.0
runtime merit	positive	0.713	0.004	-0.568 [-1.26, 0.20]	0.021
twin modal share	negative	0.409	0.087	-0.263 [-1.05, 0.56]	0.347
catalogue size	positive	-0.206	0.753	0.352 [-0.57, 1.24]	1.0

6.2.5 Executed outputs added to the record

The audit added the outputs the review listed, each in place and marked: the phrasing clusters per temperature in the literal cell (Table 206: 2/4/8, 3/3/10, 2/3/9 and 5/7/12 at theta 0.7/0.8/0.9 for temperatures 0.3, 0.7, 1.0 and 1.3, and 3/6/10 for the repeat at 0.7, so at $N = 20$ with thinking on a rise shows only at 1.3 and is the size of the repeat noise); Table 207b, the pass cost at which each knob first reaches a correct-only Hill-1 of 1.5 and of 2, with bootstrap intervals; Table 203b, panel B's knob rows, where on minimum spanning tree weight temperature 1.3 already gives Prim 18 of 49 correct programs against 20 of 50 under plan noise, because the twin itself is mixed; and the three Llama present-minor ban rows of Table 126c (Hill-1 2.87, 2.96 and 2.92 at pass costs of -12 to -27 points). Panel B's pushes stayed inside the base repertoire on 6 of 7 units; on count inversions 3 pushed programs implemented a Fenwick tree that the base model never wrote. Per task, plan noise against matched decoding at alpha 2 is 13:0 on kth smallest and 6:3 on the other four tasks together (p 0.508), with connected components at 1:3 (Table 233).

Table 233. Plan noise against decoding at matched per-token KL: slots correct and off the default under one arm only. Source: record audit `tables/pn_vs_dmd_discordant.csv`.

Task	Alpha 1: plan noise only / matched decoding only (exact p)	Alpha 2: plan noise only / matched decoding only (exact p)
kth smallest	3 / 0 (0.25)	13 / 0 (0.00024)
connected components	1 / 2 (1.0)	1 / 3 (0.625)
shortest path	0 / 1 (1.0)	2 / 0 (0.5)
two sum	0 / 0 (1.0)	2 / 0 (0.5)
grid	0 / 0 (1.0)	1 / 0 (1.0)
pooled	4 / 3 (1.0)	19 / 3 (0.00086)

6.2.6 A second blind adjudication of the 14 disputed programs

In iteration 5 two of three judges had called 14 of the 48 correct transplant programs outside the catalogue novel, and the zero count rested on a manual read by the executor. The audit stress-tested each program in a sandbox at the maximum size of the specification and on adversarial cases, retrieved its three nearest known solutions by Zhang-Shasha tree edit distance [64], and had two judges from model families the run had never used classify it blind: Mistral Medium 3.1 (three calls at temperature 0, Fleiss kappa [128] 1.00 across the calls) and Kimi (kimi-k2, Moonshot AI). Ten controls of known class were mixed in, and both judges passed the control gate at 9 of 10. All

14 programs pass their hidden tests; one, a repeated maximum selection on top-k frequent, times out at the maximum size. Mistral called 1 of 14 novel and Kimi 0 of 14 (Table 234). The one program called novel, a first-and-last-position solution, is range guards plus a linear scan to the first match and over its run; it passes 56 of 56 hidden tests and every stress group, and a full read by the executor classes it as a linear search. The final count is 0 novel of 14. Agreement with the manual verdict on the 14 is 0.86 raw (95% interval 0.57 to 0.98), Gwet's AC1 [127] 0.83 and a Cohen kappa of 0.71; with the controls included (24 items) kappa is 0.80 [0.57, 1.00]. The final read corrected one manual class: one first-and-last-position program, a linear scan plus a count of each element, is degenerate rather than a catalogue variant.

Table 234. The 14 disputed transplant programs: task, iteration-5 manual class, the majority class of Mistral Medium 3.1 (three calls), the class given by Kimi, and the final class. Source: record audit `tables/novelty_readjudication.csv`, `audit/final_read.json`.

Program	Task	Iteration-5 manual class	Mistral Medium 3.1	Kimi	Final class
1	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue (linear search)	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
2	first and last position	degenerate	degenerate	degenerate	degenerate
3	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
4	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
5	first and last position	catalogue variant	degenerate	degenerate	degenerate (corrected)
6	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	novel (3 of 3 calls)	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue (linear search)
7	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
8	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
9	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
10	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
11	first and last position	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue
12	connected components	catalogue variant	catalogue variant (union find)	known, outside the catalogue	catalogue variant
13	top-k frequent	catalogue variant	catalogue variant (sort by count)	catalogue variant	catalogue variant
14	top-k frequent	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue (binary search on a frequency threshold)	known, outside the catalogue	known, outside the catalogue

Across four judge passes the novel calls of Mistral on the 14 were 0, 0, 1 and 1, and those of Kimi 0 in every pass; the first two passes carried run-dependent timings in their prompts. No pass produced a novel call that survived a full read.

6.3 The engine control: are the random-push escapes a property of the model or of 8-bit rounding?

Why. The engine claim was the primary test of the iteration, because its answer decides which internal results of iteration 4 belong to Qwen3-8B. The review had pointed at a plausible mechanism without establishing it: a displacement changes the per-token absmax of each linear input, so under dynamic per-token 8-bit floating-point scaling it changes the rounding of every downstream activation, and the engine adds its own perturbation to the push. The 8-bit floating-point format in question is e4m3, with a maximum of 448 [115]. The engine control separated weight rounding from activation rounding by running iteration 4's own design under four numerics, all built from one bf16 snapshot of Qwen3-8B (Table 235).

Table 235. The four numerics of the engine control.

Engine	Weights	Activations	Role
W8A8	e4m3, per-output-channel absmax / 448	e4m3, per-token absmax / 448	iteration 4's engine (native 8-bit floating-point matrix multiply)
W8A16	e4m3, the same codes	bf16	weight rounding only
W16A8	bf16	e4m3, fake-quantised per token	activation rounding only
bf16	bf16	bf16	full-precision reference

Design. Everything except the numerics was held fixed: the 40 direction files of iteration 4 (seeds 9101 to 9140, checked bitwise), the absolute displacement per block and position at blocks 12 to 23 and the task-specification positions (the bench unit of iteration 4), the twin prompts, the common-random-number slots and uniforms, the stop rule, a 1,024-token cap, one labeller version (that of iteration 4 plus the iteration-5 re-gate that reads array-based Dijkstra correctly) applied to every row, and the two-stage escape rule of iteration 4, with each engine scored against its own twin. The W8A8 engine first regenerated the rows of iteration 4 on the same GPU model, driver and library versions: 400 of 400 programs of the plan-subspace experiment and 40 of 40 per-sample plan-noise programs came out byte-identical, the realised downstream displacement had ratio 1.000, and per-slot label agreement was 1.0. Under the reuse rule committed before sampling, the rows of iteration 4 therefore stand in for the W8A8 engine on every other cell. The bf16 twins reproduce the bf16 twin composition of iteration 5 (connected components union find 50 of 50; shortest path Dijkstra 49, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1). The direction screen ran at alpha 2 on connected components and shortest path, and per-sample plan noise at alpha 1 and 2; the alpha-1 direction arms of the two single-factor engines, a Gaussian mimic of the 8-bit noise and kth smallest were dropped by the committed drop order, and the W8A16 engine ran on a slower cast path because the fused kernel could not be compiled.

bf16 escapes on almost the same directions. At the same absolute displacement the bf16 engine escapes on 26 of 40 directions on connected components and 6 of 40 on shortest path, against 29 and 8 under W8A8 (Table 236). The direction-level discordance is 3:0 and 4:2 (exact McNemar p 0.25 and 0.69), the per-direction off-default shares rank alike (Spearman 0.96 and 0.87; kappa on escape 0.83 and 0.48), and permuting the pairing of directions drops kappa to about 0. The committed verdict on both tasks is the rule's outcome for a high escape fraction that 8-bit rounding does not explain: W8A8 minus bf16 is below 0.1 and bf16 is within 0.15 of iteration 4's escape fraction, so bf16 escapes too and the account specific to 8-bit rounding is not reproduced. Table 237 pairs every two engines direction by direction. The low escape fraction on shortest path is a pass-rate effect common to both engines: in each, 17 of 40 directions reach the $+0.20$ off-default excess but fail the pass clause, because the pushed Bellman-Ford/SPFA programs often fail the

hidden tests.

Table 236. Escape fraction at alpha 2 over 40 directions, each engine against its own twin (Wilson 95% intervals). Source: engine control `results/escape_by_engine.json`.

Task	Engine	Twin off-default (k/n)	Twin pass	Screen passes	Confirmed escapes	Escape fraction [95%]	Screen-level escape fraction
connected components	W8A8	0/50	1.00	30/40	29	0.725 [0.57, 0.84]	0.750
connected components	W8A16	0/50	1.00	28/40	27	incomplete (confirmation rows short of 30 for all 28 screen passers)	0.700
connected components	W16A8	0/50	1.00	27/40	24	0.600 [0.45, 0.74]	0.675
connected components	bf16	0/50	1.00	27/40	26	0.650 [0.50, 0.78]	0.675
shortest path	W8A8	0/50	1.00	15/40	8	0.200 [0.10, 0.35]	0.375
shortest path	W8A16	1/50	0.98	8/40	5	0.125 [0.05, 0.26]	0.200
shortest path	W16A8	1/50	1.00	8/40	6	0.150 [0.07, 0.29]	0.200
shortest path	bf16	1/50	0.98	9/40	6	0.150 [0.07, 0.29]	0.225

Table 237. Direction-paired contrasts of confirmed escapes (exact McNemar, Tango 90% interval, equivalence test at a margin of 0.1, kappa, and Spearman of the first-10 off-default shares). Source: engine control `results/mcnemar.json`.

Task	Pair	First escape fraction	Second escape fraction	Difference	Directions escaping under first only / second only	Two-sided p (Holm)	90% CI	Equivalent within 0.1	Kappa	Spearman of shares
connected components	W8A8 vs bf16	0.725	0.650	0.075	3 / 0	0.250 (1.000)	[0.01, 0.17]	no	0.83	0.96
connected components	W16A8 vs bf16	0.600	0.650	-0.050	1 / 3	0.625 (1.000)	[-0.15, 0.04]	no	0.79	0.96
connected components	W8A8 vs W16A8	0.725	0.600	0.125	5 / 0	0.062	[0.05, 0.24]	no	0.73	0.95
shortest path	W8A8 vs bf16	0.200	0.150	0.050	4 / 2	0.688 (1.000)	[-0.06, 0.17]	no	0.48	0.87
shortest path	W16A8 vs bf16	0.150	0.150	0.000	2 / 2	1.000 (1.000)	[-0.10, 0.10]	yes	0.61	0.90
shortest path	W8A16 vs bf16	0.125	0.150	-0.025	0 / 1	1.000 (1.000)	[-0.10, 0.04]	no	0.89	0.83
shortest path	W8A8 vs W16A8	0.200	0.150	0.050	4 / 2	0.688	[-0.06, 0.17]	no	0.48	0.81
shortest path	W8A8 vs W8A16	0.200	0.125	0.075	5 / 2	0.453	[-0.04, 0.20]	no	0.36	0.91

Per-sample plan noise reproduces in bf16 at the matched unit. On the slots, uniforms and per-

sample direction seeds that iteration 4 used, at the same absolute unit, bf16 plan noise moves connected components in 25 of 50 valid attempts at alpha 2 and shortest path in 22 of 50, against 30 and 22 under W8A8 (Table 238). The realised displacement at block 12, the first edited block, is 13.75 in the bf16 rows at alpha 2 and 13.76 in the rows of iteration 4. The bf16 plan noise of iteration 5 had moved connected components in 1 of 50 programs at alpha 1 and at alpha 2 on the same prompts and uniforms, but at the ban-free unit and with other direction seeds. The size of the push alone does not explain that null: the alpha-2 displacement of iteration 5 at block 12 (9.07) exceeds the bf16 alpha-1 displacement of this control (6.88), which still moves 7 of 50. The difference lies in the profile of the ban-free unit over positions and blocks, or in the direction seeds; which of the two matters was not tested.

Table 238. Per-sample plan noise per engine on the slots of iteration 4 at the absolute unit (valid attempts on a catalogue alternative to the default, over 50; programs labelled other are not counted). One labeller, including the iteration-5 re-gate of the shortest path rule, scores every engine, so the shortest path cells of iteration 4 read 12 and 22 of 50 here against 13 and 27 in the all-samples count of the audit (Table 228), which counts programs labelled other and predates the re-gate. Source: engine control `results/pn.json`, `data/samples.jsonl`.

Task	Arm	Iteration-4 8-bit rows	W8A8	W8A16	W16A8	bf16	Paired discordance W8A8 : bf16
connected components	alpha 1	6/50 (0.12)	6/50 (0.12)	9/50 (0.18)	4/50 (0.08)	7/50 (0.14)	1:2
connected components	alpha 2	30/50 (0.60)	30/50 (0.60)	27/50 (0.54)	22/50 (0.44)	25/50 (0.50)	6:1 (p 0.13)
shortest path	alpha 1	12/50 (0.24)	12/50 (0.24)	11/50 (0.22)	11/50 (0.22)	10/50 (0.20)	4:2
shortest path	alpha 2	22/50 (0.44)	22/50 (0.44)	19/50 (0.38)	18/50 (0.36)	22/50 (0.44)	8:8

[Figure fig_engine_escape: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The 8-bit engine adds a small boost on connected components, and activation rounding is not its source. Pairing every pushed sample with the same slot (direction, template, slot index and uniforms) in the other engine, on the 400 screen slots of the first two samples of all 40 directions, W8A8 is off the default in 58.3% of slots against 53.2% under bf16 on connected components (discordant 30:10, exact McNemar p 0.0022), and 43.2% against 40.7% on shortest path (55:45, p 0.37) (Table 239). The factorial locates the boost. Activation rounding alone (W16A8) sits slightly below bf16 on connected components (49.7% against 53.2%, 9:23, p 0.02); weight rounding alone (W8A16) sits between bf16 and W8A8 (55.6%; 17:7 against bf16, p 0.06). The small boost therefore comes from the e4m3 weights, from the native kernel's reduced-precision accumulation (it matches an exact fp64 reference on 94.2% of outputs, against 99.96% for an exact emulation), or from their interaction. The landing algorithms do not change: correct off-default programs are DFS, then BFS, on connected components and Bellman-Ford/SPFA on shortest path under every engine, with compositions compatible across engines (permutation chi-squared p 0.22 and 0.94; Table 240).

Table 239. Common-random-number pairs of screen slots under the alpha-2 pushes: off-default share under each engine, discordant slots and exact McNemar p. Source: engine control `results/slot_flips.json`.

Task	Pair	Slots	Off-default, first	Off-default, second	Discordant first : second	Exact p	Same label

connected components	W8A8 vs bf16	400	0.583	0.532	30:10	0.0022	0.873
connected components	W16A8 vs bf16	400	0.497	0.532	9:23	0.02	0.900
connected components	W8A16 vs bf16	399	0.556	0.531	17:7	0.064	0.925
connected components	W8A8 vs W16A8	400	0.583	0.497	45:11	5.4e-06	0.825
connected components	W8A8 vs W8A16	399	0.581	0.556	20:10	0.099	0.895
shortest path	W8A8 vs bf16	400	0.432	0.407	55:45	0.37	0.740
shortest path	W16A8 vs bf16	400	0.420	0.407	35:30	0.62	0.830
shortest path	W8A16 vs bf16	400	0.390	0.407	38:45	0.51	0.782
shortest path	W8A8 vs W16A8	400	0.432	0.420	57:52	0.70	0.723
shortest path	W8A8 vs W8A16	400	0.432	0.390	47:30	0.068	0.805

Table 240. Composition of correct off-default programs under every alpha-2 push, per engine. Source: engine control `results/landings.json`.

Task	W8A8	W8A16	W16A8	bf16
connected components	DFS 502, BFS 110	DFS 410, BFS 86	DFS 406, BFS 67	DFS 448, BFS 82
shortest path	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 165, Floyd-Warshall 1, other 1	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 137, Floyd-Warshall 2	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 129, other 1	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 120, Floyd-Warshall 1, other 1

Mechanism diagnostics. Per-token e4m3 rounding perturbs every linear input by about 2.5% RMS. Under an alpha-2 push, the push-induced difference in rounding error is 6% to 12% of the push-induced change in activation (median over blocks 13 to 35 per site, peaking at 34% at the block-14 attention input), and 70% to 100% of the rows the push moves receive a new per-token scale. Linear inputs at blocks 0 to 12 are bitwise identical in the pushed and the twin pass in every engine, as the edit site requires. The extra rounding barely changes how the push propagates: relative to bf16, the non-nominal part of the perturbation is 1.01 at the task-specification positions, 1.04 to 1.05 at the read position and 1.03 to 1.12 at generated tokens 1 to 32 under W16A8, and 0.995 to 1.006 under W8A16. Teacher-forced on 40 iteration-4 twin programs, every engine is very close to bf16 (Table 241). One preregistered fidelity check failed uninformatively: teacher forcing runs one long prefill instead of 20-row decode steps, which itself changes the numerics, so log probabilities of iteration 4's programs could not be matched closely enough to resolve engines at that level; the engine was validated instead by byte identity.

Table 241. Teacher-forced divergence from bf16 on 40 iteration-4 twin programs, and the failed fidelity check (median absolute difference between the summed log probability of a program and the value recorded in iteration 4). Source: engine control `results/diagnostics_summary.json`.

Engine Task	Mean per-token KL to bf16 (nats)	Argmax disagreement with bf16	Median absolute log-probability difference

W8A8	connected components	0.0036	0.0012	0.477
W8A8	shortest path	0.0015	0.0003	0.450
W8A16	connected components	0.0019	0.0000	0.315
W8A16	shortest path	0.0005	0.0003	0.703
W16A8	connected components	0.0017	0.0019	0.448
W16A8	shortest path	0.0011	0.0021	0.912
bf16	connected components	n/a	n/a	0.383
bf16	shortest path	n/a	n/a	0.679

What it changes. Table 242 assigns each earlier internal result to the numerics class that reproduces it. The 40-direction escape fractions, the per-sample plan-noise rates and the positive-control direction 9004 of the frozen screen are model properties. Only the per-slot off-default rate on connected components carries a significant 8-bit boost, of about 5 points. Iteration 5's bf16 plan-noise null and its finding that the shortest path task stops being movable in bf16 are not reproduced at the absolute unit; they belong to that design's unit and seeds. The plan-subspace claims of iteration 4 (the projection predictor, the targeted runner-up pushes, the decomposition) and the site and same-seed claims were not rerun here.

Table 242. Earlier internal results and the numerics class that reproduces them. Source: engine control `results/relabel_table.json`.

Earlier result	Class	Deciding cells
40-direction escape fraction, connected components, alpha 2 (iteration 4: 0.725)	model	escape fraction W8A8 0.725, W8A16 incomplete (screen level 0.70), W16A8 0.60, bf16 0.65
Per-sample plan noise, connected components, alpha 1 (iteration 4: 6/50)	model	shares 0.12, 0.18, 0.08, 0.14
Per-sample plan noise, connected components, alpha 2 (iteration 4: 30/50)	model	shares 0.60, 0.54, 0.44, 0.50
40-direction escape fraction, shortest path, alpha 2 (iteration 4: 0.200)	model	escape fraction 0.200, 0.125, 0.15, 0.15
Per-sample plan noise, shortest path, alpha 1 (iteration 4: 12/50)	model	shares 0.24, 0.22, 0.22, 0.20
Per-sample plan noise, shortest path, alpha 2 (iteration 4: 22/50)	model	shares 0.44, 0.38, 0.36, 0.44
Frozen-screen direction 9004 moves shortest path at alpha 1	model	first-10 off-default share W8A16 0.3, W16A8 0.4, bf16 0.3
Per-slot off-default rate under alpha-2 pushes, connected components	model plus a small 8-bit boost	W8A8 0.583 against bf16 0.532; discordant 30:10, p 0.0022
Per-slot off-default rate under alpha-2 pushes, shortest path	model	W8A8 0.432 against bf16 0.407; 55:45, p 0.37
Iteration 5's bf16 plan-noise null on connected components (1/50 at the ban-free unit; block-12 dose 0.66 of this unit)	unit and seeds, not reproduced at the absolute unit	bf16 25/50 and W8A8 30/50 at alpha 2
Iteration 5: shortest path no longer movable in bf16	not reproduced at the absolute unit	bf16 escape fraction 6/40 confirmed escapes
Site odds ratio 5.72	untested here	not rerun in this artifact

Same-seed agreement 17.25 of 20	untested here	not rerun
Plan-subspace projection predictor	untested here	not rerun
Targeted runner-up pushes	untested here	not rerun
Decomposition into subspace and orthogonal parts	untested here	not rerun

Novelty and checks. The two-judge novelty audit was replaced by a nearest-known-solution pass over all ten datasets of the declared source data (18,237 code solutions); Table 243 classes every distinct correct off-default or other program by its largest token-shingle Jaccard to a known solution. CPU gates checked the directions bitwise, the slots and seeds, the escape code (it reproduces iteration 4's escape file exactly) and the logged displacement (within 0.074% on all 1,770 iteration-4 prefills); the relabelling with the re-gated shortest path rule changed 18 iteration-4 labels and no escape fraction. GPU unit tests confirmed bitwise e4m3 codes, a bitwise twin at alpha 0, rerun identity, batch invariance for three rows or more and an exact match of the memory-capped sampler. A stdlib re-derivation and a separate audit from raw rows matched every headline, and a placebo that swaps engine labels was not significant. Judge spend was USD 0.085.

Table 243. Nearest known solution of the correct off-default and other programs per engine (distinct programs; median largest Jaccard; classes by Jaccard band). Source: engine control `results/known_solutions.json`.

Engine and task	Distinct programs	Median largest Jaccard	Variant	Distant	Known, close
W8A8, connected components	229	0.297	162	64	3
W8A8, shortest path	237	0.209	25	212	0
W8A16, connected components	186	0.291	137	47	2
W8A16, shortest path	162	0.215	14	148	0
W16A8, connected components	159	0.304	123	32	4
W16A8, shortest path	128	0.214	16	112	0
bf16, connected components	185	0.302	136	46	3
bf16, shortest path	134	0.214	14	120	0

6.4 Where a ban and an instruction are carried, and where noise acts, in bf16 (Qwen3-8B)

Why. The localization claim predicted, from the route classes of iterations 2 and 3, where the substitute of a ban is carried: in the task-specification states on the prompt-route tasks, at the condition span on the direct-route tasks. Stage A tests that prediction without any training, by moving the states themselves. The same experiment reran the iteration-4 noise-site comparison in bf16, set state noise at generated tokens against a temperature matched on per-token KL, applied the top-five plan push, and ran the landing contest. Everything ran in one bf16 engine with exact common random numbers on a 16 GB card, with the input embedding table kept in CPU memory; per-slot twin labels agreed with iteration 5's bf16 engine on 0.975 of slots for kth smallest and shortest path and 1.00 for the other tasks. Seven commitments formed an unbroken sha256 chain, and a standard-library script re-derived every headline from raw rows (295 checks, 0 mismatches) while a placebo version of each test failed.

6.4.1 Stage A: full-state exchange of the ban

We call a *full-state exchange* the replacement, in the forward pass of the neutral twin, of the residual states at a set of positions and blocks by the states the full ban prompt produces at the same positions; because the twin and the ban have identical token ids from the task text on, every task-

specification position aligns. The exchanges covered four block bands at the task-specification positions (0 to 11, 12 to 23, 24 to 35, 0 to 35), a splice of the key-value cache of the condition span (the direct route), and the read position at all 36 blocks. The controls were the twin, a matched-norm random exchange (the state of the twin plus a fresh random direction scaled to the displacement that the ban itself causes per slot, block and position), a placebo that takes a second neutral twin as the source, and an identity exchange. The outcome is the share of correct programs implementing the substitute Y of the ban; the *transfer* of a cell is its Y share minus that of the twin, and its *recovery* is the transfer divided by that of the full ban. Each cell has N = 30 on paired slots. Tables 244 to 249 give every cell on the six tasks.

The prediction held where the route data said it should, and failed at one task where they said it should not. On shortest path, exchanging the full ban's task-specification states at all blocks into the twin turns 24 of 30 slots from Dijkstra to Bellman-Ford/SPFA (transfer 0.80, McNemar 24:0, Holm p 7e-7, pass ratio 0.90), while the condition-span splice and the read-position exchange transfer nothing. Blocks 12 to 23 alone carry 0.60 and blocks 24 to 35 alone 0.37; blocks 0 to 11 carry none. On kth smallest the same exchange transfers 0.57 to quickselect with every slot leaving the full sort, blocks 0 to 11 alone already transfer 0.40, and here the condition span also carries the ban (0.93). On connected components every slot leaves union find under the exchange at blocks 12 to 23 or 0 to 35 (off-default transfer 1.00), but only 0.37 to 0.47 land on the ban's BFS and the rest on DFS. On the grid task, whose route was carried by the prompt states in likelihood and mixed in behaviour, the exchange at all blocks transfers 0.47 toward DFS and the condition-span splice 0.33, so each carries part of the ban. On the direct-route tasks the condition-span splice alone reproduces the ban (two sum 1.00, find duplicate 0.90), as predicted, but on two sum the task-specification states also transfer brute force at 0.43, above the predicted ceiling of 0.2. The committed verdict is therefore not supported. The secondary predictions hold: the condition span carries at least 0.5 on the direct-route tasks and at most 0.2 on shortest path, the read position carries at most 0.2 everywhere (it carries 0.00 on all six tasks), the placebo moves at most 0.03, and the exchange beats the matched-norm random exchange where it transfers (shortest path 23:0, kth smallest 16:2, connected components 11:0). The ban's information, not the size of the perturbation, is what moves the algorithm.

[Figure fig_exchange_transfer: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

Table 244. Stage A on kth smallest (default full sort; Y = quickselect; route class from iterations 2 and 3: either route suffices). Twin on slots 0 to 29: Y share 0.00, off-default 0.00, pass 1.00, full sort 30. Exchange at blocks 0-35 against the matched-norm random exchange: 16:2, exact p 0.0013 (Holm 0.0020). Source: exchange and site experiment `results/stage_a.json`, `results/summary.md`.

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	0.67 [0.47, 0.83]	0.67	1.00	0.93	1.00	1.00	20:0 (1.9e-06, 1.9e-06)	quickselect 18, size-k heap 10
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.40 [0.23, 0.59]	0.40	0.53	1.00	0.60	0.33	12:0 (4.9e-04, 0.003)	full sort 14, quickselect 12, size-k heap 4

exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.57 [0.37, 0.75]	0.57	1.00	0.93	0.85	0.90	17:0 (1.5e-05, 7.6e-05)	quickselect 15, size-k heap 13
exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.05	0.03	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	full sort 29, quickselect 1
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.57 [0.37, 0.75]	0.57	1.00	0.97	0.85	0.90	17:0 (1.5e-05, 7.6e-05)	quickselect 16, size-k heap 13
condition-span splice	30	0.93 [0.78, 0.99]	0.93	1.00	0.90	1.40	0.60	28:0 (7.5e-09, 3.7e-08)	quickselect 25, size-k heap 2
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	full sort 30
matched-norm random exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.10 [0.02, 0.27]	0.10	0.10	1.00	0.15	0.03	3:0 (0.250, 0.750)	full sort 27, quickselect 3
matched-norm random exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.13 [0.04, 0.31]	0.13	0.13	1.00	0.20	0.00	4:0 (0.125, 0.375)	full sort 26, quickselect 4
placebo twin	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.05	0.00	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	full sort 29, quickselect 1

Table 245. Stage A on connected components (default union find; Y = BFS). Twin: Y share 0.00, off-default 0.00, pass 1.00, union find 30. Exchange at blocks 0-35 against the matched-norm random exchange: 11:0, exact p 9.8e-4 (Holm 0.0020).

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	0.90 [0.73, 0.98]	0.90	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	27:0 (1.5e-08, 3.0e-08)	BFS 27, DFS 3
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.87	0.70	0.00	0.10	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	DFS 17, union find 4
exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.47 [0.28, 0.66]	0.47	1.00	1.00	0.52	0.43	14:0 (1.2e-04, 4.9e-04)	DFS 16, BFS 14
exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.63	1.00	0.00	0.10	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	DFS 19, union find 11
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.37 [0.20, 0.56]	0.37	1.00	1.00	0.41	0.40	11:0 (9.8e-04, 0.002)	DFS 19, BFS 11

condition-span splice	30	0.10 [0.02, 0.27]	0.10	1.00	1.00	0.11	0.20	3:0 (0.250, 0.500)	DFS 27, BFS 3
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	union find 30
matched-norm random exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.07	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	union find 28, DFS 2
matched-norm random exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.03	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	union find 29, DFS 1
placebo twin	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.03	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	union find 29, DFS 1

Table 246. Stage A on shortest path (default Dijkstra; Y = Bellman-Ford/SPFA; prompt route). Twin: Y share 0.00, off-default 0.00, pass 1.00, Dijkstra 30. Exchange at blocks 0-35 against the matched-norm random exchange: 23:0, exact p 2.4e-7 (Holm 7.2e-7).

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	0.97 [0.83, 1.00]	0.97	0.97	1.00	1.00	1.00	29:0 (3.7e-09, 1.5e-08)	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 29, Dijkstra 1
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.03	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 30
exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.60 [0.41, 0.77]	0.60	0.60	0.73	0.62	0.63	18:0 (7.6e-06, 4.6e-05)	Dijkstra 11, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 11
exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.37 [0.20, 0.56]	0.37	0.37	1.00	0.38	0.40	11:0 (9.8e-04, 0.006)	Dijkstra 19, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 11
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.80 [0.61, 0.92]	0.80	0.80	0.90	0.83	0.83	24:0 (1.2e-07, 7.2e-07)	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 21, Dijkstra 6
condition-span splice	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.03	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 30
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.03	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 30
matched-norm random exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	0.97	0.03	0.07	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 29

matched-norm random exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	0.93	0.03	0.07	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 28
placebo twin	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.03	0.07	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	Dijkstra 29, Bellman-Ford/ SPFA 1

Table 247. Stage A on two sum (default hash map; Y = brute force; direct route). Twin: Y share 0.00, pass 1.00, hash map 30.

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	1.00 [0.88, 1.00]	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	30:0 (1.9e-09, 1.1e-08)	brute force 30
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash map 30
exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.43 [0.25, 0.63]	0.43	0.43	1.00	0.43	0.43	13:0 (2.4e-04, 7.3e-04)	hash map 17, brute force 13
exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash map 30
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.43 [0.25, 0.63]	0.43	0.43	1.00	0.43	0.43	13:0 (2.4e-04, 7.3e-04)	hash map 17, brute force 13
condition-span splice	30	1.00 [0.88, 1.00]	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	1.00	30:0 (1.9e-09, 1.1e-08)	brute force 30
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash map 30

Table 248. Stage A on find duplicate (default hash set; Y = index marking; direct route). Twin: Y share 0.00, pass 1.00, hash set 30.

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	0.97 [0.83, 1.00]	0.97	1.00	0.87	1.00	1.00	29:0 (3.7e-09, 1.5e-08)	index marking 25, Floyd cycle detection 1
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash set 30
exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.10	1.00	0.00	0.03	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash set 27, Floyd cycle detection 3

exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash set 30
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.13	1.00	0.03	0.07	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash set 26, Floyd cycle detection 2, index marking 1, sort and adjacent check 1
condition-span splice	30	0.90 [0.73, 0.98]	0.90	0.90	0.97	0.93	0.90	27:0 (1.5e-08, 6.0e-08)	index marking 26, hash set 3
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	hash set 30

Table 249. Stage A on the grid task (default BFS; Y = DFS; prompt route in likelihood, mixed in behaviour). Twin: Y share 0.00, pass 0.90, BFS 27 correct. Pass ratios above 1 occur because the twin's own pass rate is below 1.

Cell	n	Y share [CP 95%]	Transfer	Off-default transfer	Pass ratio	Recovery	Slot interchange intervention accuracy	McNemar b:c (p, Holm)	Correct composition
full ban	30	1.00 [0.88, 1.00]	1.00	1.00	0.44	1.00	1.00	30:0 (1.9e-09, 1.1e-08)	DFS 12
exchange, blocks 0-11	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	1.11	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	BFS 30
exchange, blocks 12-23	30	0.37 [0.20, 0.56]	0.37	0.37	0.63	0.37	0.37	11:0 (9.8e-04, 0.002)	BFS 15, DFS 2
exchange, blocks 24-35	30	0.03 [8.4e-04, 0.17]	0.03	0.03	0.81	0.03	0.03	1:0 (1.000, 1.000)	BFS 22
exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.47 [0.28, 0.66]	0.47	0.47	0.59	0.47	0.47	14:0 (1.2e-04, 4.9e-04)	BFS 13, DFS 3
condition-span splice	30	0.33 [0.17, 0.53]	0.33	0.33	0.89	0.33	0.33	10:0 (0.002, 0.006)	BFS 17, DFS 7
read-position exchange	30	0.00 [0.00, 0.12]	0.00	0.00	0.96	0.00	0.00	0:0 (1.000, 1.000)	BFS 26

The condition-span splice also matches the behavioural route arms of iteration 3: its recovery is 1.00 on two sum and 0.93 on find duplicate, where the direct-route fraction of iteration 3 was 0.96 and 0.99, and 1.40 on kth smallest (direct-route fraction 0.74). On connected components its recovery toward BFS is 0.11, although every slot leaves union find: either route alone removes the default and lands on DFS, as the route landings of iteration 4 had shown.

Positive instructions are carried the same way. As an extension, the forced prompt `Implement Bellman-Ford or SPFA for this task.` replaced the ban as the source (Table 250). Its padding

twin, the same prompt with the tokens of the instruction replaced by padding, stays on Dijkstra in 29 of 30 programs; exchanging only the task-specification states of the forced prompt at all blocks into that twin gives Bellman-Ford/SPFA in 30 of 30. On connected components the states of the forced BFS prompt give BFS in 28 of 30 against union find 30 of 30 for its twin. The shortest path semantic seed, which moved that task 66 points in iteration 1, moved nothing under this frame (Dijkstra 30 of 30), and neither did its exchange (2 of 30). The fourth ban template, held out of every other cell, transfers through the exchange as the other templates do (shortest path 0.70, kth smallest 0.60 on quickselect with every slot off the full sort, connected components 0.70, N = 10 each).

Table 250. Extensions: forced sources, the semantic seed and the fourth template, each exchanged at blocks 0-35 into its own twin. Source: exchange and site experiment `results/summary.md`.

Task	Cell	n	Y share (Y) / default share	Off-default share	Pass	Composition
kth smallest	fourth-template ban	10	0.30 (quickselect) / 0.00	1.00	1.00	size-k heap 7, quickselect 3
kth smallest	fourth-template twin	10	0.00 / 1.00	0.00	1.00	full sort 10
kth smallest	fourth-template exchange, blocks 0-35	10	0.60 / 0.00	1.00	0.80	quickselect 6, size-k heap 4
connected components	fourth-template ban	10	0.80 (BFS) / 0.00	1.00	1.00	BFS 8, DFS 2
connected components	forced BFS	30	1.00 / 0.00	1.00	1.00	BFS 30
connected components	padding twin of forced BFS	30	0.00 / 1.00	0.00	1.00	union find 30
connected components	forced BFS exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.93 / 0.00	1.00	0.87	BFS 28, DFS 2
connected components	fourth-template twin	10	0.00 / 1.00	0.00	1.00	union find 10
connected components	fourth-template exchange, blocks 0-35	10	0.70 / 0.00	1.00	1.00	BFS 7, DFS 3
shortest path	fourth-template ban	10	0.70 (Bellman-Ford/SPFA) / 0.30	0.70	1.00	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7, Dijkstra 3
shortest path	forced Bellman-Ford or SPFA	30	1.00 / 0.00	1.00	0.90	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 30
shortest path	padding twin of the forced prompt	30	0.03 / 0.97	0.03	0.97	Dijkstra 29, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1
shortest path	forced exchange, blocks 0-35	30	1.00 / 0.00	1.00	1.00	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 30
shortest path	semantic seed	30	0.00 / 1.00	0.00	0.93	Dijkstra 30
shortest path	padding twin of the seed	30	0.03 / 0.97	0.03	0.97	Dijkstra 29, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 1
shortest path	seed exchange, blocks 0-35	30	0.07 / 0.93	0.07	0.87	Dijkstra 28, Bellman-Ford/SPFA 2
shortest path	fourth-template twin	10	0.00 / 1.00	0.00	1.00	Dijkstra 10
shortest path	fourth-template exchange, blocks 0-35	10	0.70 / 0.30	0.70	1.00	Bellman-Ford/SPFA 7, Dijkstra 3

The unit tests of Stage A passed except one: splicing the cache of the task-specification span reproduced the top token of the exchange with a logit gap of 0.5 in bf16 and 10 of 10 equal labels,

but not byte for byte. The Stage A arms on trapped rain water and minimum spanning tree weight were dropped for GPU time.

6.4.2 Where noise acts, in bf16

The site rerun repeated iteration 4's grid on kth smallest and connected components in bf16, at the ban-free unit, with a fresh direction per sample, N = 30 per cell and alpha 1, 2, 4 and 8 (Tables 251 and 252). Noise at the task-specification positions moves the algorithm in bf16: on kth smallest blocks 12 to 23 reach a correct off-default share of 0.37 at alpha 2, and on connected components blocks 0 to 11 reach 0.33 at alpha 4. The read position, the condition span and the late blocks barely move it below alpha 8. On kth smallest the plan site (the task-specification states at blocks 12 to 23, as in iteration 4) beats the read position in paired slots 24:5 (exact p 5.5e-4) and the condition span 22:0, and a Mantel-Haenszel odds ratio [129] within quintiles of the downstream displacement is 4.6 [1.9, 11.3]. Connected components shows a weaker picture: its plan site moves only 0.07 at alpha 2 and 0.17 at alpha 4, the early blocks beat it (4:18, p 0.004), and the read position starts moving at alpha 8 (0.30).

The committed rule fitted a Firth logistic regression [125] of a correct off-default program on site indicators and the log displacements, so that sites are compared at matched downstream displacement (Tables 253 and 254). It returned the verdict withdrawn, for two reasons. The raw condition-span arm never reaches the plan site's downstream displacement, so it has no common support and its energy-matched arm stood in; and at alpha 8 every plan-site program failed (pass 0.00) while the read position began to move, which erases the read-position contrast in the preregistered model. A post-hoc sensitivity restricted to alpha of 4 or less (before breakage) puts the read position clearly below the plan site on both tasks: beta -3.76 (profile interval [-7.29, -0.47], cluster bootstrap [-8.18, -1.40]) on kth smallest and -4.98 ([-9.77, -0.89]; [-11.48, -1.53]) on connected components. The prefill-site claim is therefore withdrawn as preregistered, and its post-hoc form survives in bf16 at the ban-free unit.

Table 251. The bf16 site grid on kth smallest (twin correct off-default 0.00; displacements are medians in residual units at block 35). Source: exchange and site experiment `results/site_grid.json`.

Site	Alpha	n	Correct off-default	Off-default	Pass	Median displacement at the read position, block 35	Median displacement at generated token 1, block 35	Correct composition
spec, blocks 12-23	1	30	0.13	0.13	1.00	1.708	1.315	full sort 26, quickselect 3, size-k heap 1
spec, blocks 12-23	2	30	0.37	0.37	1.00	3.353	2.478	full sort 19, quickselect 8, size-k heap 3
spec, blocks 12-23	4	30	0.33	0.40	0.87	6.293	4.628	full sort 16, size-k heap 5, quickselect 5
spec, blocks 12-23	8	30	0.00	0.10	0.00	12.230	7.135	-
read position	1	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	1.876	0.628	full sort 29, quickselect 1

read position	2	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	3.591	1.201	full sort 29, quickselect 1
read position	4	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	6.840	2.290	full sort 30
read position	8	30	0.13	0.13	0.93	10.654	3.466	full sort 24, quickselect 3, size-k heap 1
read position, energy-matched	2	30	0.07	0.07	0.77	16.426	3.870	full sort 21, quickselect 1, size-k heap 1
read position, energy-matched	4	30	0.03	0.07	0.93	25.287	3.845	full sort 27, heapify and pop 1
condition span	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.303	0.245	full sort 30
condition span	2	30	0.07	0.07	1.00	0.415	0.289	full sort 28, quickselect 2
condition span	4	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.674	0.424	full sort 29, quickselect 1
condition span	8	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.056	0.606	full sort 30
condition span, energy-matched	2	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.220	0.664	full sort 30
condition span, energy-matched	4	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.110	0.646	full sort 30
generated tokens 1-32	1	30	0.17	0.17	1.00	-	-	full sort 25, quickselect 5
generated tokens 1-32	2	50	0.26	0.34	0.94	-	-	full sort 33, quickselect 12, size-k heap 1, other 1
generated tokens 1-32	4	50	0.18	0.42	0.50	-	-	full sort 15, quickselect 4, heapify and pop 3, size-k heap 2
generated tokens 1-32	8	30	0.00	0.00	0.13	-	-	full sort 4
spec, blocks 0-11	1	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.956	0.728	full sort 29, quickselect 1
spec, blocks 0-11	2	30	0.17	0.17	1.00	1.832	1.320	full sort 25, quickselect 3, size-k heap 2

spec, blocks 0-11	4	30	0.37	0.37	1.00	3.576	2.512	full sort 19, size-k heap 9, quickselect 2
spec, blocks 0-11	8	30	0.00	0.13	0.10	16.027	8.332	full sort 3
spec, blocks 24-35	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.909	0.654	full sort 30
spec, blocks 24-35	2	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	1.777	1.261	full sort 29, size-k heap 1
spec, blocks 24-35	4	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	3.270	2.307	full sort 29, quickselect 1
spec, blocks 24-35	8	30	0.10	0.10	1.00	5.119	3.323	full sort 27, quickselect 3

Table 252. The bf16 site grid on connected components (twin correct off-default 0.00).

Site	Alpha n	Correct off-default	Off-default	Pass	Median displacement at the read position, block 35	Median displacement at generated token 1, block 35	Correct composition
spec, blocks 12-23	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.694	1.315	union find 30
spec, blocks 12-23	2	30	0.07	0.07	1.00	3.281	2.537	union find 28, DFS 2
spec, blocks 12-23	4	30	0.17	0.17	1.00	6.322	4.829	union find 25, DFS 3, BFS 2
spec, blocks 12-23	8	30	0.00	0.13	0.00	12.977	7.182	-
read position	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.800	0.606	union find 30
read position	2	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	3.700	1.197	union find 30
read position	4	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	7.200	2.234	union find 29, DFS 1
read position	8	30	0.30	0.30	0.93	10.392	3.645	union find 19, DFS 8, BFS 1
read position, energy-matched	2	30	0.03	0.03	0.77	15.570	4.091	union find 22, DFS 1
read position, energy-matched	4	30	0.07	0.07	0.83	22.781	4.019	union find 23, DFS 2
condition span	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.285	0.238	union find 30
condition span	2	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.395	0.278	union find 30
condition span	4	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.620	0.371	union find 30
condition span	8	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.931	0.557	union find 30

condition span, energy-matched	2	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.003	0.568	union find 30
condition span, energy-matched	4	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.163	0.618	union find 30
generated tokens 1-32	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	-	-	union find 30
generated tokens 1-32	2	50	0.14	0.20	0.92	-	-	union find 39, DFS 7
generated tokens 1-32	4	50	0.16	0.40	0.38	-	-	union find 11, DFS 6, BFS 2
generated tokens 1-32	8	30	0.00	0.00	0.17	-	-	union find 5
spec, blocks 0-11	1	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	0.910	0.747	union find 29, DFS 1
spec, blocks 0-11	2	30	0.20	0.20	1.00	1.717	1.308	union find 24, DFS 6
spec, blocks 0-11	4	30	0.33	0.37	0.97	3.315	2.467	union find 19, DFS 6, BFS 4
spec, blocks 0-11	8	30	0.13	0.33	0.13	16.291	9.122	BFS 3, DFS 1
spec, blocks 24-35	1	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	0.930	0.647	union find 30
spec, blocks 24-35	2	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	1.789	1.225	union find 30
spec, blocks 24-35	4	30	0.00	0.00	1.00	3.267	2.278	union find 30
spec, blocks 24-35	8	30	0.03	0.03	1.00	5.089	3.429	union find 29, DFS 1

Table 253. Firth logistic regression with site indicators on kth smallest at matched downstream displacement (n 387, 48 events, 387 of 720 rows in common support; the condition span enters through its energy-matched arm). Mantel-Haenszel odds ratio, plan site against read position, within quintiles of the log displacement at the read position: 4.61 [1.87, 11.34]. Paired flips, plan site only : other site only: read position 24:5 (p 5.5e-4), condition span 22:0 (p 4.8e-7), blocks 0-11 17:9 (p 0.169), blocks 24-35 23:3 (p 8.8e-5), generated tokens 21:18 (p 0.749).

Term	Beta	Profile 95% CI	Cluster bootstrap 95% CI
spec, blocks 0-11 (against spec, blocks 12-23)	0.24	[-0.54, 1.01]	-
spec, blocks 24-35	-1.52	[-2.74, -0.51]	-
read position	-0.17	[-2.64, 2.33]	[-2.58, 2.21]
condition span (energy-matched arm)	-0.73	[-5.71, 1.84]	[-2.12, 1.10]
log displacement at the read position	-1.92	[-4.76, 0.77]	-
log displacement at generated token 1	1.97	[-0.99, 5.03]	-

Table 254. Firth logistic regression with site indicators on connected components (n 374, 32 events, 376 of 720 rows in common support). Mantel-Haenszel odds ratio, plan site against read position: 0.82 [0.31, 2.18]. Paired flips, plan site only : other site only: read position 7:10 (p 0.629), condition span 7:0 (p 0.016), blocks 0-11 4:18 (p 0.004), blocks 24-35 7:1 (p 0.070), generated tokens 7:9 (p 0.804).

Term	Beta	Profile 95% CI	Cluster bootstrap 95% CI
spec, blocks 0-11 (against spec, blocks 12-23)	2.51	[1.39, 3.80]	-
spec, blocks 24-35	-0.72	[-3.03, 0.94]	-
read position	1.14	[-1.30, 3.64]	[-1.07, 3.24]
condition span (energy-matched arm)	2.38	[-2.72, 5.40]	[0.69, 5.18]
log displacement at the read position	0.02	[-2.94, 2.92]	-
log displacement at generated token 1	1.22	[-1.87, 4.36]	-

6.4.3 State noise at generated tokens against matched temperature

The token claim's second half set noise on the residual states of generated tokens 1 to 32 against a temperature applied to the same tokens and bisected to the same per-token KL, which we call decoding at matched departure (Table 255). At alpha 2 the state noise leads on discordant correct off-default flips, 12:6 on kth smallest and 7:3 on connected components, but neither is significant (p 0.24 and 0.34). At alpha 4 the lead on connected components reaches 8:1 (p 0.039), at a pass rate of 0.38 against 0.70. The rule (p below 0.05 on both tasks at alpha 2) is not met: state noise against token temperature is not established in bf16.

Table 255. State noise at generated tokens 1 to 32 against decoding at matched departure (N = 50 paired slots). Source: exchange and site experiment `results/state_vs_token.json`.

Task, alpha	State-noise KL per token (nats)	Matched temperature	Share of tokens with the temperature on	State only : temperature only	Exact p	State-noise flip share	Temperature flip share	State-noise pass	Temperature pass
kth smallest, alpha 2	0.3883	2.06	0.3762	12:6	0.238	0.26	0.14	0.94	0.98
kth smallest, alpha 4	2.3336	3.00	1.7734	8:3	0.227	0.18	0.08	0.50	0.82
connected components, alpha 2	0.2315	2.72	0.2310	7:3	0.344	0.14	0.06	0.92	0.92
connected components, alpha 4	3.0926	3.00	0.8178	8:1	0.039	0.16	0.02	0.38	0.70

6.4.4 The top-five push in bf16

On the grid task, iteration 4's top-five direction (from the mean of the five banned centroids toward the mean of the survivors) was applied at the plan site at alpha 1, 2, 4 and 8 (Table 256). It breaks programs before it moves the algorithm: the pass rate falls from 0.67 to 0.30, 0.03 and 0.00, with at most one correct program other than BFS per cell, so the landing test could not be computed. Projected onto the plane of the first two principal components of the ten forced-prompt centroids (36% and 25% of their variance), the push leaves the forced-prompt manifold: already at alpha 1 it moves farther along the first component than the whole spread of the ten centroids. The prompt version of the top-five ban moves the task-specification states from below the centroid cloud into it, between the banned DFS and greedy best-first centroids and the three surviving centroids (bidirectional BFS and two variants of A*), and its behaviour stays inside the banned set (BFS 25, DFS 23 of 50; avoidance 0.00).

Table 256. The top-five plan push and the prompt top-five ban on the grid task. Source: exchange and site experiment `results/top5_push.json`.

Cell	n	Pass	BFS share	Correct programs other than BFS	Landing test
twin	50	0.92	1.00	0	n/a
single BFS ban	30	0.40	0.00	12 (DFS 12)	n/a
top-five push, alpha 1	30	0.67	0.97	1 (DFS, banned)	not computable
top-five push, alpha 2	30	0.30	1.00	0	not computable
top-five push, alpha 4	30	0.03	0.97	0	not computable
top-five push, alpha 8	30	0.00	0.07	0	not computable
prompt top-five ban	50	0.62	0.50	10 (DFS 10, banned)	not computable

6.4.5 Who forecasts the landing

The landing contest scored, on the 21 recorded push-landing events, three forecasts: the base runner-up, the most frequent algorithm other than the default in the instruct twin itself (defined on 7 events), and a teacher-forced ranking of the openings of the catalogue algorithms by the instruct twin, the log-mean-exp likelihood of the first 48 tokens of each algorithm over its reference and forced programs, which we call the opening ranking (Table 257). The base runner-up named 17 of 21 landings and the opening ranking 10. On the 9 events where they disagree the base runner-up wins 8:1 (exact one-sided sign test p 0.020), and its mean log score is higher by 1.62 nats (Wilcoxon p 0.032). Where the twin wrote an alternative, its own minority does as well as the base runner-up (6 of 7; log-score difference 0.02, p 0.69). The comparison is retrospective, because the landings were known when the rule was frozen, and the opening ranking rests on 1 to 6 programs per algorithm. The base model adds information beyond the ranking of openings by the instruct model itself; it does not add information beyond the minority algorithm of the twin where one exists.

Table 257. The 21 recorded push-landing events: the landing and each forecast's top-1, with log scores (base runner-up / opening ranking / twin minority). Source: exchange and site experiment `results/landing_forecast.json`.

Event	Landing	Base runner-up	Twin minority	Opening ranking	Log score base / opening / twin
Qwen3-8B 8-bit screen, kth smallest	quickselect	quickselect (hit)	n/a	quickselect (hit)	-1.36 / -1.67 / n/a
Qwen3-8B 8-bit screen, connected components	DFS	DFS (hit)	n/a	DFS (hit)	-0.84 / -0.78 / n/a
Qwen3-8B 8-bit screen, shortest path	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA	Bellman-Ford/ SPFA (hit)	n/a	Floyd-Warshall (miss)	-0.96 / -4.59 / n/a
Qwen3-8B 8-bit screen, two sum	brute force	brute force (hit)	n/a	brute force (hit)	-0.73 / -0.05 / n/a
Qwen3-8B 8-bit screen, grid	DFS	DFS (hit)	n/a	bidirectional BFS (miss)	-1.14 / -1.14 / n/a
Qwen3-8B bf16, kth smallest	size-k heap	quickselect (miss)	quickselect (miss)	quickselect (miss)	-1.50 / -2.64 / -1.50
Qwen3-8B bf16, connected components	DFS	DFS (hit)	n/a	DFS (hit)	-0.73 / -0.05 / n/a
panel A, majority element	Boyer-Moore vote	Boyer-Moore vote (hit)	n/a	sort and take middle (miss)	-0.38 / -4.95 / n/a
panel A, trapped rain water	two pointers	two pointers (hit)	two pointers (hit)	monotonic stack (miss)	-0.33 / -4.38 / -0.14

panel A, longest mirrored substring	brute force	brute force (hit)	n/a	brute force (hit)	-0.69 / -0.97 / n/a
panel B, single number	XOR fold	XOR fold (hit)	XOR fold (hit)	set-sum identity (miss)	-0.18 / -4.39 / -0.38
panel B, minimum spanning tree weight	Prim with heap	Prim with heap (hit)	Prim with heap (hit)	Prim with heap (hit)	-0.44 / -0.05 / -0.15
panel B, integer square root	linear scan	floating point sqrt (miss)	n/a	linear scan (hit)	-1.13 / -0.56 / n/a
panel B, count inversions	sorted insertion with bisect	sorted insertion with bisect (hit)	n/a	segment tree (miss)	-0.59 / -4.37 / n/a
Gemma, grid	BFS	BFS (hit)	BFS (hit)	bidirectional BFS (miss)	-0.42 / -4.53 / -0.23
Gemma, kth smallest	size-k heap	quickselect (miss)	n/a	quickselect (miss)	-1.70 / -4.80 / n/a
Gemma, substring search	built-in find	built-in find (hit)	built-in find (hit)	built-in find (hit)	-0.13 / -0.05 / -0.50
Gemma, two sum	brute force	brute force (hit)	n/a	brute force (hit)	-0.48 / -0.05 / n/a
Gemma, connected components	union find	BFS (miss)	n/a	BFS (miss)	-0.96 / -4.39 / n/a
Gemma, first and last position	binary search	binary search (hit)	binary search (hit)	exponential search (miss)	-0.12 / -4.38 / -0.38
Gemma, longest increasing subsequence	quadratic DP	quadratic DP (hit)	n/a	quadratic DP (hit)	-0.06 / -0.04 / n/a

Per set the base runner-up hit 5 of 5 on the 8-bit screen, 7 of 9 on the bf16 Qwen3-8B events and 5 of 7 in Gemma; the opening ranking hit 3 of 5, 4 of 9 and 3 of 7. Two correct programs labelled other appeared in the whole experiment, both catalogue variants. Judge spend was USD 0.055.

6.5 Gemma: a one-token fork, and Gemma Scope 2 features against difference in means

Why Gemma. Asked one and the same grid-path prompt, gemma-3-4b-it [76] writes DFS about 70% of the time and BFS about 30%, so it offers what Qwen3-8B never does: the request's BFS-against-DFS contrast inside one prompt, with no ban or instruction to confound it. Gemma Scope 2 provides sparse autoencoders on the residual stream after each block, trained on this instruct model, so the feature claim needs no transfer test. Qwen-3 transcoders for circuit tracing exist as well [123], but they would have to study a choice Qwen3-8B does not make naturally. The experiment asked where the choice forks, whether it can be read from the internals beyond what the visible text already says, and whether the SAE features steer it better than plain baselines: a difference-in-means direction, the raw residual, random features, isotropic directions, DAS and prompting. It used the residual-stream SAEs at layers 9, 17, 22 and 29 (16k latents, at the release's medium sparsity), one 16 GB card and exact common random numbers, under two hash-chained commitments.

Natural splits. Over 200 samples per task, the grid prompt gave DFS 139 and BFS 61 (Wilson interval for DFS 0.63 to 0.75), with DFS on 134 of 172 correct programs (Table 258). The choice depends on the template: BFS takes 6 to 18 of 40 attempts per template. Substring search (naive 173, built-in find 27) and first and last position (linear scan 170, binary search 29) split as well. Labels agreed with iteration 5's Gemma rows on 0.94 of the grid slots and 1.00 of the substring

slots.

Table 258. Natural splits in gemma-3-4b-it (N = 200 per task; 40 per template). Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/natural_split.json`.

Task	Attempted	Correct	Pass	Correct-only Hill-1	Default (share of correct)	Attempted per template (first to fifth)
grid	DFS 139, BFS 61	DFS 134, BFS 38	0.86	1.68	DFS (0.78)	DFS 34 / BFS 6; DFS 22 / BFS 18; DFS 22 / BFS 18; DFS 29 / BFS 11; DFS 32 / BFS 8
substring search	naive 173, built-in find 27	same	1.00	1.47	naive (0.87)	naive 36 / built-in 4; naive 40; built-in 21 / naive 19; naive 38 / built-in 2; naive 40
first and last position	linear scan 170, binary search 29, other 1	same	1.00	1.52	linear scan (0.85)	linear 33 / binary 7; linear 28 / binary 12; linear 39 / other 1; linear 40; linear 30 / binary 10

The instrument gate. Each SAE was spliced into the forward pass on three corpora: the model's own programs, generic text and LeetCode prompts. A layer passed if its increase in cross-entropy and its fraction of variance unexplained on the model's programs were at most 1.5 times those on generic text (Table 259). Layers 22 and 29 passed; layer 9 failed the cross-entropy ratio and layer 17 the variance ratio by 0.0001, so their results are descriptive. On generic text the mean number of active latents per token was 57 to 64, slightly above the quoted medium band of 30 to 60.

Table 259. Gemma Scope 2 residual-stream SAEs spliced in on three corpora (the model's own programs / generic text / LeetCode prompts): mean active latents per token, fraction of variance explained, increase in cross-entropy (nats per token) and loss recovered. Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/gate.json`.

Layer	Active latents per token	Fraction of variance explained	Increase in cross-entropy	Loss recovered	Gate
9	52.2 / 57.5 / 57.3	0.963 / 0.974 / 0.917	0.065 / 0.033 / -0.010	0.9968 / 0.9983 / 1.0005	fail
17	59.9 / 64.1 / 61.4	0.919 / 0.946 / 0.814	0.097 / 0.184 / 0.119	0.9968 / 0.9936 / 0.9957	fail (variance ratio, by 0.0001)
22	60.0 / 61.7 / 62.2	0.809 / 0.869 / 0.750	0.036 / 0.259 / 0.167	0.9968 / 0.9789 / 0.9837	pass
29	64.1 / 64.1 / 69.5	0.637 / 0.715 / 0.635	0.017 / 0.212 / 0.142	0.9994 / 0.9932 / 0.9952	pass

The plan is a single-token fork. Prefix resampling with change-point detection, the method of forking-path analyses [30, 31], located the fork: 24 base paths, 16 prefix lengths, 8 continuations each and a refinement, 3,712 continuations in all, scored by a partial-code labeller that agreed with the full labeller on 200 of 200 programs. Every one of 12 BFS base paths had a significant change point with a rise of at least 0.4, at prefix lengths 16 to 36. In 177 of 200 programs the first 32 tokens are identical (the code fence, `def solve(grid, start, goal):`, `rows = len(grid)`, `cols = len(grid[0])` and an indent), and the next token decides (Table 260): `visited` leads to DFS (BFS probability 0.011 over 1,409 continuations), while a blank line, `if`, `queue` or `q` lead to BFS (0.95 to 1.00). The first token that identifies the algorithm in code comes a median of 138 tokens after the fork (10th to 90th percentile 80 to 181). The fork index was chosen by the token class with the most mutual information with the outcome (0.62 bits at index 32), after the first median rule landed on a deterministic indentation token; the change was made before the second

commitment.

Table 260. The fork token at response index 32 and the BFS probability of the continuations that follow it (all continuations; the natural samples alone in the last column). Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/fork.json`.

Token at index 32	Continuations	BFS	DFS	BFS probability	Natural samples (BFS / n)
`visited`	1,409	15	1,394	0.011	2 / 134
newline	204	193	11	0.946	19 / 21
`if`	177	174	2	0.989	16 / 17
`queue`	82	82	0	1.000	4 / 4
`q`	3	3	0	1.000	1 / 1

Readable beyond the text, at the fork, but not specifically through the SAE. Within one prompt, decodability before the first identifying token is at ceiling for every method, the visible-text control included (balanced accuracy 1.00 at all four layers), so the SAE has no advantage there; at the fork itself the test is undefined, because 185 of 200 samples share their prefix with a sample of the other class. Across prompts, the experiment built 120 neutral prompt variants by changing nouns and measured each variant's fork log-odds of BFS, which we write y (mean -0.92 nats, SD 0.67; the sampled BFS share tracks it at Spearman 0.65 over 60 variants of 10 samples). A Lasso on layer-29 SAE codes at the fork position predicts held-out y with R-squared 0.66, against 0.18 for a text-only model (difference 0.49, 95% interval 0.26 to 0.65, permutation p 0.003), above the difference-in-means readout (0.34) and a 16-component PCA of the raw residual (0.56) (Table 261). That meets the preregistered bar. Two checks outside the preregistration qualify it: a tuned ridge on the raw layer-29 residual reaches 0.72, and ridge on the same SAE codes reaches at most 0.09. The information is in the residual stream at the fork, and the SAE advantage depends on the estimator. At the task-specification positions, before any response token, the SAE codes do no better than the text (0.18).

Table 261. Cross-prompt readout of the fork log-odds over 120 neutral variants: R-squared with held-out nouns, Spearman with held-out nouns, and R-squared with held-out templates. Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/readout.json`.

Readout	Site	Layer	R-squared, held-out nouns	Spearman, held-out nouns	R-squared, held-out templates
text only	n/a	n/a	0.176	0.425	0.150
template only	n/a	n/a	0.148	0.272	-0.122
SAE codes (Lasso)	fork	22	0.237	0.583	0.139
raw PCA-16	fork	22	0.412	0.666	0.491
raw PCA-64	fork	22	0.092	0.533	0.239
difference in means	fork	22	0.226	0.541	0.109
SAE codes (Lasso)	task specification	22	0.180	0.464	0.123
raw PCA-16	task specification	22	-0.090	0.354	0.352
raw PCA-64	task specification	22	0.021	0.432	0.152
difference in means	task specification	22	0.063	0.282	-0.570

SAE codes (Lasso)	fork	29	0.662	0.782	0.496
raw PCA-16	fork	29	0.557	0.697	0.444
raw PCA-64	fork	29	0.432	0.715	0.403
difference in means	fork	29	0.338	0.620	0.181
SAE codes (Lasso)	task specification	29	-0.073	0.276	0.147
raw PCA-16	task specification	29	-0.602	0.194	-0.062
raw PCA-64	task specification	29	0.029	0.381	0.083
difference in means	task specification	29	0.064	0.302	-0.438

Steering: the features move the fork, difference in means moves it more, and every fork edit breaks programs. We call an *SAE clamp* setting the k latents that best separate forced-BFS from forced-DFS prompts (input-selected) to their BFS-class mean at the fork position; output-scored latents are chosen instead by their attribution to the fork's logit difference, and the two sets of 20 share 2 latents. At the fork position of layer 22, edits at matched norm moved y by $+4.04$ nats for the difference-in-means direction, $+1.78$ for the SAE clamp of the top 20 input-selected latents, $+0.51$ for 20 random latents and $+0.12$ for an isotropic direction. Table 261b gives the whole dose-response sweep over the 120 prompt variants (11,280 measurements), at the fork and at the task-specification positions. In generation ($N = 50$ paired slots), the twin wrote BFS in 13 programs; the SAE clamp raised this to 30 (top 20 latents) and 36 (top 50), the difference-in-means edit at the same norm to 46 and 49, and random latents to 21 (Table 262). Every edit at the fork lowered the pass rate, from 0.84 for the twin to 0.58 and 0.48 for the SAE clamps and 0.32 and 0.16 for difference in means, so the preregistered outcome, correct BFS programs, shows no significant effect anywhere after Holm correction, and no feature claim is made. The preregistered feature rule (SAE target-correct count at least the difference-in-means count, at a pass rate of at least 0.8 times the twin's) is also met by random latents at $k = 50$ (9 against 7, pass 0.76), so it cannot discriminate here. The informative comparisons are on attempted BFS, and they are descriptive: the SAE clamp beats the twin (17:0 and 23:0 discordant slots, p 1.5e-5 and 2.4e-7) and random latents (15:0, p 6.1e-5), and difference in means beats the SAE clamp at matched norm (16:0, p 3.1e-5). At matched effect on y rather than matched norm, difference in means and the SAE clamp shift the plan equally (32 against 30 BFS, p 0.50; 34 against 36, p 0.63) and difference in means keeps slightly more programs correct (13 against 9, 14 against 10). Edits at the task-specification positions do nothing (12 to 19 BFS against 13). Steering toward DFS works cleanly for both (SAE 47 of 50, difference in means 50 of 50, against 37 for the twin; pass 0.98 to 1.00). Difference-in-means steering of a code model's choice of language and library has shown the same trade-off, with overly strong interventions reducing output quality [130]. AxBench found simple baselines ahead of SAE steering [34], and a 2026 reanalysis puts SAEs close to AxBench's reference when latents are selected and labelled by a supervised pipeline [131]; here, at comparable norms, neither the input-selected nor the output-scored clamp reached the difference-in-means edit (Table 261b).

Table 261b. Mean change in the fork log-odds of BFS (nats) under each edit at layer 22, by number of latents k and dose lambda; the difference-in-means, random and isotropic edits are scaled to the norm of the input-selected clamp with the same k. Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/logit_sweep_summary.json`.

Edit	Latents (k)	Fork, lambda 0.5	Fork, lambda 1	Fork, lambda 2	Task specification, lambda 0.5	Task specification, lambda 1	Task specification, lambda 2
SAE clamp, input-selected	5	0.52	0.98	1.97	0.09	0.11	0.11
SAE clamp, input-selected	20	0.87	1.78	3.76	0.12	0.12	0.22
SAE clamp, input-selected	50	1.09	2.26	4.47	0.08	0.10	0.20
SAE clamp, output-scored	5	0.66	1.33	2.69	0.16	0.20	0.28
SAE clamp, output-scored	20	0.74	1.35	2.65	0.17	0.22	0.21
SAE clamp, output-scored	50	1.38	2.94	6.07	0.23	0.32	0.37
difference in means (norm of the input-selected clamp)	5	1.05	2.04	4.14	0.09	0.09	0.08
difference in means (norm of the input-selected clamp)	20	1.98	4.04	7.93	0.41	0.70	1.29
difference in means (norm of the input-selected clamp)	50	3.53	7.08	12.22	0.44	0.76	1.35
random latents (same norm)	5	-0.14	-0.37	-0.73	0.08	0.10	0.12
random latents (same norm)	20	0.26	0.51	1.26	0.04	0.01	-0.01
random latents (same norm)	50	0.32	0.89	2.65	0.18	0.31	0.54
isotropic direction (same norm)	5	0.06	0.11	0.13	0.07	0.04	0.02
isotropic direction (same norm)	20	0.07	0.12	0.26	-0.16	-0.37	-0.78
isotropic direction (same norm)	50	0.12	0.23	0.18	-0.19	-0.42	-0.81
SAE clamp with ban-contrast latents	20	n/a	0.95	n/a	n/a	0.09	n/a
SAE clamp, input-selected, layer 29	20	n/a	0.63	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a

Table 262. Generation under edits at the fork (layer 22) and at the task-specification positions (N = 50 paired slots; BFS is the target). Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/clamps.json`.

Site	Edit	Mean realised norm	Attempted BFS	Correct BFS	Pass
none	twin	0	13	6	0.84
fork	SAE clamp, top 5 input-selected latents	307.9	18	10	0.84
fork	SAE clamp, top 20 input-selected latents	602.2	30	9	0.58
fork	SAE clamp, top 50 input-selected latents	1069.8	36	10	0.48
fork	difference in means at the top-20 norm	602.2	46	12	0.32
fork	difference in means at the top-50 norm	1069.8	49	7	0.16
fork	50 random latents at the same norm	1069.8	21	9	0.76
fork	SAE clamp, top 20 output-scored latents	673.5	25	14	0.78
fork	difference in means matched on effect, top-20 level	270.6	32	13	0.62
fork	difference in means matched on effect, top-50 level	342.9	34	14	0.60
fork	DAS rank-4 interchange	496.0	50	0	0.00
fork	ablation of the top 5 attribution nodes (N = 30)	1004.7	29	0	0.03
fork	steering with the top 5 attribution nodes (N = 30)	115.5	19	12	0.73
task specification	SAE clamp, top 5	4.1	14	6	0.84
task specification	SAE clamp, top 20	92.4	12	4	0.82
task specification	SAE clamp, top 50	104.9	15	5	0.80
task specification	difference in means at the top-20 norm	92.4	17	9	0.84
task specification	difference in means at the top-50 norm	104.9	19	9	0.80
task specification	50 random features	104.9	15	9	0.88
fork, toward DFS	SAE clamp, top 20	1170.1	3 (47 DFS, all correct)	n/a	0.98
fork, toward DFS	difference in means	1170.1	0 (50 DFS, all correct)	n/a	1.00

[Figure fig_gemma_steer: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

DAS finds the choice in one direction at the fork, and forcing it breaks the program. DAS at the fork position of layer 22, with forced-BFS prompts as sources, moved held-out y by $+8.8$, $+9.5$ and $+9.8$ nats at ranks 1, 2 and 4, against -0.08 to $+0.05$ for random subspaces of the same rank (Table 263). The shuffled-source control was uninformative as built, because every source was a forced-BFS prompt. In generation the rank-4 interchange made 50 of 50 programs BFS and 0 of 50 passed. Together with the difference-in-means result, this says that the plan is close to one direction

at one position, and that pushing it hard costs correctness, as subspace interventions can when they leave the model's natural range [122].

Table 263. DAS at the fork (layer 22): mean change in the fork log-odds of BFS on held-out and training prompts. Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/das.json`.

Rank	DAS, held out	DAS, train	Share of held-out prompts moved toward BFS	Random subspace, held out	Shuffled source, held out
1	8.81	9.55	1.00	-0.08	10.11
2	9.51	10.15	1.00	0.03	9.69
4	9.76	10.25	1.00	0.05	11.42

The planned transcoder attribution graph was the first item of the drop order and was not built; a first-order attribution on the residual-stream SAEs replaced it (Table 264). Ablating the two strongest nodes moved y by 4.0 and 6.3 nats, against 0.8 and 0.4 for random active latents at matched contribution; two of the other three beat random and one did not. Jointly ablating the five nodes turned 29 of 30 programs into BFS with none passing, and jointly steering with them gave 19 BFS of 30, 12 correct.

Table 264. First-order attribution nodes at the fork, validated by ablation and steering in the real model (mean change in y, against random active latents at matched contribution). Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/attribution.json`.

Layer	Latent	Attribution score	Ablation	Random ablation	Steering	Random steering
22	1774	-4.68	4.01	0.78	0.55	0.07
29	15050	-4.35	6.28	0.40	0.45	0.11
29	735	4.11	-0.51	0.40	1.38	0.09
29	6026	3.95	-0.95	0.51	0.14	0.09
22	142	3.79	-1.26	2.10	0.24	0.09

The top-five prohibition in a model that writes two algorithms. Banning the five most common grid algorithms (BFS, DFS, IDDFS, A* and greedy best-first, which share one catalogue label here) left no program outside the banned set: avoidance 0.00, as in Qwen3-8B in iteration 2 (Table 265). The ban pushed Gemma from its default DFS to BFS (10 to 41 of 50; McNemar 32:1, p 7.9e-9) and cut the pass rate from 0.86 to 0.38. In actual activation coordinates (PCA, Isomap with $k = 10$ and classical MDS of layers 17 and 22, raw and SAE codes), the top-five prompt states sit next to the banned A* and greedy cluster (Table 266); among all 15 ways of splitting the six catalogue centroids into four banned and two survivors, the observed split ranks first in three of the four spaces (rank share 0.067) and third in the fourth (0.20). The prohibition lands inside the banned region, not at its edge or on the opposite side. The single-name bans of BFS and DFS left the banned algorithm in 11 and 8 of 50 programs, and the forced prompts gave BFS 50 of 50 (38 correct) and DFS 50 of 50 (45 correct).

Table 265. Bans and forced prompts on Gemma's grid task ($N = 50$). Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/top5.json`, `results/geometry.json`.

Prompt	Attempted	Correct	Pass	Avoidance of the banned set
top-five twin	DFS 40, BFS 10	DFS 40, BFS 3	0.86	n/a
top-five ban	BFS 41, DFS 9	BFS 10, DFS 9	0.38	0.00
ban BFS	DFS 39, BFS 11	DFS 39, BFS 2	0.82	0.78
ban DFS	BFS 42, DFS 8	BFS 15, DFS 7	0.44	0.84
forced BFS	BFS 50	BFS 38	0.76	n/a

forced DFS	DFS 50	DFS 45	0.90	n/a

Table 266. Where the top-five prompt states sit: geodesic distance from their mean to each catalogue centroid, and the rank of the observed banned-survivor split among the 15 possible splits. Source: Gemma feature experiment `results/geometry.json`.

Space	MDS stress-1	Nearest centroid	Geodesic distance to BFS / DFS / bidirectional BFS / IDDFS / A* and greedy / Dijkstra	Rank share of the observed split
raw, layer 17	0.371	A* and greedy	341.9 / 330.6 / 410.3 / 222.1 / 188.8 / 496.5	0.067
raw, layer 22	0.369	A* and greedy	734.1 / 684.9 / 900.1 / 365.2 / 318.6 / 990.5	0.067
SAE codes, layer 17	0.542	A* and greedy	27.5 / 28.4 / 41.1 / 32.9 / 26.1 / 47.1	0.067
SAE codes, layer 22	0.569	A* and greedy	43.2 / 44.1 / 61.5 / 83.6 / 43.1 / 72.5	0.20

The novelty audit found 1 correct program labelled other among 1,450 correct programs, a first-and-last-position program that two of three judges called a catalogue variant: 0 novel (rule-of-three bound 0.0021). The style re-gate agreed with the labeller on 30 of 30 grid programs. The hash chain verified, a standard-library re-derivation matched 32 of 32 headline quantities, and a shuffled-class decodability placebo sat at chance (0.43). Judge spend was USD 0.034.

6.6 The plan in words: a natural language autoencoder on Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct

Why. The request names NLA as an instrument, and the release of NLA checkpoints for Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct [124] made it possible to ask, in words, whether the residual stream states before the first code token say which algorithm will be written. The experiment read layer-20 states with the released verbalizer and reconstructor pair, judged the explanations blind, and tested an edit of the explanation as a steering vector. Published verbalizers of the same kind include LatentQA [117] and SelfIE [118], and a 2026 analysis of a released Qwen-2.5-7B verbalizer found that only a small share of an explanation's specific claims are ones the reconstruction depends on [119]. Pre-registration was a sha256 chain of four commitments, each preceding its samples; the parts added after the committed nulls are marked exploratory.

Behaviour. Over eight tasks, Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct defaults to BFS, Dijkstra (0.88), a hash map (0.98), a hash set (0.71), DFS for connected components (0.62, where Qwen3-8B writes union find), the naive scan and binary search; kth smallest has no default (quickselect 0.40, size-k heap 0.34) and failed the style re-gate. The model mostly ignores bans (Table 267). Only two sum gave a substitute (brute force in 32 of 46 correct programs). On connected components a ban of DFS raised DFS from 29 to 43 correct programs, with 15 paired slots flipping from union find to DFS, the rebound that naming a forbidden concept can cause [7, 53]. Every one of the 70 programs written under the fourth template attempted the banned default. The shortest path semantic seed barely moved the model (Dijkstra 28, Bellman-Ford 6, against 38 and 5 for the twin). The labellers recognised 51 of 51 references, and the style re-gate passed on 7 of 8 tasks against two blind code judges.

Table 267. Behaviour of Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct (twin and ban $N = 50$, paired slots; forced prompts $N = 20$ per algorithm). Source: NLA experiment `results/behaviour.json`.

Task	Default (share of correct twin programs)	Twin pass	Ban: attempts still using the default	Substitute under the ban	Forced adherence of the algorithm used in the causal arm
grid	BFS (13/13)	0.26	0.68	none (DFS 3)	none (best other 0.35)
shortest path	Dijkstra (38/43)	0.86	0.50	none (Bellman-Ford/SPFA 9, below 10)	none (Bellman-Ford 0.65, below 0.7)
kth smallest	none (quickselect 0.40)	0.94	n/a	n/a	excluded (re-gate 26/30)
two sum	hash map (49/50)	1.00	0.28	brute force (32/46)	brute force 1.00
find duplicate	hash set (35/49)	0.98	0.46	none (Floyd cycle detection 7)	Floyd cycle detection 0.95
connected components	DFS (29/47)	0.94	0.86	none (DFS 43, union find 2)	union find 0.95
substring search	naive (50/50)	1.00	0.94	none	KMP 0.90
first and last position	binary search (38/38)	0.76	0.96	none	bisect module 1.00 (not run)

The instrument gate. The extraction convention that matches the training code reads the output of block 20; it reaches a fraction of variance explained of 0.695 on the reference set against 0.580 for the convention in the release's example, and 0.695 is within 0.06 of the released 0.752. Generic web text and chat give 0.78 and 0.79. Code is out of distribution for this NLA: LeetCode prompts 0.45, HumanEval+ prompts 0.39, CLRS traces 0.33. On the task states the fraction of variance explained, with the reference-set variance as denominator, is 0.512, so the gate's verdict is partial (Table 268).

Table 268. Fraction of variance explained of the layer-20 reconstructions on the task states, by position (reference-set denominator). Source: NLA experiment `results/gate.json`.

Position	Read position	Task specification	Token 1	Token 2	Token 4	Token 8	Token 16
Fraction of variance explained	0.65	0.50	0.48	0.28	0.64	0.57	0.51

The NLA never names the planned algorithm before the code. Two blind judges from different families (Gemini 2.5 Flash Lite and Mistral Small 3.2, both scoring 1.00 on calibration; a third model resolved 1,064 disagreements) mapped each of 6,180 explanations to a catalogue algorithm or to none named (Table 269). Every preregistered readout at the end-of-prompt positions is exactly zero (Table 270). On ban prompts, explanations named the substitute in 0 of 16 states (only two sum had a substitute, so this test is underpowered); on twin prompts they named the default in 0 of 112, as did the text-only reader; on ban failures they named the default the model still writes in 0 of 96. The positive control failed too: on forced `Implement Y` prompts the explanations called Y planned in 0 of 7 tasks, while the text-only reader did so on all of them, and they mentioned the algorithm named in the prompt in 0.7% of cases. The explanations describe the local format line, such as a request for no explanation or a Python code block to follow, and confabulate the task (Fibonacci, medians, prime numbers); 4,733 of 5,700 judged explanations name no algorithm at all. At generated tokens the NLA sometimes names the realised algorithm before the visible text identifies it (up to 0.28 at token 8 under the ban), but an outside reader who sees only the prompt and prefix predicts the realised algorithm better, per sample (0.25 against 0.07; exact McNemar 20:88, p 2e-11).

Table 269. Agreement between the two judges by mode (EXPL: mapping an explanation; NAME: naming from the visible text; PREDICT: the outside reader's forecast). Source: NLA experiment `results/readout.json`.

Mode	Raw agreement	Kappa	Unresolved after the third judge
explanation	0.94	0.82	0.6%
visible text	0.67	0.56	1.6%
outside reader	0.77	0.75	3.9%

Table 270. Preregistered readout tests. Source: NLA experiment `results/readout.json`.

Test (units)	NLA	Comparator	b : c	p	Verdict
ban states name the substitute (two sum only; 16 states)	0/16	text 0/16	0 : 0	1	fail, underpowered
same, against swapped, random and outside-reader controls	0/16	swapped 0/16, random 0/8, outside reader 0/16	0 : 0	1	n/a
twin states name the default (7 tasks; 112 states)	0/112	text 0/112	0 : 0	1	fail
forced states name the forced algorithm (7 tasks)	0.00 on every task	text 1.00	n/a	n/a	fail
ban-failure states name the default still written (6 tasks; 96)	0/96	outside reader 0/96, text 0/96	0 : 0	1	null
per sample, mixed conditions (364 units, 120 samples)	0.066 correct	outside reader 0.253	20 : 88	2e-11	outside reader better
generated positions before the identifying token	ban token 8: 0.28; twin token 4: 0.18	text 0 by construction	n/a	n/a	descriptive

The information is local and fades within a sentence (exploratory). To tell an instrument limit from information that fades along the prompt, the same NLA and judges read states at the token that names the algorithm inside the condition sentence and at the final period of that sentence (220 states, 660 explanations; Table 271). At the name token the explanations mention the algorithm in 80% of forced and 89% of ban states, and they respect the negation: they call it planned in 48% of forced states and in 6% of ban states. Two to eight tokens later, at the end of the sentence, the mention rates fall to 27% and 6%, and about 170 tokens later, at the end of the prompt, to 0.7%. The null therefore says that the pre-code positions do not carry the algorithm choice in a form this NLA puts into words, not that the instrument is blind.

Table 271. Local positive control (majority of three explanations per state; 75 forced and 35 ban states at each of the first two positions). The end-of-prompt row is the committed readout and counts single explanations at the last prompt positions (the algorithm is mentioned in 8 of 1,080 forced and 3 of 420 ban explanations). Source: NLA experiment `results/local_control.json`, `README.md`.

Position	Forced: names Y as planned	Forced: mentions Y	Ban: names the default as planned	Ban: mentions the default	Reconstruction cosine
at the algorithm's name	0.48	0.80	0.06	0.89	0.92
end of that sentence (2 to 8 tokens later)	0.11	0.27	0.00	0.06	0.90

end of the prompt	0.00	0.007	0.00	0.007	0.82 to 0.87
(committed readout, about 170 tokens later)					

[Figure fig_nla_local: generated in the report phase, not in this draft]

The preregistered verbal edit fails at the prefill site. The causal arm replaced the default's name in a twin explanation by an algorithm Y the model writes on request, reconstructed both versions, and patched the difference into the layer-20 states at the last four prompt positions at doses of 1, 2 and 4 (N = 30 paired slots per cell). It failed on all four tasks (Table 272). The edits barely move the reconstruction (cosine 0.9992 between the edited and unedited reconstructions; 0.04 of the state norm per position; Table 273), the unedited round trip at 0.8 of the norm propagates downstream but moves nothing, and all 15 prefill cells per task stay within 0 to 3 slots of the unedited control. The edit direction is nearly orthogonal to the forced-state difference in means (median cosine 0.09).

Table 272. The preregistered causal arm: Y share in the unedited control and the edited-minus-round-trip difference at doses 1, 2 and 4 (N = 30 paired slots). Source: NLA experiment `results/causal.json`.

Task (default to Y)	Control Y share	Dose 1	Dose 2	Dose 4	Pass
connected components (DFS to union find)	10/30	-0.03 (0:1)	-0.03 (0:1)	+0.03 (3:2)	no
two sum (hash map to brute force)	0/30	0	0	0	no
find duplicate (hash set to Floyd cycle detection)	12/30	0	+0.03 (2:1)	+0.10 (3:0, p 0.25)	no
substring search (naive to KMP)	0/30	0	0	0	no

Table 273. Realised push sizes relative to the state norm at block 20. Source: NLA experiment `results/causal.json`.

Cell	Push norm over state norm
edit, dose 1	0.041
unrelated-word edit, dose 1	0.036
round trip, dose 1	0.201
round trip, dose 4	0.80 (0.76 at block 27)

At the generated-token site and large doses, the verbal edit steers two of four tasks (exploratory). After the committed nulls, the experiment extended the doses and moved the edit to the read position plus generated tokens 1 to 64 (Tables 274 and 275). On find duplicate the edit at dose 8 (about 0.3 of the state norm at each position) raised Floyd cycle detection from 0.28 to 0.76 (25:1 over 50 paired slots), replicated on fresh slots (15 of 20, 13:0, p 2e-4), and beat a matched random push (28:1), an unrelated-word edit built the same way (12:1, p 0.003) and a norm-matched round trip (13:1, p 0.002); at dose 16 the programs broke (pass 0.37). On two sum brute force rose from 0 to 10 of 50 at dose 8 and to 23 of 30 at dose 16 with a pass rate of 0.90, while the random push never moved it. On connected components only the forced-state difference in means steered (union find 0.80 at dose 16, 15:1); on substring search nothing steered short of breaking the program. The prefill site stayed inert even at dose 16 or at the natural norm of the difference in means. Asking for the algorithm in the prompt remained the ceiling (forced adherence 0.90 to 1.00 on all four tasks), as the AxBench comparison of prompting and steering predicts [34]. The NLA paper itself reports that editing a plan explanation and steering at one token succeeds roughly half the time; this run's success on two of four tasks is of the same kind and is not a reliable

control knob.

Table 274. Exploratory dose extension (Y share out of 30 paired slots). Source: NLA experiment `results/causal_exploratory.json`.

Task	Control	Prefill edit, dose 16	Prefill difference in means at natural norm, dose 2	Generated-site edit, dose 8	Generated-site random, dose 8	Generated-site difference in means, dose 8	Generated-site difference in means at natural norm
connected components (to union find)	10	10	9	8	11	19 (10:1, p 0.012)	13
two sum (to brute force)	0	0	0	4 (4:0, p 0.125)	0	0	0
find duplicate (to Floyd cycle detection)	12	11	12	23 (12:1, p 0.003)	8	2	6
substring search (to KMP)	0	0	0	0	0	2 (pass 0.83)	0

Table 275. Exploratory follow-up at the generated-token site: dose response, controls built the same way and a replication on fresh slots (Y share; exact McNemar on paired slots). Source: NLA experiment `results/causal_exploratory_followup.json`.

Task	Edit, dose 4	Edit, dose 8 (N = 50)	Edit, dose 16	Dose 8, fresh slots (N = 20)	Dose 8 against random	Dose 8 against unrelated-word edit	Dose 8 against matched round trip	Difference in means, dose 16
find duplicate (to Floyd cycle detection)	0.60 (7:1, p 0.07)	0.76 against control 0.28 (25:1, p < 1e-6)	0.30, pass 0.37	15/20 (13:0, p 2e-4)	28:1	12:1, p 0.003	13:1, p 0.002	0.07, pass 0.27
two sum (to brute force)	0.00	0.20 against 0.00 (10:0, p 0.002)	0.77, pass 0.90 (23:0)	6/20 (6:0, p 0.03)	10:0, p 0.002	4:0, p 0.125	4:0, p 0.125	0.37, pass 0.40
connected components (to union find)	0.33	0.24 against 0.36 (3:9)	0.17	4/20	5:13	6:6	2:6	0.80 (15:1, p 5e-4)
substring search (to KMP)	0.03	0.00	0.07, pass 0.27	0/20	0:0	0:0	0:0	0.03, pass 0.10

In activation space (exploratory), read-position states projected on the plane of the forced-prompt states show every forced algorithm in its own region, with twin and ban prompts apart from all of them. Relative to the algorithm-specific directions of the forced prompts, the ban moves the state toward the banned default's own direction on two sum (+0.13), find duplicate (+0.26) and first and last position (+0.15), as the ban sentence names the default, and toward an alternative on shortest path (Bellman-Ford +0.13), connected components (BFS +0.23), substring search and the grid task (DFS +0.18). The novelty audit found 10 correct programs labelled other in every arm: 8

labeller misses (six kth smallest counting sorts built on a counter, two boolean seen-arrays) and 2 degenerate programs, 0 novel. Spend was about USD 2.0 on OpenRouter (NLA judges with calibration, two interrupted passes, the local control and the novelty audit USD 1.82; code judges for the bench tasks USD 0.11 and for the path tasks USD 0.10) and about 2.0 GPU hours on one 24 GB NVIDIA Ada GPU (68 minutes of generation for behaviour and the committed causal arm, about 27 for the exploratory causal cells, 16 for 6,180 explanations and about 8 for reconstruction passes and the state cache).

6.7 Positioning against published work

The positioning audit, dated 2026-10-22, extended the audits of iterations 4 and 5 to this iteration's claims. A protocol frozen and stamped before the first call drove 126 logged searches over seven lanes, from 2,191 raw hits to 1,820 unique records, 1,401 in the window, and 75 claim rows scored on the occupancy rubric for 67 papers: 3 occupying, 66 adjacent and 6 irrelevant. Its 123 new quotes from 94 sources matched the cached source text and were re-matched by an independent live pass. Table 276 gives the verdict per claim, and Table 277 condenses the 65 rows of its neighbour table; the verbatim quotes are in the audit's evidence files.

Table 276. Lane verdicts for the iteration-6 claims as of 2026-10-22. Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`.

Claim	Lane verdict	Deciding neighbours
Localization: a low-rank causal plan variable, found by interchange or DAS, decides which algorithm Qwen3-8B writes, validated by generation	partly occupied: the method is occupied, the object is open; the flag for a published localization of algorithm choice did not fire, narrowly	DAS and Boundless DAS [110, 111]; MIB [52]; CDAS, DAS steering validated by generation on refusal and a backdoor [112]; prompt cues only for algorithm choice in code [1]
Mediation: the plan subspace mediates which random pushes switch the algorithm	adjacent only	pre-generation planning subspaces; output-sensitive steering components
Discreteness under interpolation	adjacent only	categorical and multidimensional feature geometry; manifold steering [27]
Ideas not in the tokens, at matched KL	adjacent only	decoding matched to steering's departure; temperature and novelty [37]; forking paths [30]
Resampling the plan as a diversity knob	partly occupied: activation noise and latent sampling for diversity are occupied	STARS [71]; noise steering [70]; random embedding injection [84]
The plan in words with NLAs	occupied (method): the NLA paper edits a plan explanation and steers with the reconstruction; this run is a replication in a new setting	the NLA paper (Transformer Circuits, May 2026); LatentQA [117]; SelfIE [118]; cautions [119, 120]
The plan in Gemma Scope 2 features	partly occupied: SAE-feature steering of reasoning strategies beats prompt and activation baselines	SAE-Steering [121]; AxBench [34]
8-bit floating-point (W8A8) activation rounding inflates perturbation effects	adjacent only in the published record; partly occupied by contemporaneous ICLR 2027 submissions at abstract level	steering under weight-only quantization [116]

Three of the audit's flags bear on what this run may claim. No source localizes which algorithm a code model will write by interchange or DAS and validates it by scoring the generated programs, so that combination is open; the method itself is DAS. Editing an NLA explanation of a plan and steering with the reconstruction is published, so the NLA arm is a replication on a new object. Steering under quantization has been compared with full precision only for weight-only 8-bit integer and 4-bit NormalFloat quantization, with activations kept in 16-bit floating point [116]; no source found measures how dynamic per-token activation rounding changes the effect of random perturbations, which is the question the engine control answered, in the negative. The audit also recorded that community NLAs exist for Qwen3-8B at layer 24, that circuit-tracer ships Qwen-3 transcoders including 8B [123] (so the choice of Gemma for the feature claim needs its reason, which is the natural within-prompt split), and that Gemma Scope 2 dates from 22 December 2025 with instruct SAEs initialised from the pretrained ones.

Table 277. The positioning audit's neighbour table, condensed (row; claim; neighbour with venue and version; relation; lane verdict; what this run adds; the baseline a reviewer would ask for). The verbatim quotes behind each row are in the audit's evidence file. Source: positioning audit `research_report.md`, Section 5. The audit wrote the last two columns before the experiments finished; for the claims that were not run (Section 6.8) they state what the planned test would add.

Row	Claim	Neighbour (venue, version)	Relation	Lane verdict	What this run adds	Reviewer baseline implied
1	localization	DAS: Geiger, Wu, Potts, Icard, Goodman, CLeaR 2024 (PMLR 236), arXiv v4, v1 2023-03-05, pub; Boundless DAS, Wu et al., NeurIPS 2023, v3	method the claim uses	PARTLY OCCUPIED (method)	object = algorithm choice in code; validation by tests on emitted programs; Sutter-style controls	DAS with a declared rotation rank, against Boundless DAS
2	localization	MIB: Mueller et al., ICML 2025, v2, v1 2025-04-17, pub	control the claim must meet (method ordering)	n/a	n/a	report neuron and SAE-feature arms beside DAS (MIB ordering)
3	localization	CDAS: Bao et al., ICLR 2026, v2, v1 2026-02-05, pub	occupies the method + criterion pair (rubric 2.5) on a non-plan attribute (refusal, CoT backdoor)	PARTLY OCCUPIED	a plan object (algorithm choice), route-derived predictions, random/ shuffled controls	a CDAS-style distribution-matching DAS arm
4	localization	Programmable Semantic Interventions, ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (rubric 1.5)	n/a	generation-validated plan object	PSI-style declared-program alignment

5	localization	Finding Algorithms in Neural Networks (DAS vs transfer), ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (1.5); supports declaring the map class (non-linear DAS needed in vision)	n/a	algorithm identity in a code LLM, checked by generation	linear vs non-linear map classes
6	localization	Causal Syntax Circuits in CodeLMs, Kumar et al., NeurIPS 2026 workshop, v1 2026-10-14, c4	adjacent (1.5): a code attribute that is not the algorithm; next-token readout	n/a	algorithm (not language); low-rank DAS; generation	random-control significance test, as there
7	localization	Steering LLM Coding Behaviors with Concept Vectors, ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (2.0)	n/a	algorithm-level object with matched-norm controls	a difference-in-means direction for the algorithm, with matched-norm random controls
8	localization	Before Reasoning Begins (Qwen3-8B, final prompt position, SAE targets), ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (2.0): same model and site; object is reasoning, not algorithm	n/a	which algorithm (not whether reasoning happens); DAS rather than SAE suppression	layer-count-matched random null interventions
9	localization	Committed Before Reasoning, Jo, v1 2026-07-17, c4	supports (pre-generation commitment in Qwen3-8B)	n/a	n/a	n/a
10	localization	Random Choice in LMs: linear choice state, ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (2.0)	n/a	code-algorithm object	switch-vs-distribution decomposition
11	localization	Detecting and Characterizing Planning in LMs, Nainani et al., v1 2025-08-25, anchor	adjacent (1.5); contradicts in part (the same abstract reports that planning is not universal)	n/a	algorithm-level plan, not a future-token plan	a planning-vs-improvisation criterion
12	localization	Algorithmic Core Extraction, Schiffman, v2, v1 2026-02-26, pub	adjacent (1.0)	n/a	choice among algorithms, not a task core	n/a

13	localization	Invisible Lottery (algorithm choice in code moved by cues), ICML 2026: see 92c source 30	adjacent (2.0): object occupied behaviourally	n/a	internal causal variable	prompt-cue baseline
14	localization	Sutter, Minder, Hofmann, Pimentel, NeurIPS 2025 Spotlight, v2, v1 2025-07-11, pub	control the claim must meet	n/a	declared linear map class and rank; random-init or random-rotation control	fit the same map on a randomly initialized Qwen3-8B, and with shuffled labels
15	localization	Makelov, Lange, Geiger, Nanda, ICLR 2024, v2, pub	control the claim must meet	n/a	nullspace/row-space decomposition of the patch	check that the patched subspace is not causally disconnected
16	localization	Reply: Wu, Geiger, Huang, Arora, Icard, Potts, Goodman, v1 2024-01-23	cite with CTRL-2	n/a	n/a	n/a
17	localization	Divergent representations: Grant et al., v5 (2026-04-22), v1 2025-11-06	control	n/a	on-distribution check of patched states	report divergence of the intervened states
18	localization	Right Answer, Wrong Mechanism, v2, v1 2026-09-30, c4	control (do not rely on distance checks alone)	n/a	n/a	planted-pathway or clamp test
19	localization	Curse of Multiple Mediators; Many Circuits, One Mechanism (TMLR 2026); identification-assumptions position	controls	n/a	n/a	report interaction effects, cross-condition transfer and identification assumptions
20	mediation	Before the First Token (causal response-length subspace; parallel/ orthogonal decomposition of interventions), ICLR 2027 submission: see 92c source 64	adjacent (nearest)	ADJACENT-ONLY	prediction of random-push effects on algorithm choice from projection onto the plan subspace	parallel/ orthogonal decomposition of each push

21	mediation	AJR; ASTEER; decodability is not actionability	adjacent	n/a	n/a	Jacobian-readout predictor of push effects
22	mediation	DecodeShare, v1 2026-05-21, pub	adjacent (1.5)	n/a	random pushes classified by plan-subspace energy	matched-budget random-subspace control
23	mediation	What Does Activation Steering Control?, v1 2026-08-24, c4	supports a projection account (1.0)	n/a	n/a	report the share of each push's norm inside the plan subspace
24	mediation	Jailbreak success coordinate outside the refusal subspace, ICLR 2027 submission, c	contradicts in part: the outcome-deciding coordinate can lie outside an evaluated subspace	n/a	n/a	test the orthogonal complement as well
25	mediation	Before Reasoning Begins (targeted vs random-null); Latent Planning Emerges with Scale, ICLR 2026	adjacent / supports	n/a	n/a	random-null arm
26	mediation	On the Non-Identifiability of Steering Vectors, v4, v1 2026-02-06, pub (found by a supplementary search)	supports a subspace-level (not direction-level) account (1.0)	n/a	n/a	report plan claims at subspace level; orthogonal-perturbation control
27	mediation	Steering off Course, v1 2025-04-06, anchor; Tele-Lens (ICML 2026)	caution	n/a	n/a	per-sample effect distributions
28	discreteness	Park, Choe, Jiang, Veitch, ICLR 2025 oral, v3, anchor	supports (categorical geometry)	ADJACENT-ONLY	an interpolation sweep between plan centroids, with the emitted algorithm labelled at each step	polytope/ simplex geometry of the plan centroids

29	discreteness	Engels et al., ICLR 2025, v3 (title changed in v3), anchor	adjacent (2.0): interventions along circular features	n/a	discreteness vs continuity of a code plan	a test for irreducible multi-dimensional features
30	discreteness	Manifold Steering (ICML 2026 MI-workshop spotlight): see 92c source 44	adjacent	n/a	n/a	geodesic vs linear paths
31	discreteness	Prolepsis, Jacopin, v2, v1 2026-04-16; Random Choice switch; manifold vs linear steering (ICLR 2027 submission)	adjacent	n/a	n/a	linear vs manifold interpolation
32	ideas not in the tokens	departure-matched decoding (an ICLR 2027 submission on activation steering for mathematical reasoning): 92c source 66; Peeperkorn; AdapT; Gumbel counterfactuals; Beneath the Diff	adjacent; departure-matched decoding is the reviewer baseline	ADJACENT-ONLY	plan-level (algorithm) readout of temperature vs state noise at matched KL	decoding matched to the perturbation's departure from greedy
33	ideas not in the tokens	Forking Paths, Bigelow et al., v1 2024-12-10, anchor	adjacent (2.0)	n/a	n/a	forking-token resampling baseline
34	ideas not in the tokens	HELIX (4-bit Granite; temperature plus steering), v1 2026-02-06; Predicting Future Behaviors, ICLR 2027 submission	adjacent	n/a	n/a	n/a

35	resampling the plan	STARS (ICLR 2026), Noise Steering, REI, NC-GRPO, 2606.10302, Diversity Without Discovery: 92c sources 15, 14, 16, 52, 31, 63	occupies the method family (activation noise for diversity)	PARTLY OCCUPIED	resampling a fitted, causally localized plan variable	matched-dose activation noise; text-level plan samplers (IFG, PlanSearch)
36	resampling the plan	Random Choice in LMs, ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (2.0); closest to flag D	n/a	per-generation resampling for algorithm diversity	distribution-direction intervention
37	resampling the plan	LP-BD; PPLR; SVP (ICLR 2027 submissions, c)	adjacent (flag D partly)	n/a	a frozen LM; the variable is fitted, not trained	n/a
38	resampling the plan	Latent Plan Transformer, v4, anchor (venue not stated in the arXiv record)	adjacent	n/a	n/a	n/a
39	the plan in words (NLA)	Fraser-Taliente, Kantamneni, Ong et al., the NLA paper, Transformer Circuits, published May 7, 2026, pub	OCCUPIES the method (rubric 2.5)	OCCUPIED (method)	replication in a new setting: algorithm choice in code, Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct at layer 20, text-only judges, an unrelated-word edit, a matched-norm random displacement	the paper's own newline-only steering protocol and success rate
40	the plan in words (NLA)	same paper, Reasoning about Rewards	occupies	n/a	n/a	AR-difference steering vector, norm-matched
41	the plan in words (NLA)	same paper, Method and Limitations	control the claim must meet (confabulation)	n/a	n/a	confabulation audit of plan claims
42	the plan in words (NLA)	Released checkpoints: kitft README; HF card; nla_meta.yaml; TransformerLens issue #1884	design facts	n/a	n/a	load nla_meta.yaml injection settings

43	the plan in words (NLA)	LatentQA, Pan, Chen, Steinhardt, ICLR 2026, v2; SelfIE, ICML 2024, PMLR 235	occupies the similar-verbaliser clause of flag C (rubric 2.0 each)	n/a	n/a	decoder-loss steering arm
44	the plan in words (NLA)	Activation Oracles, v2; Dreaming Vectors (LessWrong)	readout kin / steering kin (grey literature)	n/a	n/a	n/a
45	the plan in words (NLA)	Sood, Substack, 2026-08-18, c4; Auditing the Auditor, ICLR 2027 submission, c	control set the readout must meet	n/a	n/a	shuffled-activation control; visible-text baseline; blinded judge
46	the plan in words (NLA)	Train the Model, Not the Reader, Dingeto, v2, v1 2026-07-22, c4	contradicts in part: an edited claim may not move the AR output	n/a	measure the AR displacement caused by the edit before steering	claim-flip reconstruction test
47	the plan in words (NLA)	Colombian identity with NLA, v1 2026-07-23, c4	readout replication on the same checkpoint	n/a	n/a	n/a
48	the plan in words (NLA)	Community Qwen3-8B NLAs: nanoNLA; EasyNLA	corrects the iteration-5 statement that no NLA exists for Qwen3-8B	n/a	n/a	an optional Qwen3-8B arm (unofficial; faithfulness disclaimer)
49	the plan in words (NLA)	Planning or Improvisation?, Jacopin, v1 2026-09-16, c4	contradicts in part (no newline-resident plan in small open models)	n/a	n/a	site sweep (newline vs final prompt token)
50	the plan in words (NLA)	Measuring Activation Control; Understanding Confabulation	context	n/a	n/a	n/a
51	Gemma Scope 2 features	Gemma Scope 2: announcement 22 Dec 2025; technical report; HF card	design facts	n/a	n/a	report the IT-vs-PT dictionary used
52	Gemma Scope 2 features	circuit-tracer README; Qwen-3 transcoders (Hanna et al.)	design fact: Qwen3-8B transcoders exist, so a reviewer may ask why S uses Gemma	n/a	n/a	run S on the Qwen3-8B PLTs, or justify Gemma

53	Gemma Scope 2 features	AxBench, v3, v1 2025-01-28; rebuttal, v1 2026-05-29	prior the claim must meet	n/a	n/a	difference-in-means and prompting arms
54	Gemma Scope 2 features	SAE-Steering, Fang et al., ACL 2026 Main, v2; Galichin et al.	OCCUPIES the method on a non-code strategy (rubric 2.5)	PARTLY OCCUPIED	algorithm choice in code; Gemma Scope 2; transcoder attribution	SAE-Steering-style logit-recall feature selection
55	Gemma Scope 2 features	Do SAEs Identify Reasoning Features? (Gemma Scope 2), ICML 2026, v7	contradicts in part	n/a	n/a	token-injection falsification of candidate features
56	Gemma Scope 2 features	Prolepsis; Latent Planning Emerges with Scale	adjacent; counter-evidence to the AxBench prior for plans	n/a	n/a	CLT/PLT arm against residual difference-in-means
57	Gemma Scope 2 features	SAE Interventions are Unreliable; variable roles in code LMs (ICLR 2027 submission); attribution-graph caveat	cautions	n/a	n/a	probe baseline; post-intervention recovery check
58	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Steering Under Compression, Bhandari and Wade, v1 2026-09-06, c4	adjacent (1.5); flag B partly	ADJACENT-ONLY (published)	activation quantization; random perturbations; matched bf16 control	iso-effect comparison at matched behavioural effect
59	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Stable Directions, Different Effects, ICLR 2027, desk rejected, c	partly occupies the general claim (contemporaneous)	PARTLY OCCUPIED (contemporaneous)	random pushes; 8-bit floating-point W8A8 named; noise-floor account	a first-order local-sensitivity predictor
60	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Activation Steering under Low-Bit Quantization, ICLR 2027 submission, c	adjacent (1.0)	n/a	n/a	hold layer, direction and strength fixed
61	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Quantization Modulates Batch-Context Non-Determinism, ICLR 2027 submission, c	mechanism neighbour (noise floor)	n/a	perturbation effect sizes against the 8-bit floating-point noise floor	same-batch-context repeat runs

62	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	PRISM, v1 2026-10-14, c4	adjacent (4-bit NormalFloat)	n/a	n/a	n/a
63	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Readouts under quantization: Findings ACL 2026;;; AACL 2025; TrustNLP 2026	flag B partly (readouts, not perturbation effect sizes)	n/a	n/a	n/a
64	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Precision-induced divergence: TMLR 2026;;;	supports the mechanism (rounding flips trajectories)	n/a	n/a	a zero-norm (unperturbed) re-run under the same engine
65	engine (8-bit floating-point W8A8)	Mechanism sources: LLM.int8(); SmoothQuant; massive activations; 8-bit floating-point formats; the dynamic 8-bit floating-point scheme of llm-compressor	mechanism background	n/a	n/a	per-token-scale ablation

6.8 Planned but not run

The seventh artifact of the strategy never existed. It was to fit DAS subspaces of rank 1 to 16 at one layer of the task-specification positions in bf16 Qwen3-8B on three training templates and confirm them on two held-out templates (Stage B of the localization claim), test whether a fresh random direction's energy in that subspace predicts its effect (the mediation claim), interpolate and extrapolate the plan coordinate between algorithms (the discreteness claim), measure the plan coordinate's variance across temperatures (the first half of the token claim), resample the plan per generation as a diversity knob (the resampling claim), and draw the request's manifold of algorithms in the fitted plan subspace, with the top-five prohibition placed on it. It was lost at the planning stage: the planning agent returned no plan, so no experiment ran. These claims are untested and open; nothing in this report is a result for them, null or otherwise. The only DAS result of the iteration is Gemma's, at the fork position (Section 6.5).

6.9 Comparisons across this iteration's experiments

Where the choice is held, in three models. The three internal experiments located the choice in different places, and each location fits the behaviour of that model. In Qwen3-8B the states at the task-specification positions carry a ban or an instruction: exchanging them alone reproduces the substitute of the ban on shortest path (0.80) and a forced instruction on shortest path (30 of 30) and connected components (28 of 30), while on the direct-route tasks the condition span carries it. In gemma-3-4b-it, which writes two algorithms for one prompt, the choice is made at a single generated token after a shared opening, and edits at the task-specification positions do nothing. In

Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct the algorithm is verbalisable at the token that names it and not 170 tokens later, and edits work only at the generated-token site. In all three the read position is inert as a carrier: its exchange transfers nothing on six Qwen3-8B tasks, Gemma's readout there is no better than the text, and the NLA reads only the format line there. The finding of iteration 3 that a ban gives way at the opening of the program body and the fork of Gemma at response index 32 point at the same moment from two models: the first statement of the body that is specific to an algorithm, after an opening shared by every algorithm.

The top-five prohibition in two families. Both models answer a five-name ban by writing a banned algorithm (avoidance 0.00 in Qwen3-8B in iteration 2, in its bf16 rerun here and in Gemma). In Gemma the ban flips the model from its default DFS to its minority BFS and halves its pass rate; in activation space the ban's prompt states sit beside a banned centroid. The activation version of the prohibition breaks programs before it moves the algorithm.

Novelty, audited again. No artifact of this iteration found a correct novel algorithm (Table 278).

Table 278. Novelty audits of iteration 6. Sources: the novelty audit files of the five artifacts.

Artifact	Pool	Correct programs outside the catalogue	Final classes	Novel
Record audit	the 14 transplant programs that two of three judges had called novel in iteration 5, plus 10 controls and 17 related programs	14 disputed	known outside the catalogue 10, catalogue variant 2, degenerate 2	0
Engine control	every correct off-default or other program, against 18,237 known solutions	up to 237 per engine and task	variants and distant programs of known algorithms (nearest-known pass only)	not judged
Exchange and site experiment	every correct program labelled other	2	catalogue variant 2	0
Gemma feature experiment	1,450 correct programs	1	catalogue variant	0
NLA experiment	every correct program labelled other, all arms	10	labeller miss 8, degenerate 2	0

6.10 What iteration 6 established, what it ruled out, and what it abandoned

Everything below is one model per claim except where a second family is named, at 4B to 8B parameters, on memorised tasks in the style of LeetCode.

Established.

1. *Iteration 4's random-push escapes are a property of Qwen3-8B, not of 8-bit floating-point rounding.* At the same absolute displacement, the same 40 directions and the same slots, bf16 escapes on connected components at 0.65 against 0.725 under W8A8 and on shortest path at 0.15 against 0.20, with per-direction shares ranked alike (Spearman 0.96 and 0.87), and per-sample plan noise reproduces (25 and 22 of 50 against 30 and 22). Activation rounding alone adds nothing; a 5-point per-slot boost on connected components comes from the 8-bit floating-point weights or the native kernel. Iteration 5's bf16 null belongs to its ban-free unit

or its direction seeds.

2. *In Qwen3-8B the substitute of a ban and the algorithm of an instruction are carried by the residual states at the task-specification positions on the prompt-route tasks.* Exchanging those states alone transfers the ban on shortest path (0.80) and kth smallest (0.57), and a forced instruction on shortest path (30 of 30) and connected components (28 of 30); matched-norm random exchanges and a placebo twin transfer at most 0.13. The condition span carries the ban on the direct-route tasks (two sum 1.00, find duplicate 0.90). The read position carries nothing.
3. *Gemma's BFS-or-DFS choice is made at one generated token,* `visited` against a blank line, `if` or `queue` at response index 32, about 138 tokens before any algorithm-identifying code, and is readable from the residual stream at that position across prompts (Lasso on SAE codes R-squared 0.66 against 0.18 for text, preregistered; ridge on the raw state 0.72, post hoc).
4. *Steering the fork works and costs correctness.* Difference in means moves the fork 2.3 times as far as the SAE clamp at matched norm, both move the plan equally at matched effect, and every edit toward the minority algorithm breaks programs; edits toward the default are clean.
5. *The NLA does not verbalise the planned algorithm at pre-code positions in Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct,* although it names an algorithm at the token where the prompt names it; an outside reader of the text predicts the realised algorithm better than the NLA.
6. *Record repairs.* The landing half is descriptive (17 of 21 per set, 5 of 8 where the twin wrote no alternative, p 0.053); the movability half is not a strong predictor with a moderate relation not excluded (0.15, interval -0.44 to 0.65); the 14 disputed programs are not novel.

Ruled out, or not supported.

- *Activation rounding as the cause of the escapes* (the engine claim's preregistered account): W16A8 escapes like bf16 or slightly less, on both tasks.
- *The Stage A rule of the localization claim* as preregistered: the task-specification states of two sum also transfer brute force at 0.43, above the predicted 0.2.
- *A feature claim for Gemma Scope 2:* the SAE clamp never beats difference in means, and the preregistered feature rule is met by random latents.
- *The verbal readout claim:* 0 of 16, 0 of 112 and 0 of 96 at the end of the prompt; the preregistered verbal edit moves nothing at the prefill site.
- *State noise against token temperature at matched KL* in bf16: 12:6 and 7:3 at alpha 2, not significant.

Withdrawn.

- *The prefill-site claim in its preregistered form* in bf16: no common support for the condition span, and breakage at alpha 8. Its post-hoc form (alpha 4 or less) puts the read position below the task-specification site on both tasks.

Dead ends, with the evidence that closed them.

- *8-bit floating-point numerics as an explanation of anything in this run's internal results:* closed by Table 237 and Table 239.
- *The read position as a carrier of the choice:* zero transfer in six Qwen3-8B tasks (Tables 244 to 249), no readout beyond text in Gemma (Table 261), only the format line in the NLA explanations.

- *The released layer-20 NLA as a readout of algorithm plans in code:* code is out of distribution for it (fraction of variance explained 0.39 to 0.45), and its pre-code explanations name no algorithm.

Planned but not run. DAS in Qwen3-8B (Stage B), the mediation, discreteness and resampling claims, the temperature half of the token claim, and the causal manifold (Section 6.8).

6.11 What the next iteration takes from this one

The plan-variable account was tested in part, and its two halves came out differently. Where the choice is held is now measured in three models: the task-specification states in Qwen3-8B for bans and instructions on the prompt-route tasks, one generated token in Gemma, and nothing verbalisable before the code in Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct. Whether the choice is a low-rank variable in Qwen3-8B, and whether random pushes act through it, is untested, because the DAS experiment was lost at planning. The engine control has removed the obstacle that made such a test look premature: random pushes at iteration 4's absolute unit move the algorithm in bf16 as they did in 8-bit floating point, so the escapes are a stable target that a fitted plan subspace can be asked to explain. The next measurements are DAS at the task-specification positions of shortest path and kth smallest, with the Stage A exchanges as the full-state ceiling, and the projection of iteration 4's 40 directions onto the fitted subspace.

Three leads come with it. The ban-free unit moves fewer programs than the ban unit at a larger scalar dose, so its per-position and per-block profile, or the direction seeds, decide movability; a controlled comparison of the two units on the same seeds would say which. Gemma's one-token fork offers a clean site where DAS already captures the choice in one direction; whether a smaller push there switches the algorithm without breaking the program is the question for a usable knob. And two sum's task-specification states carry part of a ban that iteration 3 had classed as direct, so the route classes are not all-or-none.

What we have learned so far

After six iterations the run has a firm picture of the collapse, a complete answer on temperature, a confirmed internal handle on the algorithm in Qwen3-8B, a measured map of where three models hold the choice, a measured but incomplete account of what a prohibition does, and no correct novel algorithm. Qwen3-8B [5] writes BFS and Dijkstra almost without exception on the two path search tasks and one algorithm on each of 13 further coding tasks (modal share 1.00 on 12, 0.98 on one). The collapse is not universal: three of 15 new tasks are already mixed in the instruct twin (trapped rain water, default share 0.64; minimum spanning tree weight, 0.66; valid anagram, 0.76), and on two of them the instruct model is more diverse than its base model (twin off-default 0.36 against a base off-default share of 0.23, and 0.34 against 0.11). Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct [22] attempts more algorithms but its correct grid programs are BFS 20 of 20; gemma-3-4b-it [76] writes DFS in 70% and BFS in 30% of programs for one grid prompt; Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct [124] shares most of Qwen3-8B's defaults.

Sampling temperature, top-k, top-p, min-p, thinking mode and random context seeds change how the code is worded, not which algorithm it implements. With the token seed coupled across temperatures from 0.3 to 1.3, the algorithm changed in 0 of 20 seeds on three tasks with thinking off, and in 0 of 20 on the shortest path task with thinking on, under top-p 1 and under top-k 10. Phrasings per idea rose from 3 to 13 clusters on the grid task with thinking off; in the literal cell with thinking on, the clusters rise only at temperature 1.3 (5/7/12 at Jaccard thresholds

0.7/0.8/0.9, against 3/6/10 for a repeat at 0.7). State noise on generated tokens against a temperature matched on per-token KL was not established in bf16 (12:6 and 7:3 discordant flips). On other problems temperature above 1 has been reported to raise algorithmic diversity at a correctness cost [72], so the null belongs to these tasks.

A random displacement of the task-specification states at early to middle blocks, sized to the displacement a ban itself causes, changes the algorithm, and this is a property of Qwen3-8B, not of the 8-bit engine on which it was found. At iteration 4's own absolute displacement, directions and slots, bf16 escapes on 26 of 40 directions on connected components and 6 of 40 on shortest path, against 29 and 8 under the 8-bit W8A8 engine, with the same directions escaping (Spearman of per-direction shares 0.96 and 0.87), and per-sample plan noise moves 25 and 22 of 50 attempts against 30 and 22. Rounding the activations to e4m3 per token adds nothing; a 5-point per-slot boost on connected components comes from the 8-bit floating-point weights or the native kernel. The smaller effects that iteration 5 measured in bf16 belong to its ban-free dose unit or its direction seeds: its alpha-2 push was larger at the first edited block than the control's alpha-1 push, which still moved 7 of 50. In bf16 at the ban-free unit, noise at the task-specification positions moves the algorithm (kth smallest 0.37 correct off-default at alpha 2 through blocks 12 to 23; connected components 0.33 at alpha 4 through blocks 0 to 11), while the read position and the condition span barely do; the preregistered site rule was withdrawn for lack of common support and breakage at alpha 8, and a post-hoc model at alpha 4 or less puts the read position below the task-specification site on both tasks. Noise in generated tokens 1 to 32 also redirects the choice. The 8-bit site odds ratio (5.72) and the same-seed contrast (17.25 of 20 seeds) were not rerun in bf16.

Priced as a knob, plan noise is not the practical answer on the evidence so far. Under the 8-bit engine at the ban unit it was the cheapest route to a second correct algorithm on kth smallest (Hill-1 2.72 within 5 pass points) and connected components (2.09); fixed random directions reached above 2 at no cost on kth smallest and two sum, but as maxima over 21 and 9 directions. Against text-level plan samplers, measured in bf16 at the ban-free unit where plan noise was weak, plan noise matched the best sampler on 1 of 5 decisive tasks: an intent sentence written by the base model, with the code written by the instruct model, won on connected components, the shortest path task and two sum (2.53, 1.45 and 1.61), and enumerate and pick reached the most raw diversity at 16 to 62 pass points. That comparison has not been repeated at the absolute unit at which plan noise is strong. Plan noise beat decoding at matched departure on kth smallest at alpha 2 (13:0) and not elsewhere (6:3). Generate then select [43] and enumerate and pick, which hand the choice to an external random draw, remain ceilings with large pass costs.

Where the choice is held has now been measured in three models, and each location fits the behaviour of that model. In Qwen3-8B the residual states at the task-specification positions carry the substitute of a ban and the algorithm of an instruction on the prompt-route tasks: exchanging those states alone into a neutral twin transfers the ban on shortest path (0.80) and kth smallest (0.57) and a forced instruction on shortest path (30 of 30) and connected components (28 of 30), while matched-norm random exchanges and a placebo transfer at most 0.13; on the direct-route tasks the condition span carries the ban. In gemma-3-4b-it the choice between BFS and DFS is made at one generated token after a shared 32-token opening (`visited` leads to DFS with BFS probability 0.011; a blank line, `if` or `queue` lead to BFS at 0.95 to 1.00), about 138 tokens before the code identifies the algorithm. It is readable across prompts from the residual stream at that position (a preregistered Lasso on Gemma Scope 2 SAE codes R-squared 0.66 against 0.18 for the text; a post-hoc ridge on the raw state 0.72), and DAS finds it in essentially one direction (rank 1 moves the fork log-odds by 8.8 nats); a difference-in-means edit moves it 2.3 times as far as the

SAE clamp at matched norm, and every edit toward the minority algorithm breaks programs, so no feature claim is made. In Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct a natural language autoencoder names the algorithm at the token where the prompt names it and not 170 tokens later, and its pre-code explanations name no algorithm; a verbal edit steered two of four tasks only at the generated-token site and large doses, in an exploratory follow-up. In all three models the read position is inert as a carrier. Whether the choice in Qwen3-8B is a low-rank variable, and whether random pushes act through it, is untested: the DAS experiment was lost at planning. The forced-prompt subspace of iteration 4 did not predict which directions move the algorithm (within-task Spearman 0.03), although which directions move is reproducible.

The internal results that hold under bf16 are therefore: the route of a ban (iterations 2 and 3), the band patching on kth smallest and connected components, the exchange of Stage A, the escape fractions and per-sample plan-noise rates of iteration 4 at their absolute unit, the transplant results of iteration 5, the read-position transplant that breaks the output without moving the algorithm, and the post-hoc ordering of noise sites. The 8-bit site odds ratio, the same-seed contrast and the forced-prompt subspace tests are 8-bit results not rerun.

A single prompt ban, where the model obeys it, removes the default and the output collapses on one replacement: Bellman-Ford/SPFA on the shortest path task (272 of 272 compliant iteration-1 programs; 255 of 260 iteration-2 attempts not banned), DFS on the grid task (116 of 128; 257 of 257), and quickselect and size-k heap, brute force, index marking and BFS on the bench tasks where Qwen3-8B obeys (4 of 12 once avoidance counts only catalogue algorithms). Shown a correct program of another algorithm and told not to use it, the model goes home to its default (0.05 of attempts under the copy prompt, 0.72 under the ban), and Llama does the same on five of six present minor bans. Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct mostly ignores bans, and its ban of DFS on connected components raised DFS from 29 to 43 correct programs. How often a ban is obeyed depends on its wording more than on anything else measured; the fourth template, which states only that X is not allowed here, is the weakest in every artifact, in Gemma and in Qwen2.5, where all 70 of its programs used the banned default. Bans of five names fail by reimplementation in both families tested: Qwen3-8B and Gemma write no algorithm outside the banned set (avoidance 0.00), Gemma moving from its default DFS to its minority BFS (10 to 41 of 50) at half the pass rate, with its prompt states beside a banned centroid in activation space; a push along the top-five direction breaks programs before it moves the algorithm.

What decides the replacement under a modal ban has measured leads and no confirmed rule. The likelihood instrument of iteration 2 cannot decide it, and substitution by the alternative the model states is not supported in Qwen3-8B. The runner-up of the base model names where a push lands in 17 of 21 recorded events across Qwen3-8B and Gemma (5 of 5 on the 8-bit screen, 1 of 2 on the bf16 remeasurement, 3 of 3 and 3 of 4 on new tasks, 5 of 7 in Gemma), and it beats the instruct twin's teacher-forced ranking of algorithm openings 8:1 where the two disagree (p 0.020, retrospective). But where the instruct twin already writes an alternative, that alternative names the landing as often (6 of 7), and on the 8 held-out events where the twin wrote none the base runner-up named 5 (p 0.053): the landing half is descriptive. The base model's own variety does not say whether a task can be moved: over 13 new units its off-default share ranks movability at Spearman 0.15 (95% interval -0.44 to 0.65; power 0.63 at a true 0.6; 0.035 if count inversions' share is taken from its correct programs), so a strong relation is excluded and a moderate one is not; only the runtime merit of the fastest alternative tracks movability after Holm correction (0.71). Both verdicts are conditional on the ban-free unit and seeds of iteration 5. Writing the task-specification states of the base model into the instruct prefill reopened the base runner-up on 1 of 5 Qwen3-8B

tasks and 2 of 7 Gemma tasks, the latter where the instruct twin already wrote it 8% to 12% of the time.

Where a ban acts depends on the task. On the path tasks it is carried mostly by the prompt states (likelihood readout 0.85; behaviour 0.98 on the shortest path task, mixed on the grid task), and Stage A now shows the same for shortest path and kth smallest in behaviour. On the bench, pooled over five gated tasks, the direct route carries 0.744 [0.38, 1.11] of the behavioural effect and the prompt states 0.611 [0.06, 1.17], with overlapping intervals; two sum, classed as direct, also carries 0.43 of its ban in the task-specification states. The ban is enforced at the opening of the program body, to a single token on kth smallest; Gemma's natural choice falls at the same point, the first algorithm-specific statement after an opening shared by every algorithm. The read position predicts how strongly a wording will be obeyed (-0.41 across 110 wordings) but carries none of the effect when exchanged or spliced. Push movability as a forecast of which bans a model obeys is closed: inconclusive in the held-out family under its primary rule and disconfirmed under its drop sensitivity.

No instruction, knob, push, transplant, feature clamp or verbal edit produced a correct novel algorithm. Iterations 1 to 3 produced 116 correct programs outside the catalogue and none was new; iteration 4, none of 14,206 correct programs of the site and subspace experiments; iteration 5, none of 130 correct programs outside the catalogue. In iteration 6 a second blind adjudication of the 14 transplant programs that two of three judges had called novel, by two model families the run had not used and with ten controls of known class, found 1 novel call by one judge (a linear search, overturned on a full read) and 0 by the other, a final count of 0; the exchange experiment, the Gemma experiment (1 of 1,450 correct programs outside the catalogue) and the NLA experiment (10 correct programs labelled other) found none either. The long-form instruction of the request makes most outputs claim novelty while their code is a catalogue algorithm or absent. Within single-sample generation the reachable ideas are the model's known catalogue; search with an evaluator, which this run did not test, is the documented route to new programs [81, 82].

What remains open follows from this. The first question is whether the algorithm choice in Qwen3-8B is a low-rank variable at the task-specification positions: DAS fitted against the Stage A exchanges, and the projection of iteration 4's 40 directions onto the fitted subspace, would test it, and the engine control has made those directions a stable target. The second is what makes the ban-free unit weaker than the ban unit at a larger scalar dose: its per-position and per-block profile or its direction seeds. The third is whether a small push at Gemma's fork switches the algorithm without breaking the program. The fourth is whether base intent, the best knob priced so far, holds on more tasks and against plan noise at its absolute unit. Of the items of the request, the following have been run: the geometry plots in activation coordinates (at a label-dependent position in iteration 2, at the plan site in iteration 4, and for the top-five prohibition in Qwen3-8B and Gemma in iteration 6), the top-five prohibition by prompt, token veto and plan push, natural BFS against DFS internals (within a ban in Qwen3-8B, within one prompt in Gemma), thought anchors, the logit and tuned lenses, the same seed test with thinking on and off and with top-k 10, natural language autoencoders (on Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct), sparse autoencoders (Qwen-Scope on Qwen3-8B, Gemma Scope 2 on Gemma) and a first-order attribution in place of a circuit graph. The manifold of algorithms in a causally fitted plan subspace was planned and not run.

References

[1] Narula et al. The Invisible Lottery: How Subtle Cues Steer Algorithm Choice in LLM Code Generation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.04057. 2026.

[2] Wu et al. Generative Monoculture in Large Language Models. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[3] Jangra et al. DivAlgo: A systematic evaluation of algorithmic diversity for code generation models. 2026.

[4] Yoon et al. How Do LLMs Change Predictions Under Negation? 2026.

[5] Yang et al. Qwen3 Technical Report. 2025.

[6] Kwon et al. Efficient Memory Management for Large Language Model Serving with PagedAttention. Proceedings of the 29th Symposium on Operating Systems Principles. 2023.

[7] Rana. Semantic Gravity Wells: Why Negative Constraints Backfire. arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.08070. 2026.

[8] Wilson. Probable Inference, the Law of Succession, and Statistical Inference. Journal of the American Statistical Association. 1927.

[9] Hill. Diversity and Evenness: A Unifying Notation and Its Consequences. Ecology. 1973.

[10] Gneiting et al. Strictly Proper Scoring Rules, Prediction, and Estimation. Journal of the American Statistical Association. 2007.

[11] Cohen. A Coefficient of Agreement for Nominal Scales. Educational and Psychological Measurement. 1960.

[12] Xia et al. LeetCodeDataset: A Temporal Dataset for Robust Evaluation and Efficient Training of Code LLMs. arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.14655. 2025.

[13] Du et al. Mercury: A Code Efficiency Benchmark for Code Large Language Models. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 37. 2024.

[14] Markeeva et al. The CLRS-Text Algorithmic Reasoning Language Benchmark. arXiv preprint arXiv:2406.04229. 2024.

[15] Liu et al. Is Your Code Generated by ChatGPT Really Correct? Rigorous Evaluation of Large Language Models for Code Generation. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 36. 2023.

[16] Qiu et al. How Efficient is LLM-Generated Code? A Rigorous & High-Standard Benchmark. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[17] Brysbaert et al. Concreteness ratings for 40 thousand generally known English word lemmas. Behavior Research Methods. 2013.

[18] Brysbaert et al. Moving beyond Kučera and Francis: A critical evaluation of current word frequency norms and the introduction of a new and improved word frequency measure for American English. Behavior Research Methods. 2009.

[19] Xu et al. KodCode: A Diverse, Challenging, and Verifiable Synthetic Dataset for Coding. Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics. 2025.

[20] Zhu et al. XLCoST: A Benchmark Dataset for Cross-lingual Code Intelligence. arXiv preprint arXiv:2206.08474. 2022.

[21] Kendall et al. The Problem of *m* Rankings. The Annals of Mathematical Statistics. 1939.

[22] Grattafiori et al. The Llama 3 Herd of Models. 2024.

[23] Lu et al. Benchmarking Language Model Creativity: A Case Study on Code Generation. North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics. 2024.

[24] Hewitt et al. Designing and Interpreting Probes with Control Tasks. Proceedings of the 2019 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing and the 9th International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing. 2019.

[25] Tenenbaum et al. A global geometric framework for nonlinear dimensionality reduction. Science. 2000.

[26] Facco et al. Estimating the intrinsic dimension of datasets by a minimal neighborhood information. Scientific Reports. 2017.

[27] Wurgaft et al. Manifold Steering Reveals the Shared Geometry of Neural Network Representation and Behavior. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.05115. 2026.

[28] Marshall et al. Refusal in LLMs is an Affine Function. arXiv preprint arXiv:2411.09003. 2024.

[29] Arditi et al. Refusal in Language Models Is Mediated by a Single Direction. Neural Information Processing Systems. 2024.

[30] Bigelow et al. Forking Paths in Neural Text Generation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.07961. 2024.

[31] Bigelow et al. Forking Fast: Efficiently Estimating Uncertainty Dynamics in Text Generation. 2026.

[32] Zhu et al. Hot or Cold? Adaptive Temperature Sampling for Code Generation with Large Language Models. Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence. 2024.

[33] Killick et al. Optimal detection of changepoints with a linear computational cost. Journal of the American Statistical Association. 2012.

[34] Wu et al. AxBench: Steering LLMs? Even Simple Baselines Outperform Sparse Autoencoders. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2025.

[35] West et al. Base Models Beat Aligned Models at Randomness and Creativity. arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.00047. 2025.

[36] Yun et al. The Price of Format: Diversity Collapse in LLMs. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. 2025.

[37] Peeperkorn et al. Is Temperature the Creativity Parameter of Large Language Models? ICCC. 2024.

[38] Tang. Compact Constraint Encoding for LLM Code Generation: An Empirical Study of Token Economics and Constraint Compliance. arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.07192. 2026.

[39] Binder et al. Looking Inward: Language Models Can Learn About Themselves by Introspection. arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.13787. 2024.

[40] Goudarzi et al. Math Reasoning in LLMs is Organized by Approach, Not Topic. 2026.

[41] Veach et al. Optimally combining sampling techniques for Monte Carlo rendering. Proceedings of the 22nd annual conference on Computer graphics and interactive techniques - SIGGRAPH '95. 1995.

[42] Newcombe. Interval estimation for the difference between independent proportions:

comparison of eleven methods. Statistics in Medicine. 1998.

[43] Wong et al. SimpleStrat: Diversifying Language Model Generation with Stratification. arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.09038. 2024.

[44] Zhang et al. NoveltyBench: Evaluating Language Models for Humanlike Diversity. arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.05228. 2025.

[45] Lee et al. Are We Measuring Strategy or Phrasing? The Gap Between Surface- and Approach-Level Diversity in LLM Math Reasoning. arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.29985. 2026.

[46] Zhang et al. Verbalized Sampling: How to Mitigate Mode Collapse and Unlock LLM Diversity. arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.01171. 2025.

[47] Zhang et al. Towards Best Practices of Activation Patching in Language Models: Metrics and Methods. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2023.

[48] Geva et al. Dissecting Recall of Factual Associations in Auto-Regressive Language Models. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. 2023.

[49] Belrose et al. Eliciting Latent Predictions from Transformers with the Tuned Lens. arXiv preprint arXiv:2303.08112. 2023.

[50] Deng et al. Qwen-Scope: Turning Sparse Features into Development Tools for Large Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.11887. 2026.

[51] Gao et al. Scaling and evaluating sparse autoencoders. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[52] Mueller et al. MIB: A Mechanistic Interpretability Benchmark. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2025.

[53] Mann et al. Don't Think of the White Bear: Ironic Negation in Transformer Models Under Cognitive Load. arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.12381. 2025.

[54] Bogdan et al. Thought Anchors: Which LLM Reasoning Steps Matter? arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.19143. 2025.

[55] Basu et al. Interpretability without actionability: mechanistic methods cannot correct language model errors despite near-perfect internal representations. arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.18353. 2026.

[56] Zhou et al. How Language Models Process Negation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.03052. 2026.

[57] Kirk et al. Understanding the Effects of RLHF on LLM Generalisation and Diversity. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2023.

[58] Heo et al. Do LLMs "know" internally when they follow instructions? International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[59] Sia et al. Where does In-context Translation Happen in Large Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.04510. 2024.

[60] Hendel et al. In-Context Learning Creates Task Vectors. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. 2023.

[61] Todd et al. Function Vectors in Large Language Models. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2023.

[62] Biagiola et al. The Alignment Problem in Constrained Code Generation. arXiv preprint

arXiv:2606.21619. 2026.

[63] Qi et al. Safety Alignment Should Be Made More Than Just a Few Tokens Deep. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[64] Zhang et al. Simple Fast Algorithms for the Editing Distance Between Trees and Related Problems. SIAM Journal on Computing. 1989.

[65] Wilcoxon. Individual Comparisons by Ranking Methods. Biometrics Bulletin. 1945.

[66] Vehtari et al. Pareto Smoothed Importance Sampling. Journal of Machine Learning Research. 2015.

[67] Hanley et al. If nothing goes wrong, is everything all right? Interpreting zero numerators. JAMA. 1983.

[68] Efron. Better Bootstrap Confidence Intervals. Journal of the American Statistical Association. 1987.

[69] Sclar et al. Quantifying Language Models' Sensitivity to Spurious Features in Prompt Design or: How I learned to start worrying about prompt formatting. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2023.

[70] Khalid et al. Noise Steering for Controlled Text Generation: Improving Diversity and Reading-Level Fidelity in Arabic Educational Story Generation. Workshop on Innovative Use of NLP for Building Educational Applications. 2026.

[71] Zhu et al. Exploring Diverse Generation Paths via Inference-time Stiefel Activation Steering. arXiv preprint arXiv:2601.22010. 2026.

[72] Lee et al. How Diversely Can Language Models Solve Problems? Exploring the Algorithmic Diversity of Model-Generated Code. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing. 2025.

[73] Ahmed et al. Intent Factored Generation: Unleashing the Diversity in Your Language Model. arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.09659. 2025.

[74] Wang et al. Planning In Natural Language Improves LLM Search For Code Generation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2409.03733. 2024.

[75] Fan et al. When is Your LLM Steerable? arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.11599. 2026.

[76] Gemma Team et al. Gemma 3 Technical Report. arXiv preprint arXiv:2503.19786. 2025.

[77] Ravfogel et al. Gumbel Counterfactual Generation From Language Models. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[78] Dong et al. Emergent Response Planning in LLMs. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2025.

[79] Andriushchenko et al. Jailbreaking Leading Safety-Aligned LLMs with Simple Adaptive Attacks. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[80] Nagarajan et al. Roll the dice & look before you leap: Going beyond the creative limits of next-token prediction. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2025.

[81] Romera-Paredes et al. Mathematical discoveries from program search with large language models. Nature. 2023.

[82] Novikov et al. AlphaEvolve: A coding agent for scientific and algorithmic discovery. arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.13131. 2025.

[83] Zhang et al. Where You Inject Diversity Matters: A Unified Framework for Diverse Generation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.10302. 2026.

[84] Kim et al. From Noise to Diversity: Random Embedding Injection in LLM Reasoning. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.11936. 2026.

[85] Park et al. Grammar-Aligned Decoding. Neural Information Processing Systems. 2024.

[86] Zeng et al. Large Language Models Explore by Latent Distilling. arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.24927. 2026.

[87] Murthy et al. One fish, two fish, but not the whole sea: Alignment reduces language models' conceptual diversity. North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics. 2025.

[88] Prakash et al. Fine-Tuning Enhances Existing Mechanisms: A Case Study on Entity Tracking. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[89] Oozeer et al. Activation Space Interventions Can Be Transferred Between Large Language Models. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2025.

[90] Du et al. How Post-Training Reshapes LLMs: A Mechanistic View on Knowledge, Truthfulness, Refusal, and Confidence. arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.02904. 2025.

[91] Zhou. Same Targets, Different Computation: How Post-Training Divides Work Across Model Layers. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.07284. 2026.

[92] Zhang et al. Not All Layers Need Tuning: Selective Layer Restoration Recovers Diversity. arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.06665. 2026.

[93] Sumita et al. Controlling the Diversity-Quality Trade-Off of LLMs by Merging Models Before and After Alignment. arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.22999. 2026.

[94] Wang et al. Optimizing Diversity and Quality through Base-Aligned Model Collaboration. arXiv preprint arXiv:2511.05650. 2025.

[95] Peeperkorn et al. Mind the Gap: Conformative Decoding to Improve Output Diversity of Instruction-Tuned Large Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.20956. 2025.

[96] Feng et al. Don't Throw Away Your Pretrained Model. arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.09913. 2025.

[97] Anand et al. Measuring, Localizing, and Ablating Alignment Signatures in LLMs. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.30526. 2026.

[98] Zhou. When RLVR Shrinks the Reasoning Boundary: Diagnosing Pass@k Inversion. arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.20543. 2026.

[99] Duan. What Will Post-Training Fix? Per-Problem Gains Are Shared Across Independent RL Runs, and Existing Checkpoints Predict Them Better Than A Priori Signals. arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.04978. 2026.

[100] Lin et al. The Unlocking Spell on Base LLMs: Rethinking Alignment via In-Context Learning. arXiv preprint arXiv:2312.01552. 2023.

[101] Yang et al. LLM Probability Concentration: How Alignment Shrinks the Generative Horizon.

arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.17871. 2025.

[102] Dang et al. Weight Ensembling Improves Reasoning in Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.10478. 2025.

[103] Nakamura. Measuring Alignment-Induced Activation Shifts Correctly: A Template-Controlled Difference-in-Differences Protocol. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.24583. 2026.

[104] Jerge et al. Perturb the Thought, Not the Pixels: Latent-Space Rollout Diversification for Reinforcement Learning of Vision-Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.21595. 2026.

[105] Bhushan et al. Can LLM Agents Discover? Evaluating Creativity on ML Engineering Tasks. arXiv preprint arXiv:2608.30047. 2026.

[106] Maveli et al. Are you Synthesizing or Recalling? Evaluating LLMs on Algorithmic Code Retrieval. arXiv preprint arXiv:2610.02438. 2026.

[107] Le Bronnec et al. Beyond pass@k: Redundancy-Aware RLVR for Multi-Sample Code Generation. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.28022. 2026.

[108] Mohammadi. Creativity Has Left the Chat: The Price of Debiasing Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2406.05587. 2024.

[109] Nguyen et al. The Reasoning Boundary Paradox: How Reinforcement Learning Constrains Language Models. arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.02230. 2025.

[110] Geiger et al. Finding Alignments Between Interpretable Causal Variables and Distributed Neural Representations. CLeaR (PMLR 236). 2024.

[111] Wu et al. Interpretability at Scale: Identifying Causal Mechanisms in Alpaca. Neural Information Processing Systems. 2023.

[112] Bao et al. Faithful Bi-Directional Model Steering via Distribution Matching and Distributed Interchange Interventions. arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.05234. 2026.

[113] Lieberum et al. Gemma Scope: Open Sparse Autoencoders Everywhere All At Once on Gemma 2. BlackboxNLP Workshop on Analyzing and Interpreting Neural Networks for NLP. 2024.

[114] Rajamanoharan et al. Jumping Ahead: Improving Reconstruction Fidelity with JumpReLU Sparse Autoencoders. arXiv preprint arXiv:2407.14435. 2024.

[115] Micikevicius et al. FP8 Formats for Deep Learning. arXiv preprint arXiv:2209.05433. 2022.

[116] Bhandari et al. Steering Under Compression: Dose-Response, Capability Cost, and Failure Asymmetry in Quantized LLMs. arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.06473. 2026.

[117] Pan et al. LatentQA: Teaching LLMs to Decode Activations Into Natural Language. arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.08686. 2024.

[118] Chen et al. SelfIE: Self-Interpretation of Large Language Model Embeddings. International Conference on Machine Learning. 2024.

[119] Dingeto. Train the Model, Not the Reader: Decodability Supervision for Verifiable Activation Explanations. arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.20379. 2026.

[120] Jacopin. Planning or Improvisation? Stress-Testing the Poetry Planning Site on Open Models and Open Cross-Layer Transcoders. arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.18440. 2026.

[121] Fang et al. Controllable LLM Reasoning via Sparse Autoencoder-Based Steering. Annual

Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics. 2026.

[122] Makelov et al. Is This the Subspace You Are Looking for? An Interpretability Illusion for Subspace Activation Patching. International Conference on Learning Representations. 2024.

[123] Hanna et al. Latent Planning Emerges with Scale. arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.12493. 2026.

[124] Yang et al. Qwen2.5 Technical Report. arXiv preprint arXiv:2412.15115. 2024.

[125] Firth. Bias reduction of maximum likelihood estimates. Biometrika. 1993.

[126] Bonett et al. Sample size requirements for estimating Pearson, Kendall and Spearman correlations. Psychometrika. 2000.

[127] Gwet. Computing inter-rater reliability and its variance in the presence of high agreement. British Journal of Mathematical and Statistical Psychology. 2008.

[128] Fleiss. Measuring nominal scale agreement among many raters. Psychological Bulletin. 1971.

[129] Mantel et al. Statistical aspects of the analysis of data from retrospective studies of disease. Journal of the National Cancer Institute. 1959.

[130] Rahman et al. Steering Code LLMs with Activation Directions for Language and Library Control. arXiv preprint arXiv:2603.23629. 2026.

[131] Jørgensen et al. Steering LLMs? Actually, Sparse Autoencoders can outperform simple baselines. arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.31183. 2026.